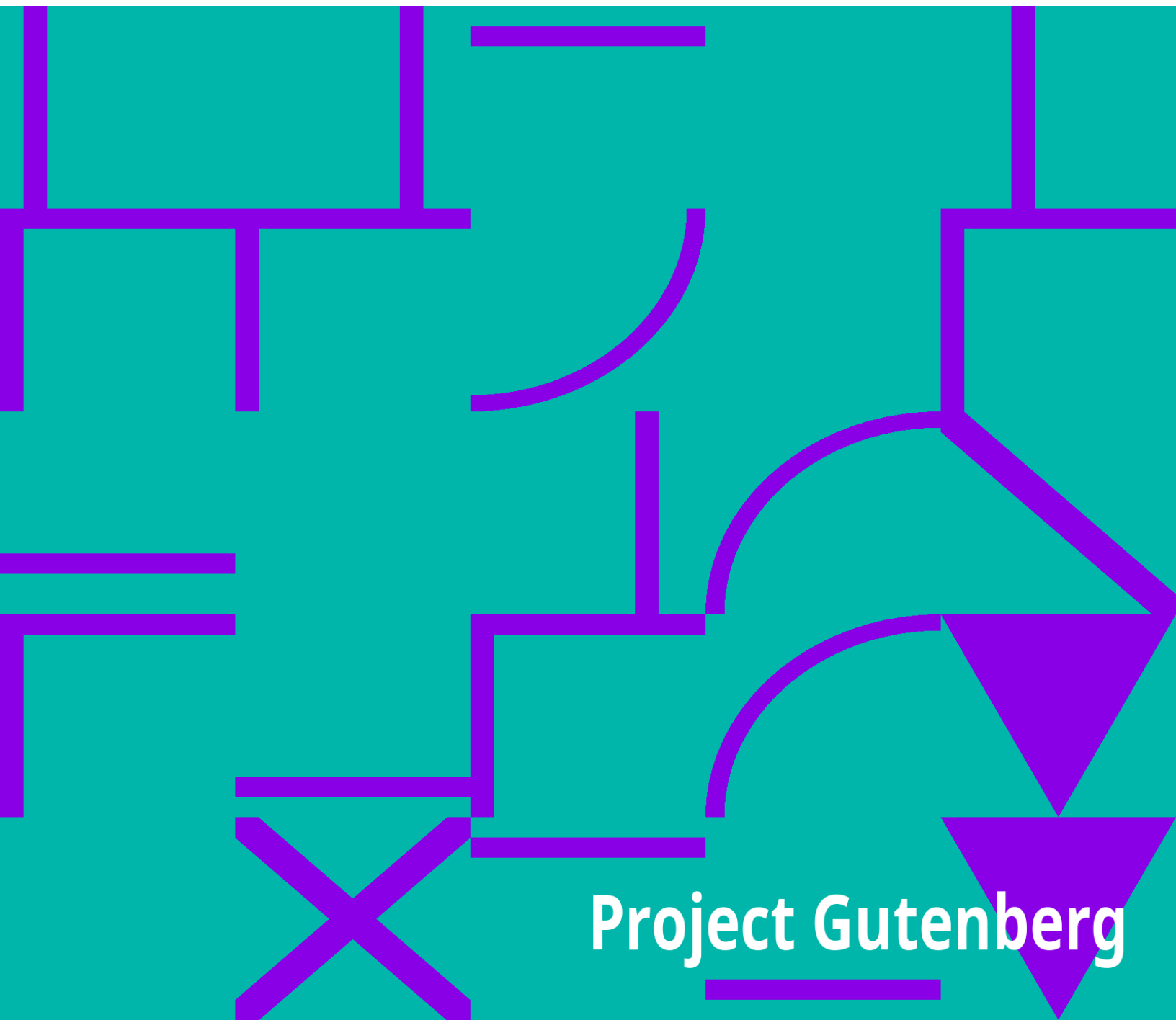


# The Book of Humorous Verse

Carolyn Wells

The background of the lower half of the cover is a teal color. It features a complex, abstract pattern of yellow lines and shapes. These include straight lines of varying lengths, some forming a grid-like structure, and others curving into arcs. There are also solid yellow geometric shapes, including a large triangle pointing downwards on the right side and a large 'X' shape on the left side. The overall effect is a modern, geometric design.

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# The Book of Humorous Verse

Carolyn Wells

An abstract geometric pattern on a teal background, featuring various purple lines, arcs, and shapes. The pattern includes several right angles, a large arc, a smaller arc, a large 'X' shape, and two downward-pointing triangles. The lines are of varying thicknesses and are scattered across the lower half of the cover.

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# THE BOOK OF HUMOROUS VERSE

*Compiled by*  
CAROLYN WELLS  
AUTHOR OF "SUCH NONSENSE,"  
"THE WHIMSEY ANTHOLOGY,"  
ETC., ETC.

NEW YORK  
GEORGE H. DORAN COMPANY

PRINTED IN THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA

TO  
ROBERT CHAPMAN SPRAGUE

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# INTRODUCTION

A hope of immortality and a sense of humor distinguish man from the beasts of the field.

A single exception may be made, perhaps, of the Laughing Hyena, and, on the other hand, not every one of the human race possesses the power of laughter. For those who do, this volume is intended.

And since there can be nothing humorous about an introduction, there can be small need of a lengthy one.

Merely a few explanations of conditions which may be censured by captious critics.

First, the limitations of space had to be recognized. Hence, the book is a compilation, not a collection. It is representative, but not exhaustive. My ambition was toward a volume to which everyone could go, with a surety of finding any one of his favorite humorous poems between these covers. But no covers of one book could insure that, so I reluctantly gave up the dream for a reality which I trust will make it possible for a majority of seekers to find their favorites here.

The compiler's course is a difficult one. The Scylla of Popularity lures him on the one hand, while the Charybdis of the Classical charms him on the other. He has nothing to steer by but his own good taste, and good taste, alack, is greatly a matter of opinion.

And no opinion seemeth good unto an honest compiler, save his own. Wherefore, the choice of these selections, like kissing, went by favor. As to the arrangement of them, every compiler will tell you that Classification is Vexation. And why not? When many a poem may be both Parody and Satire,—both Romance and Cynicism. Wherefore, the compiler sorted with loving care the selections here presented striving to do justice to the verses themselves, and taking a chance on the tolerant good nature of the reader.

For,

"A jest's prosperity lies in the ear  
Of him that hears it.  
Never in the tongue  
Of him that makes it."

Which made me all the more careful to do my authors justice, leaving the  
prosperity of the jests to the hearers.

CAROLYN WELLS.

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# THE BOOK OF HUMOROUS VERSE

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**I**

# BANTER

## THE PLAYED-OUT HUMOURIST

Quixotic is his enterprise and hopeless his adventure is,  
Who seeks for jocularities that haven't yet been said;  
The world has joked incessantly for over fifty centuries,  
And every joke that's possible has long ago been made.  
I started as a humourist with lots of mental fizziness,  
But humour is a drug which it's the fashion to abuse;  
For my stock-in-trade, my fixtures and the good-will of the business  
No reasonable offer I am likely to refuse.  
And if anybody choose  
He may circulate the news  
That no reasonable offer I am likely to refuse.

Oh, happy was that humourist—the first that made a pun at all—  
Who when a joke occurred to him, however poor and mean,  
Was absolutely certain that it never had been done at all—  
How popular at dinners must that humourist have been!  
Oh, the days when some step-father for a query held a handle out,—  
The door-mat from the scraper, is it distant very far?  
And when no one knew where Moses was when Aaron put the candle out,  
And no one had discovered that a door could be a-jar!  
But your modern hearers are  
In their tastes particular,  
And they sneer if you inform them that a door can be a jar!

In search of quip and quiddity I've sat all day alone, apart—  
And all that I could hit on as a problem was—to find  
Analogy between a scrag of mutton and a Bony-part,

Which offers slight employment to the speculative mind.

For you cannot call it very good, however great your charity—

It's not the sort of humour that is greeted with a shout—

And I've come to the conclusion that my mine of jocularly,

In present Anno Domini is worked completely out!

Though the notion you may scout,

I can prove beyond a doubt

That my mine of jocularly is worked completely out!

*W. S. Gilbert.*

---

## THE PRACTICAL JOKER

Oh, what a fund of joy jocund lies hid in harmless hoaxes!

What keen enjoyment springs

From cheap and simple things!

What deep delight from sources trite inventive humour coaxes,

That pain and trouble brew

For every one but you!

Gunpowder placed inside its waist improves a mild Havana,

Its unexpected flash

Burns eyebrows and moustache.

When people dine no kind of wine beats ipecacuanha,

But common sense suggests

You keep it for your guests—

Then naught annoys the organ boys like throwing red hot coppers.

And much amusement bides

In common butter slides;

And stringy snares across the stairs cause unexpected croppers.

Coal scuttles, recollect,



Produce the same effect.

A man possessed  
Of common sense  
Need not invest  
At great expense—

It does not call  
For pocket deep,  
These jokes are all  
Extremely cheap.

If you commence with eighteenpence—it's all you'll have to pay;  
You may command a pleasant and a most instructive day.

A good spring gun breeds endless fun, and makes men jump like rockets—

And turnip heads on posts  
Make very decent ghosts.

Then hornets sting like anything, when placed in waistcoat pockets—

Burnt cork and walnut juice  
Are not without their use.

No fun compares with easy chairs whose seats are stuffed with needles—

Live shrimps their patience tax  
When put down people's backs.

Surprising, too, what one can do with a pint of fat black beetles—

And treacle on a chair  
Will make a Quaker swear!

Then sharp tin tacks  
And pocket squirts—  
And cobbler's wax  
For ladies' skirts—

And slimy slugs  
On bedroom floors—  
And water jugs  
On open doors—

Prepared with these cheap properties, amusing tricks to play  
Upon a friend a man may spend a most delightful day.

*W. S. Gilbert.*

---

### TO PHŒBE

"Gentle, modest little flower,  
Sweet epitome of May,  
Love me but for half an hour,  
Love me, love me, little fay."  
Sentences so fiercely flaming  
In your tiny, shell-like ear,  
I should always be exclaiming  
If I loved you, Phœbe dear.

"Smiles that thrill from any distance  
Shed upon me while I sing!  
Please ecstaticize existence,  
Love me, oh, thou fairy thing!"  
Words like these, outpouring sadly,  
You'd perpetually hear,  
If I loved you fondly, madly;—  
But I do not, Phœbe dear.

*W. S. Gilbert.*

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## MALBROUCK

Malbrouck, the prince of commanders,  
Is gone to the war in Flanders;  
His fame is like Alexander's;  
But when will he come home?

Perhaps at Trinity Feast, or  
Perhaps he may come at Easter.  
Egad! he had better make haste, or  
We fear he may never come.

For Trinity Feast is over,  
And has brought no news from Dover;  
And Easter is past, moreover,  
And Malbrouck still delays.

Milady in her watch-tower  
Spends many a pensive hour,  
Not well knowing why or how her  
Dear lord from England stays.

While sitting quite forlorn in  
That tower, she spies returning  
A page clad in deep mourning,  
With fainting steps and slow.

"O page, prithee, come faster!  
What news do you bring of your master?  
I fear there is some disaster,  
Your looks are so full of woe."

"The news I bring, fair lady,"  
With sorrowful accent said he,  
"Is one you are not ready  
So soon, alas! to hear."

"But since to speak I'm hurried,"  
Added this page, quite flurried,  
"Malbrouck is dead and buried!"  
(And here he shed a tear.)

"He's dead! he's dead as a herring!  
For I beheld his 'berring,'  
And four officers transferring  
His corpse away from the field.

"One officer carried his sabre,  
And he carried it not without labour,  
Much envying his next neighbour,  
Who only bore a shield.

"The third was helmet-bearer—  
That helmet which on its wearer  
Filled all who saw with terror,  
And covered a hero's brains.

"Now, having got so far, I  
Find that (by the Lord Harry!)  
The fourth is left nothing to carry;  
So there the thing remains."

Translated by *Father Prout*.

---

## MARK TWAIN: A PIPE DREAM

Well I recall how first I met  
Mark Twain—an infant barely three  
Rolling a tiny cigarette  
While cooing on his nurse's knee.

Since then in every sort of place  
I've met with Mark and heard him joke,  
Yet how can I describe his face?  
I never saw it for the smoke.

At school he won a *smokership*,  
At Harvard College (Cambridge, Mass.)  
His name was soon on every lip,  
They made him "smoker" of his class.

Who will forget his smoking bout  
With Mount Vesuvius—our cheers—  
When Mount Vesuvius went out  
And didn't smoke again for years?

The news was flashed to England's King,  
Who begged Mark Twain to come and stay,  
Offered him dukedoms—anything  
To smoke the London fog away.

But Mark was firm. "I bow," said he,  
"To no imperial command,  
No ducal coronet for me,  
My smoke is for my native land!"

For Mark there waits a brighter crown!  
When Peter comes his card to read—  
He'll take the sign "No Smoking" down,  
Then Heaven will be Heaven indeed.

*Oliver Herford.*

---

**FROM A FULL HEART**

In days of peace my fellow-men  
Rightly regarded me as more like  
A Bishop than a Major-Gen.,  
And nothing since has made me warlike;  
But when this age-long struggle ends  
And I have seen the Allies dish up  
The goose of Hindenburg—oh, friends!  
I shall out-bish the mildest Bishop.

*When the War is over and the Kaiser's out of print  
I'm going to buy some tortoises and watch the beggars sprint;  
When the War is over and the sword at last we sheathe  
I'm going to keep a jelly-fish and listen to it breathe.*

I never really longed for gore,  
And any taste for red corpuscles  
That lingered with me left before  
The German troops had entered Brussels.  
In early days the Colonel's "'Shun!"  
Froze me; and as the war grew older  
The noise of some one else's gun  
Left me considerably colder.

*When the War is over and the battle has been won  
I'm going to buy a barnacle and take it for a run;  
When the War is over and the German fleet we sink  
I'm going to keep a silkworm's egg and listen to it think.*

The Captains and the Kings depart—  
It may be so, but not lieutenants;  
Dawn after weary dawn I start  
The never ending round of penance;  
One rock amid the welter stands  
On which my gaze is fixed intently:  
An after-life in quiet lands  
Lived very lazily and gently.

*When the War is over and we've done the Belgians proud  
I'm going to keep a chrysalis and read to it aloud;  
When the War is over and we've finished up the show  
I'm going to plant a lemon pip and listen to it grow.*

Oh, I'm tired of the noise and turmoil of battle,  
And I'm even upset by the lowing of cattle,  
And the clang of the bluebells is death to my liver,  
And the roar of the dandelion gives me a shiver,  
And a glacier, in movement, is much too exciting,  
And I'm nervous, when standing on one, of alighting—  
Give me Peace; that is all, that is all that I seek....  
Say, starting on Saturday week.

*A. A. Milne.*

---

## **THE ULTIMATE JOY**

I have felt the thrill of passion in the poet's mystic book  
And I've lingered in delight to catch the rhythm of the brook;  
I've felt the ecstasy that comes when prima donnas reach  
For upper C and hold it in a long, melodious screech.  
And yet the charm of all these blissful memories fades away  
As I think upon the fortune that befell the other day,  
As I bring to recollection, with a joyous, wistful sigh,  
That I woke and felt the need of extra covers in July.

Oh, eerie hour of drowsiness—'twas like a fairy spell,  
That respite from the terrors we have known, alas, so well,  
The malevolent mosquito, with a limp and idle bill,  
Hung supinely from the ceiling, all exhausted by his chill.  
And the early morning sunbeam lost his customary leer

And brought a gracious greeting and a prophecy of cheer;  
A generous affability reached up from earth to sky,  
When I woke and felt the need of extra covers in July.

In every life there comes a time of happiness supreme,  
When joy becomes reality and not a glittering dream.  
'Tis less appreciated, but it's worth a great deal more  
Than tides which taken at their flood lead on to fortune's shore.  
How vain is Art's illusion, and how potent Nature's sway  
When once in kindly mood she deigns to waft our woes away!  
And the memory will cheer me, though all other pleasures fly,  
Of how I woke and needed extra covers in July.

*Unknown.*

---

## **OLD FASHIONED FUN**

When that old joke was new,  
It was not hard to joke,  
And puns we now pooh-pooh,  
Great laughter would provoke.

True wit was seldom heard,  
And humor shown by few,  
When reign'd King George the Third,  
And that old joke was new.

It passed indeed for wit,  
Did this achievement rare,  
When down your friend would sit,  
To steal away his chair.

You brought him to the floor,



You bruised him black and blue,  
And this would cause a roar,  
When your old joke was new.

*W. M. Thackeray.*

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## WHEN MOONLIKE ORE THE HAZURE SEAS

When moonlike ore the hazure seas  
In soft effulgence swells,  
When silver jews and balmy breaze  
Bend down the Lily's bells;  
When calm and deap, the rosy sleap  
Has lapt your soal in dreems,  
R Hangeline! R lady mine!  
Dost thou remember Jeames?

I mark thee in the Marble all,  
Where England's loveliest shine—  
I say the fairest of them hall  
Is Lady Hangeline.  
My soul, in desolate eclipse,  
With recollection teems—  
And then I hask, with weeping lips,  
Dost thou remember Jeames?

Away! I may not tell thee hall  
This soughring heart endures—  
There is a lonely sperrit-call  
That Sorrow never cures;  
There is a little, little Star,  
That still above me beams;

It is the Star of Hope—but ar!  
Dost thou remember Jeames?

*W. M. Thackeray.*

---

## WHEN THE FROST IS ON THE PUNKIN

When the frost is on the punkin and the fodder's in the shock,  
And you hear the kyouch and gobble of the struttin' turkey-cock,  
And the clackin' of the guineys, and the cluckin' of the hens,  
And the rooster's hallylooyer as he tiptoes on the fence;  
O it's then's the times a feller is a-feelin' at his best,  
With the risin' sun to greet him from a night of peaceful rest,  
As he leaves the house, bare-headed, and goes out to feed the stock,  
When the frost is on the punkin and the fodder's in the shock.

They's something kindo' hearty-like about the atmosphere,  
When the heat of summer's over and the coolin' fall is here—  
Of course we miss the flowers, and the blossoms on the trees,  
And the mumble of the hummin'-birds and buzzin' of the bees;  
But the air's so appetisin'; and the landscape through the haze  
Of a crisp and sunny morning of the airly autumn days  
Is a pictur that no painter has the colorin' to mock—  
When the frost is on the punkin and the fodder's in the shock.

The husky, rusty rustle of the tassels of the corn,  
And the raspin' of the tangled leaves, as golden as the morn;  
The stubble in the furries—kindo' lonesome-like, but still  
A-preachin' sermons to us of the barns they growed to fill;  
The strawstack in the medder, and the reaper in the shed;  
The hosses in theyr stalls below—the clover overhead!—  
O, it sets my heart a-clickin' like the tickin' of a clock,  
When the frost is on the punkin and the fodder's in the shock!

*James Whitcomb Riley.*

---

## **TWO MEN**

There be two men of all mankind  
That I should like to know about;  
But search and question where I will,  
I cannot ever find them out.

Melchizedek he praised the Lord,  
And gave some wine to Abraham;  
But who can tell what else he did  
Must be more learned than I am.

Ucalegon he lost his house  
When Agamemnon came to Troy;  
But who can tell me who he was—  
I'll pray the gods to give him joy.

There be two men of all mankind  
That I'm forever thinking on;  
They chase me everywhere I go,—  
Melchizedek, Ucalegon.

*Edwin Arlington Robinson.*

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## **A FAMILIAR LETTER TO SEVERAL CORRESPONDENTS**

Yes, write if you want to—there's nothing like trying;  
Who knows what a treasure your casket may hold?  
I'll show you that rhyming's as easy as lying,  
If you'll listen to me while the art I unfold.

Here's a book full of words: one can choose as he fancies,  
As a painter his tint, as a workman his tool;  
Just think! all the poems and plays and romances  
Were drawn out of this, like the fish from a pool!

You can wander at will through its syllabled mazes,  
And take all you want—not a copper they cost;  
What is there to hinder your picking out phrases  
For an epic as clever as "Paradise Lost"?

Don't mind if the index of sense is at zero;  
Use words that run smoothly, whatever they mean;  
Leander and Lillian and Lillibullero  
Are much the same thing in the rhyming machine.

There are words so delicious their sweetness will smother  
That boarding-school flavour of which we're afraid;  
There is "lush" is a good one and "swirl" is another;  
Put both in one stanza, its fortune is made.

With musical murmurs and rhythmical closes  
You can cheat us of smiles when you've nothing to tell;  
You hand us a nosegay of milliner's roses,  
And we cry with delight, "Oh, how sweet they do smell!"

Perhaps you will answer all needful conditions  
For winning the laurels to which you aspire,  
By docking the tails of the two prepositions  
I' the style o' the bards you so greatly admire.

As for subjects of verse, they are only too plenty

For ringing the changes on metrical chimes;  
A maiden, a moonbeam, a lover of twenty,  
Have filled that great basket with bushels of rhymes.

Let me show you a picture—'tis far from irrelevant—  
By a famous old hand in the arts of design;  
'Tis only a photographed sketch of an elephant;  
The name of the draughtsman was Rembrandt of Rhine.

How easy! no troublesome colours to lay on;  
It can't have fatigued him, no, not in the least;  
A dash here and there with a haphazard crayon,  
And there stands the wrinkled-skinned, baggy-limbed beast.

Just so with your verse—'tis as easy as sketching;  
You can reel off a song without knitting your brow,  
As lightly as Rembrandt a drawing or etching;  
It is nothing at all, if you only know how.

Well, imagine you've printed your volume of verses;  
Your forehead is wreathed with the garland of fame;  
Your poem the eloquent school-boy rehearses;  
Her album the school-girl presents for your name.

Each morning the post brings you autograph letters;  
You'll answer them promptly—an hour isn't much  
For the honour of sharing a page with your betters,  
With magistrates, members of Congress, and such.

Of course you're delighted to serve the committees  
That come with requests from the country all round;  
You would grace the occasion with poems and ditties  
When they've got a new school-house, or poor-house, or pound.

With a hymn for the saints, and a song for the sinners,  
You go and are welcome wherever you please;  
You're a privileged guest at all manner of dinners;

You've a seat on the platform among the grandees.

At length your mere presence becomes a sensation;  
Your cup of enjoyment is filled to its brim  
With the pleasure Horatian of digimonstration,  
As the whisper runs round of "That's he!" or "That's him!"

But, remember, O dealer in phrases sonorous,  
So daintily chosen, so tunefully matched,  
Though you soar with the wings of the cherubim o'er us,  
The ovum was human from which you were hatched.

No will of your own, with its puny compulsion,  
Can summon the spirit that quickens the lyre;  
It comes, if at all, like the sibyl's convulsion,  
And touches the brain with a finger of fire.

So, perhaps, after all, it's as well to be quiet,  
If you've nothing you think is worth saying in prose,  
As to furnish a meal of their cannibal diet  
To the critics, by publishing, as you propose.

But it's all of no use, and I'm sorry I've written;  
I shall see your thin volume some day on my shelf;  
For the rhyming tarantula surely has bitten,  
And music must cure you, so pipe it yourself.

*Oliver Wendell Holmes.*

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## THE HEIGHT OF THE RIDICULOUS

I wrote some lines once on a time  
In wondrous merry mood,

And thought, as usual, men would say  
They were exceeding good.

They were so queer, so very queer,  
I laughed as I would die;  
Albeit, in the general way,  
A sober man am I.

I called my servant, and he came;  
How kind it was of him,  
To mind a slender man like me,  
He of the mighty limb!

"These to the printer," I exclaimed,  
And, in my humorous way,  
I added (as a trifling jest),  
"There'll be the devil to pay."

He took the paper, and I watched,  
And saw him peep within;  
At the first line he read, his face  
Was all upon a grin.

He read the next, the grin grew broad,  
And shot from ear to ear;  
He read the third, a chuckling noise  
I now began to hear.

The fourth, he broke into a roar;  
The fifth, his waistband split;  
The sixth, he burst five buttons off,  
And tumbled in a fit.

Ten days and nights, with sleepless eye,  
I watched that wretched man,  
And since, I never dare to write  
As funny as I can.

*Oliver Wendell Holmes.*

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## **SHAKE, MULLEARY AND GO-ETHE**

### **I**

I have a bookcase, which is what  
Many much better men have not.  
There are no books inside, for books,  
I am afraid, might spoil its looks.  
But I've three busts, all second-hand,  
Upon the top. You understand  
I could not put them underneath—  
Shake, Mulleary and Go-ethe.

### **II**

Shake was a dramatist of note;  
He lived by writing things to quote,  
He long ago put on his shroud:  
Some of his works are rather loud.  
His bald-spot's dusty, I suppose.  
I know there's dust upon his nose.  
I'll have to give each nose a sheath—  
Shake, Mulleary and Go-ethe.

### **III**

Mulleary's line was quite the same;  
He has more hair, but far less fame.  
I would not from that fame retrench—  
But he is foreign, being French.  
Yet high his haughty head he heaves,  
The only one done up in leaves,



They're rather limited on wreath—  
Shake, Mulleary and Go-ethe.

IV

Go-ethe wrote in the German tongue:  
He must have learned it very young.  
His nose is quite a butt for scoff,  
Although an inch of it is off.  
He did quite nicely for the Dutch;  
But here he doesn't count for much.  
They all are off their native heath—  
Shake, Mulleary and Go-ethe.

V

They sit there, on their chests, as bland  
As if they were not second-hand.  
I do not know of what they think,  
Nor why they never frown or wink,  
But why from smiling they refrain  
I think I clearly can explain:  
They none of them could show much teeth—  
Shake, Mulleary and Go-ethe.

*H. C. Bunner.*

---

**A RONDELAY**

Man is for woman made,  
And woman made for man:  
As the spur is for the jade,  
As the scabbard for the blade,  
As for liquor is the can,  
So man's for woman made,

And woman made for man.

As the sceptre to be sway'd,  
As to night the serenade,  
As for pudding is the pan,  
As to cool us is the fan,  
So man's for woman made,  
And woman made for man.

Be she widow, wife, or maid,  
Be she wanton, be she staid,  
Be she well or ill array'd,  
So man's for woman made,  
And woman made for man.

*Peter A. Motteux.*

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## WINTER DUSK

The prospect is bare and white,  
And the air is crisp and chill;  
While the ebon wings of night  
Are spread on the distant hill.

The roar of the stormy sea  
Seem the dirges shrill and sharp  
That winter plays on the tree—  
His wild Æolian harp.

In the pool that darkly creeps  
In ripples before the gale,  
A star like a lily sleeps  
And wiggles its silver tail.

R. K. Munkittrick.

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## COMIC MISERIES

My dear young friend, whose shining wit  
Sets all the room a-blaze,  
Don't think yourself a "happy dog,"  
For all your merry ways;  
But learn to wear a sober phiz,  
Be stupid, if you can,  
It's such a very serious thing  
To be a funny man!

You're at an evening party, with  
A group of pleasant folks,—  
You venture quietly to crack  
The least of little jokes,—  
A lady doesn't catch the point,  
And begs you to explain—  
Alas for one that drops a jest  
And takes it up again!

You're talking deep philosophy  
With very special force,  
To edify a clergyman  
With suitable discourse,—  
You think you've got him—when he calls  
A friend across the way,  
And begs you'll say that funny thing  
You said the other day!

You drop a pretty *jeu-de-mot*  
Into a neighbor's ears,

Who likes to give you credit for  
The clever thing he hears,  
And so he hawks your jest about,  
The old authentic one,  
Just breaking off the point of it,  
And leaving out the pun!

By sudden change in politics,  
Or sadder change in Polly,  
You, lose your love, or loaves, and fall  
A prey to melancholy,  
While everybody marvels why  
Your mirth is under ban,—  
They think your very grief "a joke,"  
You're such a funny man!

You follow up a stylish card  
That bids you come and dine,  
And bring along your freshest wit  
(To pay for musty wine),  
You're looking very dismal, when  
My lady bounces in,  
And wonders what you're thinking of  
And why you don't begin!

You're telling to a knot of friends  
A fancy-tale of woes  
That cloud your matrimonial sky,  
And banish all repose—  
A solemn lady overhears  
The story of your strife,  
And tells the town the pleasant news:  
You quarrel with your wife!

My dear young friend, whose shining wit  
Sets all the room a-blaze,  
Don't think yourself "a happy dog,"

For all your merry ways;  
But learn to wear a sober phiz,  
Be stupid, if you can,  
It's such a very serious thing  
To be a funny man!

*John G. Saxe.*

---

## EARLY RISING

"God bless the man who first invented sleep!"  
So Sancho Panza said, and so say I:  
And bless him, also, that he didn't keep  
His great discovery to himself; nor try  
To make it—as the lucky fellow might—  
A close monopoly by patent-right!

Yes—bless the man who first invented sleep,  
(I really can't avoid the iteration;)  
But blast the man, with curses loud and deep,  
Whate'er the rascal's name, or age, or station,  
Who first invented, and went round advising,  
That artificial cut-off—Early Rising!

"Rise with the lark, and with the lark to bed,"  
Observes some solemn, sentimental owl;  
Maxims like these are very cheaply said;  
But, ere you make yourself a fool or fowl,  
Pray just inquire about his rise and fall,  
And whether larks have any beds at all!

The time for honest folks to be a-bed  
Is in the morning, if I reason right;

And he who cannot keep his precious head  
Upon his pillow till it's fairly light,  
And so enjoy his forty morning winks,  
Is up to knavery; or else—he drinks!

Thompson, who sung about the "Seasons," said  
It was a glorious thing to *rise* in season;  
But then he said it—lying—in his bed,  
At ten o'clock A.M.,—the very reason  
He wrote so charmingly. The simple fact is  
His preaching wasn't sanctioned by his practice.

'Tis, doubtless, well to be sometimes awake,—  
Awake to duty, and awake to truth,—  
But when, alas! a nice review we take  
Of our best deeds and days, we find, in sooth,  
The hours that leave the slightest cause to weep  
Are those we passed in childhood or asleep!

'Tis beautiful to leave the world awhile  
For the soft visions of the gentle night;  
And free, at last, from mortal care or guile,  
To live as only in the angel's sight,  
In sleep's sweet realm so cosily shut in,  
Where, at the worst, we only *dream* of sin!

So let us sleep, and give the Maker praise.  
I like the lad who, when his father thought  
To clip his morning nap by hackneyed phrase  
Of vagrant worm by early songster caught,  
Cried, "Served him right!—it's not at all surprising;  
The worm was punished, sir, for early rising!"

*John G. Saxe.*

---

## TO THE PLIOCENE SKULL

"Speak, O man less recent!

Fragmentary fossil!

Primal pioneer of pliocene formation,

Hid in lowest drifts below the earliest stratum

Of volcanic tufa!

"Older than the beasts, the oldest Palæotherium;

Older than the trees, the oldest Cryptogami;

Older than the hills, those infantile eruptions

Of earth's epidermis!

"Eo—Mio—Plio—whatsoever the 'cene' was

That those vacant sockets filled with awe and wonder,—

Whether shores Devonian or Silurian beaches,—

Tell us thy strange story!

"Or has the professor slightly antedated

By some thousand years thy advent on this planet,

Giving thee an air that's somewhat better fitted

For cold-blooded creatures?

"Wert thou true spectator of that mighty forest

When above thy head the stately Sigillaria

Reared its columned trunks in that remote and distant

Carboniferous epoch?

"Tell us of that scene—the dim and watery woodland,

Songless, silent, hushed, with never bird or insect,

Veiled with spreading fronds and screened with tall club-mosses,

Lycopodiacea,—

"When beside thee walked the solemn Plesiosaurus,

And all around thee crept the festive Ichthyosaurus,

While from time to time above thee flew and circled

Cheerful Pterodactyls;—

"Tell us of thy food,—those half-marine refectations,  
Crinoids on the shell, and Brachipods *au naturel*,—  
Cuttle-fish to which the *pieuvre* of Victor Hugo  
Seems a periwinkle.

"Speak, thou awful vestige of the Earth's creation—  
Solitary fragment of remains organic!  
Tell the wondrous secret of thy past existence—  
Speak! thou oldest primate!"

Even as I gazed, a thrill of the maxilla,  
And a lateral movement of the condyloid process,  
With post-pliocene sounds of healthy mastication,  
Ground the teeth together.

And, from that imperfect dental exhibition,  
Stained with expressed juices of the weed Nicotian,  
Came these hollow accents, blent with softer murmurs  
Of expectoration:

"Which my name is Bowers, and my crust was busted  
Falling down a shaft in Calaveras county,  
But I'd take it kindly if you'd send the pieces  
Home to old Missouri!"

*Bret Harte.*

---

## ODE TO WORK IN SPRINGTIME

Oh, would that working I might shun,  
From labour my connection sever,



That I might do a bit—or none  
Whatever!

That I might wander over hills,  
Establish friendship with a daisy,  
O'er pretty things like daffodils  
Go crazy!

That I might at the heavens gaze,  
Concern myself with nothing weighty,  
Loaf, at a stretch, for seven days—  
Or eighty.

Why can't I cease a slave to be,  
And taste existence beatific  
On some fair island, hid in the  
Pacific?

Instead of sitting at a desk  
'Mid undone labours, grimly lurking—  
Oh, say, what is there picturesque  
In working?

But no!—to loaf were misery!—  
I love to work! Hang isles of coral!  
(To end this otherwise would be  
Immoral!)

*Thomas R. Ybarra.*

---

**OLD STUFF**

If I go to see the play,  
Of the story I am certain;  
Promptly it gets under way  
With the lifting of the curtain.  
Builted all that's said and done  
On the ancient recipe—  
'Tis the same old Two and One:  
*A and B in love with C.*

If I read the latest book,  
There's the mossy situation;  
One may confidently look  
For the trite triangulation.  
Old as time, but ever new,  
Seemingly, this tale of Three—  
Same old yarn of One and Two:  
*A and C in love with B.*

If I cast my eyes around,  
Far and near and middle distance,  
Still the formula is found  
In our everyday existence.  
Everywhere I look I see—  
Fact or fiction, life or play—  
Still the little game of Three:  
*B and C in love with A.*

While the ancient law fulfills,  
Myriad moons shall wane and wax.  
Jack must have his pair of Jills,  
Jill must have her pair of Jacks.

*Bert Leston Taylor.*

---

## TO MINERVA

My temples throb, my pulses boil,  
I'm sick of Song and Ode and Ballad—  
So Thyrsis, take the midnight oil,  
And pour it on a lobster salad.

My brain is dull, my sight is foul,  
I cannot write a verse, or read—  
Then Pallas, take away thine Owl,  
And let us have a Lark instead.

*Thomas Hood.*

---

## THE LEGEND OF HEINZ VON STEIN

Out rode from his wild, dark castle  
The terrible Heinz von Stein;  
He came to the door of a tavern  
And gazed on its swinging sign.

He sat himself down at a table,  
And growled for a bottle of wine;  
Up came with a flask and a corkscrew  
A maiden of beauty divine.

Then, seized with a deep love-longing,  
He uttered, "O damosel mine,  
Suppose you just give a few kisses  
To the valorous Ritter von Stein!"

But she answered, "The kissing business

Is entirely out of my line;  
And I certainly will not begin it  
On a countenance ugly as thine!"

Oh, then the bold knight was angry,  
And cursed both coarse and fine;  
And asked, "How much is the swindle  
For your sour and nasty wine?"

And fiercely he rode to the castle  
And sat himself down to dine;  
And this is the dreadful legend  
Of the terrible Heinz von Stein.

*Charles Godfrey Leland.*

---

## **THE TRUTH ABOUT HORACE**

It is very aggravating  
To hear the solemn prating  
Of the fossils who are stating  
That old Horace was a prude;  
When we know that with the ladies  
He was always raising Hades,  
And with many an escapade his  
Best productions are imbued.

There's really not much harm in a  
Large number of his carmina,  
But these people find alarm in a  
Few records of his acts;

So they'd squelch the muse caloric,

And to students sophomoric  
They'd present as metaphoric  
What old Horace meant for facts.

We have always thought 'em lazy;  
Now we adjudge 'em crazy!  
Why, Horace was a daisy  
That was very much alive!  
And the wisest of us know him  
As his Lydia verses show him,—  
Go, read that virile poem,—  
It is No. 25.

He was a very owl, sir,  
And starting out to prowl, sir,  
You bet he made Rome howl, sir,  
Until he filled his date;  
With a massic-laden ditty  
And a classic maiden pretty,  
He painted up the city,  
And Mæcenæ paid the freight!

*Eugene Field.*

---

## **PROPINQUITY NEEDED**

Celestine Silvousplait Justine de Mouton Rosalie,  
A coryphée who lived and danced in naughty, gay Paree,  
Was every bit as pretty as a French girl e'er can be  
(Which isn't saying much).

Maurice Boulanger (there's a name that would adorn a king),  
But Morris Baker was the name they called the man I sing.

He lived in New York City in the Street that's labeled Spring  
(Chosen because it rhymed).

Now Baker was a lonesome youth and wanted to be wed,  
And for a wife, all over town he hunted, it is said;  
And up and down Fifth Avenue he oftentimes wandered  
(He was a peripatetic Baker, he was).

And had he met Celestine, not a doubt but Cupid's darts  
Would in a trice have wounded both of their fond, loving hearts;  
But he has never left New York to stray in foreign parts  
(Because he hasn't the price).

And she has never left Paree and so, of course, you see  
There's not the slightest chance at all she'll marry Morris B.  
For love to get well started, really needs propinquity  
(Hence my title).

*Charles Battell Loomis.*

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## **IN THE CATACOMBS**

Sam Brown was a fellow from way down East,  
Who never was "staggered" in the least.  
No tale of marvellous beast or bird  
Could match the stories he had heard;  
No curious place or wondrous view  
"Was ekil to Podunk, I tell yu."

If they told him of Italy's sunny clime,  
"Maine kin beat it, every time!"  
If they marvelled at Ætna's fount of fire,  
They roused his ire:

With an injured air  
He'd reply, "I swear  
I don't think much of a smokin' hill;  
We've got a moderate little rill  
Kin make yer old volcaner still;  
Jes' pour old Kennebec down the crater,  
'N' I guess it'll cool her fiery nater!"

They showed him a room where a queen had slept;  
""Twan't up to the tavern daddy kept."  
They showed him Lucerne; but he had drunk  
From the beautiful Molechunkamunk.  
They took him at last to ancient Rome,  
And inveigled him into a catacomb:

Here they plied him with draughts of wine,  
Though he vowed old cider was twice as fine,  
Till the fumes of Falernian filled his head,  
And he slept as sound as the silent dead;  
They removed a mummy to make him room,  
And laid him at length in the rocky tomb.

They piled old skeletons round the stone,  
Set a "dip" in a candlestick of bone,  
And left him to slumber there alone;  
Then watched from a distance the taper's gleam,  
Waiting to jeer at his frightened scream,  
When he should wake from his drunken dream.

After a time the Yankee woke,  
But instantly saw through the flimsy joke;  
So never a cry or shout he uttered,  
But solemnly rose, and slowly muttered:  
"I see how it is. It's the judgment day,  
We've all been dead and stowed away;  
All these stone furreners sleepin' yet,  
An' I'm the fust one up, you bet!

Can't none o' you Romans start, I wonder?  
*United States ahead, by thunder!"*

*Harlan Hoge Ballard.*

---

## OUR NATIVE BIRDS

Alone I sit at eventide;  
The twilight glory pales,  
And o'er the meadows far and wide  
I hear the bobolinks—  
(We have no nightingales!)

Song-sparrows warble on the tree,  
I hear the purling brook,  
And from the old manse on the lea  
Flies slow the cawing crow—  
(In England 'twere a rook!)

The last faint golden beams of day  
Still glow on cottage panes,  
And on their lingering homeward way  
Walk weary laboring men—  
(Alas! we have no swains!)

From farmyards, down fair rural glades  
Come sounds of tinkling bells,  
And songs of merry brown milkmaids  
Sweeter than catbird's strains—  
(I should say Philomel's!)

I could sit here till morning came,  
All through the night hours dark,



Until I saw the sun's bright flame  
And heard the oriole—  
(Alas! we have no lark!)

We have no leas, no larks, no rooks,  
No swains, no nightingales,  
No singing milkmaids (save in books)  
The poet does his best:—  
It is the rhyme that fails.

*Nathan Haskell Dole.*

---

## **THE PRAYER OF CYRUS BROWN**

"The proper way for a man to pray,"  
Said Deacon Lemuel Keyes,  
"And the only proper attitude  
Is down upon his knees."

"No, I should say the way to pray,"  
Said Rev. Doctor Wise,  
"Is standing straight with outstretched arms  
And rapt and upturned eyes."

"Oh, no; no, no," said Elder Slow,  
"Such posture is too proud:  
A man should pray with eyes fast closed  
And head contritely bowed."

"It seems to me his hands should be  
Austerely clasped in front.  
With both thumbs pointing toward the ground,"  
Said Rev. Doctor Blunt.

"Las' year I fell in Hodgkin's well  
Head first," said Cyrus Brown,  
"With both my heels a-stickin' up,  
My head a-pinting down;

"An' I made a prayer right then an' there—  
Best prayer I ever said,  
The prayingest prayer I ever prayed,  
A-standing on my head."

*Sam Walter Foss.*

---

## **ERRING IN COMPANY**

"If I have erred, I err in company with Abraham Lincoln."—  
*Theodore Roosevelt.*

If e'er my rhyming be at fault,  
If e'er I chance to scribble dope,  
If that my metre ever halt,  
I err in company with Pope.

An that my grammar go awry,  
An that my English be askew,  
Sooth, I can prove an alibi—  
The Bard of Avon did it too.

If often toward the bottled grape  
My errant fancy fondly turns,  
Remember, leering jackanape,  
I err in company with Burns.

If now and then I sigh "Mine own!"  
Unto another's wedded wife,  
Remember, I am not alone—  
Hast ever read Lord Byron's Life?

If frequently I fret and fume,  
And absolutely will not smile,  
I err in company with Hume,  
Old Socrates and T. Carlyle.

If e'er I fail in etiquette,  
And foozle on The Proper Stuff  
Regarding manners, don't forget  
A. Tennyson's were pretty tough.

Eke if I err upon the side  
Of talking overmuch of Me,

I err, it cannot be denied,  
In most illustrious company.

*Franklin P. Adams.*

---

## **CUPID**

Why was Cupid a boy,  
And why a boy was he?  
He should have been a girl,  
For aught that I can see.

For he shoots with his bow,  
And the girl shoots with her eye;  
And they both are merry and glad,  
And laugh when we do cry.

Then to make Cupid a boy  
Was surely a woman's plan,  
For a boy never learns so much  
Till he has become a man.

And then he's so pierced with cares,  
And wounded with arrowy smarts,  
That the whole business of his life  
Is to pick out the heads of the darts.

*William Blake.*

---

## **IF WE DIDN'T HAVE TO EAT**

Life would be an easy matter  
If we didn't have to eat.  
If we never had to utter,  
"Won't you pass the bread and butter,  
Likewise push along that platter  
Full of meat?"  
Yes, if food were obsolete  
Life would be a jolly treat,  
If we didn't—shine or shower,  
Old or young, 'bout every hour—  
Have to eat, eat, eat, eat, eat—  
'Twould be jolly if we didn't have to eat.

We could save a lot of money  
If we didn't have to eat.  
Could we cease our busy buying,  
Baking, broiling, brewing, frying,  
Life would then be oh, so sunny  
And complete;  
And we wouldn't fear to greet  
Every grocer in the street  
If we didn't—man and woman,  
Every hungry, helpless human—  
Have to eat, eat, eat, eat, eat—  
We'd save money if we didn't have to eat.

All our worry would be over  
If we didn't have to eat.  
Would the butcher, baker, grocer  
Get our hard-earned dollars? No, Sir!  
We would then be right in clover  
Cool and sweet.  
Want and hunger we could cheat,  
And we'd get there with both feet,  
If we didn't—poor or wealthy,  
Halt or nimble, sick or healthy—

Have to eat, eat, eat, eat, eat,  
We could get there if we didn't have to eat.

*Nixon Waterman.*

---

## TO MY EMPTY PURSE

To you, my purse, and to none other wight,  
Complain I, for ye be my lady dere;  
I am sorry now that ye be light,  
For, certes, ye now make me heavy chere;  
Me were as lefe be laid upon a bere,  
For which unto your mercy thus I crie,  
Be heavy againe, or els mote I die.

Now vouchsafe this day or it be night,  
That I of you the blissful sowne may here,  
Or see your color like the sunne bright,  
That of yellowness had never pere;  
Ye are my life, ye be my hertes stere,  
Queen of comfort and of good companie,  
Be heavy againe, or els mote I die.

Now purse, thou art to me my lives light,  
And saviour, as downe in this world here,  
Out of this towne helpe me by your might,  
Sith that you will not be my treasure,  
For I am slave as nere as any frere,  
But I pray unto your curtesie,  
Be heavy againe, or els mote I die.

*Geoffrey Chaucer.*

---

## THE BIRTH OF SAINT PATRICK

On the eighth day of March it was, some people say,  
That Saint Pathrick at midnight he first saw the day;  
While others declare 'twas the ninth he was born,  
And 'twas all a mistake between midnight and morn;  
For mistakes *will* occur in a hurry and shock,  
And some blam'd the baby—and some blam'd the clock—  
Till with all their cross-questions sure no one could know,  
If the child was too fast—or the clock was too slow.

Now the first faction fight in ould Ireland, they say,  
Was all on account of Saint Pathrick's birthday,  
Some fought for the eighth—for the ninth more would die.  
And who wouldn't see right, sure they blacken'd his eye!  
At last, *both* the factions so positive grew,  
That *each* kept a birthday, so Pat then had *two*,  
Till Father Mulcahy, who showed them their sins,  
Said, "No one could have two birthdays but a *twins*."

Says he, "Boys, don't be fightin' for eight or for nine,  
Don't be always dividin'—but sometimes combine;  
Combine eight with nine, and seventeen is the mark,  
So let that be his birthday."—"Amen," says the clerk.  
"If he wasn't a *twins*, sure our hist'ry will show—  
That, at least, he's worth any *two* saints that we know!"  
Then they all got blind dhrunk—which complate'd their bliss,  
And we keep up the practice from that day to this.

*Samuel Lover.*

---

## HER LITTLE FEET

Her little feet! ... Beneath us ranged the sea,  
    She sat, from sun and wind umbrella-shaded,  
One shoe above the other danglely,  
    And lo! a Something exquisitely graded,  
Brown rings and white, distracting—to the knee!

The band was loud. A wild waltz melody  
    Flowed rhythmic forth. The nobodies paraded.  
And thro' my dream went pulsing fast and free:  
    Her little feet.

Till she made room for some one. It was He!  
    A port-wine flavored He, a He who traded,  
Rich, rosy, round, obese to a degree!  
A sense of injury overmastered me.  
    Quite bulbously his ample boots upbraided  
    Her little feet.

*William Ernest Henley.*

---

## SCHOOL

If there is a vile, pernicious,  
    Wicked and degraded rule,  
Tending to debase the vicious,  
    And corrupt the harmless fool;  
If there is a hateful habit  
    Making man a senseless tool,  
With the feelings of a rabbit  
    And the wisdom of a mule;



It's the rule which inculcates,  
It's the habit which dictates  
The wrong and sinful practice of going into school.

If there's anything improving  
    To an erring sinner's state,  
Which is useful in removing  
    All the ills of human fate;  
If there's any glorious custom  
    Which our faults can dissipate,  
And can casually thrust 'em  
    Out of sight and make us great;  
It's the plan by which we shirk  
Half our matu-ti-nal work,  
The glorious institution of always being late.

*James Kenneth Stephen.*

---

## THE MILLENNIUM

TO R. K.

*As long I dwell on some stupendous  
And tremendous (Heaven defend us!)  
Monstr'-inform'-ingens-horrendous  
Demoniaco-seraphic  
Penman's latest piece of graphic.*

—ROBERT BROWNING.

Will there never come a season  
    Which shall rid us from the curse

Of a prose which knows no reason  
And an unmelodious verse:  
When the world shall cease to wonder  
At the genius of an Ass,  
And a boy's eccentric blunder  
Shall not bring success to pass:

When mankind shall be delivered  
From the clash of magazines,  
And the inkstand shall be shivered  
Into countless smithereens:  
When there stands a muzzled stripling,  
Mute, beside a muzzled bore:  
When the Rudyards cease from Kipling  
And the Haggards Ride no more?

*James Kenneth Stephen.*

---

## **"EXACTLY SO"**

A speech, both pithy and concise,  
Marks a mind acute and wise;  
What speech, my friend, say, do you know,  
Can stand before "Exactly so?"

I have a dear and witty friend  
Who turns this phrase to every end;  
None can deny that "Yes" or "No"  
Is meant in this "Exactly so."

Or when a bore his ear assails,  
Good-humour in his bosom fails,  
No response from his lips will flow,

Save, now and then, "Exactly so."

Is there remark on matters grave  
That he may wish perchance to waive,  
Or thinks perhaps is rather slow,  
He stops it by "Exactly so."

It saves the trouble of a thought—  
No sour dispute can thence be sought;  
It leaves the thing in *statu quo*,  
This beautiful "Exactly so."

It has another charm, this phrase,  
For it implies the speaker's praise  
Of what has just been said—*ergo*—  
It pleases, this "Exactly so."

Nor need the conscience feel distress,  
By answ'ring wrongly "No" or "Yes;"  
It 'scapes a falsehood, which is low,  
And substitutes "Exactly so."

Each mortal loves to think he's right,  
That his opinion, too, is bright;  
Then, Christian, you may soothe your foe  
By chiming in "Exactly so."

Whoe'er these lines may chance peruse,  
Of this famed word will see the use,  
And mention where'er he may go,  
The praises of "Exactly so."

Of this more could my muse relate,  
But you, kind reader, I'll not sate;  
For if I did you'd cry "Hallo!  
I've heard enough"—"Exactly so."

*Lady T. Hastings.*

---

## COMPANIONS

### A TALE OF A GRANDFATHER

I know not of what we ponder'd  
Or made pretty pretence to talk,  
As, her hand within mine, we wander'd  
Tow'rd the pool by the lime-tree walk,  
While the dew fell in showers from the passion flowers  
And the blush-rose bent on her stalk.

I cannot recall her figure:  
Was it regal as Juno's own?  
Or only a trifle bigger  
Than the elves who surround the throne  
Of the Faëry Queen, and are seen, I ween,  
By mortals in dreams alone?

What her eyes were like, I know not:  
Perhaps they were blurr'd with tears;  
And perhaps in your skies there glow not  
(On the contrary) clearer spheres.  
No! as to her eyes I am just as wise  
As you or the cat, my dears.

Her teeth, I presume, were "pearly":  
But which was she, brunette or blonde?  
Her hair, was it quaintly curly,  
Or as straight as a beadle's wand?  
That I fail'd to remark;—it was rather dark

And shadowy round the pond.

Then the hand that reposed so snugly  
In mine,—was it plump or spare?  
Was the countenance fair or ugly?  
Nay, children, you have me there!  
My eyes were p'r'aps blurr'd; and besides I'd heard  
That it's horribly rude to stare.

And I—was I brusque and surly?  
Or oppressively bland and fond?  
Was I partial to rising early?  
Or why did we twain abscond,  
All breakfastless, too, from the public view,  
To prowl by a misty pond?

What pass'd, what was felt or spoken—  
Whether anything pass'd at all—  
And whether the heart was broken  
That beat under that shelt'ring shawl—  
(If shawl she had on, which I doubt)—has gone,  
Yes, gone from me past recall.

Was I haply the lady's suitor?  
Or her uncle? I can't make out—  
Ask your governess, dears, or tutor.  
For myself, I'm in hopeless doubt  
As to why we were there, who on earth we were,  
And, what this is all about.

*Charles Stuart Calverley.*

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## THE SCHOOLMASTER

## ABROAD WITH HIS SON

O what harper could worthily harp it,  
    Mine Edward! this wide-stretching wold  
(Look out *wold*) with its wonderful carpet  
    Of emerald, purple and gold!  
Look well at it—also look sharp, it  
    Is getting so cold.

The purple is heather (*erica*);  
    The yellow, gorse—call'd sometimes "whin."  
Cruel boys on its prickles might spike a  
    Green beetle as if on a pin.  
You may roll in it, if you would like a  
    Few holes in your skin.

You wouldn't? Then think of how kind you  
    Should be to the insects who crave  
Your compassion—and then, look behind you  
    At yon barley-ears! Don't they look brave  
As they undulate—(*undulate*, mind you,  
    From *unda*, a wave).

The noise of those sheep-bells, how faint it  
    Sounds here—(on account of our height)!  
And this hillock itself—who could paint it,  
    With its changes of shadow and light?  
Is it not—(never, Eddy, say "ain't it")—  
    A marvelous sight?

Then yon desolate eerie morasses.  
    The haunts of the snipe and the hern—  
(I shall question the two upper classes  
    On *aquatiles*, when we return)—  
Why, I see on them absolute masses  
    Of *filix* or fern.

How it interests e'en a beginner  
    (Or *tiro*) like dear little Ned!  
Is he listening? As I am a sinner  
    He's asleep—he is wagging his head.  
Wake up! I'll go home to my dinner,  
    And you to your bed.

The boundless ineffable prairie;  
    The splendor of mountain and lake  
With their hues that seem ever to vary;  
    The mighty pine forests which shake  
In the wind, and in which the unwary  
    May tread on a snake;

And this wold with its heathery garment—  
    Are themes undeniably great.  
But—although there is not any harm in't—  
    It's perhaps little good to dilate  
On their charms to a dull little varmint  
    Of seven or eight.

*Charles Stuart Calverley.*

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## **A APPEAL FOR ARE TO THE SEXTANT OF THE OLD BRICK MEETINOUSE**

**BY A GASPER**

The sextant of the meetinouse, which sweeps  
And dusts, or is supposed too! and makes fiers,  
And lites the gas and sometimes leaves a screw loose,  
in which case it smells orful—worse than lampile;

And wrings the Bel and toles it when men dyes  
to the grief of survivin pardners, and sweeps pathes;  
And for the servases gits \$100 per annum,  
Which them that thinks deer, let em try it;  
Getting up be foar star-lite in all weathers and  
Kindlin-fires when the wether it is cold  
As zero, and like as not green wood for kindlers;  
I wouldn't be hired to do it for no some—  
But o sextant! there are 1 kermoddity  
Which's more than gold, wich doant cost nothin,  
Worth more than anything exsep the Sole of Man.  
i mean pewer Are, sextent, i mean pewer are!  
O it is plenty out o dores, so plenty it doant no  
What on airth to dew with itself, but flys about  
Scaterin levs and bloin of men's hatts;  
in short, jest "fre as are" out dores.  
But o sextant, in our church its scarce as piety,  
scarce as bank bills wen agints beg for mischuns,  
Wich some say purty often (taint nothin to me,  
Wat I give aint nothin to nobody), but o sextant,  
u shut 500 mens wimmen and children,  
Speshally the latter, up in a tite place,  
Some has bad breths, none aint 2 swete,  
some is fevery, some is scrofilus, some has bad teeth,  
And some haint none, and some aint over clean;  
But every 1 on em breethes in and out and out and in,  
Say 50 times a minit, or 1 million and a half breths an our,  
Now how long will a church ful of are last at that rate,  
I ask you, say 15 minutes, and then wats to be did?  
Why then they must brethe it all over agin.  
And then agin, and so on, till each has took it down,  
At least ten times, and let it up again, and wats more  
The same individible don't have the privilege  
of brethen his own are, and no one's else;  
Each one mus take whatever comes to him,  
O sextant, don't you know our lungs is bellusses,  
To blo the fier of life, and keep it from



goin out; and how can bellusses blow without wind,  
And aint wind *are*? i put it to your conscens.  
Are is the same to us as milk to babes,  
Or water to fish, or pendlums to clox—  
Or roots and airbs unto an injun Doctor,  
Or little pils to an omepath,  
Or boys to gurls. Are is for us to brethe,  
Wat signifies who preeches if i cant brethe?  
Wats Pol? Wats Pollus? to sinners who are ded?  
Ded for want of breth? why sextant, when we die  
Its only coz we cant brethe no more—that's all.  
And now, O sextant, let me beg of you  
2 let a little are into our church.  
(Pewer are is sertin proper for the pews)  
And do it weak days and Sundays tew—  
It aint much trouble—only make a hole  
And the are will come in itself;  
(It luvs to come in whare it can git warm):  
And o how it will rouse the people up  
And sperrit up the preacher, and stop garbs,  
And yawns and figgits as effectooal  
As wind on the dry Boans the Profit tells of.

*Arabella Willson.*

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## CUPID'S DARTS

### WHICH ARE A GROWING MENACE TO THE PUBLIC

Do not worry if I scurry from the grill room in a hurry,  
Dropping hastily my curry and retiring into balk;  
Do not let it cause you wonder if, by some mischance or blunder,  
We encounter on the Underground and I get out and walk.

If I double as a cub'll when you meet him in the stubble,  
Do not think I am in trouble or attempt to make a fuss;  
Do not judge me melancholy or attribute it to folly  
If I leave the Metropolitan and travel 'n a bus.

Do not quiet your anxiety by giving me a diet,  
Or by base resort to *vi et armis* fold me to your arms,  
And let no suspicious tremor violate your wonted phlegm or  
Any fear that Harold's memory is faithless to your charms.

For my passion as I dash on in that disconcerting fashion  
Is as ardently irrational as when we forged the link  
When you gave your little hand away to me, my own Amanda  
As we sat 'n the veranda till the stars began to wink.

And I am in such a famine when your beauty I examine  
That it lures me as the jam invites a hungry little brat;  
But I fancy that, at any rate, I'd rather waste a penny  
Then be spitted by the many pins that bristle from your hat.

*Unknown.*

---

## **A PLEA FOR TRIGAMY**

I've been trying to fashion a wifely ideal,  
And find that my tastes are so far from concise  
That, to marry completely, no fewer than three'll  
Suffice

I've subjected my views to severe atmospheric  
Compression, but still, in defiance of force,  
They distinctly fall under three heads, like a cleric

Discourse.

My *first* must be fashion's own fancy-bred daughter,  
Proud, peerless, and perfect—in fact, *comme il faut*;  
A waltzer and wit of the very first water—  
For *show*.

But these beauties that serve to make all the men jealous,  
Once face them alone in the family cot,  
Heaven's angels incarnate (the novelists tell us)  
They're *not*.

But so much for appearances. Now for my *second*,  
My lover, the wife of my home and my heart:  
Of all fortune and fate of my life to be reckon'd  
A part.

She must know all the needs of a rational being,  
Be skilled to keep counsel, to comfort, to coax;  
And, above all things else, be accomplished at seeing  
My jokes.

I complete the ménage by including the other  
With all the domestic prestige of a hen:  
As my housekeeper, nurse, or it may be, a mother  
Of men.

Total *three!* and the virtues all well represented;  
With fewer than this such a thing can't be done;  
Though I've known married men who declare they're contented  
With one.

Would you hunt during harvest, or hay-make in winter?  
And how can one woman expect to combine  
Certain qualifications essentially inter-  
necine?

You may say that my prospects are (legally) sunless;  
I state that I find them as clear as can be:—  
I will marry *no* wife, since I can't do with one less  
Than three.

*Owen Seaman.*

---

## THE POPE

The Pope he leads a happy life,  
He fears not married care nor strife.  
He drinks the best of Rhenish wine,—  
I would the Pope's gay lot were mine.

But yet all happy's not his life,  
He has no maid, nor blooming wife;  
No child has he to raise his hope,—  
I would not wish to be the Pope.

The Sultan better pleases me,  
His is a life of jollity;  
He's wives as many as he will,—  
I would the Sultan's throne then fill.

But even he's a wretched man,  
He must obey the Alcoran;  
He dare not drink one drop of wine—  
I would not change his lot for mine.

So here I'll take my lowly stand,  
I'll drink my own, my native land;  
I'll kiss my maiden fair and fine,  
And drink the best of Rhenish wine.

And when my maiden kisses me  
I'll think that I the Sultan be;  
And when my cheery glass I tope,  
I'll fancy then I am the Pope.

*Charles Lever.*

---

## ALL AT SEA

### THE VOYAGE OF A CERTAIN UNCERTAIN SAILORMAN

I saw a certain sailorman who sat beside the sea,  
And in the manner of his tribe he yawned this yarn to me:  
"'Twere back in eighteen-fifty-three, or mebbe fifty-four,  
I skipped the farm,—no, 't were the shop,—an' went to Baltimore.  
I shipped aboard the *Lizzie*—or she might ha' bin the *Jane*;  
Them wimmin names are mixey, so I don't remember plain;  
But anyhow, she were a craft that carried schooner rig,  
(Although Sam Swab, the bo'sun, allus swore she were a brig);  
We sailed away from Salem Town,—no, lemme think;—'t were *Lynn*,—  
An' steered a course for Africa (or Greece, it might ha' bin);  
But anyway, we tacked an' backed an' weathered many a storm—  
Oh, no,—as I recall it now, that week was fine an' warm!  
Who did I say the cap'n was? I *didn't* say at all?  
Wa-a-ll now, his name were 'Lijah Bell—or was it Eli Ball?  
I kinder guess 't were Eli. He'd a big, red, bushy beard—  
No-o-o, come to think, he allus kept *his* whiskers nicely sheared.

But anyhow, that voyage was the first I'd ever took,  
An' all I had to do was cut up cabbage for the cook;  
But come to talk o' cabbage just reminds me,—that there trip  
Would prob'ly be my *third* one, on a Hong Kong clipper-ship.

The crew they were a jolly lot, an' used to sing 'Avast,'  
I think it were, or else 'Ahoy,' while bailing out the mast.  
And as I recollect it now,—"

But here I cut him short,  
And said: "It's time to tack again, and bring your wits to port;  
I came to get a story both adventurous and *true*,  
And here is how I started out to write the interview:  
'I saw a *certain* sailorman,' but you turn out to be  
The most *un*-certain sailorman that ever sailed the sea!"  
He puffed his pipe, and answered, "Wa-a-ll, I *thought* 'twere mine, but still,  
*I must ha' told the one belongs to my twin brother Bill!*"

*Frederick Moxon.*

---

## BALLAD OF THE PRIMITIVE JEST

I am an ancient Jest!  
Paleolithic man  
In his arboreal nest  
The sparks of fun would fan;  
My outline did he plan,  
And laughed like one possessed,  
'Twas thus my course began,  
I am a Merry Jest.

I am an early Jest!  
Man delved and built and span;  
Then wandered South and West  
The peoples Aryan,  
*I* journeyed in their van;  
The Semites, too, confessed,—  
From Beersheba to Dan,—

I am a Merry Jest.

I am an ancient Jest,  
Through all the human clan,  
Red, black, white, free, oppressed,  
Hilarious I ran!  
I'm found in Lucian,  
In Poggio, and the rest,  
I'm dear to Moll and Nan!  
I am a Merry Jest!

ENVOY:

Prince, you may storm and ban—  
Joe Millers *are* a pest,  
Suppress me if you can!  
I am a Merry Jest!

*Andrew Lang.*

---

## VILLANELLE OF THINGS AMUSING

These are the things that make me laugh—  
Life's a preposterous farce, say I!  
And I've missed of too many jokes by half.

The high-heeled antics of colt and calf,  
The men who think they can act, and try—  
These are the things that make me laugh.

The hard-boiled poses in photograph,  
The groom still wearing his wedding tie—  
And I've missed of too many jokes by half!

These are the bubbles I gayly quaff  
With the rank conceit of the new-born fly—  
These are the things that make me laugh!

For, Heaven help me! I needs must chaff,  
And people will tickle me till I die—  
And I've missed of too many jokes by half!

So write me down in my epitaph  
As one too fond of his health to cry—  
These are the things that make me laugh,  
And I've missed of too many jokes by half!

*Gelett Burgess.*

---

## HOW TO EAT WATERMELONS

When you slice a Georgy melon you mus' know what you is at  
An' look out how de knife is gwine in.  
Put one-half on dis side er you—de yuther half on dat,  
En' den you gits betwixt 'em, en begin!  
Oh, melons!  
Honey good ter see;  
But we'en it comes ter sweetness,  
De melon make fer me!

En den you puts yo' knife up, en you sorter licks de blade,  
En never stop fer sayin' any grace;  
But eat ontell you satisfy—roll over in de shade,  
En sleep ontell de sun shine in yo' face!  
Oh, melons!  
Honey good ter see;



But we'en it comes ter sweetness,  
De melon make fer me!

*Frank Libby Stanton.*

---

## A VAGUE STORY

Perchance it was her eyes of blue,  
Her cheeks that might the rose have shamed,  
Her figure in proportion true  
To all the rules by artists framed;  
Perhaps it was her mental worth  
That made her lover love her so,  
Perhaps her name, or wealth, or birth—  
I cannot tell—I do not know.

He may have had a rival, who  
Did fiercely gage him to a duel,  
And, being luckier of the two,  
Defeated him with triumph cruel;  
Then *she* may have proved false, and turned  
To welcome to her arms his foe,  
Left *him* despairing, conquered, spurned—  
I cannot tell—I do not know.

So oft such woes will counteract  
The thousand ecstacies of love,  
That you may fix on base of fact  
The story hinted at above;  
But all on earth so doubtful is,  
Man *knows* so little here below,  
That, if you ask for proof of this,  
I cannot tell—I do not know.

*Walter Parke.*

---

## **HIS MOTHER-IN-LAW**

He stood on his head by the wild seashore,  
And danced on his hands a jig;  
In all his emotions, as never before,  
A wildly hilarious grig.

And why? In that ship just crossing the bay  
His mother-in-law had sailed  
For a tropical country far away,  
Where tigers and fever prevailed.

Oh, now he might hope for a peaceful life  
And even be happy yet,  
Though owning no end of neuralgic wife,  
And up to his collar in debt.

He had borne the old lady through thick and thin,  
And she lectured him out of breath;  
And now as he looked at the ship she was in  
He howled for her violent death.

He watched as the good ship cut the sea,  
And bumpishly up-and-downed,  
And thought if already she qualmish might be,  
He'd consider his happiness crowned.

He watched till beneath the horizon's edge  
The ship was passing from view;  
And he sprang to the top of a rocky ledge  
And pranced like a kangaroo.

He watched till the vessel became a speck  
That was lost in the wandering sea;  
And then, at the risk of breaking his neck,  
Turned somersaults home to tea.

*Walter Parke.*

---

## ON A DEAF HOUSEKEEPER

Of all life's plagues I recommend to no man  
To hire as a domestic a deaf woman.  
I've got one who my orders does not hear,  
Mishears them rather, and keeps blundering near.  
Thirsty and hot, I asked her for a *drink*;  
She bustled out, and brought me back some *ink*.  
Eating a good rump-steak, I called for *mustard*;  
Away she went, and whipped me up a *custard*.  
I wanted with my chicken to have *ham*;  
Blundering once more, she brought a pot of *jam*.  
I wished in season for a cut of *salmon*;  
And what she brought me was a huge fat *gammon*.  
I can't my voice raise higher and still higher,  
As if I were a herald or town-crier.  
'T would better be if she were deaf outright;  
But anyhow she quits my house this night.

*Unknown.*

---

## HOMŒOPATHIC SOUP

Take a robin's leg  
(Mind, the drumstick merely);  
Put it in a tub  
Filled with water nearly;  
Set it out of doors,  
In a place that's shady;  
Let it stand a week  
(Three days if for a lady);  
Drop a spoonful of it  
In a five-pail kettle,  
Which may be made of tin  
Or any baser metal;  
Fill the kettle up,  
Set it on a boiling,  
Strain the liquor well,  
To prevent its oiling;  
One atom add of salt,  
For the thickening one rice kernel,  
And use to light the fire  
"The Homœopathic Journal."  
Let the liquor boil  
Half an hour, no longer,  
(If 'tis for a man  
Of course you'll make it stronger).  
Should you now desire  
That the soup be flavoury,  
Stir it once around,  
With a stalk of savoury.  
When the broth is made,  
Nothing can excell it:  
Then three times a day  
Let the patient *smell* it.  
If he chance to die,  
Say 'twas Nature did it:  
If he chance to live,  
Give the soup the credit.

*Unknown.*

---

## **SOME LITTLE BUG**

In these days of indigestion  
It is oftentimes a question  
    As to what to eat and what to leave alone;  
For each microbe and bacillus  
Has a different way to kill us,  
    And in time they always claim us for their own.  
There are germs of every kind  
In any food that you can find  
    In the market or upon the bill of fare.  
Drinking water's just as risky  
As the so-called deadly whiskey,  
    And it's often a mistake to breathe the air.

Some little bug is going to find you some day,  
Some little bug will creep behind you some day,  
    Then he'll send for his bug friends  
    And all your earthly trouble ends;  
Some little bug is going to find you some day.

The inviting green cucumber  
Gets most everybody's number,  
    While the green corn has a system of its own;  
Though a radish seems nutritious  
Its behaviour is quite vicious,  
    And a doctor will be coming to your home.  
Eating lobster cooked or plain  
Is only flirting with ptomaine,  
    While an oyster sometimes has a lot to say,  
But the clams we eat in chowder

Make the angels chant the louder,  
For they know that we'll be with them right away.

Take a slice of nice fried onion  
And you're fit for Dr. Munyon,  
Apple dumplings kill you quicker than a train.  
Chew a cheesy midnight "rabbit"  
And a grave you'll soon inhabit—  
Ah, to eat at all is such a foolish game.  
Eating huckleberry pie  
Is a pleasing way to die,  
While sauerkraut brings on softening of the brain.  
When you eat banana fritters  
Every undertaker titters,  
And the casket makers nearly go insane.

Some little bug is going to find you some day,  
Some little bug will creep behind you some day,  
With a nervous little quiver  
He'll give cirrhosis of the liver;  
Some little bug is going to find you some day.

When cold storage vaults I visit  
I can only say what is it  
Makes poor mortals fill their systems with such stuff?  
Now, for breakfast, prunes are dandy  
If a stomach pump is handy  
And your doctor can be found quite soon enough.  
Eat a plate of fine pigs' knuckles  
And the headstone cutter chuckles,  
While the grave digger makes a note upon his cuff.  
Eat that lovely red bologna  
And you'll wear a wooden kimona,  
As your relatives start scrappin 'bout your stuff.

Some little bug is going to find you some day,  
Some little bug will creep behind you some day,

Eating juicy sliced pineapple  
Makes the sexton dust the chapel;  
Some little bug is going to find you some day.

All those crazy foods they mix  
Will float us 'cross the River Styx,  
Or they'll start us climbing up the milky way.  
And the meals we eat in courses  
Mean a hearse and two black horses  
So before a meal some people always pray.  
Luscious grapes breed 'pendicitis,  
And the juice leads to gastritis,  
So there's only death to greet us either way;  
And fried liver's nice, but, mind you,  
Friends will soon ride slow behind you  
And the papers then will have nice things to say.

Some little bug is going to find you some day,  
Some little bug will creep behind you some day  
Eat some sauce, they call it chili,  
On your breast they'll place a lily;  
Some little bug is going to find you some day.

*Roy Atwell.*

---

## **ON THE DOWNTOWN SIDE OF AN UPTOWN STREET**

On the downtown side of an uptown street  
Is the home of a girl that I'd like to meet,  
But I'm on the uptown,  
And she's on the downtown,  
On the downtown side of an uptown street.

On the uptown side of the crowded old "L,"  
I see her so often I know her quite well,  
    But I'm on the downtown  
    When she's on the uptown,  
On the uptown side of the crowded old "L."

On the uptown side of a downtown street  
This girl is employed that I'd like to meet,  
    But I work on the downtown  
    And she on the uptown,  
The uptown side of a downtown street.

On a downtown car of the Broadway line  
Often I see her for whom I repine,  
    But when I'm on a uptown  
    She's on a downtown,  
On a downtown car of the Broadway line.

Oh, to be downtown when I am uptown,  
Oh, to be uptown when I am downtown,  
    I work at night time,  
    She in the daytime,  
Never the right time for us to meet,  
Uptown or downtown, in "L," car or street.

*William Johnston.*

---

## **WRITTEN AFTER SWIMMING FROM SESTOS TO ABYDOS**

If, in the month of dark December,  
    Leander, who was nightly wont  
(What maid will not the tale remember?)



To cross thy stream broad Hellespont.

If, when the wint'ry tempest roar'd,  
He sped to Hero nothing loth,  
And thus of old thy current pour'd,  
Fair Venus! how I pity both!

For *me*, degenerate, modern wretch,  
Though in the genial month of May,  
My dripping limbs I faintly stretch,  
And think I've done a feat to-day.

But since he crossed the rapid tide,  
According to the doubtful story,  
To woo—and—Lord knows what beside,  
And swam for Love, as I for Glory;

'T were hard to say who fared the best:  
Sad mortals! thus the gods still plague you!  
He lost his labor, I my jest;  
For he was drowned, and I've the ague.

*Lord Byron.*

---

## THE FISHERMAN'S CHANT

Oh, the fisherman is a happy wight!  
He dabbles by day, and he sniggles by night.  
He trolls for fish, and he trolls his lay—  
He sniggles by night, and he dabbles by day.  
Oh, who so merry as he!  
On the river or the sea!  
Sniggling,

Wriggling  
Eels, and higgling  
Over the price  
Of a nice  
Slice  
Of fish, twice  
As much as it ought to be.

Oh, the fisherman is a happy man!  
He dabbles, and sniggles, and fills his can!  
With a sharpened hook, and a sharper eye,  
He sniggles and dabbles for what comes by,  
Oh, who so merry as he!  
On the river or the sea!  
Dabbling  
Nibbling  
Chub, and quibbling  
Over the price  
Of a nice  
Slice  
Of fish, twice  
As much as it ought to be.

*F. C. Burnand.*

---

## **REPORT OF AN ADJUDGED CASE**

### **NOT TO BE FOUND IN ANY OF THE BOOKS**

Between Nose and Eyes a strange contest arose,  
The spectacles set them unhappily wrong;  
The point in dispute was, as all the world knows,  
To which the said spectacles ought to belong.

So Tongue was the lawyer, and argued the cause  
With a great deal of skill, and a wig full of learning;  
While chief baron Ear sat to balance the laws,  
So famed for his talent in nicely discerning.

In behalf of the Nose it will quickly appear,  
And your lordship, he said, will undoubtedly find,  
That the Nose has had spectacles always to wear,  
Which amounts to possession time out of mind.

Then holding the spectacles up to the court—  
Your lordship observes they are made with a straddle  
As wide as the ridge of the Nose is; in short,  
Designed to sit close to it, just like a saddle.

Again, would your lordship a moment suppose  
(’Tis a case that has happened, and may be again)  
That the visage or countenance had not a nose,  
Pray who would, or who could, wear spectacles then!

On the whole it appears, and my argument shows  
With a reasoning the court will never condemn,  
That the spectacles plainly were made for the Nose,  
And the Nose was as plainly intended for them.

Then shifting his side (as a lawyer knows how),  
He pleaded again in behalf of the Eyes;  
But what were his arguments few people know,  
For the court did not think they were equally wise.

So his lordship decreed with a grave solemn tone,  
Decisive and clear, without one *if* or *but*—  
That, whenever the Nose put his spectacles on,  
By daylight or candlelight—Eyes should be shut!

*William Cowper.*

---

## PREHISTORIC SMITH

### QUATERNARY EPOCH—POST-PLIOCENE PERIOD

A man sat on a rock and sought  
Refreshment from his thumb;  
A dinotherium wandered by  
And scared him some.

His name was Smith. The kind of rock  
He sat upon was shale.  
One feature quite distinguished him—  
He had a tail.

The danger past, he fell into  
A revery austere;  
While with his tail he whisked a fly  
From off his ear.

"Mankind deteriorates," he said,  
"Grows weak and incomplete;  
And each new generation seems  
Yet more effete.

"Nature abhors imperfect work,  
And on it lays her ban;  
And all creation must despise  
A tailless man.

"But fashion's dictates rule supreme,  
Ignoring common sense;  
And fashion says, to dock your tail  
Is just immense.

"And children now come in the world  
With half a tail or less;  
Too stumpy to convey a thought,  
And meaningless.

"It kills expression. How can one  
Set forth, in words that drag,  
The best emotions of the soul,  
Without a wag?"

Sadly he mused upon the world,  
Its follies and its woes;  
Then wiped the moisture from his eyes,  
And blew his nose.

But clothed in earrings, Mrs. Smith  
Came wandering down the dale;  
And, smiling, Mr. Smith arose,  
And wagged his tail.

*David Law Proudfit.*

---

## SONG

### OF ONE ELEVEN YEARS IN PRISON

#### I

Whene'er with haggard eyes I view  
This dungeon that I'm rotting in,  
I think of those companions true  
Who studied with me at the U

niversity of Gottingen,  
niversity of Gottingen.

[Weeps, and pulls out a blue kerchief, with which he wipes his eyes; gazing tenderly at it, he proceeds—

II

Sweet kerchief, check'd with heavenly blue,  
Which once my love sat knotting in!—  
Alas! Matilda *then* was true!  
At least I thought so at the U  
niversity of Gottingen,  
niversity of Gottingen.

[At the repetition of this line he clanks his chains in cadence.

III

Barbs! Barbs! alas! how swift you flew,  
Her neat post-wagon trotting in!  
Ye bore Matilda from my view;  
Forlorn I languish'd at the U  
niversity of Gottingen,  
niversity of Gottingen.

IV

This faded form! this pallid hue!  
This blood my veins is clotting in,  
My years are many—they were few  
When first I entered at the U  
niversity of Gottingen,  
niversity of Gottingen.

V

There first for thee my passion grew,  
Sweet, sweet Matilda Pottengen!

Thou wast the daughter of my tu  
tor, law professor at the U  
niversity of Gottingen,  
niversity of Gottingen.

VI

Sun, moon and thou, vain world, adieu,  
That kings and priests are plotting in;  
Here doom'd to starve on water gru  
el, never shall I see the U  
niversity of Gottingen,  
niversity of Gottingen.

[During the last stanza he dashes his head repeatedly against the walls of his prison; and, finally, so hard as to produce a visible contusion; he then throws himself on the floor in an agony. The curtain drops; the music still continuing to play till it is wholly fallen.

*George Canning.*

---

LYING

I do confess, in many a sigh,  
My lips have breath'd you many a lie,  
And who, with such delights in view,  
Would lose them for a lie or two?

Nay—look not thus, with brow reproving:  
Lies are, my dear, the soul of loving!  
If half we tell the girls were true,  
If half we swear to think and do,

Were aught but lying's bright illusion,  
The world would be in strange confusion!  
If ladies' eyes were, every one,  
As lovers swear, a radiant sun,  
Astronomy should leave the skies,  
To learn her lore in ladies' eyes!  
Oh no!—believe me, lovely girl,  
When nature turns your teeth to pearl,  
Your neck to snow, your eyes to fire,  
Your yellow locks to golden wire,  
Then, only then, can heaven decree,  
That you should live for only me,  
Or I for you, as night and morn,  
We've swearing kiss'd, and kissing sworn.

And now, my gentle hints to clear,  
For once, I'll tell you truth, my dear!  
Whenever you may chance to meet  
A loving youth, whose love is sweet,  
Long as you're false and he believes you,  
Long as you trust and he deceives you,  
So long the blissful bond endures;  
And while he lies, his heart is yours:  
But, oh! you've wholly lost the youth  
The instant that he tells you truth!

*Thomas Moore.*

---

## STRICTLY GERM-PROOF

The Antiseptic Baby and the Prophylactic Pup  
Were playing in the garden when the Bunny gamboled up;  
They looked upon the Creature with a loathing undisguised;—



It wasn't Disinfected and it wasn't Sterilized.

They said it was a Microbe and a Hotbed of Disease;  
They steamed it in a vapor of a thousand-odd degrees;  
They froze it in a freezer that was cold as Banished Hope  
And washed it in permanganate with carbolated soap.

In sulphureted hydrogen they steeped its wiggly ears;  
They trimmed its frisky whiskers with a pair of hard-boiled shears;  
They donned their rubber mittens and they took it by the hand  
And 'lected it a member of the Fumigated Band.

There's not a Micrococcus in the garden where they play;  
They bathe in pure iodoform a dozen times a day;  
And each imbibes his rations from a Hygienic Cup—  
The Bunny and the Baby and the Prophylactic Pup.

*Arthur Guiterman.*

---

## THE LAY OF THE LOVER'S FRIEND

AIR—"The days we went a-gipsying."

I would all womankind were dead,  
Or banished o'er the sea;  
For they have been a bitter plague  
These last six weeks to me:  
It is not that I'm touched myself,  
For that I do not fear;  
No female face hath shown me grace  
For many a bygone year.  
But 'tis the most infernal bore,  
Of all the bores I know,

To have a friend who's lost his heart  
A short time ago.

Whene'er we steam it to Blackwall,  
Or down to Greenwich run,  
To quaff the pleasant cider cup,  
And feed on fish and fun;  
Or climb the slopes of Richmond Hill,  
To catch a breath of air:  
Then, for my sins, he straight begins  
To rave about his fair.  
Oh, 'tis the most tremendous bore,  
Of all the bores I know,  
To have a friend who's lost his heart  
A short time ago.

In vain you pour into his ear  
Your own confiding grief;  
In vain you claim his sympathy,  
In vain you ask relief;  
In vain you try to rouse him by  
Joke, repartee, or quiz;  
His sole reply's a burning sigh,  
And "What a mind it is!"  
O Lord! it is the greatest bore,  
Of all the bores I know,  
To have a friend who's lost his heart  
A short time ago.

I've heard her thoroughly described  
A hundred times, I'm sure;  
And all the while I've tried to smile,  
And patiently endure;  
He waxes strong upon his pangs,  
And potters o'er his grog;  
And still I say, in a playful way—  
"Why you're a lucky dog!"

But oh! it is the heaviest bore,  
Of all the bores I know,  
To have a friend who's lost his heart  
A short time ago.

I really wish he'd do like me  
When I was young and strong;  
I formed a passion every week,  
But never kept it long.  
But he has not the sportive mood  
That always rescued me,  
And so I would all women could  
Be banished o'er the sea.  
For 'tis the most egregious bore,  
Of all the bores I know,  
To have a friend who's lost his heart  
A short time ago.

*William E. Aytoun.*

---

## **MAN'S PLACE IN NATURE**

### **DEDICATED TO DARWIN AND HUXLEY**

They told him gently he was made  
Of nicely tempered mud,  
That man no lengthened part had played  
Anterior to the Flood.  
'Twas all in vain; he heeded not,  
Referring plant and worm,  
Fish, reptile, ape, and Hottentot,  
To one primordial germ.

They asked him whether he could bear  
To think his kind allied  
To all those brutal forms which were  
In structure Pithecoïd;  
Whether he thought the apes and us  
Homologous in form;  
He said, "Homo and Pithecus  
Came from one common germ."

They called him "atheistical,"  
"Sceptic," and "infidel."  
They swore his doctrines without fail  
Would plunge him into hell.  
But he with proofs in no way lame,  
Made this deduction firm,  
That all organic beings came  
From one primordial germ.

That as for the Noachian flood,  
'Twas long ago disproved,  
That as for man being made of mud,  
All by whom truth is loved  
Accept as fact what, *malgré* strife,  
Research tends to confirm—  
That man, and everything with life,  
Came from one common germ.

*Unknown.*

---

## THE NEW VERSION

A soldier of the Russians  
Lay jappanned at Tschrtzvkjskivitch,

There was lack of woman's nursing  
And other comforts which  
Might add to his last moments  
And smooth the final way;—  
But a comrade stood beside him  
To hear what he might say.  
The jappanned Russian faltered  
As he took that comrade's hand,  
And he said: "I never more shall see  
My own, my native land;  
Take a message and a token  
To some distant friends of mine,  
For I was born at Smnlxzrskgqrxzski,  
Fair Smnlxzrskgqrxzski on the Irkztrvzkimnov."

*W. J. Lampton.*

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## **AMAZING FACTS ABOUT FOOD**

The Food Scientist tells us: "A deficiency of iron, phosphorus, potassium, calcium and the other mineral salts, colloids and vitamins of vegetable origin leads to numerous forms of physical disorder."

I yearn to bite on a Colloid  
With phosphorus, iron and Beans;  
I want to be filled with Calcium, grilled,  
And Veg'table Vitamines!

I yearn to bite on a Colloid  
(Though I don't know what it means)  
To line my inside with Potassium, fried,  
And Veg'table Vitamines.

I would sate my soul with spinach  
And dandelion greens.  
No eggs, nor ham, nor hard-boiled clam,  
But Veg'table Vitamines.

Hi, Waiter! Coddle the Colloids  
With phosphorus, iron and Beans;  
Though Mineral Salts may have some faults,  
Bring on the Vitamines.

*Unknown.*

---

## **TRANSCENDENTALISM**

It is told, in Buddhi-theosophic schools,  
There are rules.  
By observing which, when mundane labor irks  
One can simulate quiescence  
By a timely evanescence  
From his Active Mortal Essence,  
(Or his Works.)

The particular procedure leaves research  
In the lurch,  
But, apparently, this matter-moulded form  
Is a kind of outer plaster,  
Which a well-instructed Master  
Can remove without disaster  
When he's warm.

And to such as mourn an Indian Solar Clime  
At its prime

'Twere a thesis most immeasurably fit,  
So expansively elastic,  
And so plausibly fantastic,  
That one gets enthusiastic  
For a bit.

*Unknown.*

---

## A "CAUDAL" LECTURE

Philosophy shows us 'twixt monkey and man  
One simious line in unbroken extendage;  
Development only since first it began—  
And chiefly in losing the caudal appendage.

Our ancestors' holding was wholly *in tail*,  
And the loss of this feature we claim as a merit;  
But though often at tale-bearing people we rail,  
'Tis rather a loss than a gain we inherit.

The tail was a rudder—a capital thing  
To a man who was half—or a quarter—seas over;  
And as for a sailor, by that he could cling,  
And use for his hands and his feet both discover.

In the Arts it would quickly have found out a place;  
The painter would use it to steady his pencil;  
In music, how handy to pound at the bass!  
And then one could write by its coilings prehensile.

The Army had gained had the fashion endured—  
'Twould carry a sword, or be good in saluting;  
If the foe should turn tail, they'd be quickly secured;

Or, used as a lasso, 'twould help in recruiting.

To the Force 'twould add force—they could "run 'em in" so  
That one to three culprits would find himself equal;  
He could collar the two, have the other in tow—  
A very good form of the Tale and its Sequel.

In life many uses 'twould serve we should see—  
A man with no bed could hang cosily snoozing;  
'Twould hold an umbrella, hand cups round at tea,  
Or a candle support while our novel perusing.

In fact, when one thinks of our loss from of old,  
It makes us regret that we can't go in for it, or  
Wish, like the Dane, we a *tail* could unfold,  
Instead of remaining each one a *stump* orator.

*William Sawyer.*

---

## SALAD

To make this condiment, your poet begs  
The pounded yellow of two hard-boiled eggs;  
Two boiled potatoes, passed through kitchen-sieve,  
Smoothness and softness to the salad give;  
Let onion atoms lurk within the bowl,  
And, half-suspected, animate the whole.  
Of mordant mustard add a single spoon,  
Distrust the condiment that bites so soon;  
But deem it not, thou man of herbs, a fault,  
To add a double quantity of salt.  
And, lastly, o'er the flavored compound toss  
A magic soup-spoon of anchovy sauce.



Oh, green and glorious! Oh, herbaceous treat!  
'Twould tempt the dying anchorite to eat;  
Back to the world he'd turn his fleeting soul,  
And plunge his fingers in the salad bowl!  
Serenely full, the epicure would say,  
Fate can not harm me, I have dined to-day!

*Sydney Smith.*

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## NEMESIS

The man who invented the women's waists that button down behind,  
And the man who invented the cans with keys and the strips that will never  
wind,  
Were put to sea in a leaky boat and with never a bite to eat  
But a couple of dozen of patent cans in which was their only meat.

And they sailed and sailed o'er the ocean wide and never they had a taste  
Of aught to eat, for the cans stayed shut, and a peek-a-boo shirtwaist  
Was all they had to bale the brine that came in the leaky boat;  
And their tongues were thick and their throats were dry, and they barely  
kept afloat.

They came at last to an island fair, and a man stood on the shore.  
So they flew a signal of distress and their hopes rose high once more,  
And they called to him to fetch a boat, for their craft was sinking fast,  
And a couple of hours at best they knew was all their boat would last.

So he called to them a cheery call and he said he would make haste,  
But first he must go back to his wife and button up her waist,  
Which would only take him an hour or so and then he would fetch a boat.  
And the man who invented the backstairs waist, he groaned in his swollen  
throat.

The hours passed by on leaden wings and they saw another man  
In the window of a bungalow, and he held a tin meat can  
In his bleeding hands, and they called to him, not once but twice and  
                  trice,

And he said: "Just wait till I open this and I'll be there in a trice!"

And the man who invented the patent cans he knew what the promise  
                  meant,

So he leaped in air with a horrid cry and into the sea he went,  
And the bubbles rose where he sank and sank and a groan choked in the  
                  throat

Of the man who invented the backstairs waist and he sank with the leaky  
                  boat!

*J. W. Foley.*

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## **"MONA LISA"**

Mona Lisa, Mona Lisa!  
Have you gone? Great Julius Cæsar!  
Who's the Chap so bold and pinchey  
Thus to swipe the great da Vinci,  
Taking France's first Chef d'oeuvre  
Squarely from old Mr. Louvre,  
Easy as some pocket-picker  
Would remove our handkerchicker  
As we ride in careless folly  
On some gaily bounding trolley?

Mona Lisa, Mona Lisa,  
Who's your Captor? Doubtless he's a  
Crafty sort of treasure-seeker—  
Ne'er a Turpin e'er was sleeker—  
But, alas, if he can win you

Easily as I could chin you,  
What is safe in all the nations  
From his dreadful depredations?  
He's the style of Chap, I'm thinkin',  
Who will drive us all to drinkin'!

Mona Lisa, Mona Lisa,  
Next he'll swipe the Tower of Pisa,  
Pulling it from out its socket  
For to hide it in his pocket;  
Or perhaps he'll up and steal, O,  
Madame Venus, late of Milo;  
Or maybe while on the grab he  
Will annex Westminster Abbey,  
And elope with that distinguished  
Heap of Ashes long extinguished.

Maybe too, O Mona Lisa,  
He will come across the seas a—  
Searching for the style of treasure  
That we have in richest measure.  
Sunset Cox's brazen statue,  
Have a care lest he shall catch you!  
Or maybe he'll set his eye on  
Hammerstein's, or the Flatiron,  
Or some bit of White Wash done  
By those lads at Washington—

Truly he's a crafty geezer,  
Is your Captor, Mona Lisa!

*John Kendrick Bangs.*

---

**THE SIEGE OF DJKLXPRWBZ**

Before a Turkish town  
The Russians came.  
And with huge cannon  
Did bombard the same.

They got up close  
And rained fat bombshells down,  
And blew out every  
Vowel in the town.

And then the Turks,  
Becoming somewhat sad,  
Surrendered every  
Consonant they had.

*Eugene Fitch Ware.*

---

## **RURAL BLISS**

The poet is, or ought to be, a hater of the city,  
And so, when happiness is mine, and Maud becomes my wife,  
We'll look on town inhabitants with sympathetic pity,  
For we shall lead a peaceful and serene Arcadian life.

Then shall I sing in eloquent and most effective phrases,  
The grandeur of geraniums and the beauty of the rose;  
Immortalise in deathless strains the buttercups and daisies—  
For even I can hardly be mistaken as to those.

The music of the nightingale will ring from leafy hollow,  
And fill us with a rapture indescribable in words;  
And we shall also listen to the robin and the swallow  
(I wonder if a swallow sings?) and ... well, the other birds.

Too long I dwelt in ignorance of all the countless treasures  
Which dwellers in the country have in such abundant store;  
To give a single instance of the multitude of pleasures—  
The music of the nighting—oh, I mentioned that before.

And shall I prune potato-trees and artichokes, I wonder,  
And cultivate the silo-plant, which springs (I hope it springs?)  
In graceful foliage overhead?—Excuse me if I blunder,  
It's really inconvenient not to know the name of things!

No matter; in the future, when I celebrate the beauty  
Of country life in glowing terms, and "build the lofty rhyme"  
Aware that every Englishman is bound to do his duty,  
I'll learn to give the stupid things their proper names in time!

Meanwhile, you needn't wonder at the view I've indicated,  
The country life appears to me indubitably blest,  
For, even if its other charms are somewhat overstated,  
As long as Maud is there, you see,—what matters all the rest?

*Anthony C. Deane.*

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## **AN OLD BACHELOR**

'Twas raw, and chill, and cold outside,  
With a boisterous wind untamed,  
But I was sitting snug within,  
Where my good log-fire flamed.  
As my clock ticked,  
My cat purred,  
And my kettle sang.

I read me a tale of war and love,  
Brave knights and their ladies fair;  
And I brewed a brew of stiff hot-scotch  
To drive away dull care.  
As my clock ticked,  
My cat purred,  
And my kettle sang.

At last the candles sputtered out,  
But the embers still were bright,  
When I turned my tumbler upside down,  
An' bade m'self g' night!  
As th' ket'l t-hic-ked,  
The clock purred,  
And the cat (hic) sang!

*Tudor Jenks.*

---

## SONG

Three score and ten by common calculation  
The years of man amount to; but we'll say  
He turns four-score, yet, in my estimation,  
In all those years he has not lived a day.

Out of the eighty you must first remember  
The hours of night you pass asleep in bed;  
And, counting from December to December,  
Just half your life you'll find you have been dead.

To forty years at once by this reduction  
We come; and sure, the first five from your birth,  
While cutting teeth and living upon suction,

You're not alive to what this life is worth.

From thirty-five next take for education  
Fifteen at least at college and at school;  
When, notwithstanding all your application,  
The chances are you may turn out a fool.

Still twenty we have left us to dispose of,  
But during them your fortune you've to make;  
And granting, with the luck of some one knows of,  
'Tis made in ten—that's ten from life to take.

Out of the ten yet left you must allow for  
The time for shaving, tooth and other aches,  
Say four—and that leaves, six, too short, I vow, for  
Regretting past and making fresh mistakes.

Meanwhile each hour dispels some fond illusion;  
Until at length, sans eyes, sans teeth, you may  
Have scarcely sense to come to this conclusion—  
You've reached four-score, but haven't lived a day!

*J. R. Planché.*

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## **THE QUEST OF THE PURPLE COW**

He girded on his shining sword,  
He clad him in his suit of mail,  
He gave his friends the parting word,  
With high resolve his face was pale.  
They said, "You've kissed the Papal Toe,  
To great Moguls you've made your bow,  
Why will you thus world-wandering go?"

"I never saw a purple cow!"

"I never saw a purple cow!  
Oh, hinder not my wild emprise—  
Let me depart! For even now  
Perhaps, before some yokel's eyes  
The purpling creature dashes by,  
Bending its noble, hornèd brow.  
They see its glowing charms, but I—  
I never saw a purple cow!"

"But other cows there be," they said,  
"Both cows of high and low degree,  
Suffolk and Devon, brown, black, red,  
The Ayrshire and the Alderney.  
Content yourself with these." "No, no,"  
He cried, "Not these! Not these! For how  
Can common kine bring comfort? Oh!  
I never saw a purple cow!"

He flung him to his charger's back,  
He left his kindred limp and weak,  
They cried: "He goes, alack! alack!  
The unattainable to seek."  
But westward still he rode—pardee!  
The West! Where such freaks be; I vow,  
I'd not be much surprised if he  
Should some day see  
A  
Purple  
Cow!

*Hilda Johnson.*

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## ST. PATRICK OF IRELAND, MY DEAR!

A fig for St. Denis of France—  
He's a trumpery fellow to brag on;  
A fig for St. George and his lance,  
Which spitted a heathenish dragon;  
And the saints of the Welshman or Scot  
Are a couple of pitiful pipers,  
Both of whom may just travel to pot,  
Compared with that patron of swipers—  
St. Patrick of Ireland, my dear!

He came to the Emerald Isle  
On a lump of a paving-stone mounted;  
The steamboat he beat by a mile,  
Which mighty good sailing was counted.  
Says he, "The salt water, I think,  
Has made me most bloodily thirsty;  
So bring me a flagon of drink  
To keep down the mulligrubs, burst ye!  
Of drink that is fit for a saint!"

He preached, then, with wonderful force,  
The ignorant natives a-teaching;  
With a pint he washed down his discourse,  
"For," says he, "I detest your dry preaching."  
The people, with wonderment struck  
At a pastor so pious and civil,  
Exclaimed—"We're for you, my old buck!  
And we pitch our blind gods to the devil,  
Who dwells in hot water below!"

This ended, our worshipful spoon  
Went to visit an elegant fellow,  
Whose practice, each cool afternoon,  
Was to get most delightfully mellow.

That day with a black-jack of beer,  
It chanced he was treating a party;  
Says the saint—"This good day, do you hear,  
I drank nothing to speak of, my hearty!  
So give me a pull at the pot!"

The pewter he lifted in sport  
(Believe me, I tell you no fable);  
A gallon he drank from the quart,  
And then placed it full on the table.  
"A miracle!" every one said—  
And they all took a haul at the stingo;  
They were capital hands at the trade,  
And drank till they fell; yet, by jingo,  
The pot still frothed over the brim.

Next day, quoth his host, "'Tis a fast,  
And I've nought in my larder but mutton;  
And on Fridays who'd made such repast,  
Except an unchristian-like glutton?"  
Says Pat, "Cease your nonsense, I beg—  
What you tell me is nothing but gammon;  
Take my compliments down to the leg,  
And bid it come hither a salmon!"  
And the leg most politely complied.

You've heard, I suppose, long ago,  
How the snakes, in a manner most antic,  
He marched to the county Mayo,  
And trundled them into th' Atlantic.  
Hence, not to use water for drink,  
The people of Ireland determine—  
With mighty good reason, I think,  
Since St. Patrick has filled it with vermin  
And vipers, and other such stuff!

Oh, he was an elegant blade

As you'd meet from Fairhead to Kilcrumper;  
And though under the sod he is laid,  
Yet here goes his health in a bumper!  
I wish he was here, that my glass  
He might by art magic replenish;  
But since he is not—why, alas!  
My ditty must come to a finish,—  
Because all the liquor is out!

*William Maginn.*

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## THE IRISH SCHOOLMASTER

"Come here, my boy; hould up your head,  
And look like a jintlemàn, Sir;  
Jist tell me who King David was—  
Now tell me if you can, Sir."  
"King David was a mighty man,  
And he was King of Spain, Sir;  
His eldest daughter 'Jessie' was  
The 'Flower of Dunblane,' Sir."

"You're right, my boy; hould up your head,  
And look like a jintlemàn, Sir;  
Sir Isaac Newton—who was he?  
Now tell me if you can, Sir."  
"Sir Isaac Newton was the boy  
That climbed the apple-tree, Sir;  
He then fell down and broke his crown,  
And lost his gravity, Sir."

"You're right, my boy; hould up your head,  
And look like a jintlemàn, Sir;

Jist tell me who ould Marmion was—  
Now tell me if you can, Sir."

"Ould Marmion was a soldier bold,  
But he went all to pot, Sir;  
He was hanged upon the gallows tree,  
For killing Sir Walter Scott, Sir."

"You're right, my boy; hould up your head,  
And look like a jintlemàn, Sir;  
Jist tell me who Sir Rob Roy was;  
Now tell me if you can, Sir."

"Sir Rob Roy was a tailor to  
The King of the Cannibal Islands;  
He spoiled a pair of breeches, and  
Was banished to the Highlands."

"You're right, my boy; hould up your head,  
And look like a jintlemàn, Sir;  
Then, Bonaparte—say, who was he?  
Now tell me if you can, Sir."

"Ould Bonaparte was King of France  
Before the Revolution;  
But he was kilt at Waterloo,  
Which ruined his constitution."

"You're right, my boy; hould up your head,  
And look like a jintlemàn, Sir;  
Jist tell me who King Jonah was;  
Now tell me if you can, Sir."

"King Jonah was the strangest man  
That ever wore a crown, Sir;  
For though the whale did swallow him,  
It couldn't keep him down, Sir."

"You're right, my boy; hould up your head,  
And look like a jintlemàn, Sir;  
Jist tell me who that Moses was;

Now tell me if you can, Sir."  
"Shure Moses was the Christian name  
Of good King Pharaoh's daughter;  
She was a milkmaid, and she took  
*A profit* from the water."

"You're right, my boy; hould up your head,  
And look like a jintlemàn, Sir;  
Jist tell me now where Dublin is;  
Now tell me if you can, Sir."  
"Och, Dublin is a town in Cork,  
And built on the equator;  
It's close to Mount Vesuvius,  
And watered by the 'craythur.'"

"You're right, my boy; hould up your head,  
And look like a jintlemàn, Sir;  
Jist tell me now where London is;  
Now tell me if you can, Sir."  
"Och, London is a town in Spain;  
'Twas lost in the earthquake, Sir;  
The cockneys murther English there,  
Whenever they do spake, Sir."

"You're right, my boy; hould up your head,  
Ye're now a jintlemàn, Sir;  
For in history and geography  
I've taught you all I can, Sir.  
And if any one should ask you now,  
Where you got all your knowledge,  
Jist tell them 'twas from Paddy Blake,  
Of Bally Blarney College."

*James A. Sidey.*

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## REFLECTIONS ON CLEOPATHERA'S NEEDLE

So that's Cleopathera's Needle, bedad,  
An' a quare lookin' needle it is, I'll be bound;  
What a powerful muscle the queen must have had  
That could grasp such a weapon an' wind it around!

Imagine her sittin' there stitchin' like mad  
Wid a needle like that in her hand! I declare  
It's as big as the Round Tower of Slane, an', bedad,  
It would pass for a round tower, only it's square!

The taste of her, ordherin' a needle of granite!  
Begorra, the sight of it sthrikes me quite dumb!  
An' look at the quare sort of figures upon it;  
I wondher can these be the thracks of her thumb!

I once was astonished to hear of the faste  
Cleopathera made upon pearls; but now  
I declare, I would not be surprised in the laste  
If ye told me the woman had swallowed a cow!

It's aisy to see why bould Cæsar should quail  
In her presence, an' meekly submit to her rule;  
Wid a weapon like that in her fist I'll go bail  
She could frighten the sowl out of big Finn MacCool!

But, Lord, what poor pigmies the women are now,  
Compared with the monsther's they must have been then!  
Whin the darlin's in those days would kick up a row,  
Holy smoke, but it must have been hot for the men!

Just think how a chap that goes courtin' would start  
If his girl was to prod him wid that in the shins!  
I have often seen needles, but bouldly assart  
That the needle in front of me there takes the pins!

O, sweet Cleopathera! I'm sorry you're dead;  
An' whin lavin' this wondherful needle behind  
Had ye thought of bequathin' a spool of your thread  
An' yer thimble an' scissors, it would have been kind.

But pace to your ashes, ye plague of great men,  
Yer strength is departed, yer glory is past;  
Ye'll never wield sceptre or needle again,  
An' a poor little asp did yer bizzness at last!

*Cormac O'Leary.*

---

## THE ORIGIN OF IRELAND

With due condescension, I'd call your attention  
To what I shall mention of Erin so green,  
And without hesitation I will show how that nation  
Became of creation the gem and the queen.

'Twas early one morning, without any warning,  
That Vanus was born in the beautiful say,  
And by the same token, and sure 'twas provoking,  
Her pinions were soaking and wouldn't give play.

Old Neptune, who knew her, began to pursue her,  
In order to woo her—the wicked old Jew—  
And almost had caught her atop of the water—  
Great Jupiter's daughter!—which never would do.

But Jove, the great janius, looked down and saw Vanus,  
And Neptune so heinous pursuing her wild,  
And he spoke out in thunder, he'd rend him asunder—

And sure 'twas no wonder—for tazing his child.

A star that was flying hard by him espying,  
He caught with small trying, and down let it snap;  
It fell quick as winking, on Neptune a-sinking,  
And gave him, I'm thinking, a bit of a rap.

That star it was dry land, both low land and high land,  
And formed a sweet island, the land of my birth;  
Thus plain is the story, that sent down from glory,  
Old Erin asthore as the gem of the earth!

Upon Erin nately jumped Vanus so stately,  
But fainted, kase lately so hard she was pressed—  
Which much did bewilder, but ere it had killed her  
Her father distilled her a drop of the best.

That sup was victorious, it made her feel glorious—  
A little uproarious, I fear it might prove—  
So how can you blame us that Ireland's so famous  
For drinking and beauty, for fighting and love?

*Unknown.*

---

## **AS TO THE WEATHER**

I remember, I remember,  
Ere my childhood flitted by,  
It was cold then in December,  
And was warmer in July.  
In the winter there were freezings—  
In the summer there were thaws;



But the weather isn't now at all  
Like what it used to was!

*Unknown.*

---

## THE TWINS

In form and feature, face and limb,  
I grew so like my brother,  
That folks got taking me for him,  
And each for one another.  
It puzzled all our kith and kin,  
It reach'd an awful pitch;  
For one of us was born a twin,  
Yet not a soul knew which.

One day (to make the matter worse),  
Before our names were fix'd,  
As we were being wash'd by nurse  
We got completely mix'd;  
And thus, you see, by Fate's decree,  
(Or rather nurse's whim),  
My brother John got christen'd *me*,  
And I got christen'd *him*.

This fatal likeness even dogg'd  
My footsteps when at school,  
And I was always getting flogg'd,  
For John turned out a fool.  
I put this question hopelessly  
To every one I knew—  
What *would* you do, if you were me,  
To prove that you were *you*?

Our close resemblance turn'd the tide  
Of my domestic life;  
For somehow my intended bride  
Became my brother's wife.  
In short, year after year the same  
Absurd mistakes went on;  
And when I died—the neighbors came  
And buried brother John!

*Henry S. Leigh.*

---

## II

# THE ETERNAL FEMININE

## HE AND SHE

When I am dead you'll find it hard,  
Said he,  
To ever find another man  
Like me.

What makes you think, as I suppose  
You do,  
I'd ever want another man  
Like you?

*Eugene Fitch Ware.*

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## THE KISS

"What other men have dared, I dare,"  
He said. "I'm daring, too:  
And tho' they told me to beware,  
One kiss I'll take from you.

"Did I say one? Forgive me, dear;  
That was a grave mistake,  
For when I've taken one, I fear,  
One hundred more I'll take.

"'Tis sweet one kiss from you to win,  
But to stop there? Oh, no!  
One kiss is only to begin;  
There is no end, you know."

The maiden rose from where she sat  
And gently raised her head:  
"No man has ever talked like that—  
You may begin," she said.

*Tom Masson.*

---

## THE COURTIN'

God makes sech nights, all white an' still  
Fur 'z you can look or listen,  
Moonshine an' snow on field an' hill,  
All silence an' all glisten.

Zekle crep' up quite unbeknown  
An' peeked in thru' the winder,  
An' there sot Huldy all alone,  
'Ith no one nigh to hender.

A fireplace filled the room's one side  
With half a cord o' wood in—  
There warn't no stoves (tell comfort died)  
To bake ye to a puddin'.

The wa'nut logs shot sparkles out  
Towards the pootiest, bless her,  
An' leetle flames danced all about

The chiny on the dresser.

Agin the chimbley crook-necks hung,  
An' in amongst 'em rusted  
The ole queen's-arm that Gran'ther Young  
Fetched back f'om Concord busted.

The very room, coz she was in,  
Seemed warm f'om floor to ceilin',  
An' she looked full ez rosy agin  
Ez the apples she was peelin'.

'Twas kin' o' kingdom-come to look  
On sech a blessed cretur;  
A dogrose blushin' to a brook  
Ain't modester nor sweeter.

He was six foot o' man, A 1,  
Clear grit an' human natur';  
None couldn't quicker pitch a ton  
Nor dror a furrer straighter.

He'd sparked it with full twenty gals,  
He'd squired 'em, danced 'em, druv 'em,  
Fust this one, an' then thet, by spells—  
All is, he couldn't love 'em.

But long o' her his veins 'ould run  
All crinkly like curled maple;  
The side she breshed felt full o' sun  
Ez a south slope in Ap'il.

She thought no v'ice hed sech a swing  
Ez hisn in the choir;  
My! when he made Ole Hunderd ring,  
She *knowed* the Lord was nigher.

An' she'd blush scarlit, right in prayer,  
When her new meetin'-bunnet  
Felt somehow thru its crown a pair  
O' blue eyes sot upun it.

Thet night, I tell ye, she looked *some*!  
She seemed to 've gut a new soul,  
For she felt sartin-sure he'd come,  
Down to her very shoe-sole.

She heered a foot, an' knowed it tu,  
A-raspin' on the scraper—  
All ways to once her feelins flew  
Like sparks in burnt-up paper.

He kin' o' l'itered on the mat,  
Some doubtfle o' the sekle;  
His heart kep' goin' pity-pat,  
But hern went pity Zekle.

An' yit she gin her cheer a jerk  
Ez though she wished him funder,  
An' on her apples kep' to work,  
Parin' away like murder.

"You want to see my Pa, I s'pose?"  
"Wal ... no ... I come dasignin'—"  
"To see my Ma? She's sprinklin' clo'es  
Agin to-morrer's i'nin'."

To say why gals act so or so,  
Or don't, 'ould be presumin';  
Mebbe to mean *yes* an' say *no*  
Comes nateral to women.

He stood a spell on one foot fust,  
Then stood a spell on t'other,

An' on which one he felt the wust  
He couldn't ha' told ye nuther.

Says he, "I'd better call agin";  
Says she, "Think likely, Mister";  
Thet last word pricked him like a pin,  
An' ... Wal, he up an' kist her.

When Ma bimeby upon 'em slips,  
Huldy sot pale ez ashes,  
All kin' o' smily roun' the lips  
An' teary roun' the lashes.

For she was jes' the quiet kind  
Whose naturs never vary,  
Like streams that keep a summer mind  
Snowhid in Jenooary.

The blood clost roun' her heart felt glued  
Too tight for all expressin',  
Tell mother see how metters stood,  
An' gin 'em both her blessin'.

Then her red come back like the tide  
Down to the Bay o' Fundy,  
An' all I know is they was cried  
In meetin' come nex' Sunday.

*James Russell Lowell.*

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## **HIRAM HOVER**

### **A BALLAD OF NEW ENGLAND LIFE**



Where the Moosatockmaguntic  
Pours its waters in the Skuntic,  
Met, along the forest side  
Hiram Hover, Huldah Hyde.

She, a maiden fair and dapper,  
He, a red-haired, stalwart trapper,  
Hunting beaver, mink, and skunk  
In the woodlands of Squeedunk.

She, Pentucket's pensive daughter,  
Walked beside the Skuntic water  
Gathering, in her apron wet,  
Snake-root, mint, and bouncing-bet.

"Why," he murmured, loth to leave her,  
"Gather yarbs for chills and fever,  
When a lovyer bold and true,  
Only waits to gather you?"

"Go," she answered, "I'm not hasty,  
I prefer a man more tasty;  
Leastways, one to please me well  
Should not have a beastly smell."

"Haughty Huldah!" Hiram answered,  
"Mind and heart alike are cancered;  
Jest look here! these peltries give  
Cash, wherefrom a pair may live.

"I, you think, am but a vagrant,  
Trapping beasts by no means fragrant;  
Yet, I'm sure it's worth a thank—  
I've a handsome sum in bank."

Turned and vanished Hiram Hover,

And, before the year was over,  
Huldah, with the yarbs she sold,  
Bought a cape, against the cold.

Black and thick the furry cape was,  
Of a stylish cut the shape was;  
And the girls, in all the town,  
Envied Huldah up and down.

Then at last, one winter morning,  
Hiram came without a warning.  
"Either," said he, "you are blind,  
Huldah, or you've changed your mind.

"Me you snub for trapping varmints,  
Yet you take the skins for garments;  
Since you wear the skunk and mink,  
There's no harm in me, I think."

"Well," said she, "we will not quarrel,  
Hiram; I accept the moral,  
Now the fashion's so I guess  
I can't hardly do no less."

Thus the trouble all was over  
Of the love of Hiram Hover.  
Thus he made sweet Huldah Hyde  
Huldah Hover as his bride.

Love employs, with equal favor,  
Things of good and evil savor;  
That which first appeared to part,  
Warmed, at last, the maiden's heart.

Under one impartial banner,  
Life, the hunter, Love the tanner,

Draw, from every beast they snare,  
Comfort for a wedded pair!

*Bayard Taylor.*

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## **BLOW ME EYES!**

When I was young and full o' pride,  
A-standin' on the grass  
And gazin' o'er the water-side,  
I seen a fisher lass.  
"O, fisher lass, be kind awhile,"  
I asks 'er quite unbid.  
"Please look into me face and smile"—  
And, blow me eyes, she did!

O, blow me light and blow me blow,  
I didn't think she'd charm me so—  
But, blow me eyes, she did!

She seemed so young and beautiful  
I *had* to speak perlite,  
(The afternoon was long and dull,  
But she was short and bright).  
"This ain't no place," I says, "to stand—  
Let's take a walk instid,  
Each holdin' of the other's hand"—  
And, blow me eyes, she did!

O, blow me light and blow me blow,  
I sort o' thunk she wouldn't go—  
But, blow me eyes, she did!

And as we walked along a lane  
With no one else to see,  
Me heart was filled with sudden pain,  
And so I says to she:  
"If you would have me actions speak  
The words what can't be hid,  
You'd sort o' let me kiss yer cheek"—  
And, blow me eyes, she did!

O, blow me light and blow me blow,  
How sweet she was I didn't know—  
But, blow me eyes, *she* did!

But pretty soon me shipmate Jim  
Came strollin' down the beach,  
And she began a-oglin' him  
As pretty as a peach.  
"O, fickle maid o' false intent,"  
Impulsively I chid,  
"Why don't you go and wed that gent?"  
And, blow me eyes, she did!

O, blow me light and blow me blow,  
I didn't think she'd treat me so—  
But, blow me eyes, she did!

*Wallace Irwin.*

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## FIRST LOVE

O my earliest love, who, ere I number'd  
Ten sweet summers, made my bosom thrill!  
Will a swallow—or a swift, or some bird—

Fly to her and say, I love her still?

Say my life's a desert drear and arid,  
To its one green spot I aye recur:  
Never, never—although three times married—  
Have I cared a jot for aught but her.

No, mine own! though early forced to leave you,  
Still my heart was there where first we met;  
In those "Lodgings with an ample sea-view,"  
Which were, forty years ago, "To Let."

There I saw her first, our landlord's oldest  
Little daughter. On a thing so fair  
Thou, O Sun,—who (so they say) beholdest  
Everything,—hast gazed, I tell thee, ne'er.

There she sat—so near me, yet remoter  
Than a star—a blue-eyed, bashful imp:  
On her lap she held a happy bloater,  
"Twixt her lips a yet more happy shrimp.

And I loved her, and our troth we plighted  
On the morrow by the shingly shore:  
In a fortnight to be disunited  
By a bitter fate forevermore.

O my own, my beautiful, my blue-eyed!  
To be young once more, and bite my thumb  
At the world and all its cares with you, I'd  
Give no inconsiderable sum.

Hand in hand we tramp'd the golden seaweed,  
Soon as o'er the gray cliff peep'd the dawn:  
Side by side, when came the hour for tea, we'd  
Crunch the mottled shrimp and hairy prawn:—

Has she wedded some gigantic shrimper,  
That sweet mite with whom I loved to play?  
Is she girt with babes that whine and whimper,  
That bright being who was always gay?

Yes—she has at least a dozen wee things!  
Yes—I see her darning corduroys,  
Scouring floors, and setting out the tea-things,  
For a howling herd of hungry boys,

In a home that reeks of tar and sperm-oil!  
But at intervals she thinks, I know,  
Of those days which we, afar from turmoil,  
Spent together forty years ago.

O my earliest love, still unforgotten,  
With your downcast eyes of dreamy blue!  
Never, somehow, could I seem to cotton  
To another as I did to you!

*Charles Stuart Calverley.*

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## WHAT IS A WOMAN LIKE?

A woman is like to—but stay—  
What a woman is like, who can say?  
There is no living with or without one.  
Love bites like a fly,  
Now an ear, now an eye,  
Buzz, buzz, always buzzing about one.  
When she's tender and kind  
She is like to my mind,  
(And Fanny was so, I remember).

She's like to—Oh, dear!  
She's as good, very near,  
As a ripe, melting peach in September.  
If she laugh, and she chat,  
Play, joke, and all that,  
And with smiles and good humor she meet me,  
She's like a rich dish  
Of venison or fish,  
That cries from the table, Come eat me!  
But she'll plague you and vex you,  
Distract and perplex you;  
False-hearted and ranging,  
Unsettled and changing,  
What then do you think, she is like?  
Like sand? Like a rock?  
Like a wheel? Like a clock?  
Ay, a clock that is always at strike.  
Her head's like the island folks tell on,  
Which nothing but monkeys can dwell on;  
Her heart's like a lemon—so nice  
She carves for each lover a slice;  
In truth she's to me,  
Like the wind, like the sea,  
Whose raging will hearken to no man;  
Like a mill, like a pill,  
Like a flail, like a whale,  
Like an ass, like a glass  
Whose image is constant to no man;  
Like a shower, like a flower,  
Like a fly, like a pie,  
Like a pea, like a flea,  
Like a thief, like—in brief,  
She's like nothing on earth—but a woman!

*Unknown.*

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## MIS' SMITH

All day she hurried to get through,  
The same as lots of wimmin do;  
Sometimes at night her husban' said,  
"Ma, ain't you goin' to come to bed?"  
And then she'd kinder give a hitch,  
And pause half way between a stitch,  
And sorter sigh, and say that she  
Was ready as she'd ever be,  
She reckoned.

And so the years went one by one,  
An' somehow she was never done;  
An' when the angel said, as how  
"Mis' Smith, it's time you rested now,"  
She sorter raised her eyes to look  
A second, as a stitch she took;  
"All right, I'm comin' now," says she,  
"I'm ready as I'll ever be,  
I reckon."

*Albert Bigelow Paine.*

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## TRIOLET

"I love you, my lord!"  
Was all that she said—  
What a dissonant chord,  
"I love you, my lord!"  
Ah! how I abhorred  
That sarcastic maid!—



"I love you? My *Lord!*"  
Was all that she said.

*Paul T. Gilbert.*

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## **BESSIE BROWN, M.D.**

'Twas April when she came to town;  
The birds had come; the bees were swarming.  
Her name, she said, was Doctor Brown;  
I saw at once that she was charming.  
She took a cottage tinted green,  
Where dewy roses loved to mingle;  
And on the door, next day, was seen  
A dainty little shingle.

Her hair was like an amber wreath;  
Her hat was darker, to enhance it.  
The violet eyes that glowed beneath  
Were brighter than her keenest lancet,  
The beauties of her glove and gown  
The sweetest rhyme would fail to utter.  
Ere she had been a day in town  
The town was in a flutter.

The gallants viewed her feet and hands,  
And swore they never saw such wee things;  
The gossips met in purring bands,  
And tore her piecemeal o'er the tea-things.  
The former drank the Doctor's health  
With clinking cups, the gay carousers;  
The latter watched her door by stealth,  
Just like so many mousers.

But Doctor Bessie went her way,  
Unmindful of the spiteful cronies,  
And drove her buggy every day  
Behind a dashing pair of ponies.  
Her flower-like face so bright she bore  
I hoped that time might never wilt her.  
The way she tripped across the floor  
Was better than a philter.

Her patients thronged the village street;  
Her snowy slate was always quite full.  
Some said her bitters tasted sweet,  
And some pronounced her pills delightful.  
'Twas strange—I knew not what it meant—  
She seemed a nymph from Eldorado;  
Where'er she came, where'er she went,  
Grief lost its gloomy shadow.

Like all the rest I, too, grew ill;  
My aching heart there was no quelling.  
I tremble at my doctor's bill—  
And lo! the items still are swelling.  
The drugs I've drunk you'd weep to hear!  
They've quite enriched the fair concocter,  
And I'm a ruined man, I fear,  
Unless—I wed the Doctor!

*Samuel Minturn Peck.*

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## A SKETCH FROM THE LIFE

Its eyes are gray;  
    Its hair is either brown  
        Or black;  
And, strange to say,  
    Its dresses button down  
        The back!

It wears a plume  
    That loves to frisk around  
        My ear.  
It crowds the room  
    With cushions in a mound  
        And queer

Old rugs and lamps  
    In corners à la Turque  
        And things.  
It steals my stamps,  
    And when I want to work  
        It sings!

It rides and skates—  
    But then it comes and fills  
        My walls  
With plaques and plates  
    And keeps me paying bills  
        And calls.

It's firm; and if  
    I should my many woes  
        Deplore,  
'Twould only sniff  
    And perk its little nose  
        Some more.

It's bright, though small;

Its name, you may have guessed,  
Is "Wife."  
But, after all,  
It gives a wondrous zest  
To life!

*Arthur Guiterman.*

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## MINGUILLO'S KISS

Since for kissing thee, Minguillo,  
Mother's ever scolding me,  
Give me swiftly back, thou dear one,  
Give the kiss I gave to thee.  
Give me back the kiss—that one, now;  
Let my mother scold no more;  
Let us tell her all is o'er:  
What was done is all undone now.  
Yes, it will be wise, Minguillo,  
My fond kiss to give to me;  
Give me swiftly back, thou dear one,  
Give the kiss I gave to thee.  
Give me back the kiss, for mother  
Is impatient—prithee, do!  
For that one thou shalt have two:  
Give me that, and take another.  
Yes, then will they be contented,  
Then can't they complain of me;  
Give me swiftly back, thou dear one,  
Give the kiss I gave to thee.

*Unknown.*

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## A KISS IN THE RAIN

One stormy morn I chanced to meet  
A lassie in the town;  
Her locks were like the ripened wheat,  
Her laughing eyes were brown.  
I watched her as she tripped along  
Till madness filled my brain,  
And then—and then—I know 'twas wrong—  
I kissed her in the rain!

With rain-drops shining on her cheek,  
Like dew-drops on a rose,  
The little lassie strove to speak  
My boldness to oppose;  
She strove in vain, and quivering  
Her fingers stole in mine;  
And then the birds began to sing,  
The sun began to shine.

Oh, let the clouds grow dark above,  
My heart is light below;  
'Tis always summer when we love,  
However winds may blow;  
And I'm as proud as any prince,  
All honors I disdain:  
She says I am her *rain beau* since  
I kissed her in the rain.

*Samuel Minturn Peck.*

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## THE LOVE-KNOT

Tying her bonnet under her chin,  
She tied her raven ringlets in;  
But, not alone in the silken snare  
Did she catch her lovely floating hair,  
For, tying her bonnet under her chin,  
She tied a young man's heart within.

They were strolling together up the hill,  
Where the wind comes blowing merry and chill;  
And it blew the curls, a frolicsome race,  
All over the happy peach-coloured face,  
Till, scolding and laughing, she tied them in,  
Under her beautiful dimpled chin.

And it blew a colour bright as the bloom  
Of the pinkest fuchsia's tossing plume,  
All over the cheeks of the prettiest girl  
That ever imprisoned a romping curl,  
Or, in tying her bonnet under her chin,  
Tied a young man's heart within.

Steeper and steeper grew the hill—  
Madder, merrier, chillier still—  
The western wind blew down and played  
The wildest tricks with the little maid,  
As, tying her bonnet under her chin,  
She tied a young man's heart within.

Oh, western wind, do you think it was fair  
To play such tricks with her floating hair?—  
To gladly, gleefully do your best  
To blow her against the young man's breast,  
Where he as gladly folded her in,  
And kissed her mouth and dimpled chin?

Oh, Ellery Vane! you little thought  
An hour ago, when you besought  
This country lass to walk with you,  
After the sun had dried the dew,  
What perilous danger you'd be in  
As she tied her bonnet under her chin.

*Nora Perry.*

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## OVER THE WAY

Over the way, over the way,  
I've seen a head that's fair and gray;  
I've seen kind eyes not new to tears,  
A form of grace, though full of years—  
Her fifty summers have left no flaw—  
And I, a youth of twenty-three,  
So love this lady, fair to see,  
I want her for my mother-in-law!

Over the way, over the way,  
I've seen her with the children play;  
I've seen her with a royal grace  
Before the mirror adjust her lace;  
A kinder woman none ever saw;  
God bless and cheer her onward path,  
And bless all treasures that she hath,  
And let her be my mother-in-law!

Over the way, over the way,  
I think I'll venture, dear, some day  
(If you will lend a helping hand,

And sanctify the scheme I've planned);  
I'll kneel in loving, reverent awe  
Down at the lady's feet, and say:  
"I've loved your daughter many a day—  
Please won't you be my mother-in-law?"

*Mary Mapes Dodge.*

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## CHORUS OF WOMEN

### FROM THE "THESMOPHORIAZUSÆ."

They're always abusing the women,  
As a terrible plague to men;  
They say we're the root of all evil,  
And repeat it again and again—  
Of war, and quarrels, and bloodshed,  
All mischief, be what it may.  
And pray, then, why do you marry us,  
If we're all the plagues you say?  
And why do you take such care of us,  
And keep us so safe at home,  
And are never easy a moment  
If ever we chance to roam?  
When you ought to be thanking Heaven  
That your plague is out of the way,  
You all keep fussing and fretting—  
"Where is my Plague to-day?"  
If a Plague peeps out of the window,  
Up go the eyes of men;  
If she hides, then they all keep staring  
Until she looks out again.



*Aristophanes.*

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## **THE WIDOW MALONE**

Did you hear of the Widow Malone  
O hone!

Who lived in the town of Athlone  
Alone?

O, she melted the hearts  
Of the swains in them parts;  
So lovely the Widow Malone,  
O hone!

So lovely the Widow Malone.

Of lovers she had a full score  
Or more;  
And fortunes they all had galore  
In store;

From the minister down  
To the clerk of the Crown,  
All were courting the Widow Malone  
O hone!

All were courting the Widow Malone.

But so modest was Mrs. Malone,  
'Twas known,  
That no one could see her alone,  
O hone!

Let them ogle and sigh,  
They could ne'er catch her eye;  
So bashful the Widow Malone,  
O hone!

So bashful the Widow Malone.

## THE SMACK IN SCHOOL

A district school, not far away,  
Mid Berkshire's hills, one winter's day,  
Was humming with its wonted noise  
Of threescore mingled girls and boys;  
Some few upon their tasks intent,  
But more on furtive mischief bent.  
The while the master's downward look  
Was fastened on a copy-book;  
When suddenly, behind his back,  
Rose sharp and clear a rousing smack!  
As 'twere a battery of bliss  
Let off in one tremendous kiss!  
"What's that?" the startled master cries;  
"That, thir," a little imp replies,  
"Wath William Willith, if you pleathe,—  
I thaw him kith Thuthanna Peathe!"  
With frown to make a statue thrill,  
The master thundered, "Hither, Will!"  
Like wretch o'ertaken in his track,  
With stolen chattels on his back,  
Will hung his head in fear and shame,  
And to the awful presence came,—  
A great, green, bashful simpleton,  
The butt of all good-natured fun.  
With smile suppressed, and birch upraised,  
The thunderer faltered,—"I'm amazed  
That you, my biggest pupil, should  
Be guilty of an act so rude!  
Before the whole set school to boot—  
What evil genius put you to't?"  
"'Twas she herself, sir," sobbed the lad,  
"I did not mean to be so bad;  
But when Susannah shook her curls,  
And whispered, I was 'fraid of girls  
And dursn't kiss a baby's doll,  
I couldn't stand it, sir, at all,

But up and kissed her on the spot!  
I know—boo—hoo—I ought to not,  
But, somehow, from her looks—boo—hoo—  
I thought she kind o' wished me to!"

*William Pitt Palmer.*

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## 'SPÄCIALLY JIM

I wus mighty good-lookin' when I wus young—  
Peert an' black-eyed an' slim,  
With fellers a-courtin' me Sunday nights,  
'Späcially Jim.

The likeliest one of 'em all wus he,  
Chipper an' han'som' an' trim;  
But I toss'd up my head, an' made fun o' the crowd,  
'Späcially Jim.

I said I hadn't no 'pinion o' men  
An' I wouldn't take stock in *him*!  
But they kep' up a-comin' in spite o' my talk,  
'Späcially Jim.

I got so tired o' havin' 'em roun'  
(*'Späcially Jim!*),  
I made up my mind I'd settle down  
An' take up with him;

So we was married one Sunday in church,  
'Twas crowded full to the brim,  
'Twas the only way to get rid of 'em all,  
'Späcially Jim.

*Bessie Morgan.*

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## **KITTY OF COLERAINE**

As beautiful Kitty one morning was tripping,  
With a pitcher of milk from the fair of Coleraine,  
When she saw me she stumbled, the pitcher it tumbled,  
And all the sweet buttermilk water'd the plain.

"O, what shall I do now, 'twas looking at you now,  
Sure, sure, such a pitcher I'll ne'er meet again!  
'Twas the pride of my dairy: O Barney M'Cleary!  
You're sent as a plague to the girls of Coleraine."

I sat down beside her,—and gently did chide her,  
That such a misfortune should give her such pain;  
A kiss then I gave her,—and ere I did leave her,  
She vow'd for such pleasure she'd break it again.

'Twas hay-making season, I can't tell the reason,  
Misfortunes will never come single,—that's plain,  
For, very soon after poor Kitty's disaster,  
The devil a pitcher was whole in Coleraine.

*Edward Lysaght.*

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## **WHY DON'T THE MEN PROPOSE?**

Why don't the men propose, mamma?  
Why don't the men propose?  
Each seems just coming to the point,  
And then away he goes;  
It is no fault of yours, mamma,  
*That* everybody knows;  
You *fête* the finest men in town,  
Yet, oh! they won't propose.

I'm sure I've done my best, mamma,  
To make a proper match;  
For coronets and eldest sons,  
I'm ever on the watch;  
I've hopes when some *distingué* beau  
A glance upon me throws;  
But though he'll dance and smile and flirt,  
Alas! he won't propose.

I've tried to win by languishing,  
And dressing like a blue;  
I've bought big books and talked of them  
As if I'd read them through!  
With hair cropp'd like a man I've felt  
The heads of all the beaux;  
But Spurzheim could not touch their hearts,  
And oh! they won't propose.

I threw aside the books, and thought  
That ignorance was bliss;  
I felt convinced that men preferred  
A simple sort of Miss;  
And so I lisped out nought beyond  
Plain "yesses" or plain "noes,"  
And wore a sweet unmeaning smile;  
Yet, oh! they won't propose.

Last night at Lady Ramble's rout  
I heard Sir Henry Gale  
Exclaim, "Now I *propose* again——"  
I started, turning pale;  
I really thought my time was come,  
I blushed like any rose;  
But oh! I found 'twas only at  
*Ecarté* he'd propose.

And what is to be done, mamma?  
Oh, what is to be done?  
I really have no time to lose,  
For I am thirty-one;  
At balls I am too often left  
Where spinsters sit in rows;  
Why don't the men propose, mamma?  
Why *won't* the men propose?

*Thomas Haynes Bayly.*

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## A PIN

Oh, I know a certain woman who is reckoned with the good,  
But she fills me with more terror than a raging lion would.  
The little chills run up and down my spine when'er we meet,  
Though she seems a gentle creature and she's very trim and neat.

And she has a thousand virtues and not one acknowledged sin,  
But she is the sort of person you could liken to a pin,  
And she pricks you, and she sticks you, in a way that can't be said—  
When you seek for what has hurt you, why, you cannot find the head.

But she fills you with discomfort and exasperating pain—

If anybody asks you why, you really can't explain.  
A pin is such a tiny thing,—of that there is no doubt,—  
Yet when it's sticking in your flesh, you're wretched till it's out!

She is wonderfully observing—when she meets a pretty girl  
She is always sure to tell her if her "bang" is out of curl.  
And she is so sympathetic: to a friend, who's much admired,  
She is often heard remarking, "Dear, you look so worn and tired!"

And she is a careful critic; for on yesterday she eyed  
The new dress I was airing with a woman's natural pride,  
And she said, "Oh, how becoming!" and then softly added, "It  
Is really a misfortune that the basque is such a fit."

Then she said, "If you had heard me yestereve, I'm sure, my friend,  
You would say I am a champion who knows how to defend."  
And she left me with the feeling—most unpleasant, I aver—  
That the whole world would despise me if it had not been for her.

Whenever I encounter her, in such a nameless way  
She gives me the impression I am at my worst that day,  
And the hat that was imported (and that cost me half a sonnet)  
With just one glance from her round eyes becomes a Bowery bonnet.

She is always bright and smiling, sharp and shining for a thrust—  
Use does not seem to blunt her point, not does she gather rust—  
Oh! I wish some hapless specimen of mankind would begin  
To tidy up the world for me, by picking up this pin.

*Ella Wheeler Wilcox.*

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## THE WHISTLER



"You have heard," said a youth to his sweetheart, who stood  
While he sat on a corn-sheaf, at daylight's decline—  
"You have heard of the Danish boy's whistle of wood;  
I wish that the Danish boy's whistle were mine!"

"And what would you do with it?—tell me," she said,  
While an arch smile play'd over her beautiful face.  
"I would blow it," he answered, "and then my fair maid  
Would fly to my side, and would there take her place."

"Is that all you wish for? Why, that may be yours  
Without any magic," the fair maiden cried;  
"A favour so slight one's good-nature secures;"  
And she playfully seated herself by his side.

"I would blow it again," said the youth; "and the charm  
Would work so, that not even modesty's check  
Would be able to keep from my neck your white arm."  
She smiled, and she laid her white arm round his neck.

"Yet once more I would blow, and the music divine  
Would bring me a third time an exquisite bliss  
You would lay your fair cheek to this brown one of mine  
And your lips, stealing past it, would give me a kiss."

The maiden laughed out in her innocent glee—  
"What a fool of yourself with the whistle you'd make!  
For only consider how silly 'twould be  
To sit there and whistle for what you might take."

*Unknown.*

---

## THE CLOUD

## AN IDYLL OF THE WESTERN FRONT

### I

SCENE: *A wayside shrine in France.*

PERSONS: Celeste, Pierre, a Cloud.

CELESTE (*gazing at the solitary white Cloud*):

I wonder what your thoughts are, little Cloud,  
Up in the sky, so lonely and so proud!

CLOUD: Not proud, dear maiden; lonely, if you will.

Long have I watched you, sitting there so still  
Before that little shrine beside the way,  
And wondered where your thoughts might be astray;  
Your knitting lying idle on your knees,  
And worse than idle—like Penelope's,  
Working its own undoing!

CELESTE (*picks up her knitting*): Who was she?

Saints! What a knot!—Who was Penelope?  
What happened to *her* knitting? Tell me, Cloud!

CLOUD: She was a Queen; she wove her husband's shroud.

CELESTE (*drops the knitting*).

His shroud!

CLOUD:               There, there! 'Twas only an excuse

To put her lovers off, a wifely ruse,  
Bidding them bide till it was finished, she  
Each night the web unravelled secretly.

CELESTE: He came home safe?

CLOUD:                               If I remember right,

It was the lovers needed shrouds that night!  
It is an old, old tale. I heard it through  
A Wind whose ancestor it was that blew  
Ulysses' ship across the purple sea  
Back to his people and Penelope.  
We Clouds pick up strange tales, as far and wide  
And to and fro above the world we ride,  
Across uncharted seas, upon the swell  
Of viewless waves and tides invisible,  
Freighted with friendly flood or forkèd flame,  
Knowing not whither bound nor whence we came;  
Now drifting lonely, now a company  
Of pond'rous galleons—

CELESTE: Oft-times I see  
A Cloud, as by some playful fancy stirred,  
Take likeness of a monstrous beast or bird  
Or some fantastic fish, as though 'twere clay  
Moulded by unseen hands.

[illegible]

CELESTE: I scarcely know.  
But had you asked a little while ago,  
I should have said a camel; then your hump  
Dissolved, and you became a gosling plump,  
Downy and white and warm—

CLOUD:                               What! Warm, up here?  
Ten thousand feet above the earth!

CELESTE: Oh dear!  
What am I thinking of! Of course I know  
How cold it is. Pierre has told me so  
A thousand times.



Now I must burn the candle that I vowed—

PIERRE: Then 'twas our Blessed Lady sent that Cloud  
That saved me when the Boche came up behind.  
I made a lightning turn, only to find  
The Boche on top of me. It seemed a kind  
Of miracle to see that Cloud—I swear  
A moment past the sky was everywhere  
As clear as clear; there was no Cloud in sight.  
It looked to me, floating there calm and white.  
Like a great mother hen, and I a chick.  
She seemed to call me, and I scurried quick  
Behind her wing. That spoiled the Boche's game,  
And gave me time to turn and take good aim.  
I emptied my last drum, and saw him drop  
Ten thousand feet in flames—

CELESTE (*shuddering*): Stop! Pierre, stop!  
Maybe a girl is waiting for him too—

PIERRE: 'Twas either him or me—

CELESTE: Thank God, not you!

PIERRE (*pointing to the church*): Come, let us burn the candle that you vowed.

CELESTE: Two candles!

PIERRE: Who's the other for?

CELESTE: The Cloud!

*Oliver Herford.*

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## CONSTANCY

"You gave me the key of your heart, my love;  
Then why do you make me knock?"  
"Oh, that was yesterday, Saints above!  
And last night—I changed the lock!"

*John Boyle O'Reilly.*

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## AIN'T IT AWFUL, MABEL?

It worries me to beat the band  
To hear folks say our lives is grand;  
Wish they'd try some one-night stand.  
Ain't it awful, Mabel?

Nothin' ever seems to suit—  
The manager's an awful brute;  
Spend our lives jest lookin' cute.  
Ain't it awful, Mabel?

Met a boy last Tuesday night,  
Was spendin' money left and right—  
Me, gee! I couldn't eat a bite!  
Ain't it awful, Mabel?

Then I met another guy—  
Hungry! well, I thought I'd die!  
But I couldn't make him buy.  
Ain't it awful, Mabel?

Lots of men has called me dear,

Said without me life was drear,  
But men is all so unsincere!  
Ain't it awful, Mabel?

I tell you, life is mighty hard,  
I've had proposals by the yard—  
Some of 'em would 'a had me starved.  
Ain't it awful, Mabel?

Remember that sealskin sacque of mine?  
When I got it, look'd awful fine—  
I found out it was a shine.  
Ain't it awful, Mabel?

Prima donna's sore on me;  
My roses had her up a tree—  
I jest told her to "twenty-three."  
Ain't it awful, Mabel?

My dear, she went right out and wired  
The New York office to have me "fired";  
But say! 'twas the author had me hired.  
Ain't it awful, Mabel?

I think hotels is awful mean,  
Jim and me put out of room sixteen—  
An' we was only readin' Laura Jean.  
Ain't it awful, Mabel?

The way folks talk about us too;  
For the smallest thing we do—  
'Nuff to make a girl feel blue.  
Ain't it awful, Mabel?

My Gawd! is that the overture?  
I never will be on, I'm sure—

The things us actresses endure,  
Ain't it awful, Mabel?

*John Edward Hazzard.*

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## WING TEE WEE

Oh, Wing Tee Wee  
Was a sweet Chinee,  
And she lived in the town of Tac.  
Her eyes were blue,  
And her curling queue  
Hung dangling down her back;  
And she fell in love with gay Win Sil  
When he wrote his name on a laundry bill.

And, oh, Tim Told  
Was a pirate bold,  
And he sailed in a Chinese junk;  
And he loved, ah me!  
Sweet Wing Tee Wee,  
But his valiant heart had sunk;  
So he drowned his blues in fickle fizz,  
And vowed the maid would yet be his.

So bold Tim Told  
Showed all his gold  
To the maid in the town of Tac;  
And sweet Wing Wee  
Eloped to sea,  
And nevermore came back;  
For in far Chinee the maids are fair,  
And the maids are false,—as everywhere.



*J. P. Denison.*

---

## **PHYLLIS LEE**

Beside a Primrose 'broider'd Rill  
Sat Phyllis Lee in Silken Dress  
Whilst Lucius limn'd with loving skill  
Her likeness, as a Shepherdess.  
Yet tho' he strove with loving skill  
His Brush refused to work his Will.

"Dear Maid, unless you close your Eyes  
I cannot paint to-day," he said;  
"Their Brightness shames the very Skies  
And turns their Turquoise into Lead."  
Quoth Phyllis, then, "To save the Skies  
And speed your Brush, I'll shut my Eyes."

Now when her Eyes were closed, the Dear,  
Not dreaming of such Treachery,  
Felt a Soft Whisper in her Ear,  
"Without the Light, how can one See?"  
"If you are *sure* that none can see  
I'll keep them shut," said Phyllis Lee.

*Oliver Herford.*

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## **THE SORROWS OF WERTHER**

Werther had a love for Charlotte  
Such as words could never utter;  
Would you know how first he met her?  
She was cutting bread and butter.

Charlotte was a married lady,  
And a moral man was Werther,  
And for all the wealth of Indies,  
Would do nothing for to hurt her.

So he sigh'd and pined and ogled,  
And his passion boil'd and bubbled,  
Till he blew his silly brains out,  
And no more was by it troubled.

Charlotte, having seen his body  
Borne before her on a shutter,  
Like a well-conducted person,  
Went on cutting bread and butter.

*W. M. Thackeray.*

---

## **THE UNATTAINABLE**

Tom's album was filled with the pictures of belles  
Who had captured his manly heart,  
From the fairy who danced for the front-row swells  
To the maiden who tooled her cart;  
But one face as fair as a cloudless dawn  
Caught my eye, and I said, "Who's this?"  
"Oh, that," he replied, with a skilful yawn,  
"Is the girl I couldn't kiss."

Her face was the best in the book, no doubt,  
But I hastily turned the leaf,  
For my friend had let his cigar go out,  
And I knew I had bared his grief:  
For caresses we win and smiles we gain  
Yield only a transient bliss,  
And we're all of us prone to sigh in vain  
For "the girl we couldn't kiss."

*Harry Romaine.*

---

## **RORY O'MORE; OR, GOOD OMENS**

Young Rory O'More, courted Kathleen Bawn,  
He was bold as a hawk,—she as soft as the dawn;  
He wish'd in his heart pretty Kathleen to please,  
And he thought the best way to do that was to tease.

"Now, Rory, be aisy," sweet Kathleen would cry,  
(Reproof on her lip, but a smile in her eye),  
"With your tricks I don't know, in troth, what I'm about,  
Faith you've teased till I've put on my cloak inside out."  
"Oh, jewel," says Rory, "that same is the way  
You've thrated my heart for this many a day;  
And 'tis plaz'd that I am, and why not to be sure?  
For 'tis all for good luck," says bold Rory O'More.

"Indeed, then," says Kathleen, "don't think of the like,  
For I half gave a promise to soothing Mike;  
The ground that I walk on he loves, I'll be bound."  
"Faith," says Rory, "I'd rather love you than the ground."

"Now, Rory, I'll cry if you don't let me go;  
Sure I drame ev'ry night that I'm hating you so!"  
"Oh," says Rory, "that same I'm delighted to hear,  
For drames always go by contraries, my dear;  
Oh! jewel, keep draming that same till you die,  
And bright morning will give dirty night the black lie!  
And 'tis plaz'd that I am, and why not, to be sure?  
Since 'tis all for good luck," says bold Rory O'More.

"Arrah, Kathleen, my darlint, you've teas'd me enough,  
Sure I've thrash'd for your sake Dinny Grimes and Jim Duff;  
And I've made myself, drinking your health, quite a baste,  
So I think, after that, I may talk to the praste."  
Then Rory, the rogue, stole his arm around her neck,  
So soft and so white, without freckle or speck,  
And he look'd in her eyes that were beaming with light,  
And he kiss'd her sweet lips;—don't you think he was right?  
"Now, Rory, leave off, sir; you'll hug me no more,  
That's eight times to-day you have kiss'd me before."  
"Then here goes another," says he, "to make sure,  
For there's luck in odd numbers," says Rory O'More.

*Samuel Lover.*

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## A DIALOGUE FROM PLATO

*"Le temps le mieux employé est celui qu'  
on perd."*

—CLAUDE TILLIER.

I'd read three hours. Both notes and text  
Were fast a mist becoming;  
In bounced a vagrant bee, perplexed,

And filled the room with humming.

Then out. The casement's leafage sways,  
And, parted light, discloses  
Miss Di., with hat and book,—a maze  
Of muslin mixed with roses.

"You're reading Greek?" "I am—and you?"  
"O, mine's a mere romancer!"  
"So Plato is." "Then read him—do;  
And I'll read mine in answer."

I read. "My Plato (Plato, too,—  
That wisdom thus should harden!)  
Declares 'blue eyes look doubly blue  
Beneath a Dolly Varden.'"

She smiled. "My book in turn avers  
(No author's name is stated)  
That sometimes those Philosophers  
Are sadly mis-translated."

"But hear,—the next's in stronger style:  
The Cynic School asserted  
That two red lips which part and smile  
May not be controverted!"

She smiled once more—"My book, I find,  
Observes some modern doctors  
Would make the Cynics out a kind  
Of album-verse concoctors."

Then I—"Why not? 'Ephesian law,  
No less than time's tradition,  
Enjoined fair speech on all who saw  
Diana's apparition.'"

She blushed—this time. "If Plato's page  
No wiser precept teaches,  
Then I'd renounce that doubtful sage,  
And walk to Burnham-beeches."

"Agreed," I said. "For Socrates  
(I find he too is talking)  
Thinks Learning can't remain at ease  
While Beauty goes a-walking."

She read no more, I leapt the sill:  
The sequel's scarce essential—  
Nay, more than this, I hold it still  
Profoundly confidential.

*Austin Dobson.*

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## **DORA VERSUS ROSE**

*"The case is proceeding."*

From the tragic-est novels at Mudie's—  
At least, on a practical plan—  
To the tales of mere Hodges and Judys,  
One love is enough for a man.  
But no case that I ever yet met is  
Like mine: I am equally fond  
Of Rose, who a charming brunette is,  
And Dora, a blonde.

Each rivals the other in powers—  
Each waltzes, each warbles, each paints—  
Miss Rose, chiefly tumble-down towers;

Miss Do., perpendicular saints.  
In short, to distinguish is folly;  
    'Twixt the pair I am come to the pass  
Of Macheath, between Lucy and Polly,—  
                                    Or Buridan's ass.

If it happens that Rosa I've singled  
    For a soft celebration in rhyme,  
Then the ringlets of Dora get mingled  
    Somehow with the tune and the time;  
Or I painfully pen me a sonnet  
    To an eyebrow intended for Do.'s,  
And behold I am writing upon it  
                                    The legend, "To Rose,"

Or I try to draw Dora (my blotter  
    Is all overscrawled with her head),  
If I fancy at last that I've got her,  
    It turns to her rival instead;  
Or I find myself placidly adding  
    To the rapturous tresses of Rose  
Miss Dora's bud-mouth, and her madding  
                                    Ineffable nose.

Was there ever so sad a dilemma?  
    For Rose I would perish (pro tem.);  
For Dora I'd willingly stem a—  
    (Whatever might offer to stem);  
But to make the invidious election,—  
    To declare that on either one's side  
I've a scruple,—a grain, more affection,  
                                    I *cannot* decide.

And, as either so hopelessly nice is,  
    My sole and my final resource  
Is to wait some indefinite crisis,—  
    Some feat of molecular force,

To solve me this riddle conducive  
By no means to peace or repose,  
Since the issue can scarce be inclusive  
Of Dora *and* Rose.

(*Afterthought*)

But, perhaps, if a third (say a Nora),  
Not quite so delightful as Rose,—  
Not wholly so charming as Dora,—  
Should appear, is it wrong to suppose,—  
As the claims of the others are equal,—  
And flight—in the main—is the best,—  
That I might ... But no matter,—the sequel  
Is easily guessed.

*Austin Dobson.*

---

## TU QUOQUE

### AN IDYLL IN THE CONSERVATORY

NELLIE

If I were you, when ladies at the play, Sir,  
Beckon and nod, a melodrama through,  
I would not turn abstractedly away, Sir,  
If I were you!

FRANK

If I were you, when persons I affected,  
Wait for three hours to take me down to Kew,  
I would at least pretend I recollected,  
If I were you!



NELLIE

If I were you, when ladies are so lavish,  
Sir, as to keep me every waltz but two,  
I would not dance with *odious* Miss M'Tavish,  
If I were you!

FRANK

If I were you, who vow you cannot suffer  
Whiff of the best,—the mildest "honey dew,"  
I would not dance with smoke-consuming Puffer,  
If I were you!

NELLIE

If I were you, I would not, Sir, be bitter,  
Even to write the "Cynical Review";—

FRANK

No, I should doubtless find flirtation fitter,  
If I were you!

NELLIE

Really! You would? Why, Frank, you're quite delightful,—  
Hot as Othello, and as black of hue;  
Borrow my fan. I would not look so *frightful*,  
If I were you!

FRANK

"It is the cause." I mean your chaperon is  
Bringing some well-curled juvenile. Adieu!  
I shall retire. I'd spare that poor Adonis,  
If I were you!

NELLIE

Go, if you will. At once! And by express, Sir!  
Where shall it be? To China—or Peru?

Go. I should leave inquirers my address, Sir,  
If I were you!

FRANK

No—I remain. To stay and fight a duel  
Seems, on the whole, the proper thing to do—  
Ah, you are strong,—I would not then be cruel,  
If I were you!

NELLIE

One does not like one's feelings to be doubted,—

FRANK

One does not like one's friends to misconstrue,—

NELLIE

If I confess that I a wee-bit pouted?

FRANK

I should admit that I was *piqué*, too.

NELLIE

Ask me to dance. I'd say no more about it,  
If I were you!

[Waltz—*Exeunt.*]

*Austin Dobson.*

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## NOTHING TO WEAR

Miss Flora McFlimsey, of Madison Square,  
Has made three separate journeys to Paris;

And her father assures me, each time she was there,  
That she and her friend Mrs. Harris  
(Not the lady whose name is so famous in history,  
But plain Mrs. H., without romance or mystery)  
Spent six consecutive weeks without stopping,  
In one continuous round of shopping;—  
Shopping alone, and shopping together,  
At all hours of the day, and in all sorts of weather:  
For all manner of things that a woman can put  
On the crown of her head or the sole of her foot,  
Or wrap round her shoulders, or fit round her waist,  
Or that can be sewed on, or pinned on, or laced,  
Or tied on with a string, or stitched on with a bow,  
In front or behind, above or below;  
For bonnets, mantillas, capes, collars, and shawls;  
Dresses for breakfasts, and dinners, and balls;  
Dresses to sit in, and stand in, and walk in,  
Dresses to dance in, and flirt in, and talk in;  
Dresses in which to do nothing at all;  
Dresses for winter, spring, summer, and fall,—  
All of them different in color and pattern,  
Silk, muslin, and lace, crape, velvet, and satin,  
Brocade, and broadcloth, and other material  
Quite as expensive and much more ethereal:  
In short, for all things that could ever be thought of,  
Or milliner, modiste, or tradesman be bought of,  
From ten-thousand-francs robes to twenty-sous frills;  
In all quarters of Paris, and to every store:  
While McFlimsey in vain stormed, scolded, and swore.  
They footed the streets, and he footed the bills.

The last trip, their goods shipped by the steamer *Argo*  
Formed, McFlimsey declares, the bulk of her cargo,  
Not to mention a quantity kept from the rest,  
Sufficient to fill the largest-sized chest,  
Which did not appear on the ship's manifest,  
But for which the ladies themselves manifested

Such particular interest that they invested  
Their own proper persons in layers and rows  
Of muslins, embroideries, worked underclothes,  
Gloves, handkerchiefs, scarfs, and such trifles as those;  
Then, wrapped in great shawls, like Circassian beauties,  
Gave *good-by* to the ship, and *go-by* to the duties.  
Her relations at home all marvelled, no doubt,  
Miss Flora had grown so enormously stout  
For an actual belle and a possible bride;  
But the miracle ceased when she turned inside out,  
And the truth came to light, and the dry-goods beside,  
Which, in spite of collector and custom-house sentry,  
Had entered the port without any entry.  
And yet, though scarce three months have passed since the day  
The merchandise went, on twelve carts, up Broadway,  
This same Miss McFlimsey, of Madison Square,  
The last time we met, was in utter despair,  
Because she had nothing whatever to wear!

NOTHING TO WEAR! Now, as this is a true ditty,  
I do not assert—this you know is between us—  
That she's in a state of absolute nudity,  
Like Powers's Greek Slave, or the Medici Venus;  
But I do mean to say I have heard her declare,  
When at the same moment she had on a dress  
Which cost five hundred dollars, and not a cent less,  
And jewelry worth ten times more, I should guess,  
That she had not a thing in the wide world to wear!  
I should mention just here, that out of Miss Flora's  
Two hundred and fifty or sixty adorers,  
I had just been selected as he who should throw all  
The rest in the shade, by the gracious bestowal  
On myself, after twenty or thirty rejections  
Of those fossil remains which she called her "affections,"  
And that rather decayed but well-known work of art,  
Which Miss Flora persisted in styling "her heart."  
So we were engaged. Our troth had been plighted

Not by moonbeam or starbeam, by fountain or grove;  
But in a front parlor, most brilliantly lighted,  
    Beneath the gas-fixtures we whispered our love—  
Without any romance, or raptures, or sighs,  
Without any tears in Miss Flora's blue eyes,  
Or blushes, or transports, or such silly actions;  
It was one of the quietest business transactions,  
With a very small sprinkling of sentiment, if any,  
And a very large diamond imported by Tiffany.  
On her virginal lips while I printed a kiss,  
She exclaimed, as a sort of parenthesis,  
And by way of putting me quite at my ease,  
"You know, I'm to polka as much as I please,  
And flirt when I like,—now stop,—don't you speak,—  
And you must not come here more than twice in the week,  
Or talk to me either at party or ball;  
But always be ready to come when I call:  
So don't prose to me about duty and stuff,—  
If we don't break this off, there will be time enough  
For that sort of thing; but the bargain must be,  
That as long as I choose I am perfectly free:  
For this is a sort of engagement, you see,  
Which is binding on you, but not binding on me."

Well, having thus wooed Miss McFlimsey, and gained her,  
With the silks, crinolines, and hoops that contained her,  
I had, as I thought, a contingent remainder  
At least in the property, and the best right  
To appear as its escort by day and by night;  
And it being the week of the Stuckups' grand ball,—  
    Their cards had been out for a fortnight or so,  
    And set all the Avenue on the tiptoe,—  
I considered it only my duty to call  
    And see if Miss Flora intended to go.  
I found her—as ladies are apt to be found  
When the time intervening between the first sound  
Of the bell and the visitor's entry is shorter

Than usual—I found—I won't say I caught—her  
Intent on the pier-glass, undoubtedly meaning  
To see if perhaps it didn't need cleaning.  
She turned as I entered—"Why, Harry, you sinner,  
I thought that you went to the Flashers' to dinner!"  
"So I did," I replied; "but the dinner is swallowed,  
And digested, I trust; for 'tis now nine or more:  
So being relieved from that duty, I followed  
Inclination, which led me, you see, to your door.  
And now will your Ladyship so condescend  
As just to inform me if you intend  
Your beauty and graces and presence to lend  
(All of which, when I own, I hope no one will borrow)  
To the Stuckups, whose party, you know, is to-morrow?"  
The fair Flora looked up with a pitiful air,  
And answered quite promptly, "Why, Harry, *mon cher*,  
I should like above all things to go with you there;  
But really and truly—I've nothing to wear."

"Nothing to wear? Go just as you are:  
Wear the dress you have on, and you'll be by far,  
I engage, the most bright and particular star  
On the Stuckup horizon—" I stopped, for her eye,  
Notwithstanding this delicate onset of flattery,  
Opened on me at once a most terrible battery  
Of scorn and amazement. She made no reply,  
But gave a slight turn to the end of her nose  
(That pure Grecian feature), as much as to say,  
"How absurd that any sane man should suppose  
That a lady would go to a ball in the clothes,  
No matter how fine, that she wears every day!"  
So I ventured again—"Wear your crimson brocade."  
(Second turn-up of nose)—"That's too dark by a shade."—  
"Your blue silk—" "That's too heavy."—"Your pink—" "That's too  
light."—  
"Wear tulle over satin." "I can't endure white."—  
"Your rose-colored, then, the best of the batch—"

"I haven't a thread of point lace to match."—  
"Your brown moire-antique—" "Yes, and look like a Quaker."—  
"The pearl-colored—" "I would, but that plaguy dressmaker  
Has had it a week."—"Then that exquisite lilac,  
In which you would melt the heart of a Shylock."  
(Here the nose took again the same elevation)—  
"I wouldn't wear that for the whole of creation."—

"Why not? It's my fancy, there's nothing could strike it  
As more *comme il faut*"—"Yes, but, dear me, that lean  
Sophronia Stuckup has got one just like it,  
And I won't appear dressed like a chit of sixteen."—  
"Then that splendid purple, that sweet mazarine,  
That superb *point d'aiguille*, that imperial green,  
That zephyr-like tarlatan, that rich grenadine—"—  
"Not one of all which is fit to be seen,"  
Said the lady, becoming excited and flushed.  
"Then wear," I exclaimed, in a tone which quite crushed  
Opposition, "that gorgeous toilette which you sported  
In Paris last spring, at the grand presentation,  
When you quite turned the head of the head of the nation;  
And by all the grand court were so very much courted."  
The end of the nose was portentously tipped up,  
And both the bright eyes shot forth indignation,  
As she burst upon me with the fierce exclamation,  
"I have worn it three times at the least calculation,  
And that and most of my dresses are ripped up!"  
Here I *ripped out* something, perhaps rather rash—  
Quite innocent, though; but to use an expression  
More striking than classic, it "settled my hash,"  
And proved very soon the last act of our session.  
"Fiddlesticks, is it, sir? I wonder the ceiling  
Doesn't fall down and crush you!—oh, you men have no feeling.  
You selfish, unnatural, illiberal creatures,  
Who set yourselves up as patterns and preachers,  
Your silly pretence—why, what a mere guess it is!  
Pray, what do you know of a woman's necessities?"

I have told you and shown you I've nothing to wear,  
And it's perfectly plain you not only don't care,  
But you do not believe me" (here the nose went still higher):  
"I suppose if you dared you would call me a liar.  
Our engagement is ended, sir—yes, on the spot;  
You're a brute, and a monster, and—I don't know what."  
I mildly suggested the words Hottentot,  
Pickpocket, and cannibal, Tartar, and thief,  
As gentle expletives which might give relief:  
But this only proved as a spark to the powder,  
And the storm I had raised came faster and louder;  
It blew, and it rained, thundered, lightened, and hailed  
Interjections, verbs, pronouns, till language quite failed  
To express the abusive, and then its arrears  
Were brought up all at once by a torrent of tears;  
And my last faint, despairing attempt at an observation  
Was lost in a tempest of sobs.

Well, I felt for the lady, and felt for my hat too,  
Improvised on the crown of the latter a tattoo,  
In lieu of expressing the feelings which lay  
Quite too deep for words, as Wordsworth would say:  
Then, without going through the form of a bow,  
Found myself in the entry,—I hardly knew how,—  
On doorstep and sidewalk, past lamp-post and square,  
At home and up-stairs, in my own easy-chair;  
    Poked my feet into slippers, my fire into blaze,  
And said to myself, as I lit my cigar,—  
Supposing a man had the wealth of the Czar  
    Of the Russias to boot, for the rest of his days,  
On the whole do you think he would have much time to spare  
If he married a woman with nothing to wear?

*William Allen Butler.*

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## MY MISTRESS'S BOOTS

They nearly strike me dumb,  
And I tremble when they come  
Pit-a-pat:  
This palpitation means  
These boots are Geraldine's—  
Think of that!

Oh, where did hunter win  
So delectable a skin  
For her feet?  
You lucky little kid,  
You perished, so you did,  
For my sweet!

The faëry stitching gleams  
On the sides, and in the seams,  
And it shows  
The Pixies were the wags  
Who tipt those funny tags  
And these toes.

What soles to charm an elf!  
Had Crusoe, sick of self,  
Chanced to view  
*One* printed near the tide,  
Oh, how hard he would have tried  
For the two!

For Gerry's debonair  
And innocent, and fair  
As a rose;  
She's an angel in a frock,  
With a fascinating cock  
To her nose.

The simpletons who squeeze  
Their extremities to please  
Mandarins,  
Would positively flinch  
From venturing to pinch  
Geraldine's.

Cinderella's *lefts and rights*,  
To Geraldine's were frights;  
And I trow,  
The damsel, deftly shod,  
Has dutifully trod  
Until now.

Come, Gerry, since it suits  
Such a pretty Puss (in Boots)  
These to don;  
Set this dainty hand awhile  
On my shoulder, dear, and I'll  
Put them on.

*Frederick Locker-Lampson.*

---

## MRS. SMITH

Last year I trod these fields with Di,  
Fields fresh with clover and with rye;  
They now seem arid!  
Then Di was fair and single; how  
Unfair it seems on me, for now  
Di's fair—and married!

A blissful swain—I scorn'd the song  
Which says that though young Love is strong,  
The Fates are stronger;  
Breezes then blew a boon to men,  
The buttercups were bright, and then  
This grass was longer.

That day I saw and much esteem'd  
Di's ankles, which the clover seem'd  
Inclined to smother;  
It twitch'd, and soon untied (for fun)  
The ribbon of her shoes, first one,  
And then the other.

I'm told that virgins augur some  
Misfortune if their shoe-strings come  
To grief on Friday:  
And so did Di, and then her pride  
Decreed that shoe-strings so untied  
Are "so untidy!"

Of course I knelt; with fingers deft  
I tied the right, and then the left;  
Says Di, "The stubble  
Is very stupid!—as I live,  
I'm quite ashamed!—I'm shock'd to give  
You so much trouble!"

For answer I was fain to sink  
To what we all would say and think  
Were Beauty present:  
"Don't mention such a simple act—  
A trouble? not the least! in fact  
It's rather pleasant!"

I trust that Love will never tease  
Poor little Di, or prove that he's

A graceless rover.  
She's happy now as *Mrs. Smith*—  
And less polite when walking with  
Her chosen lover!

Heigh-ho! Although no moral clings  
To Di's blue eyes, and sandal strings,  
We've had our quarrels!—  
I think that Smith is thought an ass;  
I know that when they walk in grass  
She wears *balmorals*.

*Frederick Locker-Lampson.*

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## **A TERRIBLE INFANT**

I recollect a nurse call'd Ann,  
Who carried me about the grass,  
And one fine day a fine young man  
Came up, and kiss'd the pretty lass.  
She did not make the least objection!  
Thinks I, "*Aha!*  
*When I can talk I'll tell Mamma*"  
—And that's my earliest recollection.

*Frederick Locker-Lampson.*

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## **SUSAN**

## **A KIND PROVIDENCE**

He dropt a tear on Susan's bier,  
He seem'd a most despairing swain;  
But bluer sky brought newer tie,  
And—would he wish her back again?

The moments fly, and when we die,  
Will Philly Thistletop complain?  
She'll cry and sigh, and—dry her eye,  
And let herself be woo'd again.

*Frederick Locker-Lampson.*

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## **"I DIDN'T LIKE HIM"**

Perhaps you may a-noticed I been soht o' solemn lately,  
Haven't been a-lookin' quite so pleasant.  
Mabbe I have been a little bit too proud and stately;  
Dat's because I'se lonesome jes' at present.  
I an' him agreed to quit a week or so ago,  
Fo' now dat I am in de social swim  
I'se 'rived to de opinion dat he ain't my style o' beau,  
So I tole him dat my watch was fas' fo' him.

### **REFRAIN**

Oh, I didn't like his clo'es,  
An' I didn't like his eyes,  
Nor his walk, nor his talk,  
Nor his ready-made neckties.  
I didn't like his name a bit,  
Jes' 'spise the name o' Jim;  
If dem ere reasons ain't enough,  
I didn't like *Him*.

Dimon' ring he give to me, an' said it was a fine stone.  
Guess it's only alum mixed wif camphor.  
Took it roun' to Eisenstein; he said it was a rhinestone,  
Kind, he said, he didn't give a dam fur.

Sealskin sack he give to me it got me in a row.  
P'liceman called an' asked to see dat sack;  
Said another lady lost it. Course I don't know how;  
But I had to go to jail or give it back.

**REFRAIN**

Oh, I didn't like his trade;  
Trade dat kep' him out all night.  
He'd de look ob a crook,  
An' he owned a bull's-eye light.  
So when policemen come to ask  
What *I* know 'bout dat Jim,  
I come to de confusion dat  
I didn't like *Him*.

*Harry B. Smith.*

---

## MY ANGELINE

She kept her secret well, oh, yes,  
Her hideous secret well.  
We together were cast, I knew not her past;  
For how was I to tell?  
I married her, guileless lamb I was;  
I'd have died for her sweet sake.  
How could I have known that my Angeline  
Had been a Human Snake?  
Ah, we had been wed but a week or two  
When I found her quite a wreck:  
Her limbs were tied in a double bow-knot  
At the back of her swan-like neck.  
No curse there sprang to my pallid lips,  
Nor did I reproach her then;  
I calmly untied my bonny bride  
And straightened her out again.

### *Refrain*

My Angeline! My Angeline!  
Why didst disturb my mind serene?  
My well-belovèd circus queen,  
My Human Snake, my Angeline!

At night I'd wake at the midnight hour,  
With a weird and haunted feeling,  
And there she'd be, in her *robe de nuit*,  
A-walking upon the ceiling.  
She said she was being "the human fly,"  
And she'd lift me up from beneath  
By a section slight of my garb of night,  
Which she held in her pearly teeth.  
For the sweet, sweet sake of the Human Snake  
I'd have stood this conduct shady;

But she skipped in the end with an old, old friend,  
An eminent bearded lady.  
But, oh, at night, when my slumber's light,  
Regret comes o'er me stealing;  
For I miss the sound of those little feet,  
As they pattered along the ceiling.

*Refrain*

My Angeline! My Angeline!  
Why didst disturb my mind serene?  
My well-belovèd circus queen,  
My Human Snake, my Angeline!

*Harry B. Smith.*

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**NORA'S VOW**

Hear what Highland Nora said,—  
"The Earlie's son I will not wed,  
Should all the race of nature die,  
And none be left but he and I.  
For all the gold, for all the gear,  
And all the lands both far and near,  
That ever valour lost or won,  
I would not wed the Earlie's son."

"A maiden's vows," old Callum spoke,  
"Are lightly made and lightly broke,  
The heather on the mountain's height  
Begins to bloom in purple light;  
The frost-wind soon shall sweep away  
That lustre deep from glen and brae;  
Yet Nora, ere its bloom be gone,



May blithely wed the Earlie's son."

"The swan," she said, "the lake's clear breast  
May barter for the eagle's nest;  
The Awe's fierce stream may backward turn,  
Ben-Cruaichan fall, and crush Kilchurn;  
Our kilted clans, when blood is high,  
Before their foes may turn and fly;  
But I, were all these marvels done,  
Would never wed the Earlie's son."

Still in the water-lily's shade  
Her wonted nest the wild swan made;  
Ben-Cruaichan stands as fast as ever,  
Still downward foams the Awe's fierce river;  
To shun the clash of foeman's steel,  
No Highland brogue has turn'd the heel;  
But Nora's heart is lost and won,  
—She's wedded to the Earlie's son!

*Sir Walter Scott.*

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## HUSBAND AND HEATHEN

O'er the men of Ethiopia she would pour her cornucopia,  
And shower wealth and plenty on the people of Japan,  
Send down jelly cake and candies to the Indians of the Andes,  
And a cargo of plum pudding to the men of Hindoostan;  
And she said she loved 'em so,  
Bushman, Finn, and Eskimo.  
If she had the wings of eagles to their succour she would fly  
Loaded down with jam and jelly,  
Succotash and vermicelli,  
Prunes, pomegranates, plums and pudding, peaches, pineapples, and pie.

She would fly with speedy succour to the natives of Molucca  
With whole loads of quail and salmon, and with tons of fricassee  
And give cake in fullest measure  
To the men of Australasia  
And all the Archipelagoes that dot the southern sea;  
And the Anthropophagi,  
All their lives deprived of pie,  
She would satiate and satisfy with custards, cream, and mince;  
And those miserable Australians  
And the Borriboolighalians,  
She would gorge with choicest jelly, raspberry, currant, grape, and quince.

But like old war-time hardtackers, her poor husband lived on crackers,  
Bought at wholesale from a baker, eaten from the mantelshelf;  
If the men of Madagascar,  
And the natives of Alaska,  
Had enough to sate their hunger, let him look out for himself.  
And his coat had but one tail  
And he used a shingle nail  
To fasten up his galluses when he went out to his work;  
And she used to spend his money  
To buy sugar-plums and honey  
For the Terra del Fuegian and the Turcoman and Turk.

*Sam Walter Foss.*

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## THE LOST PLEIAD

'Twas a pretty little maiden  
In a garden gray and old,  
Where the apple trees were laden  
With the magic fruit of gold;  
But she strayed beyond the portal

Of the garden of the Sun,  
And she flirted with a mortal,  
Which she oughtn't to have done!

For a giant was her father and a goddess was her mother,  
She was Merope or Sterope—the one or else the other;  
And the man was not the equal, though presentable and rich,  
Of Merope or Sterope—I don't remember which!

Now the giant's daughters seven,  
She among them, if you please,  
Were translated to the heaven  
As the starry Pleiades!  
But amid their constellation  
One alone was always dark,  
For she shrank from observation  
Or censorious remark.

She had yielded to a mortal when he came to flirt and flatter.  
She was Merope or Sterope—the former or the latter;  
So the planets all ignored her, and the comets wouldn't call  
On Merope or Sterope—I am not sure at all!

But the Dog-star, brightly shining  
In the hottest of July,  
Saw the pretty Pleiad pining  
In the shadow of the sky,  
And he courted her and kissed her  
Till she kindled into light;  
And the Pleiads' erring sister  
Was the lady of the night!

So her former indiscretion as a fault was never reckoned,  
To Merope or Sterope—the first or else the second,  
And you'll never see so rigidly respectable a dame  
As Merope or Sterope—I can't recall her name!

*Arthur Reed Ropes.*

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## **THE NEW CHURCH ORGAN**

They've got a brand-new organ, Sue,  
For all their fuss and search;  
They've done just as they said they'd do,  
And fetched it into church.  
They're bound the critter shall be seen,  
And on the preacher's right  
They've hoisted up their new machine  
In everybody's sight.  
They've got a chorister and choir,  
Ag'in' *my* voice and vote;  
For it was never *my* desire  
To praise the Lord by note.

I've been a sister good an' true  
For five-an'-thirty year;  
I've done what seemed my part to do,  
An' prayed my duty clear;  
I've sung the hymns both slow and quick,  
Just as the preacher read,  
And twice, when Deacon Tubbs was sick,  
I took the fork an' led;  
And now, their bold, new-fangled ways  
Is comin' all about;  
And I, right in my latter days,  
Am fairly crowded out!

To-day the preacher, good old dear,  
With tears all in his eyes,  
Read, "I can read my title clear

To mansions in the skies."  
I al'ays liked that blessed hymn—  
I s'pose I al'ays will—  
It somehow gratifies *my* whim,  
In good old Ortonville;  
But when that choir got up to sing,  
I couldn't catch a word;  
They sung the most dog-gondest thing  
A body ever heard!

Some worldly chaps was standin' near;  
An' when I see them grin,  
I bid farewell to every fear,  
And boldly waded in.  
I thought I'd chase their tune along,  
An' tried with all my might;  
But though my voice was good an' strong,  
I couldn't steer it right.  
When they was high, then I was low,  
An' also contrawise;  
An' I too fast, or they too slow,  
To "mansions in the skies."

An' after every verse, you know  
They play a little tune;  
I didn't understand, and so  
I started in too soon.  
I pitched it pretty middlin' high,  
I fetched a lusty tone,  
But oh, alas! I found that I  
Was singin' there alone!  
They laughed a little, I am told;  
But I had done my best;  
And not a wave of trouble rolled  
Across my peaceful breast.

And Sister Brown—I could but look—

She sits right front of me;  
She never was no singin'-book,  
An' never went to be;  
But then she al'ays tried to do  
The best she could, she said;  
She understood the time right through,  
An' kep' it with her head;  
But when she tried this mornin', oh,  
I had to laugh, or cough!  
It kep' her head a-bobbin' so,  
It e'en a'most came off.

An' Deacon Tubbs—he all broke 'down,  
As one might well suppose;  
He took one look at Sister Brown,  
And meekly scratched his nose.  
He looked his hymn-book through and through,  
And laid it on the seat,  
And then a pensive sigh he drew,  
And looked completely beat.  
And when they took another bout,  
He didn't even rise;  
But drew his red bandanner out,  
An' wiped his weepin' eyes.

I've been a sister, good an' true,  
For five-an'-thirty year;  
I've done what seemed my part to do,  
An' prayed my duty clear;  
But Death will stop my voice, I know,  
For he is on my track;  
And some day I to church will go,  
And nevermore come back;  
And when the folks gets up to sing—  
Whene'er that time shall be—  
I do not want no *patent* thing  
A-squealin' over me!

*Will Carteton.*

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## **LARRIE O'DEE**

Now the Widow McGee,  
And Larrie O'Dee,  
Had two little cottages out on the green,  
With just room enough for two pig-pens between.  
The widow was young and the widow was fair,  
With the brightest of eyes and the brownest of hair,  
And it frequently chanced, when she came in the morn,  
With the swill for her pig, Larrie came with the corn,  
And some of the ears that he tossed from his hand  
In the pen of the widow were certain to land.

One morning said he:  
"Och! Misthress McGee,  
It's a waste of good lumber, this runnin' two rigs,  
Wid a fancy purtition betwane our two pigs!"  
"Indade, sur, it is!" answered Widow McGee,  
With the sweetest of smiles upon Larrie O'Dee.  
"And thin, it looks kind o' hard-hearted and mane,  
Kapin' two friendly pigs so exsaidenly near  
That whiniver one grunts the other can hear,  
And yit kape a cruel purtition betwane."

"Shwate Widow McGee,"  
Answered Larrie O'Dee,  
"If ye fale in your heart we are mane to the pigs,  
Ain't we mane to ourselves to be runnin' two rigs?  
Och! it made me heart ache when I paped through the cracks  
Of me shanty, lasht March, at yez shwingin' yer axe;  
An' a-bobbin' yer head an' a-shtompin' yer fate,

Wid yer purty white hands jisht as red as a bate,  
A-shplittin' yer kindlin'-wood out in the shtorm,  
When one little shtove it would kape us both warm!"

"Now, piggy," says she,  
"Larrie's courtin' o' me,  
Wid his dilicate tinder allusions to you;  
So now yez must tell me jisht what I must do:  
For, if I'm to say yes, shtir the swill wid yer snout;  
But if I'm to say no, ye must kape yer nose out.  
Now Larrie, for shame! to be bribin' a pig  
By a-tossin' a handful of corn in its shwig!"  
"Me darlint, the piggy says yes," answered he.  
And that was the courtship of Larrie O'Dee.

*William W. Fink.*

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## **NO FAULT IN WOMEN**

No fault in women, to refuse  
The offer which they most would choose.  
No fault in women to confess  
How tedious they are in their dress;  
No fault in women, to lay on  
The tincture of vermilion,  
And there to give the cheek a dye  
Of white, where Nature doth deny.  
No fault in women, to make show  
Of largeness, when they've nothing so;  
When, true it is, the outside swells  
With inward buckram, little else.  
No fault in women, though they be  
But seldom from suspicion free;



No fault in womankind at all,  
If they but slip, and never fall.

*Robert Herrick.*

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## **A COSMOPOLITAN WOMAN**

She went round and asked subscriptions  
For the heathen black Egyptians  
And the Terra del Fuegians,  
    She did;  
For the tribes round Athabasca,  
And the men of Madagascar,  
And the poor souls of Alaska,  
    So she did;  
She longed, she said, to buy  
Jelly, cake, and jam, and pie,  
For the Anthropophagi,  
    So she did.

Her heart ached for the Australians  
And the Borribooli-Ghaliens,  
And the poor dear Amahagger,  
    Yes, it did;  
And she loved the black Numidian,  
And the ebon Abyssinian,  
And the charcoal-coloured Guinean,  
    Oh, she did!  
And she said she'd cross the seas  
With a ship of bread and cheese  
For those starving Chimpanzees,  
    So she did.

How she loved the cold Norwegian  
And the poor half-melted Feejeean,  
And the dear Molucca Islander,

She did:

She sent tins of red tomato  
To the tribes beyond the Equator,  
But her husband ate potato,

So he did;

The poor helpless, homeless thing  
(My voice falters as I sing)  
Tied his clothes up with a string,  
Yes, he did.

*Unknown.*

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## **COURTING IN KENTUCKY**

When Mary Ann Dollinger got the skule daown thar on Injun Bay,  
I was glad, for I like ter see a gal makin' her honest way.  
I heerd some talk in the village abaout her flyin' high,  
Tew high for busy farmer folks with chores ter do ter fly;  
But I paid no sorter attention ter all the talk ontell  
She come in her reg'lar boardin' raound ter visit with us a spell.  
My Jake an' her had been cronies ever since they could walk,  
An' it tuk me aback to hear her kerrectin' him in his talk.

Jake ain't no hand at grammar, though he hain't his beat for work;  
But I sez ter myself, "Look out, my gal, yer a-foolin' with a Turk!"  
Jake bore it wonderful patient, an' said in a mournful way,  
He p'sumed he was behindhand with the doin's at Injun Bay.  
I remember once he was askin' for some o' my Injun buns,  
An' she said he should allus say, "them air," stid o' "them is" the ones.  
Wal, Mary Ann kep' at him stiddy mornin' an' evenin' long,  
Tell he dassent open his mouth for fear o' talkin' wrong.

One day I was pickin' currants daown by the old quince-tree,  
When I heerd Jake's voice a-saying', "Be yer willin' ter marry me?"  
An' Mary Ann kerrectin', 'Air ye willin' yeou sh'd say";  
Our Jake he put his foot daown in a plum, decided way,  
"No wimmen-folks is a-goin' ter be rearrangin' me,  
Hereafter I says 'craps,' 'them is,' 'I calk'late,' an' 'I be.'  
Ef folks don't like my talk they needn't hark ter what I say:.  
But I ain't a-goin' to take no sass from folks from Injun Bay.  
I ask you free an' final, 'Be ye goin' ter marry me?'"  
An' Mary Ann says, tremblin, yet anxious-like, "I be."

*Florence E. Pratt.*

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## **ANY ONE WILL DO**

A maiden once, of certain age,  
To catch a husband did engage;  
But, having passed the prime of life  
In striving to become a wife  
Without success, she thought it time  
To mend the follies of her prime.

Departing from the usual course  
Of paint and such like for resource,  
With all her might this ancient maid  
Beneath an oak-tree knelt and prayed;  
Unconscious that a grave old owl  
Was perched above—the mousing fowl!

"Oh, give! a husband give!" she cried,  
"While yet I may become a bride;  
Soon will my day of grace be o'er,  
And then, like many maids before,

I'll die without an early Jove,  
And none to meet me there above!

"Oh, 'tis a fate too hard to bear!  
Then answer this my humble prayer,  
And oh, a husband give to me!"  
Just then the owl from out the tree,  
In deep bass tones cried, "Who—who—who!"  
"Who, Lord? And dost Thou ask me who?  
Why, any one, good Lord, will do."

*Unknown.*

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## **A BIRD IN THE HAND**

There were three young maids of Lee;  
They were fair as fair can be,  
And they had lovers three times three,  
For they were fair as fair can be,  
These three young maids of Lee.  
But these young maids they cannot find  
A lover each to suit her mind;  
The plain-spoke lad is far too rough,  
The rich young lord is not rich enough,  
The one is too poor, and one is too tall,  
And one just an inch too short for them all.  
"Others pick and choose, and why not we?  
We can very well wait," said the maids of Lee.  
There were three young maids of Lee;  
They were fair as fair can be,  
And they had lovers three times three  
For they were fair as fair can be,  
These three young maids of Lee.

There are three old maids of Lee,  
And they are old as old can be,  
And one is deaf, and one cannot see,  
And they are all as cross as a gallows-tree,  
These three old maids of Lee.

Now, if any one chanced—'tis a chance remote—  
One single charm in these maids to note,  
He need not a poet nor handsome be,  
For one is deaf and one cannot see;  
He need not woo on his bended knee,  
For they all are willing as willing can be.  
He may take the one, or the two, or the three,  
If he'll only take them away from Lee.

There are three old maids at Lee;  
They are cross as cross can be;  
And there they are, and there they'll be  
To the end of the chapter, one, two, three,  
These three old maids of Lee.

*Frederic E. Weatherly.*

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## **THE BELLE OF THE BALL**

Years—years ago,—ere yet my dreams  
Had been of being wise and witty,—  
Ere I had done with writing themes,  
Or yawn'd o'er this infernal Chitty;—  
Years, years ago, while all my joy  
Was in my fowling-piece and filly:  
In short, while I was yet a boy,  
I fell in love with Laura Lily.

I saw her at the county ball;  
    There, when the sounds of flute and fiddle  
Gave signal sweet in that old hall  
    Of hands across and down the middle,  
Hers was the subtlest spell by far  
    Of all that set young hearts romancing:  
She was our queen, our rose, our star;  
    And when she danced—O Heaven, her dancing!

Dark was her hair, her hand was white;  
    Her voice was exquisitely tender,  
Her eyes were full of liquid light;  
    I never saw a waist so slender;  
Her every look, her every smile,  
    Shot right and left a score of arrows;  
I thought 'twas Venus from her isle,  
    And wonder'd where she'd left her sparrows.

She talk'd,—of politics or prayers;  
    Of Southey's prose, or Wordsworth's sonnets;  
Of daggers or of dancing bears,  
    Of battles, or the last new bonnets;  
By candle-light, at twelve o'clock,  
    To me it matter'd not a tittle,  
If those bright lips had quoted Locke,  
    I might have thought they murmur'd Little.

Through sunny May, through sultry June,  
    I loved her with a love eternal;  
I spoke her praises to the moon,  
    I wrote them for the *Sunday Journal*.  
My mother laugh'd; I soon found out  
    That ancient ladies have no feeling;  
My father frown'd; but how should gout  
    See any happiness in kneeling?

She was the daughter of a Dean,

Rich, fat, and rather apoplectic;  
She had one brother, just thirteen,  
Whose color was extremely hectic;  
Her grandmother for many a year  
Had fed the parish with her bounty;  
Her second cousin was a peer,  
And lord lieutenant of the county.

But titles and the three per cents,  
And mortgages, and great relations,  
And India bonds, and tithes and rents,  
Oh! what are they to love's sensations?  
Black eyes, fair forehead, clustering locks,  
Such wealth, such honors, Cupid chooses;  
He cares as little for the stocks,  
As Baron Rothschild for the Muses.

She sketch'd; the vale, the wood, the beach,  
Grew lovelier from her pencil's shading;  
She botanized; I envied each  
Young blossom in her boudoir fading;  
She warbled Handel; it was grand—  
She made the Catalani jealous;  
She touch'd the organ; I could stand  
For hours and hours to blow the bellows.

She kept an album, too, at home,  
Well fill'd with all an album's glories;  
Paintings of butterflies, and Rome,  
Patterns for trimming, Persian stories;  
Soft songs to Julia's cockatoo,  
Fierce odes to Famine and to Slaughter;  
And autographs of Prince Leboo,  
And recipes for elder water.

And she was flatter'd, worshipp'd, bored;  
Her steps were watch'd, her dress was noted;

Her poodle dog was quite adored,  
Her sayings were extremely quoted.  
She laugh'd, and every heart was glad,  
As if the taxes were abolish'd;  
She frown'd, and every look was sad,  
As if the Opera were demolished.

She smil'd on many just for fun—  
I knew that there was nothing in it;  
I was the first—the only one  
Her heart had thought of for a minute;  
I knew it, for she told me so,  
In phrase which was divinely moulded;  
She wrote a charming hand,—and oh!  
How sweetly all her notes were folded!

Our love was like most other loves—  
A little glow, a little shiver;  
A rosebud and a pair of gloves,  
And "Fly Not Yet," upon the river;  
Some jealousy of some one's heir,  
Some hopes of dying broken-hearted,  
A miniature, a lock of hair,  
The usual vows—and then we parted.

We parted;—months and years roll'd by;  
We met again four summers after;  
Our parting was all sob and sigh—  
Our meeting was all mirth and laughter;  
For in my heart's most secret cell,  
There had been many other lodgers;  
And she was not the ballroom belle,  
But only—Mrs. Something Rogers.

*Winthrop Mackworth Praed.*

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## THE RETORT

Old Nick, who taught the village school,  
Wedded a maid of homespun habit;  
He was as stubborn as a mule,  
She was as playful as a rabbit.

Poor Jane had scarce become a wife,  
Before her husband sought to make her  
The pink of country-polished life,  
And prim and formal as a Quaker.

One day the tutor went abroad,  
And simple Jenny sadly missed him;  
When he returned, behind her lord  
She slyly stole, and fondly kissed him!

The husband's anger rose!—and red  
And white his face alternate grew!  
"Less freedom, ma'am!" Jane sighed and said,  
"Oh, dear! I didn't know 'twas you!"

*George Pope Morris.*

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## BEHAVE YOURSEL' BEFORE FOLK

Behave yoursel' before folk,  
Behave yoursel' before folk,  
And dinna be sae rude to me,  
As kiss me sae before folk.

It wadna gi'e me meikle pain,

Gin we were seen and heard by nane,  
To tak' a kiss, or grant you ane;  
But guid sake! no before folk.  
Behave yoursel' before folk,  
Behave yoursel' before folk;  
Whate'er ye do, when out o' view,  
Be cautious aye before folk.

Consider, lad, how folk will crack,  
And what a great affair they'll mak'  
O' naething but a simple smack,  
That's gi'en or ta'en before folk.  
Behave yoursel' before folk,  
Behave yoursel' before folk;  
Nor gi'e the tongue o' auld or young  
Occasion to come o'er folk.

It's no through hatred o' a kiss,  
That I sae plainly tell you this;  
But, loosh! I tak' it sair amiss  
To be sae teased before folk.  
Behave yoursel' before folk,  
Behave yoursel' before folk;  
When we're our lane ye may tak' ane,  
But fient a ane before folk.

I'm sure wi' you I've been as free  
As ony modest lass should be;  
But yet it doesna do to see  
Sic freedom used before folk.  
Behave yoursel' before folk,  
Behave yoursel' before folk;  
I'll ne'er submit again to it—  
So mind you that—before folk.

Ye tell me that my face is fair;  
It may be sae—I dinna care—

But ne'er again gar't blush sae sair  
As ye ha'e done before folk.  
Behave yoursel' before folk,  
Behave yoursel' before folk;  
Nor heat my cheeks wi' your mad freaks,  
But aye de douce before folk.

Ye tell me that my lips are sweet,  
Sic tales, I doubt, are a' deceit;  
At ony rate, it's hardly meet  
To pree their sweets before folk.  
Behave yoursel' before folk,  
Behave yoursel' before folk;  
Gin that's the case, there's time, and place,  
But surely no before folk.

But, gin you really do insist  
That I should suffer to be kiss'd,  
Gae, get a license frae the priest,  
And mak' me yours before folk.  
Behave yoursel' before folk,  
Behave yoursel' before folk;  
And when we're ane, baith flesh and bane,  
Ye may tak' ten—before folk.

*Alexander Rodger.*

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## **THE CHRONICLE: A BALLAD**

Margarita first possess'd,  
If I remember well, my breast,  
Margarita, first of all;  
But when a while the wanton maid

With my restless heart had play'd,  
Martha took the flying ball.

Martha soon did it resign  
To the beauteous Catharine.  
Beauteous Catharine gave place  
(Though loth and angry she to part  
With the possession of my heart)  
To Eliza's conquering face.

Eliza till this hour might reign,  
Had she not evil counsel ta'en:  
Fundamental laws she broke,  
And still new favourites she chose,  
Till up in arms my passions rose,  
And cast away her yoke.

Mary then and gentle Anne,  
Both to reign at once began,  
Alternately they swayed:  
And sometimes Mary was the fair,  
And sometimes Anne the crown did wear,  
And sometimes both I obey'd.

Another Mary then arose,  
And did rigorous laws impose;  
A mighty tyrant she!  
Long, alas, should I have been  
Under that iron-scepter'd queen,  
Had not Rebecca set me free.

When fair Rebecca set me free,  
'Twas then a golden time with me,  
But soon those pleasures fled;  
For the gracious princess died  
In her youth and beauty's pride,  
And Judith reigned in her stead.

One month, three days, and half an hour,  
Judith held the sovereign power,  
    Wondrous beautiful her face;  
But so weak and small her wit,  
That she to govern was unfit,  
    And so Susanna took her place.

But when Isabella came,  
Arm'd with a resistless flame,  
    And th' artillery of her eye;  
Whilst she proudly march'd about  
Greater conquests to find out:  
    She beat out Susan by the bye.

But in her place I then obey'd  
Black-ey'd Bess, her viceroy maid,  
    To whom ensued a vacancy:  
Thousand worse passions then possess'd  
The interregnum of my breast;  
    Bless me from such an anarchy.

Gentle Henrietta then,  
And a third Mary next began;  
    Then Joan, and Jane, and Andria:  
And then a pretty Thomasine,  
And then another Catharine,  
    And then a long et cætera.

But should I now to you relate  
The strength and riches of their state,  
    The powder, patches, and the pins,  
The ribbons, jewels, and the rings,  
The lace, the paint, and warlike things,  
    That make up all their magazines:

If I should tell the politic arts

To take and keep men's hearts;  
The letters, embassies, and spies,  
The frowns, and smiles, and flatteries,  
The quarrels, tears, and perjuries,  
Numberless, nameless, mysteries!

And all the little lime-twigs laid  
By Machiavel, the waiting maid;  
I more voluminous should grow  
(Chiefly if I, like them, should tell  
All change of weather that befel)  
Than Holinshed or Stow.

But I will briefer with them be,  
Since few of them were long with me:  
An higher and a nobler strain  
My present empress does claim,  
Eleonora, first o' th' name,  
Whom God grant long to reign.

*Abraham Cowley.*

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## **BUXOM JOAN**

A soldier and a sailor,  
A tinker and a tailor,  
Had once a doubtful strife, sir,  
To make a maid a wife, sir,  
Whose name was Buxom Joan.  
For now the time was ended,  
When she no more intended  
To lick her lips at men, sir,  
And gnaw the sheets in vain, sir,

And lie o' nights alone.

The soldier swore like thunder,  
He loved her more than plunder;  
And showed her many a scar, sir,  
That he had brought from far, sir,  
    With fighting for her sake.  
The tailor thought to please her,  
With offering her his measure.  
The tinker too with mettle,  
Said he could mend her kettle,  
    And stop up every leak.

But while these three were prating,  
The sailor slily waiting,  
Thought if it came about, sir,  
That they should all fall out, sir,  
    He then might play his part.  
And just e'en as he meant, sir,  
To loggerheads they went, sir,  
And then he let fly at her  
A shot 'twixt wind and water,  
    That won this fair maid's heart.

*William Congreve.*

---

## **OH, MY GERALDINE**

Oh, my Geraldine,  
No flow'r was ever seen so toodle um.  
You are my lum ti toodle lay,  
    Pretty, pretty queen,  
Is rum ti Geraldine and something teen,

More sweet than tiddle lum in May.  
Like the star so bright  
That somethings all the night,  
My Geraldine!  
You're fair as the rum ti lum ti sheen,  
Hark! there is what—ho!  
From something—um, you know,  
Dear, what I mean.  
Oh I rum! tum!! tum!!! my Geraldine.

*F. C. Burnand.*

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## **THE PARTERRE**

I don't know any greatest treat  
As sit him in a gay parterre,  
And sniff one up the perfume sweet  
Of every roses buttoning there.

It only want my charming miss  
Who make to blush the self red rose;  
Oh! I have envy of to kiss  
The end's tip of her splendid nose.

Oh! I have envy of to be  
What grass 'neath her pantoffle push,  
And too much happy seemeth me  
The margaret which her vestige crush.

But I will meet her nose at nose,  
And take occasion for her hairs,  
And indicate her all my woes,  
That she in fine agree my prayers.



#### THE ENVOY

I don't know any greatest treat  
As sit him in a gay parterre,  
With Madame who is too more sweet  
Than every roses buttoning there.

*E. H. Palmer.*

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### HOW TO ASK AND HAVE

"Oh, 'tis time I should talk to your mother,  
Sweet Mary," says I;  
"Oh, don't talk to my mother," says Mary,  
Beginning to cry:  
"For my mother says men are decaivers,  
And never, I know, will consent;  
She says girls in a hurry to marry,  
At leisure repent."

"Then, suppose I should talk to your father,  
Sweet Mary," says I;  
"Oh, don't talk to my father," says Mary,  
Beginning to cry:  
"For my father he loves me so dearly,  
He'll never consent I should go;—  
If you talk to my father," says Mary,  
"He'll surely say 'No.'"

"Then how shall I get you, my jewel,  
Sweet Mary?" says I;  
"If your father and mother's so cruel,  
Most surely I'll die!"  
"Oh, never say die, dear," says Mary;

"A way now to save you I see:  
Since my parents are both so conthrairy,  
You'd better ask *me*."

*Samuel Lover.*

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## **SALLY IN OUR ALLEY**

Of all the girls that are so smart,  
There's none like Pretty Sally;  
She is the darling of my heart,  
And lives in our alley.  
There's ne'er a lady in the land  
That's half so sweet as Sally;  
She is the darling of my heart,  
And lives in our alley.

Her father he makes cabbage-nets,  
And through the streets does cry them;  
Her mother she sells laces long  
To such as please to buy them:  
But sure such folk can have no part  
In such a girl as Sally;  
She is the darling of my heart,  
And lives in our alley.

When she is by, I leave my work,  
I love her so sincerely;  
My master comes, like any Turk,  
And bangs me most severely:  
But let him bang, long as he will,  
I'll bear it all for Sally;  
She is the darling of my heart,

And lives in our alley.

Of all the days are in the week,  
I dearly love but one day,  
And that's the day that comes betwixt  
A Saturday and Monday;  
For then I'm dressed, all in my best,  
To walk abroad with Sally;  
She is the darling of my heart,  
And lives in our alley.

My master carries me to church,  
And often am I blamed,  
Because I leave him in the lurch,  
Soon as the text is named:  
I leave the church in sermon time,  
And slink away to Sally;  
She is the darling of my heart,  
And lives in our alley.

When Christmas comes about again,  
Oh, then I shall have money;  
I'll hoard it up and, box and all,  
I'll give it to my honey;  
Oh, would it were ten thousand pounds,  
I'd give it all to Sally;  
For she's the darling of my heart,  
And lives in our alley.

My master, and the neighbors all,  
Make game of me and Sally,  
And but for her I'd better be  
A slave, and row a galley:  
But when my seven long years are out,  
Oh, then I'll marry Sally,  
And then how happily we'll live—  
But not in our alley.

*Henry Carey.*

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## **FALSE LOVE AND TRUE LOGIC**

### **THE DISCONSOLATE**

My heart will break—I'm sure it will:  
My lover, yes, my favorite—he  
Who seemed my own through good and ill—  
Has basely turned his back on me.

### **THE COMFORTER**

Ah! silly sorrower, weep no more;  
Your lover's turned his back, we see;  
But you had turned his head before,  
And now he's as he ought to be.

*Laman Blanchard.*

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## **PET'S PUNISHMENT**

O, if my love offended me,  
And we had words together,  
To show her I would master be,  
I'd whip her with a feather!

If then she, like a naughty girl,  
Would tyranny declare it,  
I'd give my pet a cross of pearl,

And make her always bear it.

If still she tried to sulk and sigh,  
And threw away my posies,  
I'd catch my darling on the sly,  
And smother her with roses.

But should she clench her dimpled fists,  
Or contradict her betters,  
I'd manacle her tiny wrists  
With dainty jewelled fetters.

And if she dared her lips to pout,  
Like many pert young misses,  
I'd wind my arm her waist about,  
And punish her—with kisses!

*J. Ashby-Sterry.*

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## **AD CHLOEN, M.A.**

### **FRESH FROM HER CAMBRIDGE EXAMINATION**

Lady, very fair are you,  
And your eyes are very blue,  
And your hose;  
And your brow is like the snow,  
And the various things you know,  
Goodness knows.

And the rose-flush on your cheek,  
And your Algebra and Greek  
Perfect are;

And that loving lustrous eye  
Recognizes in the sky  
Every star.

You have pouting piquant lips,  
You can doubtless an eclipse  
Calculate;  
But for your cerulean hue,  
I had certainly from you  
Met my fate.

If by some arrangement dual  
I were Adams mixed with Whewell,  
Then some day  
I, as wooer, perhaps might come  
To so sweet an Artium  
Magistra.

*Mortimer Collins.*

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## **CHLOE, M.A.**

### **AD AMANTEM SUAM**

Careless rhymers, it is true,  
That my favourite colour's blue:  
But am I  
To be made a victim, sir,  
If to puddings I prefer  
Cambridge [pi]?

If with giddier girls I play  
Croquet through the summer day

On the turf,  
Then at night ('tis no great boon)  
Let me study how the moon  
Sways the surf.

Tennyson's idyllic verse  
Surely suits me none the worse  
If I seek  
Old Sicilian birds and bees—  
Music of sweet Sophocles—  
Golden Greek.

You have said my eyes are blue;  
There may be a fairer hue,  
Perhaps—and yet  
It is surely not a sin  
If I keep my secrets in  
Violet.

*Mortimer Collins.*

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## THE FAIR MILLINGER

**By the Watertown Horse-Car Conductor**

It was a millinger most gay,  
As sat within her shop;  
A student came along that way,  
And in he straight did pop.  
Clean shaven he, of massive mould,  
He thought his looks was killing her;  
So lots of stuff to him she sold:  
"Thanks!" says the millinger.

He loafed around and seemed to try  
On all things to converse;  
The millinger did mind her eye,  
But also mound his purse.  
He tried, then, with his flattering tongue,  
With nonsense to be filling her;  
But she was sharp, though she was young:  
"Thanks," said the millinger.

He asked her to the theatre,  
They got into my car;  
Our steeds were tired, could hardly stir,  
He thought the way not far.  
A pretty pict-i-ure she made,  
No doctors had been pilling her;  
Fairly the fair one's fare he paid:  
"Thanks!" said the millinger.

When we arrived in Bowdoin Square,  
A female to them ran;  
Then says that millinger so fair:  
"O, thank you, Mary Ann!  
She's going with us, she is," says she,  
"She only is fulfilling her  
Duty in looking after me:  
Thanks!" said that millinger.

"Why," says that student chap to her,  
"I've but two seats to hand."  
"Too bad," replied that millinger,  
"Then you will have to stand."  
"I won't stand this," says he, "I own  
The joke which you've been drilling her;  
Here, take the seats and go alone!"  
"Thanks!" says the millinger.



That ere much-taken-down young man  
Stepped back into my car.  
We got fresh horses, off they ran;  
He thought the distance far.  
And now she is my better half,  
And oft, when coo-and-billing her,  
I think about that chap and laugh:  
"Thanks!" says my millinger.

*Fred W. Loring.*

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## TWO FISHERS

One morning when Spring was in her teens—  
A morn to a poet's wishing,  
All tinted in delicate pinks and greens—  
Miss Bessie and I went fishing.

I in my rough and easy clothes,  
With my face at the sun-tan's mercy;  
She with her hat tipped down to her nose,  
And her nose tipped—*vice versa*.

I with my rod, my reel, and my hooks,  
And a hamper for lunching recesses;  
She with the bait of her comely looks,  
And the seine of her golden tresses.

So we sat us down on the sunny dike,  
Where the white pond-lilies teeter,  
And I went to fishing like quaint old Ike,  
And she like Simon Peter.

All the noon I lay in the light of her eyes,  
And dreamily watched and waited,  
But the fish were cunning and would not rise,  
And the baiter alone was baited.

And when the time of departure came,  
My bag hung flat as a flounder;  
But Bessie had neatly hooked her game—  
A hundred-and-fifty-pounder.

*Unknown.*

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## MAUD

Nay, I cannot come into the garden just now,  
Tho' it vexes me much to refuse:  
But I *must* have the next set of waltzes, I vow,  
With Lieutenant de Boots of the Blues.

I am sure you'll be heartily pleas'd when you hear  
That our ball has been quite a success.  
As for *me*—I've been looking a monster, my dear.  
In that old-fashion'd guy of a dress.

You had better at once hurry home, dear, to bed;  
It is getting so dreadfully late.  
You may catch the bronchitis or cold in the head  
If you linger so long at our gate.

Don't be obstinate, Alfy; come, take my advice—  
For I know you're in want of repose:  
Take a basin of gruel (you'll find it so nice),  
And remember to tallow your nose.

No, I tell you I can't and I shan't get away,  
For De Boots has implor'd me to sing.  
As to *you*—if you like it, of course you can stay,  
You were always an obstinate thing.

If you feel it a pleasure to talk to the flow'rs  
About "babble and revel and wine,"  
When you might have been snoring for two or three hours,  
Why, it's not the least business of mine.

*Henry S. Leigh.*

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## **ARE WOMEN FAIR?**

"Are women fair?" Ay, wondrous fair to see, too.  
"Are women sweet?" Yea, passing sweet they be, too.  
Most fair and sweet to them that only love them;  
Chaste and discreet to all save them that prove them.

"Are women wise?" Not wise, but they be witty;  
"Are women witty?" Yea, the more the pity;  
They are so witty, and in wit so wily,  
Though ye be ne'er so wise, they will beguile ye.

"Are women fools?" Not fools, but fondlings many;  
"Can women fond be faithful unto any?"  
When snow-white swans do turn to colour sable,  
Then women fond will be both firm and stable.

"Are women saints?" No saints, nor yet no devils;  
"Are women good?" Not good, but needful evils.  
So Angel-like, that devils I do not doubt them,

So needful evils that few can live without them.

"Are women proud?" Ay! passing proud, an praise them.  
"Are women kind?" Ay! wondrous kind, an please them.  
Or so imperious, no man can endure them,  
Or so kind-hearted, any may procure them.

*Francis Davison.*

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## THE PLAIDIE

Upon ane stormy Sunday,  
Coming adoon the lane,  
Were a score of bonnie lassies—  
And the sweetest I maintain  
Was Caddie,  
That I took unneath my plaidie,  
To shield her from the rain.

She said that the daisies blushed  
For the kiss that I had ta'en;  
I wadna hae thought the lassie  
Wad sae of a kiss complain:  
"Now, laddie!  
I winna stay under your plaidie,  
If I gang hame in the rain!"

But, on an after Sunday,  
When cloud there was not ane,  
This selfsame winsome lassie  
(We chanced to meet in the lane),  
Said, "Laddie,

Why dinna ye wear your plaidie?  
Wha kens but it may rain?"

*Charles Sibley.*

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## FEMININE ARITHMETIC

LAURA

On me he shall ne'er put a ring,  
So, mamma, 'tis in vain to take trouble—  
For I was but eighteen in spring  
While his age exactly is double.

MAMMA

He's but in his thirty-sixth year,  
Tall, handsome, good-natured and witty,  
And should you refuse him, my dear,  
May you die an old maid without pity!

LAURA

His figure, I grant you, will pass,  
And at present he's young enough plenty;  
But when I am sixty, alas!  
Will not he be a hundred and twenty?

*Charles Graham Halpine.*

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## LORD GUY

When swallows Northward flew  
Forth from his home did fare  
Guy, Lord of Lanturlaire  
And Lanturlu.

Swore he to cross the brine,  
Pausing not, night nor day,  
That he might Paynims slay  
In Palestine.

Half a league on his way  
Met he a shepherdess  
Beaming with loveliness—  
Fair as Young Day.

Gazed he in eyes of blue—  
Saw love in hiding there  
Guy, Lord of Lanturlaire  
And Lanturlu.

"Let the foul Paynim wait!"  
Plead Love, "and stay with me.  
Cruel and cold the sea—  
Here's brighter fate."

When swallows Southward flew  
Back to his home did fare  
Guy, Lord of Lanturlaire  
And Lanturlu.

Led he his charger gay  
Bearing a shepherdess  
Beaming with happiness—  
Fair as Young Day.

White lambs, be-ribboned blue—

Tends now with anxious care,  
Guy, Lord of Lanturlaire  
And Lanturlu.

*George F. Warren.*

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## **SARY "FIXES UP" THINGS**

Oh, yes, we've be'n fixin' up some sence we sold that piece o' groun'  
Fer a place to put a golf-lynx to them crazy dudes from town.  
(Anyway, they laughed like crazy when I had it specified,  
Ef they put a golf-lynx on it, thet they'd haf to keep him tied.)  
But they paid the price all reg'lar, an' then Sary says to me,  
"Now we're goin' to fix the parlor up, an' settin'-room," says she.  
Fer she 'lowed she'd been a-scrimpin' an' a-scrapin' all her life,  
An' she meant fer once to have things good as Cousin Ed'ard's wife.

Well, we went down to the city, an' she bought the blamedest mess;  
An' them clerks there must 'a' took her fer a' Astoroid, I guess;  
Fer they showed her fancy bureaus which they said was shiffoneers,  
An' some more they said was dressers, an' some curtains called porteeers.  
An' she looked at that there furnicher, an' felt them curtains' heft;  
Then she sailed in like a cyclone an' she bought 'em right an' left;  
An' she picked a Bress'ls carpet thet was flowered like Cousin Ed's,  
But she drawed the line com-pletely when we got to foldin'-beds.

Course, she said, 't 'u'd make the parlor lots more roomier, she s'posed;  
But she 'lowed she'd have a bedstid thet was shore to stay un-closed;  
An' she stopped right there an' told us sev'ral tales of folks she'd read  
Bein' overtook in slumber by the "fatal foldin'-bed."  
"Not ef it wuz set in di'mon's! Nary foldin'-bed fer me!  
I ain't goin' to start fer glory in a rabbit-trap!" says she.  
"When the time comes I'll be ready an' a-waitin'; but ez yet,  
I shan't go to sleep a-thinkin' that I've got the triggers set."

Well, sir, shore as yo"re a-livin', after all thet Sary said,  
'Fore we started home that evenin' she hed bought a foldin'-bed;  
An' she's put it in the parlor, where it adds a heap o' style;  
An' we're sleepin' in the settin'-room at present fer a while.  
Sary still maintains it's han'some, "an' them city folks'll see  
That we're posted on the fashions when they visit us," says she;  
But it plagues her some to tell her, ef it ain't no other use,  
We can set it fer the golf-lynx ef he ever sh'u'd get loose.

*Albert Bigelow Paine.*

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## **THE CONSTANT CANNIBAL MAIDEN**

Far, oh, far is the Mango island,  
Far, oh, far is the tropical sea—  
Palms a-slant and the hills a-smile, and  
A cannibal maiden a-waiting for me.

I've been deceived by a damsel Spanish,  
And Indian maidens both red and brown,  
A black-eyed Turk and a blue-eyed Danish,  
And a Puritan lassie of Salem town.

For the Puritan Prue she sets in the offing,  
A-castin' 'er eyes at a tall marine,  
And the Spanish minx is the wust at scoffing  
Of all of the wimming I ever seen.

But the cannibal maid is a simple creetur,  
With a habit of gazin' over the sea,  
A-hopin' in vain for the day I'll meet 'er,  
And constant and faithful a-yearnin' for me.



Me Turkish sweetheart she played me double—  
Eloped with the Sultan Harum In-Deed,  
And the Danish damsel she made me trouble  
When she ups and married an oblong Swede.

But there's truth in the heart of the maid o' Mango,  
Though her cheeks is black like the kiln-baked cork,  
As she sets in the shade o' the whingo-whango,  
A-waitin' for me—with a knife and fork.

*Wallace Irwin.*

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## **WIDOW BEDOTT TO ELDER SNIFFLES**

O reverend sir, I do declare  
It drives me most to frenzy,  
To think of you a-lying there  
Down sick with influenzy.

A body'd thought it was enough  
To mourn your wife's departer,  
Without sich trouble as this ere  
To come a-follerin' arter.

But sickness and affliction  
Are sent by a wise creation,  
And always ought to be underwent  
By patience and resignation.

O, I could to your bedside fly,  
And wipe your weeping eyes,  
And do my best to cure you up,  
If 'twouldn't create surprise.

It's a world of trouble we tarry in,  
But, Elder, don't despair;  
That you may soon be movin' again  
Is constantly my prayer.

Both sick and well, you may depend  
You'll never be forgot  
By your faithful and affectionate friend,  
PRISCILLA POOL BEDOTT.

*Frances Miriam Whitcher.*

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## UNDER THE MISTLETOE

She stood beneath the mistletoe  
That hung above the door,  
Quite conscious of the sprig above,  
Revered by maids of yore.  
A timid longing filled her heart;  
Her pulses throbbed with heat;  
He sprang to where the fair girl stood.  
"May I—just one—my sweet?"  
He asked his love, who tossed her head,  
"Just do it—if—you dare!" she said.

He sat before the fireplace  
Down at the club that night.  
"She loves me not," he hotly said,  
"Therefore she did but right!"  
She sat alone within her room,  
And with her finger-tips  
She held his picture to her heart,

Then pressed it to her lips.  
"My loved one!" sobbed she, "if you—cared  
You surely would have—would have—dared."

*George Francis Shults.*

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## THE BROKEN PITCHER

It was a Moorish maiden was sitting by a well,  
And what the maiden thought of I cannot, cannot tell.  
When by there rode a valiant knight from the town of Oviedo—  
Alphonso Guzman was he hight, the Count of Desparedo.

"Oh, maiden, Moorish maiden! why sitt'st thou by the spring?  
Say, dost thou seek a lover, or any other thing?  
Why gazest thou upon me, with eyes so large and wide,  
And wherefore doth the pitcher lie broken by thy side?"

"I do not seek a lover, thou Christian knight so gay,  
Because an article like that hath never come my way;  
And why I gaze upon you, I cannot, cannot tell,  
Except that in your iron hose you look uncommon swell.

"My pitcher it is broken, and this the reason is,—  
A shepherd came behind me, and tried to snatch a kiss;  
I would not stand his nonsense, so ne'er a word I spoke,  
But scored him on the costard, and so the jug was broke.

"My uncle, the Alcaydè, he waits for me at home,  
And will not take his tumbler until Zorayda come.  
I cannot bring him water—the pitcher is in pieces—  
And so I'm sure to catch it, 'cos he wallops all his nieces."

"Oh, maiden, Moorish maiden! wilt thou be ruled by me!  
So wipe thine eyes and rosy lips, and give me kisses three;  
And I'll give thee my helmet, thou kind and courteous lady,  
To carry home the water to thy uncle, the Alcaydè."

He lighted down from off his steed—he tied him to a tree—  
He bowed him to the maiden, and took his kisses three:  
"To wrong thee, sweet Zorayda, I swear would be a sin!"  
He knelt him at the fountain, and he dipped his helmet in.

Up rose the Moorish maiden—behind the knight she steals,  
And caught Alphonso Guzman up tightly by the heels;  
She tipped him in, and held him down beneath the bubbling water,—  
"Now, take thou that for venturing to kiss Al Hamet's daughter!"

A Christian maid is weeping in the town of Oviedo;  
She waits the coming of her love, the Count of Desparedo.  
I pray you all in charity, that you will never tell,  
How he met the Moorish maiden beside the lonely well.

*William E. Aytoun.*

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## GIFTS RETURNED

"You must give back," her mother said,  
To a poor sobbing little maid,  
"All the young man has given you,  
Hard as it now may seem to do."  
"'Tis done already, mother dear!"  
Said the sweet girl, "So never fear."  
*Mother.* Are you quite certain? Come, recount  
(There was not much) the whole amount.  
*Girl.* The locket; the kid gloves.

*Mother.* Go on.

*Girl.* Of the kid gloves I found but one.

*Mother.* Never mind that. What else? Proceed.  
You gave back all his trash?

*Girl.* Indeed.

*Mother.* And was there nothing you would save?

*Girl.* Everything I could give I gave.

*Mother.* To the last tittle?

*Girl.* Even to that.

*Mother.* Freely?

*Girl.* My heart went pit-a-pat

At giving up ... ah me! ah me!

I cry so I can hardly see ...

All the fond looks and words that past,

And all the kisses, to the last.

*Walter Savage Landor.*

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### III

# LOVE AND COURTSHIP

## NOUREDDIN, THE SON OF THE SHAH

There once was a Shah had a second son  
Who was very unlike his elder one,  
For he went about on his own affairs,  
And scorned the mosque and the daily prayers;  
When his sire frowned fierce, then he cried, "Ha, ha!"  
    Noureddin, the son of the Shah.

But worst of all of the pranks he played  
Was to fall in love with a Christian maid,—  
An Armenian maid who wore no veil,  
Nor behind a lattice grew thin and pale;  
At his sire's dark threats laughed the youth, "Ha, ha!"  
    Noureddin, the son of the Shah.

"I will shut him close in an iron cage,"  
The monarch said, in a fuming rage;  
But the prince slipped out by a postern door,  
And away to the mountains his loved one bore;  
Loud his glee rang back on the winds, "Ha, ha!"  
    Noureddin, the son of the Shah.

And still in the town of Teheran,  
When a youth and a maid adopt this plan,—  
All frowns and threats with a laugh defy,  
And away from the mosques to the mountains fly,—  
Folk meet and greet with a gay "*Ha, ha!*"  
    *Noureddin, the son of the Shah.*

*Clinton Scollard.*

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## **THE USUAL WAY**

There was once a little man, and his rod and line he took,  
For he said, "I'll go a-fishing in the neighboring brook."  
And it chanced a little maiden was walking out that day,  
And they met—in the usual way.

Then he sat him down beside her, and an hour or two went by,  
But still upon the grassy brink his rod and line did lie;  
"I thought," she shyly whispered, "you'd be fishing all the day!"  
And he was—in the usual way.

So he gravely took his rod in hand, and threw the line about,  
But the fish perceived distinctly that he was not looking out;  
And he said, "Sweetheart, I love you!" but she said she could not stay:  
But she did—in the usual way.

Then the stars came out above them, and she gave a little sigh,  
As they watched the silver ripples, like the moments, running by;  
"We must say good-by," she whispered, by the alders old and gray,  
And they did—in the usual way.

And day by day beside the stream they wandered to and fro,  
And day by day the fishes swam securely down below;  
Till this little story ended, as such little stories may,  
Very much—in the usual way.

And now that they are married, do they always bill and coo?  
Do they never fret and quarrel as other couples do?  
Does he cherish her and love her? Does she honor and obey?  
Well—they do—in the usual way.



Frederic E. Weatherly.

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## THE WAY TO ARCADY

*Oh, what's the way to Arcady,  
To Arcady, to Arcady;  
Oh, what's the way to Arcady,  
Where all the leaves are merry?*

Oh, what's the way to Arcady?  
The spring is rustling in the tree—  
The tree the wind is blowing through—  
It sets the blossoms flickering white.  
I knew not skies could burn so blue  
Nor any breezes blow so light.  
They blow an old-time way for me,  
Across the world to Arcady.

Oh, what's the way to Arcady?  
Sir Poet, with the rusty coat,  
Quit mocking of the song-bird's note.  
How have you heart for any tune,  
You with the wayworn russet shoon?  
Your scrip, a-swinging by your side,  
Gapes with a gaunt mouth hungry-wide.  
I'll brim it well with pieces red,  
If you will tell the way to tread.

*Oh, I am bound for Arcady,  
And if you but keep pace with me  
You tread the way to Arcady.*

And where away lies Arcady,  
And how long yet may the journey be?

*Ah, that (quoth he) I do not know—  
Across the clover and the snow—  
Across the frost, across the flowers—  
Through summer seconds and winter hours  
I've trod the way my whole life long,  
And know not now where it may be;  
My guide is but the stir to song,  
That tells me I cannot go wrong,  
Or clear or dark the pathway be  
Upon the road to Arcady.*

But how shall I do who cannot sing?  
I was wont to sing, once on a time—  
There is never an echo now to ring  
Remembrance back to the trick of rhyme.

*'Tis strange you cannot sing (quoth he),  
The folk all sing in Arcady.*

But how may he find Arcady  
Who hath not youth nor melody?

*What, know you not, old man (quoth he)—  
Your hair is white, your face is wise—  
That Love must kiss that Mortal's eyes  
Who hopes to see fair Arcady?  
No gold can buy you entrance there;  
But beggared Love may go all bare—  
No wisdom won with weariness;  
But Love goes in with Folly's dress—  
No fame that wit could ever win;  
But only Love may lead Love in  
To Arcady, to Arcady.*

Ah, woe is me, through all my days  
Wisdom and wealth I both have got,  
And fame and name, and great men's praise;  
But Love, ah, Love! I have it not.

There was a time, when life was new—  
But far away, and half forgot—  
I only know her eyes were blue;  
But Love—I fear I knew it not.  
We did not wed, for lack of gold,  
And she is dead, and I am old.  
All things have come since then to me,  
Save Love, ah, Love! and Arcady.  
*Ah, then I fear we part* (quoth he),  
*My way's for Love and Arcady.*

But you, you fare alone, like me;  
The gray is likewise in your hair.  
What love have you to lead you there,  
To Arcady, to Arcady?

*Ah, no, not lonely do I fare;  
My true companion's Memory.  
With Love he fills the Spring-time air;  
With Love he clothes the Winter tree.  
Oh, past this poor horizon's bound  
My song goes straight to one who stands—  
Her face all gladdening at the sound—  
To lead me to the Spring-green lands,  
To wander with enlacing hands.  
The songs within my breast that stir  
Are all of her, are all of her.  
My maid is dead long years* (quoth he),  
*She waits for me in Arcady.*

*Oh, yon's the way to Arcady,  
To Arcady, to Arcady;*

*Oh, yon's the way to Arcady,  
Where all the leaves are merry.*

*H. C. Bunner.*

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## MY LOVE AND MY HEART

Oh, the days were ever shiny  
When I ran to meet my love;  
When I press'd her hand so tiny  
Through her tiny tiny glove.  
Was I very deeply smitten?  
Oh, I loved like *anything*!  
But my love she is a kitten,  
And my heart's a ball of string.

She was pleasingly poetic,  
And she loved my little rhymes;  
For our tastes were sympathetic,  
In the old and happy times.  
Oh, the ballads I have written,  
And have taught my love to sing!  
But my love she is a kitten,  
And my heart's a ball of string.

Would she listen to my offer,  
On my knees I would impart  
A sincere and ready proffer  
Of my hand and of my heart.  
And below her dainty mitten  
I would fix a wedding ring—  
But my love she is a kitten,  
And my heart's a ball of string.

Take a warning, happy lover,  
From the moral that I show;  
Or too late you may discover  
What I learn'd a month ago.  
We are scratch'd or we are bitten  
By the pets to whom we cling.  
Oh, my love she is a kitten,  
And my heart's a ball of string.

*Henry S. Leigh.*

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## QUITE BY CHANCE

She flung the parlour window wide  
One eve of mid-July,  
And he, as fate would have it tide,  
That moment sauntered by.  
His eyes were blue and hers were brown,  
With drooping fringe of jet;  
And he looked up as she looked down,  
And so their glances met.  
*Things as strange, I dare to say,  
Happen somewhere every day.*

A mile beyond the straggling street,  
A quiet pathway goes;  
And lovers here are wont to meet,  
As all the country knows.  
Now she one night at half-past eight  
Had sought that lonely lane,  
When *he* came up, by will of fate,  
And so they met again.

*Things as strange, I dare to say,  
Happen somewhere every day.*

The parish church, so old and gray,  
Is quite a sight to see;  
And he was there at ten one day,  
And so, it chanced, was she.  
And while they stood, with cheeks aflame,  
And neighbours liked the fun,  
In stole and hood the parson came,  
And made the couple one.  
*Things as strange, I dare to say,  
Happen somewhere every day.*

*Frederick Langbridge.*

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## THE NUN

**SUGGESTED BY PART OF THE ITALIAN SONG, BEGINNING "SE  
MONECA TI FAI."**

### I

If you become a nun, dear,  
A friar I will be;  
In any cell you run, dear,  
Pray look behind for me.  
The roses all turn pale, too;  
The doves all take the veil, too;  
The blind will see the show:  
What! you become a nun, my dear!  
I'll not believe it, no.

### II

If you become a nun, dear,  
The bishop Love will be;  
The Cupids every one, dear,  
Will chaunt "We trust in thee";  
The incense will go sighing,  
The candles fall a dying,  
The water turn to wine:  
What! you go take the vows, my dear!  
You may—but they'll be mine.

*Leigh Hunt.*

---

## THE CHEMIST TO HIS LOVE

I love thee, Mary, and thou lovest me—  
Our mutual flame is like th' affinity  
That doth exist between two simple bodies:  
I am Potassium to thine Oxygen.  
'Tis little that the holy marriage vow  
Shall shortly make us one. That unity  
Is, after all, but metaphysical.  
Oh, would that I, my Mary, were an acid,  
A living acid; thou an alkali  
Endow'd with human sense, that, brought together,  
We both might coalesce into one salt,  
One homogeneous crystal. Oh, that thou  
Wert Carbon, and myself were Hydrogen;  
We would unite to form olefiant gas,  
Or common coal, or naphtha—would to heaven  
That I were Phosphorus, and thou wert Lime!  
And we of Lime composed a Phosphuret.  
I'd be content to be Sulphuric Acid,  
So that thou might be Soda. In that case

We should be Glauber's Salt. Wert thou Magnesia  
Instead we'd form the salt that's named from Epsom.  
Couldst thou Potassa be, I Aqua-fortis,  
Our happy union should that compound form,  
Nitrate of Potash—otherwise Saltpetre.  
And thus our several natures sweetly blent,  
We'd live and love together, until death  
Should decompose the fleshly *tertium quid*,  
Leaving our souls to all eternity  
Amalgamated. Sweet, thy name is Briggs  
And mine is Johnson. Wherefore should not we  
Agree to form a Johnsonate of Briggs?

*Unknown.*

---

## CATEGORICAL COURTSHIP

I sat one night beside a blue-eyed girl—  
The fire was out, and so, too, was her mother;  
A feeble flame around the lamp did curl,  
Making faint shadows, blending in each other:  
'Twas nearly twelve o'clock, too, in November;  
She had a shawl on, also, I remember.

Well, I had been to see her every night  
For thirteen days, and had a sneaking notion  
To pop the question, thinking all was right,  
And once or twice had make an awkward motion  
To take her hand, and stammer'd, cough'd, and stutter'd,  
But, somehow, nothing to the point had utter'd.

I thought this chance too good now to be lost;  
I hitched my chair up pretty close beside her,



Drew a long breath, and then my legs I cross'd,  
Bent over, sighed, and for five minutes eyed her:  
She looked as if she knew what next was coming,  
And with her feet upon the floor was drumming.

I didn't know how to begin, or where—  
I couldn't speak—the words were always choking;  
I scarce could move—I seem'd tied to the chair—  
I hardly breathed—'twas awfully provoking!  
The perspiration from each pore came oozing,  
My heart, and brain, and limbs their power seem'd losing.

At length I saw a brindle tabby cat  
Walk purring up, inviting me to pat her;  
An idea came, electric-like at that—  
My doubts, like summer clouds, began to scatter,  
I seized on tabby, though a scratch she gave me,  
And said, "Come, Puss, ask Mary if she'll have me."

'Twas done at once—the murder now was out;  
The thing was all explain'd in half a minute.  
She blush'd, and, turning pussy-cat about,  
Said, "Pussy, tell him 'yes'"; her foot was in it!  
The cat had thus saved me my category,  
And here's the catastrophe of my story.

*Unknown.*

---

## LANTY LEARY

Lanty was in love, you see,  
With lovely, lively Rosie Carey;  
But her father can't agree

To give the girl to Lanty Leary.  
Up to fun, "Away we'll run,"  
Says she, "my father's so contrary.  
Won't you follow me? Won't you follow me?"  
"Faith, I will!" says Lanty Leary.

But her father died one day  
(I hear 'twas not by dhrinkin' wather);  
House and land and cash, they say,  
He left, by will, to Rose, his daughter;  
House and land and cash to seize,  
Away she cut so light and airy.  
"Won't you follow me? Won't you follow me?"  
"Faith, I will!" says Lanty Leary.

Rose, herself, was taken bad;  
The fayver worse each day was growin';  
"Lanty, dear," says she, "'tis sad,  
To th' other world I'm surely goin'.  
You can't survive my loss, I know,  
Nor long remain in Tipperary.  
Won't you follow me? Won't you follow me?"  
"Faith, I won't!" says Lanty Leary.

*Samuel Lover.*

---

## THE SECRET COMBINATION

Her heart she locked fast in her breast,  
Away from molestation;  
The lock was warranted the best—  
A patent combination.  
She knew no simple lock and key

Would serve to keep out Love and me.

But Love a clever cracksman is,  
And cannot be resisted;  
He likes such stubborn jobs as this,  
Complex and hard and twisted,  
And though we worked a many day,  
At last we bore her heart away.

For Love has learned full many tricks  
In his strange avocation;  
He knew the figures were but six  
In this, her combination;  
Nor did we for a minute rest  
Until we had unlocked her breast.

First, then, we turned the knob to "Sighs,"  
Then back to "Words Sincerest,"  
Then "Gazing Fondly in Her Eyes,"  
Then "Softly Murmured 'Dearest;'"  
Then, next, "A Warm Embrace" we tried,  
And at "A Kiss" the door flew wide.

*Ellis Parker Butler.*

---

## **FORTY YEARS AFTER**

We climbed to the top of Goat Point hill,  
Sweet Kitty, my sweetheart, and I;  
And watched the moon make stars on the waves,  
And the dim white ships go by,  
While a throne we made on a rough stone wall,  
And the king and the queen were we;

And I sat with my arm about Kitty,  
And she with her arm about me.

The water was mad in the moonlight,  
And the sand like gold where it shone,  
And our hearts kept time to its music,  
As we sat in the splendour alone.  
And Kitty's dear eyes twinkled brightly,  
And Kitty's brown hair blew so free,  
While I sat with my arm about Kitty,  
And she with her arm about me.

Last night we drove in our carriage,  
To the wall at the top of the hill;  
And though we're forty years older,  
We're children and sweethearts still.  
And we talked again of that moonlight  
That danced so mad on the sea,  
When I sat with my arm about Kitty,  
And she with her arm about me.

The throne on the wall was still standing,  
But we sat in the carriage last night,  
For a wall is too high for old people  
Whose foreheads have linings of white.  
And Kitty's waist measure is forty,  
While mine is full fifty and three,  
So I can't get my arm about Kitty,  
Nor can she get both hers around me.

*H. H. Porter.*

---

**CUPID**

Beauties, have ye seen this toy,  
Calléd love, a little boy  
Almost naked, wanton, blind,  
Cruel now, and then as kind?  
If he be amongst ye, say!  
He is Venus' runaway.

He hath of marks about him plenty;  
Ye shall know him among twenty;  
All his body is a fire,  
And his breath a flame entire,  
That, being shot like lightning in,  
Wounds the heart, but not the skin.

He doth bear a golden bow,  
And a quiver, hanging low,  
Full of arrows, that outbrave  
Dian's shafts, where, if he have  
Any head more sharp than other,  
With that first he strikes his mother.

Trust him not: his words, though sweet,  
Seldom with his heart do meet;  
All his practice is deceit,  
Every gift is but a bait;  
Not a kiss but poison bears,  
And most treason in his tears.

If by these ye please to know him,  
Beauties, be not nice, but show him,  
Though ye had a will to hide him.  
Now, we hope, ye'll not abide him,  
Since ye hear his falser play,  
And that he's Venus' runaway.

*Ben Jonson.*

---

## PARING-TIME ANTICIPATED

I shall not ask Jean Jacques Rousseau  
If birds confabulate or no;  
'Tis clear that they were always able  
To hold discourse, at least in fable;  
And e'en the child who knows no better  
Than to interpret, by the letter,  
A story of a cock and bull,  
Must have a most uncommon skull.  
It chanced, then, on a winter's day,  
But warm, and bright, and calm as May,  
The birds, conceiving a design  
To forestall sweet St. Valentine,  
In many an orchard, copse, and grove,  
Assembled on affairs of love,  
And, with much twitter and much chatter,  
Began to agitate the matter.  
At length a bullfinch, who could boast  
More years and wisdom than the most,  
Entreated, opening wide his beak,  
A moment's liberty to speak;  
And, silence publicly enjoin'd,  
Deliver'd briefly thus his mind:  
"My friends, be cautious how ye treat  
The subject upon which we meet;  
I fear we shall have winter yet."  
A finch, whose tongue knew no control,  
With golden wing and satin poll,  
A last year's bird, who ne'er had tried  
What marriage means, thus pert replied:  
"Methinks the gentleman," quoth she,  
"Opposite in the apple-tree,  
By his good-will would keep us single

Till yonder heaven and earth shall mingle,  
Or—which is likelier to befall—  
'Til death exterminate us all.  
I marry without more ado.  
My dear Dick Redcap, what say you?"  
Dick heard, and tweedling, ogling, bridling,  
Turned short 'round, strutting, and sidling,  
Attested, glad, his approbation  
Of an immediate conjugation.  
Their sentiments, so well express'd,  
Influenced mightily the rest;  
All pair'd, and each pair built a nest.  
But, though the birds were thus in haste,  
The leaves came on not quite so fast,  
And destiny, that sometimes bears  
An aspect stern on man's affairs,  
Not altogether smiled on theirs.  
The wind, of late breathed gently forth,  
Now shifted east, and east by north;  
Bare trees and shrubs but ill, you know,  
Could shelter them from rain or snow.  
Stepping into their nests, they paddled,  
Themselves were chill'd, their eggs were addled.  
Soon every father bird and mother  
Grew quarrelsome, and peck'd each other,  
Parted without the least regret,  
Except that they had ever met,  
And learn'd in future to be wiser  
Than to neglect a good adviser.

#### MORAL

Misses, the tale that I relate  
This lesson seems to carry:  
Choose not alone a proper mate,  
But proper time to marry.

*William Cowper.*

---

## WHY

Do you know why the rabbits are caught in the snare  
Or the tabby cat's shot on the tiles?  
Why the tigers and lions creep out of their lair?  
Why an ostrich will travel for miles?  
Do you know why a sane man will whimper and cry  
And weep o'er a ribbon or glove?  
Why a cook will put sugar for salt in a pie?  
Do you know? Well, I'll tell you—it's Love.

*H. P. Stevens.*

---

## THE SABINE FARMER'S SERENADE

### I

'Twas on a windy night,  
At two o'clock in the morning,  
An Irish lad so tight,  
All wind and weather scorning,  
At Judy Callaghan's door.  
Sitting upon the palings,  
His love-tale he did pour,  
And this was part of his wailings:—  
*Only say*  
*You'll be Mrs. Brallaghan;*  
*Don't say nay,*  
*Charming Judy Callaghan.*

### II



Oh! list to what I say,  
Charms you've got like Venus;  
Own your love you may,  
There's but the wall between us.  
You lie fast asleep  
Snug in bed and snoring;  
Round the house I creep,  
Your hard heart imploring.  
*Only say*  
*You'll have Mr. Brallaghan;*  
*Don't say nay,*  
*Charming Judy Callaghan.*

### III

I've got a pig and a sow,  
I've got a sty to sleep 'em  
A calf and a brindled cow,  
And a cabin too, to keep 'em;  
Sunday hat and coat,  
An old grey mare to ride on,  
Saddle and bridle to boot,  
Which you may ride astride on.  
*Only say*  
*You'll be Mrs. Brallaghan;*  
*Don't say nay,*  
*Charming Judy Callaghan.*

### IV

I've got an acre of ground,  
I've got it set with praties;  
I've got of 'baccy a pound,  
I've got some tea for the ladies;  
I've got the ring to wed,  
Some whisky to make us gaily;  
I've got a feather bed  
And a handsome new shillelagh.  
*Only say*

*You'll have Mr. Brallaghan;  
Don't say nay,  
Charming Judy Callaghan.*

V

*You've got a charming eye,  
You've got some spelling and reading  
You've got, and so have I,  
A taste for genteel breeding;  
You're rich, and fair, and young,  
As everybody's knowing;  
You've got a decent tongue  
Whene'er 'tis set a-going.  
Only say  
You'll be Mrs. Brallaghan;  
Don't say nay,  
Charming Judy Callaghan.*

VI

*For a wife till death  
I am willing to take ye;  
But, och! I waste my breath,  
The devil himself can't wake ye.  
'Tis just beginning to rain,  
So I'll get under cover;  
To-morrow I'll come again,  
And be your constant lover.  
Only say  
You'll be Mrs. Brallaghan;  
Don't say nay,  
Charming Judy Callaghan.*

*Father Prout.*

---

## I HAE LAID A HERRING IN SAUT

I hae laid a herring in saut—  
Lass, gin ye lo'e me, tell me now;  
I hae brew'd a forpit o' maut,  
And I canna come ilka day to woo:

I hae a calf that will soon be a cow—  
Lass, gin ye lo'e me, tell me now;  
I hae a stook, and I'll soon hae a mowe,  
And I canna come ilka day to woo:

I hae a house upon yon moor—  
Lass, gin ye lo'e me, tell me now;  
Three sparrows may dance upon the floor,  
And I canna come ilka day to woo:  
I hae a but, and I hae a ben—  
Lass, gin ye lo'e me, tell me now;  
A penny to keep, and a penny to spen',  
And I canna come ilka day to woo:

I hae a hen wi' a happitie leg—  
Lass, gin ye lo'e me, tell me now;  
That ilka day lays me an egg,  
And I canna come ilka day to woo:  
I hae a cheese upon my skelf—  
Lass, gin ye lo'e me, tell me now;  
And soon wi' mites 'twill rin itself,  
And I canna come ilka day to woo.

*James Tytler.*

---

## THE CLOWN'S COURTSHIP

Quoth John to Joan, will thou have me;  
I prithee now, wilt? and I'll marry thee,  
My cow, my calf, my house, my rents,  
And all my lands and tenements:  
Oh, say, my Joan, will not that do?  
I cannot come every day to woo.

I've corn and hay in the barn hardby,  
And three fat hogs pent up in the sty,  
I have a mare and she is coal black,  
I ride on her tail to save my back.  
Then say, etc.

I have a cheese upon the shelf,  
And I cannot eat it all myself;  
I've three good marks that lie in a rag,  
In a nook of the chimney, instead of a bag.  
Then say, etc.

To marry I would have thy consent,  
But faith I never could compliment;  
I can say nought but "Hoy, gee ho!"  
Words that belong to the cart and the plough.  
So say, my Joan, will not that do,  
I cannot come every day to woo.  
*Unknown.*

---

## OUT UPON IT

Out upon it, I have loved  
Three whole days together;

And am like to love three more,  
If it prove fair weather.

Time shall moult away his wings,  
Ere he shall discover  
In the whole wide world again  
Such a constant Lover.

But the spite on't is, no praise  
Is due at all to me:  
Love with me had made no stays,  
Had it any been but she.

Had it any been but she,  
And that very face,  
There had been at least ere this  
A dozen dozen in her place.

*Sir John Suckling.*

---

## LOVE IS LIKE A DIZZINESS

I lately lived in quiet case,  
An' ne'er wish'd to marry, O!  
But when I saw my Peggy's face,  
I felt a sad quandary, O!  
Though wild as ony Athol deer,  
She has trepann'd me fairly, O!  
Her cherry cheeks an' een sae clear  
Torment me late an' early O!  
O, love, love, love!  
Love is like a dizziness;  
It winna let a poor body

Gang about his bizness!

To tell my feats this single week  
Wad mak a daft-like diary, O!  
I drave my cart out ow'r a dike,  
My horses in a miry, O!  
I wear my stockings white an' blue,  
My love's sae fierce an' fiery, O!  
I drill the land that I should pleugh,  
An' pleugh the drills entirely, O!  
O, love, love, love! etc.

Ae morning, by the dawn o' day,  
I rase to theek the stable, O!  
I keust my coat, and plied away  
As fast as I was able, O!  
I wrought that morning out an' out,  
As I'd been redding fire, O!  
When I had done an look'd about,  
Gudefaith, it was the byre, O!  
O, love, love, love! etc.

Her wily glance I'll ne'er forget,  
The dear, the lovely blinkin o't  
Has pierced me through an' through the heart,  
An' plagues me wi' the prinking o't.  
I tried to sing, I tried to pray,  
I tried to drown't wi' drinkin' o't,  
I tried with sport to drive't away,  
But ne'er can sleep for thinkin' o't.  
O, love, love, love! etc.

Nae man can tell what pains I prove,  
Or how severe my pliskie, O!  
I swear I'm sairer drunk wi' love  
Than ever I was wi' whiskey, O!  
For love has raked me fore an' aft,

I scarce can lift a leggie, O!  
I first grew dizzy, then gaed daft,  
An' soon I'll dee for Peggy, O!  
O, love, love, love!  
Love is like a dizziness;  
It winna let a poor body  
Gang about his bizness!

*James Hogg.*

---

## THE KITCHEN CLOCK

Knitting is the maid o' the kitchen, Milly,  
Doing nothing sits the chore boy, Billy:  
"Seconds reckoned,  
Seconds reckoned;  
Every minute,  
Sixty in it.  
Milly, Billy,  
Billy, Milly,  
Tick-tock, tock-tick,  
Nick-knock, knock-nick,  
Knockety-nick, nickety-knock,"—  
Goes the kitchen clock.

Closer to the fire is rosy Milly,  
Every whit as close and cosy, Billy:  
"Time's a-flying,  
Worth your trying;  
Pretty Milly—  
Kiss her, Billy!  
Milly, Billy,  
Billy, Milly,

Tick-tock, tock-tick,  
Now—now, quick—quick!  
Knockety-nick, nickety-knock,"—  
Goes the kitchen clock.

Something's happened, very red is Milly,  
Billy boy is looking very silly;  
"Pretty misses,  
Plenty kisses;  
Make it twenty,  
Take a plenty.  
Billy, Milly,  
Milly, Billy,  
Right—left, left—right,  
That's right, all right,  
Knockety-nick, nickety-knock,"—  
Goes the kitchen clock.

Weeks gone, still they're sitting, Milly, Billy;  
O, the winter winds are wondrous chilly!  
"Winter weather,  
Close together;  
Wouldn't tarry,  
Better marry.  
Milly, Billy,  
Billy, Milly,  
Two—one, one—two,  
Don't wait, 'twon't do,  
Knockety-nick, nickety-knock,"—  
Goes the kitchen clock.

Winters two have gone, and where is Milly?  
Spring has come again, and where is Billy?  
"Give me credit,  
For I did it;  
Treat me kindly,  
Mind you wind me.



Mister Billy,  
Mistress Milly,  
My—O, O—my,  
By-by, by-by,  
Nickety-knock, cradle rock,"—  
Goes the kitchen clock.

*John Vance Cheney.*

---

## **LADY MINE**

Lady mine, most fair thou art  
With youth's gold and white and red;  
'Tis a pity that thy heart  
Is so much harder than thy head.

This has stayed my kisses oft,  
This from all thy charms debarr'd,  
That thy head is strangely soft,  
While thy heart is strangely hard.

Nothing had kept us apart—  
I had loved thee, I had wed—  
Hadst thou had a softer heart  
Or a harder head.

But I think I'll bear Love's smart  
Till the wound has healed and fled,  
Or thy head is like thy heart,  
Or thy heart is like thy head.

*H. E. Clarke.*

---

## BALLADE OF THE GOLFER IN LOVE

In the "foursome" some would fain  
Find nepenthe for their woe;  
Following through shine or rain  
Where the "greens" like satin show;  
But I vote such sport as "slow"—  
Find it rather glum and gruesome;  
With a little maid I know  
I would play a quiet "twosome"!

In the "threesome," some maintain,  
Lies excitement's gayest glow—  
Strife that mounts unto the brain  
Like the sparkling *Veuve Clicquot*;  
My opinion? Nay, not so!  
Noon or eve or morning dewsome  
With a little maid I know  
I would play a quiet "twosome"!

Bays of glory some would gain  
With grim "Bogey" for their foe;  
(He's a bogey who's not slain  
Save one smite with canny blow!)  
Yet I hold this tame, and though  
My refrain seems trite, 'tis truesome;  
With a little maid I know  
I would play a quiet "twosome"!

### ENVOY

Comrades all who golfing go,  
Happiness—if you would view some—  
With a little maid *you* know,  
Haste and play a quiet "twosome"!

*Clinton Scollard.*

---

## **BALLADE OF FORGOTTEN LOVES**

Some poets sing of sweethearts dead,  
Some sing of true loves far away;  
Some sing of those that others wed,  
And some of idols turned to clay.  
I sing a pensive roundelay  
To sweethearts of a doubtful lot,  
The passions vanished in a day—  
The little loves that I've forgot.

For, as the happy years have sped,  
And golden dreams have changed to gray,  
How oft the flame of love was fed  
By glance, or smile, from Maud or May,  
When wayward Cupid was at play;  
Mere fancies, formed of who knows what,  
But still my debt I ne'er can pay—  
The little loves that I've forgot.

O joyous hours forever fled!  
O sudden hopes that would not stay!  
Held only by the slender thread  
Of memory that's all astray.  
Their very names I cannot say.  
Time's will is done, I know them not;  
But blessings on them all, I pray—  
The little loves that I've forgot.

ENVOI

Sweetheart, why foolish fears betray?  
Ours is the one true lovers' knot;  
Note well the burden of my lay—  
The little loves that I've forgot.

*Arthur Grissom.*

---

# IV

# SATIRE

## A BALLADE OF SUICIDE

The gallows in my garden, people say,  
Is new and neat and adequately tall.  
I tie the noose on in a knowing way  
As one that knots his necktie for a ball;  
But just as all the neighbours—on the wall—  
Are drawing a long breath to shout "Hurrray!"  
The strangest whim has seized me.... After all  
I think I will not hang myself to-day.

To-morrow is the time I get my pay—  
My uncle's sword is hanging in the hall—  
I see a little cloud all pink and grey—  
Perhaps the rector's mother will *not* call—  
I fancy that I heard from Mr. Gall  
That mushrooms could be cooked another way—  
I never read the works of Juvenal—  
I think I will not hang myself to-day.

The world will have another washing day;  
The decadents decay; the pedants pall;  
And H. G. Wells has found that children play,  
And Bernard Shaw discovered that they squall;  
Rationalists are growing rational—  
And through thick woods one finds a stream astray,  
So secret that the very sky seems small—  
I think I will not hang myself to-day.

ENVOI

Prince, I can hear the trump of Germinal,  
The tumbrils toiling up the terrible way;  
Even to-day your royal head may fall—  
I think I will not hang myself to-day.

*G. K. Chesterton.*

---

## FINNIGIN TO FLANNIGAN

Superintendent wuz Flannigan;  
Boss av the siction wuz Finnigin;  
Whiniver the kyars got offen the thrack,  
An' muddled up things t' th' divil an' back,  
Finnigin writ it to Flannigan,  
Afther the wrick wuz all on ag'in;  
That is, this Finnigin  
Repoorted to Flannigan.

Whin Finnigin furst writ to Flannigan,  
He writed tin pages—did Finnigin,  
An' he tould jist how the smash occurred;  
Full minny a tajus, blunderin' wurrd  
Did Finnigin write to Flannigan  
Afther the cars had gone on ag'in.  
That wuz how Finnigin  
Repoorted to Flannigan.

Now Flannigan knowed more than Finnigin—  
He'd more idjucation, had Flannigan;  
An' it wore'm clane an' completely out  
To tell what Finnigin writ about  
In his writin' to Muster Flannigan.  
So he writed back to Finnigin:

"Don't do sich a sin ag'in;  
Make 'em brief, Finnigin!"

Whin Finnigin got this from Flannigan,  
He blushed rosy rid, did Finnigin;  
An' he said: "I'll gamble a whole month's pa-ay  
That it will be minny an' minny a da-ay  
Befoore Sup'rintindint—that's Flannigan—  
Gits a whack at this very same sin ag'in.  
From Finnigin to Flannigan  
Repoorts won't be long ag'in."

---

Wan da-ay, on the siction av Finnigin,  
On the road sup'rintinded by Flannigan,  
A rail give way on a bit av a curve,  
An' some kyars went off as they made the swerve.  
"There's nobody hurtet," sez Finnigin,  
"But repoorts must be made to Flannigan."  
An' he winked at McGorrigan,  
As married a Finnigin.

He wuz shantyin' thin, wuz Finnigin,  
As minny a railroader's been ag'in,  
An' the shmoky ol' lamp wuz burnin' bright  
In Finnigin's shanty all that night—  
Bilin' down his repoort, was Finnigin!  
An' he writed this here: "Muster Flannigan:  
Off ag'in, on ag'in,  
Gone ag'in—Finnigin."

*S. W. Gillinan.*

---

**STUDY OF AN ELEVATION, IN INDIAN INK**



Potiphar Gubbins, C. E.,  
Stands at the top of the tree;  
And I muse in my bed on the reasons that led  
To the hoisting of Potiphar G.

Potiphar Gubbins, C. E.,  
Is seven years junior to Me;  
Each bridge that he makes either buckles or breaks,  
And his work is as rough as he.

Potiphar Gubbins, C. E.,  
Is coarse as a chimpanzee;  
And I can't understand why you gave him your hand,  
Lovely Mehitabel Lee.

Potiphar Gubbins, C. E.,  
Is dear to the Powers that Be;  
For they bow and They smile in an affable style  
Which is seldom accorded to Me.

Potiphar Gubbins, C. E.,  
Is certain as certain can be  
Of a highly paid post which is claimed by a host  
Of seniors—including Me.

Careless and lazy is he,  
Greatly inferior to Me.  
What is the spell that you manage so well,  
Commonplace Potiphar G.?

Lovely Mehitabel Lee,  
Let me inquire of thee,  
Should I have riz to what Potiphar is,  
Hadst thou been mated to Me?

*Rudyard Kipling.*

---

## THE V-A-S-E

From the madding crowd they stand apart,  
The maidens four and the Work of Art;

And none might tell from sight alone  
In which had culture ripest grown,—

The Gotham Million fair to see,  
The Philadelphia Pedigree,

The Boston Mind of azure hue,  
Or the soulful Soul from Kalamazoo,—

For all loved Art in a seemly way,  
With an earnest soul and a capital A.

---

Long they worshiped; but no one broke  
The sacred stillness, until up spoke

The Western one from the nameless place,  
Who blushing said, "What a lovely vase!"

Over three faces a sad smile flew,  
And they edged away from Kalamazoo.

But Gotham's haughty soul was stirred  
To crush the stranger with one small word.

Deftly hiding reproof in praise,  
She cries, "'Tis, indeed, a lovely vase!"

But brief her unworthy triumph when  
The lofty one from the house of Penn,

With the consciousness of two grandpapas,  
Exclaims, "It is quite a lovely vahs!"

And glances round with an anxious thrill,  
Awaiting the word of Beacon Hill.

But the Boston maid smiles courteouslee,  
And gently murmurs, "Oh, pardon me!

"I did not catch your remark, because  
I was so entranced with that lovely vaws!"

*Dies erit praegelida  
Sinistra quum Bostonia.*

*James Jeffrey Roche.*

---

## **MINIVER CHEEVY**

Miniver Cheevy, child of scorn,  
Grew lean while he assailed the seasons;  
He wept that he was ever born,  
And he had reasons.

Miniver loved the days of old  
When swords were bright and steeds were prancing;  
The vision of a warrior bold  
Would set him dancing.

Miniver sighed for what was not,  
And dreamed and rested from his labors;  
He dreamed of Thebes and Camelot

And Priam's neighbors.

Miniver mourned the ripe renown  
That made so many a name so fragrant;  
He mourned Romance, now on the town,  
And Art, a vagrant.

Miniver loved the Medici,  
Albeit he had never seen one;  
He would have sinned incessantly  
Could he have been one.

Miniver cursed the commonplace,  
And eyed a khaki suit with loathing;  
He missed the mediæval grace  
Of iron clothing.

Miniver scorned the gold he sought,  
But sore annoyed he was without it;  
Miniver thought and thought and thought  
And thought about it.

Miniver Cheevy, born too late,  
Scratched his head and kept on thinking;  
Miniver coughed, and called it fate,  
And kept on drinking.

*Edwin Arlington Robinson.*

---

## THE RECRUIT

Sez Corporal Madden to Private McFadden:  
"Bedad, yer a bad un!"

Now turn out yer toes!  
Yer belt is unhookit,  
Yer cap is on crookit,  
Ye may not be dhrunk,  
But, be jabers, ye look it!  
Wan—two!  
Wan—two!  
Ye monkey-faced divil, I'll jolly ye through!  
Wan—two!—  
Time! Mark!  
Ye march like the aigle in Cintheral Parrk!"

Sez Corporal Madden to Private McFadden:  
"A saint it ud sadden  
To dhrill such a mug!  
Eyes front!—ye baboon, ye!—  
Chin up!—ye gossoon, ye!  
Ye've jaws like a goat—  
Halt! ye leather-lipped loon, ye!  
Wan—two!  
Wan—two!  
Ye whiskered orang-outang, I'll fix you!  
Wan—two!—  
Time! Mark!  
Ye've eyes like a bat!—can ye see in the dark?"

Sez Corporal Madden to Private McFadden:  
"Yer figger wants padd'n'—  
Sure, man, ye've no shape!  
Behind ye yer shoulders  
Stick out like two boulders;  
Yer shins is as thin  
As a pair of pen-holders!  
Wan—two!  
Wan—two!  
Yer belly belongs on yer back, ye Jew!  
Wan—two!—

Time! Mark!  
I'm dhry as a dog—I can't shpake but I bark!"

Sez Corporal Madden to Private McFadden:

"Me heart it ud gladden  
To blacken your eye.  
Ye're gettin' too bold, ye  
Compel me to scold ye,—  
Tis halt! that I say,—  
Will ye heed what I told ye?

Wan—two!

Wan—two!

Be jabbers, I'm dhryer than Brian Boru!

Wan—two!—

Time! Mark!

What's wur-ruk for chickens is sport for the lark!"

Sez Corporal Madden to Private McFadden:

"I'll not stay a gaddin',  
Wid dagoes like you!  
I'll travel no farther,  
I'm dyin' for—wather;—  
Come on, if ye like,—  
Can ye loan me a quather?

Ya-as, you—

What,—two?

And ye'll pay the potheen? Ye're a daisy! Whurroo!

You'll do!

Whist! Mark!

The Rigiment's flattered to own ye, me spark!"

*Robert W. Chambers.*

---

**OFFICER BRADY**

## THE MODERN RECRUIT

### I

Sez Alderman Grady  
To Officer Brady:  
"G'wan! Ye're no lady!  
Luk here what ye've done:  
Ye've run in Red Hogan,  
Ye've pulled Paddy Grogan,  
Ye've fanned Mither Brogan  
An' called him a 'gun'!

"Way up in Tammany Hall  
They's a gintleman layin' f'r you!  
'An' what,' sez he, 't' 'ell,' sez he,  
'Does the villyun mane to do?  
Lock up the ass in his shtall!  
He'll rue the day I rue,  
F'r he's pulled the dive that kapes me alive,  
An' he'll go to the goats! Whurroo!"

### II

Sez Alderman Grady  
To Officer Brady:  
"Ye pinched young Mullady  
F'r crackin' a safe!  
An' Sinitor Moran  
An' Alderman Doran  
Is inside, a-roarin'  
F'r justice, ye thafe!

"Way up in Tammany Hall  
They's a gintleman layin' f'r you!  
'What's this,' sez he, 'I hear?' sez he—  
An' the air, bedad, grew blue!  
'Well, I nivver did hear av such gall!

But if phwat ye say is thrue,  
He's pulled a fri'nd av a fri'nd av me fri'nd,  
An' he'll go to the goats! Whurroo!"

### III

Sez Alderman Grady  
To Officer Brady:  
"Here's Sullivan's lady  
Cavoortin' an' riled;  
She lifted a locket  
From Casey's coat pocket,  
An' it goes to the docket,  
An' Sullivan's wild!

"Way up in Tammany Hall  
They's a gintleman layin' f'r you!  
'Tis a shame,' sez he, 'f'r to blame,' sez he,  
'A lady so fair an' thrue,  
An' so divinely tall'—  
'Tis po'ms he talked, ye Jew!  
An' ye've cooked yer goose, an' now ye're loose  
F'r to folly the goats! Whurroo!"

### IV

Sez Alderman Grady  
To Officer Brady:  
"Where's Katie Macready,  
The Confidence Queen?  
She's niece to O'Lafferty's  
Cousins, the Caffertys—  
Sinitor Rafferty's  
Steady colleen!

"Way up in Tammany Hall  
They's a gintleman layin' f'r you!  
'He's pinched,' sez he, 'an' cinched,' sez he,  
'A lady tray comme eel foo!



Go dangle th' tillyphone call,  
An' gimme La Mulberry Roo,  
F'r the town is too warrm f'r this gendarme,  
An' he'll go to the goats, mon Dieu!"

V

Sez Alderman Grady  
To Officer Brady:  
"McCabe is afraid he  
Can't open to-night,  
F'r throuble's a-brewin',  
An' mischief's a-stewin',  
Wid nothin' a-doin'  
An' everything tight!  
There's Register Ronnell,  
Commissioner Donnell,  
An' Congressman Connell  
Preparin' f'r flight;  
The Dhistrict Attorney  
Told Magistrate Kearny  
That Captain McBurney  
Was dyin' o' fright!

"Oh!  
'Way up in Tammany Hall  
They's a gintleman lookin' f'r you!  
'Bedad,' sez he, 'he's mad,' sez he.  
'So turrrn on the screw f'r Bellevue,  
An' chain 'im ag'in' the wall,  
An' lather 'im wan or two,  
An' tether 'im out on the Bloomin'dale route  
Like a loonytick goat! Whurroo!"

*Robert W. Chambers.*

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## POST-IMPRESSIONISM

I cannot tell you how I love  
The canvases of Mr. Dove,  
Which Saturday I went to see  
In Mr. Thurber's gallery.

At first you fancy they are built  
As patterns for a crazy quilt,  
But soon you see that they express  
An ambient simultaneousness.

This thing which you would almost bet  
Portrays a Spanish omelette,  
Depicts instead, with wondrous skill,  
A horse and cart upon a hill.

Now, Mr. Dove has too much art  
To show the horse or show the cart;  
Instead, he paints the *creak* and *strain*,  
Get it? No pike is half as plain.

This thing which would appear to show  
A fancy vest scenario,  
Is really quite another thing,  
A flock of pigeons on the wing.

But Mr. Dove is much too keen  
To let a single bird be seen;  
To show the pigeons would not do  
And so he simply paints the *coo*.

It's all as simple as can be;  
He paints the things you cannot see,  
Just as composers please the ear  
With "programme" things you cannot hear.

Dove is the cleverest of chaps;  
And, gazing at his rhythmic maps,  
I wondered (and I'm wondering yet)  
Whether he did them on a bet.

*Bert Leston Taylor.*

---

**TO THE PORTRAIT OF "A GENTLEMAN,"  
IN THE ATHENÆUM GALLERY**

It may be so—perhaps thou hast  
    A warm and loving heart;  
I will not blame thee for thy face,  
    Poor devil as thou art.

That thing, thou fondly deem'st a nose,  
    Unsightly though it be,—  
In spite of all the cold world's scorn,  
    It may be much to thee.

Those eyes,—among thine elder friends  
    Perhaps they pass for blue;—  
No matter,—if a man can see,  
    What more have eyes to do?

Thy mouth—that fissure in thy face  
    By something like a chin,—  
May be a very useful place  
    To put thy victual in.

I know thou hast a wife at home,

I know thou hast a child,  
By that subdued, domestic smile  
Upon thy features mild.

That wife sits fearless by thy side,  
That cherub on thy knee;  
They do not shudder at thy looks,  
They do not shrink from thee.

Above thy mantel is a hook,—  
A portrait once was there;  
It was thine only ornament,—  
Alas! that hook is bare.

She begged thee not to let it go,  
She begged thee all in vain:  
She wept,—and breathed a trembling prayer  
To meet it safe again.

It was a bitter sight to see  
That picture torn away;  
It was a solemn thought to think  
What all her friends would say!

And often in her calmer hours,  
And in her happy dreams,  
Upon its long-deserted hook  
The absent portrait seems.

Thy wretched infant turns his head  
In melancholy wise,  
And looks to meet the placid stare  
Of those unbending eyes.

I never saw thee, lovely one,—  
Perchance I never may;  
It is not often that we cross

Such people in our way;  
But if we meet in distant years,  
Or on some foreign shore,  
Sure I can take my Bible oath  
I've seen that face before.

*Oliver Wendell Holmes.*

---

## **CACOËTHES SCRIBENDI**

If all the trees in all the woods were men,  
And each and every blade of grass a pen;  
If every leaf on every shrub and tree  
Turned to a sheet of foolscap; every sea  
Were changed to ink, and all earth's living tribes  
Had nothing else to do but act as scribes,  
And for ten thousand ages, day and night,  
The human race should write, and write, and write,  
Till all the pens and paper were used up,  
And the huge inkstand was an empty cup,  
Still would the scribblers clustered round its brink  
Call for more pens, more paper, and more ink.

*Oliver Wendell Holmes.*

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## **CONTENTMENT**

**"MAN WANTS BUT LITTLE HERE BELOW"**

Little I ask; my wants are few;  
I only wish a hut of stone  
(A very plain brone stone will do)  
That I may call my own;  
And close at hand is such a one,  
In yonder street that fronts the sun.

Plain food is quite enough for me;  
Three courses are as good as ten;  
If Nature can subsist on three,  
Thank Heaven for three—Amen!  
I always thought cold victual nice—  
My choice would be vanilla-ice.

I care not much for gold or land;  
Give me a mortgage here and there,  
Some good bank-stock, some note of hand,  
Or trifling railroad share.  
I only ask that Fortune send  
A little more than I shall spend.

Jewels are baubles; 'tis a sin  
To care for such unfruitful things;  
One good-sized diamond in a pin,  
Some, *not so large*, in rings.  
A ruby, and a pearl, or so,  
Will do for me—I laugh at show.

My dame should dress in cheap attire  
(Good, heavy silks are never dear);  
I own perhaps I *might* desire  
Some shawls of true Cashmere—  
Some marrowy crape of China silk,  
Like wrinkled skins on scalded milk.

I would not have the horse I drive

So fast that folks must stop and stare;  
An easy gait—two, forty-five—  
Suits me; I do not care;  
Perhaps, for just a *single spurt*,  
Some seconds less would do no hurt.

Of pictures, I should like to own  
Titians and Raphaels three or four—  
I love so much their style and tone—  
One Turner, and no more.  
(A landscape, foreground golden dirt,  
The sunshine painted with a squirt).

Of books but few—some fifty score  
For daily use, and bound for wear;  
The rest upon an upper floor;  
Some *little luxury there*  
Of red morocco's gilded gleam,  
And vellum rich as country cream.

Busts, cameos, gems—such things as these,  
Which others often show for pride,  
I value for their power to please,  
And selfish churls deride;  
*One* Stradivarius, I confess,  
*Two* Meerschaums, I would fain possess.

Wealth's wasteful tricks I will not learn,  
Nor ape the glittering upstart fool;  
Shall not carved tables serve my turn,  
But *all* must be of buhl?  
Give grasping pomp its double share—  
I ask but *one* recumbent chair.

Thus humble let me live and die,  
Nor long for Midas' golden touch;  
If Heaven more generous gifts deny,

I shall not miss them *much*—  
Too grateful for the blessing lent  
Of simple tastes and mind content!

*Oliver Wendell Holmes.*

---

## **A BOSTON LULLABY**

Baby's brain is tired of thinking  
On the Wherefore and the Whence;  
Baby's precious eyes are blinking  
With incipient somnolence.

Little hands are weary turning  
Heavy leaves of lexicon;  
Little nose is fretted learning  
How to keep its glasses on.

Baby knows the laws of nature  
Are beneficent and wise;  
His medulla oblongata  
Bids my darling close his eyes.

And his pneumogastrics tell him  
Quietude is always best  
When his little cerebellum  
Needs recuperative rest.

Baby must have relaxation,  
Let the world go wrong or right.  
Sleep, my darling—leave Creation  
To its chances for the night.



*James Jeffrey Roche.*

---

## **A GRAIN OF SALT**

Of all the wimming doubly blest  
The sailor's wife's the happiest,  
For all she does is stay to home  
And knit and darn—and let 'im roam.

Of all the husbands on the earth  
The sailor has the finest berth,  
For in 'is cabin he can sit  
And sail and sail—and let 'er knit.

*Wallace Irwin.*

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## **SONG**

Why should you swear I am forsworn,  
Since thine I vowed to be?  
Lady, it is already morn,  
And 'twas last night I swore to thee  
That fond impossibility.

Have I not loved thee much and long,  
A tedious twelve hours' space?  
I must all other beauties wrong,  
And rob thee of a new embrace,  
Could I still dote upon thy face.

Not but all joy in thy brown hair  
By others may be found;  
But I must search the black and fair,  
Like skilful mineralists that sound  
For treasure in unploughed-up ground.

Then, if when I have loved my round,  
Thou prov'st the pleasant she;  
With spoils of meaner beauties crowned  
I laden will return to thee,  
Even sated with variety.

*Richard Lovelace.*

---

## **A PHILOSOPHER**

Zack Bumstead useter flosserfize  
About the ocean an' the skies;  
An' gab an' gas f'um morn till noon  
About the other side the moon;  
An' 'bout the natur of the place  
Ten miles beyend the end of space.  
An' if his wife she'd ask the crank  
Ef he wouldn't kinder try to yank  
Hisself out-doors an' git some wood  
To make her kitchen fire good,  
So she c'd bake her beans an' pies,  
He'd say, "I've gotter flosserfize."

An' then he'd set an' flosserfize  
About the natur an' the size  
Of angels' wings, an' think, and gawp,

An' wonder how they make 'em flop.  
He'd calkerlate how long a skid  
'Twould take to move the sun, he did;  
An' if the skid was strong an' prime,  
It couldn't be moved to supper-time.  
An' w'en his wife 'd ask the lout  
Ef he wouldn't kinder waltz about  
An' take a rag an' shoo the flies,  
He'd say, "I've gotter flosserfize."

An' then he'd set an' flosserfize  
'Bout schemes for fencing in the skies,  
Then lettin' out the lots to rent,  
So's he could make an honest cent.  
An' if he'd find it pooty tough  
To borry cash fer fencin'-stuff;  
An' if 'twere best to take his wealth  
An' go to Europe for his health,  
Or save his cash till he'd enough  
To buy some more of fencin'-stuff;  
Then, ef his wife she'd ask the gump  
Ef he wouldn't kinder try to hump  
Hisself to t'other side the door,  
So she c'd come an' sweep the floor,  
He'd look at her with mournful eyes,  
An' say, "I've gotter flosserfize."

An' so he'd set an' flosserfize  
'Bout what it wuz held up the skies,  
An' how God made this earthly ball  
Jest simply out er nawthin' 'tall,  
An' 'bout the natur, shape, an' form  
Of nawthin' that he made it from.  
Then, ef his wife sh'd ask the freak  
Ef he wouldn't kinder try to sneak  
Out to the barn an' find some aigs,  
He'd never move, nor lift his laigs;

He'd never stir, nor try to rise,  
But say, "I've gotter flosserfize."

An' so he'd set an' flosserfize  
About the earth, an' sea, an' skies,  
An' scratch his head, an' ask the cause  
Of w'at there wuz before time wuz,  
An' w'at the universe 'd do  
Bimeby w'en time hed all got through;  
An' jest how fur we'd have to climb  
Ef we sh'd travel out er time;  
An' ef we'd need, w'en we got there,  
To keep our watches in repair.  
Then, ef his wife she'd ask the gawk  
Ef he wouldn't kinder try to walk  
To where she had the table spread,  
An' kinder git his stomach fed,  
He'd leap for that ar kitchen door,  
An' say, "W'y didn't you speak afore?"  
An' when he'd got his supper et,  
He'd set, an' set, an' set, an' set,  
An' fold his arms, an' shet his eyes,  
An' set, an' set, an' flosserfize.

*Sam Walter Foss.*

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## THE MEETING OF THE CLABBERHUSES

### I

He was the Chairman of the Guild  
Of Early Pleiocene Patriarchs;  
He was chief Mentor of the Lodge  
Of the Oracular Oligarchs;

He was the Lord High Autocrat  
And Vizier of the Sons of Light,  
And Sultan and Grand Mandarin  
Of the Millennial Men of Might.

He was Grand Totem and High Priest  
Of the Independent Potentates;  
Grand Mogul of the Galaxy  
Of the Illustrious Stay-out-lates;  
The President of the Dandydudes,  
The Treasurer of the Sons of Glee;  
The Leader of the Clubtown Band  
And Architects of Melody.

## II

She was Grand Worthy Prophetess  
Of the Illustrious Maids of Mark;  
Of Vestals of the Third Degree  
She was Most Potent Matriarch;  
She was High Priestess of the Shrine  
Of Clubtown's Culture Coterie,  
And First Vice-President of the League  
Of the illustrious G. A. B.

She was the First Dame of the Club  
For teaching Patagonians Greek;  
She was Chief Clerk and Auditor  
Of Clubtown's Anti-Bachelor Clique;  
She was High Treasurer of the Fund  
For Borrioboolighalians,  
And the Fund for Sending Browning's Poems  
To Native-born Australians.

## III

Once to a crowded social fête  
Both these much-titled people came,  
And each perceived, when introduced,

They had the selfsame name.  
Their hostess said, when first they met:  
"Permit me now to introduce  
My good friend Mr. Clabberhuse  
To Mrs. Clabberhuse."

"'Tis very strange," said she to him,  
"Such an unusual name!—  
A name so very seldom heard,  
That we should bear the same."  
"Indeed, 'tis wonderful," said he,  
"And I'm surprised the more,  
Because I never heard the name  
Outside my home before."

"But now I come to look at you,"  
Said he, "upon my life,  
If I am not indeed deceived,  
You are—you are—my wife."  
She gazed into his searching face  
And seemed to look him through;  
"Indeed," said she, "it seems to me  
You are my husband, too."

"I've been so busy with my clubs  
And in my various spheres  
I have not seen you now," she said,  
"For over fourteen years."  
"That's just the way it's been with me,  
These clubs demand a sight"—  
And then they both politely bowed,  
And sweetly said "Good night."

*Sam Walter Foss.*

---

## THE IDEAL HUSBAND TO HIS WIFE

We've lived for forty years, dear wife,  
And walked together side by side,  
And you to-day are just as dear  
As when you were my bride.  
I've tried to make life glad for you,  
One long, sweet honeymoon of joy,  
A dream of marital content,  
Without the least alloy.  
I've smoothed all boulders from our path,  
That we in peace might toil along,  
By always hastening to admit  
That I was right and you were wrong.

No mad diversity of creed  
Has ever sundered me from thee;  
For I permit you evermore  
To borrow your ideas of me.  
And thus it is, through weal or woe,  
Our love forevermore endures;  
For I permit that you should take  
My views and creeds, and make them yours.  
And thus I let you have my way,  
And thus in peace we toil along,  
For I am willing to admit  
That I am right and you are wrong.

And when our matrimonial skiff  
Strikes snags in love's meandering stream,  
I lift our shallop from the rocks,  
And float as in a placid dream.  
And well I know our marriage bliss  
While life shall last will never cease;  
For I shall always let thee do,  
In generous love, just what I please.

Peace comes, and discord flies away,  
Love's bright day follows hatred's night;  
For I am ready to admit  
That you are wrong and I am right.

*Sam Walter Foss.*

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## **DISTICHS**

Wisely a woman prefers to a lover a man who neglects her.  
This one may love her some day; some day the lover will not.

There are three species of creatures who when they seem coming are  
going,  
When they seem going they come: Diplomats, women, and crabs.

As the meek beasts in the Garden came flocking for Adam to name them,  
Men for a title to-day crawl to the feet of a king.

What is a first love worth except to prepare for a second?  
What does the second love bring? Only regret for the first.

*John Hay.*

---

## **THE HEN-ROOST MAN**

De Hen-roost Man he'll preach about Paul,  
An' James an' John, an' Herod, an' all,  
But nuver a word about Peter, oh, no!  
He's afeard he'll hear dat rooster crow.



An' he ain't by 'isself in dat, in dat—  
An' he ain't by 'isself in dat.

*Ruth McEnery Stuart.*

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## **IF THEY MEANT ALL THEY SAID**

Charm is a woman's strongest arm;  
My charwoman is full of charm;  
I chose her, not for strength of arm  
But for her strange, elusive charm.

And how tears heighten woman's powers!  
My typist weeps for hours and hours:  
I took her for her weeping powers—  
They so delight my business hours.

A woman lives by intuition.  
Though my accountant shuns addition  
She has the rarest intuition.  
(And I myself can do addition.)

Timidity in girls is nice.  
My cook is so afraid of mice.  
Now you'll admit it's very nice  
To feel your cook's afraid of mice.

*Alice Duer Miller.*

---

## **THE MAN**

A man said to the universe,  
"Sir, I exist!"  
"However," replied the universe,  
"The fact has not created in me  
A sense of obligation."

*Stephen Crane.*

---

## A THOUGHT

If all the harm that women have done  
Were put in a bundle and rolled into one,  
    Earth would not hold it,  
    The sky could not enfold it,  
It could not be lighted nor warmed by the sun;  
    Such masses of evil  
    Would puzzle the devil,  
And keep him in fuel while Time's wheels run.

But if all the harm that's been done by men  
Were doubled, and doubled, and doubled again,  
And melted and fused into vapour, and then  
Were squared and raised to the power of ten,  
There wouldn't be nearly enough, not near,  
To keep a small girl for the tenth of a year.  
To keep a small girl for the tenth of a year.

*James Kenneth Stephen.*

---

## THE MUSICAL ASS

The fable which I now present,  
Occurred to me by accident:  
And whether bad or excellent,  
Is merely so by accident.

A stupid ass this morning went  
Into a field by accident:  
And cropped his food, and was content,  
Until he spied by accident  
A flute, which some oblivious gent  
Had left behind by accident;  
When, sniffing it with eager scent,  
He breathed on it by accident,  
And made the hollow instrument  
Emit a sound by accident.  
"Hurrah, hurrah!" exclaimed the brute,  
"How cleverly I play the flute!"

A fool, in spite of nature's bent,  
May shine for once,—by accident.

*Tomaso de Yriarte.*

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## THE KNIFE-GRINDER

*Friend of Humanity*

"Needy Knife-grinder! whither are you going?  
Rough is the road—your wheel is out of order—  
Bleak blows the blast; your hat has got a hole in't,  
So have your breeches!

"Weary Knife-grinder! little think the proud ones,

Who in their coaches roll along the turnpike-  
Road, what hard work 'tis crying all day' Knives and  
Scissors to grind O!"

"Tell me, Knife-grinder, how you came to grind knives?  
Did some rich man tyrannically use you?  
Was it the squire? or parson of the parish?  
Or the attorney?"

"Was it the squire, for killing of his game? or  
Covetous parson, for his tithes distraining?  
Or roguish lawyer, made you lose your little  
All in a law-suit?"

"(Have you not read the Rights of Man, by Tom Paine?)  
Drops of compassion tremble on my eyelids,  
Ready to fall, as soon as you have told your  
Pitiful story."

*Knife-grinder*

"Story! God bless you! I have none to tell, sir,  
Only last night, a-drinking at the Chequers,  
This poor old hat and breeches, as you see, were  
Tom in a scuffle.

"Constables came up for to take me into  
Custody; they took me before the justice;  
Justice Oldmixon put me in the parish-  
Stocks for a vagrant.

"I should be glad to drink your Honour's health in  
A pot of beer, if you will give me sixpence;  
But for my part, I never love to meddle  
With politics, sir."

*Friend of Humanity*

"I give thee sixpence! I will see thee damn'd first—  
Wretch! whom no sense of wrongs can rouse to vengeance—  
Sordid, unfeeling, reprobate, degraded,  
Spiritless outcast!"

*[Kicks the Knife-grinder, overturns his wheel, and exit in a transport of Republican enthusiasm and universal philanthropy.]*

*George Canning.*

---

## ST. ANTHONY'S SERMON TO THE FISHES

Saint Anthony at church  
Was left in the lurch,  
So he went to the ditches  
And preached to the fishes.  
    They wriggled their tails,  
    In the sun glanced their scales.

The carps, with their spawn,  
Are all thither drawn;  
Have opened their jaws,  
Eager for each clause.  
    No sermon beside  
    Had the carps so edified.

Sharp-snouted pikes,  
Who keep fighting like tikes,  
Now swam up harmonious  
To hear Saint Antonius.  
    No sermon beside  
    Had the pikes so edified.

And that very odd fish,  
Who loves fast-days, the cod-fish,—  
The stock-fish, I mean—  
At the sermon was seen.  
    No sermon beside

Had the cods so edified.

Good eels and sturgeon,  
Which aldermen gorge on,  
Went out of their way  
To hear preaching that day.  
No sermon beside  
Had the eels so edified.

Crabs and turtles also,  
Who always move low,  
Made haste from the bottom  
As if the devil had got 'em.  
No sermon beside  
The crabs so edified.

Fish great and fish small,  
Lords, lackeys, and all,  
Each looked at the preacher  
Like a reasonable creature.  
At God's word,  
They Anthony heard.

The sermon now ended,  
Each turned and descended;  
The pikes went on stealing,  
The eels went on eeling.  
Much delighted were they,  
But preferred the old way.

The crabs are backsliders,  
The stock-fish thick-siders,  
The carps are sharp-set—  
All the sermon forget.  
Much delighted were they,  
But preferred the old way.

*Abraham á Sancta-Clara.*

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## **THE BATTLE OF BLENHEIM**

It was a summer's evening;  
Old Casper's work was done,  
And he before his cottage-door  
Was sitting in the sun;  
And by him sported on the green  
His little grandchild Wilhelmine.

She saw her brother Peterkin  
Roll something large and round,  
That he beside the rivulet  
In playing there had found.  
He came to ask what he had found,  
That was so large, and smooth, and round.

Old Casper took it from the boy,  
Who stood expectant by;  
And then the old man shook his head,  
And with a natural sigh,  
"'Tis some poor fellow's skull," said he,  
"Who fell in the great victory.

"I find them in the garden, for  
There's many here about;  
And often, when I go to plough,  
The ploughshare turns them out;  
For many thousand men," said he,  
"Were slain in the great victory."

"Now tell us what 'twas all about,"



Young Peterkin he cries;  
And little Wilhelmine looks up,  
With wonder-waiting eyes:  
"Now tell us all about the war,  
And what they kill'd each other for."

"It was the English," Casper cried,  
"That put the French to rout;  
But what they kill'd each other for,  
I could not well make out;  
But everybody said," quoth he,  
"That 'twas a famous victory."

"My father lived at Blenheim then,  
Yon little stream hard by;  
They burnt his dwelling to the ground,  
And he was forced to fly;  
So with his wife and child he fled,  
Nor had he where to rest his head."

"With fire and sword the country round,  
Was wasted far and wide,  
And many a childing mother then  
And new-born infant died.  
But things like that, you know, must be  
At every famous victory."

"They say it was a shocking sight,  
After the field was won,  
For many a thousand bodies here  
Lay rotting in the sun.  
But things like that, you know, must be  
After a famous victory."

"Great praise the Duke of Marlbro' won,  
And our good Prince Eugene."  
"Why, 'twas a very wicked thing!"

Said little Wilhelmine.  
"Nay, nay, my little girl," quoth he,  
"It was a famous victory;

"And everybody praised the duke,  
Who such a fight did win."  
"But what good came of it at last?"  
Quoth little Peterkin.  
"Why, that I cannot tell," said he;  
"But 'twas a famous victory."

*Robert Southey.*

---

## THE THREE BLACK CROWS

Two honest tradesmen meeting in the Strand,  
One took the other briskly by the hand;  
"Hark-ye," said he, "'tis an odd story, this,  
About the crows!" "I don't know what it is,"  
Replied his friend. "No! I'm surprised at that;  
Where I came from it is the common chat;  
But you shall hear—an odd affair indeed!  
And that it happened, they are all agreed.  
Not to detain you from a thing so strange,  
A gentleman, that lives not far from 'Change,  
This week, in short, as all the alley knows,  
Taking a puke, has thrown up three black crows."  
"Impossible!" "Nay, but it's really true;  
I have it from good hands, and so may you."  
"From whose, I pray?" So, having named the man,  
Straight to inquire his curious comrade ran.  
"Sir, did you tell"—relating the affair.  
"Yes, sir, I did; and, if it's worth your care,

Ask Mr. Such-a-one, he told it me.  
But, by the bye, 'twas two black crows—not three."  
Resolved to trace so wondrous an event,  
Whip, to the third, the virtuoso went;  
"Sir"—and so forth. "Why, yes; the thing is fact,  
Though, in regard to number, not exact;  
It was not two black crows—'twas only one;  
The truth of that you may depend upon;  
The gentleman himself told me the case."  
"Where may I find him?" "Why, in such a place."  
Away goes he, and, having found him out,  
"Sir, be so good as to resolve a doubt."  
Then to his last informant he referred,  
And begged to know if true what he had heard.  
"Did you, sir, throw up a black crow?" "Not I."  
"Bless me! how people propagate a lie!  
Black crows have been thrown up, three, two, and one;  
And here, I find, all comes, at last, to none.  
Did you say nothing of a crow at all?"  
"Crow—crow—perhaps I might, now I recall  
The matter over." "And pray, sir, what was't?"  
"Why, I was horrid sick, and, at the last,  
I did throw up, and told my neighbor so,  
Something that was—as black, sir, as a crow."

*John Byrom.*

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## **TO THE TERRESTRIAL GLOBE**

**BY A MISERABLE WRETCH**

Roll on, thou ball, roll on!  
Through pathless realms of space

Roll on!  
What though I'm in a sorry case?  
What though I cannot meet my bills?  
What though I suffer toothache's ills?  
What though I swallow countless pills?  
Never *you* mind!  
Roll on!

Roll on, thou ball, roll on!  
Through seas of inky air  
Roll on!  
It's true I've got no shirts to wear;  
It's true my butcher's bill is due;  
It's true my prospects all look blue;  
But don't let that unsettle you.  
Never *you* mind!  
Roll on!  
(*It rolls on.*)

W. S. Gilbert.

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## ETIQUETTE

The *Ballyshannon* foundered off the coast of Cariboo,  
And down in fathoms many went the captain and the crew;  
Down went the owners—greedy men whom hope of gain allured:  
Oh, dry the starting tear, for they were heavily insured.

Besides the captain and the mate, the owners and the crew,  
The passengers were also drowned excepting only two:  
Young Peter Gray, who tasted teas for Baker, Croop, and Co.,  
And Somers, who from Eastern shores imported indigo.

These passengers, by reason of their clinging to a mast,  
Upon a desert island were eventually cast.  
They hunted for their meals, as Alexander Selkirk used,  
But they couldn't chat together—they had not been introduced.

For Peter Gray, and Somers, too, though certainly in trade,  
Were properly particular about the friends they made;  
And somehow thus they settled it, without a word of mouth,  
That Gray should take the northern half, while Somers took the south.

On Peter's portion oysters grew—a delicacy rare,  
But oysters were a delicacy Peter couldn't bear.  
On Somer's side was turtle, on the shingle lying thick,  
Which Somers couldn't eat, because it always made him sick.

Gray gnashed his teeth with envy as he saw a mighty store  
Of turtle unmolested on his fellow-creature's shore.  
The oysters at his feet aside impatiently he shoved,  
For turtle and his mother were the only things he loved.

And Somers sighed in sorrow as he settled in the south,  
For the thought of Peter's oysters brought the water to his mouth.  
He longed to lay him down upon the shelly bed, and stuff:  
He had often eaten oysters, but had never had enough.

How they wished an introduction to each other they had had  
When on board the *Ballyshannon*! And it drove them nearly mad  
To think how very friendly with each other they might get,  
If it wasn't for the arbitrary rule of etiquette!

One day, when out a-hunting for the *mus ridiculus*,  
Gray overheard his fellow-man soliloquising thus:  
"I wonder how the playmates of my youth are getting on,  
M'Connell, S. B. Walters, Paddy Byles, and Robinson?"

These simple words made Peter as delighted as could be;  
Old chummies at the Charterhouse were Robinson and he.

He walked straight up to Somers, then he turned extremely red,  
Hesitated, hummed and hawed a bit, then cleared his throat, and said:

"I beg your pardon—pray forgive me if I seem too bold,  
But you have breathed a name I knew familiarly of old.  
You spoke aloud of Robinson—I happened to be by.  
You know him?" "Yes, extremely well." "Allow me, so do I."

It was enough: they felt they could more pleasantly get on,  
For (ah, the magic of the fact!) they each knew Robinson!  
And Mr. Somers' turtle was at Peter's service quite,  
And Mr. Somers punished Peter's oyster-beds all night.

They soon became like brothers from community of wrongs;  
They wrote each other little odes and sang each other songs;  
They told each other anecdotes disparaging their wives;  
On several occasions, too, they saved each other's lives.

They felt quite melancholy when they parted for the night,  
And got up in the morning soon as ever it was light;  
Each other's pleasant company they reckoned so upon,  
And all because it happened that they both knew Robinson!

They lived for many years on that inhospitable shore,  
And day by day they learned to love each other more and more.  
At last, to their astonishment, on getting up one day,  
They saw a frigate anchored in the offing of the bay.

To Peter an idea occurred. "Suppose we cross the main?  
So good an opportunity may not be found again."  
And Somers thought a minute, then ejaculated, "Done!  
I wonder how my business in the City's getting on?"

"But stay," said Mr. Peter; "when in England, as you know,  
I earned a living tasting teas for Baker, Croop, and Co.,  
I may be superseded—my employers think me dead!"  
"Then come with me," said Somers, "and taste indigo instead."

But all their plans were scattered in a moment when they found  
The vessel was a convict ship from Portland outward bound;  
When a boat came off to fetch them, though they felt it very kind,  
To go on board they firmly but respectfully declined.

As both the happy settlers roared with laughter at the joke,  
They recognized a gentlemanly fellow pulling stroke:  
'Twas Robinson—a convict, in an unbecoming frock!  
Condemned to seven years for misappropriating stock!!!

They laughed no more, for Somers thought he had been rather rash  
In knowing one whose friend had misappropriated cash;  
And Peter thought a foolish tack he must have gone upon  
In making the acquaintance of a friend of Robinson.

At first they didn't quarrel very openly, I've heard;  
They nodded when they met, and now and then exchanged a word:  
The word grew rare, and rarer still the nodding of the head.  
And when they meet each other now, they cut each other dead.

To allocate the island they agreed by word of mouth,  
And Peter takes the north again, and Somers takes the south;  
And Peter has the oysters, which he hates, in layers thick,  
And Somers has the turtle—turtle always makes him sick.

*W. S. Gilbert.*

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## **A MODEST WIT**

A supercilious nabob of the East—  
Haughty, being great—purse-proud, being rich—  
A governor, or general, at the least,

I have forgotten which—  
Had in his family a humble youth,  
Who went from England in his patron's suite,  
An unassuming boy, in truth  
A lad of decent parts, and good repute.

This youth had sense and spirit;  
But yet with all his sense,  
Excessive diffidence  
Obscured his merit.

One day, at table, flushed with pride and wine,  
His honor, proudly free, severely merry,  
Conceived it would be vastly fine  
To crack a joke upon his secretary.

"Young man," he said, "by what art, craft, or trade  
Did your good father gain a livelihood?"  
"He was a saddler, sir," Modestus said,  
"And in his time was reckoned good."

"A saddler, eh? and taught you Greek,  
Instead of teaching you to sew!  
Pray, why did not your father make  
A saddler, sir, of you?"

Each parasite, then, as in duty bound,  
The joke applauded, and the laugh went round.  
At length Modestus, bowing low,  
Said (craving pardon, if too free he made),  
"Sir, by your leave, I fain would know  
Your father's trade!"

"My father's trade! by Heaven, that's too bad!  
My father's trade? Why, blockhead, are you mad?  
My father, sir, did never stoop so low—  
He was a gentleman, I'd have you know."



"Excuse the liberty I take,"  
Modestus said, with archness on his brow,  
"Pray, why did not your father make  
A gentleman of you?"

*Selleck Osborn.*

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## **THE LATEST DECALOGUE**

Thou shalt have one God only, who  
Would be at the expense of two?  
No graven images may be  
Worshipped, except the currency:  
Swear not at all; for, for thy curse  
Thine enemy is none the worse:  
At Church on Sunday to attend  
Will serve to keep the world thy friend:  
Honour thy parents; that is, all  
From whom advancement may befall:  
Thou shalt not kill; but need'st not strive  
Officiously to keep alive:  
Do not adultery commit;  
Advantage rarely comes of it:  
Thou shalt not steal; an empty feat,  
When it's so lucrative to cheat:  
Bear not false witness; let the lie  
Have time on its own wings to fly:  
Thou shalt not covet, but tradition  
Approves all forms of competition.

*Arthur Hugh Clough.*

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## A SIMILE

Dear Thomas, didst thou never pop  
Thy head into a tin-man's shop?  
There, Thomas, didst thou never see  
('Tis but by way of simile)  
A squirrel spend his little rage,  
In jumping round a rolling cage?  
The cage, as either side turn'd up,  
Striking a ring of bells a-top?—  
    Mov'd in the orb, pleas'd with the chimes,  
The foolish creature thinks he climbs:  
But here or there, turn wood or wire,  
He never gets two inches higher.  
    So fares it with those merry blades,  
That frisk it under Pindus' shades.  
In noble songs, and lofty odes,  
They tread on stars, and talk with gods;  
Still dancing in an airy round,  
Still pleas'd with their own verses' sound;  
Brought back, how fast soe'er they go,  
Always aspiring, always low.

*Matthew Prior.*

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## BY PARCELS POST

## A DOMESTIC IDYLL

I sent my love a parcel  
In the days when we were young,  
Or e'er by care and trouble  
Our heart-strings had been wrung.  
By parcels post I sent it—  
What 'twas I do not know—  
In the days when we were courting,  
A long time ago.

The spring-time waxed to summer,  
Then autumn leaves grew red,  
And in the sweet September  
My love and I were wed.  
But though the Church had blessed us,  
My little wife looked glum;  
I'd posted her a parcel,  
And the parcel hadn't come.

Ah, many moons came after,  
And then there was a voice,  
A little voice whose music  
Would make our hearts rejoice.  
And, singing to her baby,  
My dear one oft would say,  
"I wonder, baby darling,  
Will that parcel come to-day?"

The gold had changed to silver  
Upon her matron brow;  
The years were eight-and-twenty  
Since we breathed our marriage vow,  
And our grandchildren were playing  
Hunt-the-slipper on the floor,  
When they saw the postman standing  
By our open cottage door.

Then they ran with joy to greet him,  
For they knew he'd come at last;  
They had heard me tell the story  
Very often in the past.  
He handed them a parcel,  
And they brought it in to show—  
'Twas the parcel I had posted  
Eight-and-twenty years ago.

*George R. Sims.*

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## **ALL'S WELL THAT ENDS WELL**

A friend of mine was married to a scold,  
To me he came, and all his troubles told.  
Said he, "She's like a woman raving mad."  
"Alas! my friend," said I, "that's very bad!"  
"No, not so bad," said he; "for, with her, true  
I had both house and land, and money too."  
"That was well," said I;  
"No, not so well," said he;  
"For I and her own brother  
Went to law with one another;  
I was cast, the suit was lost,  
And every penny went to pay the cost."—  
"That was bad," said I;  
"No, not so bad," said he:  
"For we agreed that he the house should keep,  
And give to me four score of Yorkshire sheep  
All fat, and fair, and fine, they were to be."  
"Well, then," said I, "sure that was well for thee?"  
"No, not so well," said he;  
"For, when the sheep I got,

They every one died of the rot."  
"That was bad," said I;  
"No, not so bad," said he;  
"For I had thought to scrape the fat,  
And keep it in an oaken vat;  
Then into tallow melt for winter store."  
"Well, then," said I, "that's better than before?"  
"'Twas not so well," said he;  
"For having got a clumsy fellow  
To scrape the fat and melt the tallow;  
Into the melting fat the fire catches,  
And, like brimstone matches,  
Burnt my house to ashes."  
"That was bad," said I;  
"No! not so bad," said he; "for, what is best,  
My scolding wife has gone among the rest."

*Unknown.*

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## THE CONTRAST

In London I never know what I'd be at,  
Enraptured with this, and enchanted with that;  
I'm wild with the sweets of variety's plan,  
And life seems a blessing too happy for man.

But the country, Lord help me! sets all matters right,  
So calm and composing from morning to night;  
Oh, it settles the spirits when nothing is seen  
But an ass on a common, a goose on a green!

In town, if it rain, why it damps not our hope,  
The eye has her choice, and the fancy her scope;

What harm though it pour whole nights or whole days?  
It spoils not our prospects, or stops not our ways.

In the country, what bliss, when it rains in the fields,  
To live on the transports that shuttlecock yields;  
Or go crawling from window to window, to see  
A pig on a dunghill or crow on a tree.

In town, we've no use for the skies overhead,  
For when the sun rises then we go to bed;  
And as to that old-fashioned virgin the moon,  
She shines out of season, like satin in June.

In the country, these planets delightfully glare,  
Just to show us the object we want isn't there;  
Oh, how cheering and gay, when their beauties arise,  
To sit and gaze round with the tears in one's eyes!

But 'tis in the country alone we can find  
That happy resource, the relief of the mind,  
When, drove to despair, our last efforts we make,  
And drag the old fish-pond, for novelty's sake:

Indeed I must own, 'tis a pleasure complete  
To see ladies well-draggled and wet in their feet;  
But what is all that to the transport we feel  
When we capture, in triumph, two toads and an eel?

I have heard though, that love in a cottage is sweet,  
When two hearts in one link of soft sympathy meet;  
That's to come—for as yet I, alas! am a swain,  
Who require, I own it, more links to my chain.

In the country, if Cupid should find a man out,  
The poor tortured victim mopes hopeless about;  
But in London, thank Heaven! our peace is secure,  
Where for one eye to kill, there's a thousand to cure.

In town let me live then, in town let me die,  
For in truth I can't relish the country, not I.  
If one must have a villa in summer to dwell,  
Oh, give me the sweet shady side of Pall Mall!

*Captain C. Morris.*

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## **THE DEVONSHIRE LANE**

In a Devonshire lane as I trotted along  
T'other day, much in want of a subject for song;  
Thinks I to myself, I have hit on a strain—  
Sure marriage is much like a Devonshire lane.

In the first place, 'tis long, and when once you are in it,  
It holds you as fast as the cage holds a linnet;  
For howe'er rough and dirty the road may be found,  
Drive forward you must, since there's no turning round.

But though 'tis so long, it is not very wide,  
For two are the most that together can ride;  
And e'en there 'tis a chance but they get in a pother,  
And jostle and cross, and run foul of each other.

Old Poverty greets them with mendicant looks,  
And Care pushes by them o'erladen with crooks,  
And Strife's grating wheels try between them to pass,  
Or Stubbornness blocks up the way on her ass.

Then the banks are so high, both to left hand and right,  
That they shut up the beauties around from the sight;  
And hence, you'll allow, 'tis an inference plain

That marriage is just like a Devonshire lane.

But, thinks I, too, these banks within which we are pent,  
With bud, blossom, and berry are richly besprent;  
And the conjugal fence which forbids us to roam  
Looks lovely when deck'd with the comforts of home.

In the rock's gloomy crevice the bright holly grows,  
The ivy waves fresh o'er the withering rose;  
And the evergreen love of a virtuous wife  
Smooths the roughness of care—cheers the winter of life.

Then long be the journey and narrow the way;  
I'll rejoice that I've seldom a turnpike to pay;  
And, whate'er others think, be the last to complain,  
Though marriage is just like a Devonshire lane.

*John Marriott.*

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## **A SPLENDID FELLOW**

Delmonico's is where he dines  
On quail on toast, washed down with wines;  
Then lights a twenty-cent cigar  
With quite a flourish at the bar.

He throws his money down so proud,  
And "sets 'em up" for all the crowd;  
A dozen games of billiards, too,  
He gaily loses ere he's through.

Oh, he's a splendid fellow, quite;  
He pays his debts with such delight,



And often boasts of—to his clan—  
His honour as a gentleman.

But when this splendid fellow's wife,  
Who leads at home a frugal life  
Begs for a little change to buy  
A dress, he looks at her so wry,

That she, alarmed at his distress,  
Gives him a kiss and sweet caress,  
And says, "Don't worry so, my dear,  
I'll turn the dress I made last year."

*H. C. Dodge.*

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## **IF**

If a man could live a thousand years,  
When half his life had passed,  
He might, by strict economy,  
A fortune have amassed.

Then having gained some common-sense,  
And knowledge, too, of life,  
He could select the woman who  
Would make him a true wife.

But as it is, man hasn't time  
To even pay his debts,  
And weds to be acquainted with  
The woman whom he gets.

*H. C. Dodge.*

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## ACCEPTED AND WILL APPEAR

One evening while reclining  
In my easy-chair, repining  
O'er the lack of true religion, and the dearth of common sense,  
A solemn visaged lady,  
Who was surely on the shady  
Side of thirty, entered proudly, and to crush me did commence:

"I sent a poem here, sir,"  
Said the lady, growing fiercer,  
"And the subject which I'd chosen, you remember, sir, was 'Spring';  
But, although I've scanned your paper,  
Sir, by sunlight, gas, and taper,  
I've discovered of that poem not a solitary thing."

She was muscular and wiry,  
And her temper sure was fiery,  
And I knew to pacify her I would have to—fib like fun.  
So I told her ere her verses,  
Which were great, had come to—bless us,  
We'd received just sixty-one on "Spring," of which we'd printed one.

And I added, "We've decided  
That they'd better be divided  
Among the years that follow—one to each succeeding Spring.  
So your work, I'm pleased to mention,  
Will receive our best attention  
In the year of nineteen-forty, when the birds begin to sing."

*Parmenas Mix.*

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## THE LITTLE VAGABOND

Dear mother, dear mother, the Church is cold;  
But the Alehouse is healthy, and pleasant, and warm.  
Besides, I can tell where I am used well;  
The poor parsons with wind like a blown bladder swell.

But, if at the Church they would give us some ale,  
And a pleasant fire our souls to regale,  
We'd sing and we'd pray all the livelong day,  
Nor ever once wish from the Church to stray.

Then the Parson might preach, and drink, and sing,  
And we'd be as happy as birds in the spring;  
And modest Dame Lurch, who is always at Church,  
Would not have bandy children, nor fasting, nor birch.

And God, like a father, rejoicing to see  
His children as pleasant and happy as He,  
Would have no more quarrel with the Devil or the barrel,  
But kiss him, and give him both drink and apparel.

*William Blake.*

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## SYMPATHY

A knight and a lady once met in a grove  
While each was in quest of a fugitive love;  
A river ran mournfully murmuring by,  
And they wept in its waters for sympathy.

"Oh, never was knight such a sorrow that bore!"

"Oh, never was maid so deserted before!"  
"From life and its woes let us instantly fly,  
And jump in together for company!"

They searched for an eddy that suited the deed,  
But here was a bramble and there was a weed;  
"How tiresome it is!" said the fair, with a sigh;  
So they sat down to rest them in company.

They gazed at each other, the maid and the knight;  
How fair was her form, and how goodly his height!  
"One mournful embrace," sobbed the youth, "ere we die!"  
So kissing and crying kept company.

"Oh, had I but loved such an angel as you!"  
"Oh, had but my swain been a quarter as true!"  
"To miss such perfection how blinded was I!"  
Sure now they were excellent company!

At length spoke the lass, 'twixt a smile and a tear,  
"The weather is cold for a watery bier;  
When summer returns we may easily die,  
Till then let us sorrow in company."

*Reginald Heber.*

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## THE RELIGION OF HUDIBRAS

For his religion it was fit  
To match his learning and his wit:  
'Twas Presbyterian true blue;  
For he was of that stubborn crew  
Of errant saints, whom all men grant

To be the true church militant;  
Such as do build their faith upon  
The holy text of pike and gun;  
Decide all controversies by  
Infallible artillery;  
And prove their doctrine orthodox,  
By apostolic blows and knocks;  
Call fire, and sword, and desolation,  
A godly, thorough reformation,  
Which always must be carried on,  
And still be doing, never done;  
As if religion were intended  
For nothing else but to be mended:  
A sect whose chief devotion lies  
In odd perverse antipathies;  
In falling out with that or this,  
And finding somewhat still amiss;  
More peevish, cross, and splenetic,  
Than dog distract, or monkey sick;  
That with more care keep holy-day  
The wrong, than others the right way,  
Compound for sins they are inclin'd to,  
By damning those they have no mind to:  
Still so perverse and opposite,  
As if they worshipped God for spite:  
The self-same thing they will abhor  
One way, and long another for:  
Free-will they one way disavow,  
Another, nothing else allow:  
All piety consists therein  
In them, in other men all sin:  
Rather than fail, they will defy  
That which they love most tenderly;  
Quarrel with minc'd pies and disparage  
Their best and dearest friend, plum porridge,  
Fat pig and goose itself oppose,  
And blaspheme custard through the nose.

*Samuel Butler.*

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## **HOLY WILLIE'S PRAYER**

O thou wha in the heavens dost dwell,  
Wha, as it pleases best Thysel,  
Sends ane to Heaven, an' ten to Hell,  
A' for Thy glory,  
And no for onie guid or ill  
They've done before Thee!

I bless and praise Thy matchless might,  
When thousands Thou hast left in night,  
That I am here, before Thy sight,  
For gifts an' grace,  
A burnin' an' a shinin' light  
To a' this place.

What was I, or my generation,  
That I should get sic exaltation!  
I, wha deserv'd most just damnation,  
For broken laws  
Sax thousand years ere my creation,  
Thro' Adam's cause.

When frae my mither's womb I fell,  
Thou might hae plung'd me deep in Hell,  
To gnash my gooms, to weep and wail  
In burnin' lakes,  
Whare damnèd devils roar and yell,  
Chain'd to their stakes.

Yet I am here, a chosen sample,

To show Thy grace is great and ample;  
I'm here a pillar o' Thy temple,  
Strong as a rock,  
A guide, a buckler, an example  
To a' Thy flock!

But yet, O Lord! confess I must,  
At times I'm fash'd wi' fleshly lust;  
An' sometimes, too, in warldly trust,  
Vile self gets in;  
But Thou remembers we are dust,  
Defil'd wi' sin.

May be Thou lets this fleshly thorn  
Beset Thy servant e'en and morn,  
Lest he owre proud and high should turn  
That he's sae gifted:  
If sae, Thy han' maun e'en be borne  
Until Thou lift it.

Lord, bless Thy chosen in this place,  
For here Thou has a chosen race:  
But God confound their stubborn face,  
An' blast their name,  
Wha bring Thy elders to disgrace  
An' open shame!

Lord, mind Gawn Hamilton's deserts,  
He drinks, an' swears, an' plays at cartes,  
Yet has sae monie takin' arts,  
Wi' great and sma',  
Frae God's ain priest the people's hearts  
He steals awa.

An' when we chasten'd him therefore,  
Thou kens how he bred sic a splore,  
As set the warld in a roar

O' laughin' at us;—  
Curse Thou his basket and his store,  
Kail an' potatoes!

Lord, hear my earnest cry and pray'r  
Against the Presbyt'ry of Ayr!  
Thy strong right hand, Lord, mak it bare  
Upo' their heads!  
Lord, visit them, an' dinna spare,  
For their misdeeds!

O Lord, my God! that glib-tongu'd Aiken,  
My vera heart and saul are quakin'  
To think how we stood sweatin', shakin',  
An' pish'd wi' dread,  
While he wi' hingin' lip an' snakin',  
Held up his head.

Lord, in Thy day o' vengeance try him!  
Lord, visit them wha did employ him,  
And pass not in Thy mercy by them,  
Nor hear their pray'r;  
But for Thy people's sake destroy them,  
An' dinna spare!

But, Lord, remember me and mine,  
Wi' mercies temp'ral and divine,  
That I for grace and gear may shine,  
Excell'd by nane,  
An' a' the glory shall be Thine,  
Amen, Amen!

*Robert Burns.*

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## THE LEARNED NEGRO

There was a negro preacher, I have heard,  
In Southern parts before rebellion stirred,  
Who did not spend his strength in empty sound;  
His was a mind deep-reaching and profound.  
Others might beat the air, and make a noise,  
And help to amuse the silly girls and boys;  
But as for him, he was a man of thought,  
Deep in theology, although untaught.  
He could not read or write, but he was wise,  
And knew right smart how to extemporize.  
One Sunday morn, when hymns and prayers were said,  
The preacher rose and rubbing up his head,  
"Bredren and sisterin, and companions dear,  
Our preachment for to-day, as you shall hear,  
Will be ob de creation,—ob de plan  
On which God fashioned Adam, de fust man.  
When God made Adam, in de ancient day,  
He made his body out ob earth and clay,  
He shape him all out right, den by and by,  
He set him up again de fence to dry."  
"Stop," said a voice; and straightway there arose  
An ancient negro in his master's clothes.  
"Tell me," said he, "before you farder go,  
One little thing which I should like to know.  
It does not quite get through dis niggas's har,  
How came dat fence so nice and handy dar?"  
Like one who in the mud is tightly stuck,  
Or one nonplussed, astonished, thunderstruck,  
The preacher looked severely on the pews,  
And rubbed his hair to know what words to use:  
"Bredren," said he, "dis word I hab to say;  
De preacher can't be bothered in dis way;  
For, if he is, it's jest as like as not,  
Our whole theology will be upsot."

*Unknown.*

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## TRUE TO POLL

I'll sing you a song, not very long,  
But the story somewhat new,  
Of William Kidd, who, whatever he did,  
To his Poll was always true.  
He sailed away in a galliant ship  
From the port of old *Bristol*,  
And the last words he uttered,  
As his hankercher he fluttered,  
Were, "My heart is true to Poll."

His heart was true to Poll,  
His heart was true to Poll,  
It's no matter what you do  
If your heart be only true:  
And his heart *was* true to Poll.

'Twas a wreck. *William*, on shore he swam,  
And looked about for an inn;  
When a noble savage lady, of a color rather shady,  
Came up with a kind of grin:  
"Oh, marry *me*, and a king you'll be,  
And in a palace loll;  
Or we'll eat you willy-nilly."  
So he gave his *hand*, did Billy,  
But his *heart* was true to Poll.

Away a twelvemonth sped, and a happy life he led  
As the King of the Kikeryboos;  
His paint was red and yellar, and he used a big umbrella,

And he wore a pair of over-*shoes*;  
He'd corals and knives, and twenty-six wives,  
Whose beauties I cannot here extol;  
One day they all revolted,  
So he back to Bristol bolted,  
For his *heart* was true to Poll.

His heart was true to Poll,  
His heart was true to Poll,  
It's no matter what you do  
If your heart be only true:  
And his heart *was* true to Poll.

*F. C. Burnand.*

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## TRUST IN WOMEN

When these things following be done to our intent,  
Then put women in trust and confident.

When nettles in winter bring forth roses red,  
And all manner of thorn trees bear figs naturally,  
And geese bear pearls in every mead,  
And laurel bear cherries abundantly,  
And oaks bear dates very plenteously,  
And kisks give of honey superfluence,  
Then put women in trust and confidence.

When box bear paper in every land and town,  
And thistles bear berries in every place,  
And pikes have naturally feathers in their crown,  
And bulls of the sea sing a good bass,  
And men be the ships fishes trace,

And in women be found no insipience,  
Then put them in trust and confidence.

When whittings do walk forests to chase harts,  
And herrings their horns in forests boldly blow,  
And marmsets mourn in moors and lakes,  
And gurnards shoot rooks out of a crossbow,  
And goslings hunt the wolf to overthrow,  
And sprats bear spears in armès of defence,  
Then put women in trust and confidence.

When swine be cunning in all points of music,  
And asses be doctors of every science,  
And cats do heal men by practising of physic,  
And buzzards to scripture give any credence,  
And merchants buy with horn, instead of groats and pence,  
And pyes be made poets for their eloquence,  
Then put women in trust and confidence.

When sparrows build churches on a height,  
And wrens carry sacks unto the mill,  
And curlews carry timber houses to dight,  
And fomalls bear butter to market to sell,  
And woodcocks bear woodknives cranes to kill,  
And greenfinches to goslings do obedience,  
Then put women in trust and confidence.

When crows take salmon in woods and parks,  
And be take with swifts and snails,  
And camels in the air take swallows and larks,  
And mice move mountains by wagging of their tails,  
And shipmen take a ride instead of sails,  
And when wives to their husbands do no offence,  
Then put women in trust and confidence.

When antelopes surmount eagles in flight,  
And swans be swifter than hawks of the tower,

And wrens set gos-hawks by force and might,  
And muskets make verjuice of crabbes sour,  
And ships sail on dry land, silt give flower,  
And apes in Westminster give judgment and sentence,  
Then put women in trust and confidence.

*Unknown.*

---

## THE LITERARY LADY

What motley cares Corilla's mind perplex,  
Whom maids and metaphors conspire to vex!  
In studious dishabille behold her sit,  
A lettered gossip and a household wit;  
At once invoking, though for different views,  
Her gods, her cook, her milliner and muse.  
Round her strewn room a frippery chaos lies,  
A checkered wreck of notable and wise,  
Bills, books, caps, couplets, combs, a varied mass,  
Oppress the toilet and obscure the glass;  
Unfinished here an epigram is laid,  
And there a mantua-maker's bill unpaid.  
There new-born plays foretaste the town's applause,  
There dormant patterns pine for future gauze.  
A moral essay now is all her care,  
A satire next, and then a bill of fare.  
A scene she now projects, and now a dish;  
Here Act the First, and here, Remove with Fish.  
Now, while this eye in a fine frenzy rolls,  
That soberly casts up a bill for coals;  
Black pins and daggers in one leaf she sticks,  
And tears, and threads, and bowls, and thimbles mix.

*Richard Brinsley Sheridan.*

---

## **TWELVE ARTICLES**

### **I**

Lest it may more quarrels breed,  
I will never hear you read.

### **II**

By disputing, I will never,  
To convince you once endeavor.

### **III**

When a paradox you stick to,  
I will never contradict you.

### **IV**

When I talk and you are heedless,  
I will show no anger needless.

### **V**

When your speeches are absurd,  
I will ne'er object a word.

### **VI**

When you furious argue wrong,  
I will grieve and hold my tongue.

### **VII**

Not a jest or humorous story  
Will I ever tell before ye:

To be chidden for explaining,  
When you quite mistake the meaning.

VIII

Never more will I suppose,  
You can taste my verse or prose.

IX

You no more at me shall fret,  
While I teach and you forget.

X

You shall never hear me thunder,  
When you blunder on, and blunder.

XI

Show your poverty of spirit,  
And in dress place all your merit;  
Give yourself ten thousand airs:  
That with me shall break no squares.

XII

Never will I give advice,  
Till you please to ask me thrice:  
Which if you in scorn reject,  
'T will be just as I expect.

Thus we both shall have our ends  
And continue special friends.

*Dean Swift.*

---

**ALL-SAINTS**

In a church which is furnish'd with mullion and gable,  
With altar and reredos, with gargoyle and groin,  
The penitents' dresses are sealskin and sable,  
The odour of sanctity's eau-de-Cologne.

But only could Lucifer, flying from Hades,  
Gaze down on this crowd with its panniers and paints,  
He would say, as he look'd at the lords and the ladies,  
"Oh, where is All-Sinners', if this is All-Saints'?"

*Edmund Yates.*

---

## HOW TO MAKE A MAN OF CONSEQUENCE

A brow austere, a circumspective eye.  
A frequent shrug of the *os humeri*;  
A nod significant, a stately gait,  
A blustering manner, and a tone of weight,  
A smile sarcastic, an expressive stare:  
Adopt all these, as time and place will bear;  
Then rest assur'd that those of little sense  
Will deem you sure a man of consequence.

*Mark Lemon.*

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## ON A MAGAZINE SONNET



"Scorn not the sonnet," though its strength be sapped,  
Nor say malignant its inventor blundered;  
The corpse that here in fourteen lines is wrapped  
Had otherwise been covered with a hundred.

*Russell Hilliard Loines.*

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## PARADISE

### A HINDOO LEGEND

A Hindoo died—a happy thing to do  
When twenty years united to a shrew.  
Released, he hopefully for entrance cries  
Before the gates of Brahma's Paradise.  
"Hast been through Purgatory?" Brahma said.  
"I have been married," and he hung his head.  
"Come in, come in, and welcome, too, my son!  
Marriage and Purgatory are as one."  
In bliss extreme he entered heaven's door,  
And knew the peace he ne'er had known before.

He scarce had entered in the Garden fair,  
Another Hindoo asked admission there.  
The self-same question Brahma asked again:  
"Hast been through Purgatory?" "No; what then?"  
"Thou canst not enter!" did the god reply.  
"He that went in was no more there than I."  
"Yes, that is true, but he has married been,  
And so on earth has suffered for all sin."  
"Married? 'Tis well; for I've been married twice!"  
"Begone! We'll have no fools in Paradise!"

*George Birdseye.*

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## **THE FRIAR OF ORDERS GRAY**

I am a friar of orders gray,  
And down in the valleys I take my way;  
I pull not blackberry, haw, or hip;  
Good store of venison fills my scrip;  
My long bead-roll I merrily chant;  
Where'er I walk no money I want;  
And why I'm so plump the reason I tell:  
Who leads a good life is sure to live well.  
    What baron or squire,  
    Or knight of the shire,  
    Lives half so well as a holy friar?

After supper, of heaven I dream,  
But that is a pullet and clouted cream;  
Myself by denial I mortify—  
With a dainty bit of a warden-pie;  
I'm clothed in sackcloth for my sin—  
With old sack wine I'm lined within;  
A chirping cup is my matin song,  
And the vesper's bell is my bowl, ding-dong.  
    What baron or squire,  
    Or knight of the shire,  
    Lives half so well as a holy friar?

*John O'Keefe.*

---

## OF A CERTAIN MAN

There was (not certain when) a certain preacher  
That never learned, and yet became a teacher,  
Who, having read in Latin thus a text  
Of *erat quidam homo*, much perplexed,  
He seemed the same with study great to scan,  
In English thus, *There was a certain man*.  
"But now," quoth he, "good people, note you this,  
He said there was: he doth not say there is;  
For in these days of ours it is most plain  
Of promise, oath, word, deed, no man's certain;  
Yet by my text you see it comes to pass  
That surely once a certain man there was;  
But yet, I think, in all your Bible no man  
Can find this text, *There was a certain woman*."

*Sir John Harrington.*

---

## CLEAN CLARA

What! not know our Clean Clara?  
Why, the hot folks in Sahara,  
And the cold Esquimaux,  
Our little Clara knows!  
Clean Clara, the Poet sings!  
Cleaned a hundred thousand things!

She cleaned the keys of the harpsichord,  
She cleaned the hilt of the family sword,  
She cleaned my lady, she cleaned my lord,  
All the pictures in their frames,

Knights with daggers and stomachered dames—  
Cecils, Godfreys, Montforts, Graemes,  
Winifreds—all those nice old names!

She cleaned the works of the eight-day clock,  
She cleaned the spring of a secret lock,  
She cleaned the mirror, she cleaned the cupboard,  
All the books she India-rubbered!  
She cleaned the Dutch tiles in the place,  
She cleaned some very old-fashioned lace;  
The Countess of Miniver came to her,  
"Pray, my dear, will you clean my fur?"  
All her cleanings are admirable.  
To count your teeth you will be able,  
If you look in the walnut table.

She cleaned the tent-stitch and the sampler,  
She cleaned the tapestry, which was ampler;  
Joseph going down into the pit,  
And the Shunammite woman with the boy in a fit.

You saw the reapers, *not* in the distance.  
And Elisha, coming to the child's assistance,  
With the house on the wall that was built for the prophet,  
The chair, the bed and the bolster of it.  
The eyebrows all had a twirl reflective,  
Just like an eel: to spare invective  
There was plenty of color but no perspective.  
However, Clara cleaned it all,  
With a curious lamp, that hangs in the hall;  
She cleaned the drops of the chandeliers,  
Madam, in mittens, was moved to tears.

She cleaned the cage of the cockatoo,  
The oldest bird that ever grew;  
I should say a thousand years old would do.  
I'm sure he looked it, but nobody knew;

She cleaned the china, she cleaned the delf,  
She cleaned the baby, she cleaned herself!

Tomorrow morning, she means to try  
To clean the cobwebs from the sky;  
Some people say the girl will rue it,  
But my belief is she will do it.

So I've made up my mind to be there to see  
There's a beautiful place in the walnut tree;  
The bough is as firm as a solid rock;  
She brings out her broom at six o'clock.

W. B. Rands.

---

## CHRISTMAS CHIMES

Little Penelope Socrates,  
A Boston maid of four,  
Wide opened her eyes on Christmas morn,  
And looked the landscape o'er.  
"What is it inflates my *bas de bleu*?"  
She asked with dignity;  
"'Tis Ibsen in the original!  
Oh, joy beyond degree!"

Miss Mary Cadwallader Rittenhouse  
Of Philadelphia town,  
Awoke as much as they ever do there  
And watched the snow come down.  
"I'm glad that it is Christmas,"  
You might have heard her say,  
"For my family is one year older now

Than it was last Christmas day."

'Twas Christmas in giddy Gotham.  
And Miss Irene de Jones  
Awoke at noon and yawned and yawned,  
And stretched her languid bones.  
"I'm sorry it is Christmas,  
Papa at home will stay,  
For 'Change is closed and he won't make  
A single cent to-day."

Windily dawned the Christmas  
On the city by the lake,  
And Miss Arabel Wabash Breezy  
Was instantly awake.  
"What's that thing in my stocking?  
Well, in two jiffs I'll know!"  
And she drew a grand piano forth  
From 'way down in the toe.

*Unknown.*

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## **THE RULING PASSION**

**From "Moral Essays," Epistle I**

The frugal crone, whom praying priests attend,  
Still tries to save the hallowed taper's end,  
Collects her breath, as ebbing life retires,  
For one puff more, and in that puff expires.  
"Odious! in woollen! 'twould a saint provoke,"  
Were the last words that poor Narcissa spoke;  
"No, let a charming chintz and Brussels lace

Wrap my cold limbs, and shade my lifeless face:  
One would not, sure, be frightful when one's dead,—  
And—Betty—give this cheek a little red."

The courtier smooth, who forty years had shined  
An humble servant to all humankind.  
Just brought out this, when scarce his tongue could stir,  
"If—where I'm going—I could serve you, sir?"

"I give and I devise" (old Euclio said,  
And sighed) "my lands and tenements to Ned."  
Your money, sir? "My money, sir! What, all?  
Why—if I must" (then wept)—"I give it Paul."  
The manor, sir? "The manor, hold!" he cried,  
"Not that,—I cannot part with that,"—and died.

*Alexander Pope.*

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## **THE POPE AND THE NET**

What, he on whom our voices unanimously ran,  
Made Pope at our last Conclave? Full low his life began:  
His father earned the daily bread as just a fisherman.

So much the more his boy minds book, gives proof of mother-wit,  
Becomes first Deacon, and then Priest, then Bishop: see him sit  
No less than Cardinal ere long, while no one cries "Unfit!"

But some one smirks, some other smiles, jogs elbow and nods head;  
Each wings at each: "I' faith, a rise! Saint Peter's net, instead  
Of sword and keys, is come in vogue!" You think he blushes red?

Not he, of humble holy heart! "Unworthy me!" he sighs:  
"From fisher's drudge to Church's prince—it is indeed a rise:  
So, here's my way to keep the fact forever in my eyes!"

And straightway in his palace-hall, where commonly is set  
Some coat-of-arms, some portraiture ancestral, lo, we met  
His mean estate's reminder in his fisher-father's net!

Which step conciliates all and some, stops cavil in a trice:  
"The humble holy heart that holds of new-born pride no spice!  
He's just the saint to choose for Pope!" Each adds, "'Tis my advice."

So Pope he was: and when we flocked—its sacred slipper on—  
To kiss his foot, we lifted eyes, alack, the thing was gone—  
That guarantee of lowlihead,—eclipsed that star which shone!

Each eyed his fellow, one and all kept silence. I cried "Pish!  
I'll make me spokesman for the rest, express the common wish.  
Why, Father, is the net removed?" "Son, it hath caught the fish."

*Robert Browning.*

---

## AN ACTOR

A shabby fellow chanced one day to meet  
The British Roscius in the street,  
    Garrick, of whom our nation justly brags;  
The fellow hugged him with a kind embrace;—  
"Good sir, I do not recollect your face,"  
    Quoth Garrick. "No?" replied the man of rags;  
"The boards of Drury you and I have trod  
    Full many a time together, I am sure."  
"When?" with an oath, cried Garrick, "for, by G—d,  
I never saw that face of yours before!  
    What characters, I pray,  
    Did you and I together play?"



"Lord!" quoth the fellow, "think not that I mock—  
When you played Hamlet, sir, I played the cock!"

*John Wolcot.*

---

## THE LOST SPECTACLES

A country curate, visiting his flock,  
At old Rebecca's cottage gave a knock.  
"Good morrow, dame, I mean not any libel,  
But in your dwelling have you got a Bible?"  
"A Bible, sir?" exclaimed she in a rage,  
"D'ye think I've turned a Pagan in my age?  
Here, Judith, and run upstairs, my dear,  
'Tis in the drawer, be quick and bring it here."  
The girl return'd with Bible in a minute,  
Not dreaming for a moment what was in it;  
When lo! on opening it at parlor door,  
Down fell her spectacles upon the floor.  
Amaz'd she stared, was for a moment dumb,  
But quick exclaim'd, "Dear sir, I'm glad you're come.  
'Tis six years since these glasses first were lost,  
And I have miss'd 'em to my poor eyes' cost!"  
Then as the glasses to her nose she raised,  
She closed the Bible—saying, "God be praised!"

*Unknown.*

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## THAT TEXAN CATTLE MAN

We rode the tawny Texan hills,  
A bearded cattle man and I;  
Below us laughed the blossomed rills,  
Above the dappled clouds blew by.  
We talked. The topic? Guess. Why, sir,  
Three-fourths of man's whole time he keeps  
To talk, to think, to *be* of HER;  
The other fourth he sleeps.

To learn what he might know of love,  
I laughed all constancy to scorn.  
"Behold yon happy, changeful dove!  
Behold this day, all storm at morn,  
Yet now 't is changed to cloud and sun.  
Yea, all things change—the heart, the head,  
Behold on earth there is not one  
That changeth not," I said.

He drew a glass as if to scan  
The plain for steers; raised it and sighed.  
He craned his neck, this cattle man,  
Then drove the cork home and replied:  
"For twenty years (forgive these tears)—  
For twenty years no word of strife—  
I have not known for twenty years  
One folly from my wife."

I looked that Texan in the face—  
That dark-browed, bearded cattle man,  
He pulled his beard, then dropped in place  
A broad right hand, all scarred and tan,  
And toyed with something shining there  
From out his holster, keen and small.  
I was convinced. I did not care  
To argue it at all.

But rest I could not. Know I must  
The story of my Texan guide;  
His dauntless love, enduring trust;  
His blessed, immortal bride.  
I wondered, marvelled, marvelled much.  
Was she of Texan growth? Was she  
Of Saxon blood, that boasted such  
Eternal constancy?

I could not rest until I knew—  
"Now twenty years, my man," said I,  
"Is a long time." He turned and drew  
A pistol forth, also a sigh.  
"'Tis twenty years or more," said he,  
"Nay, nay, my honest man, I vow  
I do not doubt that this may be;  
But tell, oh! tell me how.

"'T would make a poem true and grand;  
All time should note it near and far;  
And thy fair, virgin Texan land  
Should stand out like a Winter star.  
America should heed. And then  
The doubtful French beyond the sea—  
'T would make them truer, nobler men.  
To know how this may be."

"It's twenty years or more," urged he,  
"Nay, that I know, good guide of mine;  
But lead me where this wife may be,  
And I a pilgrim at a shrine.  
And kneeling, as a pilgrim true"—  
He, scowling, shouted in my ear;  
"I cannot show my wife to you;  
She's dead this twenty year."

*Joaquin Miller.*

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## FABLE

The mountain and the squirrel  
Had a quarrel,  
And the former called the latter "Little Prig";  
Bun replied,  
"You are doubtless very big;  
But all sorts of things and weather  
Must be taken in together,  
To make up a year  
And a sphere,  
And I think it no disgrace  
To occupy my place.  
If I'm not so large as you,  
You are not so small as I,  
And not half so spry.  
I'll not deny you make  
A very pretty squirrel track;  
Talents differ; all is well and wisely put;  
If I cannot carry forests on my back,  
Neither can you crack a nut."

*Ralph Waldo Emerson.*

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## HOCH! DER KAISER

Der Kaiser of dis Faterland  
Und Gott on high all dings command,  
Ve two—ach! Don't you understand?  
Myself—und Gott.

Vile some men sing der power divine,  
Mine soldiers sing, "Der Wacht am Rhine,"  
Und drink der health in Rhenish wine  
Of Me—und Gott.

Dere's France, she swaggers all aroundt;  
She's ausgespielt, of no account,  
To much we think she don't amount;  
Myself—und Gott.

She vill not dare to fight again,  
But if she shouldt, I'll show her blain  
Dot Elsass und (in French) Lorraine  
Are mein—by Gott!

Dere's grandma dinks she's nicht small beer,  
Mit Boers und such she interfere;  
She'll learn none owns dis hemisphere  
But me—und Gott!

She dinks, good frau, fine ships she's got  
And soldiers mit der scarlet goat.  
Ach! We could knock them! Pouf! Like dot,  
Myself—mit Gott!

In dimes of peace, brebare for wars,  
I bear the spear and helm of Mars,  
Und care not for a thousand Czars,  
Myself—mit Gott!

In fact, I humor efery whim,  
With aspect dark and visage grim;  
Gott pulls mit Me, and I mit him,  
Myself—und Gott!

*Rodney Blake.*

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## WHAT MR. ROBINSON THINKS

Gineral B. is a sensible man;  
He stays to his home an' looks arter his folks;  
He draws his furrer ez straight ez he can,  
An' into nobody's tater-patch pokes;  
But John P.  
Robinson, he  
Sez he wunt vote for Gineral B.

My! ain't it terrible? Wut shall we do?  
We can't never choose him, o' course—that's flat:  
Guess we shall hev to come round (don't you?),  
An' go in for thunder an' guns, an' all that;  
Fer John P.  
Robinson, he  
Sez he wunt vote for Gineral B.

Gineral C. is a dreffle smart man:  
He's been on all sides that give places or pelf;  
But consistency still was a part of his plan—  
He's been true to' *one* party, and that is himself;  
So John P.  
Robinson, he  
Sez he shall vote fer Gineral C.

Gineral C. goes in for the war;  
He don't vally principle mor'n an old cud;  
What did God make us raytional creeturs fer,  
But glory an' gunpowder, plunder an' blood?  
So John P.  
Robinson, he  
Sez he shall vote fer Gineral C.

We're gettin' on nicely up here to our village,  
With good old idees o' wut's right an' wut ain't;  
We o' thought Christ went against war and pillage,  
An' that eppyletts worn't the best mark of a saint;  
But John P.  
Robinson, he  
Sez this kind o' thing's an exploded idee.

The side of our country must ollers be took,  
An' President Pulk, you know, *he* is our country;  
An' the angel that writes all our sins in a book,  
Puts the *debit* to him, an' to us the *per contry*;  
An' John P.  
Robinson, he  
Sez this is his view o' the thing to a T.

Parson Wilbur he calls all these arguments lies;  
Sez they're nothin' on airth but jest *fee, faw, fum*;  
An' that all this big talk of our destinies  
Is half on it ignorance, an' t'other half rum;  
But John P.  
Robinson, he  
Sez it ain't no such thing; an', of course, so must we.

Parson Wilbur sez *he* never heered in his life  
Thet the Apostles rigg'd out in their swallow-tail coats,  
An' marched round in front of a drum an' a fife,  
To git some on 'em office, an' some on 'em votes;  
But John P.  
Robinson, he  
Sez they didn't know everythin' down in Judee.

Wal, it's a marcy we're gut folks to tell us  
The rights an' the wrongs o' these matters, I vow—  
God sends country lawyers an' other wise fellers  
To drive the world's team wen it gits in a slough;  
For John P.

Robinson, he  
Sez the world'll go right, ef he hollers out Gee!

*James Russell Lowell.*

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## THE CANDIDATE'S CREED

### BIGLOW PAPERS

I du believe in Freedom's cause,  
Ez fur away ez Paris is;  
I love to see her stick her claws  
In them infarnal Pharisees;  
It's wal enough agin a king  
To dror resolves and triggers,—  
But libbaty's a kind o' thing  
Thet don't agree with niggers.

I du believe the people want  
A tax on teas and coffees,  
Thet nothin' ain't extravygunt,—  
Purvidin' I'm in office;  
For I hev loved my country sence  
My eye-teeth filled their sockets,  
An' Uncle Sam I reverence,  
Partic'larly his pockets.

I du believe in *any* plan  
O' levyin' the taxes,  
Ez long ez, like a lumberman,  
I git jest wut I axes:  
I go free-trade thru thick an' thin,  
Because it kind o' rouses



The folks to vote—and keep us in  
Our quiet custom-houses.

I du believe it's wise an' good  
To sen' out furrin missions,  
Thet is, on sartin understood  
An' orthydox conditions;—  
I mean nine thousan' dolls, per ann.,  
Nine thousan' more fer outfit,  
An' me to recommend a man  
The place 'ould jest about fit.

I du believe in special ways  
O' prayin' an' convartin';  
The bread comes back in many days,  
An' buttered, tu, fer sartin;—  
I mean in preyin' till one busts  
On wut the party chooses,  
An' in convartin' public trusts  
To very privit uses.

I do believe hard coin the stuff  
Fer 'lectioneers to spout on;  
The people's ollers soft enough  
To make hard money out on;  
Dear Uncle Sam pervides fer his,  
An' gives a good-sized junk to all—  
I don't care *how* hard money is,  
Ez long ez mine's paid punctooal.

I du believe with all my soul  
In the gret Press's freedom,  
To pint the people to the goal  
An' in the traces lead 'em:  
Palsied the arm thet forges yokes  
At my fat contracts squintin',  
An' withered be the nose thet pokes

Inter the gov'ment printin'!

I du believe thet I should give  
Wut's his'n unto Cæsar,  
Fer it's by him I move an' live,  
From him my bread an' cheese air.  
I du believe thet all o' me  
Doth bear his souperscription,—  
Will, conscience, honor, honesty,  
An' things o' thet description.

I du believe in prayer an' praise  
To him thet hez the grantin'  
O' jobs—in every thin' thet pays,  
But most of all in CANTIN';  
This doth my cup with marcies fill,  
This lays all thought o' sin to rest—  
I *don't* believe in princerple,  
But, O, I *du* in interest.

I du believe in bein' this  
Or thet, ez it may happen  
One way, or t' other hendiest is  
To ketch the people nappin';  
It ain't by princerples nor men  
My prudent course is steadied—  
I scent wich pays the best, an' then  
Go into it baldheaded.

I du believe thet holdin' slaves  
Comes nat'ral tu a President,  
Let 'lone the rowdedow it saves  
To have a wal-broke precedunt;  
Fer any office, small or gret,  
I couldn't ax with no face,  
Without I'd been, thru dry an' wet,  
The unrizziest kind o' doughface.

I du believe wutever trash  
    'll keep the people in blindness,—  
Thet we the Mexicans can thrash  
    Right inter brotherly kindness—  
Thet bombshells, grape, an' powder 'n' ball  
    Air good-will's strongest magnets—  
Thet peace, to make it stick at all,  
    Must be druv in with bagnets.

In short, I firmly du believe  
    In Humbug generally,  
Fer it's a thing thet I perceive  
    To hev a solid vally;  
This heth my faithful shepherd ben,  
    In pastures sweet heth led me,  
An' this'll keep the people green  
    To feed ez they have fed me.

*James Russell Lowell.*

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## THE RAZOR SELLER

A fellow in a market town,  
Most musical, cried razors up and down,  
    And offered twelve for eighteen-pence;  
Which certainly seemed wondrous cheap,  
And for the money quite a heap,  
    As every man would buy, with cash and sense.

A country bumpkin the great offer heard:  
Poor Hodge, who suffered by a broad black beard,  
    That seemed a shoe-brush stuck beneath his nose

With cheerfulness the eighteen-pence he paid,  
And proudly to himself, in whispers, said,  
    "This rascal stole the razors, I suppose.

"No matter if the fellow *be* a knave,  
Provided that the razors *shave*;  
    It certainly will be a monstrous prize."  
So home the clown, with his good fortune, went,  
Smiling in heart and soul, content,  
    And quickly soaped himself to ears and eyes.

Being well lathered from a dish or tub,  
Hodge now began with grinning pain to grub,  
    Just like a hedger cutting furze:  
'Twas a vile razor!—then the rest he tried—  
All were imposters—"Ah," Hodge sighed!  
    "I wish my eighteen-pence within my purse."

In vain to chase his beard, and bring the graces,  
    He cut, and dug, and winced, and stamped, and swore,  
Brought blood, and danced, blasphemed, and made wry faces,  
    And cursed each razor's body o'er and o'er:

His muzzle, formed of *opposition* stuff,  
Firm as a Foxite, would not lose its ruff!  
    So kept it—laughing at the steel and suds:  
Hodge, in a passion, stretched his angry jaws,  
Vowing the direst vengeance, with clenched claws,  
    On the vile cheat that sold the goods.  
"Razors; a damned, confounded dog,  
Not fit to scrape a hog!"

Hodge sought the fellow—found him—and begun:  
"P'rhaps, Master Razor rogue, to you 'tis fun,  
    That people flay themselves out of their lives:  
You rascal! for an hour have I been grubbing,  
Giving my crying whiskers here a scrubbing,

With razors just like oyster knives.  
Sirrah! I tell you, you're a knave,  
To cry up razors that can't *shave*."  
"Friend," quoth the razor-man, "I'm not a knave.  
As for the razors you have bought,  
Upon my soul I never thought  
That they would *shave*."  
"Not think they'd *shave*!" quoth Hodge, with wond'ring eyes,  
And voice not much unlike an Indian yell;  
"What were they made for then, you dog?" he cries:  
"Made!" quoth the fellow, with a smile—"to *sell*."

*John Wolcot.*

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## THE DEVIL'S WALK ON EARTH

From his brimstone bed at break of day  
A walking the Devil is gone,  
To look at his snug little farm of the World,  
And see how his stock went on.

Over the hill and over the dale,  
And he went over the plain;  
And backward and forward he swish'd his tail  
As a gentleman swishes a cane.

How then was the Devil drest?  
Oh, he was in his Sunday's best  
His coat was red and his breeches were blue,  
And there was a hole where his tail came through.  
A lady drove by in her pride,  
In whose face an expression he spied  
For which he could have kiss'd her;

Such a flourishing, fine, clever woman was she,  
With an eye as wicked as wicked can be,  
I should take her for my Aunt, thought he,  
If my dam had had a sister.

He met a lord of high degree,  
No matter what was his name;  
Whose face with his own when he came to compare  
The expression, the look, and the air,  
And the character, too, as it seem'd to a hair—  
Such a twin-likeness there was in the pair  
That it made the Devil start and stare  
For he thought there was surely a looking-glass there,  
But he could not see the frame.

He saw a Lawyer killing a viper,  
On a dung-hill beside his stable;  
Ha! quoth he, thou put'st me in mind  
Of the story of Cain and Abel.

An Apothecary on a white horse  
Rode by on his vocation;  
And the Devil thought of his old friend  
Death in the Revelation.

He pass'd a cottage with a double coach-house,  
A cottage of gentility,  
And he own'd with a grin  
That his favorite sin,  
Is pride that apes humility.

He saw a pig rapidly  
Down a river float;  
The pig swam well, but every stroke  
Was cutting his own throat;

And Satan gave thereat his tail

A twirl of admiration;  
For he thought of his daughter War,  
And her suckling babe Taxation.

Well enough, in sooth, he liked that truth  
And nothing the worse for the jest;  
But this was only a first thought  
And in this he did not rest:  
Another came presently into his head,  
And here it proved, as has often been said  
That second thoughts are best.

For as Piggy plied with wind and tide,  
His way with such celerity,  
And at every stroke the water dyed  
With his own red blood, the Devil cried,  
Behold a swinish nation's pride  
In cotton-spun prosperity.

He walk'd into London leisurely,  
The streets were dirty and dim:  
But there he saw Brothers the Prophet,  
And Brothers the Prophet saw him.

He entered a thriving bookseller's shop;  
Quoth he, we are both of one college,  
For I myself sate like a Cormorant once  
Upon the Tree of Knowledge.

As he passed through Cold-Bath Fields he look'd  
At a solitary cell;  
And he was well-pleased, for it gave him a hint  
For improving the prisons of Hell.

He saw a turnkey tie a thief's hands  
With a cordial tug and jerk;  
Nimble, quoth he, a man's fingers move

When his heart is in his work.

He saw the same turnkey unfettering a man  
With little expedition;  
And he chuckled to think of his dear slave-trade,  
And the long debates and delays that were made,  
Concerning its abolition.

He met one of his favorite daughters  
By an Evangelical Meeting:  
And forgetting himself for joy at her sight,  
He would have accosted her outright,  
And given her a fatherly greeting.

But she tipt him the wink, drew back, and cried,  
Avaunt! my name's Religion!  
And then she turn'd to the preacher  
And leer'd like a love-sick pigeon.

A fine man and a famous Professor was he,  
As the great Alexander now may be,  
Whose fame not yet o'erpast is:  
Or that new Scotch performer  
Who is fiercer and warmer,  
The great Sir Arch-Bombastes.

With throbs and throes, and ah's and oh's.  
Far famed his flock for frightening;  
And thundering with his voice, the while  
His eyes zigzag like lightning.

This Scotch phenomenon, I trow,  
Beats Alexander hollow;  
Even when most tame  
He breathes more flame  
Then ten Fire-Kings could swallow.



Another daughter he presently met;  
With music of fife and drum,  
And a consecrated flag,  
And shout of tag and rag,  
And march of rank and file,  
Which had fill'd the crowded aisle  
Of the venerable pile,  
From church he saw her come.

He call'd her aside, and began to chide,  
For what dost thou here? said he,  
My city of Rome is thy proper home,  
And there's work enough there for thee.

Thou hast confessions to listen,  
And bells to christen,  
And altars and dolls to dress;  
And fools to coax,  
And sinners to hoax,  
And beads and bones to bless;  
And great pardons to sell  
For those who pay well,  
And small ones for those who pay less.

Nay, Father, I boast, that this is my post,  
She answered; and thou wilt allow,  
That the great Harlot,  
Who is clothed in scarlet,  
Can very well spare me now.

Upon her business I am come here,  
That we may extend our powers:  
Whatever lets down this church that we hate,  
Is something in favor of ours.

You will not think, great Cosmocrat!  
That I spend my time in fooling;

Many irons, my sire, have we in the fire,  
And I must leave none of them cooling;  
For you must know state-councils here,  
Are held which I bear rule in.  
When my liberal notions,  
Produce mischievous motions,  
There's many a man of good intent,  
In either house of Parliament,  
Whom I shall find a tool in;  
And I have hopeful pupils too  
Who all this while are schooling.

Fine progress they make in our liberal opinions,  
My Utilitarians,  
My all sorts of—inians  
And all sorts of—arians;  
My all sorts of—ists,  
And my Prigs and my Whigs  
Who have all sorts of twists  
Train'd in the very way, I know,  
Father, you would have them go;  
High and low,  
Wise and foolish, great and small,  
March-of-Intellect-Boys all.

Well pleased wilt thou be at no very far day  
When the caldron of mischief boils,  
And I bring them forth in battle array  
And bid them suspend their broils,  
That they may unite and fall on the prey,  
For which we are spreading our toils.  
How the nice boys all will give mouth at the call,  
Hark away! hark away to the spoils!  
My Macs and my Quacks and my lawless-Jacks,  
My Shiels and O'Connells, my pious Mac-Donnells,  
My joke-smith Sydney, and all of his kidney,  
My Humes and my Broughams,

My merry old Jerry,  
My Lord Kings, and my Doctor Doyles!

At this good news, so great  
The Devil's pleasure grew,  
That with a joyful swish he rent  
The hole where his tail came through.

His countenance fell for a moment  
When he felt the stitches go;  
Ah! thought he, there's a job now  
That I've made for my tailor below.

Great news! bloody news! cried a newsman;  
The Devil said, Stop, let me see!  
Great news? bloody news? thought the Devil,  
The bloodier the better for me.

So he bought the newspaper, and no news  
At all for his money he had.  
Lying varlet, thought he, thus to take in old Nick!  
But it's some satisfaction, my lad,  
To know thou art paid beforehand for the trick,  
For the sixpence I gave thee is bad.

And then it came into his head  
By oracular inspiration,  
That what he had seen and what he had said  
In the course of this visitation,  
Would be published in the Morning Post  
For all this reading nation.

Therewith in second sight he saw  
The place and the manner and time,  
In which this mortal story  
Would be put in immortal rhyme.

That it would happen when two poets  
Should on a time be met,  
In the town of Nether Stowey,  
In the shire of Somerset.

There while the one was shaving  
Would he the song begin;  
And the other when he heard it at breakfast,  
In ready accord join in.

So each would help the other,  
Two heads being better than one;  
And the phrase and conceit  
Would in unison meet,  
And so with glee the verse flow free,  
In ding-dong chime of sing-song rhyme,  
Till the whole were merrily done.

And because it was set to the razor,  
Not to the lute or harp,  
Therefore it was that the fancy  
Should be bright, and the wit be sharp.

But, then, said Satan to himself,  
As for that said beginner,  
Against my infernal Majesty,  
There is no greater sinner.

He hath put me in ugly ballads  
With libelous pictures for sale;  
He hath scoff'd at my hoofs and my horns,  
And has made very free with my tail.

But this Mister Poet shall find  
I am not a safe subject for whim;  
For I'll set up a School of my own,  
And my Poets shall set upon him.

He went to a coffee-house to dine,  
And there he had soy in his dish;  
Having ordered some soles for his dinner,  
Because he was fond of flat fish.

They are much to my palate, thought he,  
And now guess the reason who can,  
Why no bait should be better than place,  
When I fish for a Parliament-man.

But the soles in the bill were ten shillings;  
Tell your master, quoth he, what I say;  
If he charges at this rate for all things,  
He must be in a pretty good way.

But mark ye, said he to the waiter,  
I'm a dealer myself in this line,  
And his business, between you and me,  
Nothing like so extensive as mine.

Now soles are exceedingly cheap,  
Which he will not attempt to deny,  
When I see him at my fish-market,  
I warrant him, by-and-by.

As he went along the Strand  
Between three in the morning and four  
He observed a queer-looking person  
Who staggered from Perry's door.

And he thought that all the world over  
In vain for a man you might seek,  
Who could drink more like a Trojan  
Or talk more like a Greek.

The Devil then he prophesied

It would one day he matter of talk,  
That with wine when smitten,  
And with wit moreover being happily bitten,  
The erudite bibber was he who had written  
The story of this walk.

A pretty mistake, quoth the Devil;  
A pretty mistake I opine!  
I have put many ill thoughts in his mouth,  
He will never put good ones in mine.

And whoever shall say that to Porson  
These best of all verses belong,  
He is an untruth-telling whore-son,  
And so shall be call'd in the song.

And if seeking an illicit connection with fame,  
Any one else should put in a claim,  
In this comical competition;  
That excellent poem will prove  
A man-trap for such foolish ambition,  
Where the silly rogue shall be caught by the leg,  
And exposed in a second edition.

Now the morning air was cold for him  
Who was used to a warm abode;  
And yet he did not immediately wish,  
To set out on his homeward road.

For he had some morning calls to make  
Before he went back to Hell;  
So thought he I'll step into a gaming-house,  
And that will do as well;  
But just before he could get to the door  
A wonderful chance befell.

For all on a sudden, in a dark place,

He came upon General ——'s burning face;  
And it struck him with such consternation,  
That home in a hurry his way did he take,  
Because he thought, by a slight mistake  
'Twas the general conflagration.

*Robert Southey.*

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## FATHER MOLLOY

### OR, THE CONFESSION

Paddy McCabe was dying one day,  
And Father Molloy he came to confess him;  
Paddy pray'd hard he would make no delay,  
But forgive him his sins and make haste for to bless him.  
"First tell me your sins," says Father Molloy,  
"For I'm thinking you've not been a very good boy."  
"Oh," says Paddy, "so late in the evenin', I fear,  
'Twould trouble you such a long story to hear,  
For you've ten long miles o'er the mountains to go,  
While the road I've to travel's much longer, you know.  
So give us your blessin' and get in the saddle,  
To tell all my sins my poor brain it would addle;  
And the docther gave ordhers to keep me so quiet—  
'Twould disturb me to tell all my sins, if I'd thry it,  
And your Reverence has towld us, unless we tell *all*,  
'Tis worse than not makin' confession at all.  
So I'll say in a word I'm no very good boy—  
And, therefore, your blessin', sweet Father Molloy."

"Well, I'll read from a book," says Father Molloy,  
"The manifold sins that humanity's heir to;

And when you hear those that your conscience annoy,  
You'll just squeeze my hand, as acknowledging thereto."  
Then the father began the dark roll of iniquity,  
And Paddy, thereat, felt his conscience grow rickety,  
And he gave such a squeeze that the priest gave a roar—  
"Oh, murdher," says Paddy, "don't read any more,  
For, if you keep readin', by all that is thrue,  
Your Reverence's fist will be soon black and blue;  
Besides, to be throubled my conscience begins,  
That your Reverence should have any hand in my sins,  
So you'd betther suppose I committed them all,  
For whether they're great ones, or whether they're small,  
Or if they're a dozen, or if they're fourscore,  
'Tis your Reverence knows how to absolve them, asthore;  
So I'll say in a word, I'm no very good boy—  
And, therefore, your blessin', sweet Father Molloy."

"Well," says Father Molloy, "if your sins I forgive,  
So you must forgive all your enemies truly;  
And promise me also that, if you should live,  
You'll leave off your old tricks, and begin to live newly."  
"I forgive ev'rybody," says Pat, with a groan,  
"Except that big vagabone Micky Malone;  
And him I will murdher if ever I can—"  
"Tut, tut," says the priest, "you're a very bad man;  
For without your forgiveness, and also repentance,  
You'll ne'er go to Heaven, and that is my sentence."  
"Poo!" says Paddy McCabe, "that's a very hard case—  
With your Reverence and Heaven I'm content to make pace;  
But with Heaven and your Reverence I wondher—*Och hone*—  
You would think of comparin' that blackguard Malone—  
But since I'm hard press'd and that I *must* forgive,  
I forgive—if I die—but as sure as I live  
That ugly blackguard I will surely desthroy!—  
So, *now* for your blessin', sweet Father Molloy!"

*Samuel Lover.*



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## THE OWL-CRITIC

"Who stuffed that white owl?" No one spoke in the shop,  
The barber was busy, and he couldn't stop;  
The customers, waiting their turns, were all reading  
The "Daily," the "Herald," the "Post," little heeding  
The young man who blurted out such a blunt question;  
Not one raised a head, or even made a suggestion;  
And the barber kept on shaving.

"Don't you see, Mr. Brown,"  
Cried the youth, with a frown,  
"How wrong the whole thing is,  
How preposterous each wing is  
How flattened the head is, how jammed down the neck is—  
In short, the whole owl, what an ignorant wreck 't is!  
I make no apology;  
I've learned owl-eology.

I've passed days and nights in a hundred collections,  
And cannot be blinded to any deflections  
Arising from unskilful fingers that fail  
To stuff a bird right, from his beak to his tail.  
Mister Brown! Mister Brown!  
Do take that bird down,  
Or you'll soon be the laughing-stock all over town!"  
And the barber kept on shaving.

"I've *studied* owls,  
And other night-fowls,  
And I tell you  
What I know to be true;  
An owl cannot roost  
With his limbs so unloosed;

No owl in this world  
Ever had his claws curled,  
Ever had his legs slanted,  
Ever had his bill canted,  
Ever had his neck screwed  
Into that attitude.  
He can't *do* it, because  
'Tis against all bird-laws.

Anatomy teaches,  
Ornithology preaches,  
An owl has a toe  
That *can't* turn out so!  
I've made the white owl my study for years,  
And to see such a job almost moves me to tears!  
Mr. Brown, I'm amazed  
You should be so gone crazed  
As to put up a bird  
In that posture absurd!  
To *look* at that owl really brings on a dizziness;  
The man who stuffed *him* don't half know his business!"  
And the barber kept on shaving.

"Examine those eyes.  
I'm filled with surprise  
Taxidermists should pass  
Off on you such poor glass;  
So unnatural they seem  
They'd make Audubon scream,  
And John Burroughs laugh  
To encounter such chaff.  
Do take that bird down;  
Have him stuffed again, Brown!"  
And the barber kept on shaving.

"With some sawdust and bark  
I could stuff in the dark

An owl better than that.  
I could make an old hat  
Look more like an owl  
Than that horrid fowl,  
Stuck up there so stiff like a side of coarse leather.  
In fact, about *him* there's not one natural feather."

Just then, with a wink and a sly normal lurch,  
The owl, very gravely, got down from his perch,  
Walked round, and regarded his fault-finding critic  
(Who thought he was stuffed) with a glance analytic,  
And then fairly hooted, as if he should say:  
"Your learning's at fault *this* time, anyway;  
Don't waste it again on a live bird, I pray.  
I'm an owl; you're another. Sir Critic, good day!"  
And the barber kept on shaving.

*James Thomas Fields.*

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## WHAT WILL WE DO?

What will we do when the good days come—  
When the prima donna's lips are dumb,  
And the man who reads us his "little things"  
Has lost his voice like the girl who sings;  
When stilled is the breath of the cornet-man,  
And the shrilling chords of the quartette clan;  
When our neighbours' children have lost their drums—  
Oh, what will we do when the good time comes?  
Oh, what will we do in that good, blithe time,  
When the tramp will work—oh, thing sublime!  
And the scornful dame who stands on your feet  
Will "Thank you, sir," for the proffered seat;

And the man you hire to work by the day,  
Will allow you to do his work your way;  
And the cook who trieth your appetite  
Will steal no more than she thinks is right;  
When the boy you hire will call you "Sir,"  
Instead of "Say" and "Guverner";  
When the funny man is humorsome—  
How can we stand the millennium?

*Robert J. Burdette.*

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## **LIFE IN LACONICS**

Given a roof, and a taste for rations,  
And you have the key to the "wealth of nations."

Given a boy, a tree, and a hatchet,  
And virtue strives in vain to match it.

Given a pair, a snake, and an apple,  
You make the whole world need a chapel.

Given "no cards," broad views, and a hovel,  
You have a realistic novel.

Given symptoms and doctors with potion and pill,  
And your heirs will ere long be contesting your will.

That good leads to evil there's no denying:  
If it were not for *truth* there would be no *lying*.

"I'm nobody!" should have a hearse;  
But then, "I'm somebody!" is worse.

"Folks say," *et cetera*! Well, they shouldn't,  
And if they knew you well, they wouldn't.

When you coddle your life, all its vigor and grace  
Shrink away with the whisper, "We're in the wrong place."

*Mary Mapes Dodge.*

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## ON KNOWING WHEN TO STOP

The woodchuck told it all about.  
"I'm going to build a dwelling  
Six stories high, up to the sky!"  
He never tired of telling.

He dug the cellar smooth and well  
But made no more advances;  
That lovely hole so pleased his soul  
And satisfied his fancies.

*L. J. Bridgman.*

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## REV. GABE TUCKER'S REMARKS

You may notch it on de palin's as a mighty resky plan  
To make your judgment by de clo'es dat kivers up a man;  
For I hardly needs to tell you how you often come across  
A fifty-dollar saddle on a twenty-dollar hoss;

An', wukin' in de low-groun's, you diskiver, as you go,  
Dat de fines' shuck may hide de meanes' nubbin in a row.

I think a man has got a mighty slender chance for heben  
Dat holds on to his piety but one day out o' seben;  
Dat talks about de sinners wid a heap o' solemn chat,  
And nebber draps a nickel in de missionary hat;  
Dat's foremost in de meetin'-house for raisin' all de chunes,  
But lays aside his 'ligion wid his Sunday pantaloons.

I nebber judge o' people dat I meets along de way  
By de places whar dey come fum an' de houses whar dey stay;  
For de bantam chicken's awful fond o' roostin' pretty high,  
An' de turkey buzzard sails above de eagle in de sky;  
Dey ketches little minners in de middle ob de sea,  
An' you finds de smalles' possum up de bigges' kind o' tree!

*Unknown.*

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## THURSDAY

The sun was setting, and vespers done;  
From chapel the monks came one by one,  
And down they went thro' the garden trim,  
In cassock and cowl, to the river's brim.  
Ev'ry brother his rod he took;  
Ev'ry rod had a line and a hook;  
Ev'ry hook had a bait so fine,  
And thus they sang in the even shine:  
"Oh, to-morrow will be Friday, so we'll fish the stream to-day!  
Oh, to-morrow will be Friday, so we'll fish the stream to-day!  
Benedicite!"

So down they sate by the river's brim,  
And fish'd till the light was growing dim;  
They fish'd the stream till the moon was high,  
But never a fish came wand'ring by.  
They fish'd the stream in the bright moonshine,  
But not one fish would he come to dine.  
And the Abbot said, "It seems to me  
These rascally fish are all gone to sea.  
And to-morrow will be Friday, but we've caught no fish to-day;  
Oh, to-morrow will be Friday, but we've caught no fish to-day!  
Maledicite!"

So back they went to the convent gate,  
Abbot and monks disconsolate;  
For they thought of the morrow with faces white,  
Saying, "Oh, we must curb our appetite!  
But down in the depths of the vault below  
There's Malvoisie for a world of woe!"  
So they quaff their wine, and all declare  
That fish, after all, is but gruesome fare.  
"Oh, to-morrow will be Friday, so we'll warm our souls to-day!  
Oh, to-morrow will be Friday, so we'll warm our souls to-day!  
Benedicite!"

*Frederick E. Weatherly.*

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## SKY-MAKING

### TO PROFESSOR TYNDALL

Just take a trifling handful, O philosopher,  
Of magic matter, give it a slight toss over  
The ambient ether, and I don't see why

You shouldn't make a sky.

O hours Utopian which we may anticipate!  
Thick London fog how easy 'tis to dissipate,  
And make the most pea-soupy day as clear  
As Bass's brightest beer!

Poet-professor! now my brain thou kindlest;  
I am become a most determined Tyndallist.  
If it is known a fellow can make skies,  
Why not make bright blue eyes?

This to deny, the folly of a dunce it is;  
Surely a girl as easy as a sunset is.  
If you can make a halo or eclipse,  
Why not two laughing lips?

The creed of Archimedes, erst of Sicily,  
And of D'Israeli ... *forti nil difficile*,  
Is likewise mine. Pygmalion was a fool  
Who should have gone to school.

Why should an author scribble rhymes or articles?  
Bring me a dozen tiny Tyndall particles;  
Therefrom I'll coin a dinner, Nash's wine,  
And a nice girl to dine.

*Mortimer Collins.*

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## THE POSITIVISTS

Life and the Universe show spontaneity:  
Down with ridiculous notions of Deity!



Churches and creeds are all lost in the mists;  
Truth must be sought with the Positivists.

Wise are their teachers beyond all comparison,  
Comte, Huxley, Tyndall, Mill, Morley, and Harrison;  
Who will adventure to enter the lists  
With such a squadron of Positivists?

Social arrangements are awful miscarriages;  
Cause of all crime is our system of marriages.  
Poets with sonnets, and lovers with trysts,  
Kindle the ire of the Positivists.

Husbands and wives should be all one community,  
Exquisite freedom with absolute unity.  
Wedding-rings worse are than manacled wrists—  
Such is the creed of the Positivists.

There was an ape in the days that were earlier;  
Centuries passed, and his hair became curlier;  
Centuries more gave a thumb to his wrist—  
Then he was Man, and a Positivist.

If you are pious (mild form of insanity)  
Bow down and worship the mass of humanity.  
Other religions are buried in mists;  
We're our own Gods, say the Positivists.

*Mortimer Collins.*

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## MARTIAL IN LONDON

Exquisite wines and comestibles,  
From Slater, and Fortnum and Mason;  
Billiard, écarté, and chess tables;  
Water in vast marble basin;  
Luminous books (not voluminous)  
To read under beech-trees cacuminous;  
One friend, who is fond of a distich,  
And doesn't get too syllogistic;  
A valet, who knows the complete art  
Of service—a maiden, his sweetheart:  
Give me these, in some rural pavilion,  
And I'll envy no Rothschild his million.

*Mortimer Collins.*

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## THE SPLENDID SHILLING

"... Sing, heavenly Muse!  
Things unattempted yet, in prose or rhyme,"  
A shilling, breeches, and chimeras dire.

Happy the man, who, void of cares and strife,  
In silken or in leather purse retains  
A Splendid Shilling: he nor hears with pain  
New oysters cried, nor sighs for cheerful ale;  
But with his friends, when nightly mists arise,  
To Juniper's Magpie, or Town-hall repairs:  
Where, mindful of the nymph, whose wanton eye  
Transfix'd his soul, and kindled amorous flames,  
Chloe, or Phillis, he each circling glass  
Wisheth her health, and joy, and equal love.  
Meanwhile, he smokes, and laughs at merry tale,  
Or pun ambiguous, or conundrum quaint.

But I, whom griping penury surrounds,  
And Hunger, sure attendant upon Want,  
With scanty offals, and small acid tiff,  
(Wretched repast!) my meagre corpse sustain:  
Then solitary walk, or doze at home  
In garret vile, and with a warming puff  
Regale chill'd fingers: or from tube as black  
As winter-chimney, or well-polish'd jet,  
Exhale mundungus, ill-perfuming scent:  
Not blacker tube, nor of a shorter size,  
Smokes Cambro-Briton (vers'd in pedigree,  
Sprung from Cadwallador and Arthur, kings  
Full famous in romantic tale) when he,  
O'er many a craggy hill and barren cliff,  
Upon a cargo of fam'd Cestrian cheese,  
High over-shadowing rides, with a design  
To vend his wares, or at th' Avonian mart,  
Or Maridunum, or the ancient town  
Yelep'd Brechinia, or where Vaga's stream  
Encircles Ariconium, fruitful soil!  
Whence flow nectareous wines, that well may vie  
With Massic, Setin, or renown'd Falern.

Thus while my joyless minutes tedious flow,  
With looks demure, and silent pace, a Dun,  
Horrible monster! hated by gods and men,  
To my aërial citadel ascends,  
With vocal heel thrice thundering at my gate,  
With hideous accent thrice he calls; I know  
The voice ill-boding, and the solemn sound.  
What should I do? or whither turn? Amaz'd,  
Confounded, to the dark recess I fly  
Of wood-hole; straight my bristling hairs erect  
Through sudden fear; a chilly sweat bedews  
My shuddering limbs, and (wonderful to tell!)  
My tongue forgets her faculty of speech;  
So horrible he seems! His faded brow,  
Intrench'd with many a frown, and conic beard,

And spreading band, admir'd by modern saints,  
Disastrous acts forbode; in his right hand  
Long scrolls of paper solemnly he waves,  
With characters and figures dire inscrib'd,  
Grievous to mortal eyes; (ye gods, avert  
Such plagues from righteous men!) Behind him stalks  
Another monster, not unlike himself,  
Sullen of aspect, by the vulgar call'd  
A catchpole, whose polluted hands the gods,  
With force incredible, and magic charms,  
First have endued: if he his ample palm  
Should haply on ill-fated shoulder lay  
Of debtor, straight his body, to the touch  
Obsequious (as whilom knights were wont,)   
To some enchanted castle is convey'd,  
Where gates impregnable, and coercive chains,  
In durance strict detain him, till, in form  
Of money, Pallas sets the captive free.

Beware, ye debtors! when ye walk, beware,  
Be circumspect; oft with insidious ken  
The caitiff eyes your steps aloof, and oft  
Lies perdu in a nook or gloomy cave,  
Prompt to enchant some inadvertent wretch  
With his unhallowed touch. So, (poets sing)  
Grimalkin, to domestic vermin sworn  
An everlasting foe, with watchful eye  
Lies nightly brooding o'er a chinky gap,  
Portending her fell claws, to thoughtless mice  
Sure ruin. So her disembowell'd web  
Arachne, in a hall or kitchen, spreads  
Obvious to vagrant flies: she secret stands  
Within her woven cell: the humming prey,  
Regardless of their fate, rush on the toils  
Inextricable, nor will aught avail  
Their arts, or arms, or shapes of lovely hue;  
The wasp insidious, and the buzzing drone,  
And butterfly, proud of expanded wings

Distinct with gold, entangled in her snares,  
Useless resistance make; with eager strides,  
She towering flies to her expected spoils;  
Then, with envenomed jaws, the vital blood  
Drinks of reluctant foes, and to her cave  
Their bulky carcasses triumphant drags.

So pass my days. But when nocturnal shades  
This world envelop, and th' inclement air  
Persuades men to repel benumbing frosts  
With pleasant wines, and crackling blaze of wood;  
Me, lonely sitting, nor the glimmering light  
Of make-weight candle, nor the joyous talk  
Of loving friend, delights: distress'd, forlorn,  
Amidst the horrors of the tedious night,  
Darkling I sigh, and feed with dismal thoughts  
My anxious mind: or sometimes mournful verse  
Indite, and sing of groves and myrtle shades,  
Or desperate lady near a purling stream,  
Or lover pendent on a willow tree.  
Meanwhile I labor with eternal drought,  
And restless wish, and rave; my parched throat  
Finds no relief, nor heavy eyes repose:  
But if a slumber haply does invade  
My weary limbs, my fancy's still awake,  
Thoughtful of drink, and eager, in a dream,  
Tipples imaginary pots of ale,  
In vain; awake I find the settled thirst  
Still gnawing, and the pleasant phantom curse.

Thus do I live, from pleasure quite debarred,  
Nor taste the fruits that the sun's genial rays  
Mature, john-apple, nor the downy peach,  
Nor walnut in rough-furrow'd coat secure,  
Nor medlar, fruit delicious in decay;  
Afflictions great! yet greater still remain:  
My galligaskins, that have long withstood  
The winter's fury, and encroaching frosts,  
By time subdued (what will not time subdue!)

An horrid chasm disclos'd with orifice  
Wide, discontinuous; at which the winds  
Eurus and Auster, and the dreadful force  
Of Boreas, that congeals the Cronian waves,  
Tumultuous enter with dire chilling blasts,  
Portending agues. Thus a well-fraught ship,  
Long sail'd secure, or through th' Ægean deep,  
Or the Ionian, till cruising near  
The Lilybean shore, with hideous crush  
On Scylla, or Charybdis (dangerous rocks!)  
She strikes rebounding; whence the shatter'd oak,  
So fierce a shock unable to withstand,  
Admits the sea: in at the gaping side  
The crowding waves gush with impetuous rage  
Resistless, overwhelming; horrors seize  
The mariners; Death in their eyes appears,  
They stare, they lave, they pump, they swear, they pray  
(Vain efforts!) still the battering waves rush in,  
Implacable, till, delug'd by the foam,  
The ship sinks foundering in the vast abyss.

*John Philips.*

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## **AFTER HORACE**

What asks the Bard? He prays for nought  
But what the truly virtuous crave:  
That is, the things he plainly ought  
To have.

'Tis not for wealth, with all the shocks  
That vex distracted millionaires,  
Plagued by their fluctuating stocks

And shares:

While plutocrats their millions new  
Expend upon each costly whim,  
A great deal less than theirs will do  
For him:

The simple incomes of the poor  
His meek poetic soul content:  
Say, £30,000 at four  
Per cent.!

His taste in residence is plain:  
No palaces his heart rejoice:  
A cottage in a lane (Park Lane  
For choice)—

Here be his days in quiet spent:  
Here let him meditate the Muse:  
Baronial Halls were only meant  
For Jews,

And lands that stretch with endless span  
From east to west, from south to north,  
Are often much more trouble than  
They're worth!

Let epicures who eat too much  
Become uncomfortably stout:  
Let gourmets feel th' approaching touch  
Of gout,—

The Bard subsists on simpler food:  
A dinner, not severely plain,  
A pint or so of really good  
Champagne—

Grant him but these, no care he'll take  
Though Laureates bask in Fortune's smile,  
Though Kiplings and Corellis make  
Their pile:

Contented with a scantier dole  
His humble Muse serenely jogs,  
Remote from scenes where authors roll  
Their logs:

Far from the madding crowd she lurks,  
And really cares no single jot  
Whether the public read her works  
Or not!

*A. D. Godley.*

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## **OF A PRECISE TAILOR**

A tailor, a man of an upright dealing,  
True but for lying, honest but for stealing,  
Did fall one day extremely sick by chance,  
And on the sudden was in wondrous trance.  
The Fiends of hell, mustering in fearful manner,  
Of sundry-coloured silks displayed a banner,  
Which he had stol'n; and wished, as they did tell,  
That one day he might find it all in hell.  
The man, affrighted at this apparition,  
Upon recovery grew a great precisian.  
He bought a Bible of the new translation,  
And in his life he showed great reformation.  
He walkèd mannerly and talkèd meekly;  
He heard three lectures and two sermons weekly;



He vowed to shun all companies unruly,  
And in his speech he used no oath but "truly":  
And, zealously to keep the Sabbath's rest,  
His meat for that day on the even was dressed.  
And, lest the custom that he had to steal  
Might cause him sometime to forget his zeal,  
He gives his journeyman a special charge  
That, if the stuff allowed fell out too large,  
And that to filch his fingers were inclined,  
He then should put the Banner in his mind.  
This done, I scant the rest can tell for laughter.  
A Captain of a ship came three days after,  
And bought three yards of velvet and three quarters,  
To make Venetians down below the garters.  
He, that precisely knew what was enough,  
Soon slipped away three quarters of the stuff.  
His man, espying it, said in derision,  
"Remember, Master, how you saw the vision!"  
"Peace, knave," quoth he; "I did not see one rag  
Of such-a-coloured silk in all the flag."

*Sir John Harrington.*

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## **MONEY**

Who money has, well wages the campaign;  
Who money has, becomes of gentle strain;  
Who money has, to honor all accord:  
    He is my lord.  
Who money has, the ladies ne'er disdain;  
Who money has, loud praises will attain;  
Who money has, in the world's heart is stored,  
    The flower adored.

O'er all mankind he holds his conquering track—  
They only are condemned who money lack.

Who money has, will wisdom's credit gain;  
Who money has, all earth is his domain;  
Who money has, praise is his sure reward,  
Which all afford.  
Who money has, from nothing need refrain;  
Who money has, on him is favor poured;  
And, in a word,  
Who money has, need never fear attack—  
They only are condemned who money lack.

Who money has, in every heart does reign;  
Who money has, all to approach are fain;  
Who money has, of him no fault is told,  
Nor harm can hold.  
Who money has, none does his right restrain;  
Who money has, can whom he will maintain;  
Who money has, clerk, prior, by his gold,  
Is straight enrolled.  
Who money has, all raise, none hold him back—  
They only are condemned who money lack.

*Jehan du Pontalais.*

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## **BOSTON NURSERY RHYMES**

### **RHYME FOR A GEOLOGICAL BABY**

Trilobite, Graptolite, Nautilus pie;  
Seas were calcareous, oceans were dry.  
Eocene, miocene, pliocene Tuff,  
Lias and Trias and that is enough.

#### **RHYME FOR ASTRONOMICAL BABY**

Bye Baby Bunting,  
Father's gone star-hunting;  
Mother's at the telescope  
Casting baby's horoscope.  
Bye Baby Buntoid,  
Father's found an asteroid;  
Mother takes by calculation  
The angle of its inclination.

#### **RHYME FOR BOTANICAL BABY**

Little bo-peepals  
Has lost her sepals,  
And can't tell-where to find them;  
In the involucre  
By hook or by crook or  
She'll make up her mind not to mind them.

#### **RHYME FOR A CHEMICAL BABY**

Oh, sing a song of phosphates,  
Fibrine in a line,  
Four-and-twenty follicles  
In the van of time.

When the phosphorescence  
Evolved brain,  
Superstition ended,  
Men began to reign.

*Rev. Joseph Cook.*

---

#### **KENTUCKY PHILOSOPHY**

You Wi'yum, cum 'ere, suh, dis minute. Wut dat you got under dat box?  
I don't want no foolin'—you hear me? Wut you say? Ain't nu'h'n but *rocks*?  
'Peahs ter me you's owdashus perticler. S'posin' dey's uv a new kine.  
I'll des take a look at dem rocks. Hi yi! der you think dat I's bline?

*I* calls dat a plain water-million, you scamp, en I knows whah it growed;  
It come fum de Jimmerson cawn fiel', dah on ter side er de road.  
You stole it, you rascal—you stole it! I watched you fum down in de lot.  
En time I gits th'ough wid you, nigger, you won't eb'n be a grease spot!

*I'll* fix you. Mirandy! Mirandy! go cut me a hick'ry—make 'ase!  
En cut me de toughes' en keenes' you c'n fine anywhah on de place.  
I'll larn you, Mr. Wi'yum Joe Vettters, ter steal en ter lie, you young sinner,  
Disgracin' yo' ole Christian mammy, en makin' her leave cookin' dinner!

Now ain't you ashamed er yo'se'f, suh? I is. I's 'shamed you's my son!  
En de holy accorjun angel he's 'shamed er wut you has done;  
En he's tuk it down up yander in coal-black, blood-red letters—  
"One water-million stoled by Wi'yum Josephus Vettters."

En wut you s'posin' Brer Bascom, yo' teacher at Sunday school,  
'Ud say ef he knowed how you's broke de good Lawd's Gol'n Rule?  
Boy, whah's de raisin' I give you? Is you boun' fuh ter be a black villiun?  
I's s'prised dat a chile er yo' mammy 'ud steal any man's water-million.

En I's now gwiner cut it right open, en you shain't have narry bite,  
Fuh a boy who'll steal water-millions—en dat in de day's broad light—  
Ain't—*Lawdy!* it's GREEN! Mirandy; Mi-ran-dy! come on wi' dat switch!  
*Well*, stealin' a g-r-e-e-n water-million! who ever heered tell er des sich?

Cain't tell w'en dey's ripe? W'y, you thump 'um, en w'en dey go pank dey is  
green;  
But when dey go *punk*, now you mine me, dey's ripe—en dat's des wut I  
mean.  
En nex' time you hook water-millions—you heered me, you ign'ant young  
hunk,  
Ef you don't want a lickin' all over, be sho dat dey allers go "punk"!

---

**JOHN GRUMLIE**

John Grumlie swore by the light o' the moon  
And the green leaves on the tree,  
That he could do more work in a day  
Than his wife could do in three.  
His wife rose up in the morning  
Wi' cares and troubles enow—  
John Grumlie bide at hame, John,  
And I'll go haud the plow.

First ye maun dress your children fair,  
And put them a' in their gear;  
And ye maun turn the malt, John,  
Or else ye'll spoil the beer;  
And ye maun reel the tweel, John,  
That I span yesterday;  
And ye maun ca' in the hens, John,  
Else they'll all lay away.

O he did dress his children fair,  
And put them a' in their gear;  
But he forgot to turn the malt,  
And so he spoil'd the beer:  
And he sang loud as he reeled the tweel  
That his wife span yesterday;  
But he forgot to put up the hens,  
And the hens all layed away.

The hawket crummie loot down nae milk;  
He kirned, nor butter gat;

And a' gade wrang, and nought gade right;  
He danced with rage, and grat;  
Then up he ran to the head o' the knowe  
Wi' mony a wave and shout—  
She heard him as she heard him not,  
And steered the stots about.

John Grumlie's wife cam hame at e'en,  
A weary wife and sad,  
And burst into a laughter loud,  
And laughed as she'd been mad:  
While John Grumlie swore by the light o' the moon  
And the green leaves on the tree,  
If my wife should na win a penny a day  
She's aye have her will for me.

*Allan Cunningham.*

---

## **A SONG OF IMPOSSIBILITIES**

Lady, I loved you all last year,  
How honestly and well—  
Alas! would weary you to hear,  
And torture me to tell;  
I raved beneath the midnight sky,  
I sang beneath the limes—  
Orlando in my lunacy,  
And Petrarch in my rhymes.  
But all is over! When the sun  
Dries up the boundless main,  
When black is white, false-hearted one,  
I may be yours again!

When passion's early hopes and fears  
Are not derided things;  
When truth is found in falling tears,  
Or faith in golden rings;  
When the dark Fates that rule our way  
Instruct me where they hide  
One woman that would ne'er betray,  
One friend that never lied;  
When summer shines without a cloud,  
And bliss without a pain;  
When worth is noticed in a crowd,  
I may be yours again!

When science pours the light of day  
Upon the lords of lands;  
When Huskisson is heard to say  
That Lethbridge understands;  
When wrinkles work their way in youth,  
Or Eldon's in a hurry;  
When lawyers represent the truth,  
Or Mr. Sumner Surrey;  
When aldermen taste eloquence  
Or bricklayers champagne;  
When common law is common sense,  
I may be yours again!

When learned judges play the beau,  
Or learned pigs the tabor;  
When traveller Bankes beats Cicero,  
Or Mr. Bishop Weber;  
When sinking funds discharge a debt,  
Or female hands a bomb;  
When bankrupts study the *Gazette*,  
Or colleges *Tom Thumb*;  
When little fishes learn to speak,  
Or poets not to feign;  
When Dr. Geldart construes Greek,

I may be yours again!

When Pole and Thornton honour cheques,  
Or Mr. Const a rogue;  
When Jericho's in Middlesex,  
Or minuets in vogue;  
When Highgate goes to Devonport,  
Or fashion to Guildhall;  
When argument is heard at Court,  
Or Mr. Wynn at all;  
When Sydney Smith forgets to jest,  
Or farmers to complain;  
When kings that are are not the best,  
I may be yours again!

When peers from telling money shrink,  
Or monks from telling lies;  
When hydrogen begins to sink,  
Or Grecian scrip to rise;  
When German poets cease to dream,  
Americans to guess;  
When Freedom sheds her holy beam  
On Negroes, and the Press;  
When there is any fear of Rome,  
Or any hope of Spain;  
When Ireland is a happy home,  
I may be yours again!

When you can cancel what has been,  
Or alter what must be,  
Or bring once more that vanished scene,  
Those withered joys to me;  
When you can tune the broken lute,  
Or deck the blighted wreath,  
Or rear the garden's richest fruit,  
Upon a blasted heath;  
When you can lure the wolf at bay



Back to his shattered chain,  
To-day may then be yesterday—  
I may be yours again!

*Winthrop Mackworth Praed.*

---

## SONG

Go and catch a falling star,  
Get with child a mandrake root;  
Tell me where all past years are,  
Or who cleft the Devil's foot;  
Teach me to hear Mermaids singing,—  
Or to keep off envy's stinging,  
And find  
What wind  
Serves to advance an honest mind.

If thou beest born to strange sights,  
Things invisible to see,  
Ride ten thousand days and nights,  
Till age snow white hairs on thee;  
Thou, when thou return'st, wilt tell me  
All strange wonders that befell thee,  
And swear  
Nowhere  
Lives a woman true and fair.

If thou find'st one, let me know;  
Such a pilgrimage were sweet.  
Yet do not; I would not go,  
Though at next door we might meet.  
Though she were true when you met her,

And last till you write your letter,  
Yet she  
Will be  
False, ere I come, to two or three.

*John Donne.*

---

## THE OUBIT

It was an hairy oubit, sae proud he crept alang;  
A feckless hairy oubit, and merrily he sang:  
"My Minnie bade me bide at home until I won my wings,  
I shew her soon my soul's aboon the warks o' creeping things."

This feckless hairy oubit cam' hirpling by the linn,  
A swirl o' wind cam' doun the glen, and blew that oubit in.  
Oh, when he took the water, the saumon fry they rose,  
And tigg'd him a' to pieces sma', by head and tail and toes.

Tak' warning then, young poets a', by this poor oubit's shame;  
Though Pegasus may nicher loud, keep Pegasus at hame.  
O haud your hands frae inkhorns, though a' the Muses woo;  
For critics lie, like saumon fry, to mak' their meals o' you.

*Charles Kingsley.*

---

## DOUBLE BALLADE OF PRIMITIVE MAN

He lived in a cave by the seas,  
He lived upon oysters and foes,  
But his list of forbidden degrees  
An extensive morality shows;  
Geological evidence goes  
To prove he had never a pan,  
But he shaved with a shell when he chose,—  
'Twas the manner of Primitive Man.

He worshipp'd the rain and the breeze,  
He worshipp'd the river that flows,  
And the Dawn, and the Moon, and the trees  
And bogies, and serpents, and crows;  
He buried his dead with their toes  
Tucked-up, an original plan,  
Till their knees came right under their nose,—  
'Twas the manner of Primitive Man.

His communal wives, at his ease,  
He would curb with occasional blows  
Or his State had a queen, like the bees  
(As another philosopher trows):  
When he spoke, it was never in prose,  
But he sang in a strain that would scan,  
For (to doubt it, perchance, were morose)  
'Twas the manner of Primitive Man!

On the coasts that incessantly freeze,  
With his stones, and his bones, and his bows,  
On luxuriant tropical leas,  
Where the summer eternally glows,  
He is found, and his habits disclose  
(Let theology say what she can)  
That he lived in the long, long agos,  
'Twas the manner of Primitive Man!

From a status like that of the Crees  
Our society's fabric arose,—  
Develop'd, evolved, if you please,  
But deluded chronologists chose,  
In a fancied accordance with Mos  
es, 4000 B.C. for the span  
When he rushed on the world and its woes,—  
'Twas the manner of Primitive Man.

But the mild anthropologist—*he's*  
Not *recent* inclined to suppose  
Flints Palæolithic like these,  
Quaternary bones such as those!  
In Rhinoceros, Mammoth and Co.'s  
First epoch the Human began  
Theologians all to expose,—  
'Tis the *mission* of Primitive Man.

#### ENVOY

Max, proudly your Aryans pose,  
But their rigs they undoubtedly ran,  
For, as every Darwinian knows,  
'Twas the manner of Primitive Man!

*Andrew Lang.*

---

### PHILLIS'S AGE

How old may Phillis be, you ask,  
Whose beauty thus all hearts engages?  
To answer is no easy task:  
For she has really two ages.

Stiff in brocade, and pinch'd in stays,  
Her patches, paint, and jewels on;  
All day let envy view her face,  
And Phillis is but twenty-one.

Paint, patches, jewels laid aside,  
At night astronomers agree,  
The evening has the day belied;  
And Phillis is some forty-three.

*Matthew Prior.*

---

**v**

# CYNICISM

## GOOD AND BAD LUCK

Good Luck is the gayest of all gay girls;  
Long in one place she will not stay:  
Back from your brow she strokes the curls,  
Kisses you quick and flies away.

But Madame Bad Luck soberly comes  
And stays—no fancy has she for flitting;  
Snatches of true-love songs she hums,  
And sits by your bed, and brings her knitting.

*John Hay.*

---

## BANGKOLIDYE

"Gimme my scarlet tie,"  
Says I.

"Gimme my brownest boots and hat,  
Gimme a vest with a pattern fancy,  
Gimme a gel with some style, like Nancy,  
And then—well, it's gimes as I'll be at,  
Seein' as its bangkolidye,"

Says I.

"May miss it, but we'll try,"

Says I.

Nancy ran like a frightened 'en  
Hup the steps of the bloomin' styeshun.  
Bookin'-orfus at last! Salvyeshun!  
An' the two returns was five-and-ten.  
"An' travellin' mikes your money fly,"

Says I.

"This atmosphere is 'igh,"

Says I.

Twelve in a carriage is pretty thick,  
When 'ite of the twelve is a sittin', smokin';  
Nancy started 'er lawkin, and jokin',  
Syin' she 'oped as we shouldn't be sick;  
"Don't go on, or you'll mike me die!"

Says I.

"Three styeshuns we've porst by,"

Says I.

"So hout we get at the next, my gel."  
When we got hout, she wer pale and saint-like,  
White in the gills, and sorter faint-like,  
An' said my cigaw 'ad a powerful smell,  
"Well, it's the sime as I always buy,"

Says I.

"'Ites them clouds in the sky,"

Says I.

"Don't like 'em at all," I says, "that's flat—  
Black as your boots and sorter thick'nin'.  
"If it's wet," says she, "it *will* be sick'nin'.  
I wish as I'd brought my other 'at."  
"You thinks too much of your finery,"

Says I.

"Keep them sanwidjus dry,"



Says I.  
When the rine came down in a reggiler sheet.  
But what can yo do with one umbrella,  
And a damp gel strung on the arm of a fella?  
"Well, rined-on 'am ain't pleasant to eat,  
If yer don't believe it, just go an try,"  
Says I.

"There is some gels whort cry,"  
Says I.  
"And there is some don't shed a tear,  
But just get tempers, and when they has'em  
Reaches a pint in their sarcasem,  
As on'y a dorg could bear to 'ear."  
This unto Nancy by-and-by,  
Says I.

All's hover now. And why,  
Says I.  
But why did I wear them boots, that vest?  
The bloom is off 'em; they're sad to see;  
And hev'rythin's off twixt Nancy and me;  
And my trousers is off and gone to be pressed—  
And ain't this a blimed bangkolidye?  
Says I.  
*Barry Pain.*

---

## PENSÉES DE NOËL

When the landlord wants the rent  
Of your humble tenement;  
When the Christmas bills begin

Daily, hourly pouring in;  
When you pay your gas and poor rate  
Tip the rector, fee the curate,  
Let this thought your spirit cheer—  
Christmas comes but once a year.

When the man who brings the coal  
Claims his customary dole:  
When the postman rings and knocks  
For his usual Christmas-box:  
When you're dunned by half the town  
With demands for half-a-crown,—  
Think, although they cost you dear,  
Christmas comes but once a year.

When you roam from shop to shop,  
Seeking, till you nearly drop,  
Christmas cards and small donations  
For the maw of your relations,  
Questing vainly 'mid the heap  
For a thing that's nice, and cheap:  
Think, and check the rising tear,  
Christmas comes but once a year.

Though for three successive days  
Business quits her usual ways;  
Though the milkman's voice be dumb;  
Though the paper doesn't come;  
Though you want tobacco, but  
Find that all the shops are shut:  
Bravely still your sorrows bear—  
Christmas comes but once a year.

When mince-pies you can't digest  
Join with waits to break your rest:  
When, oh when, to crown your woe,  
Persons who might better know

Think it needful that you should  
Don a gay convivial mood:—  
Bear with fortitude and patience  
These afflicting dispensations:  
Man was born to suffer here:  
Christmas comes but once a year.

*A. D. Godley.*

---

## **A BALLADE OF AN ANTI-PURITAN**

They spoke of Progress spiring round,  
Of Light and Mrs. Humphry Ward—  
It is not true to say I frowned,  
Or ran about the room and roared;  
I might have simply sat and snored—  
I rose politely in the club  
And said, "I feel a little bored;  
Will someone take me to a pub?"

The new world's wisest did surround  
Me; and it pains me to record  
I did not think their views profound,  
Or their conclusions well assured;  
The simple life I can't afford,  
Besides, I do not like the grub—  
I want a mash and sausage, "scored"—  
Will someone take me to a pub?

I know where Men can still be found,  
Anger and clamorous accord,  
And virtues growing from the ground,  
And fellowship of beer and board,

And song, that is a sturdy cord,  
And hope, that is a hardy shrub,  
And goodness, that is God's last word—  
Will someone take me to a pub?

ENVOI

Prince, Bayard would have smashed his sword  
To see the sort of knights you dub—  
Is that the last of them—O Lord!  
Will someone take me to a pub?

*G. K. Chesterton.*

---

**PESSIMISM**

In the age that was golden, the halcyon time,  
All the billows were balmy and breezes were bland.  
Then the poet was never hard up for a rhyme,  
Then the milk and the honey flew free and were prime,  
And the voice of the turtle was heard in the land.

In the times that are guilty the winds are perverse,  
Blowing fair for the sharper and foul for the dupe.  
Now the poet's condition could scarcely be worse,  
Now the milk and the honey are strained through the purse,  
And the voice of the turtle is dead in the soup.

*Newton Mackintosh.*

---

**CYNICAL ODE TO AN ULTRA-CYNICAL PUBLIC**

You prefer a buffoon to a scholar,  
A harlequin to a teacher,  
A jester to a statesman,  
An Anonyma flaring on horseback  
To a modest and spotless woman—  
Brute of a public!

You think that to sneer shows wisdom,  
That a gibe outvalues a reason,  
That slang, such as thieves delight in,  
Is fit for the lips of the gentle,  
And rather a grace than a blemish,  
Thick-headed public!

You think that if merit's exalted  
'Tis excellent sport to decry it,  
And trail its good name in the gutter;  
And that cynics, white-gloved and cravatted,  
Are the cream and quintessence of all things,  
Ass of a public!

You think that success must be merit,  
That honour and virtue and courage  
Are all very well in their places,  
But that money's a thousand times better;  
Detestable, stupid, degraded  
Pig of a public!

*Charles Mackay.*

---

## YOUTH AND ART

It once might have been, once only:  
We lodged in a street together.  
You, a sparrow on the house-top lonely,  
I, a lone she-bird of his feather.

Your trade was with sticks and clay,  
You thumbed, thrust, patted and polished,  
Then laughed, "They will see some day  
Smith made, and Gibson demolished."

My business was song, song, song;  
I chirped, cheeped, trilled and twittered,  
"Kate Brown's on the boards ere long,  
And Grisi's existence embittered!"

I earned no more by a warble  
Than you by a sketch in plaster;  
You wanted a piece of marble,  
I needed a music-master.

We studied hard in our styles,  
Chipped each at a crust like Hindoos,  
For air, looked out on the tiles,  
For fun watched each other's windows.

You lounged, like a boy of the South,  
Cap and blouse—nay, a bit of beard too;  
Or you got it rubbing your mouth  
With fingers the clay adhered to.

And I—soon managed to find  
Weak points in the flower-fence facing,  
Was forced to put up a blind  
And be safe in my corset-lacing.

No harm! It was not my fault

If you never turned your eyes' tail up,  
As I shook upon E *in alt.*,  
Or ran the chromatic scale up:

For spring bade the sparrows pair,  
And the boys and girls gave guesses,  
And stalls in our streets looked rare  
With bulrush and watercresses.

Why did not you pinch a flower  
In a pellet of clay and fling it?  
Why did I not put a power  
Of thanks in a look, or sing it?

I did look, sharp as a lynx,  
(And yet the memory rankles,)  
When models arrived, some minx  
Tripped up-stairs, she and her ankles.

But I think I gave you as good!  
"That foreign fellow—who can know  
How she pays, in a playful mood,  
For his tuning her that piano?"

Could you say so, and never say,  
"Suppose we join hands and fortunes,  
And I fetch her from over the way,  
Her, piano, and long tunes and short tunes?"

No, no; you would not be rash,  
Nor I rasher and something over:  
You've to settle yet Gibson's hash,  
And Grisi yet lives in clover.

But you meet the Prince at the Board,  
I'm queen myself at *bals-paré*,  
I've married a rich old lord,

And you're dubbed knight and an R. A.

Each life's unfulfilled, you see;  
It hangs still, patchy and scrappy:  
We have not sighed deep, laughed free,  
Starved, feasted, despaired—been happy.

And nobody calls you a dunce,  
And people suppose me clever:  
This could but have happened once,  
And we missed it, lost it forever.

*Robert Browning.*

---

## **THE BACHELOR'S DREAM**

My pipe is lit, my grog is mixed,  
My curtains drawn and all is snug;  
Old Puss is in her elbow-chair,  
And Tray is sitting on the rug.  
Last night I had a curious dream,  
Miss Susan Bates was Mistress Mogg—  
What d'ye think of that, my cat?  
What d'ye think of that, my dog?

She looked so fair, she sang so well,  
I could but woo and she was won;  
Myself in blue, the bride in white,  
The ring was placed, the deed was done!  
Away we went in chaise-and-four.  
As fast as grinning boys could flog—  
What d'ye think of that, my cat?  
What d'ye think of that, my dog?



At times we had a spar, and then  
Mamma must mingle in the song—  
The sister took a sister's part—  
The maid declared her master wrong—  
The parrot learned to call me "Fool!"  
My life was like a London fog—  
What d'ye think of that, my cat?  
What d'ye think of that, my dog?

My Susan's taste was superfine,  
As proved by bills that had no end;  
*I* never had a decent coat—  
*I* never had a coin to spend!  
She forced me to resign my club,  
Lay down my pipe, retrench my grog—  
What d'ye think of that, my cat?  
What d'ye think of that, my dog?

Each Sunday night we gave a rout  
To fops and flirts, a pretty list;  
And when I tried to steal away,  
I found my study full of whist!  
Then, first to come, and last to go,  
There always was a Captain Hogg—  
What d'ye think of that, my cat?  
What d'ye think of that, my dog?

Now was not that an awful dream  
For one who single is and snug—  
With Pussy in the elbow chair,  
And Tray reposing on the rug?—  
If I must totter down the hill,  
'Tis safest done without a clog—  
What d'ye think of that, my cat?  
What d'ye think of that, my dog?

*Thomas Hood.*

---

## **ALL THINGS EXCEPT MYSELF I KNOW**

I know when milk does flies contain;  
I know men by their bravery;  
I know fair days from storm and rain;  
And what fruit apple-trees supply;  
And from their gums the trees descry;  
I know when all things smoothly flow;  
I know who toil or idle lie;  
All things except myself I know.

I know the doublet by the grain;  
The monk beneath the hood can spy;  
Master from man can ascertain;  
I know the nun's veiled modesty;  
I know when sportsmen fables ply;  
Know fools who creams and dainties stow;  
Wine from the butt I certify;  
All things except myself I know.

Know horse from mule by tail and mane;  
I know their worth or high or low;  
Bell, Beatrice, I know the twain;  
I know each chance of cards and dice;  
I know what visions prophesy,  
Bohemian heresies, I trow;  
I know men of each quality;  
All things except myself I know.

**ENVOY**

Prince, I know all things 'neath the sky,  
Pale cheeks from those of rosy glow;  
I know death whence can no man fly;  
All things except myself I know.

*François Villon.*

---

## **THE JOYS OF MARRIAGE**

How uneasy is his life,  
Who is troubled with a wife!  
Be she ne'er so fair or comely,  
Be she ne'er so foul or homely,  
Be she ne'er so young and toward,  
Be she ne'er so old and froward,  
Be she kind, with arms enfolding,  
Be she cross, and always scolding,  
Be she blithe or melancholy,  
Have she wit, or have she folly,  
Be she wary, be she squandering,  
Be she staid, or be she wandering,  
Be she constant, be she fickle,  
Be she fire, or be she ickle;  
Be she pious or ungodly,  
Be she chaste, or what sounds oddly:  
Lastly, be she good or evil,  
Be she saint, or be she devil,—  
Yet, uneasy is his life  
Who is married to a wife.

*Charles Cotton.*

---

## THE THIRD PROPOSITION

If I were thine, I'd fail not of endeavour  
    The loftiest,  
To make thy daily life, now and forever,  
    Supremely blest—  
I'd watch thy moods, I'd toil and wait, with yearning,  
Incessant incense at thy dear shrine burning,  
    If I were thine.

If thou wert mine, quite changed would be these features.  
    Then, I suspect,  
Thou wouldst the humblest prove of loving creatures,  
    And not object  
To do the very things I am declaring  
I'd undertake for *thee*, with selfless daring,  
    If thou wert mine.

If we were ours? And now, here comes the riddle!  
    How would that work?  
I'm sure *you'd* never stoop to second fiddle,  
    And—I might shirk  
The part of serf. And, likewise, each might neither  
Be willing slave or servitor of either,  
    If we were ours!

*Madeline Bridges.*

---

## THE BALLAD OF CASSANDRA BROWN

Though I met her in the summer, when one's heart lies round at ease,  
As it were in tennis costume, and a man's not hard to please,  
Yet I think that any season to have met her was to love,

While her tones, unspoiled, unstudied, had the softness of the dove.

At request she read us poems in a nook among the pines,  
And her artless voice lent music to the least melodious lines;  
Though she lowered her shadowing lashes, in an earnest reader's wise,  
Yet we caught blue, gracious glimpses of the heavens which were her eyes.

As in paradise I listened—ah, I did not understand  
That a little cloud, no larger than the average human hand,  
Might, as stated oft in fiction, spread into a sable pall,  
When she said that she should study Elocution in the fall!

I admit her earliest efforts were not in the Ercles vein;  
She began with "Little Maaybel, with her faayce against the payne  
And the beacon-light a-t-r-r-remble"—which, although it made me wince,  
Is a thing of cheerful nature to the things she's rendered since.

Having heard the Soulfu! Quiver, she acquired the Melting Mo-o-an,  
And the way she gave "Young Grayhead" would have liquefied a stone.  
Then the Sanguinary Tragic did her energies employ,  
And she tore my taste to tatters when she slew "The Polish Boy."

It's not pleasant for a fellow when the jewel of his soul  
Wades through slaughter on the carpet, while her orbs in frenzy roll;  
What was I that I should murmur? Yet it gave me grievous pain  
That she rose in social gatherings, and Searched among the Slain.

I was forced to look upon her in my desperation dumb,  
Knowing well that when her awful opportunity was come  
She would give us battle, murder, sudden death at very least,  
As a skeleton of warning, and a blight upon the feast.

Once, ah! once I fell a-dreaming; some one played a polonaise  
I associated strongly with those happier August days;  
And I mused, "I'll speak this evening," recent pangs forgotten quite—  
Sudden shrilled a scream of anguish: "Curfew shall not ring to-night!"

Ah, that sound was as a curfew, quenching rosy, warm romance—

Were it safe to wed a woman one so oft would wish in France?  
Oh, as she "cul-limbed" that ladder, swift my mounting hope came down,  
I am still a single cynic; she is still Cassandra Brown!

*Helen Gray Cone.*

---

## WHAT'S IN A NAME?

In letters large upon the frame,  
That visitors might see,  
The painter placed his humble name:  
*O'Callaghan McGee.*

And from Beersheba unto Dan,  
The critics with a nod  
Exclaimed: "This painting Irishman  
Adores his native sod.

"His stout heart's patriotic flame  
There's naught on earth can quell;  
He takes no wild romantic name  
To make his pictures sell!"

Then poets praise in sonnets neat  
His stroke so bold and free;  
No parlour wall was thought complete  
That hadn't a McGee.

All patriots before McGee  
Threw lavishly their gold;  
His works in the Academy  
Were very quickly sold.

His "Digging Clams at Barnegat,"  
His "When the Morning smiled,"  
His "Seven Miles from Ararat,"  
His "Portrait of a Child,"

Were purchased in a single day  
And lauded as divine.—

---

That night as in his *atelier*  
The artist sipped his wine,

And looked upon his gilded frames,  
He grinned from ear to ear:—  
"They little think my *real* name's  
V. Stuyvesant De Vere!"

*R. K. Munkittrick.*

---

## TOO LATE

*"Ah! si la jeunesse savait,—si la vieillesse pouvait!"*

There sat an old man on a rock,  
And unceasing bewailed him of Fate,—  
That concern where we all must take stock,  
Though our vote has no hearing or weight;  
And the old man sang him an old, old song,—  
Never sang voice so clear and strong  
That it could drown the old man's for long,  
For he sang the song "Too late! too late!"

When we want, we have for our pains  
The promise that if we but wait

Till the want has burned out of our brains,  
Every means shall be present to state;  
While we send for the napkin the soup gets cold,  
While the bonnet is trimming the face grows old,  
When we've matched our buttons the pattern is sold  
And everything comes too late,—too late!

"When strawberries seemed like red heavens,—  
Terrapin stew a wild dream,—  
When my brain was at sixes and sevens,  
If my mother had 'folks' and ice cream,  
Then I gazed with a lickerish hunger  
At the restaurant man and fruit-monger,—  
But oh! how I wished I were younger  
When the goodies all came in a stream! in a stream!

"I've a splendid blood horse, and—a liver  
That it jars into torture to trot;  
My row-boat's the gem of the river,—  
Gout makes every knuckle a knot!  
I can buy boundless credits on Paris and Rome,  
But no palate for *ménus*,—no eyes for a dome,—  
*Those* belonged to the youth who must tarry at home,  
When no home but an attic he'd got,—he'd got!

"How I longed, in that lonest of garrets,  
Where the tiles baked my brains all July,  
For ground to grow two pecks of carrots,  
Two pigs of my own in a sty,  
A rosebush,—a little thatched cottage,—  
Two spoons—love—a basin of pottage!—  
Now in freestone I sit,—and my dotage,—  
With a woman's chair empty close by, close by!

"Ah! now, though I sit on a rock,  
I have shared one seat with the great;  
I have sat—knowing naught of the clock—



On love's high throne of state;  
But the lips that kissed, and the arms that caressed,  
To a mouth grown stern with delay were pressed,  
And circled a breast that their clasp had blessed,  
Had they only not come too late,—too late!"

*Fitz Hugh Ludlow.*

---

## THE ANNUITY

I gaed to spend a week in Fife—  
An unco week it proved to be—  
For there I met a waesome wife  
Lamentin' her viduity.  
Her grief brak out sae fierce and fell,  
I thought her heart wad burst the shell;  
And,—I was sae left to mysel',—  
I sell't her an annuity.

The bargain lookit fair eneugh—  
She just was turned o' saxty-three—  
I couldna guessed she'd prove sae teugh,  
By human ingenuity.  
But years have come, and years have gane,  
And there she's yet as stieve as stane—  
The limmer's growin' young again,  
Since she got her annuity.

She's crined' awa' to bane and skin,  
But that, it seems, is nought to me;  
She's like to live—although she's in  
The last stage o' tenuity.  
She munches wi' her wizen'd gums,

An' stumps about on legs o' thrums;  
But comes, as sure as Christmas comes,  
To ca' for her annuity.

I read the tables drawn wi' care  
For an insurance company;  
Her chance o' life was stated there,  
Wi' perfect perspicuity.  
But tables here or tables there,  
She's lived ten years beyond her share,  
An' 's like to live a dozen mair,  
To ca' for her annuity.

Last Yule she had a fearfu' host,  
I thought a kink might set me free—  
I led her out, 'mang snaw and frost,  
Wi' constant assiduity.  
But deil ma' care—the blast gaed by,  
And miss'd the auld anatomy—  
It just cost me a tooth, for bye  
Discharging her annuity.

If there's a' sough o' cholera,  
Or typhus,—wha sae gleg as she?  
She buys up baths, an' drugs, an' a',  
In siccan superfluity!  
She doesna need—she's fever proof—  
The pest walked o'er her very roof—  
She tauld me sae—an' then her loof  
Held out for her annuity.

Ae day she fell, her arm she brak—  
A compound fracture as could be—  
Nae leech the cure wad undertake,  
Whate'er was the gratuity.  
It's cured! She handles 't like a flail—  
It does as weel in bits as hale—

But I'm a broken man mysel'  
Wi' her and her annuity.

Her broozled flesh and broken banes  
Are weel as flesh and banes can be.  
She beats the taeds that live in stanes,  
An' fatten in vacuity!  
They die when they're exposed to air—  
They canna thole the atmosphere;  
But her!—expose her onywhere—  
She lives for her annuity.

If mortal means could nick her thread,  
Sma' crime it wad appear to me;  
Ca't murder, or ca't homicide,  
I'd justify 't—an' do it tae.  
But how to fell a withered wife  
That's carved out o' the tree o' life—  
The timmer limmer daurs the knife  
To settle her annuity.

I'd try a shot: but whar's the mark?—  
Her vital parts are hid frae me;  
Her backbane wanders through her sark  
In an unkenn'd corkscrewity.  
She's palsified—an shakes her head  
Sae fast about, ye scarce can see;  
It's past the power o' steel or lead  
To settle her annuity.

She might be drowned—but go she'll not  
Within a mile o' loch or sea;  
Or hanged—if cord could grip a throat  
O' siccan exiguity.  
It's fitter far to hang the rope—  
It draws out like a telescope;  
'Twad tak a dreadfu' length o' drop

To settle her annuity.

Will puzion do't?—It has been tried;  
But, be't in hash or fricassee,  
That's just the dish she can't abide,  
Whatever kind o' gout it hae.  
It's needless to assail her doubts,  
She gangs by instinct, like the brutes,  
An' only eats an' drinks what suits  
Hersel' and her annuity.

The Bible says the age o' man  
Threescore and ten, perchance, may be;  
She's ninety-four. Let them who can,  
Explain the incongruity.  
She should hae lived afore the flood—  
She's come o' patriarchal blood,  
She's some auld Pagan mummified  
Alive for her annuity.

She's been embalmed inside and oot—  
She's sauted to the last degree—  
There's pickle in her very snoot  
Sae caper-like an' cruelty.  
Lot's wife was fresh compared to her—  
They've kyanized the useless knir,  
She canna decompose—nae mair  
Than her accursed annuity.

The water-drop wears out the rock,  
As this eternal jaud wears me;  
I could withstand the single shock,  
But not the continuity.  
It's pay me here, an' pay me there,  
An' pay me, pay me, evermair—  
I'll gang demented wi' despair—  
I'm charged for her annuity.

*George Outram.*

---

## **K. K.—CAN'T CALCULATE**

What poor short-sighted worms we be;  
For we can't calculate,  
With any sort of sartintee,  
What is to be our fate.

These words Prissilla's heart did reach,  
And caused her tears to flow,  
When first she heard the Elder preach,  
About six months ago.

How true it is what he did state,  
And thus affected her,  
That nobody can't calculate  
What is a-gwine to occur.

When we retire, can't calculate  
But what afore the morn  
Our housen will conflaggerate,  
And we be left forlorn.

Can't calculate when we come in  
From any neighborin' place,  
Whether we'll ever go out agin  
To look on natur's face.

Can't calculate upon the weather,  
It always changes so;  
Hain't got no means of telling whether  
It's gwine to rain or snow.

Can't calculate with no precision  
On naught beneath the sky;  
And so I've come to the decision  
That't ain't worth while to try.

*Frances M. Whitcher.*

---

## NORTHERN FARMER

### NEW STYLE

Dosn't thou 'ear my 'erse's legs, as they canters awaäy?  
Proputty, proputty, proputty—that's what I 'ears 'em saäy.  
Proputty, proputty, proputty—Sam, thou's an ass for thy paaïns:  
Theer's moor sense i' one o' 'is legs nor in all thy braaïns.

Woä—theer's a crow to pluck wi' tha, Sam: yon's parson's 'ouse—  
Dosn't thou knaw that a man mun be eäther a man or a mouse?  
Time to think on it, then; for thou'll be twenty to weeäk.  
Proputty, proputty—woä then, woä—let ma 'ear mysén speäk.

Me an' thy muther, Sammy, 'as beän a-talkin' o' thee;  
Thou's been talkin' to muther, an' she beän a-tellin' it me.  
Thou'll not marry for munny—thou's sweet upo' parson's lass—  
Noä—thou'll marry for luvv—an' we boäth of us thinks tha an ass.

Seeä'd her to-daäy goä by—Saäint's-daäy—they was ringing the bells.  
She's a beauty, thou thinks—an' soä is scoors o' gells.  
Them as 'as munny an' all—wot's a beauty?—the flower as blaws.  
But proputty, proputty sticks, an' proputty, proputty graws.

Do'ant be stunt: taäke time: I knaws what maäkes tha sa mad.

Warn't I craäzed fur the lasses mysén when I wur a lad?  
But I knaw'd a Quaäker feller as often 'as tow'd ma this:  
"Do'ant thou marry for munny, but goä wheer munny is!"

An' I went wheer munny war: an' thy mother coom to 'and,  
Wi' lots o' munny laaïd by, an' a nicetish hit o' land.  
Maäybe she warn't a beauty: I niver giv it a thowt—  
But warn't she as good to cuddle an' kiss as a lass as 'ant nowt?

Parson's lass 'ant nowt, an' she weänt 'a nowt when 'e's deäd,  
Mun be a guvness, lad, or summut, and addle her breäd:  
Why? fur 'e's nobbut a curate, an' weänt niver git naw 'igher;  
An' 'e's maäde the bed as 'e ligs on afoor 'e coom'd to the shire.

An' thin 'e coom'd to the parish wi' lots o' 'Varsity debt,  
Stook to his taäil they did, an' 'e 'ant got shut on 'em yet.  
An' 'e ligs on 'is back i' the grip, wi' noän to lend 'im a shove,  
Woorse nor a far-welter'd yowe: fur, Sammy, 'e married fur luvv.

Luvv? what's luvv? thou can luvv thy lass an' 'er munny too,  
Maäkin' 'em goä togither, as they've good right to do.  
Couldn't I luvv thy muther by cause o' 'er munny laaïd by?  
Naäy—for I luvv'd her a vast sight moor fur it: reäson why.

Ay, an' thy muther says thou wants to marry the lass,  
Cooms of a gentleman burn; an' we boäth on us thinks tha an ass.  
Woä then, propuppy, wiltha?—an ass as near as mays nowt—  
Woä then, wiltha? dangtha!—the bees is as fell as owt.

Breäk me a bit o' the esh for his 'eäd, lad, out o' the fence!  
Gentleman burn! What's gentleman burn? Is it shillins an' pence?  
Propuppy, propuppy's ivrything 'ere, an', Sammy, I'm blest  
If it isn't the saäme oop yonder, fur them as 'as it's the best.

'Tisn' them as 'as munny as breäks into 'ouses an' steäls,  
Them as 'as coöts to their backs an' taäkes their regular meäls.  
Noä, but it's them as niver knaws wheer a meäl's to be 'ad.

Taäke my word for it, Sammy, the poor in a loomp is bad.

Them or thir feythurs, tha sees, mun 'a beän a laäzy lot.  
Fur work mun 'a gone to the gittin' whiniver munny was got.  
Feyther 'ad ammost nowt; leästways 'is munny was 'id.  
But 's tued an' moil'd 'issén deäd, an' 'e died a good un, 'e did.

Looök thou theer wheer Wigglesby beck cooms out by the 'ill!  
Feyther run oop to the farm, an' I runs oop to the mill;  
An' I'll run oop to the brig, an' that thou'll live to see;  
And if thou marries a good un I'll leäve the land to thee.

Thim's my noätions, Sammy, wheerby I meäns to stick;  
But if 'thou marries a bad un, I'll leäve the land to Dick.—  
Coom oop, propuppy, propuppy—that's what I 'ears 'im saäy—  
Propuppy, propuppy, propuppy—canter an' canter awaäy.

*Lord Tennyson.*

---

## FIN DE SIÈCLE

Life is a gift that most of us hold dear:  
I never asked the spiteful gods to grant it;  
Held it a bore—in short; and now it's here,  
I do not want it.

Thrust into life, I eat, smoke, drink, and sleep,  
My mind's a blank I seldom care to question;  
The only faculty I active keep  
Is my digestion.

Like oyster on his rock, I sit and jest  
At others' dreams of love or fame or pelf,



Discovering but a languid interest  
Even in myself.

An oyster: ah! beneath the quiet sea  
To know no care, no change, no joy, no pain,  
The warm salt water gurgling into me  
And out again.

While some in life's old roadside inns at ease  
Sit careless, all unthinking of the score  
Mine host chalks up in swift unseen increase  
Behind the door;

Bound like Ixion on life's torture-wheel,  
I whirl inert in pitiless gyration,  
Loathing it all; the one desire I feel,  
Annihilation!

*Unknown.*

---

## **THEN AG'IN**

Jim Bowker, he said, ef he'd had a fair show,  
And a big enough town for his talents to grow,  
And the least bit assistance in hoein' his row,  
Jim Bowker, he said,  
He'd filled the world full of the sound of his name,  
An' clim the top round in the ladder of fame.  
It may have been so;  
I dunno;  
Jest so, it might been,  
Then ag'in—

But he had tarnal luck—eyerythin' went ag'in him,  
The arrers of fortune they allus' 'ud pin him;  
So he didn't get no chance to show off what was in him.

Jim Bowker, he said,  
Ef he'd had a fair show, you couldn't tell where he'd come,  
An' the feats he'd a-done, an' the heights he'd a-clum—  
It may have been so;  
I dunno;  
Jest so, it might been,  
Then ag'in—

But we're all like Jim Bowker, thinks I, more or less—  
Charge fate for our bad luck, ourselves for success,  
An' give fortune the blame for all our distress,  
As Jim Bowker, he said,  
Ef it hadn't been for luck an' misfortune an' sich,  
We might a-been famous, an' might a-been rich.

It might be jest so;  
I dunno;  
Jest so, it might been,  
Then ag'in—

*Sam Walter Foss.*

---

## THE PESSIMIST

Nothing to do but work,  
Nothing to eat but food,  
Nothing to wear but clothes,  
To keep one from going nude.

Nothing to breathe but air,  
Quick as a flash 't is gone;

Nowhere to fall but off,  
Nowhere to stand but on.

Nothing to comb but hair,  
Nowhere to sleep but in bed,  
Nothing to weep but tears,  
Nothing to bury but dead.

Nothing to sing but songs,  
Ah, well, alas! alack!  
Nowhere to go but out,  
Nowhere to come but back.

Nothing to see but sights,  
Nothing to quench but thirst,  
Nothing to have but what we've got  
Thus through life we are cursed.

Nothing to strike but a gait;  
Everything moves that goes.  
Nothing at all but common sense  
Can ever withstand these woes.

*Ben King.*

---

## WITHOUT AND WITHIN

My coachman, in the moonlight there,  
Looks through the side-light of the door;  
I hear him with his brethren swear,  
As I could do,—but only more.

Flattening his nose against the pane,

He envies me my brilliant lot,  
Breathes on his aching fist in vain,  
And dooms me to a place more hot.

He sees me in to supper go,  
A silken wonder by my side,  
Bare arms, bare shoulders, and a row  
Of flounces, for the door too wide.

He thinks how happy is my arm,  
'Neath its white-gloved and jewelled load;  
And wishes me some dreadful harm,  
Hearing the merry corks explode.

Meanwhile I inly curse the bore  
Of hunting still the same old coon,  
And envy him, outside the door,  
The golden quiet of the moon.

The winter wind is not so cold  
As the bright smile he sees me win,  
Nor the host's oldest wine so old  
As our poor gabble, sour and thin.

I envy him the rugged prance  
By which his freezing feet he warms,  
And drag my lady's chains, and dance,  
The galley-slave of dreary forms.

Oh, could he have my share of din,  
And I his quiet—past a doubt  
'Twould still be one man bored within,  
And just another bored without.

*James Russell Lowell.*

---

## SAME OLD STORY

History, and nature, too, repeat themselves, they say;  
Men are only habit's slaves; we see it every day.  
Life has done its best for me—I find it tiresome still;  
For nothing's everything at all, and everything is nil.

Same old get-up, dress, and tub;  
Same old breakfast; same old club;  
Same old feeling; same old blue;  
Same old story—nothing new!

Life consists of paying bills as long as you have health;  
Woman? She'll be true to you—as long as you have wealth;  
Think sometimes of marriage, if the right girl I could strike;  
But the more I see of girls, the more they are alike.

Same old giggles, smiles, and eyes;  
Same old kisses; same old sighs;  
Same old chaff you; same adieu;  
Same old story—nothing new!

Go to theatres sometimes to see the latest plays;  
Same old plots I played with in my happy childhood's days;  
Hero, same; same villain; and same heroine in tears,  
Starving, homeless, in the snow—with diamonds in her ears.

Same stern father making "bluffs";  
Leading man all teeth and cuffs;  
Same soubrettes, still twenty-two;  
Same old story—nothing new!

Friend of mine got married; in a year or so, a boy!  
Father really foolish in his fond paternal joy;  
Talked about that "kiddy," and became a dreadful bore—  
Just as if a baby never had been born before.

Same old crying, only more;  
Same old business, walking floor;

Same old "kitchy—coochy—coo!"  
Same old baby—nothing new!

*Harry B. Smith.*





# **EPIGRAMS**

## **WOMAN'S WILL**

Men, dying, make their wills, but wives  
Escape a work so sad;  
Why should they make what all their lives  
The gentle dames have had?

*John G. Saxe.*

---

## **CYNICUS TO W. SHAKESPEARE**

You wrote a line too much, my sage,  
Of seers the first, and first of sayers;  
For only half the world's a stage,  
And only all the women players.

*James Kenneth Stephen.*

---

## **SENEX TO MATT. PRIOR**



Ah! Matt, old age has brought to me  
Thy wisdom, less thy certainty;  
The world's a jest, and joy's a trinket;  
I knew that once,—but now I think it.

*James Kenneth Stephen.*

---

## **TO A BLOCKHEAD**

You beat your pate, and fancy wit will come:  
Knock as you please, there's nobody at home.

*Alexander Pope.*

---

## **THE FOOL AND THE POET**

Sir, I admit your general rule,  
That every poet is a fool,  
But you yourself may serve to show it,  
That every fool is not a poet.

*Alexander Pope.*

---

## **A RHYMESTER**

Jem writes his verses with more speed  
Than the printer's boy can set 'em;  
Quite as fast as we can read,  
And only not so fast as we forget 'em.

*Samuel Taylor Coleridge.*

---

### **GILES'S HOPE**

What? rise again with *all* one's bones,  
Quoth Giles, I hope you fib:  
I trusted, when I went to Heaven,  
To go without my rib.

*Samuel Taylor Coleridge.*

---

### **COLOGNE**

In Köln, a town of monks and bones,  
And pavements fanged with murderous stones,  
And rags, and hags, and hideous wenches,  
I counted two-and-seventy stenchs,  
All well defined, and separate stinks!  
Ye nymphs that reign o'er sewers and sinks,  
The river Rhine, it is well known,  
Doth wash your city of Cologne;  
But tell me, nymphs, what power divine  
Shall henceforth wash the river Rhine?

*Samuel Taylor Coleridge.*

---

## **AN ETERNAL POEM**

Your poem must *eternal* be,  
Dear sir, it can not fail,  
For 'tis incomprehensible,  
And wants both *head* and *tail*.

*Samuel Taylor Coleridge.*

---

## **ON A BAD SINGER**

Swans sing before they die:—'twere no bad thing,  
Should certain persons die before they sing.

*Samuel Taylor Coleridge.*

---

## **JOB**

Sly Beelzebub took all occasions  
To try Job's constancy and patience.  
He took his honor, took his health;  
He took his children, took his wealth,  
His servants, horses, oxen, cows,—

But cunning Satan did *not* take his spouse.

But Heaven, that brings out good from evil,  
And loves to disappoint the devil,  
Had predetermined to restore  
*Twofold* all he had before;  
His servants, horses, oxen, cows—  
Short-sighted devil, *not* to take his spouse!

*Samuel Taylor Coleridge.*

---

## REASONS FOR DRINKING

If all be true that I do think,  
There are five reasons we should drink;  
Good wine—a friend—or being dry—  
Or lest we should be by and by—  
Or any other reason why.

*Dr. Henry Aldrich.*

---

## SMATTERERS

All smatterers are more brisk and pert  
Than those that understand an art;  
As little sparkles shine more bright  
Than glowing coals, that give them light.

*Samuel Butler.*

---

## **HYPOCRISY**

Hypocrisy will serve as well  
To propagate a church, as zeal;  
As persecution and promotion  
Do equally advance devotion:  
So round white stones will serve, they say,  
As well as eggs to make hens lay.

*Samuel Butler.*

---

## **TO DOCTOR EMPIRIC**

When men a dangerous disease did 'scape,  
Of old, they gave a cock to Æsculape;  
Let me give two, that doubly am got free;  
From my disease's danger, and from thee.

*Ben Jonson.*

---

## **A REMEDY WORSE THAN THE DISEASE**

I sent for Ratcliffe; was so ill,  
That other doctors gave me over:  
He felt my pulse, prescribed his pill,  
And I was likely to recover.

But when the wit began to wheeze,  
And wine had warm'd the politician,  
Cured yesterday of my disease,  
I died last night of my physician.

*Matthew Prior.*

---

## **A WIFE**

Lord Erskine, at women presuming to rail,  
Calls a wife "a tin canister tied to one's tail";  
And fair Lady Anne, while the subject he carries on,  
Seems hurt at his Lordship's degrading comparison.  
But wherefore degrading? consider'd aright,  
A canister's useful, and polish'd, and bright:  
And should dirt its original purity hide,  
That's the fault of the puppy to whom it is tied.

*Richard Brinsley Sheridan.*

---

## **THE HONEY-MOON**

The honey-moon is very strange.  
Unlike all other moons the change  
She regularly undergoes.  
She rises at the full; then loses  
Much of her brightness; then reposes  
Faintly; and then ... has naught to lose.

*Walter Savage Landor.*

---

## **DIDO**

### **IMPROMPTU EPIGRAM ON THE LATIN GERUNDS**

When Dido found Æneas would not come,  
She mourn'd in silence, and was *Di-do-dum(b)*.

*Richard Parson.*

---

## **AN EPITAPH**

A lovely young lady I mourn in my rhymes:  
She was pleasant, good-natured, and civil sometimes.  
Her figure was good: she had very fine eyes,  
And her talk was a mixture of foolish and wise.  
Her adorers were many, and one of them said,  
"She waltzed rather well! It's a pity she's dead!"

*George John Cayley.*

---

## **ON TAKING A WIFE**

"Come, come," said Tom's father, "at your time of life,  
There's no longer excuse for thus playing the rake.—  
It is time you should think, boy, of taking a wife."—  
"Why, so it is, father,—whose wife shall I take?"

*Thomas Moore.*

---

**UPON BEING OBLIGED TO LEAVE A PLEASANT PARTY  
FROM THE WANT OF A PAIR OF BREECHES TO DRESS  
FOR DINNER IN**

Between Adam and me the great difference is,  
Though a paradise each has been forced to resign,  
That he never wore breeches till turn'd out of his,  
While, for want of my breeches, I'm banish'd from mine.

*Thomas Moore.*

---

**SOME LADIES**

Some ladies now make pretty songs,  
And some make pretty nurses;  
Some men are great at righting wrongs  
And some at writing verses.

*Frederick Locker-Lampson.*

---



## **ON A SENSE OF HUMOUR**

He cannot be complete in aught  
Who is not humorously prone;  
A man without a merry thought  
Can hardly have a funny-bone.

*Frederick Locker-Lampson.*

---

## **ON HEARING A LADY PRAISE A CERTAIN REV. DOCTOR'S EYES**

I cannot praise the Doctor's eyes;  
I never saw his glance divine;  
He always shuts them when he prays,  
And when he preaches he shuts mine.

*George Outram.*

---

## **EPITAPH INTENDED FOR HIS WIFE**

Here lies my wife: here let her lie!  
Now she's at rest, and so am I.

*John Dryden.*

---

## **TO A CAPRICIOUS FRIEND**

### **IMITATED FROM MARTIAL**

In all thy humors, whether grave or mellow,  
Thou 'rt such a touchy, testy, pleasant fellow;  
Hast so much wit, and mirth, and spleen about thee,  
There is no living with thee, nor without thee.

*Joseph Addison.*

---

## **WHICH IS WHICH**

"God bless the King! God bless the faith's defender!  
God bless—no harm in blessing—the Pretender.  
But who pretender is, and who is king,  
God bless us all, that's quite another thing."

*John Byrom.*

---

## **ON A FULL-LENGTH PORTRAIT OF BEAU MARSH PLACED BETWEEN THE BUSTS OF NEWTON AND POPE**

"Immortal Newton never spoke  
More truth than here you'll find;  
Nor Pope himself e'er penn'd a joke  
More cruel on mankind.

"The picture placed the busts between,  
Gives satire all its strength;  
Wisdom and Wit are little seen—  
But Folly at full length."

*Lord Chesterfield.*

---

## ON SCOTLAND

"Had Cain been Scot, God would have changed his doom;  
Nor forced him wander, but confined him home."

*Cleveland.*

---

## MENDAX

See yonder goes old Mendax, telling lies  
To that good easy man with whom he's walking;  
How know I that? you ask, with some surprise;  
Why, don't you see, my friend, the fellow's talking.

*Lessing.*

---

## TO A SLOW WALKER AND QUICK EATER

So slowly you walk, and so quickly you eat,  
You should march with your mouth, and devour with your feet.

*Lessing.*

---

## WHAT'S MY THOUGHT LIKE?

*Quest.*—Why is a Pump like Viscount Castlereagh?

*Answ.*—Because it is a slender thing of wood,  
That up and down its awkward arm doth sway,  
And coolly spout, and spout, and spout away,  
In one weak, washy, everlasting flood!

*Thomas Moore.*

---

## OF ALL THE MEN

Of all the men one meets about,  
There's none like Jack—he's everywhere:  
At church—park—auction—dinner—rout—  
Go when and where you will, he's there.  
Try the West End, he's at your back—  
Meets you, like Eurus, in the East—  
You're call'd upon for "How do, Jack?"  
One hundred times a day, at least.  
A friend of his one evening said,  
As home he took his pensive way,

"Upon my soul, I fear Jack's dead—  
I've seen him but three times to-day!"

*Thomas Moore.*

---

## ON BUTLER'S MONUMENT

While Butler, needy wretch, was yet alive,  
No generous patron would a dinner give.  
See him, when starved to death and turn'd to dust,  
Presented with a monumental bust.  
The poet's fate is here in emblem shown—  
He ask'd for *bread*, and he received a *stone*.

*Rev. Samuel Wesley.*

---

## A CONJUGAL CONUNDRUM

Which is of greater value, prythee, say,  
The Bride or Bridegroom?—must the truth be told?  
Alas, it must! The Bride is given away—  
The Bridegroom's often regularly sold.

*Unknown.*

---

## VII

# BURLESQUE

## LOVERS AND A REFLECTION

In moss-prankt dells which the sunbeams flatter  
    (And heaven it knoweth what that may mean;  
Meaning, however, is no great matter)  
    Where woods are a-tremble with words a-tween;

Thro' God's own heather we wonned together,  
    I and my Willie (O love my love):  
I need hardly remark it was glorious weather,  
    And flitter-bats wavered alow, above:

Boats were curtseying, rising, bowing,  
    (Boats in that climate are so polite,)  
And sands were a ribbon of green endowing,  
    And O the sun-dazzle on bark and bight!

Thro' the rare red heather we danced together  
    (O love my Willie,) and smelt for flowers:  
I must mention again it was glorious weather,  
    Rhymes are so scarce in this world of ours:

By rises that flushed with their purple favors,  
    Thro' becks that brattled o'er grasses sheen,  
We walked or waded, we two young shavers,  
    Thanking our stars we were both so green.

We journeyed in parallels, I and Willie,  
    In fortunate parallels! Butterflies,

Hid in weltering shadows of daffodilly  
Or Marjoram, kept making peacock eyes:

Song-birds darted about, some inky  
As coal, some snowy (I ween) as curds;  
Or rosy as pinks, or as roses pinky—  
They reckon of no eerie To-come, those birds!

But they skim over bents which the mill-stream washes,  
Or hang in the lift 'neath a white cloud's hem;  
They need no parasols, no goloshes;  
And good Mrs. Trimmer she feedeth them.

Then we thrifed God's cowslips (as erst his heather),  
That endowed the wan grass with their golden blooms;  
And snapt—(it was perfectly charming weather)—  
Our fingers at Fate and her goddess-glooms:

And Willie 'gan sing—(Oh, his notes were fluty;  
Wafts fluttered them out to the white-winged sea)—  
Something made up of rhymes that have done much duty,  
Rhymes (better to put it) of "ancientry":

Bowers of flowers encountered showers  
In William's carol—(O love my Willie!)  
Then he bade sorrow borrow from blithe to-morrow  
I quite forget what—say a daffodilly.

A nest in a hollow, "with buds to follow,"  
I think occurred next in his nimble strain;  
And clay that was "kneaden" of course in Eden—  
A rhyme most novel I do maintain:

Mists, bones, the singer himself, love-stories,  
And all least furlable things got furled;  
Not with any design to conceal their glories,  
But simply and solely to rhyme with world.



O if billows and pillows and hours and flowers,  
And all the brave rhymes of an elder day,  
Could be furled together, this genial weather,  
And carted or carried on wafts away,  
Nor ever again trotted out—ah me!  
How much fewer volumes of verse there'd be.

*Charles Stuart Calverley.*

---

## OUR HYMN

At morning's call  
The small-voiced pug dog welcomes in the sun,  
And flea-bit mongrels wakening one by one,  
Give answer all.

When evening dim  
Draws rounds us, then the lovely caterwaul,  
Tart solo, sour duet and general squall,  
These are our hymn.

*Oliver Wendell Holmes.*

---

## "SOLDIER, REST!"

A Russian sailed over the blue Black Sea  
Just when the war was growing hot,  
And he shouted, "I'm Tjalikavakeree—

Karindabrolikanavandorot—  
Schipkadirova—  
Ivandiszstova—  
Sanilik—  
Danilik—  
Varagobhot!"

A Turk was standing upon the shore  
Right where the terrible Russian crossed;  
And he cried, "Bismillah! I'm Abd el Kor—  
Bazaroukilgonautoskobrosk—  
Getzinpravadi—  
Kilgekosladji—  
Grivido—  
Blivido—  
Jenikodosk!"

So they stood like brave men, long and well,  
And they called each other their proper names,  
Till the lockjaw seized them, and where they fell  
They buried them both by the Irdosholames—  
Kalatalustchuk—  
Mischaribustchup—  
Bulgari—  
Dulgari—  
Sagharimainz.

*Robert J. Burdette.*

---

## IMITATION

Calm and implacable,  
Eying disdainfully the world beneath,

Sat Humpty-Dumpty on his mural eminence  
In solemn state:  
And I relate his story  
In verse unfettered by the bothering restrictions of rhyme or metre,  
In verse (or "rhythm," as I prefer to call it)  
Which, consequently, is far from difficult to write.

He sat. And at his feet  
The world passed on—the surging crowd  
Of men and women, passionate, turgid, dense,  
Keenly alert, lethargic, or obese.  
(Those two lines scan!)

Among the rest  
He noted Jones; Jones with his Roman nose,  
His eyebrows—the left one streaked with a dash of gray—  
And yellow boots.  
Not that Jones  
Has anything in particular to do with the story;  
But a descriptive phrase  
Like the above shows that the writer is  
A Master of Realism.

Let us proceed. Suddenly from his seat  
Did Humpty-Dumpty slip. Vainly he clutched  
The impalpable air. Down and down,  
Right to the foot of the wall,  
Right on to the horribly hard pavement that ran beneath it,  
Humpty-Dumpty, the unfortunate Humpty-Dumpty,  
Fell.

And him, alas! no equine agency,  
Him no power of regal battalions—  
Resourceful, eager, strenuous—  
Could ever restore to the lofty eminence  
Which once was his.  
Still he lies on the very identical

Spot where he fell—lies, as I said on the ground,  
Shamefully and conspicuously abased!

*Anthony C. Deane.*

---

## THE MIGHTY MUST

Come mighty Must!  
Inevitable Shall!  
In thee I trust.  
Time weaves my coronal!  
Go mocking Is!  
Go disappointing Was!  
That I am this  
Ye are the cursed cause!  
Yet humble second shall be first,  
I ween;  
And dead and buried be the curst  
Has Been!

Oh weak Might Be!  
Oh, May, Might, Could, Would, Should!  
How powerless ye  
For evil or for good!  
In every sense  
Your moods I cheerless call,  
Whate'er your tense  
Ye are imperfect, all!  
Ye have deceived the trust I've shown  
In ye!  
Away! The Mighty Must alone  
Shall be!

*W. S. Gilbert.*

---

## **MIDSUMMER MADNESS**

### **A SOLILOQUY**

I am a hearthrug—

Yes, a rug—

Though I cannot describe myself as snug;

Yet I know that for me they paid a price

For a Turkey carpet that would suffice

(But we live in an age of rascal vice).

Why was I ever woven,

For a clumsy lout, with a wooden leg,

To come with his endless Peg! Peg!

Peg! Peg!

With a wooden leg,

Till countless holes I'm drove in.

("Drove," I have said, and it should be "driven";

A hearthrug's blunders should be forgiven,

For wretched scribblers have exercised

Such endless bosh and clamour,

So improvidently have improvised,

That they've utterly ungrammaticised

Our ungrammatical grammar).

And the coals

Burn holes,

Or make spots like moles,

And my lily-white tints, as black as your hat turn,

And the housemaid (a matricide, will-forging slattern),

Rolls

The rolls

From the plate, in shoals,  
When they're put to warm in front of the coals;  
And no one with me condoles,  
For the butter stains on my beautiful pattern.  
But the coals and rolls, and sometimes soles,  
Dropp'd from the frying-pan out of the fire.  
Are nothing to raise my indignant ire,  
Like the Peg! Peg!  
Of that horrible man with the wooden leg.  
This moral spread from me,  
Sing it, ring it, yelp it—  
Never a hearthrug be,  
That is if you can help it.

*Unknown.*

---

## MAVRONE

### ONE OF THOSE SAD IRISH POEMS, WITH NOTES

From Arranmore the weary miles I've come;  
An' all the way I've heard  
A Shrawn<sup>[1]</sup> that's kep' me silent, speechless, dumb,  
Not sayin' any word.  
An' was it then the Shrawn of Eire,<sup>[2]</sup> you'll say,  
For him that died the death on Carrisbool?  
It was not that; nor was it, by the way,  
The Sons of Garnim<sup>[3]</sup> blitherin' their drool;  
Nor was it any Crowdie of the Shee,<sup>[4]</sup>  
Or Itt, or Himm, nor wail of Barryhoo<sup>[5]</sup>  
For Barrywhich that stilled the tongue of me.  
'Twas but my own heart cryin' out for you

Magraw!<sup>[6]</sup> Bulleen, shinnanigan, Boru,  
Aroon, Machree, Aboo!<sup>[7]</sup>

*Arthur Guiterman.*

[1] A Shrawn is a pure Gaelic noise, something like a groan, more like a shriek, and most like a sigh of longing.

[2] Eire was daughter of Carne, King of Connaught. Her lover, Murdh of the Open Hand, was captured by Greatcoat Mackintosh, King of Ulster, on the plain of Carrisbool, and made into soup. Eire's grief on this sad occasion has become proverbial.

[3] Garnim was second cousin to Manannan MacLir. His sons were always sad about something. There were twenty-two of them, and they were all unfortunate in love at the same time, just like a chorus at the opera. "Blitherin' their drool" is about the same as "dreeing their weird."

[4] The Shee (or "Sidhe," as I should properly spell it if you were not so ignorant) were, as everybody knows, the regular, stand-pat, organization fairies of Erin. The Crowdie was their annual convention, at which they made melancholy sounds. The Itt and Himm were the irregular, or insurgent, fairies. They *never* got any offices or patronage. See MacAlester, *Polity of the Sidhe of West Meath*, page 985.

[5] The Barryhoo is an ancient Celtic bird about the size of a Mavis, with lavender eyes and a black-crape tail. It continually mourns its mate (Barrywhich, feminine form), which has an hereditary predisposition to an early and tragic demise and invariably dies first.

[6] Magraw, a Gaelic term of endearment, often heard on the baseball fields of Donnybrook.

[7] These last six words are all that tradition has preserved of the original incantation by means of which Irish rats were rhymed to death. Thereby hangs a good Celtic tale, which I should be glad to tell you in this note; but the publishers say that being prosed to death is as bad as being rhymed to death, and that the readers won't stand for any more.

---

## LILIES

Lilies, lilies, white lilies and yellow—  
Lilies, lilies, purple lilies and golden—  
Calla lilies, tiger lilies, lilies of the valley—

Lilies, lilies, lilies—  
Bulb, bud and blossom—  
What made them lilies?  
If they were not lilies they would have to be something else, would they  
not?  
What was it that made them lilies instead of making them violets or roses  
or geraniums or petunias?  
What was it that made you yourself and me myself? What?  
Alas! I do not know!

*Don Marquis.*

---

## **FOR I AM SAD**

No usual words can bear the woe I feel,  
No tralatitious trite give me relief!  
O Webster! lend me words to voice my grief  
Bitter as quassia, quass or kumquat peel!  
For I am sad ... bound on the cosmic wheel,  
What mad chthonophagy bids slave and chief  
Through endless cycles bite the earth like beef,  
By turns each cannibal and each the meal?  
Turn we to nature Webster, and we see  
Your whidah bird refuse all strobile fruit,  
Your tragacanth in tears ooze from the tree ...  
We hear your flammulated owlets hoot!  
Turn we to nature, Webster, and we find  
Few creatures have a quite contented mind.  
Your koulan there, with dyslogistic snort,  
Will leave his phacoid food on worts to browse,  
While glactophorous Himalayan cows  
The knurled kohl-rabi spurn in uncouth sport;  
No margay climbs margosa trees; the short



Gray mullet drink no mulse, nor house  
In pibcorns when the youth of Wales carouse ...  
No tournure doth the toucan's tail contort ...  
So I am sad! ... and yet, on Summer eves,  
When xebecs search the whishing scree for whelk,  
And the sharp sorrel lifts obcordate leaves,  
And cryptogamous plants fulfil the elk,  
I see the octopus play with his feet,  
And find within this sadness something sweet.

The thing we like about that poem is its recognition of all the sorrow there is in the universe ... its *unflinching* recognition, we might say, if we were not afraid of praising our own work too highly ... combined with its happy ending.

One feels, upon reading it, that, although everything everywhere is very sad, and all wrong, one has only to have patience and after a while everything everywhere will be quite right and very sweet.

No matter how interested one may be in these literary problems, one must cease discussing them at times or one will be late to one's meals.

*Don Marquis.*

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## **A LITTLE SWIRL OF VERS LIBRE**

### **NOT COVERED, STRANGE TO SAY, BY THE PENAL CODE**

I am numb from world-pain—  
I sway most violently as the thoughts course through me,  
And athwart me,  
And up and down me—

Thoughts of cosmic matters,  
Of the mergings of worlds within worlds,  
And unutterabilities  
And room-rent,  
And other tremendously alarming phenomena,  
Which stab me,  
Rip me most outrageously;  
(Without a semblance, mind you, of respect for the Hague Convention's  
rules governing soul-slitting.)  
Aye, as with the poniard of the Finite pricking the rainbow-bubble of the  
Infinite!  
(Some figure, that!)  
(Some little rush of syllables, that!)—  
And make me—(are you still whirling at my coat-tails, reader?)  
Make me—ahem, where was I?—oh, yes—make me,  
In a sudden, overwhelming gust of soul-shattering rebellion,  
Fall flat on my face!

*Thomas R. Ybarra.*

---

## **YOUNG LOCHINVAR**

### **THE TRUE STORY IN BLANK VERSE**

Oh! young Lochinvar has come out of the West,  
Thro' all the wide border his horse has no equal,  
Having cost him forty-five dollars at the market,  
Where good nags, fresh from the country,  
With burrs still in their tails are selling  
For a song; and save his good broad sword  
He weapon had none, except a seven-shooter  
Or two, a pair of brass knuckles, and an Arkansaw

Toothpick in his boot, so, comparatively speaking,  
He rode all unarmed, and he rode all alone,  
Because there was no one going his way.  
He stayed not for brake, and he stopped not for  
Toll-gates; he swam the Eske River where ford  
There was none, and saved fifteen cents  
In ferriage, but lost his pocket-book, containing  
Seventeen dollars and a half, by the operation.  
Ere he alighted at the Netherby mansion  
He stopped to borrow a dry suit of clothes,  
And this delayed him considerably, so when  
He arrived the bride had consented—the gallant  
Came late—for a laggard in love and a dastard in war  
Was to wed the fair Ellen, and the guests had assembled.

So, boldly he entered the Netherby Hall  
Among bridesmen and kinsmen and brothers and  
Brothers-in-law and forty or fifty cousins;  
Then spake the bride's father, his hand on his sword  
(For the poor craven bridegroom ne'er opened his head)

"Oh, come ye in peace here, or come ye in anger,  
Or to dance at our bridal, young Lord Lochinvar?"  
"I long wooed your daughter, and she will tell you  
I have the inside track in the free-for-all  
For her affections! my suit you denied; but let  
That pass, while I tell you, old fellow, that love  
Swells like the Solway, but ebbs like its tide,  
And now I am come with this lost love of mine  
To lead but one measure, drink one glass of beer;  
There are maidens in Scotland more lovely by far  
That would gladly be bride to yours very truly."

The bride kissed the goblet, the knight took it up,  
He quaffed off the nectar and threw down the mug,  
Smashing it into a million pieces, while  
He remarked that he was the son of a gun

From Seven-up and run the Number Nine.  
She looked down to blush, but she looked up again  
For she well understood the wink in his eye;  
He took her soft hand ere her mother could  
Interfere, "Now tread we a measure; first four  
Half right and left; swing," cried young Lochinvar.

One touch to her hand and one word in her ear,  
When they reached the hall door and the charger  
Stood near on three legs eating post hay;  
So light to the croup the fair lady he swung,  
Then leaped to the saddle before her.  
"She is won! we are gone! over bank, bush, and spar,  
They'll have swift steeds that follow"—but in the

Excitement of the moment he had forgotten  
To untie the horse, and the poor brute could  
Only gallop in a little circus around the  
Hitching-post; so the old gent collared  
The youth and gave him the awfulest lambasting  
That was ever heard of on Canobie Lee;  
So dauntless in war and so daring in love,  
Have ye e'er heard of gallant like young Lochinvar?

*Unknown.*

---

## IMAGISTE LOVE LINES

I love my lady with a deep purple love;  
She fascinates me like a fly  
Struggling in a pot of glue.  
Her eyes are grey, like twin ash-cans,  
Just emptied, about which still hovers

A dainty mist.  
Her disposition is as bright as a ten-cent shine,  
Yet her kisses are tender and goulashy.  
I love my lady with a deep purple love.

*Unknown.*

---

## BYGONES

Or ever a lick of Art was done,  
Or ever a one to care,  
I was a Purple Polygon,  
And you were a Sky-Blue Square.

You yearned for me across a void,  
For I lay in a different plane,  
I'd set my heart on a Red Rhomboid,  
And your sighing was in vain.

You pined for me as well I knew,  
And you faded day by day,  
Until the Square that was heavenly Blue,  
Had paled to an ashen grey.

A myriad years or less or more,  
Have softly fluttered by,  
Matters are much as they were before,  
Except 'tis I that sigh.

I yearn for you, but I have no chance,  
You lie in a different plane,  
I break my heart for a single glance,  
And I break said heart in vain.

And ever I grow more pale and wan,  
And taste your old despair,  
When I was a Purple Polygon,  
And you were a Sky-Blue Square.

*Bert Leston Taylor.*

---

## JUSTICE TO SCOTLAND

### AN UNPUBLISHED POEM BY BURNS

O mickle yeuks the keckle doup,  
An' a' unsicker girns the graith,  
For wae and wae! the crowdies loup  
O'er jouk an' hallan, braw an' baith  
Where ance the coggie hirpled fair,  
And blithesome poortith toomed the loof,  
There's nae a burnie giglet rare  
But blaws in ilka jinking coof.

The routhie bield that gars the gear  
Is gone where glint the pawky een.  
And aye the stound is birkin lear  
Where sconnered yowies wheeped yestreen,  
The creeshie rax wi' skelpin' kaes  
Nae mair the howdie bicker whangs,  
Nor weanies in their wee bit claes  
Glour light as lammies wi' their sangs.

Yet leeze me on my bonny byke!  
My drappie aiblins blinks the noo,  
An' leesome luve has lapt the dyke

Forgatherin' just a wee bit fou.  
And Scotia! while thy rantin' lunt  
Is mirk and moop with gowans fine,  
I'll stowlins pit my unco brunt,  
An' cleek my duds for auld lang syne.

*Unknown.*

---

## LAMENT OF THE SCOTCH-IRISH EXILE

Oh, I want to win me hame  
To my ain countrie,  
The land frae whence I came  
Far away across the sea;  
Bit I canna find it there, on the atlas anywhere,  
And I greet and wonder sair  
Where the deil it can be?

I hae never met a man,  
In a' the world wide,  
Who has trod my native lan'  
Or its distant shores espied;  
But they tell me there's a place where my hypothetical race  
Its dim origin can trace—  
Tipperary-on-the-Clyde.

But anither answers: "Nae,  
Ye are varra far frae richt;  
Glasgow town in Dublin Bay  
Is the spot we saw the licht."  
But I dinna find the maps bearing out these pawkie chaps,  
And I sometimes think perhaps  
It has vanished out o' sight.

Oh, I fain wad win me hame  
To that undiscovered lan'  
That has neither place nor name  
Where the Scoto-Irishman  
May behold the castles fair by his fathers builded there  
Many, many ages ere  
Ancient history began.

*James Jeffrey Roche.*

---

## **A SONG OF SORROW**

### **A LULLABYLET FOR A MAGAZINELET**

Wan from the wild and woful West—  
Sleep, little babe, sleep on!  
Mother will sing to—you know the rest—  
Sleep, little babe, sleep on!  
Softly the sand steals slowly by,  
Cursed be the curlew's chittering cry;  
By-a-by, oh, by-a-by!  
Sleep, little babe, sleep on!

Rosy and sweet come the hush of night—  
Sleep, little babe, sleep on!  
(Twig to the lilt, I have got it all right)  
Sleep, little babe, sleep on!  
Dark are the dark and darkling days  
Winding the webbed and winsome ways,  
Homeward she creeps in dim amaze—  
Sleep, little babe, sleep on!  
(But it waked up, drat it!)



*Charles Battell Loomis.*

---

## **THE REJECTED "NATIONAL HYMNS"**

### **I**

**BY H—Y W. L-NGF—W**

Back in the years when Phlagstaff, the Dane, was monarch  
Over the sea-ribb'd land of the fleet-footed Norsemen,  
Once there went forth young Ursa to gaze at the heavens—  
Ursa—the noblest of all the Vikings and horsemen.

Musing, he sat in his stirrups and viewed the horizon,  
Where the Aurora lapt stars in a North-polar manner,  
Wildly he started,—for there in the heavens before him  
Flutter'd and flam'd the original Star Spangled Banner.

### **II**

**BY J-HN GR—NL—F WH—T—R**

My Native Land, thy Puritanic stock  
Still finds its roots firm-bound in Plymouth Rock,  
And all thy sons unite in one grand wish—  
To keep the virtues of Preservèd Fish.

Preservèd Fish, the Deacon stern and true,  
Told our New England what her sons should do,  
And if they swerve from loyalty and right,  
Then the whole land is lost indeed in night.

### **III**

**BY DR. OL-V-R W-ND-L H-LMES**

A diagnosis of our hist'ry proves  
Our native land a land its native loves;  
Its birth a deed obstetric without peer,  
Its growth a source of wonder far and near.

To love it more behold how foreign shores  
Sink into nothingness beside its stores;  
Hyde Park at best—though counted ultra-grand—  
The "Boston Common" of Victoria's land.

IV

BY R-LPH W-LDO EM-R—N

Source immaterial of material naught,  
Focus of light infinitesimal,  
Sum of all things by sleepless Nature wrought,  
Of which the normal man is decimal.

Refract, in prism immortal, from thy stars  
To the stars bent incipient on our flag,  
The beam translucent, neutrifying death,  
And raise to immortality the rag.

V

BY W-LL—M C-LL-N B-Y-NT

The sun sinks softly to his Ev'ning Post,  
The sun swells grandly to his morning crown;  
Yet not a star our Flag of Heav'n has lost,  
And not a sunset stripe with him goes down.

So thrones may fall, and from the dust of those  
New thrones may rise, to totter like the last;  
But still our Country's nobler planet glows  
While the eternal stars of Heaven are fast.

VI

BY N. P. W-LL-IS

One hue of our Flag is taken  
From the cheeks of my blushing Pet,  
And its stars beat time and sparkle  
Like the studs on her chemisette.

Its blue is the ocean shadow  
That hides in her dreamy eyes,  
It conquers all men, like her,  
And still for a Union flies.

VII

BY TH-M—S B-IL-Y ALD—CH

The little brown squirrel hops in the corn,  
The cricket quaintly sings,  
The emerald pigeon nods his head,  
And the shad in the river springs,  
The dainty sunflow'r hangs its head  
On the shore of the summer sea;  
And better far that I were dead,  
If Maud did not love me.

I love the squirrel that hops in the corn,  
And the cricket that quaintly sings;  
And the emerald pigeon that nods his head,  
And the shad that gaily springs.  
I love the dainty sunflow'r, too,  
And Maud with her snowy breast;  
I love them all;—but I love—I love—  
I love my country best.

*Robert H. Newell.*

---

**THE EDITOR'S WOOING**

We love thee, Ann Maria Smith,  
And in thy condescension  
We see a future full of joys  
Too numerous to mention.

There's Cupid's arrow in thy glance,  
That by thy love's coercion  
Has reached our melting heart of hearts,  
And asked for one insertion.

With joy we feel the blissful smart;  
And ere our passion ranges,  
We freely place thy love upon  
The list of our exchanges.

There's music in thy lowest tone,  
And silver in thy laughter:  
And truth—but we will give the full  
Particulars hereafter.

Oh, we could tell thee of our plans  
All obstacles to scatter;  
But we are full just now, and have  
A press of other matter.

Then let us marry, Queen of Smiths,  
Without more hesitation:  
The very thought doth give our blood  
A larger circulation.

*Robert H. Newell.*

## A BURLESQUE IMITATION OF WORDSWORTH—REJECTED ADDRESSES

[Spoken in the character of Nancy Lake, a girl eight years of age, who is drawn upon the stage in a child's chaise by Samuel Hughes, her uncle's porter.]

My brother Jack was nine in May,  
And I was eight on New-year's-day;  
So in Kate Wilson's shop  
Papa (he's my papa and Jack's)  
Bought me, last week, a doll of wax,  
And brother Jack a top.  
Jack's in the pouts, and this it is—  
He thinks mine came to more than his;

So to my drawer he goes,  
Takes out the doll, and, O, my stars!  
He pokes her head between the bars,  
And melts off half her nose!

Quite cross, a bit of string I beg,  
And tie it to his peg-top's peg,  
And bang, with might and main,  
Its head against the parlor-door:  
Off flies the head, and hits the floor,  
And breaks a window-pane.

This made him cry with rage and spite:  
Well, let him cry, it serves him right.  
A pretty thing, forsooth!  
If he's to melt, all scalding hot,  
Half my doll's nose, and I am not  
To draw his peg-top's tooth!

Aunt Hannah heard the window break,

And cried, "O naughty Nancy Lake,  
Thus to distress your aunt:  
No Drury Lane for you to-day!"  
And while papa said, "Pooh, she may!"  
Mamma said, "No, she sha'n't!"

Well, after many a sad reproach,  
They got into a hackney-coach,  
And trotted down the street.  
I saw them go: one horse was blind,  
The tails of both hung down behind,  
Their shoes were on their feet.

The chaise in which poor brother Bill  
Used to be drawn to Pentonville,  
Stood in the lumber-room:  
I wiped the dust from off the top,  
While Molly mopped it with a mop,  
And brushed it with a broom.

My uncle's porter, Samuel Hughes,  
Came in at six to black the shoes,  
(I always talk to Sam:)  
So what does he, but takes, and drags  
Me in the chaise along the flags,  
And leaves me where I am.

My father's walls are made of brick,  
But not so tall and not so thick  
As these; and, goodness me!  
My father's beams are made of wood,  
But never, never half so good  
As those that now I see.

What a large floor! 'tis like a town!  
The carpet, when they lay it down,  
Won't hide it, I'll be bound;

And there's a row of lamps!—my eye!  
How they do blaze! I wonder why  
They keep them on the ground.

At first I caught hold of the wing,  
And kept away; but Mr. Thing-  
umbob, the prompter man,  
Gave with his hand my chaise a shove,  
And said, "Go on, my pretty love;  
Speak to 'em little Nan.

"You've only got to curtsy, whisp-  
er, hold your chin up, laugh and lisp,  
And then you're sure to take:  
I've known the day when brats, not quite  
Thirteen, got fifty pounds a night;  
Then why not Nancy Lake?"

But while I'm speaking, where's papa?  
And where's my aunt? and where's mamma?  
Where's Jack? O there they sit!  
They smile, they nod; I'll go my ways,  
And order round poor Billy's chaise,  
To join them in the pit.

And now, good gentlefolks, I go  
To join mamma, and see the show;  
So, bidding you adieu,  
I curtsy like a pretty miss,  
And if you'll blow to me a kiss,  
I'll blow a kiss to you.  
[Blows a kiss, and exit.]

*James Smith.*

[1] "The author does not, in this instance, attempt to copy any of the higher attributes of Mr. Wordsworth's poetry; but has succeeded perfectly in the imitation of his mawkish affectations of childish simplicity and nursery

stammering. We hope it will make him ashamed of his *Alice Fell*, and the greater part of his last volumes—of which it is by no means a parody, but a very fair, and indeed we think a flattering, imitation."—*Edinburg Review*.

---

## THE CANTELOPE

Side by side in the crowded streets,  
Amid its ebb and flow,  
We walked together one autumn morn;  
('Twas many years ago!)  
The markets blushed with fruits and flowers;  
(Both Memory and Hope!)  
You stopped and bought me at the stall,  
A spicy cantelope.  
We drained together its honeyed wine,  
We cast the seeds away;  
I slipped and fell on the moony rinds,  
And you took me home on a dray!  
The honeyed wine of your love is drained;  
I limp from the fall I had;  
The snow-flakes muffle the empty stall,  
And everything is sad.  
The sky is an inkstand, upside down,  
It splashes the world with gloom;  
The earth is full of skeleton bones,  
And the sea is a wobbling tomb!

*Bayard Taylor.*

---

**POPULAR BALLAD: "NEVER FORGET YOUR PARENTS"**



A young man once was sitting  
Within a swell café,  
The music it was playing sweet—  
The people was quite gay.  
But he alone was silent,  
A tear was in his eye—  
A waitress she stepped up to him, and  
Asked him gently why.

(Change to Minor)

He turned to her in sorrow and  
At first he spoke no word,  
But soon he spoke unto her, for  
She was an honest girl.  
He rose up from the table  
In that elegant café,  
And in a voice replete with tears  
To her he then did say:

#### CHORUS

Never forget your father,  
Think all he done for you;  
A mother is a boy's best friend,  
So loving, kind, and true,  
If it were not for them, I'm sure  
I might be quite forlorn;  
And if your parents had not have lived  
You would not have been born.

A hush fell on the laughing throng,  
It made them feel quite bad,  
For most of them was people, and  
Some parents they had had.  
Both men and ladies did shed tears.  
The music it did cease,  
For all knew he had spoke the truth

By looking at his face.

(Change to Minor)

The waitress she wept bitterly  
And others was in tears  
It made them think of the old home  
They had not saw in years.  
And while their hearts was heavy and  
Their eyes they was quite red.  
This brave and honest boy again  
To them these words he said:

**CHORUS**

Never forget your father,  
Think all he done for you;  
A mother is a boy's best friend,  
So loving, kind, and true,  
If it were not for them, I'm sure  
I might be quite forlorn;  
And if your parents had not have lived  
You would not have been born.

*Franklin P. Adams.*

---

## **HOW A GIRL WAS TOO RECKLESS OF GRAMMAR**

Matilda Maud Mackenzie frankly hadn't any chin,  
Her hands were rough, her feet she turned invariably in;  
Her general form was German,  
By which I mean that you  
Her waist could not determine  
Within a foot or two.  
And not only did she stammer,

But she used the kind of grammar  
That is called, for sake of euphony, askew.

From what I say about her, don't imagine I desire  
A prejudice against this worthy creature to inspire.  
She was willing, she was active,  
She was sober, she was kind,  
But she *never* looked attractive  
And she *hadn't* any mind.  
I knew her more than slightly,  
And I treated her politely  
When I met her, but of course I wasn't blind!

Matilda Maud Mackenzie had a habit that was droll,  
She spent her morning seated on a rock or on a knoll,  
And threw with, much, composure  
A smallish rubber ball  
At an inoffensive osier  
By a little waterfall;  
But Matilda's way of throwing  
Was like other people's mowing,  
And she never hit the willow-tree at all!

One day as Miss Mackenzie with uncommon ardour tried  
To hit the mark, the missile flew exceptionally wide.  
And, before her eyes astounded,  
On a fallen maple's trunk  
Ricocheted and rebounded  
In the rivulet, and sunk!  
Matilda, greatly frightened,  
In her grammar unenlightened,  
Remarked, "Well now I ast yer, who'd 'er thunk?"

But what a marvel followed! From the pool at once there rose  
A frog, the sphere of rubber balanced deftly on his nose.  
He beheld her fright and frenzy  
And, her panic to dispel,

On his knee by Miss Mackenzie  
He obsequiously fell.  
With quite as much decorum  
As a speaker in a forum  
He started in his history to tell.

"Fair maid," he said, "I beg you do not hesitate or wince,  
If you'll promise that you'll wed me, I'll at once become a prince;  
For a fairy, old and vicious,  
An enchantment round me spun!"  
Then he looked up, unsuspecting,  
And he saw what he had won,  
And in terms of sad reproach, he  
Made some comments, *sotto voce*,  
(Which the publishers have bidden me to shun!)

Matilda Maud Mackenzie said, as if she meant to scold;  
"I *never*! Why, you forward thing! Now, ain't you awful bold!"  
Just a glance he paused to give her,  
And his head was seen to clutch,  
Then he darted to the river,  
And he dived to beat the Dutch!  
While the wrathful maiden panted  
"I don't think he was enchanted!"  
(And he really didn't look it overmuch!)

#### THE MORAL

In one's language one conservative should be;  
Speech is silver and it never should be free!

*Guy Wetmore Carryl.*

---

**BEHOLD THE DEEDS!**

## CHANT ROYAL

(Being the Complaint of Adolphe Culpepper Ferguson, Salesman of Fancy Notions, held in durance of his Landlady for a failure to connect on Saturday night.)

### I

I would that all men my hard case might know;  
How grievously I suffer for no sin:  
I, Adolphe Culpepper Ferguson, for lo!  
I, of my landlady am lockèd in.  
For being short on this sad Saturday,  
Nor having shekels of silver wherewith to pay,  
She has turned and is departed with my key;  
Wherefore, not even as other boarders free,  
I sing (as prisoners to their dungeon stones  
When for ten days they expiate a spree):  
Behold the deeds that are done of Mrs. Jones!

### II

One night and one day have I wept my woe;  
Nor wot I when the morrow doth begin,  
If I shall have to write to Briggs & Co.,  
To pray them to advance the requisite tin  
For ransom of their salesman, that he may  
Go forth as other boarders go away—  
As those I hear now flocking from their tea,  
Led by the daughter of my landlady  
Pianoward. This day for all my moans,  
Dry bread and water have been servèd me.  
Behold the deeds that are done of Mrs. Jones!

### III

Miss Amabel Jones is musical, and so  
The heart of the young he-boarder doth win,  
Playing "The Maiden's Prayer," adagio—  
That fetcheth him, as fetcheth the banco skin

The innocent rustic. For my part, I pray:  
That Badarjewska maid may wait for aye  
Ere sits she with a lover, as did we  
Once sit together, Amabel! Can it be  
That all of that arduous wooing not atones  
For Saturday shortness of trade dollars three?  
Behold the deeds that are done of Mrs. Jones!

IV

Yea! she forgets the arm was wont to go  
Around her waist. She wears a buckle whose pin  
Galleth the crook of the young man's elbow;  
I forget not, for I that youth have been.  
Smith was aforetime the Lothario gay.  
Yet once, I mind me, Smith was forced to stay  
Close in his room. Not calm, as I, was he;  
But his noise brought no pleasaunce, verily.  
Small ease he gat of playing on the bones,  
Or hammering on his stove-pipe, that I see.  
Behold the deeds that are done of Mrs. Jones!

V

Thou, for whose fear the figurative crow  
I eat, accursed be thou and all thy kin!  
Thee will I show up—yea, up will I show  
Thy too thick buckwheats, and thy tea too thin.  
Ay! here I dare thee, ready for the fray!  
Thou dost not keep a first-class house, I say!  
It does not with the advertisements agree.  
Thou lodgest a Briton with a pugaree,  
And thou hast harbored Jacobses and Cohns,  
Also a Mulligan. Thus denounce I thee!  
Behold the deeds that are done of Mrs. Jones!

ENVOY

Boarders! the worst I have not told to ye:  
She hath stole my trousers, that I may not flee

Privily by the window. Hence these groans,  
There is no fleeing in a *robe de nuit*.  
Behold the deeds that are done of Mrs. Jones!

*H. C. Bunner.*

---

## VILLON'S STRAIGHT TIP TO ALL CROSS COVES

*"Tout aux tavernes et aux fiells"*

Suppose you screeve? or go cheap-jack?  
Or fake the broads? or fig a nag?  
Or thimble-rig? or knap a yack?  
Or pitch a snide? or smash a rag?  
Suppose you duff? or nose and lag?  
Or get the straight, and land your pot?  
How do you melt the multy swag?  
Booze and the blowens cop the lot.

Fiddle, or fence, or mace, or mack;  
Or moskeneer, or flash the drag;  
Dead-lurk a crib, or do a crack;  
Pad with a slang, or chuck a fag;  
Bonnet, or tout, or mump and gag;  
Rattle the tats, or mark the spot;  
You cannot bag a single stag;  
Booze and the blowens cop the lot.

Suppose you try a different tack,  
And on the square you flash your flag?  
At penny-a-lining make your whack,  
Or with the mummers mug and gag?  
For nix, for nix the dibbs you bag!

At any graft, no matter what,  
Your merry goblins soon stravag:  
Booze and the blowens cop the lot.

**THE MORAL**

It's up the spout and Charley Wag  
With wipes and tickers and what not  
Until the squeezer nips your scrag,  
Booze and the blowens cop the lot.

*William Ernest Henley.*

---

**CULTURE IN THE SLUMS**

Inscribed to an Intense Poet

**I. RONDEAU**

"O crikey, Bill!" she ses to me, she ses.  
"Look sharp," ses she, "with them there sossiges.  
Yea! sharp with them there bags of mysteree!  
For lo!" she ses, "for lo! old pal," ses she,  
"I'm blooming peckish, neither more nor less."

Was it not prime—I leave you all to guess  
How prime!—to have a Jude in love's distress  
Come spooning round, and murmuring balmilee,  
"O crikey, Bill!"

For in such rorty wise doth Love express  
His blooming views, and asks for your address,  
And makes it right, and does the gay and free.  
I kissed her—I did so! And her and me



Was pals. And if that ain't good business,

"O crikey, Bill!"

## II. VILLANELLE

Now ain't they utterly too-too  
    (She ses, my Missus mine, ses she),  
Them flymy little bits of Blue.

Joe, just you kool 'em—nice and skew  
    Upon our old meogginee,  
Now ain't they utterly too-too?

They're better than a pot'n' a screw,  
    They're equal to a Sunday spree,  
Them flymy little bits of Blue!

Suppose I put 'em up the flue,  
    And booze the profits, Joe? Not me.  
Now ain't they utterly too-too?

I do the 'Igh Art fake, I do.  
    Joe, I'm consummate; and I *see*  
Them flymy little bits of Blue.

Which Joe, is why I ses ter you—  
    Æsthetic-like, and limp, and free—  
Now *ain't* they utterly too-too,  
Them flymy little bits of Blue?

## III. BALLADE

I often does a quiet read  
    At Booty Shelly's poetry;  
I thinks that Swinburne at a screed  
    Is really almost too too fly;  
    At Signor Vagna's harmony  
I likes a merry little flutter;  
    I've had at Pater many a shy;

In fact, my form's the Bloomin' Utter.

My mark's a tidy little feed,  
And 'Enery Irving's gallery,  
To see old 'Amlick do a bleed,  
And Ellen Terry on the die,  
Or Frankey's ghostes at hi-spy,  
And parties carried on a shutter.  
Them vulgar Coupeaus is my eye!  
In fact my form's the Bloomin' Utter.

The Grosvenor's nuts—it is, indeed!  
I goes for 'Olman 'Unt like pie.  
It's equal to a friendly lead  
To see B. Jones's judes go by.  
Stanhope he make me fit to cry.  
Whistler he makes me melt like butter.  
Strudwick he makes me flash my cly—  
In fact, my form's the Bloomin' Utter.

#### ENVOY

I'm on for any Art that's 'Igh;  
I talks as quiet as I can splutter;  
I keeps a Dado on the sly;  
In fact, my form's the Bloomin' Utter.

*William Ernest Henley.*

---

## THE LAWYER'S INVOCATION TO SPRING

Whereas, on certain boughs and sprays  
Now divers birds are heard to sing,  
And sundry flowers their heads upraise,

Hail to the coming on of Spring!

The songs of those said birds arouse  
The memory of our youthful hours,  
As green as those said sprays and boughs,  
As fresh and sweet as those said flowers.

The birds aforesaid—happy pairs—  
Love, 'mid the aforesaid boughs, inshrines  
In freehold nests; themselves their heirs,  
Administrators, and assigns.

O busiest term of Cupid's Court,  
Where tender plaintiffs actions bring,—  
Season of frolic and of sport,  
Hail, as aforesaid, coming Spring!

*Henry Howard Brownell.*

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## **NORTH, EAST, SOUTH, AND WEST**

### **AFTER R. K.**

Oh! I have been North, and I have been South, and the East hath seen me  
pass,  
And the West hath cradled me on her breast, that is circled round with  
brass,  
And the world hath laugh'd at me, and I have laugh'd at the world alone,  
With a loud hee-haw till my hard-work'd jaw is stiff as a dead man's bone!

Oh! I have been up and I have been down and over the sounding sea,  
And the sea-birds cried as they dropp'd and died at the terrible sight of me,

For my head was bound with a star, and crown'd with the fire of utmost  
hell,  
And I made this song with a brazen tongue and a more than fiendish yell:

"Oh! curse you all, for the sake of men who have liv'd and died for spite,  
And be doubly curst for the dark ye make where there ought to be but light,  
And be trebly curst by the deadly spell of a woman's lasting hate,—  
And drop ye down to the mouth of hell who would climb to the Golden  
Gate!"

Then the world grew green, and grim and grey at the horrible noise I made,  
And held up its hands in a pious way when I call'd a spade a spade;  
But I cared no whit for the blame of it, and nothing at all for its praise,  
And the whole consign'd with a tranquil mind to a sempiternal blaze!

All this have I sped, and have brought me back to work at the set of sun,  
And I set my seal to the thoughts I feel in the twilight one by one,  
For I speak but sooth in the name of Truth when I write such things as  
these;

And the whole I send to a critical friend who is learnèd in Kiplingese!

*Unknown.*

---

## MARTIN LUTHER AT POTSDAM

What lightning shall light it? What thunder shall tell it?  
In the height of the height, in the depth of the deep?  
Shall the sea-storm declare it, or paint it, or smell it?  
Shall the price of a slave be its treasure to keep?  
When the night has grown near with the gems on her bosom,  
When the white of mine eyes is the whiteness of snow,  
When the cabman—in liquor—drives a blue roan, a kicker,  
Into the land of the dear long ago.

Ah!—Ah, again!—You will come to me, fall on me—  
You are so heavy, and I am so flat.  
And I? I shall not be at home when you call on me,  
But stray down the wind like a gentleman's hat:  
I shall list to the stars when the music is purple,  
Be drawn through a pipe, and exhaled into rings;  
Turn to sparks, and then straightway get stuck in the gateway  
That stands between speech and unspeakable things.

As I mentioned before, by what light is it lighted?  
Oh! Is it fourpence, or piebald, or gray?  
Is it a mayor that a mother has knighted  
Or is it a horse of the sun and the day?  
Is it a pony? If so, who will change it?  
O golfer, be quiet, and mark where it scuds,  
And think of its paces—of owners and races—  
Relinquish the links for the study of studs.

Not understood? Take me hence! Take me yonder!  
Take me away to the land of my rest—  
There where the Ganges and other gees wander,  
And uncles and antelopes act for the best,  
And all things are mixed and run into each other  
In a violet twilight of virtues and sins,  
With the church-spires below you and no one to show you  
Where the curate leaves off and the pew-rent begins!

In the black night through the rank grass the snakes peer—  
The cobs and the cobras are partial to grass—  
And a boy wanders out with a knowledge of Shakespeare  
That's not often found in a boy of his class,  
And a girl wanders out without any knowledge,  
And a bird wanders out, and a cow wanders out,  
Likewise one wether, and they wander together—  
There's a good deal of wandering lying about.

But its all for the best; I've been told by my friends, Sir,  
That in verses I'd written the meaning was slight;  
I've tried with no meaning—to make 'em amends, Sir—  
And find that this kind's still more easy to write.  
The title has nothing to do with the verses,  
But think of the millions—the laborers who  
In busy employment find deepest enjoyment,  
And yet, like my title, have nothing to do!

*Barry Pain.*

---

## **AN IDYLL OF PHATTE AND LEENE**

The hale John Sprat—oft called for shortness, Jack—  
Had married—had, in fact, a wife—and she  
Did worship him with wifely reverence.  
He, who had loved her when she was a girl,  
Compass'd her too, with sweet observances;  
E'en at the dinner table did it shine.  
For he—liking no fat himself—he never did,  
With jealous care piled up her plate with lean,  
Not knowing that all lean was hateful to her.  
And day by day she thought to tell him o't,  
And watched the fat go out with envious eye,  
But could not speak for bashful delicacy.

At last it chanced that on a winter day,  
The beef—a prize joint!—little was but fat;  
So fat, that John had all his work cut out,  
To snip out lean fragments for his wife,  
Leaving, in very sooth, none for himself;  
Which seeing, she spoke courage to her soul,  
Took up her fork, and, pointing to the joint

Where 'twas the fattest, piteously she said;  
"Oh, husband! full of love and tenderness!  
What is the cause that you so jealously  
Pick out the lean for me. I like it not!  
Nay, loathe it—'tis on the fat that I would feast;  
O me, I fear you do not like my taste!"

Then he, dropping his horny-handled carving knife,  
Sprinkling therewith the gravy o'er her gown,  
Answer'd, amazed: "What! you like fat, my wife!  
And never told me. Oh, this is not kind!  
Think what your reticence has wrought for us;  
How all the fat sent down unto the maid—  
Who likes not fat—for such maids never do—  
Has been put in the waste-tub, sold for grease,  
And pocketed as servant's perquisite!  
Oh, wife! this news is good; for since, perforce,  
A joint must be not fat nor lean, but both;  
Our different tastes will serve our purpose well;  
For, while you eat the fat—the lean to me  
Falls as my cherished portion. Lo! 'tis good!"  
So henceforth—he that tells the tale relates—  
In John Sprat's household waste was quite unknown;  
For he the lean did eat, and she the fat,  
And thus the dinner-platter was all cleared.

*Unknown.*

---

## THE HOUSE THAT JACK BUILT

And this reft house is that the which he built,  
Lamented Jack! and here his malt he piled.  
Cautious in vain! these rats that squeak so wild,

Squeak not unconscious of their father's guilt.  
Did he not see her gleaming through the glade!  
Belike 'twas she, the maiden all forlorn.  
What though she milked no cow with crumpled horn,  
Yet, aye she haunts the dale where erst she strayed:  
And aye before her stalks her amorous knight!  
Still on his thighs their wonted brogues are worn,  
And through those brogues, still tattered and betorn,  
His hindward charms gleam an unearthly white.

*Samuel Taylor Coleridge.*

---

## **PALABRAS GRANDIOSAS**

**AFTER T—— B—— A——**

I lay i' the bosom of the sun,  
Under the roses dappled and dun.  
I thought of the Sultan Gingerbeer,  
In his palace beside the Bendemeer,  
With his Afghan guards and his eunuchs blind,  
And the harem that stretched for a league behind.

The tulips bent i' the summer breeze,  
Under the broad chrysanthemum-trees,  
And the minstrel, playing his culverin,  
Made for mine ears a merry din,  
If I were the Sultan, and he were I,  
Here i' the grass he should loafing lie,  
And I should bestride my zebra steed,  
And ride to the hunt of the centipede:  
While the pet of the harem, Dandeline,  
Should fill me a crystal bucket of wine,



And the kishlar aga, Up-to-Snuff,  
Should wipe my mouth when I sighed, "Enough!"  
And the gay court poet, Fearfulbore,  
Should sit in the hall when the hunt was o'er,  
And chant me songs of silvery tone,  
Not from Hafiz, but—mine own!

Ah, wee sweet love, beside me here,  
I am not the Sultan Gingerbeer,  
Nor you the odalisque Dandeline,  
Yet I am yourn, and you are mine!

*Bayard Taylor.*

---

## **A LOVE PLAYNT—1370**

To yow, my Purse, and to noon other wighte,  
Complayne I, for ye be my lady dere!  
I am so sorry now that ye been lyghte,  
For, certes, yf ye make me hevy chere,  
Me were as leef be layde upon my beere.  
For whiche unto your mercie thus I crye,  
Beethe hevy ageyne, or elles mote I die!

Now voucheth sauf this day, or hyt be nighte,  
That I of yow the blissful soun may here,  
Or see your colour lyke the sunnè brighte,  
That of yellownesse haddè never pere.  
Ye be my lyf! ye be myn herty's stere!  
Quenè of comfort and good companye!  
Beethe hevy ageyne, or elles mote I die!

Now, Purse! that ben to me my lyve's lyghte,

And surety as doune in this world here,  
Out of this tounè helpè me through your myghte,  
Syn that you wole not bene my tresorere;  
For I am shave as nigh as is a frere.  
But I pray unto your curtesye,  
Beethe hevy ageyne, or elles mote I die!

*Godfrey Turner.*

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## **DARWINITY**

Power to thine elbow, thou newest of sciences,  
All the old landmarks are ripe for decay;  
Wars are but shadows, and so are alliances,  
Darwin the great is the man of the day.

All other 'ologies want an apology;  
Bread's a mistake—Science offers a stone;  
Nothing is true but Anthropobiology—  
Darwin the great understands it alone.

Mighty the great evolutionist teacher is  
Licking Morphology clean into shape;  
Lord! what an ape the Professor or Preacher is  
Ever to doubt his descent from an ape.

Man's an Anthropoid—he cannot help that, you know—  
First evolved from Pongos of old;  
He's but a branch of the *catarrhine* cat, you know—  
Monkey I mean—that's an ape with a cold.

Fast dying out are man's later Appearances,  
Cataclysmic Geologies gone;

Now of Creation completed the clearance is,  
Darwin alone you must anchor upon.

Primitive Life—Organisms were chemical,  
Busting spontaneous under the sea;  
Purely subaqueous, panaquademical,  
Was the original Crystal of Me.

I'm the Apostle of mighty Darwinity,  
Stands for Divinity—sounds much the same—  
Apo-theistico-Pan-Asininity  
Only can doubt whence the lot of us came.

Down on your knees, Superstition and Flunkeydom!  
Won't you accept such plain doctrines instead?  
What is so simple as primitive Monkeydom  
Born in the sea with a cold in its head?

*Herman C. Merivale.*

---

## SELECT PASSAGES FROM A COMING PORT

### DISENCHANTMENT

My Love has sicklied unto Loath,  
And foul seems all that fair I fancied—  
The lily's sheen's a leprous growth,  
The very buttercups are rancid.

### ABASEMENT

With matted head a-dabble in the dust,  
And eyes tear-sealèd in a saline crust  
I lie all loathly in my rags and rust—  
Yet learn that strange delight may lurk in self-disgust.

#### STANZA WRITTEN IN DEPRESSION NEAR DULWICH

The lark soars up in the air;  
The toad sits tight in his hole;  
And I would I were certain which of the pair  
Were the truer type of my soul!

#### TO MY LADY

Twine, lanken fingers, lily-lithe,  
Gleam, slanted eyes, all beryl-green,  
Pout, blood-red lips that burst a-writhe,  
Then—kiss me, Lady Grisoline!

#### THE MONSTER

Uprears the monster now his slobberous head,  
Its filamentous chaps her ankles brushing;  
Her twice-five roseal toes are cramped in dread,  
Each maidly instep mauven-pink is flushing.

#### A TRUMPET BLAST

Pale Patricians, sunk in self-indulgence,  
Blink your bleared eyes. Behold the Sun—  
Burst proclaim in purpurate effulgence,  
Demos dawning, and the Darkness done!

*F. Anstey.*

---

### THE ROMAUNT OF HUMPTY DUMPTY

'Tis midnight, and the moonbeam sleeps  
Upon the garden sward;  
My lady in yon turret keeps  
Her tearful watch and ward.

"Beshrew me!" mutters, turning pale,  
The stalwart seneschal;  
"What's he, that sitteth, clad in mail  
Upon our castle wall?"

"Arouse thee, friar of orders grey;  
What ho! bring book and bell!  
Ban yonder ghastly thing, I say;  
And, look ye, ban it well!  
By cock and pye, the Humpty's face!"  
The form turned quickly round;  
Then totter'd from its resting-place—

---

That night the corse was found.

The king, with hosts of fighting men  
Rode forth at break of day;  
Ah! never gleamed the sun till then  
On such a proud array.

But all that army, horse and foot,  
Attempted, quite in vain,  
Upon the castle wall to put  
The Humpty up again.

*Henry S. Leigh.*

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## **THE WEDDING**

Lady Clara Vere de Vere!  
I hardly know what I must say,  
But I'm to be Queen of the May, mother,  
I'm to be Queen of the May!

I am half-crazed; I don't feel grave,  
Let me rave!

Whole weeks and months, early and late,  
To win his love I lay in wait.  
Oh, the Earl was fair to see,  
As fair as any man could be;—  
The wind is howling in turret and tree!

We two shall be wed tomorrow morn,  
And I shall be the Lady Clare,  
And when my marriage morn shall fall,  
I hardly know what I shall wear.  
But I shan't say "my life is dreary,"  
And sadly hang my head,  
With the remark, "I'm very weary,  
And wish that I were dead."

But on my husband's arm I'll lean,  
And roundly waste his plenteous gold,  
Passing the honeymoon serene  
In that new world which is the old.  
For down we'll go and take the boat  
Beside St. Katherine's docks afloat,  
Which round about its prow has wrote—  
"The Lady of Shalotter"  
(Mondays and Thursdays,—Captain Foat),  
Bound for the Dam of Rotter.

*Thomas Hood, Jr.*

---

**IN MEMORIAM TECHNICAM**

I count it true which sages teach—  
That passion sways not with repose,  
That love, confounding these with those,  
Is ever welding each with each.

And so when time has ebbd away,  
Like childish wreaths too lightly held,  
The song of immemorial eld  
Shall moan about the belted bay.

Where slant Orion slopes his star,  
To swelter in the rolling seas,  
Till slowly widening by degrees  
The grey climbs upward from afar.

And golden youth and passion stray  
Along the ridges of the strand,—  
Not far apart, but hand in hand,—  
With all the darkness danced away!

*Thomas Hood, Jr.*

---

## "SONGS WITHOUT WORDS"

I cannot sing the old songs,  
Though well I know the tune,  
Familiar as a cradle-song  
With sleep-compelling croon;  
Yet though I'm filled with music  
As choirs of summer birds  
"I cannot sing the old songs"—  
I do not know the words.

I start on "Hail Columbia,"  
And get to "heav'n-born band,"  
And there I strike an up-grade  
With neither steam nor sand;

"Star Spangled Banner" downs me  
Right in my wildest screaming,  
I start all right, but dumbly come  
To voiceless wreck at "streaming."

So, when I sing the old songs,  
Don't murmur or complain  
If "Ti, diddy ah da, tum dum,"  
Should fill the sweetest strain.  
I love "Tolly um dum di do,"  
And the "trilla-la yeeep da" birds,  
But "I cannot sing the old songs"—  
I do not know the words.

*Robert J. Burdette.*

---

## **AT THE SIGN OF THE COCK**

### **FRENCH STYLE, 1898**

Being an Ode in further "Contribution to the Song of French History," dedicated, without malice or permission to Mr. George Meredith.

#### **I**

Rooster her sign,  
Rooster her pugnant note, she struts



Evocative, amazon spurs aprick at heel;  
Nid-nod the authentic stump  
Of the once ensanguined comb vermeil as wine;  
With conspuent doodle-doo  
Hails breach o' the hectic dawn of yon New Year,  
Last issue up to date  
Of quiverful Fate  
Evolved spontaneous; hails with tenant trump  
The spiriting prime o' the clashed carillon-peal;  
Ruffling her caudal plumes derisive of scuts;  
Inconscient how she stalks an immarcessibly absurd  
Bird.

## II

Mark where her Equatorial Pioneer  
Delirant on the tramp goes littoralwise.  
His Flag at furl, portmanteaued; drains to the dregs  
The penultimate brandy-bottle, coal-on-the-head-piece gift  
Of who avenged the Old Sea-Rover's smirch.  
Marchant he treads the all-along of inarable drift  
On dubiously connivent legs,  
The facile prey of predatory flies;  
Panting for further; sworn to lurch  
Empirical on to the Menelik-buffered, enhavened blue,  
Rhyming—see Cantique I.—with doodle-doo.

## III

Infuriate she kicked against Imperial fact;  
Vulnant she felt  
What pin-stab should have stained Another's pelt  
Puncture her own Colonial lung-balloon,  
Volant to nigh meridian. Whence rebuffed,  
The perjured Scythian she lacked  
At need's pinch, sick with spleen of the rudely cuffed  
Below her breath she cursed; she cursed the hour  
When on her spring for him the young Tyrannical broke  
Amid the unhallowed wedlock's vodka-shower,

She passionate, he dispassionate; tricked  
Her wits to eye-blind; borrowed the ready as for dower;  
Till from the trance of that Hymettus-moon  
She woke,  
A nuptial-knotted derelict;  
Pensioned with Rescripts other aid declined  
By the plumped leech saturate urging Peace  
In guise of heavy-armed Gospeller to men,  
Tyrannical unto fraternal equal liberal, her. Not she;  
Not till Alsace her consanguineous find  
What red deteutonising artillery  
Shall shatter her beer-reek alien police  
The just-now pluripollent; not till then.

#### IV

More pungent yet the esoteric pain  
Squeezing her pliable vitals nourishes feud  
Insanely grumous, grumously insane.  
For lo!  
Past common balmly on the Bordereau,  
Churns she the skim o' the gutter's crust  
With Anti-Judaic various carmagnole,  
Whooped praise of the Anti-just;  
Her boulevard brood  
Gyratory in convolvements militant-mad;  
Theatrical of faith in the Belliform,  
Her Og,  
Her Monstrous. Fled what force she had  
To buckle the jaw-gape, wide agog  
For the Preconcerted One,  
The Anticipated, ripe to clinch the whole;  
Queen-bee to hive the hither and thither volant swarm.

Bides she his coming; adumbrates the new  
Expurgatorial Divine,  
Her final effulgent Avatar,  
Postured outside a trampling mastodon

Black as her Baker's charger; towering; visibly gorged  
With blood of traitors. Knee-grip stiff,  
Spine straightened, on he rides;  
Embossed the Patriot's brow with hieroglyph  
Of martial *dossiers*, nothing forged  
About him save his armour. So she bides  
Voicing his advent indeterminably far,  
Rooster her sign,  
Rooster her conspuent doodle-doo.

V

Behold her, pranked with spurs for bloody sport,  
How she acclaims,  
A crapulous chanticleer,  
Breach of the hectic dawn of yon New Year.  
Not yet her fill of rumours sucked;  
Inebriate of honour; blushfully wroth;  
Tireless to play her old primeval games;  
Her plumage preened the yet unplucked  
Like sails of a galleon, rudder hard amont  
With crepitant mast  
Fronting the hazard to dare of a dual blast  
The intern and the extern, blizzards both.

*Owen Seaman.*

---

**PRESTO FURIOSO**

**AFTER WALT WHITMAN**

Spontaneous Us!  
O my Camarados! I have no delicatessen as a diplomat, but I go  
blind on Libertad!

Give me the flap-flap of the soaring Eagle's pinions!  
Give me the tail of the British lion tied in a knot inextricable, not to  
be solved anyhow!  
Give me a standing army (I say "give me," because just at present  
we want one badly, armies being often useful in time  
of war).

I see our superb fleet (I take it that we are to have a superb fleet  
built almost immediately);  
I observe the crews prospectively; they are constituted of various  
nationalities, not necessarily American;  
I see them sling the slug and chew the plug;  
I hear the drum begin to hum;

Both the above rhymes are purely accidental, and contrary to my  
principles.  
We shall wipe the floor of the mill-pond with the scalps of able-  
bodied British tars!  
I see Professor Edison about to arrange for us a torpedo-hose on  
wheels, likewise an infernal electro-semaphore;  
I see Henry Irving dead sick and declining to play Corporal  
Brewster;  
Cornell, I yell! I yell Cornell!

I note the Manhattan boss leaving his dry-goods store and investing  
in a small Gatling-gun and a ten-cent banner;  
I further note the Identity evolved out of forty-four spacious and  
thoughtful States;  
I note Canada as shortly to be merged in that Identity; similarly Van  
Diemen's Land, Gibraltar, and Stratford-on-Avon;  
Briefly, I see creation whipped!

O ye Colonels! I am with you (I too am a Colonel and on the  
pension-list);  
I drink to the lot of you; to Colonels Cleveland, Hitt, Vanderbilt,  
Chauncey M. Depew, O'Donovan Rossa, and the late

Colonel Monroe;  
I drink an egg-flip, a morning-caress, an eye-opener, a maiden-  
bosom, a vermuth-cocktail, three sherry-cobblers, and  
a gin-sling!  
Good old Eagle!

*Owen Seaman.*

---

## **TO JULIA IN SHOOTING TOGS AND A HERRICKOSE VEIN**

When as to shoot my Julia goes,  
Then, then (methinks), how bravely shows  
That rare arrangement of her clothes!

So shod as when the Huntress Maid  
With thumping buskin bruised the glade,  
She moveth, making earth afraid.

Against the sting of random chaff  
Her leathern gaiters circle half  
The arduous crescent of her calf.

Unto th' occasion timely fit,  
My love's attire doth show her wit,  
And of her legs a little bit.

Sorely it sticketh in my throat,  
She having nowhere to bestow't  
To name the absent petticoat.

In lieu whereof a wanton pair  
Of knickerbockers she doth wear,

Full windy and with space to spare.

Enlargèd by the bellying breeze,  
Lord! how they playfully do ease  
The urgent knocking of her knees!

Lengthways curtailed to her taste  
A tunic circumvents her waist,  
And soothly it is passing chaste.

Upon her head she hath a gear  
Even such as wights of ruddy cheer  
Do use in stalking of the deer.

Haply her truant tresses mock  
Some coronal of shapelier block,  
To wit, the bounding billy-cock.

Withal she hath a loaded gun,  
Whereat the pheasants, as they run,  
Do make a fair diversión.

For very awe, if so she shoots,  
My hair upriseth from the roots,  
And lo! I tremble in my boots!

*Owen Seaman.*

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**FAREWELL**

**PROVOKED BY CALVERLEY'S "FOREVER"**

"Farewell!" Another gloomy word  
As ever into language crept.  
'Tis often written, never heard,  
Except

In playhouse. Ere the hero flits—  
In handcuffs—from our pitying view.  
"Farewell!" he murmurs, then exits  
R. U.

"Farewell" is much too sighful for  
An age that has not time to sigh.  
We say, "I'll see you later," or  
"Good by!"

When, warned by chanticleer, you go  
From her to whom you owe devoir,  
"Say not 'good by,'" she laughs, "but  
'Au Revoir!'"

Thus from the garden are you sped;  
And Juliet were the first to tell  
You, you were silly if you said  
"Farewell!"

"Farewell," meant long ago, before  
It crept, tear-spattered, into song,  
"Safe voyage!" "Pleasant journey!" or  
"So long!"

But gone its cheery, old-time ring;  
The poets made it rhyme with knell—  
Joined it became a dismal thing—  
"Farewell!"

"Farewell!" into the lover's soul

You see Fate plunge the fatal iron.  
All poets use it. It's the whole  
Of Byron.

"I only feel—farewell!" said he;  
And always fearful was the telling—  
Lord Byron was eternally  
Farewelling.

"Farewell!" A dismal word, 'tis true  
(And why not tell the truth about it!);  
But what on earth would poets do  
Without it?

*Bert Leston Taylor.*

---

## HERE IS THE TALE

### AFTER RUDYARD KIPLING

*Here is the tale—and you must make the most of it!  
Here is the rhyme—ah, listen and attend!  
Backwards—forwards—read it all and boast of it  
If you are anything the wiser at the end!*

Now Jack looked up—it was time to sup, and the bucket was yet to  
fill,  
And Jack looked round for a space and frowned, then beckoned his  
sister Jill,  
And twice he pulled his sister's hair, and thrice he smote her side;  
"Ha' done, ha' done with your impudent fun—ha' done with your  
games!" she cried;



"You have made mud-pies of a marvellous size—finger and face  
are black,  
You have trodden the Way of the Mire and Clay—now up and wash  
you, Jack!  
Or else, or ever we reach our home, there waiteth an angry dame—  
Well you know the weight of her blow—the supperless open  
shame!  
Wash, if you will, on yonder hill—wash, if you will, at the spring,  
—  
Or keep your dirt, to your certain hurt, and an imminent  
walloping!"

"You must wash—you must scrub—you must scrape!" growled  
Jack, "you must traffic with cans and pails,  
Nor keep the spoil of the good brown soil in the rim of your finger-  
nails!  
The morning path you must tread to your bath—you must wash ere  
the night descends,  
And all for the cause of conventional laws and the soap-makers'  
dividends!  
But if 'tis sooth that our meal in truth depends on our washing, Jill,  
By the sacred right of our appetite—haste—haste to the top of the  
hill!"

They have trodden the Way of the Mire and Clay, they have toiled  
and travelled far,  
They have climbed to the brow of the hill-top now, where the  
bubbling fountains are,  
They have taken the bucket and filled it up—yea, filled it up to the  
brim;  
But Jack he sneered at his sister Jill, and Jill she jeered at him:  
"What, blown already!" Jack cried out (and his was a biting mirth!)  
"You boast indeed of your wonderful speed—but what is the  
boasting worth?  
Now, if you can run as the antelope runs and if you can turn like a  
hare,

Come, race me, Jill, to the foot of the hill—and prove your  
boasting fair!"

"Race? What is a race" (and a mocking face had Jill as she spake  
the word)

"Unless for a prize the runner tries? The truth indeed ye heard,  
For I can run as the antelope runs, and I can turn like a hare:—  
The first one down wins half-a-crown—and I will race you there!"

"Yea, if for the lesson that you will learn (the lesson of humbled  
pride)

The price you fix at two-and-six, it shall not be denied;  
Come, take your stand at my right hand, for here is the mark we  
toe:

Now, are you ready, and are you steady? Gird up your petticoats!  
Go!"

And Jill she ran like a winging bolt, a bolt from the bow released,  
But Jack like a stream of the lightning gleam, with its pathway duly  
greased;

He ran down hill in front of Jill like a summer-lightning flash—  
Till he suddenly tripped on a stone, or slipped, and fell to the earth  
with a crash.

Then straight did rise on his wondering eyes the constellations fair,  
Arcturus and the Pleiades, the Greater and Lesser Bear,  
The swirling rain of a comet's train he saw, as he swiftly fell—  
And Jill came tumbling after him with a loud triumphant yell:  
"You have won, you have won, the race is done! And as for the  
wager laid—

You have fallen down with a broken crown—the half-crown debt is  
paid!"

They have taken Jack to the room at the back where the family  
medicines are,

And he lies in bed with a broken head in a halo of vinegar;  
While, in that Jill had laughed her fill as her brother fell to earth,  
She had felt the sting of a wallop—she hath paid the price of her  
mirth!

*Here is the tale—and now you have the whole of it,*

*Here is the story—well and wisely planned,  
Beauty—Duty—these make up the soul of it—  
But, ah, my little readers, will you mark and understand?*

*Anthony C. Deane.*

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## THE WILLOWS

The skies they were ashen and sober,  
The streets they were dirty and drear;  
It was night in the month of October,  
Of my most immemorial year;  
Like the skies I was perfectly sober,  
As I stopped at the mansion of Shear,—  
At the "Nightingale,"—perfectly sober,  
And the willowy woodland, down here.

Here once in an alley Titanic  
Of Ten-pins,—I roamed with my soul,—  
Of Ten-pins,—with Mary, my soul;  
They were days when my heart was volcanic,  
And impelled me to frequently roll,  
And made me resistlessly roll,  
Till my ten-strikes created a panic  
In the realms of the Boreal pole,  
Till my ten-strikes created a panic  
With the monkey atop of his pole.

I repeat, I was perfectly sober,  
But my thoughts they were palsied and sear,—  
My thoughts were decidedly queer;  
For I knew not the month was October,  
And I marked not the night of the year;

I forgot that sweet *morceau* of Auber  
That the band oft performèd down here;  
And I mixed the sweet music of Auber  
With the Nightingale's music by Shear.

And now as the night was senescent,  
And star-dials pointed to morn,  
And car-drivers hinted of morn,  
At the end of the path a liquescent  
And bibulous lustre was born:  
'Twas made by the bar-keeper present,  
Who mixèd a duplicate horn,—  
His two hands describing a crescent  
Distinct with a duplicate horn.

And I said: "This looks perfectly regal;  
For it's warm, and I know I feel dry,—  
I am confident that I feel dry.  
We have come past the emeu and eagle,  
And watched the gay monkey on high;

Let us drink to the emeu and eagle,—  
To the swan and the monkey on high—  
To the eagle and monkey on high;  
For this bar-keeper will not inveigle,—  
Bully boy with the vitreous eye;  
He surely would never inveigle,—  
Sweet youth with the crystalline eye."

But Mary, uplifting her finger,  
Said, "Sadly this bar I mistrust,—  
I fear that this bar does not trust.  
Oh, hasten! oh, let us not linger!  
Oh, fly!—let us fly—ere we must!"  
In terror she cried, letting sink her  
Parasol till it trailed in the dust,—  
In agony sobbed, letting sink her

Parasol till it trailed in the dust,—  
Till it sorrowfully trailed in the dust.

Then I pacified Mary, and kissed her,  
And tempted her into the room,  
And conquer'd her scruples and gloom;  
And we passed to the end of the vista,  
But were stopped by the warning of doom—  
By some words that were warning of doom.  
And I said, "What is written, sweet sister,  
At the opposite end of the room?"  
She sobbed, as she answered, "All liquors  
Must be paid for ere leaving the room."

Then my heart it grew ashen and sober,  
As the streets were deserted and drear—  
For my pockets were empty and drear;  
And I cried, "It was surely October,  
On this very night of last year,  
That I journeyed—I journeyed down here—  
That I brought a fair maiden down here,  
On this night of all nights in the year.  
Ah! to me that inscription is clear:

Well I know now I'm perfectly sober,  
Why no longer they credit me here,—  
Well I know now that music of Auber,  
And this Nightingale, kept by one Shear."

*Bret Harte.*

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## A BALLAD

IN THE MANNER OF R-DY-RD K-PL-NG

As I was walkin' the jungle round, a-killin' of tigers an' time;  
I seed a kind of an author man a writin' a rousin' rhyme;  
'E was writin' a mile a minute an' more, an' I sez to 'im, "'Oo are you?"  
Sez 'e, "I'm a poet—'er majesty's poet—soldier an' sailor, too!"  
An 'is poem began in Ispahan an' ended in Kalamazoo,  
It 'ad army in it, an' navy in it, an' jungle sprinkled through,  
For 'e was a poet—'er majesty's poet—soldier an' sailor, too!

An' after, I met 'im all over the world, a doin' of things a host;  
'E 'ad one foot planted in Burmah, an' one on the Gloucester coast;  
'Es 'alf a sailor an' 'alf a whaler, 'e's captain, cook and crew,  
But most a poet—'er majesty's poet—soldier an' sailor too!  
'E's often Scot an' 'e's often not, but 'is work is never through  
For 'e laughs at blame, an' 'e writes for fame, an' a bit for revenoo,—  
Bein' a poet—'er majesty's poet—soldier an' sailor too!

'E'll take you up to the Artic zone, 'e'll take you down to the Nile,  
'E'll give you a barrack ballad in the Tommy Atkins style,  
Or 'e'll sing you a Dipsy Chantey, as the bloomin' bo'suns do,  
For 'e is a poet—'er majesty's poet—soldier an' sailor too.  
An' there isn't no room for others, an' there's nothin' left to do;  
'E 'as sailed the main from the 'Orn to Spain, 'e 'as tramped the jungle  
through,  
An' written up all there is to write—soldier an' sailor, too!

There are manners an' manners of writin', but 'is is the *proper* way,  
An' it ain't so hard to be a bard if you'll imitate Rudyard K.;  
But sea an' shore an' peace an' war, an' everything else in view—  
'E 'as gobbled the lot!—'er majesty's poet—soldier an' sailor, too.  
'E's not content with 'is Indian 'ome, 'e's looking for regions new,  
In another year 'e'll ave swept 'em clear, an' what'll the rest of us do?  
'E's *crowdin' us out!*—'er majesty's poet—soldier an' sailor too!

Guy Wetmore Carryl.

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## THE TRANSLATED WAY

Being a lyric translation of Heine's "Du bist wie eine Blume," as it is usually done.

Thou art like unto a Flower,  
So pure and clean thou art;  
I view thee and much sadness  
Steals to me in the heart.

To me it seems my Hands I  
Should now impose on your  
Head, praying God to keep you  
So fine and clean and pure.

*Franklin P. Adams.*

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## COMMONPLACES

Rain on the face of the sea,  
Rain on the sodden land,  
And the window-pane is blurred with rain  
As I watch it, pen in hand.

Mist on the face of the sea,  
Mist on the sodden land,  
Filling the vales as daylight fails,  
And blotting the desolate sand.

Voices from out of the mist,  
Calling to one another:  
"Hath love an end, thou more than friend,

Thou dearer than ever brother?"

Voices from out of the mist,  
Calling and passing away;  
But I cannot speak, for my voice is weak,  
And ... this is the end of my lay.

*Rudyard Kipling.*

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## **ANGELO ORDERS HIS DINNER**

I, Angelo, obese, black-garmented,  
Respectable, much in demand, well fed  
With mine own larder's dainties, where, indeed,  
Such cakes of myrrh or fine alyssum seed,  
Thin as a mallow-leaf, embrowned o' the top.  
Which, cracking, lets the ropy, trickling drop  
Of sweetness touch your tongue, or potted nests  
Which my recondite recipe invests  
With cold conglomerate tidbits—ah, the bill!  
(You say), but given it were mine to fill  
My chests, the case so put were yours, we'll say  
(This counter, here, your post, as mine to-day),  
And you've an eye to luxuries, what harm  
In smoothing down your palate with the charm  
Yourself concocted? There we issue take;  
And see! as thus across the rim I break  
This puffy paunch of glazed embroidered cake,  
So breaks, through use, the lust of watering chaps  
And craveth plainness: do I so? Perhaps;  
But that's my secret. Find me such a man  
As Lippo yonder, built upon the plan  
Of heavy storage, double-navelled, fat



From his own giblet's oils, an Ararat  
Uplift o'er water, sucking rosy draughts  
From Noah's vineyard,—crisp, enticing wafts  
Yon kitchen now emits, which to your sense  
Somewhat abate the fear of old events,  
Qualms to the stomach,—I, you see, am slow  
Unnecessary duties to forego,—  
You understand? A venison haunch, *haul gout*.  
Ducks that in Cimbrian olives mildly stew.  
And sprigs of anise, might one's teeth provoke  
To taste, and so we wear the complex yoke  
Just as it suits,—my liking, I confess,  
More to receive, and to partake no less,  
Still more obese, while through thick adipose  
Sensation shoots, from testing tongue to toes  
Far off, dim-conscious, at the body's verge,  
Where the froth-whispers of its waves emerge  
On the untasting sand. Stay, now! a seat  
Is bare: I, Angelo, will sit and eat.

*Bayard Taylor.*

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## THE PROMISSORY NOTE

In the lonesome latter years  
    (Fatal years!)  
To the dropping of my tears  
Danced the mad and mystic spheres  
In a rounded, reeling rune,  
    'Neath the moon,  
To the dripping and the dropping of my tears.

Ah, my soul is swathed in gloom,

(Ulalume!)  
In a dim Titanic tomb,  
For my gaunt and gloomy soul  
Ponders o'er the penal scroll,  
O'er the parchment (not a rhyme),  
Out of place,—out of time,—  
I am shredded, shorn, unshifty,  
(Oh, the fifty!)  
And the days have passed, the three,  
Over me!  
And the debit and the credit are as one to him and me!

'Twas the random runes I wrote  
At the bottom of the note,  
(Wrote and freely  
Gave to Greeley)  
In the middle of the night,  
In the mellow, moonless night,  
When the stars were out of sight,  
When my pulses, like a knell,  
(Israfel!)  
Danced with dim and dying fays  
O'er the ruins of my days,  
O'er the dimeless, timeless days,  
When the fifty, drawn at thirty,  
Seeming thrifty, yet the dirty  
Lucre of the market, was the most that I could raise!

Fiends controlled it,  
(Let him hold it!)  
Devils held for me the inkstand and the pen;  
Now the days of grace are o'er,  
(Ah, Lenore!)  
I am but as other men;  
What is time, time, time,  
To my rare and runic rhyme,  
To my random, reeling rhyme,

By the sands along the shore,  
Where the tempest whispers, "Pay him!" and I answer, "Nevermore!"

*Bayard Taylor.*

---

## CAMERADOS

Everywhere, everywhere, following me;  
Taking me by the buttonhole, pulling off my boots, hustling me with the  
elbows;  
Sitting down with me to clams and the chowder-kettle;  
Plunging naked at my side into the sleek, irascible surges;  
Soothing me with the strain that I neither permit nor prohibit;  
Flocking this way and that, reverent, eager, orotund, irrepressible;  
Denser than sycamore leaves when the north-winds are scouring  
Paumanok;  
What can I do to restrain them? Nothing, verily nothing,  
Everywhere, everywhere, crying aloud for me;  
Crying, I hear; and I satisfy them out of my nature;  
And he that comes at the end of the feast shall find something over.  
Whatever they want I give; though it be something else, they shall have it.  
Drunkard, leper, Tammanyite, small-pox and cholera patient, shoddy and  
codfish millionaire,  
And the beautiful young men, and the beautiful young women, all the  
same,  
Crowding, hundreds of thousands, cosmical multitudes,  
Buss me and hang on my hips and lean up to my shoulders,  
Everywhere listening to my yawp and glad whenever they hear it;  
Everywhere saying, say it, Walt, we believe it:  
Everywhere, everywhere.

*Bayard Taylor.*

---

## THE LAST RIDE TOGETHER

### FROM HER POINT OF VIEW

When I had firmly answered "No,"  
And he allowed that that was so,  
I really thought I should be free  
For good and all from Mr. B.,  
    And that he would soberly acquiesce.  
I said that it would be discreet  
That for awhile we should not meet;  
I promised that I would always feel  
A kindly interest in his weal;  
I thanked him for his amorous zeal;  
    In short, I said all I could but "yes."

I said what I'm accustomed to;  
I acted as I always do.  
I promised he should find in me  
A friend,—a sister, if that might be;  
    But he was still dissatisfied.  
He certainly was most polite;  
He said exactly what was right,  
He acted very properly,  
Except indeed for this, that he  
Insisted on inviting me  
    To come with him for "one more last ride."

A little while in doubt I stood:  
A ride, no doubt, would do me good;  
I had a habit and a hat  
Extremely well worth looking at;  
    The weather was distinctly fine.  
My horse, too, wanted exercise,

And time, when one is riding, flies;  
Besides, it really seemed, you see,  
The only way of ridding me  
Of pertinacious Mr. B.;  
    So my head I graciously incline.

I won't say much of what happened next;  
I own I was extremely vexed.  
Indeed I should have been aghast  
If any one had seen what passed;  
    But nobody need ever know  
That, as I leaned forward to stir the fire,  
He advanced before I could well retire;  
And I suddenly felt, to my great alarm,  
The grasp of a warm, unlicensed arm,  
An embrace in which I found no charm;  
    I was awfully glad when he let me go.

Then we began to ride; my steed  
Was rather fresh, too fresh indeed,  
And at first I thought of little, save  
The way to escape an early grave,  
    As the dust rose up on either side.  
My stern companion jogged along  
On a brown old cob both broad and strong.  
He looked as he does when he's writing verse,  
Or endeavoring not to swear and curse,  
Or wondering Where he has left his purse;  
    Indeed it was a sombre ride.

I spoke of the weather to Mr. B.,  
But he neither listened nor spoke to me.  
I praised his horse, and I smiled the smile  
Which was wont to move him once in a while.  
    I said I was wearing his favorite flowers,  
But I wasted my words on the desert air,  
For he rode with a fixed and gloomy stare.

I wonder what he was thinking about.  
As I don't read verse, I shan't find out.  
It was something subtle and deep, no doubt,  
    A theme to detain a man for hours.

Ah! there was the corner where Mr. S.  
So nearly induced me to whisper "yes";  
And here it was that the next but one  
Proposed on horseback, or would have done,  
    Had his horse not most opportunely shied;  
Which perhaps was due to the unseen flick  
He received from my whip; 'twas a scurvy trick,  
But I never could do with that young man,—  
I hope his present young woman can.  
Well, I must say, never, since time began,  
    Did I go for a duller or longer ride.

He never smiles and he never speaks;  
He might go on like this for weeks;  
He rolls a slightly frenzied eye  
Towards the blue and burning sky,  
    And the cob bounds on with tireless stride.  
If we aren't home for lunch at two  
I don't know what papa will do;  
But I know full well he will say to me,  
"I never approved of Mr. B.;  
It's the very devil that you and he  
    Ride, ride together, forever ride."

*James Kenneth Stephen.*

---

## IMITATION OF WALT WHITMAN

Who am I?

I have been reading Walt Whitman, and know not whether he be me, or me  
he;—

Or otherwise!

Oh, blue skies! oh, rugged mountains! oh, mighty, rolling Niagara!

O, chaos and everlasting bosh!

I am a poet; I swear it! If you do not believe it you are a dolt, a fool, an  
idiot!

Milton, Shakespere, Dante, Tommy Moore, Pope, never, but Byron, too,  
perhaps, and last, not least, Me, and the Poet Close.

We send our resonance echoing down the adamantine cañons of the future!

We live forever! The worms who criticise us (asses!) laugh, scoff, jeer, and  
babble—die!

Serve them right.

What is the difference between Judy, the pride of Fleet Street, the glory of  
Shoe Lane, and Walt Whitman?

Start not! 'Tis no end of a minstrel show who perpends this query;

'Tis no brain-racking puzzle from an inner page of the Family Herald,

No charade, acrostic (double or single), conundrum, riddle, rebus,  
anagram, or other guess-work.

I answer thus: We both write truths—great, stern, solemn, unquenchable  
truths—couched in more or less ridiculous language.

I, as a rule use rhyme, he does not; therefore, I am his Superior (which is  
also a lake in his great and glorious country).

I scorn, with the unutterable scorn of the despiser of pettiness, to take a  
mean advantage of him.

He writes, he sells, he is read (more or less); why then should I rack my  
brains and my rhyming dictionary? I will see the public  
hanged first!

I sing of America, of the United States, of the stars and stripes of Oskhosh,  
of Kalamazoo, and of Salt Lake City.

I sing of the railroad cars, of the hotels, of the breakfasts, the lunches, the  
dinners, and the suppers;

Of the soup, the fish, the entrées, the joints, the game, the puddings and the  
ice-cream.

I sing all—I eat all—I sing in turn of Dr. Bluffem's Anti-bilious Pills.

No subject is too small, too insignificant, for Nature's poet.

I sing of the cocktail, a new song for every cocktail, hundreds of songs,  
hundreds of cocktails.  
It is a great and a glorious land! The Mississippi, the Missouri, and a  
million other torrents roll their waters to the ocean.  
It is a great and glorious land! The Alleghanies, the Catskills, the Rockies  
(see atlas for other mountain ranges too numerous to mention)  
pierce the clouds!  
And the greatest and most glorious product of this great and glorious land  
is Walt Whitman;  
This must be so, for he says it himself.  
There is but one greater than he between the rising and the setting sun.  
There is but one before whom he meekly bows his humbled head.  
Oh, great and glorious land, teeming producer of all things, creator of  
Niagara, and inventor of Walt Whitman,  
Erase your national advertisements of liver pads and cures for rheumatism  
from your public monuments, and inscribe thereon in letters of  
gold the name *Judy*.

*Unknown.*

---

## **SALAD**

O cool in the summer is salad,  
And warm in the winter is love;  
And a poet shall sing you a ballad  
Delicious thereon and thereof.  
A singer am I, if no sinner,  
My muse has a marvellous wing,  
And I willingly worship at dinner  
The Sirens of Spring.

Take endive—like love it is bitter,  
Take beet—for like love it is red;



Crisp leaf of the lettuce shall glitter,  
And cress from the rivulet's bed;  
Anchovies, foam-born, like the lady  
Whose beauty has maddened this bard;  
And olives, from groves that are shady;  
And eggs—boil 'em hard.

*Mortimer Collins.*

---

## IF

If life were never bitter,  
And love were always sweet,  
Then who would care to borrow  
A moral from to-morrow—  
If Thames would always glitter,  
And joy would ne'er retreat,  
If life were never bitter,  
And love were always sweet!

If care were not the waiter  
Behind a fellow's chair,  
When easy-going sinners  
Sit down to Richmond dinners,  
And life's swift stream flows straighter,  
By Jove, it would be rare,  
If care were not the waiter  
Behind a fellow's chair.

If wit were always radiant,  
And wine were always iced,  
And bores were kicked out straightway  
Through a convenient gateway;

Then down the year's long gradient  
'Twere sad to be enticed,  
If wit were always radiant,  
And wine were always iced.

*Mortimer Collins.*

---

## THE JABBERWOCKY OF AUTHORS

'Twas gilbert. The kchesterton  
Did locke and bennett in the reed.  
All meredith was the nicholson,  
And harrison outqueed.

Beware the see-enn-william, son,  
The londonjack with call that's wild.  
Beware the gertroo datherton  
And richardwashburnchild.

He took his brady blade in hand;  
Long time the partridge foe he sought.  
Then stood a time by the oppenheim  
In deep mcnaughton thought.

In warwick deeping thought he stood—  
He poised on edithwharton brink;  
He cried, "Ohbernardshaw! I could  
If basilking would kink."

Rexbeach! rexbeach!—and each on each  
O. Henry's mantles ferber fell.  
It was the same'sif henryjames  
Had wally eaton well.

"And hast thou writ the greatest book?  
Come to thy birmingham, my boy!  
Oh, beresford way! Oh, holman day!"  
He kiplinged in his joy.

'Twas gilbert. The kchesterton  
Did locke and bennett in the reed.  
All meredith was the nicholson,  
And harrison outqueed.

*Harry Persons Taber.*

---

## THE TOWN OF NICE

**MAY, 1874**

The town of Nice! the town of Nice!  
Where once mosquitoes buzzed and stung,  
And never gave me any peace,  
The whole year round when I was young!  
Eternal winter chills it yet,  
It's always cold, and mostly wet.

Lord Brougham sate on the rocky brow,  
Which looks on sea-girt Cannes, I wis,  
But wouldn't like to sit there now,  
Unless 'twere warmer than it is;  
I went to Cannes the other day,  
But found it much too damp to stay.

The mountains look on Monaco,  
And Monaco looks on the sea;

And, playing there some hours ago,  
I meant to win enormously;  
But, tho' my need of coin was bad  
I lost the little that I had.

Ye have the southern charges yet—  
Where is the southern climate gone?  
Of two such blessings, why forget  
The cheaper and the seemlier one?  
My weekly bill my wrath inspires;  
Think ye I meant to pay for fires?

Why should I stay? No worse art thou,  
My country! on thy genial shore  
The local east-winds whistle now,  
The local fogs spread more and more;  
But in the sunny south, the weather  
Beats all you know of put together.

I cannot eat—I cannot sleep—  
The waves are not so blue as I;  
Indeed, the waters of the deep  
Are dirty-brown, and so's the sky:  
I get dyspepsia when I dine—  
Oh, dash that pint of country-wine!

*Herman C. Merivale.*

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## **THE WILLOW-TREE**

### **ANOTHER VERSION**

Long by the willow-trees  
Vainly they sought her,  
Wild rang the mother's screams  
O'er the gray water:  
Where is my lovely one?  
Where is my daughter?

"Rouse thee, Sir Constable—  
Rouse thee and look;  
Fisherman, bring your net,  
Boatman, your hook.  
Beat in the lily-beds,  
Dive in the brook!"

Vainly the constable  
Shouted and called her;  
Vainly the fisherman  
Beat the green alder;  
Vainly he flung the net,  
Never it hauled her!

Mother beside the fire  
Sat, her nightcap in;  
Father, in easy chair,  
Gloomily napping,  
When at the window-sill  
Came a light tapping!

And a pale countenance  
Looked through the casement,  
Loud beat the mother's heart,  
Sick with amazement,  
And at the vision which  
Came to surprise her,  
Shrieked in an agony—  
"Lor'! it's Elizar!"

Yes, 'twas Elizabeth—  
Yes, 'twas their girl;  
Pale was her cheek, and her  
Hair out of curl.  
"Mother," the loving one,  
Blushing exclaimed,  
"Let not your innocent  
Lizzy be blamed.

"Yesterday, going to Aunt  
Jones's to tea,  
Mother, dear mother, I  
Forgot the door-key!  
And as the night was cold  
And the way steep,  
Mrs. Jones kept me to  
Breakfast and sleep."

Whether her Pa and Ma  
Fully believed her,  
That we shall never know,  
Stern they received her;  
And for the work of that  
Cruel, though short, night  
Sent her to bed without  
Tea for a fortnight.

#### **MORAL**

Hey diddle diddlety,  
Cat and the fiddlety,  
Maidens of England, take caution by she!  
Let love and suicide  
Never tempt you aside,  
And always remember to take the door-key.

*W. M. Thackeray.*

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## **A BALLADE OF BALLADE-MONGERS**

### **AFTER THE MANNER OF MASTER FRANÇOIS VILLON OF PARIS**

In Ballades things always contrive to get lost,  
And Echo is constantly asking where  
Are last year's roses and last year's frost?  
And where are the fashions we used to wear?  
And what is a "gentleman," and what is a "player"?  
Irrelevant questions I like to ask:  
Can you reap the tret as well as the tare?  
And who was the Man in the Iron Mask?

What has become of the ring I tossed  
In the lap of my mistress false and fair?  
Her grave is green and her tombstone mossed;  
But who is to be the next Lord Mayor?  
And where is King William, of Leicester Square?  
And who has emptied my hunting flask?  
And who is possessed of Stella's hair?  
And who was the Man in the Iron Mask?

And what became of the knee I crossed,  
And the rod and the child they would not spare?  
And what will a dozen herring cost  
When herring are sold at three halfpence a pair?  
And what in the world is the Golden Stair?  
Did Diogenes die in a tub or cask,

Like Clarence, for love of liquor there?  
And who was the Man in the Iron Mask?

ENVOY

Poets, your readers have much to bear,  
For Ballade-making is no great task,  
If you do not remember, I don't much care  
Who was the man in the Iron Mask.

*Augustus M. Moore.*

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# VIII

# BATHOS

## THE CONFESSION

There's somewhat on my breast, father,  
    There's somewhat on my breast!  
The livelong day I sigh, father,  
    And at night I cannot rest.  
I cannot take my rest, father,  
    Though I would fain do so;  
A weary weight oppresseth me—  
    This weary weight of woe!

'Tis not the lack of gold, father,  
    Nor want of worldly gear;  
My lands are broad, and fair to see,  
    My friends are kind and dear.  
My kin are leal and true, father,  
    They mourn to see my grief;  
But, oh! 'tis not a kinsman's hand  
    Can give my heart relief!

'Tis not that Janet's false, father,  
    'Tis not that she's unkind;  
Though busy flatterers swarm around,  
    I know her constant mind.  
'Tis not *her* coldness, father,  
    That chills my laboring breast;  
It's that confounded cucumber  
    I ate, and can't digest.

*Richard Harris Barham.*

---

## IF YOU HAVE SEEN

Good reader! if you e'er have seen,  
When Phœbus hastens to his pillow,  
The mermaids, with their tresses green,  
Dancing upon the western billow:  
If you have seen, at twilight dim,  
When the lone spirit's vesper hymn  
Floats wild along the winding shore:  
If you have seen, through mist of eve,  
The fairy train their ringlets weave,  
Glancing along the spangled green;—  
If you have seen all this and more,  
God bless me! what a deal you've seen!

*Thomas Moore.*

---

## CIRCUMSTANCE

### THE ORANGE

It ripen'd by the river banks,  
Where, mask and moonlight aiding,  
Dons Blas and Juan play their pranks,  
Dark Donnas serenading.

By Moorish damsel it was pluck'd,  
Beneath the golden day there;

By swain 'twas then in London suck'd—  
Who flung the peel away there.

He could not know in Pimlico,  
As little she in Seville,  
That *I* should reel upon that peel,  
And—wish them at the devil!

*Frederick Locker-Lampson.*

---

## ELEGY

The jackals prowl, the serpents hiss  
In what was once Persepolis.  
Proud Babylon is but a trace  
Upon the desert's dusty face.  
The topless towers of Ilium  
Are ashes. Judah's harp is dumb.  
The fleets of Nineveh and Tyre  
Are down with Davy Jones, Esquire  
And all the oligarchies, kings,  
And potentates that ruled these things  
Are gone! But cheer up; don't be sad;  
Think what a lovely time they had!

*Arthur Guiterman.*

---

## OUR TRAVELLER

If thou would'st stand on Etna's burning brow,  
With smoke above, and roaring flame below;  
And gaze adown that molten gulf reveal'd,  
Till thy soul shudder'd and thy senses reel'd:  
If thou wouldst beard Niag'ra in his pride,  
Or stem the billows of Propontic tide;  
Scale all alone some dizzy Alpine *haut*,  
And shriek "Excelsior!" among the snow:  
Would'st tempt all deaths, all dangers that may be—  
Perils by land, and perils on the sea;  
This vast round world, I say, if thou wouldst view it—  
Then, why the dickens don't you go and do it?

*Henry Cholmondeley-Pennell.*

---

## OPTIMISM

Be brave, faint heart,  
    The dough shall yet be cake;  
Be strong, weak heart,  
    The butter is to come.  
Some cheerful chance will right the apple-cart,  
The devious pig will gain the lucky mart,  
    Loquacity be dumb,—  
    Collapsed the fake.  
Be brave, faint heart!

Be strong, weak heart,  
    The path will be made plain;  
Be brave, faint heart,  
    The bore will crawl away.  
The upside down will turn to right side up,

The stiffened lip compel that slipping cup,  
The doldrums of the day  
Be not in vain.  
Be strong, weak heart!

Be brave, faint heart,  
The jelly means to jell;  
Be strong, weak heart,  
The hopes are in the malt.  
The wrong side in will yet turn right side out,  
The long-time lost come down yon cormorant spout.  
Life still is worth her salt:  
What ends well's well.  
Be brave, faint heart!

*Newton Mackintosh.*

---

## THE DECLARATION

Twas late, and the gay company was gone,  
And light lay soft on the deserted room  
From alabaster vases, and a scent  
Of orange-leaves, and sweet verbena came  
Through the unshutter'd window on the air.  
And the rich pictures with their dark old tints  
Hung like a twilight landscape, and all things  
Seem'd hush'd into a slumber. Isabel,  
The dark-eyed, spiritual Isabel  
Was leaning on her harp, and I had stay'd  
To whisper what I could not when the crowd  
Hung on her look like worshipers. I knelt,

And with the fervor of a lip unused

To the cool breath of reason, told my love.  
There was no answer, and I took the hand  
That rested on the strings, and press'd a kiss  
Upon it unforbidden—and again  
Besought her, that this silent evidence  
That I was not indifferent to her heart,  
Might have the seal of one sweet syllable.  
I kiss'd the small white fingers as I spoke,  
And she withdrew them gently, and upraised  
Her forehead from its resting-place, and look'd  
Earnestly on me—*She had been asleep!*

N. P. Willis.

---

## HE CAME TO PAY

The editor sat with his head in his hands  
And his elbows at rest on his knees;  
He was tired of the ever-increasing demands  
On his time, and he panted for ease.  
The clamor for copy was scorned with a sneer,  
And he sighed in the lowest of tones:  
"Won't somebody come with a dollar to cheer  
The heart of Emanuel Jones?"

Just then on the stairway a footstep was heard  
And a rap-a-tap loud at the door,  
And the flickering hope that had been long deferred  
Blazed up like a beacon once more;  
And there entered a man with a cynical smile  
That was fringed with a stubble of red,  
Who remarked, as he tilted a sorry old tile  
To the back of an average head:

"I have come here to pay"—Here the editor cried:  
"You're as welcome as flowers in spring!  
Sit down in this easy armchair by my side,  
And excuse me awhile till I bring  
A lemonade dashed with a little old wine  
And a dozen cigars of the best....  
Ah! Here we are! This, I assure you, is fine;  
Help yourself, most desirable guest."

The visitor drank with a relish, and smoked  
Till his face wore a satisfied glow,  
And the editor, beaming with merriment, joked  
In a joyous, spontaneous flow;  
And then, when the stock of refreshments was gone,  
His guest took occasion to say,  
In accents distorted somewhat by a yawn,  
"My errand up here is to pay—"

But the generous scribe, with a wave of his hand,  
Put a stop to the speech of his guest,  
And brought in a melon, the finest the land  
Ever bore on its generous breast;  
And the visitor, wearing a singular grin,  
Seized the heaviest half of the fruit,  
And the juice, as it ran in a stream from his chin,  
Washed the mud of the pike from his boot.

Then, mopping his face on a favorite sheet  
Which the scribe had laid carefully by,  
The visitor lazily rose to his feet  
With the dreariest kind of a sigh,  
And he said, as the editor sought his address,  
In his books to discover his due:  
"I came here to pay—my respects to the press,  
And to borrow a dollar of you!"



## **THE FORLORN ONE**

Ah! why those piteous sounds of woe,  
Lone wanderer of the dreary night?  
Thy gushing tears in torrents flow,  
Thy bosom pants in wild affright!

And thou, within whose iron breast  
Those frowns austere too truly tell,  
Mild pity, heaven-descended guest,  
Hath never, never deign'd to dwell.

"That rude, uncivil touch forego,"  
Stern despot of a fleeting hour!  
Nor "make the angels weep" to know  
The fond "fantastic tricks" of power!

Know'st thou not "mercy is not strain'd,  
But droppeth as the gentle dew,"  
And while it blesseth him who gain'd,  
It blesseth him who gave it, too?

Say, what art thou? and what is he,  
Pale victim of despair and pain,  
Whose streaming eyes and bended knee  
Sue to thee thus—and sue in vain?

Cold callous man!—he scorns to yield,  
Or aught relax his felon gripe,  
But answers, "I'm Inspector Field  
And this here warment's prigg'd your wive."

*Richard Harris Barham.*

---

## **RURAL RAPTURES**

'Tis sweet at dewy eve to rove  
When softly sighs the western breeze,  
And wandering 'mid the starlit grove  
To take a pinch of snuff and sneeze.

'Tis sweet to see in daisied field  
The flocks and herds their pleasure take;  
But sweeter are the joys they yield  
In tender chop and juicy steak.

'Tis sweet to hear the murmurous sound  
That from the vocal woods doth rise,  
To mark the pigeons wheeling round,  
And think how nice they'd be in pies.

When nightingales pour from their throats  
Their gushing melody, 'tis sweet;  
Yet sweeter 'tis to catch the notes  
That issue from Threadneedle Street.

*Unknown.*

---

## **A FRAGMENT**

His eye was stern and wild—his cheek was pale and cold as clay;  
Upon his tightened lip a smile of fearful meaning lay.  
He mused awhile—but not in doubt—no trace of doubt was there;  
It was the steady solemn pause of resolute despair.  
Once more he looked upon the scroll—once more its words he read—  
Then calmly, with unflinching hand, its folds before him spread.  
I saw him bare his throat, and seize the blue-cold gleaming steel,  
And grimly try the tempered edge he was so soon to feel!  
A sickness crept upon my heart, and dizzy swam my head—  
I could not stir—I could not cry—I felt benumbed and dead;  
Black icy horrors struck me dumb, and froze my senses o'er;  
I closed my eyes in utter fear, and strove to think no more.

Again I looked: a fearful change across his face had passed—  
He seemed to rave—on cheek and lip a flaky foam was cast;  
He raised on high the glittering blade—then first I found a tongue—  
"Hold, madman! stay thy frantic deed!" I cried, and forth I sprung;  
He heard me, but he heeded not; one glance around he gave,  
And ere I could arrest his hands, he had—begun to *shave*!

*Unknown.*

---

## THE BITER BIT

The sun is in the sky, mother, the flowers are springing fair,  
And the melody of woodland birds is stirring in the air;  
The river, smiling to the sky, glides onward to the sea,  
And happiness is everywhere, oh, mother, but with me!

They are going to the church, mother—I hear the marriage bell  
It booms along the upland—oh! it haunts me like a knell;  
He leads her on his arm, mother, he cheers her faltering step,

And closely to his side she clings—she does, the demirep!

They are crossing by the stile, mother, where we so oft have stood,  
The stile beside the shady thorn, at the corner of the wood;  
And the boughs, that wont to murmur back the words that won my ear,  
Wave their silver branches o'er him, as he leads his bridal fere.

He will pass beside the stream, mother, where first my hand he pressed,  
By the meadow where, with quivering lip, his passion he confessed;  
And down the hedgerows where we've strayed again and yet again;  
But he will not think of me, mother, his broken-hearted Jane!

He said that I was proud, mother, that I looked for rank and gold,  
He said I did not love him—he said my words were cold;  
He said I kept him off and on, in hopes of higher game—  
And it may be that I did, mother; but who hasn't done the same.

I did not know my heart, mother—I know it now too late;  
I thought that I without a pang could wed some nobler mate;  
But no nobler suitor sought me—and he has taken wing,  
And my heart is gone, and I am left a lone and blighted thing.

You may lay me in my bed, mother—my head is throbbing sore;  
And, mother, prithee, let the sheets be duly aired before;  
And, if you'd please, my mother dear, your poor desponding child,  
Draw me a pot of beer, mother, and, mother, draw it mild!

*William E. Aytoun.*

---

## COMFORT IN AFFLICTION

"Wherefore starts my bosom's lord?  
Why this anguish in thine eye?

Oh, it seems as thy heart's chord  
Had broken with that sigh!

"Rest thee, my dear lord, I pray,  
Rest thee on my bosom now!  
And let me wipe the dew away,  
Are gathering on thy brow.

"There, again! that fevered start!  
What, love! husband! is thy pain?  
There is a sorrow in thy heart,  
A weight upon thy brain!

"Nay, nay, that sickly smile can ne'er  
Deceive affection's searching eye;  
'Tis a wife's duty, love, to share  
Her husband's agony.

"Since the dawn began to peep,  
Have I lain with stifled breath;  
Heard thee moaning in thy sleep,  
As thou wert at grips with death.

"Oh, what joy it was to see  
My gentle lord once more awake!  
Tell me, what is amiss with thee?  
Speak, or my heart will break!"

"Mary, thou angel of my life,  
Thou ever good and kind;  
'Tis not, believe me, my dear wife,  
The anguish of the mind!

"It is not in my bosom, dear,  
No, nor in my brain, in sooth;  
But, Mary, oh, I feel it here,  
Here in my wisdom tooth!

"Then give,—oh, first, best antidote,—  
Sweet partner of my bed!  
Give me thy flannel petticoat  
To wrap around my head!"

*William E. Aytoun.*

---

## **THE HUSBAND'S PETITION**

Come hither, my heart's darling,  
Come, sit upon my knee,  
And listen, while I whisper,  
A boon I ask of thee.  
You need not pull my whiskers  
So amorously, my dove;  
'Tis something quite apart from  
The gentle cares of love.

I feel a bitter craving—  
A dark and deep desire,  
That glows beneath my bosom  
Like coals of kindled fire.  
The passion of the nightingale,  
When singing to the rose,  
Is feebler than the agony  
That murders my repose!

Nay, dearest! do not doubt me,  
Though madly thus I speak—  
I feel thy arms about me,  
Thy tresses on my cheek:  
I know the sweet devotion

That links thy heart with mine—  
I know my soul's emotion  
Is doubly felt by thine:

And deem not that a shadow  
Hath fallen across my love:  
No, sweet, my love is shadowless,  
As yonder heaven above.  
These little taper fingers—  
Ah! Jane, how white they be!—  
Can well supply the cruel want  
That almost maddens me.

Thou wilt not sure deny me  
My first and fond request;  
I pray thee, by the memory  
Of all we cherish best—  
By all the dear remembrance  
Of those delicious days,  
When, hand in hand, we wandered  
Along the summer braes:

By all we felt, unspoken,  
When 'neath the early moon,  
We sat beside the rivulet,  
In the leafy month of June;  
And by the broken whisper,  
That fell upon my ear,  
More sweet than angel-music,  
When first I woo'd thee, dear!

By that great vow which bound thee  
Forever to my side,  
And by the ring that made thee  
My darling and my bride!  
Thou wilt not fail nor falter,  
But bend thee to the task—

A BOILED SHEEP'S HEAD ON SUNDAY  
Is all the boon I ask.

*William E. Aytoun.*

---

## **Lines Written After a Battle**

**By an Assistant Surgeon of the Nineteenth Nankeens**

Stiff are the warrior's muscles,  
Congeal'd, alas! his chyle;  
No more in hostile tussles  
Will he excite his bile.  
Dry is the epidermis,  
A vein no longer bleeds—  
And the communis vermis  
Upon the warrior feeds.

Compress'd, alas! the thorax,  
That throbb'd with joy or pain;  
Not e'en a dose of borax  
Could make it throb again.  
Dried up the warrior's throat is,  
All shatter'd too, his head:  
Still is the epiglottis—  
The warrior is dead.

*Unknown.*

---



## LINES

**ADDRESSED TO \*\* \*\*\*\*\* ON THE 29TH OF SEPTEMBER,  
WHEN WE PARTED FOR THE LAST TIME**

I have watch'd thee with rapture, and dwelt on thy charms,  
As link'd in Love's fetters we wander'd each day;  
And each night I have sought a new life in thy arms,  
And sigh'd that our union could last not for aye.

But thy life now depends on a frail silken thread,  
Which I even by kindness may cruelly sever,  
And I look to the moment of parting with dread,  
For I feel that in parting I lose thee forever.

Sole being that cherish'd my poor troubled heart!  
Thou know'st all its secrets—each joy and each grief;  
And in sharing them all thou did'st ever impart  
To its sorrows a gentle and soothing relief.

The last of a long and affectionate race,  
As thy days are declining I love thee the more,  
For I feel that thy loss I can never replace—  
That thy death will but leave me to weep and deplore.

Unchanged, thou shalt live in the mem'ry of years,  
I cannot—I will not—forget what thou wert!  
While the thoughts of thy love as they call forth my tears,  
In fancy will wash thee once more—MY LAST SHIRT.

*Unknown.*

---

**THE IMAGINATIVE CRISIS**

Oh, solitude! thou wonder-working fay,  
Come nurse my feeble fancy in your arms,  
Though I, and thee, and fancy town-pent lay,  
Come, call around, a world of country charms.  
Let all this room, these walls dissolve away,  
And bring me Surrey's fields to take their place:  
This floor be grass, and draughts as breezes play;  
Yon curtains trees, to wave in summer's face;  
My ceiling, sky; my water-jug a stream;  
My bed, a bank, on which to muse and dream.  
The spell is wrought: imagination swells  
My sleeping-room to hills, and woods, and dells!  
I walk abroad, for naught my footsteps hinder,  
And fling my arms. Oh! mi! I've broke the *winder*!

*Unknown.*

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# PARODY

## THE HIGHER PANTHEISM IN A NUTSHELL

One, who is not, we see; but one, whom we see not, is;  
Surely, this is not that; but that is assuredly this.

What, and wherefore, and whence: for under is over and under;  
If thunder could be without lightning, lightning could be without thunder.

Doubt is faith in the main; but faith, on the whole, is doubt;  
We cannot believe by proof; but could we believe without?

Why, and whither, and how? for barley and rye are not clover;  
Neither are straight lines curves; yet over is under and over.

One and two are not one; but one and nothing is two;  
Truth can hardly be false, if falsehood cannot be true.

Parallels all things are; yet many of these are askew;  
You are certainly I; but certainly I am not you.

One, whom we see not, is; and one, who is not, we see;  
Fiddle, we know, is diddle; and diddle, we take it, is dee.

*Algernon Charles Swinburne.*

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**NEPHELIDIA**

From the depth of the dreamy decline of the dawn through a notable  
nimbus of nebulous moonshine,  
Pallid and pink as the palm of the flag-flower that flickers with fear of  
the flies as they float,  
Are they looks of our lovers that lustrously lean from a marvel of mystic  
miraculous moonshine,  
These that we feel in the blood of our blushes that thicken and threaten  
with throbs through the throat?  
Thicken and thrill as a theatre thronged at appeal of an actor's appalled  
agitation,  
Fainter with fear of the fires of the future than pale with the promise of  
pride in the past;  
Flushed with the famishing fulness of fever that reddens with radiance of  
rather recreation,  
Gaunt as the ghastliest of glimpses that gleam through the gloom of the  
gloaming when ghosts go aghast?  
Nay, for the nick of the tick of the time is a tremulous touch on the temples  
of terror,  
Strained as the sinews yet strenuous with strife of the dead who is dumb  
as the dust-heaps of death;  
Surely no soul is it, sweet as the spasm of erotic emotional exquisite error,  
Bathed in the balms of beatified bliss, beatific itself by beatitude's  
breath.  
Surely no spirit or sense of a soul that was soft to the spirit and soul of our  
senses  
Sweetens the stress of surprising suspicion that sobs in the semblance  
and sound of a sigh;  
Only this oracle opens Olympian, in mystical moods and triangular tenses,  
—  
"Life is the lust of a lamp for the light that is dark till the dawn of the  
day when we die."  
Mild is the mirk and monotonous music of memory, melodiously mute as it  
may be,  
While the hope in the heart of a hero is bruised by the breach of men's  
rapiers, resigned to the rod;  
Made meek as a mother whose bosom-beats bound with the bliss-bringing  
bulk of a balm-breathing baby,

As they grope through the grave-yard of creeds, under skies growing  
green at a groan for the grimness of God.  
Blank is the book of his bounty beholden of old, and its binding is blacker  
than bluer:  
Out of blue into black is the scheme of the skies, and their dewes are the  
wine of the bloodshed of things:  
Till the darkling desire of delight shall be free as a fawn that is freed from  
the fangs that pursue her,  
Till the heart-beats of hell shall be hushed by a hymn from the hunt that  
has harried the kennel of kings.

*Algernon Charles Swinburne.*

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## UP THE SPOUT

### I

Hi! Just you drop that! Stop, I say!  
Shirk work, think slink off, twist friend's wrist?  
Where that spined sand's lined band's the bay—  
Lined blind with true sea's blue, as due—  
Promising—not to pay?

### II

For the sea's debt leaves wet the sand;  
Burst worst fate's weight's in one burst gun?  
A man's own yacht, blown—What? off land?  
Tack back, or veer round here, then—queer!  
Reef points, though—understand?

### III

I'm blest if I do. Sigh? be blowed!  
Love's doves make break life's ropes, eh? Tropes!  
Faith's brig, baulked, sides caulked, rides at road;

Hope's gropes befogged, storm-dogged and bogged—  
Clogged, water-logged, her load!

IV

Stowed, by Jove, right and tight, away.  
No show now how best plough sea's brow,  
Wrinkling—breeze quick, tease thick, ere day,  
Clear sheer wave's sheen of green, I mean,  
With twinkling wrinkles—eh?

V

Sea sprinkles wrinkles, tinkles light  
Shells' bells—boy's joys that hap to snap!  
It's just sea's fun, breeze done, to spite  
God's rods that scourge her surge, I'd urge—  
Not proper, is it—quite?

VI

See, fore and aft, life's craft undone!  
Crank plank, split spritsail—mark, sea's lark!  
That gray cold sea's old sprees, begun  
When men lay dark i' the ark, no spark,  
All water—just God's fun!

VII

Not bright, at best, his jest to these  
Seemed—screamed, shrieked, wreaked on kin for sin!  
When for mirth's yell earth's knell seemed please  
Some dumb new grim great whim in him  
Made Jews take chalk for cheese.

VIII

Could God's rods bruise God's Jews? Their jowls  
Bobbed, sobbed, gaped, aped, the plaice in face!  
None heard, 'tis odds, his—God's—folk's howls.  
Now, how must I apply, to try  
This hookiest-beaked of owls?

IX

Well, I suppose God knows—I don't.

Time's crimes mark dark men's types, in stripes  
Broad as fen's lands men's hands were wont

Leave grieve unploughed, though proud and loud  
With birds' words—No! he won't!

X

One never should think good impossible.

Eh? say I'd hide this Jew's oil's cruse—  
His shop might hold bright gold, engrossible

By spy—spring's air takes there no care  
To wave the heath-flower's glossy bell!

XI

But gold bells chime in time there, coined—

Gold! Old Sphinx winks there—"Read my screed!"  
Doctrine Jews learn, use, burn for, joined  
(Through new craft's stealth) with health and wealth—  
At once all three purloined!

XII

I rose with dawn, to pawn, no doubt,

(Miss this chance, glance untried aside?)  
John's shirt, my—no! Ay, so—the lout!

Let yet the door gape, store on floor  
And not a soul about?

XIII

Such men lay traps, perhaps—and I'm

Weak—meek—mild—child of woe, you know!  
But theft, I doubt, my lout calls crime.

Shrink? Think! Love's dawn in pawn—you spawn  
Of Jewry! Just in time!

*Algernon Charles Swinburne.*



---

## IN IMMEMORIAM

We seek to know, and knowing seek;  
We seek, we know, and every sense  
Is trembling with the great Intense  
And vibrating to what we speak.

We ask too much, we seek too oft,  
We know enough, and should no more;  
And yet we skim through Fancy's lore  
And look to earth and not aloft.

A something comes from out the gloom;  
I know it not, nor seek to know;  
I only see it swell and grow,  
And more than this world would presume.

Meseems, a circling void I fill,  
And I, unchanged where all is changed;  
It seems unreal; I own it strange,  
Yet nurse the thoughts I cannot kill.

I hear the ocean's surging tide,  
Raise quiring on its carol-tune;  
I watch the golden-sickled moon,  
And clearer voices call beside.

O Sea! whose ancient ripples lie  
On red-ribbed sands where seaweeds shone;  
O Moon! whose golden sickle's gone;  
O Voices all! like ye I die!

*Cuthbert Bede.*

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## LUCY LAKE

Poor Lucy Lake was overgrown,  
But somewhat underbrained.  
She did not know enough, I own,  
To go in when it rained.

Yet Lucy was constrained to go;  
Green bedding,—you infer.  
Few people knew she died, but oh,  
The difference to her!

*Newton Mackintosh.*

---

## THE COCK AND THE BULL

You see this pebble-stone? It's a thing I bought  
Of a bit of a chit of a boy i' the mid o' the day—  
I like to dock the smaller parts-o'-speech,  
As we curtail the already cur-tailed cur  
(You catch the paronomasia, play 'po' words?)  
Did, rather, i' the pre-Landseerian days.  
Well, to my muttons. I purchased the concern,  
And clapt it i' my poke, having given for same  
By way o' chop, swop, barter or exchange—  
"Chop" was my snickering dandiprat's own term—  
One shilling and fourpence, current coin o' the realm.  
O-n-e one and f-o-u-r four  
Pence, one and fourpence—you are with me, sir?—  
What hour it skills not: ten or eleven o' the clock,

One day (and what a roaring day it was  
Go shop or sight-see—bar a spit o' rain!)  
In February, eighteen sixty nine,  
Alexandrina Victoria, Fidei,  
Hm—hm—how runs the jargon? being on the throne.

Such, sir, are all the facts, succinctly put,  
The basis or substratum—what you will—  
Of the impending eighty thousand lines.  
"Not much in 'em either," quoth perhaps simple Hodge.  
But there's a superstructure. Wait a bit.

Mark first the rationale of the thing:  
Hear logic rivel and levigate the deed.  
That shilling—and for matter o' that, the pence—  
I had o' course upo' me—wi' me say—  
(*Mecum's* the Latin, make a note o' that)  
When I popp'd pen i' stand, scratched ear, wiped snout,

(Let everybody wipe his own himself)  
Sniff'd—tch!—at snuffbox; tumbled up, he-heed,  
Haw-haw'd (not he-haw'd, that's another guess thing):  
Then fumbled at, and stumbled out of, door,  
I shoved the timber ope wi' my omoplat;  
And *in vestibulo*, i' the lobby to-wit,  
(*Iacobi Facciolati's* rendering, sir,)  
Donned galligaskins, antigropeloes,  
And so forth; and, complete with hat and gloves,  
One on and one a-dangle i' in my hand,  
And ombrifuge (Lord love you!) cas o' rain,  
I flopped forth, 'sbuddikins! on my own ten toes,  
(I do assure you there be ten of them)  
And went clump-clumping up hill and down dale  
To find myself o' the sudden i' front o' the boy.  
Put case I hadn't 'em on me, could I ha' bought  
This sort-o'-kind-o'-what-you-might-call-toy,  
This pebble-thing, o' the boy-thing? Q. E. D.

That's proven without aid for mumping Pope,  
Sleek porporate or bloated cardinal.  
(Isn't it, old Fatchops? You're in Euclid now.)  
So, having the shilling—having i' fact a lot—  
And pence and halfpence, ever so many o' them,  
I purchased, as I think I said before,  
The pebble (*lapis, lapidis, di, dem, de*—  
What nouns 'crease short i' the genitive, Fatchops, eh?)  
O, the boy, a bare-legg'd beggarly son of a gun,  
For one-and-fourpence. Here we are again.  
Now Law steps in, bewigged, voluminous-jaw'd;  
Investigates and re-investigates.  
Was the transaction illegal? Law shakes head.  
Perpend, sir, all the bearings of the case.

At first the coin was mine, the chattel his.  
But now (by virtue of the said exchange  
And barter) *vice versa* all the coin,  
*Rer juris operationem*, vests  
I' the boy and his assigns till ding o' doom;  
*In sæcula sæculo-o-orum*;  
(I think I hear the Abate mouth out that.)  
To have and hold the same to him and them ...  
Confer some idiot on Conveyancing.  
Whereas the pebble and every part thereof,  
And all that appertaineth thereunto,  
*Quodcunque pertinet ad em rem*,  
(I fancy, sir, my Latin's rather pat)  
Or shall, will, may, might, can, could, would, or should,  
*Subaudi cætera*—clap we to the close—  
For what's the good of law in such a case o' the kind  
Is mine to all intents and purposes.  
This settled, I resume the thread o' the tale.

Now for a touch o' the vendor's quality.  
He says a gen'lman bought a pebble of him,  
(This pebble i' sooth, sir, which I hold i' my hand)—

And paid for 't, *like* a gen'lman, on the nail.  
"Did I o'ercharge him a ha'penny? Devil a bit.  
Fiddlepin's end! Get out, you blazing ass!  
Gabble o' the goose. Don't bugaboo-baby *me*!  
Go double or quits? Yah! tittup! what's the odds?"  
—There's the transaction viewed in the vendor's light.

Next ask that dumped hag, stood snuffling by,  
With her three frowsy blowsy brats o' babes,  
The scum o' the Kennel, cream o' the filth-heap—Faugh!  
Aie, aie, aie, aie! [Greek: otototototoi],  
(‘Stead which we blurt out, Hoighty toighty now)—  
And the baker and candlestick maker, and Jack and Gill.  
Blear'd Goody this and queasy Gaffer that,  
Ask the Schoolmaster, Take Schoolmaster first.  
He saw a gentleman purchase of a lad  
A stone, and pay for it *rite* on the square,  
And carry it off *per saltum*, jauntily  
*Propria quæ maribus*, gentleman's property now  
(Agreeable to the law explained above).  
*In proprium usum*, for his private ends,  
The boy he chucked a brown i' the air, and bit  
I' the face the shilling; heaved a thumping stone  
At a lean hen that ran cluck-clucking by,  
(And hit her, dead as nail i' post o' door,)  
Then *abiit*—What's the Ciceronian phrase?  
*Excessit, evasit, erupit*—off slogs boy;

Off like bird, *avi similis*—(you observed  
The dative? Pretty i' the Mantuan!)—*Anglice*  
Off in three flea skips. *Hactenus*, so far,  
So good, *tam bene. Bene, satis, male*,—  
Where was I with my trope 'bout one in a quag?  
I did once hitch the Syntax into verse  
*Verbum personale*, a verb personal,  
*Concordat*—ay, "agrees," old Fatchops—*cum*  
*Nominativo*, with its nominative,

*Genere*, i' point of gender, *numero*,  
O' number, *et persona*, and person. *Ut*,  
Instance: *Sol ruit*, down flops sun, *et* and,  
*Montes umbrantur*, out flounce mountains. Pah!  
Excuse me, sir, I think I'm going mad.

You see the trick on't, though, and can yourself  
Continue the discourse *ad libitum*.  
It takes up about eighty thousand lines,  
A thing imagination boggles at;  
And might, odds-bobs, sir! in judicious hands  
Extend from here to Mesopotamy.

*Charles Stuart Calverley.*

---

## BALLAD

The auld wife sat at her ivied door,  
    *(Butter and eggs and a pound of cheese)*  
A thing she had frequently done before;  
    And her spectacles lay on her apron'd knees.

The piper he piped on the hilltop high,  
    *(Butter and eggs and a pound of cheese)*  
Till the cow said "I die," and the goose asked "Why?"  
    And the dog said nothing, but search'd for fleas.

The farmer he strode through the square farmyard;  
    *(Butter and eggs and a pound of cheese)*  
His last brew of ale was a trifle hard—  
    The connection of which the plot one sees.

The farmer's daughter hath frank blue eyes;  
    *(Butter and eggs and a pound of cheese)*  
She hears the rooks caw in the windy skies,  
    As she sits at her lattice and shells her peas.

The farmer's daughter hath ripe red lips;  
    *(Butter and eggs and a pound of cheese)*  
If you try to approach her, away she skips  
    Over tables and chairs with apparent ease.

The farmer's daughter hath soft brown hair;  
    *(Butter and eggs and a pound of cheese)*  
And I met with a ballad, I can't say where,  
    Which wholly consisted of lines like these.

## PART II

She sat with her hands 'neath her dimpled cheeks,  
    *(Butter and eggs and a pound of cheese)*

And spake not a word. While a lady speaks  
There is hope, but she didn't even sneeze.

She sat, with her hands 'neath her crimson cheeks;  
*(Butter and eggs and a pound of cheese)*  
She gave up mending her father's breeks,  
And let the cat roll in her new chemise.

She sat with her hands 'neath her burning cheeks,  
*(Butter and eggs and a pound of cheese)*  
And gazed at the piper for thirteen weeks;  
Then she follow'd him o'er the misty leas.

Her sheep follow'd her, as their tails did them,  
*(Butter and eggs and a pound of cheese)*  
And this song is consider'd a perfect gem,  
And as to the meaning, it's what you please.

*Charles Stuart Calverley.*

---

## DISASTER

'Twas ever thus from childhood's hour!  
My fondest hopes would not decay;  
I never loved a tree or flower  
Which was the first to fade away!  
The garden, where I used to delve  
Short-frock'd, still yields me pinks in plenty;  
The pear-tree that I climbed at twelve  
I see still blossoming, at twenty.

I never nursed a dear gazelle;  
But I was given a parroquet—



(How I did nurse him if unwell!)  
He's imbecile, but lingers yet.  
He's green, with an enchanting tuft;  
He melts me with his small black eye;  
He'd look inimitable stuffed,  
And knows it—but he will not die!

I had a kitten—I was rich  
In pets—but all too soon my kitten  
Became a full-sized cat, by which  
I've more than once been scratched and bitten  
And when for sleep her limbs she curl'd  
One day beside her untouch'd plateful,  
And glided calmly from the world,  
I freely own that I was grateful.

And then I bought a dog—a queen!  
Ah, Tiny, dear departing pug!  
She lives, but she is past sixteen  
And scarce can crawl across the rug.  
I loved her beautiful and kind;  
Delighted in her pert bow-wow;  
But now she snaps if you don't mind;  
'Twere lunacy to love her now.

I used to think, should e'er mishap  
Betide my crumple-visaged Ti,  
In shape of prowling thief, or trap,  
Or coarse bull-terrier—I should die.  
But ah! disasters have their use,  
And life might e'en be too sunshiny;  
Nor would I make myself a goose,  
If some big dog should swallow Tiny.

*Charles Stuart Calverley.*

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## WORDSWORTHIAN REMINISCENCE

I walked and came upon a picket fence,  
And every picket went straight up and down,  
And all at even intervals were placed,  
All painted green, all pointed at the top,  
And every one inextricably nailed  
Unto two several cross-beams, which did go,  
Not as the pickets, but quite otherwise,  
And they two crossed, but back of all were posts.

O beauteous picket fence, can I not draw  
Instruction from thee? Yea, for thou dost teach,  
That even as the pickets are made fast  
To that which seems all at cross purposes,  
So are our human lives, to the Divine,  
But, oh! not purposeless, for even as they  
Do keep stray cows from trespass, we, no doubt,  
Together guard some plan of Deity.

Thus did I moralise. And from the beams  
And pickets drew a lesson to myself,—  
But where the posts came in, I could not tell.

*Unknown.*

---

## INSPECT US

Out of the clothes that cover me  
Tight as the skin is on the grape,  
I thank whatever gods may be  
For my unconquerable shape.

In the fell clutch of bone and steel  
I have not whined nor cried aloud;  
Whatever else I may conceal,  
I show my thoughts unshamed and proud.

The forms of other actorines  
I put away into the shade;  
All of them flossy near-blondines  
Find and shall find me unafraid.

It matters not how straight the tape,  
How cold the weather is, or warm—  
I am the mistress of my shape—  
I am the captain of my form.

*Edith Daniell.*

---

## **THE MESSED DAMOZEL**

### **AT THE CUBIST EXHIBITION**

The Messed Damozel leaned out  
From the gold cube of Heav'n;  
There were three cubes within her hands,  
And the cubes in her hair were seven;  
I looked, and looked, and looked, and looked—  
I could not see her, even.

Her robe, a cube from clasp to hem,  
Was moderately clear;  
Methought I saw two cubic eyes,  
When I had looked a year;

But when I turned to tell the world,  
Those eyes did disappear!

It was the rampart of some house  
That she was standing on;  
That much, at least, was plain to me  
As her I gazed upon;  
But even as I gazed, alas!  
The rampart, too, was gone!

(I saw her smile!) Oh, no, I didn't,  
Though long mine eyes did stare;  
The cubes closed down and shut her out;  
I wept in deep despair;  
But this I know, and know full well—  
*She simply wasn't there!*

*Charles Hanson Towne.*

---

## **A MELTON MOWBRAY PORK-PIE**

Strange pie that is almost a passion,  
O passion immoral for pie!  
Unknown are the ways that they fashion,  
Unknown and unseen of the eye.  
The pie that is marbled and mottled,  
The pie that digests with a sigh:  
For all is not Bass that is bottled,  
And all is not pork that is pie.

*Richard Le Gallienne.*

---

## ISRAFIDDLESTRINGS

In heaven a Spirit doth dwell  
Whose heart strings are a fiddle,  
(The reason he sings so well—  
This fiddler Israfel),  
And the giddy stars (will any one tell  
Why giddy?) to attend his spell  
Cease their hymns in the middle.

On the height of her go  
Totters the Moon, and blushes  
As the song of that fiddle rushes  
Across her bow.  
The red Lightning stands to listen,  
And the eyes of the Pleiads glisten  
As each of the seven puts its fist in  
Its eye, for the mist in.

And they say—it's a riddle—  
That all these listening things,  
That stop in the middle  
For the heart-strung fiddle  
With such the Spirit sings,  
Are held as on the griddle  
By these unusual strings.

Wherefore thou art not wrong,  
Israfel! in that thou boastest  
Fiddlestrings uncommon strong;  
To thee the fiddlestrings belong  
With which thou toastest  
Other hearts as on a prong.

Yes! heaven is thine, but this  
Is a world of sours and sweets,

Where cold meats are cold meats,  
And the eater's most perfect bliss  
Is the shadow of him who treats.

If I could griddle  
As Israfiddle  
Has griddled—he fiddle as I,—  
He might not fiddle so wild a riddle  
As this mad melody,  
While the Pleiads all would leave off in the middle  
Hearing my griddle-cry.

*Unknown.*

---

## AFTER DILETTANTE CONCETTI

"Why do you wear your hair like a man,  
Sister Helen?  
This week is the third since you began."  
"I'm writing a ballad; be still if you can,  
Little brother.  
(O Mother Carey, mother!  
What chickens are these between sea and heaven?)"

"But why does your figure appear so lean,  
Sister Helen?  
And why do you dress in sage, sage green?"  
"Children should never be heard, if seen,  
Little brother?  
(O Mother Carey, mother!  
What fowls are a-wing in the stormy heaven!)"

"But why is your face so yellowy white,

Sister Helen?  
And why are your skirts so funnily tight?"  
"Be quiet, you torment, or how can I write,  
Little brother?  
(O Mother Carey, mother!  
How gathers thy train to the sea from the heaven!)"

"And who's Mother Carey, and what is her train,  
Sister Helen?  
And why do you call her again and again?"  
"You troublesome boy, why that's the refrain,  
Little brother.  
(O Mother Carey, mother!  
What work is toward in the startled heaven?)"

"And what's a refrain? What a curious word,  
Sister Helen!  
Is the ballad you're writing about a sea-bird?"  
"Not at all; why should it be? Don't be absurd,  
Little brother.  
(O Mother Carey, mother!  
Thy brood flies lower as lowers the heaven.)"

(A big brother speaketh:)  
"The refrain you've studied a meaning had,  
Sister Helen!  
It gave strange force to a weird ballad.  
But refrains have become a ridiculous 'fad,'  
Little brother.  
And Mother Carey, mother,  
Has a bearing on nothing in earth or heaven.

"But the finical fashion has had its day,  
Sister Helen.  
And let's try in the style of a different lay  
To bid it adieu in poetical way,  
Little brother.

So, Mother Carey, mother!  
Collect your chickens and go to—heaven."

*(A pause. Then the big brother singeth, accompanying himself in a plaintive wise on the triangle.)*

"Look in my face. My name is Used-to-was;  
I am also called Played-out, and Done to Death,  
And It-will-wash-no-more. Awakeneth  
Slowly but sure awakening it has,  
The common-sense of man; and I, alas!  
The ballad-burden trick, now known too well,  
And turned to scorn, and grown contemptible—  
A too transparent artifice to pass.

"What a cheap dodge I am! The cats who dart  
Tin-kettled through the streets in wild surprise  
Assail judicious ears not otherwise;  
And yet no critics praise the urchin's 'art,'  
Who to the wretched creature's caudal part  
Its foolish empty-jingling 'burden' ties."

*H. D. Traill.*

---

## **WHENCENESS OF THE WHICH**

### **SOME DISTANCE AFTER TENNYSON**

Come into the Whenceness Which,  
For the fierce Because has flown:  
Come into the Whenceness Which,  
I am here by the Where alone;  
And the Whereas odors are wafted abroad



Till I hold my nose and groan.

Queen Which of the Whichbud garden of What's  
Come hither the jig is done.  
In gloss of Isness and shimmer of Was,  
Queen Thisness and Which in one;  
Shine out, little Which, sunning over the bangs,  
To the Nowness, and be its sun.

There has fallen a splendid tear  
From the Is flower at the fence;  
She is coming, my Which, my dear,  
And as she Whistles a song of the Whence,  
The Nowness cries, "She is near, she is near."  
And the Thingness howls, "Alas!"  
The Whoness murmurs, "Well, I should smile,"  
And the Whatlet sobs, "I pass."

*Unknown.*

---

## THE LITTLE STAR

Scintillate, scintillate, globule orific,  
Fain would I fathom thy nature's specific.  
Loftily poised in ether capacious,  
Strongly resembling a gem carbonaceous.

When torrid Phœbus refuses his presence  
And ceases to lamp with fierce incandescence,  
Then you illumine the regions supernal,  
Scintillate, scintillate, semper nocturnal.

Then the victim of hospiceless peregrination

Gratefully hails your minute coruscation.  
He could not determine his journey's direction  
But for your bright scintillating protection.

*Unknown.*

---

## THE ORIGINAL LAMB

Oh, Mary had a little Lamb, regarding whose cuticular  
The fluff exterior was white and kinked in each particular.  
On each occasion when the lass was seen perambulating,  
The little quadruped likewise was there a gallivating.

One day it did accompany her to the knowledge dispensary,  
Which to every rule and precedent was recklessly contrary.  
Immediately whereupon the pedagogue superior,  
Exasperated, did eject the lamb from the interior.

Then Mary, on beholding such performance arbitrary,  
Suffused her eyes with saline drops from glands called lachrymary,  
And all the pupils grew thereat tumultuously hilarious,  
And speculated on the case with wild conjectures various.

"What makes the lamb love Mary so?" the scholars asked the teacher.  
He paused a moment, then he tried to diagnose the creature.

"Oh pecus amorem Mary habit omnia temporum."

"Thanks, teacher dear," the scholars cried, and awe crept darkly o'er 'em.

*Unknown.*

---

## SAINTE MARGÉRIE

Slim feet than lilies tenderer,—

*Margérie!*

That scarce upbore the body of her,

Naked upon the stones they were;—

*C'est ça Sainte Margérie!*

White as a shroud the silken gown,—

*Margérie!*

That flowed from shoulder to ankle down,

With clear blue shadows along it thrown;

*C'est ça Sainte Margérie!*

On back and bosom withouten braid,—

*Margérie!*

In crispèd glory of darkling red,

Round creamy temples her hair was shed;—

*C'est ça Sainte Margérie!*

Eyes, like a dim sea, viewed from far,—

*Margérie!*

Lips that no earthly love shall mar,

More sweet than lips of mortals are;—

*C'est ça Sainte Margérie!*

The chamber walls are cracked and bare;—

*Margérie!*

Without the gossips stood astare

At men her bed away that bare;—

*C'est ça Sainte Margérie!*

Five pennies lay her hand within,—

*Margérie!*

So she her fair soul's weal might win,

Little she reck'd of dule or teen;—

*C'est ça Sainte Margérie!*

Dank straw from dunghill gathered,—

*Margérie!*

Where fragrant swine have made their bed,

Thereon her body shall be laid;—

*C'est ça Sainte Margérie!*

Three pennies to the poor in dole,—

*Margérie!*

One to the clerk her knell shall toll,

And one to masses for her soul;—

*C'est ça Sainte Margérie!*

*Unknown.*

---

## **ROBERT FROST**

### **RELATES THE DEATH OF THE TIRED MAN**

There were two of us left in the berry-patch;  
Bryan O'Lin and Jack had gone to Norwich.—  
They called him Jack a' Nory, half in fun  
And half because it seemed to anger him.—  
So there we stood and let the berries go,  
Talking of men we knew and had forgotten.  
A sprawling, humpbacked mountain frowned on us  
And blotted out a smouldering sunset cloud  
That broke in fiery ashes. "Well," he said,  
"Old Adam Brown is dead and gone; you'll never  
See him any more. He used to wear  
A long, brown coat that buttoned down before.  
That's all I ever knew of him; I guess that's all

That anyone remembers. Eh?" he said,  
And then, without a pause to let me answer,  
He went right on.

"How about Dr. Foster?"

"Well, how *about* him?" I managed to reply.  
He glared at me for having interrupted.  
And stopped to pick his words before he spoke;  
Like one who turns all personal remarks  
Into a general survey of the world.  
Choosing his phrases with a finicky care  
So they might fit some vague opinions,  
Taken, third-hand, from last year's *New York Times*  
And jumbled all together into a thing  
He thought was his philosophy.

"Never mind;

There's more in Foster than you'd understand.  
But," he continued, darkly as before,  
"What do you make of Solomon Grundy's case?  
You know the gossip when he first came here.  
Folks said he'd gone to smash in Lunenburg,  
And four years in the State Asylum here  
Had almost finished him. It was Sanders' job  
That put new life in him. A clear, cool day;  
The second Monday in July it was.  
'Born on a Monday,' that is what they said.  
Remember the next few days? I guess you don't;  
That was before your time. Well, Tuesday night  
He said he'd go to church; and just before the prayer  
He blurts right out, 'I've come here to get christened.  
If I am going to have a brand new life  
I'll have a new name, too.' Well, sure enough  
They christened him, though I've forgotten what;  
And Etta Stark, (you know, the pastor's girl)  
Her head upset by what she called romance,  
She went and married him on Wednesday noon.  
Thursday the sun or something in the air  
Got in his blood and right off he took sick.

Friday the thing got worse, and so did he;  
And Saturday at four o'clock he died.  
Buried on Sunday with the town decked out  
As if it was a circus-day. And not a soul  
Knew why they went or what he meant to them  
Or what he died of. What would be *your* guess?"  
"Well," I replied, "it seems to me that he,  
Just coming from a sedentary life,  
Felt a great wave of energy released,  
And tried to crowd too much in one short week.  
The laws of physics teach—"   
"No, not at all.  
He never knew 'em. He was just tired," he said.

*Louis Untermeyer.*

---

## OWEN SEAMAN

**ESTABLISHES THE "ENTENTE CORDIALE" BY RECITING  
"THE SINGULAR STUPIDITY OF J. SPRATT, ESQ.," IN THE  
MANNER OF GUY WETMORE CARRYL.**

Of all the mismated pairs ever created  
The worst of the lot were the Spratts.  
Their life was a series of quibbles and queries  
And quarrels and squabbles and spats.  
They argued at breakfast, they argued at tea,  
And they argued from midnight to quarter past three.

The family Spratt-head was rather a fat-head,  
And a bellicose body to boot.  
He was selfish and priggish and worse, he was piggish—  
A regular beast of a brute.

At table his acts were incredibly mean;  
He gave his wife fat—and *he* gobbled the lean!

What's more, she was censured whenever she ventured  
To dare to object to her fare;  
He said "It ain't tasteful, but we can't be wasteful;  
And *someone* must eat what is there!"  
But his coarseness exceeded all bounds of control  
When he laughed at her Art and the State of her Soul.

So what with his jeering and fleering and sneering,  
He plagued her from dawn until dark.  
He bellowed "I'll teach ye to read Shaw and Nietzsche"—  
And he was as bad as his bark.  
"The place for a woman——" he'd start, very glib....  
And so on, for two or three hours *ad lib*.

So very malignant became his indignant  
Remarks about "Culture" and "Cranks,"  
That at last she revolted. She up and she bolted  
And entered the militant ranks....  
When she died, after breaking nine-tenths of the laws,  
She left all her money and jewels to the Cause!

And *THE MORAL* is this (though a bit abstruse):  
What's sauce for a more or less proper goose,  
When it rouses the violent, feminine dander,  
Is apt to be sauce for the propaganda.

*Louis Untermeyer.*

---

## THE MODERN HIAWATHA

He killed the noble Mudjokivis.  
Of the skin he made him mittens,  
Made them with the fur side inside  
Made them with the skin side outside.  
He, to get the warm side inside,  
Put the inside skin side outside;  
He, to get the cold side outside,  
Put the warm side fur side inside.  
That's why he put the fur side inside,  
Why he put the skin side outside.  
Why he turned them inside outside.

*Unknown.*

---

## **SOMEWHERE-IN-EUROPE-WOCKY**

'Twas brussels, and the loos liège  
Did meuse and arras in latour;  
All vimy were the metz maubege,  
And the tsing-tau namur.

"Beware the petrograd, my son—  
The jaws that bite, the claws that plough!  
Beware the posen, and verdun  
The soldan mons glogau!"

He took his dixmude sword in hand;  
Long time his altkirch foe he sought;  
Then rested he 'neath the warsaw tree,  
And stood awhile in thought.

And as in danzig thought he stood



The petrograd, with eyes of flame,  
Came ypring through the cracow wood,  
And longwied as it came.

One two! One two! and through and through  
The dixmude blade went snicker-snack;  
He left it dead, and with its head  
He gallipolied back.

"And hast thou slain the petrograd?  
Come to my arms, my krithnia boy!  
O chanak day! Artois! Grenay!"  
He woevred in his joy.

'Twas brussels, and the loos liège  
Did meuse and arras in latour;  
All vimy were the metz maubege,  
And the tsing-tau namur.

*F. G. Hartswick.*

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## **RIGID BODY SINGS**

Gin a body meet a body  
Flyin' through the air,  
Gin a body hit a body,  
Will it fly? and where?  
Ilka impact has its measure,  
Ne'er a' ane hae I,  
Yet a' the lads they measure me,  
Or, at least, they try.

Gin a body meet a body

Altogether free,  
How they travel afterwards  
We do not always see.  
Ilka problem has its method  
By analytics high;  
For me, I ken na ane o' them,  
But what the waur am I?

*J. C. Maxwell.*

---

## **A BALLAD OF HIGH ENDEAVOR**

Ah Night! blind germ of days to be,  
Ah, me! ah me!  
(Sweet Venus, mother!)  
What wail of smitten strings hear we?  
(Ah me! ah me!  
*Hey diddle dee!*)

Ravished by clouds our Lady Moon,  
Ah me! ah me!  
(Sweet Venus, mother!)  
Sinks swooning in a lady-swoon  
(Ah me! ah me!  
*Dum diddle dee!*)

What profits it to rise i' the dark?  
Ah me! ah me!  
(Sweet Venus, mother!)  
If love but over-soar its mark  
(Ah me! ah me!  
*Hey diddle dee!*)

What boots to fall again forlorn?  
Ah me! ah me!  
(Sweet Venus, mother!)  
Scorned by the grinning hound of scorn,  
(Ah me! ah me!  
*Dum diddle dee!*)

Art thou not greater who art less?  
Ah me! ah me!  
(Sweet Venus, mother!)  
Low love fulfilled of low success?  
(Ah me! ah me!  
*Hey diddle dee!*)

*Unknown.*

---

## FATHER WILLIAM

"You are old, Father William," the young man said,  
"And your hair has become very white;  
And yet you incessantly stand on your head—  
Do you think, at your age, it is right?"

"In my youth," Father William replied to his son,  
"I feared it might injure the brain;  
But now that I'm perfectly sure I have none,  
Why, I do it again and again."

"You are old," said the youth, "as I mentioned before,  
And have grown most uncommonly fat;  
Yet you turned a back somersault in at the door—  
Pray, what is the reason of that?"

"In my youth," said the sage, as he shook his gray locks,  
"I kept all my limbs very supple  
By the use of this ointment—one shilling the box—  
Allow me to sell you a couple."

"You are old," said the youth, "and your jaws are too weak  
For anything tougher than suet;  
Yet you finished the goose, with the bones and the beak;  
Pray, how did you manage to do it?"

"In my youth," said his father, "I took to the law,  
And argued each case with my wife;  
And the muscular strength which it gave to my jaw,  
Has lasted the rest of my life."

"You are old," said the youth; "one would hardly suppose  
That your eye was as steady as ever;  
Yet you balanced an eel on the end of your nose—  
What made you so awfully clever?"

"I have answered three questions, and that is enough,"  
Said his father; "don't give yourself airs!  
Do you think I can listen all day to such stuff?  
Be off, or I'll kick you down-stairs!"

*Lewis Carroll.*

---

## THE POETS AT TEA

1—(*Macaulay, who made it*)

Pour, varlet, pour the water,  
The water steaming hot!  
A spoonful for each man of us,

Another for the pot!  
We shall not drink from amber,  
Nor Capuan slave shall mix  
For us the snows of Athos  
With port at thirty-six;  
Whiter than snow the crystals,  
Grown sweet 'neath tropic fires,  
More rich the herbs of China's field,  
The pasture-lands more fragrance yield;  
For ever let Britannia wield  
The tea-pot of her sires!

2—(*Tennyson, who took it hot*)

I think that I am drawing to an end:  
For on a sudden came a gasp for breath,  
And stretching of the hands, and blinded eyes,  
And a great darkness falling on my soul.  
O Hallelujah!... Kindly pass the milk.

3—(*Swinburne, who let it get cold*)

As the sin that was sweet in the sinning  
Is foul in the ending thereof,  
As the heat of the summer's beginning  
Is past in the winter of love:  
O purity, painful and pleading!  
O coldness, ineffably gray!  
Oh, hear us, our handmaid unheeding.  
And take it away!

4—(*Cowper, who thoroughly enjoyed it*)

The cosy fire is bright and gay,  
The merry kettle boils away  
And hums a cheerful song.  
I sing the saucer and the cup;  
Pray, Mary, fill the tea-pot up,  
And do not make it strong.

5—(*Browning, who treated it allegorically*)

Tut! Bah! We take as another case—

Pass the bills on the pills on the window-sill; notice the capsule  
(A sick man's fancy, no doubt, but I place

Reliance on trade-marks, Sir)—so perhaps you'll  
Excuse the digression—this cup which I hold

Light-poised—Bah, it's spilt in the bed!—well, let's on go—  
Hold Bohea and sugar, Sir; if you were told

The sugar was salt, would the Bohea be Congo?

6—(*Wordsworth, who gave it away*)

"Come, little cottage girl, you seem

To want my cup of tea;

And will you take a little cream?

Now tell the truth to me."

She had a rustic, woodland grin,

Her cheek was soft as silk,

And she replied, "Sir, please put in

A little drop of milk."

"Why, what put milk into your head?

'Tis cream my cows supply;"

And five times to the child I said,

"Why, pig-head, tell me, why?"

"You call me pig-head," she replied;

"My proper name is Ruth.

I called that milk"—she blushed with pride—

"You bade me speak the truth."

7—(*Poe, who got excited over it*)

Here's a mellow cup of tea, golden tea!

What a world of rapturous thought its fragrance brings to me!

Oh, from out the silver cells

How it wells!

How it smells!

Keeping tune, tune, tune

To the tintinnabulation of the spoon.  
And the kettle on the fire  
Boils its spout off with desire,  
With a desperate desire  
And a crystalline endeavour  
Now, now to sit, or never,  
On the top of the pale-faced moon,  
But he always came home to tea, tea, tea, tea, tea,  
Tea to the n——th.

8—(*Rossetti, who took six cups of it*)

The lilies lie in my lady's bower  
(O weary mother drive the cows to roost),  
They faintly droop for a little hour;  
My lady's head droops like a flower.

She took the porcelain in her hand  
(O weary mother, drive the cows to roost);  
She poured; I drank at her command;  
Drank deep, and now—you understand!  
(O weary mother, drive the cows to roost.)

9—(*Burns, who liked it adulterated*)

Weel, gin ye speir, I'm no inclined,  
Whusky or tay—to state my mind,  
Fore ane or ither;  
For, gin I tak the first, I'm fou,  
And gin the next, I'm dull as you,  
Mix a' thegither.

10—(*Walt Whitman, who didn't stay more than a minute*)

One cup for myself-hood,  
Many for you. Allons, camerados, we will drink together,  
O hand-in-hand! That tea-spoon, please, when you've done with it.  
What butter-colour'd hair you've got. I don't want to be personal.  
All right, then, you needn't. You're a stale-cadaver.

Eighteen-pence if the bottles are returned.  
Allons, from all bat-eyed formula.

*Barry Pain.*

---

## HOW OFTEN

They stood on the bridge at midnight,  
In a park not far from the town;  
They stood on the bridge at midnight,  
Because they didn't sit down.

The moon rose o'er the city,  
Behind the dark church spire;  
The moon rose o'er the city  
And kept on rising higher.

How often, oh, how often!  
They whispered words so soft;  
How often, oh, how often;  
How often, oh, how oft!

*Ben King.*

---

## IF I SHOULD DIE TO-NIGHT

If I should die to-night  
And you should come to my cold corpse and say,  
Weeping and heartsick o'er my lifeless clay—



If I should die to-night,  
And you should come in deepest grief and woe—  
And say: "Here's that ten dollars that I owe,"  
I might arise in my large white cravat  
And say, "What's that?"

If I should die to-night  
And you should come to my cold corpse and kneel,  
Clasping my bier to show the grief you feel,  
I say, if I should die to-night  
And you should come to me, and there and then  
Just even hint 'bout paying me that ten,  
I might arise the while,  
But I'd drop dead again.

*Ben King.*

---

## **"THE DAY IS DONE"**

The day is done, and darkness  
From the wing of night is loosed,  
As a feather is wafted downward,  
From a chicken going to roost.

I see the lights of the baker,  
Gleam through the rain and mist,  
And a feeling of sadness comes o'er me,  
That I cannot well resist.

A feeling of sadness and longing  
That is not like being sick,  
And resembles sorrow only  
As a brickbat resembles a brick.

Come, get for me some supper,—  
A good and regular meal—  
That shall soothe this restless feeling,  
And banish the pain I feel.

Not from the pastry bakers,  
Not from the shops for cake;  
I wouldn't give a farthing  
For all that they can make.

For, like the soup at dinner,  
Such things would but suggest  
Some dishes more substantial,  
And to-night I want the best.

Go to some honest butcher,  
Whose beef is fresh and nice,  
As any they have in the city  
And get a liberal slice.

Such things through days of labor,  
And nights devoid of ease,  
For sad and desperate feelings,  
Are wonderful remedies.

They have an astonishing power  
To aid and reinforce,  
And come like the "finally, brethren,"  
That follows a long discourse.

Then get me a tender sirloin  
From off the bench or hook.  
And lend to its sterling goodness  
The science of the cook.

And the night shall be filled with comfort,

And the cares with which it begun  
Shall fold up their blankets like Indians,  
And silently cut and run.

*Phæbe Cary.*

---

## JACOB

He dwelt among "Apartments let,"  
About five stories high;  
A man, I thought, that none would get,  
And very few would try.

A boulder, by a larger stone  
Half hidden in the mud,  
Fair as a man when only one  
Is in the neighborhood.

He lived unknown, and few could tell  
When Jacob was not free;  
But he has got a wife—and O!  
The difference to me!

*Phæbe Cary.*

---

## BALLAD OF THE CANAL

We were crowded in the cabin,  
Not a soul had room to sleep;

It was midnight on the waters,  
And the banks were very steep.

'Tis a fearful thing when sleeping,  
To be startled by the shock,  
And to hear the rattling trumpet  
Thunder, "Coming to a lock!"

So we shuddered there in silence,  
For the stoutest berth was shook,  
While the wooden gates were opened  
And the mate talked with the cook.

And as thus we lay in darkness,  
Each one wishing we were there,  
"We are through!" the captain shouted,  
And he sat down on a chair.

And his little daughter whispered,  
Thinking that he ought to know,  
"Isn't travelling by canal-boats  
Just as safe as it is slow?"

Then he kissed the little maiden,  
And with better cheer we spoke,  
And we trotted into Pittsburg,  
When the morn looked through the smoke.

*Phæbe Cary.*

---

## **THERE'S A BOWER OF BEAN-VINES**

There's a bower of bean-vines in Benjamin's yard,  
And the cabbages grow round it, planted for greens;  
In the time of my childhood 'twas terribly hard  
To bend down the bean-poles, and pick off the beans.

That bower and its products I never forget,  
But oft, when my landlady presses me hard,  
I think, are the cabbages growing there yet,  
Are the bean-vines still bearing in Benjamin's yard?

No, the bean-vines soon withered that once used to wave,  
But some beans had been gathered, the last that hung on;  
And a soup was distilled in a kettle, that gave  
All the fragrance of summer when summer was gone.

Thus memory draws from delight, ere it dies,  
An essence that breathes of it awfully hard;  
As thus good to my taste as 'twas then to my eyes,  
Is that bower of bean-vines in Benjamin's yard.

*Phæbe Cary.*

---

## REUBEN

That very time I saw, (but thou couldst not),  
Walking between the garden and the barn,  
Reuben, all armed; a certain aim he took  
At a young chicken, standing by a post,  
And loosed his bullet smartly from his gun,  
As he would kill a hundred thousand hens.  
But I might see young Reuben's fiery shot  
Lodged in the chaste board of the garden fence,

And the domesticated fowl passed on  
In henly meditation, bullet free.

*Phæbe Cary.*

---

## THE WIFE

Her washing ended with the day,  
Yet lived she at its close,  
And passed the long, long night away  
In darning ragged hose.

But when the sun in all its state  
Illumed the Eastern skies,  
She passed about the kitchen grate  
And went to making pies.

*Phæbe Cary.*

---

## WHEN LOVELY WOMAN

When lovely woman wants a favor,  
And finds, too late, that man won't bend,  
What earthly circumstance can save her  
From disappointment in the end?

The only way to bring him over,  
The last experiment to try,

Whether a husband or a lover,  
If he have feeling is—to cry.

*Phæbe Cary.*

---

## JOHN THOMPSON'S DAUGHTER

A fellow near Kentucky's clime  
Cries, "Boatman, do not tarry,  
And I'll give thee a silver dime  
To row us o'er the ferry."

"Now, who would cross the Ohio,  
This dark and stormy water?"  
"O, I am this young lady's beau,  
And she, John Thompson's daughter.

"We've fled before her father's spite  
With great precipitation;  
And should he find us here to-night,  
I'd lose my reputation.

"They've missed the girl and purse beside,  
His horsemen hard have pressed me;  
And who will cheer my bonny bride,  
If yet they shall arrest me?"

Out spoke the boatman then in time,  
"You shall not fail, don't fear it;  
I'll go, not for your silver dime,  
But for your manly spirit.

"And by my word, the bonny bird

In danger shall not tarry;  
For though a storm is coming on,  
I'll row you o'er the ferry."

By this the wind more fiercely rose,  
The boat was at the landing;  
And with the drenching rain their clothes  
Grew wet where they were standing.

But still, as wilder rose the wind,  
And as the night grew drearer;  
Just back a piece came the police,  
Their tramping sounded nearer.

"Oh, haste thee, haste!" the lady cries,  
"It's anything but funny;  
I'll leave the light of loving eyes,  
But not my father's money!"

And still they hurried in the face  
Of wind and rain unsparing;  
John Thompson reached the landing place—  
His wrath was turned to swearing.

For by the lightning's angry flash,  
His child he did discover;  
One lovely hand held all the cash,  
And one was round her lover!

"Come back, come back!" he cried in woe,  
Across the stormy water;  
"But leave the purse, and you may go,  
My daughter, oh, my daughter!"

'Twas vain; they reached the other shore  
(Such doom the Fates assign us);



The gold he piled went with his child,  
And he was left there *minus*.

*Phæbe Cary.*

---

## A PORTRAIT

He is to weet a melancholy carle:  
Thin in the waist, with bushy head of hair,  
As hath the seeded thistle, when a parle  
It holds with Zephyr, ere it sendeth fair  
Its light balloons into the summer air;  
Thereto his beard had not begun to bloom.  
No brush had touched his cheek, or razor sheer;  
No care had touched his cheek with mortal doom,  
But new he was and bright, as scarf from Persian loom.

Ne carèd he for wine, or half and half;  
Ne carèd he for fish, or flesh, or fowl;  
And sauces held he worthless as the chaff;  
He 'sdeigned the swine-head at the wassail-bowl:  
Ne with lewd ribbalds sat he cheek by jowl;  
Ne with sly lemans in the scorner's chair;  
But after water-brooks this pilgrim's soul  
Panted and all his food was woodland air;  
Though he would oft-times feast on gilliflowers rare.

The slang of cities in no wise he knew,  
*Tipping the wink* to him was heathen Greek;  
He sipped no "olden Tom," or "ruin blue,"  
Or Nantz, or cherry-brandy, drunk full meek  
By many a damsel brave and rouge of cheek;  
Nor did he know each aged watchman's beat,

Nor in obscurèd purlieus would be seek  
For curlèd Jewesses, with ankles neat,  
Who, as they walk abroad, make tinkling with their feet.

*John Keats.*

---

## ANNABEL LEE

'Twas more than a million years ago,  
Or so it seems to me,  
That I used to prance around and beau  
The beautiful Annabel Lee.  
There were other girls in the neighborhood  
But none was a patch to she.

And this was the reason that long ago,  
My love fell out of a tree,  
And busted herself on a cruel rock;  
A solemn sight to see,  
For it spoiled the hat and gown and looks  
Of the beautiful Annabel Lee.

We loved with a love that was lovely love,  
I and my Annabel Lee,  
And we went one day to gather the nuts  
That men call hickoree.  
And I stayed below in the rosy glow  
While she shinned up the tree,  
But no sooner up than down kerslup  
Came the beautiful Annabel Lee.

And the pallid moon and the hectic noon  
Bring gleams of dreams for me,

Of the desolate and desperate fate  
Of the beautiful Annabel Lee.

And I often think as I sink on the brink  
Of slumber's sea, of the warm pink link  
That bound my soul to Annabel Lee;  
And it wasn't just best for her interest  
To climb that hickory tree,  
For had she stayed below with me,  
We'd had no hickory nuts maybe,  
But I should have had my Annabel Lee.

*Stanley Huntley.*

---

## HOME SWEET HOME WITH VARIATIONS

Being suggestions of the various styles in which an old theme  
might have been treated by certain metrical composers.

### FANTASIA

#### I

*The original theme as John Howard Payne wrote it:*

'Mid pleasures and palaces though we may roam,  
Be it ever so humble, there's no place like home!  
A charm from the skies seems to hallow it there,  
Which, seek through the world, is not met with elsewhere.

Home, home! Sweet, Sweet Home!  
There's no place like Home!

An exile from home, splendor dazzles in vain!  
Oh, give me my lowly thatched cottage again!  
The birds singing gaily that came at my call!

Give me them! and the peace of mind, dearer than all.

Home, home! Sweet, Sweet Home!  
There's no place like Home!

## II

*(As Algernon Charles Swinburne might have wrapped it up in variations.)*

(Mid pleasures and palaces—)

As sea-foam blown of the winds, as blossom of brine that is drifted  
Hither and yon on the barren breast of the breeze,  
Though we wander on gusts of a god's breath, shaken and shifted,  
The salt of us stings and is sore for the sobbing seas.  
For home's sake hungry at heart, we sicken in pillared porches  
Of bliss made sick for a life that is barren of bliss,  
For the place whereon is a light out of heaven that sears not nor scorches,  
Nor elsewhere than this.

(An exile from home, splendor dazzles in vain—)

For here we know shall no gold thing glisten,  
No bright thing burn, and no sweet thing shine;  
Nor love lower never an ear to listen  
To words that work in the heart like wine.  
What time we are set from our land apart,  
For pain of passion and hunger of heart,  
Though we walk with exiles fame faints to christen,  
Or sing at the Cytherean's shrine.

(Variation: An exile from home—)

Whether with him whose head  
Of gods is honored,  
With song made splendid in the sight of men—  
Whose heart most sweetly stout,

From ravishing France cast out,  
Being firstly hers, was hers most wholly then—  
Or where on shining seas like wine  
The dove's wings draw the drooping Erycine.

(Give me my lowly thatched cottage—)

For Joy finds Love grow bitter,  
And spreads his wings to quit her,  
At thought of birds that twitter  
Beneath the roof-tree's straw—  
Of birds that come for calling,  
No fear or fright appalling,  
When dews of dusk are falling,  
Or daylight's draperies draw.

(Give me them, and the peace of mind—)

Give me these things then back, though the giving  
Be at cost of earth's garner of gold;  
There is no life without these worth living,  
No treasure where these are not told.  
For the heart give the hope that it knows not,  
Give the balm for the burn of the breast—  
For the soul and the mind that repose not,  
Oh, give us a rest!

### III

*(As Mr. Francis Bret Harte might have woven it into a touching tale of a western gentleman in a red shirt.)*

Brown o' San Juan,  
Stranger, I'm Brown.  
Come up this mornin' from 'Frisco—  
Be'n a-saltin' my specie-stacks down.

Be'n a-knockin' around,

Fer a man from San Juan,  
Putty consid'able frequent—  
Jes' catch onter that streak o' the dawn!

Right thar lies my home—  
Right thar in the red—  
I could slop over, stranger, in po'try—  
Would spread out old Shakspoke cold dead.

Stranger, you freeze to this: there ain't no kinder gin-palace,  
Nor no variety-show lays over a man's own rancho.  
Maybe it hain't no style, but the Queen in the Tower o' London,  
Ain't got naathin' I'd swop for that house over thar on the hill-side.

Thar is my ole gal, 'n' the kids, 'n' the rest o' my live-stock;  
Thar my Remington hangs, and thar there's a griddle-cake br'ilin'—  
For the two of us, pard—and thar, I allow, the heavens  
Smile more friendly-like than on any other locality.

Stranger, nowhere else I don't take no satisfaction.  
Gimme my ranch, 'n' them friendly old Shanghai chickens—  
I brung the original pair f'm the States in eighteen-'n'-fifty—  
Gimme me them and the feelin' of solid domestic comfort.

Yer parding, young man—  
But this landscape a kind  
Er flickers—I 'low 'twuz the po'try—  
I thought that my eyes hed gone blind.

Take that pop from my belt!  
Hi, thar!—gimme yer han'—  
Or I'll kill myself—Lizzie—she's left me—  
Gone off with a purtier man!

Thar, I'll quit—the ole gal  
An' the kids—run away!

I be derved! Howsomever, come in, pard—  
The griddle-cake's thar, anyway.

IV

*(As Austin Dobson might have translated it from Horace, if it  
had ever occurred to Horace to write it.)*

RONDEAU

At home alone, O Nomades,  
Although Mæcenas' marble frieze

Stand not between you and the sky  
Nor Persian luxury supply  
Its rosy surfeit, find ye ease.

Tempt not the far Ægean breeze;  
With home-made wine and books that please,  
To duns and bores the door deny,  
At home, alone.

Strange joys may lure. Your deities  
Smile here alone. Oh, give me these:  
Low eaves, where birds familiar fly,  
And peace of mind, and, fluttering by,  
My Lydia's graceful draperies,  
At home, alone.

V

*(As it might have been constructed in 1744, Oliver Goldsmith, at  
19, writing the first stanza, and Alexander Pope, at 52, the  
second.)*

Home! at the word, what blissful visions rise,  
Lift us from earth, and draw us toward the skies;  
'Mid mirag'd towers, or meretricious joys,  
Although we roam, one thought the mind employs:

Or lowly hut, good friend, or loftiest dome,  
Earth knows no spot so holy as our Home.  
There, where affection warms the father's breast,  
There is the spot of heav'n most surely blest.  
Howe'er we search, though wandering with the wind  
Through frigid Zembla, or the heats of Ind,  
Not elsewhere may we seek, nor elsewhere know,  
The light of heaven upon our dark below.

When from our dearest hope and haven reft,  
Delight nor dazzles, nor is luxury left,  
We long, obedient to our nature's law,  
To see again our hovel thatched with straw:

See birds that know our avenaceous store  
Stoop to our hand, and thence repleted soar:  
But, of all hopes the wanderer's soul that share,  
His pristine peace of mind's his final prayer.

## VI

*(As Walt Whitman might have written all around it.)*

### I

You over there, young man with the guide-book, red-bound, covered  
flexibly with red linen,  
Come here, I want to talk with you; I, Walt, the Manhattanese, citizen of  
these States, call you.  
Yes, and the courier, too, smirking, smug-mouthed, with oil'd hair; a  
garlicky look about him generally; him, too, I take in, just as I  
would a coyote or a king, or a toad-stool, or a ham-sandwich,  
or anything, or anybody else in the world.  
Where are you going?  
You want to see Paris, to eat truffles, to have a good time; in Vienna,  
London, Florence, Monaco, to have a good time; you want to  
see Venice.



Come with me. I will give you a good time; I will give you all the Venice  
you want, and most of the Paris.

I, Walt, I call to you. I am all on deck! Come and loafe with me! Let me  
tote you around by your elbow and show you things.

You listen to my ophicleide!

Home!

Home, I celebrate. I elevate my fog-whistle, inspir'd by the thought of  
home.

Come in!—take a front seat; the jostle of the crowd not minding; there is  
room enough for all of you.

This is my exhibition—it is the greatest show on earth—there is no charge  
for admission.

All you have to pay me is to take in my romanza.

## II

1. The brown-stone house; the father coming home worried from a bad  
day's business; the wife meets him in the marble pav'd vestibule;  
she throws her arms about him; she presses him close to her; she  
looks him full in the face with affectionate eyes; the frown from his  
brow disappearing.

Darling, she says, Johnny has fallen down and cut his head; the  
cook is going away, and the boiler leaks.

2. The mechanic's dark little third-story room, seen in a flash from the  
Elevated Railway train; the sewing-machine in a corner; the small  
cook-stove; the whole family eating cabbage around a kerosene  
lamp; of the clatter and roar and groaning wail of the Elevated train  
unconscious; of the smell of the cabbage unconscious.

Me, passant, in the train, of the cabbage not quite so unconscious.

3. The French Flat; the small rooms, all right-angles, un-individual; the  
narrow halls; the gaudy, cheap decorations everywhere.

The janitor and the cook exchanging compliments up and down the  
elevator-shaft; the refusal to send up more coal, the solid splash of  
the water upon his head, the language he sends up the shaft, the  
triumphant laughter of the cook, to her kitchen retiring.

4. The widow's small house in the suburbs of the city; the widow's boy coming home from his first day down town; he is flushed with happiness and pride; he is no longer a school-boy, he is earning money; he takes on the airs of a man and talks learnedly of business.
5. The room in the third-class boarding-house; the mean little hard-coal fire, the slovenly Irish servant-girl making it, the ashes on the hearth, the faded furniture, the private provender hid away in the closet, the dreary backyard out the window; the young girl at the glass, with her mouth full of hairpins, doing up her hair to go downstairs and flirt with the young fellows in the parlor.
6. The kitchen of the old farm-house; the young convict just returned from prison—it was his first offense, and the judges were lenient on him.

He is taking his first meal out of prison; he has been received back, kiss'd, encourag'd to start again; his lungs, his nostrils expand with the big breaths of free air; with shame, with wonderment, with a trembling joy, his heart too, expanding.

The old mother busies herself about the table; she has ready for him the dishes he us'd to like; the father sits with his back to them, reading the newspaper, the newspaper shaking and rustling much; the children hang wondering around the prodigal—they have been caution'd: Do not ask where our Jim has been; only say you are glad to see him.

The elder daughter is there, palefac'd, quiet; her young man went back on her four years ago; his folks would not let him marry a convict's sister. She sits by the window, sewing on the children's clothes, the clothes not only patching up; her hunger for children of her own invisibly patching up.

The brother looks up; he catches her eye, he fearful, apologetic; she smiles back at him, not reproachfully smiling, with loving pretence of hope smiling—it is too much for him; he buries his face in the folds of the mother's black gown.

7. The best room of the house, on the Sabbath only open'd; the smell of horse-hair furniture and mahogany varnish; the ornaments on the what-not in the corner; the wax fruit, dusty, sunken, sagged in, consumptive-looking, under a glass globe, the sealing-wax imitation of coral; the cigar boxes with shells plastered over, the perforated card-board motto.

The kitchen; the housewife sprinkling the clothes for the fine ironing to-morrow—it is the Third-day night, and the plain things are ready iron'd, now in cupboards, in drawers stowed away.

The wife waiting for the husband—he is at the tavern, jovial, carousing; she, alone in the kitchen sprinkling clothes—the little red wood clock with peaked top, with pendulum wagging behind a pane of gayly painted glass, strikes twelve.

The sound of the husband's voice on the still night air—he is singing: "We won't go home until morning!"—the wife arising, toward the wood-shed hastily going, stealthily entering, the voice all the time coming nearer, inebriate, chantant.

The husband passing the door of the wood-shed; the club over his head, now with his head in contact; the sudden cessation of the song; the benediction of peace over the domestic foyer temporarily resting.

I sing the soothing influences of home.

You, young man, thoughtlessly wandering, with courier, with guide-book wandering,

You hearken to the melody of my steam-calliope

Yawp!

*H. C. Bunner.*

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## AN OLD SONG BY NEW SINGERS

## IN THE ORIGINAL

Mary had a little lamb,  
Its fleece was white as snow,—  
And everywhere that Mary went  
The lamb was sure to go.

*(As Austin Dobson writes it.)*

### TRIOLET

A little lamb had Mary, sweet,  
With a fleece that shamed the driven snow.  
Not alone Mary went when she moved her feet  
(For a little lamb had Mary, sweet),  
And it tagged her 'round with a pensive bleat,  
And wherever she went it wanted to go;  
A little lamb had Mary, sweet,  
With a fleece that shamed the driven snow.

*(As Mr. Browning has it.)*

You knew her?—Mary the small,  
How of a summer,—or, no, was it fall?  
You'd never have thought it, never believed,  
But the girl owned a lamb last fall.

Its wool was subtly, silky white,  
Color of lucent obliteration of night,  
Like the shimmering snow or—our Clothild's arm!  
You've seen her arm—her right, I mean—  
The other she scalded a-washing, I ween—  
How white it is and soft and warm?

Ah, there was soul's heart-love, deep, true, and tender,  
Wherever went Mary, the maiden so slender,  
There followed, his all-absorbed passion, inciting,  
That passionate lambkin—her soul's heart delighting—

Ay, every place that Mary sought in,  
That lamb was sure to soon be caught in.

*(As Longfellow might have done it.)*

Fair the daughter known as Mary,  
Fair and full of fun and laughter,  
Owned a lamb, a little he-goat,  
Owned him all herself and solely.  
White the lamb's wool as the Gotchi—  
The great Gotchi, driving snowstorm.  
Hither Mary went and thither,  
But went with her to all places,  
Sure as brook to run to river,  
Her pet lambkin following with her.

*(How Andrew Lang sings it.)*

#### RONDEAU

A wonderful lass was Marie, petite,  
And she looked full fair and passing sweet—  
And, oh! she owned—but cannot you guess  
What pet can a maiden so love and caress  
As a tiny lamb with a plaintive bleat

And mud upon his dainty feet  
And a gentle veally odour of meat,  
And a fleece to finger and kiss and press—  
White as snow?

Wherever she wandered, in lane or street,  
As she sauntered on, there at her feet  
She would find that lambkin—bless  
The dear!—treading on her dainty dress,  
Her dainty dress, fresh and neat—  
White as snow!

*(Mr. Algernon C. Swinburne's idea.)*

## VILLANELLE

Dewy-eyed with shimmering hair,  
Maiden and lamb were a sight to see,  
For her pet was white as she was fair.

And its lovely fleece was beyond compare,  
And dearly it loved its Mistress Marie,  
Dewy-eyed, with shimmering hair.

Its warpéd wool was an inwove snare,  
To tangle her fingers in, where they could be  
(For her pet was white as she was fair).

Lost from sight, both so snow-white were,  
And the lambkin adored the maiden wee,  
Dewy-eyed with shimmering hair.

Th' impassioned incarnation of rare,  
Of limpid-eyed, luscious-lipped, loved beauty,  
And her pet was white as she was fair.

Wherever she wandered, hither and there,  
Wildly that lambkin sought with her to be,  
With the dewy-eyed, with shimmering hair,  
And a pet as white as its mistress was fair.

*A. C. Wilkie.*

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## MORE IMPRESSIONS

### LA FUITE DES OIES

To outer senses they are geese,  
Dull drowsing by a weedy pool;  
But try the impression trick. Cool! Cool!  
Snow-slumbering sentinels of Peace!

Deep silence on the shadowy flood,  
Save rare sharp stridence (that means "quack"),  
Low amber light in Ariel track  
Athwart the dun (that means the mud).

And suddenly subsides the sun,  
Bulks mystic, ghostly, thrid the gloom  
(That means the white geese waddling home),  
And darkness reigns! (See how it's done?)

*Oscuro Wildgoose.*

---

## NURSERY RHYMES À LA MODE

*(Our nurseries will soon lie too cultured to admit the old rhymes in their Philistine and unæsthetic garb. They may be redressed somewhat on this model.)*

Oh, but she was dark and shrill,  
(Hey-de-diddle and hey-de-dee!)  
The cat that (on the first April)  
Played the fiddle on the lea.  
Oh, and the moon was wan and bright,  
(Hey-de-diddle and hey-de-dee!)  
The Cow she looked nor left nor right,  
But took it straight at a jump, pardie!  
The hound did laugh to see this thing,  
(Hey-de-diddle and hey-de-dee!)

As it was parlous wantoning,  
    (Ah, good my gentles, laugh not ye,)  
And underneath a dreesome moon  
    Two lovers fled right piteouslie;  
A spooney plate with a plated spoon,  
    (Hey-de-diddle and hey-de-dee!)

**POSTSCRIPT**

Then blame me not, altho' my verse  
    Sounds like an echo of C. S. C.  
Since still they make ballads that worse and worse  
    Savor of diddle and hey-de-dee.

*Unknown.*

---

**A MAUDLE-IN BALLAD**

**TO HIS LILY**

My lank limp lily, my long lithe lily,  
My languid lily-love fragile and thin,  
With dank leaves dangling and flower-flap chilly.  
That shines like the shin of a Highland gilly!  
Mottled and moist as a cold toad's skin!  
Lustrous and leper-white, splendid and splay!  
Art thou not Utter and wholly akin  
To my own wan soul and my own wan chin,  
And my own wan nose-tip, tilted to sway  
The peacock's feather, *sweeter than sin*,  
That I bought for a halfpenny yesterday?

My long lithe lily, my languid lily,  
My lank limp lily-love, how shall I win—



Woo thee to wink at me? Silver lily,  
How shall I sing to thee, softly or shrilly?  
What shall I weave for thee—what shall I spin—  
Rondel, or rondeau, or virelai?  
Shall I buzz like a bee with my face thrust in  
Thy choice, chaste chalice, or choose me a tin  
Trumpet, or touchingly, tenderly play  
On the weird bird-whistle, *sweeter than sin*,  
That I bought for a halfpenny yesterday.

My languid lily, my lank limp lily,  
My long lithe lily-love, men may grin—  
Say that I'm soft and supremely silly—  
What care I while you whisper stilly;  
What care I while you smile? Not a pin!  
While you smile, you whisper—"Tis sweet to decay?

I have watered with chlorodine, tears of chagrin,  
The churchyard mould I have planted thee in,  
Upside down in an intense way,  
In a rough red flower-pot, *sweeter than sin*,  
That I bought for a halfpenny yesterday.

*Unknown.*

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## GILLIAN

Jack and Jille

I have made me an end of the moods of maidens,  
I have loosed me, and leapt from the links of love;  
From the kiss that cloyes and desire that deadens,  
The woes that madden, the words that move.  
In the dim last days of a spent September,

When fruits are fallen, and flies are fain;  
Before you forget, and while I remember,  
I cry as I shall cry never again.

Went up a hylle

Where the strong fell faints in the lazy levels  
Of misty meadows, and streams that stray;  
We raised us at eve from our rosy revels,  
With the faces aflame for the death of the day;  
With pale lips parted, and sighs that shiver,  
Low lids that cling to the last of love:  
We left the levels, we left the river,  
And turned us and toiled to the air above.

To fetch a paile of water,

By the sad sweet springs that have salved our sorrow,  
The fates that haunt us, the grief that grips—  
Where we walk not to-day nor shall walk not tomorrow—  
The wells of Lethe for wearied lips.  
With souls nor shaken with tears nor laughter,  
With limp knees loosed as of priests that pray,  
We bowed us and bent to the white well-water,  
We dipped and we drank it and bore away.

Jack felle downe

The low light trembled on languid lashes,  
The haze of your hair on my mouth was blown,  
Our love flashed fierce from its fading ashes,  
As night's dim net on the day was thrown.  
What was it meant for, or made for, that minute,  
But that our lives in delight should be dipt?  
Was it yours, or my fault, or fate's, that in it  
Our frail feet faltered, our steep steps slipt.

And brake his crowne, and Jille came tumblynge after.

Our linked hands loosened and lapsed in sunder,  
Love from our limbs as a shift was shed,

But paused a moment, to watch with wonder  
The pale pained body, the bursten head.  
While our sad souls still with regrets are riven,  
While the blood burns bright on our bruised brows,  
I have set you free, and I stand forgiven—  
And now I had better go call my cows.

*Unknown.*

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## EXTRACTS FKOM THE RUBAIYAT OF OMAR CAYENNE

Wake! for the Hack can scatter into flight  
Shakespeare and Dante in a single Night!  
The Penny-a-Liner is Abroad, and strikes  
Our Modern Literature with blithering Blight.

Before Historical Romances died,  
Methought a Voice from Art's Olympus cried,  
"When all Dumas and Scott is still for Sale,  
Why nod o'er drowsy Tales, by Tyros tried?"

A Book of Limericks—Nonsense, anyhow—  
Alice in Wonderland, the Purple Cow  
Beside me singing on Fifth Avenue—  
Ah, this were Modern Literature enow!

Ah, my Beloved, write the Book that clears  
To-DAY of dreary Debt and sad Arrears;  
To-morrow!—Why, To-Morrow I may see  
My Nonsense popular as Edward Lear's.

And we, that now within the Editor's Room  
Make merry while we have our little Boom,

Ourselves must we give way to next month's Set—  
Girls with Three Names, who know not Who from Whom!

As then the Poet for his morning Sup  
Fills with a Metaphor his mental Cup,  
Do you devoutly read your Manuscripts  
That Someone may, before you burn them up!

And if the Bosh you write, the Trash you read,  
End in the Garbage-Barrel—take no Heed;  
Think that you are no worse than other Scribes,  
Who scribble Stuff to meet the Public Need.

So, when WHO'S-WHO records your silly Name,  
You'll think that you have found the Road to Fame;  
And though ten thousand other Names are there,  
You'll fancy you're a Genius, just the Same!

Why, if an Author can fling Art aside,  
And in a Book of Balderdash take pride,  
Were't not a Shame—were't not a Shame for him  
A Conscientious Novel to have tried?

And fear not, if the Editor refuse  
Your work, he has no more from which to choose;  
The Literary Microbe shall bring forth  
Millions of Manuscripts too bad to use.

The Woman's Touch runs through our Magazines;  
For her the Home, and Mother-Tale, and Scenes  
Of Love-and-Action, Happy at the End—  
The same old Plots, the same old Ways and Means.

But if, in spite of this, you build a Plot  
Which these immortal Elements has not,  
You gaze TO-DAY upon a Slip, which reads,  
"The Editor Regrets"—and such-like Rot.

Waste not your Ink, and don't attempt to use  
That subtle Touch which Editors refuse;  
Better be jocund at two cents a word,  
Than, starving, court an ill-requited Muse!

Strange—is it not?—that of the Authors who  
Publish in England, such a mighty Few  
Make a Success, though here they score a Hit?  
The British Public knows a Thing or Two!

The Scribe no question makes of Verse or Prose,  
But what the Editor demands, he shows;  
And he who buys three thousand words of Drool,  
He knows what People want—you Bet He knows!

Would but some wingèd Angel bring the News  
Of Critic who reads Books that he Reviews,  
And make the stern Reviewer do as well  
Himself, before he Meed of Praise refuse!

Ah, Love, could you and I perchance succeed  
In boiling down the Million Books we read  
Into One Book, and edit that a Bit—  
There'd be a WORLD'S BEST LITERATURE indeed!

*Gelett Burgess.*

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## **DIVERSIONS OF THE RE-ECHO CLUB**

It is with pleasure that we announce our ability to offer to the public the papers of the Re-Echo Club. This club, somewhat after the order of the Echo Club, late of Boston, takes pleasure in trying to better what is done. On the occasion of the meeting

of which the following gems of poesy are the result, the several members of the club engaged to write up the well-known tradition of the Purple Cow in more elaborate form than the quatrain made famous by Mr. Gelett Burgess:

"I never saw a Purple Cow,  
I never hope to see one;  
But I can tell you, anyhow,  
I'd rather see than be one."

The first attempt here cited is the production of Mr. John Milton:

Hence, vain, deluding cows.  
The herd of folly, without colour bright,  
How little you delight,  
Or fill the Poet's mind, or songs arouse!  
But, hail! thou goddess gay of feature!  
Hail, divinest purple creature!  
Oh, Cow, thy visage is too bright  
To hit the sense of human sight.  
And though I'd like, just once, to see thee,  
I never, never, never'd be thee!

**MR. P. BYSSHE SHELLEY:**

Hail to thee, blithe spirit!  
Cow thou never wert;  
But in life to cheer it  
Playest thy full part  
In purple lines of unpremeditated art.

The pale purple colour  
Melts around thy sight  
Like a star, but duller,  
In the broad daylight.  
I'd see thee, but I would not be thee if I might.

We look before and after

At cattle as they browse;  
Our most hearty laughter  
Something sad must rouse.  
Our sweetest songs are those that tell of Purple Cows.

**Mr. W. WORDSWORTH:**

She dwelt among the untrodden ways  
Beside the springs of Dee;  
A Cow whom there were few to praise  
And very few to see.

A violet by a mossy stone  
Greeting the smiling East  
Is not so purple, I must own,  
As that erratic beast.  
She lived unknown, that Cow, and so  
I never chanced to see;  
But if I had to be one, oh,  
The difference to me!

**MR. T. GRAY:**

The curfew tolls the knell of parting day,  
The lowing herd winds slowly o'er the lea;  
I watched them slowly wend their weary way,  
But, ah, a Purple Cow I did not see.  
Full many a cow of purplest ray serene  
Is haply grazing where I may not see;  
Full many a donkey writes of her, I ween,  
But neither of these creatures would I be.

**MR. J. W. RILEY:**

There, little Cow, don't cry!  
You are brindle and brown, I know.  
And with wild, glad hues  
Of reds and blues,

You never will gleam and glow.  
But though not pleasing to the eye,  
There, little Cow, don't cry, don't cry.

**LORD A. TENNYSON:**

Ask me no more. A cow I fain would see  
Of purple tint, like to a sun-soaked grape—  
Of purple tint, like royal velvet cape—  
But such a creature I would never be—  
Ask me no more.

**MR. R. BROWNING:**

All that I know  
Of a certain Cow  
Is it can throw,  
Somewhere, somehow,  
Now a dart of red,  
Now a dart of blue  
(That makes purple, 'tis said).  
I would fain see, too.  
This Cow that darkles the red and the blue!

**MR. J. KEATS:**

A cow of purple is a joy forever.  
Its loveliness increases. I have never  
Seen this phenomenon. Yet ever keep  
A brave lookout; lest I should be asleep  
When she comes by. For, though I would not be one,  
I've oft imagined 'twould be joy to see one.

**MR. D. G. ROSSETTI:**

The Purple Cow strayed in the glade;  
(Oh, my soul! but the milk is blue!)  
She strayed and strayed and strayed and strayed



(And I wail and I cry Wa-hoo!)

I've never seen her—nay, not I;  
(Oh, my soul! but the milk is blue!)  
Yet were I that Cow I should want to die.  
(And I wail and I cry Wa-hoo!)  
But in vain my tears I strew.

**MR. T. ALDRICH:**

Somewhere in some faked nature place,  
In Wonderland, in Nonsense Land,  
Two darkling shapes met face to face,  
And bade each other stand.

"And who are you?" said each to each;  
"Tell me your title, anyhow."  
One said, "I am the Papal Bull,"  
"And I the Purple Cow."

**MR. E. ALLAN POE:**

Open then I flung a shutter,  
And, with many a flirt and flutter,  
In there stepped a Purple Cow which gayly tripped around my floor.  
Not the least obeisance made she,  
Not a moment stopped or stayed she,  
But with mien of chorus lady perched herself above my door.  
On a dusty bust of Dante perched and sat above my door.

And that Purple Cow unflitting  
Still is sitting—still is sitting  
On that dusty bust of Dante just above my chamber door,  
And her horns have all the seeming  
Of a demon's that is screaming,  
And the arc-light o'er her streaming  
Casts her shadow on the floor.

And my soul from out that pool of Purple shadow on the floor,  
Shall be lifted Nevermore!

**MR. H. LONGFELLOW:**

The day is done, and the darkness  
Falls from the wing of night  
As ballast is wafted downward  
From an air-ship in its flight.

I dream of a purple creature  
Which is not as kine are now;  
And resembles cattle only  
As Cowper resembles a cow.

Such cows have power to quiet  
Our restless thoughts and rude;  
They come like the Benedictine  
That follows after food.

**MR. A. SWINBURNE:**

Oh, Cow of rare rapturous vision,  
Oh, purple, impalpable Cow,  
Do you browse in a Dream Field Elysian,  
Are you purpling pleasantly now?  
By the side of wan waves do you languish?  
Or in the lithe lush of the grove?  
While vainly I search in my anguish,  
O Bovine of mauve!

Despair in my bosom is sighing,  
Hope's star has sunk sadly to rest;  
Though cows of rare sorts I am buying,  
Not one breathes a balm to my breast.  
Oh, rapturous rose-crowned occasion,  
When I such a glory might see!

But a cow of a purple persuasion  
I never would be.

**MR. A. DOBSON:**

I'd love to see  
A Purple Cow,  
Oh, Goodness me!  
I'd love to see  
But not to be  
One. Anyhow,  
I'd love to see  
A Purple Cow.

**MR. O. HERFORD:**

Children, observe the Purple Cow,  
You cannot see her, anyhow;  
And, little ones, you need not hope  
Your eyes will e'er attain such scope.  
But if you ever have a choice  
To be, or see, lift up your voice  
And choose to see. For surely you  
Don't want to browse around and moo.

**MR. H. C. BUNNER:**

*Oh, what's the way to Arcady,  
Where all the cows are purple?*  
Ah, woe is me! I never hope  
On such a sight my eyes to ope;  
But as I sing in merry glee  
Along the road to Arcady,  
Perchance full soon I may espy  
A Purple Cow come dancing by.  
Heigho! I then shall see one.  
Her horns bedecked with ribbons gay,  
And garlanded with rosy may,—

A tricky sight. Still I must say  
I'd rather see than be one.

**MR. A. SWINBURNE:**

(Who was so enthused that he made a second attempt.)

Only in dim, drowsy depths of a dream do I dare to delight in deliciously  
dreaming

Cows there may be of a passionate purple,—cows of a violent violet hue;

Ne'er have I seen such a sight, I am certain it is but a demi-delirious  
dreaming—

Ne'er may I happily harbour a hesitant hope in my heart that my dream  
may come true.

Sad is my soul, and my senses are sobbing so strong is my strenuous spirit  
to see one.

Dolefully, drearily doomed to despair as warily wearily watching I wait;

Thoughts thickly thronging are thrilling and throbbing; to see is a glorious  
gain—but to *be* one!

That were a darker and direfuller destiny, that were a fearfuller, frightfuller  
fate!

**MR R. KIPLING:**

In the old ten-acre pasture,  
Lookin' eastward toward a tree,  
There's a Purple Cow a-settin'  
And I know she thinks of me.  
For the wind is in the gum-tree,  
And the hay is in the mow,  
And the cow-bells are a-calling  
"Come and see a Purple Cow!"

But I am not going now,  
Not at present, anyhow,  
For I am not fond of purple, and

I can't abide a cow;  
No, I shall not go to-day,  
Where the Purple Cattle play.  
But I think I'd rather see one  
Than to be one, anyhow.

*Carolyn Wells.*

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## **STYX RIVER ANTHOLOGY**

### **ALICE BEN BOLT**

I couldn't help weeping with delight  
When the boys kissed me and called me sweet.  
It was foolish, I know,  
To weep when I was glad;  
But I was young and I wasn't very well.  
I was nervous, weak, anemic,  
A sort of human mimosa; and I hadn't much brains,  
And my mind wouldn't jell, anyhow.  
That's why I trembled with fear when they frowned.  
But they didn't frown often,  
For I was sweetly pretty and most pliable.  
But, oh, the grim joke of asking Ben Bolt if he remembered me!  
Me!  
Why, it was Ben Bolt who—  
Well, never mind. He paid for this granite slab,  
And it's as stylish as any in the church yard.  
But I wish I had a more becoming shroud.

### **THE BLESSED DAMOZEL**

I was one of those long, lanky, loose-jointed girls  
Who fool people into believing  
They are willowy and psychic and mysterious.

I was always hungry; I never ate enough to satisfy me,  
For fear I'd get fat.  
Oh, how little the world knows of the bitterness of life  
To a woman who tries to keep thin!  
Many thought I died of a broken heart,  
But it was an empty stomach.  
Then Mr. Rossetti wrote about me.  
He described me all dolled up in some ladies' wearing apparel  
That I wore at a fancy ball.  
I had fasted all day, and had had my hair marcelled  
And my face corrected.  
And I *was* a dream.  
But he seemed to think he really saw me,  
Seemed to think I appeared to him after my death.  
Oh, fudge!  
Those spiritualists are always seeing things!

**ENOCH ARDEN**

Yes, it was the eternal triangle,  
Only they didn't call it that then.  
Of course everybody thought I was all broken up  
When I found Annie wed to Philip,  
But, as a matter of fact,  
I didn't care so much;  
For she was one of those self-starting weepers,  
And a man can't stand blubbering all the time.  
And, then, of course,  
When I was off on that long sea trip—  
Oh, well, you know what sailors are.

**LITTLE EVA**

To be honest,  
I didn't mind dying,  
For I had  
One of these here now  
Dressy deaths.  
It was staged, you know,

And, like Samson,  
My death brought down the house.  
I was a smarty kid,  
And they were less frequent then than later.  
Oh, I was the Mary Pickford of my time,  
And I rest content  
With my notoriety.

LUCY

Yes, I am in my grave,  
And you bet it makes a difference to him!  
For we were to be married,—at least, I think we were,  
And he'd made me promise to deed him the house.  
But I had to go and get appendicitis,  
And they took me to the hospital.  
It was a nice hospital, clean,  
And Tables Reserved For Ladies.  
Well, my heart gave out.  
He came and stood over my grave,  
And registered deep concern.  
And now, he's going round with that  
Hen-minded Hetty What's-her-name!  
Her with her Whistler's Mother and her Baby Stuart  
On her best-room wall!  
And I hate her, and I'm glad she squints.  
Well, I suppose I lived my life,  
But it was Life in name only.  
And I'm mad at the whole world!

OPHELIA

No, it wasn't suicide,  
But I had heard so much of those mud baths,  
I thought I'd try one.  
Ugh! it was a mess!  
Weeds, slime, and tangled vines! Oh, me!  
Had I been Annette Kellerman  
Or even a real mermaid,

I had lived to tell the tale.  
But I slid down and under,  
And so Will Shaxpur told it for me.  
Just as well.  
But I think my death scene is unexcelled  
By any in cold print.  
It beats that scrawny, red-headed old thing of Tom Hood's  
All hollow!

**CASABLANCA**

I played to the Grand Stand!  
Sure I did,  
And I made good.  
Ain't I in McGuffey's Third Reader?  
Don't they speak pieces about me Friday afternoons?  
Don't everybody know the first two lines of my story,—  
And no more?  
Say, I was there with the goods,  
Wasn't I?  
And it paid.  
But I wish Movin' Pitchers had been invented then!

**ANNABEL LEE**

They may say all they like  
About germs and micro-crocuses,—  
Or whatever they are!  
But my set opinion is,—  
If you want to get a good, old-fashioned chills and fever,  
Just poke around  
In a damp, messy place by the sea,  
Without rubbers on.  
A good cold wind,  
Blowing out of a cloud, by night,  
Will give you a harder shaking ague  
Than all the bacilli in the Basilica.  
It did me.

**ANGUS MCPHAIRSON**



Oh, of course,  
It's always some dratted petticoat!  
Just because that little flibbertigibbet, Annie Laurie  
Had a white throat and a blue e'e,  
She played the very devil with my peace of mind.  
She'd dimple at me  
Till I was about crazy;  
And then laugh at me through her dimples!  
She was my bespoke.  
And I'd beg her to have the banns called,—  
But there was no pinning her down.  
Well, she was so bonny  
That like a fool, I said I'd lay me doon  
And dee for her.  
And,—like a fool,—  
I did.

*Carolyn Wells.*

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**ANSWER TO MASTER WITHER'S SONG, "SHALL I,  
WASTING IN DESPAIR?"**

Shall I, mine affections slack,  
'Cause I see a woman's black?  
Or myself, with care cast down,  
'Cause I see a woman brown?  
Be she blacker than the night,  
Or the blackest jet in sight!  
If she be not so to me,  
What care I how black she be?

Shall my foolish heart be burst,  
'Cause I see a woman's curst?

Or a thwarting hoggish nature  
Joinèd in as bad a feature?  
Be she curst or fiercer than  
Brutish beast, or savage man!  
If she be not so to me,  
What care I how curst she be?

Shall a woman's vices make  
Me her vices quite forsake?  
Or her faults to me made known,  
Make me think that I have none?  
Be she of the most accurst,  
And deserve the name of worst!  
If she be not so to me,  
What care I how bad she be?

'Cause her fortunes seem too low,  
Shall I therefore let her go?  
He that bears an humble mind  
And with riches can be kind,  
Think how kind a heart he'd have,  
If he were some servile slave!  
And if that same mind I see  
What care I how poor she be?

Poor, or bad, or curst, or black,  
I will ne'er the more be slack!  
If she hate me (then believe!)  
She shall die ere I will grieve!  
If she like me when I woo  
I can like and love her too!  
If that she be fit for me!  
What care I what others be?

*Ben Jonson.*

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## SONG OF THE SPRINGTIDE

O Season supposed of all free flowers,  
    Made lovely by light of the sun,  
Of garden, of field, and of tree-flowers,  
    Thy singers are surely in fun!  
Or what is it wholly unsettles  
    Thy sequence of shower and shine,  
And maketh thy pushings and petals  
    To shrivel and pine?

Why is it that o'er the wild waters  
    That beastly North-Easter still blows,  
Dust-dimming the eyes of our daughters,  
    Blue-nipping each nice little nose?  
Why is it these sea-skirted islands  
    Are plagued with perpetual chills,  
Driving men to Italian or Nile-lands  
    From Albion's ills?

Happy he, O Springtide, who hath found thee,  
    All sunlit, in luckier lands,  
With thy garment of greenery round thee,  
    And belted with blossomy bands.  
From us by the blast thou art drifted,  
    All brag of thy beauties is bosh;  
When the songs of thy singers are sifted,  
    They simply won't wash.

What lunatic lune, what vain vision,  
    Thy laureate, Springtide, may move  
To sing thee,—oh, bitter derision!  
    A season of laughter and love?  
You make a man mad beyond measure,  
    O Spring, and thy lauders like thee:

Thy flowers, thy pastimes and pleasures,  
Are fiddlededee!

*Unknown.*

---

## THE VILLAGE CHOIR

Half a bar, half a bar,  
Half a bar onward!  
Into an awful ditch  
Choir and precentor hitch,  
Into a mess of pitch,  
    They led the Old Hundred.  
Trebles to right of them,  
Tenors to left of them,  
Basses in front of them,  
    Bellowed and thundered.  
Oh, that precentor's look,  
When the sopranos took  
Their own time and hook  
    From the Old Hundred!  
Screeched all the trebles here,  
Boggled the tenors there,  
Raising the parson's hair,  
    While his mind wandered;  
Theirs not to reason why  
This psalm was pitched too high:  
Theirs but to gasp and cry  
    Out the Old Hundred.  
Trebles to right of them,  
Tenors to left of them,  
Basses in front of them,  
    Bellowed and thundered.

Stormed they with shout and yell,  
Not wise they sang nor well,  
Drowning the sexton's bell,  
While all the church wondered.

Dire the percenter's glare,  
Flashed his pitchfork in air  
Sounding fresh keys to bear  
Out the Old Hundred.  
Swiftly he turned his back,  
Reached he his hat from rack,  
Then from the screaming pack,  
Himself he sundered.  
Tenors to right of him,  
Tenors to left of him,  
Discords behind him,  
Bellowed and thundered.  
Oh, the wild howls they wrought:  
Right to the end they fought!  
Some tune they sang, but not,  
Not the Old Hundred.

*Unknown.*

---

## **MY FOE**

John Alcohol, my foe, John,  
When we were first acquaint,  
I'd siller in my pockets, John,  
Which noo, ye ken, I want;  
I spent it all in treating, John,  
Because I loved you so;

But mark ye, how you've treated me,  
John Alcohol, my foe.

John Alcohol, my foe, John,  
We've been ower lang together,  
Sae ye maun tak' ae road, John,  
And I will take anither;  
For we maun tumble down, John,  
If hand in hand we go;  
And I shall hae the bill to pay,  
John Alcohol, my foe.

John Alcohol, my foe, John,  
Ye've blear'd out a' my een,  
And lighted up my nose, John,  
A fiery sign atween!  
My hands wi' palsy shake, John,  
My locks are like the snow;  
Ye'll surely be the death of me,  
John Alcohol, my foe.

John Alcohol, my foe, John,  
'Twas love to you, I ween,  
That gart me rise sae ear', John,  
And sit sae late at e'en;  
The best o' friens maun part, John,  
It grieves me sair, ye know;  
But "we'll nae mair to yon town,"  
John Alcohol, my foe.

John Alcohol, my foe, John,  
Ye've wrought me muckle skaith;  
And yet to part wi' you, John,  
I own I'm unko' laith;  
But I'll join the temperance ranks, John,  
Ye needna say me no;

It's better late than ne'er do weel,  
John Alcohol, my foe.

*Unknown.*

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## **NURSERY SONG IN PIDGIN ENGLISH**

Singee a songee sick a pence,  
Pockee muchee lye;  
Dozen two time blackee bird  
Cookee in e pie.  
When him cutee topside  
Birdee bobbery sing;  
Himee tinkee nicey dish.  
Setee foree King!

Kingee in a talkee loom  
Countee muchee money;  
Queeny in e kitchee,  
Chew-chee breadee honey.  
Servant galo shakee,  
Hangee washee clothes;  
Cho-chop comee blackie bird,  
Nipee off her nose!

*Unknown.*

---

## **FATHER WILLIAM**

"You are old, Father William," the young man said,  
"And your nose has a look of surprise;  
Your eyes have turned round to the back of your head,  
And you live upon cucumber pies."  
"I know it, I know it," the old man replied,  
"And it comes from employing a quack,  
Who said if I laughed when the crocodile died  
I should never have pains in my back."

"You are old, Father William," the young man said,  
"And your legs always get in your way;  
You use too much mortar in mixing your bread,  
And you try to drink timothy hay."  
"Very true, very true," said the wretched old man,  
"Every word that you tell me is true;  
And it's caused by my having my kerosene can  
Painted red where it ought to be blue."

"You are old, Father William," the young man said,  
"And your teeth are beginning to freeze,  
Your favorite daughter has wheels in her head,  
And the chickens are eating your knees."  
"You are right," said the old man, "I cannot deny,  
That my troubles are many and great,  
But I'll butter my ears on the Fourth of July,  
And then I'll be able to skate."

*Unknown.*

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## **A POE-'EM OF PASSION**



It was many and many a year ago,  
On an island near the sea,  
That a maiden lived whom you mightn't know  
By the name of Cannibalee;  
And this maiden she lived with no other thought  
Than a passionate fondness for me.

I was a child, and she was a child—  
Tho' her tastes were adult Feejee—  
But she loved with a love that was more than love,  
My yearning Cannibalee;  
With a love that could take me roast or fried  
Or raw, as the case might be.

And that is the reason that long ago,  
In that island near the sea,  
I had to turn the tables and eat  
My ardent Cannibalee—  
Not really because I was fond of her,  
But to check her fondness for me.

But the stars never rise but I think of the size  
Of my hot-potted Cannibalee,  
And the moon never stares but it brings me nightmares  
Of my spare-rib Cannibalee;  
And all the night-tide she is restless inside,  
Is my still indigestible dinner-belle bride,  
In her pallid tomb, which is Me,  
In her solemn sepulcher, Me.

*C. F. Lummis.*

---

**HOW THE DAUGHTERS COME DOWN AT DUNOON**

How do the daughters  
Come down at Dunoon?

Daintily,  
Tenderly,  
Fairily,  
Gingerly,  
Glidingly,  
Slidingly,  
Slippingly,  
Skippingly,  
Trippingly,  
Clippingly,  
Bumpingly,  
Thumpingly,  
Stumpingly,  
Clumpingly,

Starting and bolting,  
And darting and jolting,  
And tottering and staggering,  
And lumbering and slithering,  
And hurrying and scurrying,  
And worrying and flurrying,

And rushing and leaping and crushing and creeping;  
Feathers a-flying all—bonnets untying all—  
Petticoats rapping and flapping and slapping all,  
Crinolines flowing and blowing and showing all  
Balmorals, dancing and glancing, entrancing all;

Feats of activity—  
Nymphs on declivity—  
Mothers in extacies—  
Fathers in vextacies—

Lady-loves whisking and frisking and clinging on  
True-lovers puffing and blowing and springing on,  
Dashing and clashing and shying and flying on,  
Blushing and flushing and wriggling and giggling on,  
Teasing and pleasing and squeezing and wheezing on,

Everlastingly falling and bawling and sprawling on,  
Tumbling and rumbling and grumbling and stumbling on,  
Any fine afternoon,  
About July or June—  
That's just how the Daughters  
Come down at Dunoon!

*H. Cholmondeley Pennell.*

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## **TO AN IMPORTUNATE HOST**

### **DURING DINNER AND AFTER TENNYSON**

Ask me no more: I've had enough Chablis;  
The wine may come again, and take the shape,  
From glass to glass, of "Mountain" or of "Cape;"  
But, my dear boy, when I have answered thee,  
Ask me no more.

Ask me no more: what answer should I give,  
I love not pickled pork nor partridge pie;  
I feel if I took whisky I should die!  
Ask me no more—for I prefer to live:  
Ask me no more.

Ask me no more: unless my fate is sealed,  
And I have striven against you all in vain.  
Let your good butler bring me Hock again:  
Then rest, dear boy. If for this once I yield,  
Ask me no more!  
*Unknown.*

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## CREMATION

BY A BURNING ADMIRER OF SIR HENRY THOMPSON

To Urn, or not to Urn? that is the question:  
Whether 'tis nobler for our frames to suffer  
The shows and follies of outrageous custom,  
Or to take fire—against a sea of zealots—  
And by consuming, end them? To Urn—to keep—  
No more: and while we keep, to say we end  
Contagion and the thousand graveyard ills  
That flesh is heir to—'tis a consume-ation  
Devoutly to be wished! To burn—to keep—  
To keep! Perchance to lose—aye, there's the rub:  
For in the course of things what duns may come,  
Or who may shuffle off our Dresden urn,  
Must give us pause. There's the respect  
That makes inter-i-ment of so long use.  
For who would have the pall and plumes of hire,  
The tradesman's prize—a proud man's obsequies,  
The chaffering for graves, the legal fee,  
The cemetery beadle and the rest,  
When he himself might his few ashes make  
With a mere furnace? Who would tombstones bear,  
And lie beneath a lying epitaph,  
But that the dread of simmering after death—  
That uncongenial furnace from whose burn  
No incremate returns—weakens the will,  
And makes us rather bear the graves we have  
Than fly to ovens that we know not of?  
This, Thompson, does make cowards of us all.  
And thus the wisdom of incineration  
Is thick-laid o'er with the pale ghost of nought,  
And incremators of great pith and courage

With this regard their faces turn awry,  
And shudder at cremation.

*William Sawyer.*

---

## AN IMITATION OF WORDSWORTH

There is a river clear and fair,  
'Tis neither broad nor narrow;  
It winds a little here and there—  
It winds about like any hare;  
And then it takes as straight a course  
As on the turnpike road a horse,  
Or through the air an arrow.

The trees that grow upon the shore,  
Have grown a hundred years or more;  
So long there is no knowing.  
Old Daniel Dobson does not know  
When first these trees began to grow;  
But still they grew, and grew, and grew,  
As if they'd nothing else to do,  
But ever to be growing.

The impulses of air and sky  
Have rear'd their stately heads so high,  
And clothed their boughs with green;  
Their leaves the dews of evening quaff,—  
And when the wind blows loud and keen,  
I've seen the jolly timbers laugh,  
And shake their sides with merry glee—  
Wagging their heads in mockery.

Fix'd are their feet in solid earth,  
Where winds can never blow;  
But visitings of deeper birth  
Have reach'd their roots below.  
For they have gain'd the river's brink,  
And of the living waters drink.

There's little Will, a five years child—  
He is my youngest boy:  
To look on eyes so fair and wild,  
It is a very joy:—  
He hath conversed with sun and shower  
And dwelt with every idle flower,  
As fresh and gay as them.  
He loiters with the briar rose,—  
The blue-belles are his play-fellows,  
That dance upon their slender stem.

And I have said, my little Will,  
Why should not he continue still  
A thing of Nature's rearing?  
A thing beyond the world's control—  
A living vegetable soul,—  
No human sorrow fearing.

It were a blessed sight to see  
That child become a Willow-tree,  
His brother trees among.  
He'd be four times as tall as me,  
And live three times as long.

*Catharine M. Fanshawe.*

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## THE LAY OF THE LOVE-LORN

## PARODY ON TENNYSON'S "LOCKSLEY HALL"

Comrades, you may pass the rosy. With permission of the chair,  
I shall leave you for a little, for I'd like to take the air.

Whether 'twas the sauce at dinner, or that glass of ginger-beer,  
Or these strong cheroots, I know not, but I feel a little queer.

Let me go. Now, Chuckster, blow me, 'pon my soul, this is too bad!  
When you want me, ask the waiter, he knows where I'm to be had!

Whew! This is a great relief now! Let me but undo my stock;  
Resting here beneath the porch, my nerves will steady like a rock.

In my ears I hear the singing of a lot of favourite tunes—  
Bless my heart, how very odd! Why, surely, there's a brace of moons!

See—the stars! How bright they twinkle, winking with a frosty glare,  
Like my faithless cousin Amy when she drove me to despair.

Oh, my cousin, spider-hearted! Oh, my Amy! No, confound it!  
I must wear the mournful willow—all around my hat I've bound it.

Falser than the Bank of Fancy, frailer than a shilling glove,  
Puppet to a father's anger, minion to a nabob's love!

Is it well to wish thee happy? Having known me, could you ever  
Stoop to marry half a heart, and little more than half a liver?

Happy! Damme! Thou shalt lower to his level day by day,  
Changing from the best of china to the commonest of clay.

As the husband is, the wife is. He is stomach-plagued and old,  
And his curry soups will make thy cheek the colour of his gold.

When his feeble love is sated, he will hold thee surely then

Something lower than his hookah, something less than his cayenne.

What is this? His eyes are pinky. Was't the claret? Oh, no, no—  
Bless your soul, it was the salmon—salmon always makes him so.

Take him to thy dainty chamber, soothe him with thy lightest fancies,  
He will understand thee, won't he—pay thee with a lover's glances?

Louder than the loudest trumpet, harsh as harshest ophicleide,  
Nasal respirations answer the endearments of his bride.

Sweet response, delightful music! Gaze upon thy noble charge  
Till the spirit fill thy bosom that inspired the meek Lafarge.

Better thou wert dead before me, better, better that I stood  
Looking on thy murdered body, like the injured Daniel Good!

Better thou and I were lying, cold and limber-stiff and dead,  
With a pan of burning charcoal underneath our nuptial bed!

Cursed be the Bank of England's notes, that tempt the soul to sin!  
Cursed be the want of acres—doubly cursed the want of tin!

Cursed be the marriage contract, that enslaved thy soul to greed!  
Cursed be the sallow lawyer, that prepared and drew the deed!

Cursed be his foul apprentice, who the loathsome fees did earn!  
Cursed be the clerk and parson—cursed be the whole concern!

Oh, 'tis well that I should bluster; much I'm like to make of that.  
Better comfort have I found in singing "All Around My Hat."

But that song, so wildly plaintive, palls upon my British ears.  
'Twill not do to pine for ever: I am getting up in years.

Can't I turn the honest penny, scribbling for the weekly press,  
And in writing Sunday libels drown my private wretchedness?



Oh, to feel the wild pulsation that in manhood's dawn I knew,  
When my days were all before me, and my years were twenty-two;

When I smoked my independent pipe along the Quadrant wide,  
With the many larks of London flaring up on every side;

When I went the pace so wildly, caring little what might come,  
Coffee-milling care and sorrow, with a nose-adapted thumb;

Felt the exquisite enjoyment, tossing nightly off, oh, heavens!  
Brandy at the Cider Cellars, kidneys smoking-hot at Evans';

Or in the Adelphi sitting, half in rapture, half in tears,  
Saw the glorious melodrama conjure up the shades of years—

Saw Jack Sheppard, noble stripling, act his wondrous feats again,  
Snapping Newgate's bars of iron, like an infant's daisy chain;

Might was right, and all the terrors which had held the world in awe  
Were despised and priggish prospered, spite of Laurie, spite of law.

In such scenes as these I triumphed, ere my passion's edge was rusted,  
And my cousin's cold refusal left me very much disgusted!

Since, my heart is sore and withered, and I do not care a curse  
Whether worse shall be the better, or the better be the worse.

Hark! my merry comrades call me, bawling for another jorum;  
They would mock me in derision, should I thus appear before 'em.

Womankind no more shall vex me, such, at least, as go arrayed  
In the most expensive satins, and the newest silk brocade.

I'll to Afric, lion-haunted, where the giant forest yields  
Rarer robes and finer tissue than are sold at Spitalfields.

Or to burst all chains of habit, flinging habit's self aside,  
I shall walk the tangled jungle in mankind's primeval pride;

Feeding on the luscious berries and the rich casava root,  
Lots of dates and lots of guavas, clusters of forbidden fruit.

Never comes the trader thither, never o'er the purple main  
Sounds the oath of British commerce, or the accents of Cockaigne.

There, methinks, would be enjoyment, where no envious rule prevents;  
Sink the steamboats! Cuss the railways! Rot, oh, rot the Three per Cents!

There the passions, cramped no longer, shall have space to breathe, my  
cousin!  
I will take some savage woman—nay, I'll take at least a dozen.

There I'll rear my young mulattoes, as no Bond Street brats are reared:  
They shall dive for alligators, catch the wild goats by the beard,

Whistle to the cockatoos, and mock the hairy-faced baboon,  
Worship mighty Mumbo Jumbo, in the mountains of the Moon.

I, myself, in far Timbuctoo, leopard's blood will daily quaff,  
Ride a-tiger-hunting, mounted on a thorough-bred giraffe.

Fiercely shall I shout the war-whoop, as some sullen stream he crosses,  
Startling from their noon-day slumbers iron-bound rhinoceroses.

Fool! Again, the dream, the fancy! But I know my words are mad,  
For I hold the gray barbarian lower than the Christian cad.

I, the swell, the city dandy! I to seek such horrid places,  
I to haunt with squalid Negroes, blubber-lips, and monkey faces!

I to wed with Coromantees! I, who managed—very near—  
To secure the heart and fortune of the widow Shillibeer!

Stuff and nonsense! Let me never fling a single chance away.  
Maids ere now, I know, have loved me, and another maiden may.

*Morning Post* (*The Times* won't trust me), help me, as I know you can;  
I will pen an advertisement—that's a never-failing plan:

"WANTED—By a bard in wedlock, some young interesting woman.  
Looks are not so much an object, if the shiners be forthcoming!

"Hymen's chains, the advertiser vows, shall be but silken fetters.  
Please address to A. T., Chelsea. N.B.—You must pay the letters."

That's the sort of thing to do it. Now I'll go and taste the balmy.  
Rest thee with thy yellow nabob, spider-hearted cousin Amy!

*Aytoun and Martin.*

---

## ONLY SEVEN

### A PASTORAL STORY AFTER WORDSWORTH

I marvell'd why a simple child,  
That lightly draws its breath,  
Should utter groans so very wild,  
And look as pale as Death.

Adopting a parental tone,  
I ask'd her why she cried;  
The damsel answered with a groan,  
"I've got a pain inside!

"I thought it would have sent me mad  
Last night about eleven."

Said I, "What is it makes you bad?  
How many apples have you had?"  
She answered, "Only seven!"

"And are you sure you took no more,  
My little maid?" quoth I;  
"Oh, please, sir, mother gave me four,  
But *they* were in a pie!"

"If that's the case," I stammer'd out,  
"Of course you've had eleven."  
The maiden answer'd with a pout,  
"I ain't had more nor seven!"

I wonder'd hugely what she meant,  
And said, "I'm bad at riddles;  
But I know where little girls are sent  
For telling taradiddles.

"Now, if you won't reform," said I,  
"You'll never go to Heaven."  
But all in vain; each time I try,  
That little idiot makes reply,  
"I ain't had more nor seven!"

#### POSTSCRIPT

To borrow Wordsworth's name was wrong,  
Or slightly misapplied;  
And so I'd better call my song,  
"Lines after Ache-Inside."

*Henry S. Leigh.*

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**'T WAS EVER THUS**

I never rear'd a young gazelle,  
    (Because, you see, I never tried);  
But had it known and loved me well,  
    No doubt the creature would have died.  
My rich and aged Uncle John  
    Has known me long and loves me well  
But still persists in living on—  
    I would he were a young gazelle.

I never loved a tree or flower;  
    But, if I had, I beg to say  
The blight, the wind, the sun, or shower  
    Would soon have withered it away.  
I've dearly loved my Uncle John,  
    From childhood to the present hour,  
And yet he will go living on—  
    I would he were a tree or flower!

*Henry S. Leigh.*

---

## **FOAM AND FANGS**

O nymph with the nicest of noses;  
    And finest and fairest of forms;  
Lips ruddy and ripe as the roses  
    That sway and that surge in the storms;  
O buoyant and blooming Bacchante,  
    Of fairer than feminine face,  
Rush, raging as demon of Dante—  
    To this, my embrace!

The foam and the fangs and the flowers,

The raving and ravenous rage  
Of a poet as pinion'd in powers  
As a condor confined in a cage!  
My heart in a haystack I've hidden,  
As loving and longing I lie,  
Kiss open thine eyelids unbidden—  
I gaze and I die!

I've wander'd the wild waste of slaughter,  
I've sniffed up the sepulchre's scent,  
I've doated on devilry's daughter,  
And murmur'd much more than I meant;  
I've paused at Penelope's portal,  
So strange are the sights that I've seen,  
And mighty's the mind of the mortal  
Who knows what I mean.

*Walter Parke.*

---

**X**

# NARRATIVE

## LITTLE BILLEE

There were three sailors of Bristol City  
Who took a boat and went to sea,  
But first with beef and captain's biscuits,  
And pickled pork they loaded she.

There was gorging Jack, and guzzling Jimmy,  
And the youngest he was little Billee.  
Now when they'd got as far as the Equator  
They'd nothing left but one split pea.

Says gorging Jack to guzzling Jimmy,  
"I am extremely hungaree."  
To gorging Jack says guzzling Jimmy,  
"We've nothing left, us must eat we."

Says gorging Jack to guzzling Jimmy,  
"With one another we shouldn't agree!  
There's little Bill, he's young and tender,  
"We're old and tough, so let's eat he."

"O Billy! we're going to kill and eat you,  
So undo the button of your chemie."  
When Bill received this information,  
He used his pocket-handkerchie.

"First let me say my catechism,  
Which my poor mother taught to me."



"Make haste! make haste!" says guzzling Jimmy,  
While Jack pulled out his snicker-snee.

Then Bill went up to the main-top-gallant-mast,  
And down he fell on his bended knee,  
He scarce had come to the Twelfth Commandment  
When up he jumps—"There's land I see!"

"Jerusalem and Madagascar,  
And North and South Amerikee,  
There's the British flag a-riding at anchor,  
With Sir Admiral Napier, K.C.B."

So when they got aboard of the Admiral's,  
He hanged fat Jack and flogged Jimmee,  
But as for little Bill, he made him  
The captain of a Seventy-three.

*W. M. Thackeray.*

---

## THE CRYSTAL PALACE

With ganial foire  
Thransfuse me loyre,  
Ye sacred nymphs of Pindus,  
The whoile I sing  
That wondthrous thing,  
The Palace made o' windows!

Say, Paxton, truth,  
Thou wondthrous youth,  
What sthroke of art celistial,  
What power was lint

You to invint  
This combineetion cristial.

O would before  
That Thomas Moore,  
Likewise the late Lord Boyron,  
Thim aigles sthrong  
Of godlike song,  
Cast oi on that cast oiron!

And saw thim walls,  
And glittering halls,  
Thim rising slendther columns,  
Which I, poor pote,  
Could not denote,  
No, not in twinty vollums.

My Muse's words  
Is like the bird's  
That roosts beneath the panes there;  
Her wings she spoils  
'Gainst them bright toiles,  
And cracks her silly brains there.

This Palace tall,  
This Cristial Hall,  
Which Imperors might covet,  
Stands in High Park  
Like Noah's Ark,  
A rainbow bint above it.

The towers and fanes,  
In other scaynes,  
The fame of this will undo,  
Saint Paul's big doom,  
Saint Payther's, Room.  
And Dublin's proud Rotundo.

'Tis here that roams,  
As well becomes  
Her dignitee and stations,  
Victoria Great,  
And houlds in state  
The Congress of the Nations.

Her subjects pours  
From distant shores,  
Her Injians and Canajians,  
And also we,  
Her kingdoms three,  
Attind with our allagiance.

Here come likewise  
Her bould allies,  
Both Asian and European;  
From East and West  
They send their best  
To fill her Coornucopean.

I seen (thank Grace!)  
This wondthrous place  
(His Noble Honour Mither  
H. Cole it was  
That gave the pass,  
And let me see what is there).

With conscious proide  
I stud insoide  
And look'd the World's Great Fair in,  
Until me sight  
Was dazzled quite,  
And couldn't see for staring.

There's holy saints

And window paints,  
By maydiayval Pugin;  
Alhamborough Jones  
Did paint the tones,  
Of yellow and gambouge in.

There's fountains there  
And crosses fair;  
There's water-gods with urns;  
There's organs three,  
To play, d'ye see,  
"God save the Queen," by turns.

There's statues bright  
Of marble white,  
Of silver, and of copper;  
And some in zinc,  
And some, I think,  
That isn't over proper.

There's staym injynes,  
That stands in lines,  
Enormous and amazing,  
That squeal and snort  
Like whales in sport,  
Or elephants a-grazing.

There's carts and gigs,  
And pins for pigs,  
There's dibblers and there's harrows,  
And ploughs like toys  
For little boys,  
And illigant wheelbarrows.

For thim genteels  
Who ride on wheels,  
There's plenty to indulge 'em:

There's droskys snug  
From Paytersbug,  
And vayhycles from Bulgium.

There's cabs on stands  
And shandthrydanns;  
There's wagons from New York here;  
There's Lapland sleighs  
Have cross'd the seas,  
And jaunting cyars from Cork here.

Amazed I pass  
From glass to glass,  
Deloighted I survey 'em;  
Fresh wondthers grows  
Before me nose  
In this sublime Musayum!

Look, here's a fan  
From far Japan,  
A sabre from Damasco:  
There's shawls ye get  
From far Thibet,  
And cotton prints from Glasgow.

There's German flutes,  
Marocky boots,  
And Naples macaronies;  
Bohaymia  
Has sent Behay;  
Polonia her polonies.

There's granite flints  
That's quite imminse,  
There's sacks of coals and fuels,  
There's swords and guns,  
And soap in tuns,

And gingerbread and jewels.

There's taypots there,  
And cannons rare;  
There's coffins fill'd with roses;  
There's canvas tints,  
Teeth insthrumints,  
And shuits of clothes by Moses.

There's lashins more  
Of things in store,  
But thim I don't remimber;  
Nor could disclose  
Did I compose  
From May time to Novimber!

Ah, Judy thru!  
With eyes so blue,  
That you were here to view it!  
And could I screw  
But tu pound tu,  
'Tis I would thrait you to it!

So let us raise  
Victoria's praise,  
And Albert's proud condition  
That takes his ayse  
As he surveys  
This Cristial Exhibition.

*W. M. Thackeray.*

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**THE WOFLE NEW BALLAD OF JANE RONEY AND MARY  
BROWN**

An igstrawnary tail I vill tell you this veek—  
I stood in the Court of A'Beckett the Beak,  
Vere Mrs. Jane Roney, a widow, I see,  
Who charged Mary Brown with a robbin' of she.

This Mary was pore and in misery once,  
And she came to Mrs. Roney it's more than twelve monce  
She adn't got no bed, nor no dinner, nor no tea,  
And kind Mrs. Roney gave Mary all three.

Mrs. Roney kep Mary for ever so many weeks  
(Her conduct disgusted the best of all Beax),  
She kept her for nothink, as kind as could be,  
Never thinking that this Mary was a traitor to she.

"Mrs. Roney, O Mrs. Roney, I feel very ill;  
Will you jest step to the doctor's for to fetch me a pill?"  
"That I will, my pore Mary," Mrs. Roney says she:  
And she goes off to the doctor's as quickly as may be.

No sooner on this message Mrs. Roney was sped,  
Than hup gits vicked Mary, and jumps out a bed;  
She hopens all the trunks without never a key—  
She bustes all the boxes, and vith them makes free.

Mrs. Roney's best linning gownds, petticoats, and close,  
Her children's little coats and things, her boots and her hose,  
She packed them, and she stole 'em, and away vith them did flee  
Mrs. Roney's situation—you may think vat it vould be!

Of Mary, ungrateful, who had served her this vay,  
Mrs. Roney heard nothink for a long year and a day,  
Till last Thursday, in Lambeth, ven whom should she see?  
But this Mary, as had acted so ungrateful to she.

She was leaning on the helbo of a worthy young man;

They were going to be married, and were walkin hand in hand;  
And the church-bells was a ringin for Mary and he,  
And the parson was ready, and a waitin' for his fee.

When up comes Mrs. Roney, and faces Mary Brown,  
Who trembles, and castes her eyes upon the ground.  
She calls a jolly pleaseman, it happens to be me;  
I charge this young woman, Mr. Pleaseman, says she.

Mrs. Roney, o, Mrs. Roney, o, do let me go,  
I acted most ungrateful I own, and I know,  
But the marriage bell is ringin, and the ring you may see,  
And this young man is a waitin, says Mary, says she.

I don't care three fardens for the parson and clark,  
And the bell may keep ringin from noon day to dark.  
Mary Brown, Mary Brown, you must come along with me.  
And I think this young man is lucky to be free.

So, in spite of the tears which bejewed Mary's cheek,  
I took that young gurl to A'Beckett the Beak;  
That exlent justice demanded her plea—  
But never a sullable said Mary said she.

On account of her conduck so base and so vile,  
That wicked young gurl is committed for trile,  
And if she's transpawted beyond the salt sea,  
It's a proper reward for such willians as she.

Now, you young gurls of Southwark for Mary who veep,  
From pickin and stealin your ands you must keep,  
Or it may be my dooty, as it was Thursday veek  
To pull you all hup to A'Beckett the Beak.

*W. M. Thackeray.*

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## KING JOHN AND THE ABBOT

An ancient story Ile tell you anon  
Of a notable prince, that was called King John;  
And he ruled England with maine and with might,  
For he did great wrong, and maintein'd little right.

And Ile tell you a story, a story so merrie,  
Concerning the Abbot of Canterbùrye;  
How for his house-keeping, and high renowne,  
They rode poste for him to fair London towne.

An hundred men, the king did heare say,  
The abbot kept in his house every day;  
And fifty golde chaynes, without any doubt,  
In velvet coates waited the abbot about.

How now, father abbot, I heare it of thee,  
Thou keepest a farre better house than mee,  
And for thy house-keeping and high renowne,  
I feare thou work'st treason against my crown.

My liege, quo' the abbot, I would it were knowne,  
I never spend nothing but what is my owne;  
And I trust your grace will doe me no deere  
For spending of my owne true-gotten geere.

Yes, yes, father abbot, thy fault it is highe,  
And now for the same thou needest must dye;  
For except thou canst answer me questions three,  
Thy head shall be smitten from thy bodie.

And first, quo' the king, when I'm in this stead,  
With my crowne of golde so faire on my head,  
Among all my liege-men, so noble of birthe,  
Thou must tell me to one penny what I am worthe.

Secondlye, tell me, without any doubt,  
How soone I may ride the whole world about,  
And at the third question thou must not shrink,  
But tell me here truly what I do think.

O, these are hard questions for my shallow witt,  
Nor I cannot answer your grace as yet;  
But if you will give me but three weekes space,  
Ile do my endeavour to answer your grace.

Now three weeks space to thee will I give.  
And that is the longest time thou hast to live;  
For if thou dost not answer my questions three,  
Thy lands and thy livings are forfeit to mee.

Away rode the abbot, all sad at that word,  
And he rode to Cambridge and Oxenford;  
But never a doctor there was so wise,  
That could with his learning an answer devise.

Then home rode the abbot, of comfort so cold,  
And he mett his shepheard agoing to fold:  
How now, my lord abbot, you are welcome home  
What newes do you bring us from good King John?

Sad newes, sad newes, shepheard, I must give:  
That I have but three days more to live;  
For if I do not answer him questions three,  
My head will be smitten from my bodie.

The first is to tell him there in that stead,  
With his crowne of golde so fair on his head  
Among all his liege-men so noble of birth,  
To within one penny of what he is worth.

The seconde, to tell him, without any doubt,

How soone he may ride this whole world about:  
And at the third question I must not shrink,  
But tell him there truly what he does thinke.

Now cheare up, sire abbot, did you never hear yet,  
That a fool he may learne a wise man witt?  
Lend me horse, and serving-men, and your apparel,  
And I'll ride to London to answere your quarrel.

Nay frowne not, if it hath bin told unto mee,  
I am like your lordship, as ever may bee:  
And if you will but lend me your gowne,  
There is none shall knowe us in fair London towne.

Now horses and serving-men thou shalt have,  
With sumptuous array most gallant and brave;  
With crozier, and miter, and rochet, and cope,  
Fit to appears 'fore our fader the pope.

Now welcome, sire abbot, the king he did say,  
'Tis well thou'rt come back to keepe thy day;  
For and if thou canst answer my questions three,  
Thy life and thy living both saved shall bee.

And first, when thou seest me here in this stead,  
With my crown of golde so fair on my head,  
Among all my liege-men so noble of birthe,  
Tell me to one penny what I am worth.

For thirty pence our Saviour was sold  
Among the false Jewes, as I have bin told:  
And twenty-nine is the worth of thee,  
For I thinke, thou art one penny worser than hee.

The king he laughed, and swore by St. Bittel,  
I did not think I had been worth so littel!  
—Now secondly tell me, without any doubt,

How soone I may ride this whole world about.

You must rise with the sun, and ride with the same,  
Until the next morning he riseth againe;  
And then your grace need not make any doubt  
But in twenty-four hours you'll ride it about.

The king he laughed, and swore by St. Jone,  
I did not think it could be gone so soone!  
—Now from the third question thou must not shrink,  
But tell me here truly what I do thinke.

Yea, that shall I do, and make your grace merry:  
You thinke I'm the abbot of Canterbùry;  
But I'm his poor shepheard, as plain you may see,  
That am come to beg pardon for him and for mee.

The king he laughed, and swore by the masse,  
Ile make thee lord abbot this day in his place!  
Now naye, my liege, be not in such speede,  
For alacke I can neither write, ne reade.

Four nobles a week, then, I will give thee,  
For this merry jest thou hast showne unto mee:  
And tell the old abbot, when thou comest home,  
Thou hast brought him a pardon from good King John.

*From Percy's Reliques.*

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**ON THE DEATH OF A FAVORITE CAT,  
DROWNED IN A TUB OF GOLDFISHES**

'Twas on a lofty vase's side,  
Where China's gayest art had dyed  
The azure flowers that blow,  
Demurest of the tabby kind,  
The pensive Selima, reclined,  
Gazed on the lake below.

Her conscious tail her joy declared;  
The fair round face, the snowy beard,  
The velvet of her paws,  
Her coat that with the tortoise vies,  
Her ears of jet, and emerald eyes,  
She saw, and purred applause.

Still had she gaz'd, but, 'midst the tide,  
Two angel forms were seen to glide,  
The Genii of the stream:  
Their scaly armor's Tyrian hue,  
Through richest purple, to the view  
Betrayed a golden gleam.

The hapless nymph with wonder saw:  
A whisker first, and then a claw,  
With many an ardent wish,  
She stretched in vain to reach the prize:  
What female heart can gold despise?  
What Cat's averse to fish?

Presumptuous maid! with looks intent,  
Again she stretched, again she bent,  
Nor knew the gulf between:  
(Malignant Fate sat by and smiled)  
The slippery verge her feet beguiled;  
She tumbled headlong in.

Eight times emerging from the flood,

She mewed to every watery god  
Some speedy aid to send.  
No Dolphin came, no Nereid stirred,  
Nor cruel Tom or Susan heard:  
A fav'rite has no friend!

From hence, ye Beauties! undeceived,  
Know one false step is ne'er retrieved,  
And be with caution bold:  
Not all that tempts your wandering eyes,  
And heedless hearts, is lawful prize,  
Nor all that glistens gold.

*Thomas Gray.*

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## MISADVENTURES AT MARGATE

### A LEGEND OF JARVIS'S JETTY

MR. SIMPKINSON (*loquitur*)

I was in Margate last July, I walk'd upon the pier,  
I saw a little vulgar Boy—I said "What make you here?—  
The gloom upon your youthful cheek speaks any thing but joy;"  
Again I said, "What make you here, you little vulgar Boy?"

He frown'd, that little vulgar Boy—he deem'd I meant to scoff:  
And when the little heart is big, a little "sets it off";  
He put his finger in his mouth, his little bosom rose,—  
He had no little handkerchief to wipe his little nose!

"Hark! don't you hear, my little man?—it's striking nine," I said,  
"An hour when all good little boys and girls should be in bed.

Run home and get your supper, else your Ma' will scold—Oh! fie!—  
It's very wrong indeed for little boys to stand and cry!"

The tear-drop in his little eye again began to spring,  
His bosom throb'd with agony—he cried like any thing!  
I stoop'd, and thus amidst his sobs I heard him murmur—"Ah  
I haven't got no supper! and I haven't got no Ma'!!—

"My father, he is on the seas,—my mother's dead and gone!  
And I am here, on this here pier, to roam the world alone;  
I have not had, this live-long day, one drop to cheer my heart,  
Nor '*brown*' to buy a bit of bread with,—let alone a tart.

"If there's a soul will give me food, or find me in employ,  
By day or night, then blow me tight!" (he was a vulgar Boy);  
"And now I'm here, from this here pier it is my fixed intent  
To jump, as Mr. Levi did from off the Monu-ment!"

"Cheer up! cheer up! my little man—cheer up!" I kindly said.  
"You are a naughty boy to take such things into your head:  
If you should jump from off the pier, you'd surely break your legs,  
Perhaps your neck—then Bogey'd have you, sure as eggs are eggs!

"Come home with me, my little man, come home with me and sup;  
My landlady is Mrs. Jones—we must not keep her up—  
There's roast potatoes on the fire,—enough for me and you—  
Come home,—you little vulgar Boy—I lodge at Number 2."

I took him home to Number 2, the house beside "The Foy,"  
I bade him wipe his dirty shoes,—that little vulgar Boy,—  
And then I said to Mistress Jones, the kindest of her sex,  
"Pray be so good as go and fetch a pint of double X!"

But Mrs. Jones was rather cross, she made a little noise,  
She said she "did not like to wait on little vulgar Boys."  
She with her apron wiped the plates, and, as she rubb'd the delf,  
Said I might "go to Jericho, and fetch my beer myself!"

I did not go to Jericho—I went to Mr. Cobb—  
I changed a shilling—(which in town the people call "a Bob")—  
It was not so much for myself as for that vulgar child—  
And I said, "A pint of double X, and please to draw it mild!"

When I came back I gazed about—I gazed on stool and chair—  
I could not see my little friend—because he was not there!  
I peep'd beneath the table-cloth—beneath the sofa too—  
I said "You little vulgar Boy! why what's become of you?"

I could not see my table-spoons—I look'd, but could not see  
The little fiddle-pattern'd ones I use when I'm at tea;  
—I could not see my sugar-tongs—my silver watch—oh, dear!  
I know 'twas on the mantle-piece when I went out for beer.

I could not see my Mackintosh!—it was not to be seen!  
Nor yet my best white beaver hat, broad-brimm'd and lined with green;  
My carpet-bag—my cruet-stand, that holds my sauce and soy,—  
My roast potatoes!—all are gone!—and so's that vulgar Boy!

I rang the bell for Mrs. Jones, for she was down below,  
"—Oh, Mrs. Jones! what *do* you think?—ain't this a pretty go?  
—That horrid little vulgar Boy whom I brought here to-night,  
—He's stolen my things and run away!!"—Says she, "And sarve you  
right!!"

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Next morning I was up betimes—I sent the Crier round,  
All with his bell and gold-laced hat, to say I'd give a pound  
To find that little vulgar Boy, who'd gone and used me so;  
But when the Crier cried "O Yes!" the people cried, "O No!"

I went to "Jarvis' Landing-place," the glory of the town,  
There was a common sailor-man a-walking up and down;  
I told my tale—he seem'd to think I'd not been treated well,  
And called me "Poor old Buffer!" what that means I cannot tell.



That sailor-man, he said he'd seen that morning on the shore,  
A son of—something—'twas a name I'd never heard before,  
A little "gallows-looking chap"—dear me; what could he mean?  
With a "carpet-swab" and "muckingtogs," and a hat turned up with green.

He spoke about his "precious eyes," and said he'd seen him "sheer,"  
—It's very odd that sailor-men should talk so very queer—  
And then he hitch'd his trowsers up, as is, I'm told, their use,  
—It's very odd that sailor-men should wear those things so loose.

I did not understand him well, but think he meant to say  
He'd seen that little vulgar Boy, that morning swim away  
In Captain Large's Royal George about an hour before,  
And they were now, as he supposed, "*somewheres*" about the Nore.

A landsman said, "I *twig* the chap—he's been upon the Mill—  
And 'cause he *gammons* so the flats, ve calls him Veeping Bill!"  
He said "he'd done me wery brown," and "nicely *stow'd* the *swag*."  
—That's French, I fancy, for a hat—or else a carpet-bag.

I went and told the constable my property to track;  
He asked me if "I did not wish that I might get it back?"  
I answered, "To be sure I do!—it's what I come about."  
He smiled and said, "Sir, does your mother know that you are out?"

Not knowing what to do, I thought I'd hasten back to town,  
And beg our own Lord Mayor to catch the Boy who'd "done me brown."  
His Lordship very kindly said he'd try and find him out,  
But he "rather thought that there were several vulgar boys about."

He sent for Mr. Whithair then, and I described "the swag,"  
My Mackintosh, my sugar-tongs, my spoons, and carpet-bag;  
He promised that the New Police should all their powers employ;  
But never to this hour have I beheld that vulgar Boy!

**MORAL**

Remember, then, what when a boy I've heard my Grandma' tell,  
"BE WARN'D IN TIME BY OTHERS' HARM, AND YOU SHALL DO FULL WELL!"  
Don't link yourself with vulgar folks, who've got no fix'd abode,  
Tell lies, use naughty words, and say they "wish they may be blow'd!"

Don't take too much of double X!—and don't at night go out  
To fetch your beer yourself, but make the pot-boy bring your stout!  
And when you go to Margate next, just stop and ring the bell,  
Give my respects to Mrs. Jones, and say I'm pretty well!

*Richard Harris Barham.*

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## THE GOUTY MERCHANT AND THE STRANGER

In Broad Street Buildings on a winter night,  
Snug by his parlor-fire a gouty wight  
Sat all alone, with one hand rubbing  
His feet, rolled up in fleecy hose:  
While t'other held beneath his nose  
The *Public Ledger*, in whose columns grubbing,  
He noted all the sales of hops,  
Ships, shops, and slops;  
Gum, galls, and groceries; ginger, gin,  
Tar, tallow, turmeric, turpentine, and tin;  
When lo! a decent personage in black  
Entered and most politely said:  
"Your footman, sir, has gone his nightly track  
To the King's Head,  
And left your door ajar; which I  
Observed in passing by,  
And thought it neighborly to give you notice."  
"Ten thousand thanks; how very few get,  
In time of danger,

Such kind attentions from a stranger!  
Assuredly, that fellow's throat is  
Doomed to a final drop at Newgate:  
He knows, too (the unconscionable elf!),  
That there's no soul at home except myself."  
"Indeed," replied the stranger (looking grave),  
"Then he's a double knave;  
He knows that rogues and thieves by scores  
Nightly beset unguarded doors:  
And see, how easily might one  
    Of these domestic foes,  
    Even beneath your very nose,  
Perform his knavish tricks;  
Enter your room, as I have done,  
Blow out your candles—*thus*—and *thus*—  
Pocket your silver candlesticks,  
    And—walk off—*thus!*"—  
So said, so done; he made no more remark  
    Nor waited for replies,  
    But marched off with his prize,  
Leaving the gouty merchant in the dark.

*Horace Smith.*

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## **THE DIVERTING HISTORY OF JOHN GILPIN**

### **SHOWING HOW HE WENT FARTHER THAN HE INTENDED AND CAME SAFE HOME AGAIN**

John Gilpin was a citizen of credit and renown;  
A train-band captain eke was he, of famous London town.

John Gilpin's spouse said to her dear—"Though wedded we have been

These twice ten tedious years, yet we no holiday have seen.

"To-morrow is our wedding-day, and we will then repair  
Unto the Bell at Edmonton all in a chaise and pair.

"My sister, and my sister's child, myself, and children three,  
Will fill the chaise; so you must ride on horseback after we."

He soon replied, "I do admire of womankind but one,  
And you are she, my dearest dear; therefore it shall be done.

"I am a linendraper bold, as all the world doth know;  
And my good friend, the calender, will lend his horse to go."

Quoth Mrs. Gilpin, "That's well said; and, for that wine is dear,  
We will be furnished with our own, which is both bright and clear."

John Gilpin kissed his loving wife; o'erjoyed was he to find  
That, though on pleasure she was bent, she had a frugal mind.

The morning came, the chaise was brought, but yet was not allowed  
To drive up to the door, lest all should say that she was proud.

So three doors off the chaise was stayed, where they did all get in—  
Six precious souls, and all agog to dash through thick and thin.

Smack went the whip, round went the wheels—were never folks so glad;  
The stones did rattle underneath, as if Cheapside were mad.

John Gilpin at his horse's side seized fast the flowing mane,  
And up he got, in haste to ride—but soon came down again:

For saddletree scarce reached had he, his journey to begin,  
When, turning round his head, he saw three customers come in.

So down he came: for loss of time, although it grieved him sore,  
Yet loss of pence, full well he knew, would trouble him much more.

'Twas long before the customers were suited to their mind;  
When Betty, screaming, came down-stairs—"The wine is left behind!"

"Good lack!" quoth he—"yet bring it me, my leathern belt likewise,  
In which I wear my trusty sword when I do exercise."

Now Mistress Gilpin (careful soul!) had two stone bottles found,  
To hold the liquor that she loved, and keep it safe and sound.

Each bottle had a curling ear, through which the belt he drew,  
And hung a bottle on each side to make his balance true.

Then over all, that he might be equipped from top to toe,  
His long red cloak, well brushed and neat, he manfully did throw.

Now see him mounted once again upon his nimble steed,  
Full slowly pacing o'er the stones, with caution and good heed.

But finding soon a smoother road beneath his well-shod feet,  
The snorting beast began to trot, which galled him in his seat.

So, "Fair and softly," John he cried, but John he cried in vain;  
That trot became a gallop soon, in spite of curb and rein.

So stooping down, as needs he must who cannot sit upright,  
He grasped the mane with both his hands, and eke with all his might.

His horse, who never in that sort had handled been before,  
What thing upon his back had got did wonder more and more.

Away went Gilpin, neck or nought; away went hat and wig;  
He little dreamt, when he set out, of running such a rig.

The wind did blow—the cloak did fly, like streamer long and gay;  
Till, loop and button failing both, at last it flew away.

Then might all people well discern the bottles he had slung—  
A bottle swinging at each side, as hath been said or sung.

The dogs did bark, the children screamed, up flew the windows all;  
And every soul cried out, "Well done!" as loud as he could bawl.

Away went Gilpin—who but he? His fame soon spread around—  
"He carries weight! he rides a race! 'Tis for a thousand pound!"

And still as fast as he drew near, 'twas wonderful to view  
How in a trice the turnpike men their gates wide open threw.

And now, as he went bowing down his reeking head full low,  
The bottles twain behind his back were shattered at a blow.

Down ran the wine into the road, most piteous to be seen,  
Which made his horse's flanks to smoke as they had basted been.

But still he seemed to carry weight, with leathern girdle braced;  
For all might see the bottle necks still dangling at his waist.

Thus all through merry Islington these gambols did he play,  
Until he came unto the Wash of Edmonton so gay;

And there he threw the wash about on both sides of the way,  
Just like unto a trundling mop, or a wild goose at play.

At Edmonton his loving wife from the balcony spied  
Her tender husband, wondering much to see how he did ride.

"Stop, stop, John Gilpin! here's the house," they all at once did cry;  
"The dinner waits, and we are tired." Said Gilpin—"So am I!"

But yet his horse was not a whit inclined to tarry there;  
For why?—his owner had a house full ten miles off, at Ware.

So like an arrow swift he flew, shot by an archer strong:

So did he fly—which brings me to the middle of my song.

Away went Gilpin out of breath, and sore against his will,  
Till at his friend the calender's his horse at last stood still.

The calender, amazed to see his neighbor in such trim,  
Laid down his pipe, flew to the gate, and thus accosted him:

"What news? what news? your tidings tell; tell me you must and shall—  
Say why bareheaded you are come, or why you come at all?"

Now Gilpin had a pleasant wit, and loved a timely joke;  
And thus unto the calender in merry guise he spoke:

"I came because your horse would come; and, if I well forebode,  
My hat and wig will soon be here, they are upon the road."

The calender, right glad to find his friend in merry pin,  
Returned him not a single word, but to the house went in;

Whence straight he came with hat and wig: a wig that flowed behind,  
A hat not much the worse for wear—each comedy in its kind.

He held them up, and in his turn thus showed his ready wit—  
"My head is twice as big as yours, they therefore needs must fit.

"But let me scrape the dirt away that hangs upon your face,  
And stop and eat, for well you may be in a hungry case."

Said John, "It is my wedding-day, and all the world would stare,  
If wife should dine at Edmonton, and I should dine at Ware."

So, turning to his horse, he said, "I am in haste to dine;  
'Twas for your pleasure you came here—you shall go back for mine."

Ah, luckless speech, and bootless boast, for which he paid full dear!  
For, while he spake, a braying ass did sing most loud and clear;

Whereat his horse did snort, as he had heard a lion roar,  
And galloped off with all his might, as he had done before.

Away went Gilpin, and away went Gilpin's hat and wig:  
He lost them sooner than at first, for why?—they were too big.

Now Mistress Gilpin, when she saw her husband posting down  
Into the country far away, she pulled out half a crown;

And thus unto the youth she said, that drove them to the Bell,  
"This shall be yours when you bring back my husband safe and well."

The youth did ride, and soon did meet John coming back amain—  
Whom in a trice he tried to stop, by catching at his rein;

But not performing what he meant, and gladly would have done,  
The frightened steed he frightened more, and made him faster run.

Away went Gilpin, and away went post-boy at his heels,  
The post-boy's horse right glad to miss the lumbering of the wheels.

Six gentlemen upon the road, thus seeing Gilpin fly,  
With post-boy scampering in the rear, they raised the hue and cry:

"Stop thief! stop thief!—a highwayman!" Not one of them was mute;  
And all and each that passed that way did join in the pursuit.

And now the turnpike gates again flew open in short space;  
The tollmen thinking, as before, that Gilpin rode a race.

And so he did, and won it, too, for he got first to town;  
Nor stopped till where he had got up he did again get down.

Now let us sing, long live the king! and Gilpin, long live he;  
And when he next doth ride abroad, may I be there to see!



William Cowper.

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## PADDY O'RAFOTHER

Paddy, in want of a dinner one day,  
Credit all gone, and no money to pay,  
Stole from a priest a fat pullet, they say,  
And went to confession just afther;  
"Your riv'rinse," says Paddy, "I stole this fat hen."  
"What, what!" says the priest, "at your ould thricks again?  
Faith, you'd rather be staalin' than sayin' *amen*,  
Paddy O'Rafther!"

"Sure, you wouldn't be angry," says Pat, "if you knew  
That the best of intintions I had in my view—  
For I stole it to make it a present to you,  
And you can absolve me afther."  
"Do you think," says the priest, "I'd partake of your theft?  
Of your seven small senses you must be bereft—  
You're the biggest blackguard that I know, right and left,  
Paddy O'Rafther."

"Then what shall I do with the pullet," says Pat,  
"If your riv'rinse won't take it? By this and by that  
I don't know no more than a dog or a cat  
What your riv'rinse would have me be afther."  
"Why, then," says his rev'rence, "you sin-blinded owl,  
Give back to the man that you stole from his fowl:  
For if you do not, 'twill be worse for your sowl,  
Paddy O'Rafther."

Says Paddy, "I ask'd him to take it—'tis thrue  
As this minit I'm talkin', your riv'rinse, to you;

But he wouldn't resave it—so what can I do?"

Says Paddy, nigh choken with laughter.

"By my throth," says the priest, "but the case is absthurse;

If he won't take his hen, why the man is a goose:

'Tis not the first time my advice was no use,

Paddy O'Rafther."

"But, for sake of your sowl, I would sthrongly advise

To some one in want you would give your supplies—

Some widow, or orphan, with tears in their eyes;

And *then* you may come to *me* afther."

So Paddy went off to the brisk Widow Hoy,

And the pullet between them was eaten with joy,

And, says she, "'Pon my word you're the cleverest boy,

Paddy O'Rafther."

Then Paddy went back to the priest the next day,

And told him the fowl he had given away

To a poor lonely widow, in want and dismay,

The loss of her spouse weeping afther.

"Well, now," says the priest, "I'll absolve you, my lad,

For repentantly making the best of the bad,

In feeding the hungry and cheering the sad,

Paddy O'Rafther!"

*Samuel Lover.*

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## HERE SHE GOES, AND THERE SHE GOES

Two Yankee wags, one summer day,

Stopped at a tavern on their way,

Supped, frolicked, late retired to rest,

And woke to breakfast on the best.

The breakfast over, Tom and Will  
Sent for the landlord and the bill;  
Will looked it over:—"Very right—  
But hold! what wonder meets my sight?  
Tom, the surprise is quite a shock!"  
"What wonder? where?" "The clock, the clock!"

Tom and the landlord in amaze  
Stared at the clock with stupid gaze,  
And for a moment neither spoke;  
At last the landlord silence broke,—  
"You mean the clock that's ticking there?  
I see no wonder, I declare!  
Though maybe, if the truth were told,  
'Tis rather ugly, somewhat old;  
Yet time it keeps to half a minute;  
But, if you please, what wonder's in it?"

"Tom, don't you recollect," said Will,  
"The clock at Jersey, near the mill,  
The very image of this present,  
With which I won the wager pleasant?"  
Will ended with a knowing wink;  
Tom scratched his head and tried to think.  
"Sir, begging pardon for inquiring,"  
The landlord said, with grin admiring,  
"What wager was it?"

"You remember

It happened, Tom, in last December:  
In sport I bet a Jersey Blue  
That it was more than he could do  
To make his finger go and come  
In keeping with the pendulum,  
Repeating, till the hour should close,  
Still,—'*Here she goes, and there she goes.*'  
He lost the bet in half a minute."

"Well, if I would, the deuce is in it!"  
Exclaimed the landlord; "try me yet,  
And fifty dollars be the bet."  
"Agreed, but we will play some trick,  
To make you of the bargain sick!"  
"I'm up to that!"

"Don't make us wait,—  
Begin,—the clock is striking eight."  
He seats himself, and left and right  
His finger wags with all its might,  
And hoarse his voice and hoarser grows,  
With—"Here she goes, and there she goes!"

"Hold!" said the Yankee, "Plank the ready!"  
The landlord wagged his finger steady,  
While his left hand, as well as able,  
Conveyed a purse upon the table.  
"Tom! with the money let's be off!"  
This made the landlord only scoff.

He heard them running down the stair,  
But was not tempted from his chair;  
Thought he, "The fools! I'll bite them yet!  
So poor a trick sha'n't win the bet."  
And loud and long the chorus rose  
Of—"Here she goes, and there she goes!"  
While right and left his finger swung,  
In keeping to his clock and tongue.

His mother happened in to see  
Her daughter: "Where is Mrs. B——?"  
"When will she come, do you suppose?  
Son!"—

*"Here she goes, and there she goes!"*

"Here!—where?"—the lady in surprise  
His finger followed with her eyes:  
"Son! why that steady gaze and sad?  
Those words,—that motion,—are you mad?  
But here's your wife, perhaps she knows,  
And—"

*"Here she goes, and there she goes!"*

His wife surveyed him with alarm,  
And rushed to him, and seized his arm;  
He shook her off, and to and fro  
His finger persevered to go;  
While curled his very nose with ire  
That *she* against him should conspire;  
And with more furious tone arose  
The—"*Here she goes, and there she goes!*"

"Lawks!" screamed the wife, "I'm in a whirl!  
Run down and bring the little girl;  
She is his darling, and who knows  
But—"

*"Here she goes, and there she goes!"*

"Lawks! he is mad! What made him thus?  
Good Lord! what will become of us?  
Run for a doctor,—run, run, run,—  
For Doctor Brown and Doctor Dun,  
And Doctor Black and Doctor White,  
And Doctor Gray, with all your might!"

The doctors came, and looked, and wondered,  
And shook their heads, and paused and pondered.  
Then one proposed he should be bled,—  
"No, leeches you mean," the other said,  
"Clap on a blister!" roared another,—  
"No! cup him,"—"No, trepan him, brother."

A sixth would recommend a purge,  
The next would an emetic urge;  
The last produced a box of pills,  
A certain cure for earthly ills:  
"I had a patient yesternight,"  
Quoth he, "and wretched was her plight,  
And as the only means to save her,  
Three dozen patent pills I gave her;  
And by to-morrow I suppose  
That—"

*"Here she goes, and there she goes!"*

"You are all fools!" the lady said,—  
"The way is just to shave his head.  
Run! bid the barber come anon."  
"Thanks, mother!" thought her clever son;  
"You help the knaves that would have bit me,  
But all creation sha'n't outwit me!"  
Thus to himself while to and fro  
His finger perseveres to go,  
And from his lips no accent flows  
But,—"*Here she goes, and there she goes!"*  
The barber came—"Lord help him! what  
A queerish customer I've got;  
But we must do our best to save him,—  
So hold him, gemmen, while I shave him!"  
But here the doctors interpose,—  
"A woman never—"

*"There she goes!"*

"A woman is no judge of physic,  
Not even when her baby is sick.  
He must be bled,"—"No, cup him,"—"Pills!"  
And all the house the uproar fills.

What means that smile? what means that shiver?

The landlord's limbs with rapture quiver,  
And triumph brightens up his face,  
His finger yet will win the race;  
The clock is on the stroke of nine,  
And up he starts,—"'Tis mine! 'tis mine!"  
"What do you mean?"

"I mean the fifty;  
I never spent an hour so thrifty.  
But you who tried to make me lose,  
Go, burst with envy, if you choose!  
But how is this? where are they?"

"Who?"

"The gentlemen,—I mean the two  
Came yesterday,—are they below?"  
"They galloped off an hour ago."  
"Oh, dose me! blister! shave and bleed!  
For, hang the knaves, I'm mad indeed!"

*James Nack.*

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## THE QUAKER'S MEETING

A traveller wended the wilds among,  
With a purse of gold and a silver tongue;  
His hat it was broad, and all drab were his clothes,  
For he hated high colors—except on his nose,  
And he met with a lady, the story goes.  
Heigho! *yea* thee and *nay* thee.

The damsel she cast him a merry blink,  
And the traveller nothing was loth, I think,  
Her merry black eye beamed her bonnet beneath,  
And the Quaker, he grinned, for he'd very good teeth,

And he asked, "Art thee going to ride on the heath?"

"I hope you'll protect me, kind sir," said the maid,  
"As to ride this heath over, I'm sadly afraid;  
For robbers, they say, here in numbers abound,  
And I wouldn't for anything I should be found,  
For, between you and me, I have five hundred pound."

"If that is thee own, dear," the Quaker, he said,  
"I ne'er saw a maiden I sooner would wed;  
And I have another five hundred just now,  
In the padding that's under my saddle-bow,  
And I'll settle it all upon thee, I vow!"

The maiden she smil'd, and her rein she drew,  
"Your offer I'll take, but I'll not take you,"  
A pistol she held at the Quaker's head—  
"Now give me your gold, or I'll give you my lead,  
'Tis under the saddle, I think you said."

The damsel she ripped up the saddle-bow,  
And the Quaker was never a quaker till now!  
And he saw, by the fair one he wished for a bride,  
His purse borne away with a swaggering stride,  
And the eye that shamm'd tender, now only defied.

"The spirit doth move me, friend Broadbrim," quoth she,  
"To take all this filthy temptation from thee,  
For Mammon deceiveth, and beauty is fleeting,  
Accept from thy maiden this right-loving greeting,  
For much doth she profit by this Quaker's meeting!"

"And hark! jolly Quaker, so rosy and sly,  
Have righteousness, more than a wench, in thine eye;  
Don't go again peeping girls' bonnets beneath,  
Remember the one that you met on the heath,  
Her name's Jimmy Barlow, I tell to your teeth."



"Friend James," quoth the Quaker, "pray listen to me,  
For thou canst confer a great favor, d'ye see;  
The gold thou hast taken is not mine, my friend,  
But my master's; and truly on thee I depend,  
To make it appear I my trust did defend.

"So fire a few shots thro' my clothes, here and there,  
To make it appear 'twas a desp'rate affair."  
So Jim he popp'd first through the skirt of his coat,  
And then through his collar—quite close to his throat;  
"Now one thro' my broadbrim," quoth Ephraim, "I vote."

"I have but a brace," said bold Jim, "and they're spent,  
And I won't load again for a make-believe rent."—  
"Then!"—said Ephraim, producing his pistols, "just give  
My five hundred pounds back, or, as sure as you live,  
I'll make of your body a riddle or sieve."

Jim Barlow was diddled—and, tho' he was game,  
He saw Ephraim's pistol so deadly in aim,  
That he gave up the gold, and he took to his scrapers,  
And when the whole story got into the papers,  
They said that "*the thieves were no match for the Quakers.*"  
Heigho! yea thee and nay thee.

*Samuel Lover.*

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## THE JESTER CONDEMNED TO DEATH

One of the Kings of Scanderoon,  
A royal jester  
Had in his train, a gross buffoon,

Who used to pester  
The court with tricks inopportune,  
Venting on the highest folks his  
Scurvy pleasantries and hoaxes.

It needs some sense to play the fool,  
Which wholesome rule  
    Occurred not to our jackanapes,  
Who consequently found his freaks  
    Lead to innumerable scrapes,  
And quite as many tricks and tweaks,  
    Which only seemed to make him faster  
    Try the patience of his master.

Some sin, at last, beyond all measure  
Incurred the desperate displeasure  
    Of his Serene and raging Highness:  
Whether he twitched his most revered  
And sacred beard,  
    Or had intruded on the shyness  
    Of the seraglio, or let fly  
    An epigram at royalty,  
None knows: his sin was an occult one,  
But records tell us that the Sultan,  
Meaning to terrify the knave,  
    Exclaimed, "'Tis time to stop that breath;  
Thy doom is sealed, presumptuous slave!  
    Thou stand'st condemned to certain death:

"Silence, base rebel! no replying!  
    But such is my indulgence still,  
    That, of my own free grace and will,  
I leave to thee the mode of dying,"  
"Thy royal will be done—'tis just,"  
Replied the wretch, and kissed the dust.  
    "Since my last moment to assuage,  
Your majesty's humane decree

Has deigned to leave the choice to me,  
I'll die, so please you, of old age!"

*Horace Smith.*

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**THE DEACON'S MASTERPIECE;  
OR, THE WONDERFUL "ONE-HOSS SHAY"**

*A Logical Story*

Have you heard of the wonderful one-hoss shay,  
That was built in such a logical way,  
It ran a hundred years to a day,  
And then, of a sudden, it—ah, but stay,  
I'll tell you what happened without delay,—  
Scaring the parson into fits,  
Frightening the people out of their wits—  
Have you ever heard of that, I say?

Seventeen hundred and fifty-five,  
*Georgius Secundus* was then alive—  
Stuffy old drone from the German hive.  
That was the year when Lisbon-town  
Saw the earth open and gulp her down,  
And Braddock's army was done so brown,  
Left without a scalp to its crown.  
It was on the terrible earthquake-day  
That the Deacon finished his one-hoss shay.

Now in building of chaises, I'll tell you what,  
There is always *somewhere* a weakest spot—  
In hub, tire, or felloe, in spring or thill,

In panel, or crossbar, or floor, or sill,  
In screw, bolt, thorough brace—lurking still,  
Find it somewhere you must and will—  
Above or below, or within or without—  
And that's the reason, beyond a doubt,  
A chaise *breaks down*, but doesn't *wear out*.

But the Deacon swore (as Deacons do,  
With an "I dew vam" or an "I tell yeou"),  
He would build one shay to beat the taown  
'n' the keounty 'n' all the kentry raoun';  
It should be so built that it *couldna'* break daown;

—"Fur," said the Deacon, "'t's mighty plain  
That the weakes' place mus' stan' the strain;  
'n' the way t' fix it, uz I maintain,  
Is only jest  
T' make that place uz strong uz the rest."

So the deacon inquired of the village folk  
Where he could find the strongest oak,  
That couldn't be split nor bent nor broke—  
That was for spokes and floor and sills;  
He sent for lancewood to make the thills;  
The cross-bars were ash, from the straightest trees;  
The panels of white-wood, that cuts like cheese,  
But lasts like iron for things like these;  
The hubs of logs from the "Settler's ellum"—  
Last of its timber—they couldn't sell 'em,

Never an axe had seen their chips,  
And the wedges flew from between their lips;  
Their blunt ends frizzled like celery-tips;  
Step and prop-iron, bolt and screw,  
Spring, tire, axle, and linch-pin too,  
Steel of the finest, bright and blue;  
Thorough-broke bison-skin, thick and wide;

Boot, top, dasher, from tough old hide  
Found in the pit when the tanner died.  
That was the way he "put her through"—  
"There!" said the deacon, "naow she'll dew!"

Do! I tell you, I rather guess  
She was a wonder, and nothing less.  
Colts grew horses, beards turned gray,  
Deacon and deaconess dropped away,  
Children and grandchildren—where were they!  
But there stood the stout old one-hoss shay  
As fresh as on Lisbon earthquake-day!

EIGHTEEN HUNDRED;—it came and found  
The deacon's masterpiece strong and sound.  
Eighteen hundred increased by ten;—  
"Hahnsum kerridge" they called it then.  
Eighteen hundred and twenty came;—  
Running as usual; much the same.  
Thirty and forty at last arrive,  
And then came fifty and FIFTY-FIVE.

Little of all we value here  
Wakes on the morn of its hundredth year  
Without both feeling and looking queer.  
In fact, there's nothing that keeps its youth,  
So far as I know but a tree and truth.  
(That is a moral that runs at large;  
Take it—you're welcome.—No extra charge.)

FIRST OF NOVEMBER—The Earthquake-day—  
There are traces of age in the one-hoss shay,  
A general flavour of mild decay,  
But nothing local, as one may say.  
There couldn't be—for the deacon's art  
Had made it so like in every part  
That there wasn't a chance for one to start.

For the wheels were just as strong as the thills,  
And the floor was just as strong as the sills,  
And the panels just as strong as the floor,  
And the whippetree neither less nor more,  
And the back-crossbar as strong as the fore,  
And spring and axle and hub *encore*.  
And yet, *as a whole* it is past a doubt  
In another hour it will be *worn out*!

First of November, 'Fifty-five!  
This morning the parson takes a drive.  
Now, small boys, get out of the way!  
Here comes the wonderful one-hoss shay,  
Drawn by a rat-tailed, ewe-necked bay,  
"Huddup!" said the parson.—Off went they.

The parson was working his Sunday's text—  
Had got to *fifthly*, and stopped perplexed  
At what the—Moses—was coming next.  
All at once the horse stood still,  
Close by the meet'n'-house on the hill.

—First a shiver, and then a thrill,  
Then something decidedly like a spill—  
And the parson was sitting upon a rock  
At half-past nine by the meet'n'-house clock—  
Just the hour of the earthquake shock!  
—What do you think the parson found,  
When he got up and stared around?  
The poor old chaise in a heap or mound,  
As if it had been to the mill and ground!  
You see, of course, if you're not a dunce,  
How it went to pieces all at once,—  
All at once and nothing first—  
Just as bubbles do when they burst.

End of the wonderful one-hoss shay.  
Logic is logic. That's all I say.

*Oliver Wendell Holmes.*



## THE BALLAD OF THE OYSTERMAN

It was a tall young oysterman lived by the river-side;  
His shop was just upon the bank, his boat was on the tide.  
The daughter of a fisherman, that was so straight and slim,  
Lived over on the other bank, right opposite to him.

It was the pensive oysterman that saw a lovely maid,  
Upon a moonlight evening, a-sitting in the shade;  
He saw her wave her handkerchief, as much as if to say,  
"I'm wide awake, young oysterman, and all the folks away."

Then up arose the oysterman, and to himself said he,  
"I guess I'll leave the skiff at home, for fear that folks should see;  
I read it in the story-book, that, for to kiss his dear,  
Leander swam the Hellespont—and I will swim this here."

And he has leaped into the waves, and crossed the shining stream,  
And he has clambered up the bank, all in the moonlight gleam;  
O there were kisses sweet as dew, and words as soft as rain—  
But they have heard her father's step, and in he leaps again!

Out spoke the ancient fisherman—"O what was that, my daughter?"  
"'Twas nothing but a pebble, sir, I threw into the water."  
"And what is that, pray tell me, love, that paddles off so fast?"  
"It's nothing but a porpoise, sir, that's been a-swimming past."

Out spoke the ancient fisherman—"Now bring me my harpoon!  
I'll get into my fishing-boat, and fix the fellow soon."  
Down fell that pretty innocent, as falls a snow-white lamb;  
Her hair drooped round her pallid cheeks, like sea-weed on a clam.

Alas for those two loving ones! she waked not from her swoon,  
And he was taken with the cramp, and in, the waves was drowned;



But Fate has metamorphosed them, in pity of their wo,  
And now they keep an oyster-shop for mermaids down below.

*Oliver Wendell Holmes.*

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## THE WELL OF ST. KEYNE

A well there is in the west country,  
And a clearer one never was seen;  
There is not a wife in the west country  
But has heard of the Well of St. Keyne.

An oak and an elm-tree stand beside,  
And behind doth an ash-tree grow,  
And a willow from the bank above  
Droops to the water below.

A traveller came to the Well of St. Keyne,  
Joyfully he drew nigh,  
For from cock-crow he had been travelling,  
And there was not a cloud in the sky.

He drank of the water so cool and clear,  
For thirsty and hot was he;  
And he sat down upon the bank  
Under the willow-tree.

There came a man from the house hard by  
At the well to fill his pail;  
On the well-side he rested it,  
And he bade the stranger hail.

"Now art thou a bachelor, stranger?" quoth he,

"For an if thou hast a wife,  
The happiest draught thou hast drank this day  
That ever thou didst in thy life.

"Or hast thy good woman, if one thou hast,  
Ever here in Cornwall been?  
For an if she have, I'll venture my life  
She has drank of the Well of St. Keyne."

"I have left a good woman who never was here,"  
The stranger he made reply;  
"But that my draught should be the better for that  
I pray you answer me why?"

"St. Keyne," quoth the Cornishman, "many a time  
Drank of this crystal well,  
And before the angels summon'd her,  
She laid on the water a spell.

"If the husband of this gifted well  
Shall drink before his wife,  
A happy man thenceforth is he,  
For he shall be master for life.

"But if the wife should drink of it first,  
God help the husband then!"  
The stranger stooped to the Well of St. Keyne,  
And drank of the water again.

"You drank of the well, I warrant, betimes?"  
He to the Cornishman said:  
But the Cornishman smiled as the stranger spake,  
And sheepishly shook his head.

"I hasten'd as soon as the wedding was done,  
And left my wife in the porch;

But i' faith she had been wiser than me,  
For she took a bottle to church."

*Robert Southey.*

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## THE JACKDAW OF RHEIMS

The Jackdaw sat on the Cardinal's chair!  
Bishop, and Abbot, and Prior were there;  
    Many a monk, and many a friar,  
    Many a knight and many a squire,  
With a great many more of lesser degree—  
In sooth, a goodly company;  
And they served the Lord Primate on bended knee,  
    Never, I ween,  
    Was a prouder seen,  
Read of in books, or dreamt of in dreams,  
Than the Cardinal Lord Archbishop of Rheims!

    In and out  
    Through the motley rout,  
That little Jackdaw kept hopping about;  
    Here and there,  
    Like a dog in a fair,  
    Over comfits and cates,  
    And dishes and plates,  
Cowl and cope, and rochet and pall,  
Mitre and crosier, he hopped upon all!  
    With saucy air,  
    He perched on the chair  
Where, in state, the great Lord Cardinal sat  
In the great Lord Cardinal's great red hat;

And he peered in the face  
Of his Lordship's grace,  
With a satisfied look, as if he would say,  
"We two are the greatest folks here to-day!"  
And the priests, with awe,  
As such freaks they saw,  
Said, "The devil must be in that little Jackdaw!"

The feast was over, the board was cleared,  
The flawns and the custards had all disappeared,  
And six little singing-boys—dear little souls!  
In nice clean faces, and nice white stoles,  
Came, in order due,  
Two by two,  
Marching that grand refectory through!

A nice little boy held a golden ewer,  
Embossed and filled with water, as pure  
As any that flows between Rheims and Namur,  
Which a nice little boy stood ready to catch  
In a fine golden hand-basin made to match.  
Two nice little boys, rather more grown,  
Carried lavender-water and eau-de-Cologne;  
And a nice little boy had a nice cake of soap,  
Worthy of washing the hands of the Pope.  
One little boy more  
A napkin bore,  
Of the best white diaper, fringed with pink,  
And a cardinal's hat marked in "permanent ink."

The great Lord Cardinal turns at the sight  
Of these nice little boys dressed all in white:  
From his finger he draws  
His costly turquoise,  
And, not thinking at all about little Jackdaws,  
Deposits it straight  
By the side of his plate,

While the nice little boys on his Eminence wait;  
Till, when nobody's dreaming of any such thing,  
That little Jackdaw hops off with the ring!

There's a cry and a shout,  
And a deuce of a rout,  
And nobody seems to know what they're about,  
But the monks have their pockets all turned inside out;  
The friars are kneeling,  
And hunting and feeling  
The carpet, the floor, and the walls, and the ceiling.  
The Cardinal drew  
Off each plum-coloured shoe,  
And left his red stockings exposed to the view;  
He peeps and he feels,  
In the toes and the heels;  
They turn up the dishes, they turn up the plates,  
They take up the poker and poke out the grates,  
They turn up the rugs,  
They examine the mugs—  
But no! no such thing;  
They can't find THE RING!  
And the Abbot declared that "when nobody twigged it,  
Some rascal or other had popped in and prigged it."

The Cardinal rose with a dignified look,  
He called for his candle, his bell, and his book!  
In holy anger and pious grief,  
He solemnly cursed that rascally thief!  
He cursed him at board, he cursed him in bed;  
From the sole of his foot to the crown of his head;  
He cursed him in sleeping, that every night  
He should dream of the devil, and wake in a fright;  
He cursed him in eating, he cursed him in drinking,  
He cursed him in coughing, in sneezing, in winking;  
He cursed him in sitting, in standing, in lying;  
He cursed him in walking, in riding, in flying;

He cursed him in living, he cursed him in dying!—  
Never was heard such a terrible curse!

But, what gave rise  
To no little surprise,  
Nobody seemed one penny the worse!

The day was gone,  
The night came on,  
The monks and the friars they searched till dawn;  
When the Sacristan saw,  
On crumpled claw,  
Come limping a poor little lame Jackdaw;  
No longer gay,  
As on yesterday;  
His feathers all seemed to be turned the wrong way;  
His pinions drooped, he could hardly stand,  
His head was as bald as the palm of your hand;  
His eye so dim,  
So wasted each limb,  
That, heedless of grammar, they all cried "THAT'S HIM!  
That's the scamp that has done this scandalous thing!  
That's the thief that has got my Lord Cardinal's ring!"

The poor little Jackdaw,  
When the monks he saw,  
Feebly gave vent to the ghost of a caw,  
And turned his bald head, as much as to say,  
"Pray be so good as to walk this way!"  
Slower and slower  
He limped on before,  
Till they came to the back of the belfry door,  
Where the first thing they saw,  
Midst the sticks and the straw,  
Was the RING in the nest of that little Jackdaw!

Then the great Lord Cardinal called for his book,  
And off that terrible curse he took;

The mute expression  
Served in lieu of confession,  
And, being thus coupled with full restitution,  
The Jackdaw got plenary absolution!  
When these words were heard,  
That poor little bird  
Was so changed in a moment, 'twas really absurd;  
He grew sleek and fat;  
In addition to that,  
A fresh crop of feathers came thick as a mat!  
His tail waggled more  
Even than before;  
But no longer it wagged with an impudent air,  
No longer he perched on the Cardinal's chair,  
He hopped now about  
With a gait devout;  
At matins, at vespers, he never was out;  
And, so far from any more pilfering deeds,  
He always seemed telling the Confessor's beads.

If any one lied, or if any one swore,  
Or slumbered in prayer-time and happened to snore,  
That good Jackdaw  
Would give a great "Caw!"  
As much as to say, "Don't do so any more!"  
While many remarked, as his manners they saw,  
That they "never had known such a pious Jackdaw!"  
He long lived the pride  
Of that country side,  
And at last in the odour of sanctity died;  
When, as words were too faint  
His merits to paint,  
The Conclave determined to make him a Saint;  
And on newly-made Saints and Popes, as you know,  
It's the custom, at Rome, new names to bestow,  
So they canonised him by the name of Jim Crow!

Richard Harris Barham.

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## THE KNIGHT AND THE LADY

The Lady Jane was tall and slim,  
The Lady Jane was fair  
And Sir Thomas, her lord, was stout of limb,  
And his cough was short, and his eyes were dim,  
And he wore green "specs" with a tortoise shell rim,  
And his hat was remarkably broad in the brim,  
And she was uncommonly fond of him—

And they were a loving pair!  
And wherever they went, or wherever they came,  
Every one hailed them with loudest acclaim;  
Far and wide,  
The people cried,  
All sorts of pleasure, and no sort of pain,  
To Sir Thomas the good, and the fair Lady Janel

Now Sir Thomas the good, be it well understood,  
Was a man of very contemplative mood—  
He would pour by the hour, o'er a weed or a flower,  
Or the slugs, that came crawling out after a shower;  
Black beetles, bumble-bees, blue-bottle flies,  
And moths, were of no small account in his eyes;  
An "industrious flea," he'd by no means despise,  
While an "old daddy long-legs," whose long legs and thighs  
Passed the common in shape, or in color, or size,  
He was wont to consider an absolute prize.  
Giving up, in short, both business and sport, he  
Abandoned himself, *tout entier*, to philosophy.

Now as Lady Jane was tall and slim,



And Lady Jane was fair.  
And a good many years the junior of him,  
There are some might be found entertaining a notion,  
That such an entire, and exclusive devotion,  
To that part of science, folks style entomology,  
Was a positive shame,  
And, to such a fair dame,  
Really demanded some sort of apology;  
Ever poking his nose into this, and to that—  
At a gnat, or a bat, or a cat, or a rat,  
At great ugly things, all legs and wings,  
With nasty long tails, armed with nasty long stings  
And eternally thinking, and blinking, and winking,  
At grubs—when he ought of *her* to be thinking.  
But no! ah no! 'twas by no means so  
With the fair Lady Jane,  
*Tout au contraire*, no lady so fair,  
Was e'er known to wear more contented an air;  
And—let who would call—every day she was there  
Propounding receipts for some delicate fare,  
Some toothsome conserve, of quince, apple or pear  
Or distilling strong waters—or potting a hare—  
Or counting her spoons, and her crockery ware;  
Enough to make less gifted visitors stare.

Nay more; don't suppose  
With such doings as those  
This account of her merits must come to a close;  
No!—examine her conduct more closely, you'll find  
She by no means neglected improving her mind;  
For there all the while with an air quite bewitching  
She sat herring-boning, tambouring, or stitching,  
Or having an eye to affairs of the kitchen.  
Close by her side,  
Sat her kinsman, MacBride—  
Captain Dugald MacBride, Royal Scots Fusiliers;—  
And I doubt if you'd find, in the whole of his clan,

A more highly intelligent, worthy young man;  
And there he'd be sitting,  
While she was a-knitting,  
Reading aloud, with a very grave look,  
Some very "wise saw," from some very good book—  
No matter who came,  
It was always the same,  
The Captain was reading aloud to the dame,  
Till, from having gone through half the books on the shelf,  
They were *almost* as wise as Sir Thomas himself.

Well it happened one day—  
I really can't say  
The particular month;—but I *think* 'twas in May,  
'Twas I *know* in the spring-time, when "nature looks gay,"  
As the poet observes—and on tree-top and spray,  
The dear little dickey birds carol away,  
That the whole of the house was thrown into affright,  
For no soul could conceive what was gone with the Knight.

It seems he had taken  
A light breakfast—bacon,  
An egg, a little broiled haddock—at most  
A round and a half of some hot buttered toast,  
With a slice of cold sirloin from yesterday's roast.  
And then, let me see,—  
He had two,—perhaps three  
Cups, with sugar and cream, of strong gunpowder tea,—  
But no matter for that—  
He had called for his hat,  
With the brim that I've said was so broad and so flat,  
And his "specs" with the tortoise-shell rim, and his cane.  
With the crutch-handled top, which he used to sustain  
His steps in his walk, or to poke in the shrubs  
Or the grass, when unearthing his worms or his grubs;  
Thus armed he set out on a ramble—a-lack!  
He *set out*, poor dear soul!—but he never came back!

"First dinner bell" rang  
Out its euphonous clang  
At five—folks kept early hours then—and the "last"  
Ding-donged, as it ever was wont, at half-past.  
Still the master was absent—the cook came and said, he  
Feared dinner would spoil, having been so long ready,  
That the puddings her ladyship thought such a treat  
He was morally sure, would be scarce fit to eat!  
Said the lady, "Dish up! Let the meal be served straight,  
And let two or three slices be put on a plate,  
And kept hot for Sir Thomas."—Captain Dugald said grace,  
Then set himself down in Sir Thomas' place.

Wearily, wearily, all that night,  
That live-long night did the hours go by;  
And the Lady Jane,  
In grief and pain,  
She sat herself down to cry!  
And Captain MacBride,  
Who sat by her side,  
Though I really can't say that he actually cried,  
At least had a tear in his eye!  
As much as can well be expected, perhaps,  
From "very young fellows," for very "old chaps."  
And if he had said  
What he'd got in his head,  
"Twould have been, "Poor old Duffer, he's certainly dead!"  
The morning dawned—and the next—and the next  
And all in the mansion were still perplexed;  
No knocker fell,  
His approach to tell;  
Not so much as a runaway ring at the bell.

Yet the sun shone bright upon tower and tree,  
And the meads smiled green as green may be,  
And the dear little dicky birds caroled with glee,  
And the lambs in the park skipped merry and free.—

Without, all was joy and harmony!

And thus 'twill be—nor long the day—  
Ere we, like him, shall pass away!  
Yon sun that now our bosoms warms,  
Shall shine—but shine on other forms;  
Yon grove, whose choir so sweetly cheers  
Us now, shall sound on other ears;  
The joyous lambs, as now, shall play,  
But other eyes its sports survey;  
The stream we loved shall roll as fair,  
The flowery sweets, the trim parterre,  
Shall scent, as now, the ambient air;  
The tree whose bending branches bear  
The one loved name—shall yet be there—  
But where the hand that carved it? Where?

These were hinted to me as the very ideas  
Which passed through the mind of the fair Lady Jane,  
As she walked on the esplanade to and again,  
With Captain MacBride,  
Of course at her side,  
Who could not look *quite* so forlorn—though he tried,  
An "idea" in fact, had got into *his* head,  
That if "poor dear Sir Thomas" should really be dead,  
It might be no bad "spec" to be there in his stead,  
And by simply contriving, in due time, to wed  
A lady who was young and fair,  
A lady slim and tall,  
To set himself down in comfort there,  
The lord of Tapton Hall.

Thinks he, "We have sent  
Half over Kent,  
And nobody knows how much money's been spent,  
Yet no one's been found to say which way he went!  
Here's a fortnight and more has gone by, and we've tried

Every plan we could hit on—and had him well cried

'MISSING!! *Stolen or Strayed,*

*Lost or Mislaid,*

A GENTLEMAN;—middle-aged, sober and staid;

Stoops slightly;—and when he left home was arrayed

In a sad-colored suit, somewhat dingy and frayed;

Had spectacles on with a tortoise-shell rim,

And a hat rather low crowned, and broad in the brim.

Whoe'er shall bear,

Or send him with care,

(Right side uppermost) home; or shall give notice where

Said middle-aged GENTLEMAN is; or shall state

Any fact, that may tend to throw light on his fate,

To the man at the turnpike, called *Tappington Gate*,

Shall receive a reward of *Five Pounds* for his trouble.

N.B. If defunct, the *Reward* will be double!!'

"Had he been above ground,

He *must* have been found.

No; doubtless he's shot—or he's hanged—or he's drowned!

Then his widow—ay! ay!

But what will folks say?—

To address her at once, at so early a day.

Well—what then—who cares!—let 'em say what they may."

When a man has decided

As Captain MacBride did,

And once fully made up his mind on the matter, he

Can't be too prompt in unmasking his battery.

He began on the instant, and vowed that her eyes

Far exceeded in brilliance the stars in the skies;

That her lips were like roses, her cheeks were like lilies;

Her breath had the odor of daffadownillies!—

With a thousand more compliments, equally true,

Expressed in similitudes equally new!

Then his left arm he placed

Round her jimp, taper waist—

Ere she fixed to repulse or return his embrace,  
Up came running a man at a deuce of a pace,  
With that very peculiar expression of face  
Which always betokens dismay or disaster,  
Crying out—'twas the gard'ner—"Oh, ma'am! we've found master!!"  
"Where! where?" screamed the lady; and echo screamed,  
    "Where?"  
    The man couldn't say "there!"  
    He had no breath to spare,  
But gasping for breath he could only respond  
By pointing—be pointed, alas! TO THE POND.  
'Twas e'en so; poor dear Knight, with his "specs" and his hat,  
He'd gone poking his nose into this and to that;  
When close to the side of the bank, he espied  
An uncommon fine tadpole, remarkably fat!  
    He stooped;—and he thought her  
    His own;—he had caught her!  
Got hold of her tail—and to land almost brought her,  
When—he plumped head and heels into fifteen feet water!

The Lady Jane was tall and slim,  
    The Lady Jane was fair,  
Alas! for Sir Thomas!—she grieved for him,  
As she saw two serving men sturdy of limb,  
    His body between them bear;  
She sobbed and she sighed, she lamented and cried,  
    For of sorrow brimful was her cup;  
She swooned, and I think she'd have fallen down and died,  
    If Captain MacBride  
    Hadn't been by her side  
With the gardener;—they both their assistance supplied,  
And managed to hold her up.  
    But when she "comes to,"  
    Oh! 'tis shocking to view  
The sight which the corpse reveals!  
    Sir Thomas' body,  
    It looked so odd—he

Was half eaten up by the eels!

His waistcoat and hose,  
And the rest of his clothes,  
Were all gnawed through and through;  
And out of each shoe,  
An eel they drew;  
And from each of his pockets they pulled out two!  
And the gardener himself had secreted a few,  
As well might be supposed he'd do,  
For, when he came running to give the alarm,  
He had six in the basket that hung on his arm.

Good Father John was summoned anon;  
Holy water was sprinkled and little bells tinkled,  
And tapers were lighted,  
And incense ignited,  
And masses were sung, and masses were said,  
All day, for the quiet repose of the dead,  
And all night no one thought about going to bed.

But Lady Jane was tall and slim,  
And Lady Jane was fair,  
And ere morning came, that winsome dame  
Had made up her mind, or—what's much the same—  
Had *thought about*, once more "changing her name,"  
And she said with a pensive air,  
To Thompson the valet, while taking away,  
When supper was over, the cloth and the tray,  
"Eels a many I've ate; but any  
So good ne'er tasted before!—  
They're a fish too, of which I'm remarkably fond—  
Go—pop Sir Thomas again in the pond—  
Poor dear!—*he'll catch us some more.*"

**MORAL**

All middle-aged gentlemen let me advise,  
If you're married, and hav'n't got very good eyes,  
Don't go poking about after blue-bottle flies.  
If you've spectacles, don't have a tortoise-shell rim,  
And don't go near the water—unless you can swim.  
Married ladies, especially such as are fair,  
Tall and slim, I would next recommend to beware,  
How, on losing one spouse, they give way to despair,  
But let them reflect, there are fish, and no doubt on't,  
As good *in* the river, as ever came *out* on't.

*Richard Harris Barham.*

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## AN EASTERN QUESTION

My William was a soldier, and he says to me, says he,  
"My Susan, I must sail across the South Pacific sea;  
For we've got to go to Egypt for to fight the old Khedive;  
But when he's dead I'll marry you, as sure as I'm alive!"

'Twere hard for me to part with him; he couldn't read nor write,  
So I never had love letters for to keep my memory bright;  
But Jim, who is our footman, took the *Daily Telegraph*,  
And told me William's reg-i-ment mowed down the foe like chaff.

So every day Jim come to me to read the Eastern news,  
And used to bring me bouquets, which I scarcely could refuse;  
Till one fine day it happened—*how* it happened, goodness knows,—  
He put his arm around me and he started to propose.

I put his hand from off me, and I said in thrilling tones,  
"I like you, Jim, but *never* will I give up William Jones;  
It ain't no good your talking, for my heart is firm and fixed,



For William is engaged to me, and naught shall come betwixt."

So Jim he turned a ghastly pale to find there was no hope;  
And made remarks about a pond, and razors, and a rope;  
The other servants pitied him, and Rosie said as much;  
But Rosie was too flighty, and he didn't care for such.

The weeks and months passed slowly, till I heard the Eastern war  
Was over, and my William would soon be home once more;  
And I was proud and happy for I knew that I could say  
I'd been true to my sweet William all the years he'd been away.

Says Jim to me, "I love you, Sue, you know full well I do,  
And evermore whilst I draw breath I vow I will be true;  
But my feelings are too sensitive, I really couldn't stand  
A-seeing of that soldier taking hold your little hand.

"So I've made my mind up finally to throw myself away;  
There's Rosie loves me truly, and no more I'll say her nay;  
I've bought a hat on purpose, and I'm going to hire a ring,  
And I've borrowed father's wedding suit that looks the very thing."

So Jim he married Rosie, just the very day before  
My William's reg-i-ment was due to reach their native shore;  
I was there to see him landed and to give him welcome home,  
And take him to my arms from which he never more should roam.

But I couldn't see my William, for the men were all alike,  
With their red coats and their rifles, and their helmets with a spike;  
So I curtseys to a sergeant who was smiling very kind,  
"Where's William Jones?" I asks him, "if so be you wouldn't mind?"

Then he calls a gawky, red-haired chap, that stood good six-feet two:  
"Here, Jones," he cries, "this lady here's enquiring after you."  
"Not me!" I says, "I want a man who 'listed from our Square;  
With a small moustache, but growing fast, and bright brown curly hair."

The sergeant wiped his eye, and took his helmet from his head,  
"I'm very sorry, ma'am," he said, "*that* William Jones is dead;  
He died from getting sunstroke, and we envied him his lot,  
For we were melted to our bones, the climate was that hot!"

So that's how 'tis that I'm condemned to lead a single life,  
For the sergeant, who was struck with me, already had a wife;  
And Jim is tied to Rosie, and can't get himself untied,  
Whilst the man that I was faithful to has been and gone and died!

*H. M. Paull.*

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## MY AUNT'S SPECTRE

They tell me (but I really can't  
Imagine such a rum thing),  
It is the phantom of my Aunt,  
Who ran away—or something.

It is the very worst of bores:  
(My Aunt was most delightful).  
It prowls about the corridors,  
And utters noises frightful.

At midnight through the rooms It glides,  
Behaving very coolly,  
Our hearts all throb against our sides—  
The lights are burning bluely.

The lady, in her living hours,  
Was the most charming vixen  
That ever this poor sex of ours  
Delighted to play tricks on.

Yes, that's her portrait on the wall,  
In quaint old-fangled bodice:  
Her eyes are blue—her waist is small—  
A ghost! Pooh, pooh,—a goddess!

A fine patrician shape, to suit  
My dear old father's sister—  
Lips softly curved, a dainty foot:  
Happy the man that kissed her!

Light hair of crisp irregular curl  
Over fair shoulders scattered—  
Egad, she was a pretty girl,  
Unless Sir Thomas flattered!

And who the deuce, in these bright days,  
Could possibly expect her  
To take to dissipated ways,  
And plague us as a spectre?

*Mortimer Collins.*

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## CASEY AT THE BAT

It looked extremely rocky for the Mudville nine that day,  
The score stood four to six with but an inning left to play.  
And so, when Cooney died at first, and Burrows did the same,  
A pallor wreathed the features of the patrons of the game.  
A straggling few got up to go, leaving there the rest,  
With that hope which springs eternal within the human breast.  
For they thought if only Casey could get a whack at that,  
They'd put up even money with Casey at the bat.

But Flynn preceded Casey, and likewise so did Blake,  
And the former was a pudding and the latter was a fake;  
So on that stricken multitude a death-like silence sat,  
For there seemed but little chance of Casey's getting to the bat.  
But Flynn let drive a single to the wonderment of all,  
And the much despised Blakey tore the cover off the ball,  
And when the dust had lifted and they saw what had occurred,  
There was Blakey safe on second, and Flynn a-hugging third.  
Then from the gladdened multitude went up a joyous yell,  
It bounded from the mountain top and rattled in the dell,  
It struck upon the hillside, and rebounded on the flat,  
For Casey, mighty Casey, was advancing to the bat.  
There was ease in Casey's manner as he stepped into his place,  
There was pride in Casey's bearing and a smile on Casey's face,  
And when responding to the cheers he lightly doffed his hat,  
No stranger in the crowd could doubt, 'twas Casey at the bat.  
Ten thousand eyes were on him as he rubbed his hands with dirt,  
Five thousand tongues applauded as he wiped them on his shirt;  
And while the writhing pitcher ground the ball into his hip—  
Defiance gleamed from Casey's eye—a sneer curled Casey's lip.  
And now the leather-covered sphere came hurtling through the air,  
And Casey stood a-watching it in haughty grandeur there;  
Close by the sturdy batsman the ball unheeded sped—  
"That hain't my style," said Casey—"Strike one," the Umpire said.  
From the bleachers black with people there rose a sullen roar,  
Like the beating of the storm waves on a stern and distant shore,  
"Kill him! kill the Umpire!" shouted some one from the stand—  
And it's likely they'd have done it had not Casey raised his hand.  
With a smile of Christian charity great Casey's visage shone,  
He stilled the rising tumult and he bade the game go on;  
He signalled to the pitcher and again the spheroid flew,  
But Casey still ignored it and the Umpire said "Strike two."  
"Fraud!" yelled the maddened thousands, and the echo answered "Fraud,"  
But one scornful look from Casey and the audience was awed;  
They saw his face grow stern and cold; they saw his muscles strain,  
And they knew that Casey would not let that ball go by again.  
The sneer is gone from Casey's lip; his teeth are clenched with hate,

He pounds with cruel violence his bat upon the plate;  
And now the pitcher holds the ball, and now he lets it go,  
And now the air is shattered by the force of Casey's blow.  
Oh! somewhere in this favored land the sun is shining bright,  
The band is playing somewhere, and somewhere hearts are light,  
And somewhere men are laughing, and somewhere children shout;  
But there is no joy in Mudville—mighty Casey has "Struck Out."

*Ernest Lawrence Thayer.*

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## **THE PIED PIPER OF HAMELIN**

Hamelin Town's in Brunswick,  
By famous Hanover City;  
The river Weser, deep and wide,  
Washes its wall on the southern side;  
A pleasanter spot you never spied;  
But when begins my ditty,  
Almost five hundred years ago,  
To see the townsfolk suffer so  
From vermin was a pity.

Rats!  
They fought the dogs, and killed the cats,  
And bit the babies in the cradles,  
And ate the cheeses out of the vats,  
And licked the soup from the cook's own ladles,  
Split open the kegs of salted sprats,  
Made nests inside men's Sunday hats,  
And even spoiled the women's chats,  
By drowning their speaking  
With shrieking and squeaking  
In fifty different sharps and flats.

At last the people in a body  
To the Town Hall came flocking:  
"Tis clear," cried they, "our Mayor's a noddy;  
And as for our Corporation—shocking  
To think we buy gowns lined with ermine  
For dolts that can't or won't determine  
What's best to rid us of our vermin!  
You hope, because you're old and obese,  
To find in the furry civic robe ease?  
Rouse up, Sirs! Give your brains a racking  
To find the remedy we're lacking,  
Or, sure as fate, we'll send you packing!"  
At this the Mayor and Corporation  
Quaked with a mighty consternation.

An hour they sate in council,  
At length the Mayor broke silence:  
"For a guilder I'd my ermine gown sell!  
I wish I were a mile hence!  
It's easy to bid one rack one's brain—  
I'm sure my poor head aches again  
I've scratched it so, and all in vain.  
Oh, for a trap, a trap, a trap!"

Just as he said this, what should hap  
At the chamber door but a gentle tap?  
"Bless us," cried the Mayor, "what's that?"  
(With the Corporation as he sat,  
Looking little though wondrous fat;  
Nor brighter was his eye, nor moister,  
Than a too-long-opened oyster,  
Save when at noon his paunch grew mutinous  
For a plate of turtle green and glutinous),  
"Only a scraping of shoes on the mat?  
Anything like the sound of a rat  
Makes my heart go pit-a-pat!"

"Come in!"—the Mayor cried, looking bigger:  
And in did come the strangest figure.  
His queer long coat from heel to head  
Was half of yellow and half of red;  
And he himself was tall and thin,  
With sharp blue eyes, each like a pin,  
And light loose hair, yet swarthy skin,  
No tuft on cheek nor beard on chin,  
But lips where smiles went out and in;  
There was no guessing his kith and kin:  
And nobody could enough admire  
The tall man and his quaint attire.  
Quoth one: "It's as my great grandsire,  
Starting up at the Trump of Doom's tone,  
Had walked this way from his painted tombstone!"

He advanced to the council-table;  
And, "Please your honours," said he, "I'm able,  
By means of a secret charm, to draw  
All creatures living beneath the sun,  
That creep or swim or fly or run,  
After me so as you never saw!  
And I chiefly use my charm  
On creatures that do people harm,  
The mole and toad and newt and viper;  
And people call me the Pied Piper."  
(And here they noticed round his neck  
A scarf of red and yellow stripe,  
To match with his coat of the selfsame cheque;  
And at the scarf's end hung a pipe;  
And his fingers, they noticed, were ever straying  
As if impatient to be playing  
Upon this pipe, as low it dangled  
Over his vesture so old-fangled.)  
"Yet," said he, "poor piper as I am,  
In Tartary I freed the Cham,

Last June, from his huge swarms of gnats;  
I eased in Asia the Nizam  
Of a monstrous brood of vampyre bats:  
And as for what your brain bewilders,  
If I can rid your town of rats,  
Will you give me a thousand guilders?"  
"One? fifty thousand!" was the exclamation  
Of the astonished Mayor and Corporation.

Into the street the Piper stept,  
Smiling first a little smile,  
As if he knew what magic slept  
In his quiet pipe the while;  
Then, like a musical adept,  
To blow the pipe his lips he wrinkled,  
And green and blue his sharp eyes twinkled  
Like a candle flame where salt is sprinkled;  
And ere three shrill notes the pipe uttered,  
You heard as if an army muttered;  
And the muttering grew to a grumbling;  
And the grumbling grew to a mighty rumbling;  
And out of the house the rats came tumbling.  
Great rats, small rats, lean rats, brawny rats,  
Brown rats, black rats, grey rats, tawny rats,  
Grave old plodders, gay young friskers,  
Fathers, mothers, uncles, cousins,  
Cocking tails and pricking whiskers,  
Families by tens and dozens,  
Brothers, sisters, husbands, wives—  
Followed the Piper for their lives.  
From street to street he piped advancing,  
And step by step they followed dancing,  
Until they came to the river Weser  
Wherein all plunged and perished  
—Save one, who, stout as Julius Cæsar,  
Swam across and lived to carry  
(As he the manuscript he cherished)



To Rat-land home his commentary,  
Which was, "At the first shrill notes of the pipe,  
I heard a sound as of scraping tripe,  
And putting apples wondrous ripe,  
Into a cider-press's gripe:  
And a moving away of pickle-tub boards,  
And a leaving ajar of conserve cupboards,  
And a drawing the corks of train-oil-flasks,  
And a breaking the hoops of butter-casks:

And it seemed as if a voice  
(Sweeter far than by harp or by psaltery  
Is breathed) called out, Oh rats, rejoice!  
The world is grown to one vast drysaltery!  
So munch on, crunch on, take your nuncheon,  
Breakfast, supper, dinner, luncheon!  
And just as a bulky sugar puncheon,  
All ready staved, like a great sun shone  
Glorious scarce an inch before me,  
Just as methought it said, Come, bore me!  
—I found the Weser rolling o'er me."

You should have heard the Hamelin people  
Ringing the bells till they rocked the steeple.  
"Go," cried the Mayor, "and get long poles!  
Poke out the nests and block up the holes!  
Consult with carpenters and builders,  
And leave in our town not even a trace  
Of the rats!"—when suddenly, up the face  
Of the piper perked in the market-place,  
With a "First, if you please, my thousand guilders!"

A thousand guilders! The Mayor looked blue;  
So did the Corporation too.  
For council dinners made rare havock  
With Claret, Moselle, Vin-de-Grave, Hock;  
And half the money would replenish

Their cellar's biggest butt with Rhenish.  
To pay this sum to a wandering fellow  
With a gipsy coat of red and yellow!  
"Beside," quoth the Mayor with a knowing wink,  
"Our business was done at the river's brink;  
We saw with our eyes the vermin sink,  
And what's dead can't come to life, I think.  
So, friend, we're not the folks to shrink  
From the duty of giving you something to drink,  
And a matter of money to put in your poke;  
But as for the guilders, what we spoke  
Of them, as you very well know, was in joke;  
Beside, our losses have made us thrifty:  
A thousand guilders! Come, take fifty!"

The Piper's face fell, and he cried,  
"No trifling! I can't wait, beside!  
I've promised to visit by dinner time  
Bagdad, and accept the prime  
Of the Head Cook's pottage, all he's rich in,  
For having left in the Caliph's kitchen,  
Of a nest of scorpions no survivor:  
With him I proved no bargain-driver,  
With you, don't think I'll bate a stiver!  
And folks who put me in a passion  
May find me pipe after another fashion."

"How?" cried the Mayor, "d'ye think I'll brook  
Being worse treated than a Cook?  
Insulted by a lazy ribald  
With idle pipe and vesture piebald?  
You threaten us, fellow? Do your worst,  
Blow your pipe there till you burst!"

Once more he stept into the street;  
And to his lips again  
Laid his long pipe of smooth straight cane;

And ere he blew three notes (such sweet  
Soft notes as yet musician's cunning  
Never gave the enraptured air),  
There was a rustling, that seemed like a bustling  
Of merry crowds justling at pitching and hustling,  
Small feet were pattering, wooden shoes clattering,  
Little hands clapping and little tongues chattering,  
And, like fowls in a farmyard when barley is scattering,  
Out came the children running.  
All the little boys and girls,  
With rosy cheeks and flaxen curls  
And sparkling eyes and teeth like pearls,  
Tripping and skipping, ran merrily after  
The wonderful music with shouting and laughter.

The Mayor was dumb, and the Council stood  
As if they were changed into blocks of wood,  
Unable to move a step, or cry  
To the children merrily skipping by,  
And could only follow with the eye

That joyous crowd at the Piper's back.  
But how the Mayor was on the rack,  
And the wretched Council's bosoms beat,  
As the Piper turned from the High Street  
To where the Weser rolled its waters  
Right in the way of their sons and daughters!  
However he turned from South to West,  
And to Koppelberg Hill his steps addressed,  
And after him the children pressed;  
Great was the joy in every breast.

"He never can cross that mighty top!

He's forced to let the piping drop,  
And we shall see our children stop!"  
When, lo, as they reached the mountain's side,  
A wondrous portal opened wide,  
As if a cavern were suddenly hollowed;

And the Piper advanced and the children followed,  
And when all were in to the very last,  
The door in the mountain-side shut fast.  
Did I say—all? No! one was lame,  
And could not dance the whole of the way;  
And in after years, if you would blame  
His sadness, he was used to say,—  
"It's dull in our town since my playmates left;  
I can't forget that I'm bereft  
Of all the pleasant sights they see,  
Which the Piper also promised me;  
For he led us, he said, to a joyous land,  
Joining the town and just at hand,  
Where waters gushed and fruit-trees grew,  
And flowers put forth a fairer hue,  
And everything was strange and new;  
The sparrows were brighter than peacocks here,  
And their dogs outran our fallow deer,  
And honey-bees had lost their stings;  
And horses were born with eagle's wings;  
And just as I became assured  
My lame foot would be speedily cured,  
The music stopped, and I stood still,  
And found myself outside the Hill,  
Left alone against my will,  
To go now limping as before,  
And never hear of that country more!"

Alas, alas, for Hamelin!

There came into many a burgher's pate  
A text which says, that Heaven's Gate  
Opes to the Rich at as easy rate  
As the needle's eye takes a camel in!  
The Mayor sent East, West, North, and South,  
To offer the Piper by word of mouth,  
Wherever it was men's lot to find him,  
Silver and gold to his heart's content,

If he'd only return the way he went,  
And bring the children all behind him.  
But when they saw 'twas a lost endeavour,  
And Piper and dancers were gone for ever,  
They made a decree that lawyers never  
Should think their records dated duly  
If, after the day of the month and year,  
These words did not as well appear,  
"And so long after what happened here  
On the twenty-second of July,  
Thirteen hundred and seventy-six:"  
And the better in memory to fix  
The place of the Children's last retreat,  
They called it the Pied Piper's Street—  
Where any one playing on pipe or tabor  
Was sure for the future to lose his labour.  
Nor suffered they hostelry or tavern  
To shock with mirth a street so solemn;  
But opposite the place of the cavern  
They wrote the story on a column.  
And on the great Church Window painted  
The same, to make the world acquainted  
How their children were stolen away,  
And there it stands to this very day.  
And I must not omit to say  
That in Transylvania there's a tribe  
Of alien people that ascribe  
The outlandish ways and dress,  
On which their neighbours lay such stress,  
To their fathers and mothers having risen  
Out of some subterraneous prison,  
Into which they were trepanned  
Long time ago in a mighty band  
Out of Hamelin town in Brunswick Land,  
But how or why, they don't understand.

So, Willy, let me and you be wipers

Of scores out with all men—especially pipers;  
And, whether they pipe us free from rats or from mice,  
If we've promised them aught, let us keep our promise.

*Robert Browning.*

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## THE GOOSE

I knew an old wife lean and poor,  
Her rags scarce held together;  
There strode a stranger to the door,  
And it was windy weather.

He held a goose upon his arm,  
He utter'd rhyme and reason,  
"Here, take the goose, and keep you warm,  
It is a stormy season."

She caught the white goose by the leg,  
A goose—'twas no great matter.  
The goose let fall a golden egg  
With cackle and with clatter.

She dropt the goose, and caught the pelf,  
And ran to tell her neighbours;  
And bless'd herself, and cursed herself,  
And rested from her labours.

And feeding high, and living soft,  
Grew plump and able-bodied;  
Until the grave churchwarden doff'd,  
The parson smirk'd and nodded.

So sitting, served by man and maid,  
She felt her heart grow prouder:  
But, ah! the more the white goose laid  
It clack'd and cackled louder.

It clutter'd here, it chuckled there;  
It stirr'd the old wife's mettle:  
She shifted in her elbow-chair,  
And hurl'd the pan and kettle.

"A quinsy choke thy cursed note!"  
Then wax'd her anger stronger.  
"Go, take the goose, and wring her throat,  
I will not bear it longer."

Then yelp'd the cur, and yawl'd the cat;  
Ran Gaffer, stumbled Gammer.  
The goose flew this way and flew that,  
And fill'd the house with clamour.

As head and heels upon the floor  
They flounder'd all together,  
There strode a stranger to the door,  
And it was windy weather:

He took the goose upon his arm,  
He utter'd words of scorning;  
"So keep you cold, or keep you warm,  
It is a stormy morning."

The wild wind rang from park and plain,  
And round the attics rumbled,  
Till all the tables danced again,  
And half the chimneys tumbled.

The glass blew in, the fire blew out,  
The blast was hard and harder.

Her cap blew off, her gown blew up,  
And a whirlwind clear'd the larder:

And while on all sides breaking loose  
Her household fled the danger,  
Quoth she, "The Devil take the goose,  
And God forget the stranger!"

*Lord Tennyson.*

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## **THE BALLAD OF CHARITY**

It was in a pleasant deepô, sequestered from the rain,  
That many weary passengers were waitin' for the train;  
Piles of quite expensive baggage, many a gorgeous portmantó,  
Ivory-handled umberellas made a most touristic show.

Whereunto there came a person, very humble was his mien,  
Who took an observation of the interestin' scene;  
Closely scanned the umberellas, watched with joy the mighty trunks,  
And observed that all the people were securin' Pullman bunks:

Who was followed shortly after by a most unhappy tramp,  
Upon whose features poverty had jounced her iron stamp;  
And to make a clear impression as bees sting you while they buzz,  
She had hit him rather harder than she generally does.

For he was so awful ragged, and in parts so awful bare,  
That the folks were quite repulsioned to behold him begging there;  
And instead of drawing currency from out their pocket-books,  
They drew themselves asunder with aversionary looks.

Sternly gazed the first newcomer on the unindulgent crowd,



Then in tones which pierced the deepô he solilicussed aloud:—  
"I hev trevelled o'er this cont'nent from Quebec to Bogotáw,  
But sech a set of scallawags as these I never saw.

"Ye are wealthy, ye are gifted, ye have house and lands and rent,  
Yet unto a suff'rin' mortal ye will not donate a cent;  
Ye expend your missionaries to the heathen and the Jew,  
But there isn't any heathen that is half as small as you.

"Ye are lucky—ye hev cheque-books and deeposits in the bank,  
And ye squanderate your money on the titled folks of rank;  
The onyx and the sardonyx upon your garments shine,  
An' ye drink at every dinner p'r'aps a dollar's wuth of wine.

"Ye are goin' for the summer to the islands by the sea,  
Where it costs four dollars daily—setch is not for setch as me;  
Iv'ry-handled umberellas do not come into my plan,  
But I kin give a dollar to this suff'rin' fellow-man.

"Hand-bags made of Rooshy leather are not truly at my call,  
Yet in the eyes of Mussy I am richer 'en you all,  
For I kin give a dollar wher' you dare not stand a dime,  
And never miss it nother, nor regret it ary time."

Sayin' this he drew a wallet from the inner of his vest,  
And gave the tramp a daddy, which it was his level best;  
Other people havin' heard him soon to charity inclined—  
One giver soon makes twenty if you only get their wind.

The first who gave the dollar led the other one about,  
And at every contribution he a-raised a joyful shout,  
Exclaimin' how 'twas noble to relieviate distress,  
And remarkin' that our duty is our present happiness.

Thirty dollars altogether were collected by the tramp,  
When he bid 'em all good evenin' and went out into the damp,  
And was followed briefly after by the one who made the speech,

And who showed by good example how to practise as to preach.

Which soon around the corner the couple quickly met,  
And the tramp produced the specie for to liquidate his debt;  
And the man who did the preachin' took his twenty of the sum,  
Which you see that out of thirty left a tenner for the bum.

And the couple passed the summer at Bar Harbor with the rest,  
Greatly changed in their appearance and most elegently dressed.  
Any fowl with change of feathers may a brilliant bird become:  
Oh, how hard is life for many! oh, how sweet it is for some!

*Charles Godfrey Leland.*

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## **THE POST CAPTAIN**

When they heard the Captain humming and beheld the dancing crew,  
On the "Royal Biddy" frigate was Sir Peter Bombazoo;  
His mind was full of music and his head was full of tunes,  
And he cheerfully exhibited on pleasant afternoons.

He could whistle, on his fingers, an invigorating reel,  
And could imitate a piper on the handles of the wheel;  
He could play in double octaves, too, all up and down the rail,  
Or rattle off a rondo on the bottom of a pail.

Then porters with their packages and bakers with their buns,  
And countesses in carriages and grenadiers with guns,  
And admirals and commodores arrived from near and far,  
To listen to the music of this entertaining tar.

When they heard the Captain humming and beheld the dancing crew.  
The commodores severely said, "Why, this will never do!"

And the admirals all hurried home, remarking, "This is most  
Extraordinary conduct for a captain at his post."

Then they sent some sailing-orders to Sir Peter, in a boat,  
And he did a little fifying on the edges of the note;  
But he read the sailing orders, as of course he had to do,  
And removed the "Royal Biddy" to the Bay of Boohgabooh.

Now, Sir Peter took it kindly, but it's proper to explain  
He was sent to catch a pirate out upon the Spanish Main.  
And he played, with variations, an imaginary tune  
On the buttons of his waistcoat, like a jocular bassoon.

Then a topman saw the pirate come a-sailing in the bay,  
And reported to the Captain in the ordinary way.  
"I'll receive him," said Sir Peter, "with a musical salute,"  
And he gave some imitations of a double-jointed flute.

Then the Pirate cried derisively, "I've heard it done before!"  
And he hoisted up a banner emblematical of gore.  
But Sir Peter said serenely, "You may double-shot the guns  
While I sing my little ballad of 'The Butter on the Buns.'"

Then the Pirate banged Sir Peter and Sir Peter banged him back,  
And they banged away together as they took another tack.  
Then Sir Peter said, politely, "You may board him, if you like,"  
And he played a little dirge upon the handle of a pike.

Then the "Biddies" poured like hornets down upon the Pirate's deck  
And Sir Peter caught the Pirate and he took him by the neck,  
And remarked, "You must excuse me, but you acted like a brute  
When I gave my imitation of that double-jointed flute."

So they took that wicked Pirate and they took his wicked crew,  
And tied them up with double knots in packages of two.  
And left them lying on their backs in rows upon the beach  
With a little bread and water within comfortable reach.

Now the Pirate had a treasure (mostly silverware and gold),  
And Sir Peter took and stowed it in the bottom of his hold;  
And said, "I will retire on this cargo of doubloons,  
And each of you, my gallant crew, may have some silver spoons."

Now commodores in coach-and-fours and corporals in cabs,  
And men with carts of pies and tarts and fishermen with crabs,  
And barristers with wigs, in gigs, still gather on the strand,  
But there isn't any music save a little German band.

*Charles E. Carryl.*

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## **ROBINSON CRUSOE'S STORY**

The night was thick and hazy  
When the *Piccadilly Daisy*  
Carried down the crew and captain in the sea;  
And I think the water drowned 'em,  
For they never, never found 'em,  
And I know they didn't come ashore with me.

Oh! 'twas very sad and lonely  
When I found myself the only  
Population on this cultivated shore;  
But I've made a little tavern  
In a rocky little cavern,  
And I sit and watch for people at the door.

I spent no time in looking  
For a girl to do my cooking,  
As I'm quite a clever hand at making stews;  
But I had that fellow Friday

Just to keep the tavern tidy,  
And to put a Sunday polish on my shoes.

I have a little garden  
That I'm cultivating lard in,  
As the things I eat are rather tough and dry;  
For I live on toasted lizards,  
Prickly pears and parrot gizzards,  
And I'm really very fond of beetle pie.

The clothes I had were furry,  
And it made me fret and worry  
When I found the moths were eating off the hair;  
And I had to scrape and sand 'em,  
And I boiled 'em and I tanned 'em,  
Till I got the fine morocco suit I wear.

I sometimes seek diversion  
In a family excursion,  
With the few domestic animals you see;  
And we take along a carrot  
As refreshment for the parrot,  
And a little can of jungleberry tea.

Then we gather as we travel  
Bits of moss and dirty gravel,  
And we chip off little specimens of stone;  
And we carry home as prizes  
Funny bugs of handy sizes,  
Just to give the day a scientific tone.

If the roads are wet and muddy  
We remain at home and study,—  
For the Goat is very clever at a sum,—  
And the Dog, instead of fighting  
Studies ornamental writing,  
While the Cat is taking lessons on the drum.

We retire at eleven,  
And we rise again at seven;  
And I wish to call attention, as I close,  
To the fact that all the scholars  
Are correct about their collars,  
And particular in turning out their toes.

*Charles E. Carryl.*

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## **BEN BLUFF**

Ben Bluff was a whaler, and many a day  
Had chased the huge fish about Baffin's old Bay;  
But time brought a change his diversion to spoil,  
And that was when Gas took the shine out of Oil.

He turned up his nose at the fumes of the coke,  
And swore the whole scheme was a bottle of smoke;  
As to London, he briefly delivered his mind,  
"Sparma-city," said he,—but the city declined.

So Ben cut his line in a sort of a huff,  
As soon as his whales had brought profits enough,—  
And hard by the Docks settled down for his life,  
But, true to his text, went to Wales for a wife.

A big one she was, without figure or waist,  
More bulky than lovely, but that was his taste;  
In fat she was lapped from her sole to her crown,  
And, turned into oil, would have lighted a town.

But Ben, like a whaler, was charmed with the match,

And thought, very truly, his spouse a great catch;  
A flesh-and-blood emblem of Plenty and Peace,  
And would not have changed her for Helen of Greece!

For Greenland was green in his memory still;  
He'd quitted his trade, but retained the good-will;  
And often when softened by bumbo and flip,  
Would cry till he blubbered about his old ship.

No craft like the *Grampus* could work through a floe,  
What knots she could run, and what tons she could stow!  
And then that rich smell he preferred to the rose,  
By just nosing the hold without holding his nose.

Now Ben he resolved, one fine Saturday night,  
A snug arctic circle of friends to invite;  
Old tars in the trade, who related old tales,  
And drank, and blew clouds that were "very like whales."

Of course with their grog there was plenty of chat,  
Of canting, and flenching, and cutting up fat;  
And how gun-harpoons into fashion had got,  
And if they were meant for the gun-whale or not?

At last they retired, and left Ben to his rest,  
By fancies cetaceous and drink well possessed,  
When, lo! as he lay by his partner in bed,  
He heard something blow through two holes in its head!

"A start!" muttered Ben, in the *Grampus* afloat,  
And made but one jump from the deck to the boat!  
"Huzza! pull away for the blubber and bone,—  
I look on that whale as already my own!"

Then groping about by the light of the moon,  
He soon laid his hand on his trusty harpoon;  
A moment he poised it, to send it more pat,

And then made a plunge to imbed it in fat!

"Starn all!" he sang out, "as you care for your lives,—  
Starn all! as you hope to return to your wives,—  
Stand by for the flurry! she throws up the foam!  
Well done, my old iron; I've sent you right home!"

And scarce had he spoken, when lo! bolt upright  
The leviathan rose in a great sheet of white,  
And swiftly advanced for a fathom or two,  
As only a fish out of water could do.

"Starn all!" echoed Ben, with a movement aback,  
But too slow to escape from the creature's attack;  
If flippers it had, they were furnished with nails,—  
"You willin, I'll teach you that women ain't whales!"

"Avast!" shouted Ben, with a sort of a screech,  
"I've heard a whale spouting, but here is a speech!"  
"A-spouting, indeed!—very pretty," said she;  
"But it's you I'll blow up, not the froth of the sea!

"To go to pretend to take *me* for a fish!  
You great polar bear—but I know what you wish;  
You're sick of a wife that your hankering balks,  
You want to go back to some young Esquimaux!"

"O dearest," cried Ben, frightened out of his life,  
"Don't think I would go for to murder a wife  
I must long have bewailed!" But she only cried, "Stuff!"  
Don't name it, you brute, you've *be-whaled* me enough!"

"Lord, Polly!" said Ben, "such a deed could I do?  
I'd rather have murdered all Wapping than you!  
Come, forgive what is past." "O you monster!" she cried,  
"It was none of your fault that it passed off one side!"



However, at last she inclined to forgive;  
"But, Ben, take this warning as long as you live,—  
If the love of harpooning so strong must prevail,  
Take a whale for a wife,—not a wife for a whale!"

*Thomas Hood.*

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## THE PILGRIMS AND THE PEAS

A brace of sinners, for no good,  
Were order'd to the Virgin Mary's shrine,  
Who at Loretto dwelt, in wax, stone, wood,  
And in a fair white wig look'd wondrous fine.

Fifty long miles had those sad rogues to travel,  
With something in their shoes much worse than gravel;  
In short, their toes so gentle to amuse,  
The priest had order'd peas into their shoes:

A nostrum, famous in old popish times,  
For purifying souls that stunk with crimes;  
A sort of apostolic salt,  
Which popish parsons for its powers exalt,  
For keeping souls of sinners sweet,  
Just as our kitchen salt keeps meat.

The knaves set off on the same day,  
Peas in their shoes, to go and pray:  
But very different was their speed, I wot:  
One of the sinners gallop'd on,  
Swift as a bullet from a gun;  
The other limp'd, as if he had been shot.

One saw the Virgin soon—*peccavi* cried—  
Had his soul whitewash'd all so clever;  
Then home again he nimbly hied,  
Made fit with saints above to live forever.

In coming back, however, let me say,  
He met his brother rogue about half-way,  
Hobbling, with outstretch'd arms and bended knees,  
Damning the souls and bodies of the peas;  
His eyes in tears, his cheeks and brow in sweat,  
Deep sympathizing with his groaning feet.

"How now," the light-toed, white-wash'd pilgrim broke,  
"You lazy lubber!"  
"Odds curse it!" cried the other, "'tis no joke;  
My feet, once hard as any rock,  
Are now as soft as blubber.

"Excuse me, Virgin Mary, that I swear:  
As for Loretto, I shall not go there;  
No! to the Devil my sinful soul must go,  
For damme if I ha'n't lost every toe.  
But, brother sinner, pray explain  
How 'tis that you are not in pain?  
What power hath work'd a wonder for your toes?  
Whilst I, just like a snail, am crawling,  
Now swearing, now on saints devoutly bawling,  
Whilst not a rascal comes to ease my woes?

"How is't that *you* can like a greyhound go,  
Merry as if that naught had happen'd, burn ye!"  
"Why," cried the other, grinning, "you must know,  
That, just before I ventured on my journey,  
To walk a little more at ease,  
I took the liberty to boil *my* peas."

*John Wolcot.*

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## TAM O'SHANTER

When chapman billies leave the street,  
And drouthy neibors neibors meet,  
As market days are wearin' late,  
And folk begin to tak the gate:

While we sit bousing at the nappy,  
And gettin' fou and unco happy,  
We thinkna on the lang Scots miles,  
The mosses, waters, slaps, and stiles,  
That lie between us and our hame,  
Whare sits our sulky sullen dame,  
Gathering her brows like gathering storm,  
Nursing her wrath to keep it warm.

This truth fand honest Tam o'Shanter,  
As he frae Ayr ae night did canter  
(Auld Ayr, wham ne'er a town surpasses  
For honest men and bonny lasses).

O Tam! hadst thou but been sae wise  
As ta'en thy ain wife Kate's advice!  
She tauld thee weel thou wast a skellum,  
A blethering, blustering, drunken blellum;  
That frae November till October,  
Ae market day thou wasna sober;  
That ilka melder, wi' the miller  
Thou sat as lang as thou hadst siller;  
That every naig was ca'd a shoe on,  
The smith and thee gat roaring fou on;  
That at the Lord's house, even on Sunday,  
Thou drank wi' Kirkton Jean till Monday.  
She prophesied, that, late or soon,

Thou wouldst be found deep drown'd in Doon!  
Or catch'd wi' warlocks i' the mirk,  
By Alloway's auld haunted kirk.

Ah, gentle dames! it gars me greet  
To think how mony counsels sweet,  
How mony lengthen'd, sage advices,  
The husband frae the wife despises!

But to our tale:—Ae market night,  
Tam had got planted unco right,  
Fast by an ingle, bleezing finely,  
Wi' reaming swats, that drank divinely;  
And at his elbow, Souter Johnny,  
His ancient, trusty, drouthy crony;  
Tam lo'ed him like a very brither—  
They had been fou for weeks thegither!  
The night drave on wi' sangs and clatter,  
And aye the ale was growing better:  
The landlady and Tam grew gracious,  
Wi' favours secret, sweet, and precious  
The Souter tauld his queerest stories,  
The landlord's laugh was ready chorus:  
The storm without might rair and rustle—  
Tam didna mind the storm a whistle.

Care, mad to see a man sae happy,  
E'en drown'd himsel' amang the nappy!  
As bees flee hame wi' lades o' treasure,  
The minutes wing'd their way wi' pleasure;  
Kings may be blest, but Tam was glorious,  
O'er a' the ills o' life victorious!

But pleasures are like poppies spread,  
You seize the flower, its bloom is shed!  
Or like the snowfall in the river,  
A moment white—then melts for ever;

Or like the borealis race,  
That flit ere you can point their place  
Or like the rainbow's lovely form,  
Evanishing amid the storm.  
Nae man can tether time or tide;  
The hour approaches Tam maun ride;  
That hour, o' night's black arch the keystone,  
That dreary hour he mounts his beast in;  
And sic a night he takes the road in  
As ne'er poor sinner was abroad in.

The wind blew as 'twad blawn its last;  
The rattling showers rose on the blast;  
The speedy gleams the darkness swallow'd;  
Loud, deep, and lang, the thunder bellow'd:  
That night, a child might understand  
The deil had business on his hand.

Weel mounted on his grey mare Meg,  
A better never lifted leg,  
Tam skelpit on through dub and mire,  
Despising wind, and rain, and fire;  
Whiles holding fast his guid blue bonnet,  
Whiles crooning o'er some auld Scots sonnet;  
Whiles glowering round wi' prudent cares,  
Lest bogles catch him unawares:  
Kirk-Alloway was drawing nigh,  
Where ghaists and houlets nightly cry.  
By this time he was 'cross the foord,  
Where in the snaw the chapman smoor'd;  
And past the birks and meikle stane  
Where drunken Charlie brak's neck-bane:  
And through the whins, and by the cairn  
Where hunters fand the murder'd bairn;  
And near the thorn, aboon the well,  
Where Mungo's mither hang'd hersel'.  
Before him Doon pours a' his floods;

The doubling storm roars through the woods;  
The lightnings flash frae pole to pole;  
Near and more near the thunders roll;  
When, glimmering through the groaning trees,  
Kirk-Alloway seem'd in a bleeze;  
Through ilka bore the beams were glancing,  
And loud resounded mirth and dancing.

Inspiring bold John Barleycorn!  
What dangers thou canst mak us scorn!  
Wi' tippenny, we fear nae evil;  
Wi' usquebae, we'll face the devil!—  
The swats sae ream'd in Tammie's noddle,  
Fair play, he cared na deils a boddle.  
But Maggie stood right sair astonish'd,  
Till, by the heel and hand admonish'd,  
She ventured forward on the light;  
And, wow! Tam saw an unco sight!  
Warlocks and witches in a dance;  
Nae cotillon brent-new frae France,  
But hornpipes, jigs, strathspeys, and reels,  
Put life and mettle i' their heels:  
At winnock-bunker, i' the east,  
There sat auld Nick, in shape o' beast;  
A towzie tyke, black, grim, and large,  
To gie them music was his charge;  
He screw'd the pipes, and gart them skirl,  
Till roof and rafters a' did dirl.  
Coffins stood round, like open presses,  
That shaw'd the dead in their last dresses;  
And by some devilish cantrip slight  
Each in its cauld hand held a light,—  
By which heroic Tam was able  
To note upon the haly table,  
A murderer's banes in gibbet airns;  
Twa span-lang, wee, unchristian bairns;  
A thief, new-cutted frae a rape,

Wi' his last gasp his gab did gape;  
Five tomahawks, wi' bluid red-rusted;  
Five scimitars, wi' murder crusted;  
A garter, which a babe had strangled;  
A knife, a father's throat had mangled,  
Whom his ain son o' life bereft,  
The grey hairs yet stack to the heft:  
Wi' mair o' horrible and awfu',  
Which even to name wad be unlawfu'.

As Tammie glower'd, amazed and curious  
The mirth and fun grew fast and furious  
The piper loud and louder blew,  
The dancers quick and quicker flew;  
They reel'd, they set, they cross'd, they cleekit,  
Till ilka carlin swat and reekit,  
And coost her duddies to the wark,  
And linket at it in her sark.  
Now Tam! O Tam! had thae been queans,  
A' plump and strappin' in their teens,  
Their sarks, instead o' creeshie flannen,  
Been snaw-white seventeen-hunder linen!  
Thir breeks o' mine, my only pair,  
That ance were plush, o' guid blue hair,  
I wad hae gien them aff my hurdies,  
For ae blink o' the bonny burdies!

But wither'd beldams, auld and droll,  
Rigwoodie hags, wad spean a foal,  
Lowpin' and flingin' on a cummock,  
I wonder didna turn thy stomach.

But Tam kenn'd what was what fu' brawlie,  
"There was ae winsome wench and walie,"  
That night enlisted in the core  
(Lang after kenn'd on Carrick shore;  
For mony a beast to dead she shot,

And perish'd money a bonny boat,  
And shook baith meikle corn and bear,  
And kept the country-side in fear).  
Her cutty sark, o' Paisley harn,  
That, while a lassie, she had worn,  
In longitude though sorely scanty,  
It was her best, and she was vauntie.

Ah! little kenn'd thy reverend grannie,  
That sark she coft for her wee Nannie,  
Wi' twa pund Scots ('twas a' her riches),  
Wad ever graced a dance o' witches!  
But here my Muse her wing maun core,  
Sic flights are far beyond her power;  
To sing how Nannie lap and flang  
(A souple jade she was, and strang),  
And how Tam stood, like ane bewitch'd,  
And thought, his very een enriched.  
Even Satan glower'd, and fidget fu' fain,  
And hotch'd and blew wi' might and main;  
Till first ae caper, syne anither,  
Tam tint his reason a' thegither,  
And roars out, "Weel done, Cutty-sark!"  
And in an instant a' was dark:  
And scarcely had he Maggie rallied,  
When out the hellish legion sallied.  
As bees bizz out wi' angry fyke,  
When plundering herds assail their byke,  
As open pussie's mortal foes,  
When, pop! she starts before their nose;  
As eager runs the market-crowd,  
When "Catch the thief!" resounds aloud;  
So Maggie runs, the witches follow,  
Wi' mony an eldritch screech and hollow.

Ah, Tam! ah, Tam! thou'lt get thy fairin'!  
In hell they'll roast thee like a herrin'!



In vain thy Kate awaits thy comin'!  
Kate soon will be a woefu' woman!  
Now, do thy speedy utmost, Meg,  
And win the keystone of the brig;  
There at them thou thy tail may toss,  
A running stream they darena cross;  
But ere the keystone she could make,  
The fient a tail she had to shake!  
For Nannie, far before the rest,  
Hard upon noble Maggie prest,  
And flew at Tam wi' furious ettle;  
But little wist she Maggie's mettle—  
Ae spring brought off her master hale,  
But left behind her ain grey tail:  
The carlin caught her by the rump,  
And left poor Maggie scarce a stump.  
Now, wha this tale o' truth shall read,  
Ilk man and mother's son, take heed:  
Whane'er to drink you are inclined,  
Or cutty-sarks run in your mind,  
Think! ye may buy the joys ower dear—  
Remember Tam o' Shanter's mare.

*Robert Burns.*

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## **THAT GENTLE MAN FROM BOSTON TOWN**

### **AN IDYL OF OREGON**

Two webfoot brothers loved a fair  
Young lady, rich and good to see;  
And oh, her black abundant hair!  
And oh, her wondrous witchery!

Her father kept a cattle farm,  
These brothers kept her safe from harm:

From harm of cattle on the hill;  
    From thick-necked bulls loud bellowing  
The livelong morning, loud and shrill,  
    And lashing sides like anything;  
From roaring bulls that tossed the sand  
And pawed the lilies from the land.

There came a third young man. He came  
    From far and famous Boston town.  
He was not handsome, was not "game,"  
    But he could "cook a goose" as brown  
As any man that set foot on  
The sunlit shores of Oregon.

This Boston man he taught the school,  
    Taught gentleness and love alway,  
Said love and kindness, as a rule,  
    Would ultimately "make it pay."  
He was so gentle, kind, that he  
Could make a noun and verb agree.

So when one day the brothers grew  
    All jealous and did strip to fight,  
He gently stood between the two,  
    And meekly told them 'twas not right.  
"I have a higher, better plan,"  
Outspoke this gentle Boston man.

"My plan is this: Forget this fray  
    About that lily hand of hers;  
Go take your guns and hunt all day  
    High up yon lofty hill of firs,  
And while you hunt, my loving doves,  
Why, I will learn which one she loves."

The brothers sat the windy hill,  
    Their hair shone yellow, like spun gold,  
Their rifles crossed their laps, but still  
    They sat and sighed and shook with cold.  
Their hearts lay bleeding far below;  
Above them gleamed white peaks of snow.

Their hounds lay couching, slim and neat;  
    A spotted circle in the grass.  
The valley lay beneath their feet;  
    They heard the wide-winged eagles pass.  
The eagles cleft the clouds above;  
Yet what could they but sigh and love?

"If I could die," the elder sighed,  
    "My dear young brother here might wed."  
"Oh, would to Heaven I had died!"  
    The younger sighed, with bended head.  
Then each looked each full in the face  
And each sprang up and stood in place.

"If I could die,"—the elder spake,—  
    "Die by your hand, the world would say  
'Twas accident;—and for her sake,  
    Dear brother, be it so, I pray."  
"Not that!" the younger nobly said;  
Then tossed his gun and turned his head.

And fifty paces back he paced!  
    And as he paced he drew the ball;  
Then sudden stopped and wheeled and faced  
    His brother to the death and fall!  
Two shots rang wild upon the air!  
But lo! the two stood harmless there!

An eagle poised high in the air;

Far, far below the bellowing  
Of bullocks ceased, and everywhere  
Vast silence sat all questioning.  
The spotted hounds ran circling round  
Their red, wet noses to the ground.

And now each brother came to know  
That each had drawn the deadly ball;  
And for that fair girl far below  
Had sought in vain to silent fall.  
And then the two did gladly "shake,"  
And thus the elder bravely spake:

"Now let us run right hastily  
And tell the kind schoolmaster all!  
Yea! yea! and if she choose not me,  
But all on you her favors fall,  
This valiant scene, till all life ends,  
Dear brother, binds us best of friends."

The hounds sped down, a spotted line,  
The bulls in tall, abundant grass,  
Shook back their horns from bloom and vine,  
And trumpeted to see them pass—  
They loved so good, they loved so true,  
These brothers scarce knew what to do.

They sought the kind schoolmaster out  
As swift as sweeps the light of morn;  
They could but love, they could not doubt  
This man so gentle, "in a horn,"  
They cried, "Now whose the lily hand—  
That lady's of this webfoot land?"

They bowed before that big-nosed man,  
That long-nosed man from Boston town;  
They talked as only lovers can,

They talked, but he could only frown;  
And still they talked, and still they plead;  
It was as pleading with the dead.

At last this Boston man did speak—  
"Her father has a thousand ceows,  
An hundred bulls, all fat and sleek;  
He also had this ample heouse."  
The brothers' eyes stuck out thereat,  
So far you might have hung your hat.

"I liked the looks of this big heouse—  
My lovely boys, won't you come in?  
Her father has a thousand ceows,  
He also had a heap of tin.  
The guirl? Oh yes, the guirl, you see—  
The guirl, just neow she married me."

*Joaquin Miller.*

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## **THE YARN OF THE "NANCY BELL"**

'Twas on the shores that round our coast  
From Deal to Ramsgate span,  
That I found alone on a piece of stone  
An elderly naval man.

His hair was weedy, his beard was long,  
And weedy and long was he,  
And I heard this wight on the shore recite,  
In a singular minor key:

"Oh, I am a cook and the captain bold,

And the mate of the *Nancy* brig,  
And a bo'sun tight, and a midshipmite,  
And the crew of the captain's gig."

And he shook his fists and he tore his hair,  
Till I really felt afraid,  
For I couldn't help thinking the man had been drinking,  
And so I simply said:

"Oh, elderly man, it's little I know  
Of the duties of men of the sea,  
And I'll eat my hand if I understand  
How you can possibly be

"At once a cook, and a captain bold,  
And the mate of the *Nancy* brig,  
And a bo'sun tight, and a midshipmite,  
And the crew of the captain's gig."

Then he gave a hitch to his trousers, which  
Is a trick all seamen larn,  
And having got rid of a thumping quid,  
He spun this painful yarn:

"'Twas in the good ship *Nancy Bell*  
That we sailed to the Indian Sea,  
And there on a reef we come to grief,  
Which has often occurred to me.

"And pretty nigh all the crew was drowned  
(There was seventy-seven o' soul),  
And only ten of the *Nancy's* men  
Said 'here' to the muster-roll.

"There was me and the cook and the captain bold,  
And the mate of the *Nancy* brig,  
And the bo'sun tight, and a midshipmite,

And the crew of the captain's gig.

"For a month we'd neither wittles nor drink,  
Till a-hungry we did feel,  
So we drewed a lot, and accordin' shot  
The captain for our meal.

"The next lot fell to the *Nancy's* mate,  
And a delicate dish he made;  
Then our appetite with the midshipmite  
We seven survivors stayed.

"And then we murdered the bos'un tight,  
And he much resembled pig;  
Then we wittled free, did the cook and me,  
On the crew of the captain's gig.

"Then only the cook and me was left,  
And the delicate question, 'Which  
Of us two goes to the kettle?' arose,  
And we argued it out as sich.

"For I loved that cook as a brother, I did,  
And the cook he worshipped me;  
But we'd both be blowed if we'd either be stowed  
In the other chap's hold, you see.

"'I'll be eat if you dines off me,' says Tom.  
'Yes, that,' says I, 'you'll be,—  
I'm boiled if I die, my friend,' quoth I.  
And 'Exactly so,' quoth he.

"Says he, 'Dear James, to murder me  
Were a foolish thing to do,  
For don't you see that you can't cook *me*,  
While I can—and will—cook *you*!'

"So he boils the water, and takes the salt  
And the pepper in portions true  
(Which he never forgot), and some chopped shalot,  
And some sage and parsley too.

"'Come here,' says he, with a proper pride,  
Which his smiling features tell,  
"Twill soothing be if I let you see  
How extremely nice you'll smell.'

"And he stirred it round and round and round,  
And he sniffed at the foaming froth;  
When I ups with his heels, and smothers his squeals  
In the scum of the boiling broth.

"And I eat that cook in a week or less,  
And—as I eating be  
The last of his chops, why, I almost drops,  
For a vessel in sight I see.

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"And I never larf, and I never smile,  
And I never lark or play,  
But sit and croak, and a single joke  
I have,—which is to say:

"Oh, I am a cook and a captain bold,  
And the mate of the *Nancy* brig,  
And a bos'un tight, and a midshipmite,  
And the crew of the captain's gig."

*W. S. Gilbert.*

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**FERDINANDO AND ELVIRA**



## OR, THE GENTLE PIEMAN

### PART I

At a pleasant evening party I had taken down to supper  
One whom I will call Elvira, and we talked of love and Tupper.

Mr. Tupper and the Poets, very lightly with them dealing,  
For I've always been distinguished for a strong poetic feeling.

Then we let off paper crackers, each of which contained a motto,  
And she listened while I read them, till her mother told her not to.

Then she whispered, "To the ballroom we had better, dear, be walking;  
If we stop down here much longer, really people will be talking."

There were noblemen in coronets, and military cousins,  
There were captains by the hundred, there were baronets by dozens.

Yet she heeded not their offers, but dismissed them with a blessing;  
Then she let down all her back hair, which had taken long in dressing.

Then she had convulsive sobbings in her agitated throttle,  
Then she wiped her pretty eyes and smelt her pretty smelling bottle.

So I whispered, "Dear Elvira, say,—what can the matter be with you?  
Does anything you've eaten, darling Popsy, disagree with you?"

But spite of all I said, her sobs grew more and more distressing,  
And she tore her pretty back hair, which had taken long in dressing.

Then she gazed upon the carpet, at the ceiling, then above me,  
And she whispered, "Ferdinando, do you really, *really* love me?"

"Love you?" said I, then I sighed, and then I gazed upon her sweetly—  
For I think I do this sort of thing particularly neatly.

"Send me to the Arctic regions, or illimitable azure,  
On a scientific goose-chase, with my Coxwell or my Glaisher!

"Tell me whither I may hie me—tell me, dear one, that I may know—  
Is it up the highest Andes? down a horrible volcano?"

But she said, "It isn't polar bears, or hot volcanic grottoes;  
Only find out who it is that writes those lovely cracker mottoes!"

## PART II

"Tell me, Henry Wadsworth, Alfred, Poet Close, or Mister Tupper,  
Do you write the bon-ton mottoes my Elvira pulls at supper?"

But Henry Wadsworth smiled, and said he had not had that honor;  
And Alfred, too, disclaimed the words that told so much upon her.

"Mister Martin Tupper, Poet Close, I beg of you inform us;"  
But my question seemed to throw them both into a rage enormous.

Mister Close expressed a wish that he could only get anigh to me;  
And Mister Martin Tupper sent the following reply to me:

"A fool is bent upon a twig, but wise men dread a bandit,"—  
Which I know was very clever; but I didn't understand it.

Seven weary years I wandered—Patagonia, China, Norway,  
Till at last I sank exhausted at a pastrycook his doorway.

There were fuchsias and geraniums, and daffodils and myrtle;  
So I entered, and I ordered half a basin of mock turtle.

He was plump and he was chubby, he was smooth and he was rosy,  
And his little wife was pretty and particularly cosy.

And he chirped and sang, and skipped about, and laughed with laughter  
                  hearty—  
He was wonderfully active for so very stout a party.

And I said, "O gentle pieman, why so very, very merry?  
Is it purity of conscience, or your one-and-seven sherry?"

But he answered, "I'm so happy—no profession could be dearer—

If I am not humming 'Tra la la' I'm singing 'Tirer, lirer!'

"First I go and make the patties, and the puddings, and the jellies,  
Then I make a sugar bird-cage, which upon a table swell is:

"Then I polish all the silver, which a supper-table lacquers:  
Then I write the pretty mottoes which you find inside the crackers—"

"Found at last!" I madly shouted. "Gentle pieman, you astound me!"  
Then I waved the turtle soup enthusiastically round me.

And I shouted and I danced until he'd quite a crowd around him,  
And I rushed away, exclaiming, "I have found him! I have found him!"

And I heard the gentle pieman in the road behind me trilling,  
"'Tira! lira!' stop him, stop him! 'Tra! la! la!' the soup's a shilling!"

But until I reached Elvira's home, I never, never waited,  
And Elvira to her Ferdinand's irrevocably mated!

*W. S. Gilbert.*

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## **GENTLE ALICE BROWN**

It was a robber's daughter, and her name was Alice Brown.  
Her father was the terror of a small Italian town;  
Her mother was a foolish, weak, but amiable old thing;  
But it isn't of her parents that I'm going for to sing.

As Alice was a-sitting at her window-sill one day,  
A beautiful young gentleman he chanced to pass that way;  
She cast her eyes upon him, and he looked so good and true,  
That she thought, "I could be happy with a gentleman like you!"

And every morning passed her house that cream of gentlemen,  
She knew she might expect him at a quarter unto ten,  
A sorter in the Custom-house, it was his daily road  
(The Custom-house was fifteen minutes' walk from her abode.)

But Alice was a pious girl, who knew it wasn't wise  
To look at strange young sorters with expressive purpleeyes;  
So she sought the village priest to whom her family confessed,  
The priest by whom their little sins were carefully assessed.

"Oh, holy father," Alice said, "'twould grieve you, would it not?  
To discover that I was a most disreputable lot!  
Of all unhappy sinners I'm the most unhappy one!"  
The padre said, "Whatever have you been and gone and done?"

"I have helped mamma to steal a little kiddy from its dad,  
I've assisted dear papa in cutting up a little lad.  
I've planned a little burglary and forged a little cheque,  
And slain a little baby for the coral on its neck!"

The worthy pastor heaved a sigh, and dropped a silent tear—  
And said, "You mustn't judge yourself too heavily, my dear—  
It's wrong to murder babies, little corals for to fleece;  
But sins like these one expiates at half-a-crown apiece.

"Girls will be girls—you're very young, and flighty in your mind;  
Old heads upon young shoulders we must not expect to find:  
We mustn't be too hard upon these little girlish tricks—  
Let's see—five crimes at half-a-crown—exactly twelve-and-six."

"Oh, father," little Alice cried, "your kindness makes me weep,  
You do these little things for me so singularly cheap—  
Your thoughtful liberality I never can forget;  
But oh, there is another crime I haven't mentioned yet!

"A pleasant-looking gentleman, with pretty purple eyes,  
I've noticed at my window, as I've sat a-catching flies;

He passes by it every day as certain as can be—  
I blush to say I've winked at him and he has winked at me!"

"For shame," said Father Paul, "my erring daughter! On my word  
This is the most distressing news that I have ever heard.  
Why, naughty girl, your excellent papa has pledged your hand  
To a promising young robber, the lieutenant of his band!

"This dreadful piece of news will pain your worthy parents so!  
They are the most remunerative customers I know;  
For many many years they've kept starvation from my doors,  
I never knew so criminal a family as yours!

"The common country folk in this insipid neighborhood  
Have nothing to confess, they're so ridiculously good;  
And if you marry any one respectable at all,  
Why, you'll reform, and what will then become of Father Paul?"

The worthy priest, he up and drew his cowl upon his crown,  
And started off in haste to tell the news to Robber Brown;  
To tell him how his daughter, who was now for marriage fit,  
Had winked upon a sorter, who reciprocated it.

Good Robber Brown, he muffled up his anger pretty well,  
He said, "I have a notion, and that notion I will tell;  
I will nab this gay young sorter, terrify him into fits,  
And get my gentle wife to chop him into little bits.

"I've studied human nature, and I know a thing or two,  
Though a girl may fondly love a living gent, as many do—  
A feeling of disgust upon her senses there will fall  
When she looks upon his body chopped particularly small."

He traced that gallant sorter to a still suburban square;  
He watched his opportunity and seized him unaware;  
He took a life-preserver and he hit him on the head,  
And Mrs. Brown dissected him before she went to bed.

And pretty little Alice grew more settled in her mind,  
She nevermore was guilty of a weakness of the kind,  
Until at length good Robber Brown bestowed her pretty hand  
On the promising young robber, the lieutenant of his band.

*W. S. Gilbert.*

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## **THE STORY OF PRINCE AGIB**

Strike the concertina's melancholy string!  
Blow the spirit-stirring harp like anything!  
Let the piano's martial blast  
Rouse the Echoes of the Past,  
For of Agib, Prince of Tartary, I sing!

Of Agib, who, amid Tartaric scenes,  
Wrote a lot of ballet music in his teens:  
His gentle spirit rolls  
In the melody of souls—  
Which is pretty, but I don't know what it means.

Of Agib, who could readily, at sight,  
Strum a march upon the loud Theodolite.  
He would diligently play  
On the Zoetrope all day,  
And blow the gay Pantechnicon all night.

One winter—I am shaky in my dates—  
Came two starving Tartar minstrels to his gates;  
Oh, Allah be obeyed,  
How infernally they played!  
I remember that they called themselves the "Oüaits."

Oh! that day of sorrow, misery, and rage  
I shall carry to the Catacombs of Age,  
    Photographically lined  
    On the tablet of my mind,  
When a yesterday has faded from its page!

Alas! Prince Agib went and asked them in;  
Gave them beer, and eggs, and sweets, and scent, and tin.  
    And when (as snobs would say)  
    They had "put it all away,"  
He requested them to tune up and begin.

Though its icy horror chill you to the core,  
I will tell you what I never told before,—  
    The consequences true  
    Of that awful interview,  
*For I listened at the keyhole in the door!*

They played him a sonata—let me see!  
"Medulla oblongata"—key of G.  
    Then they began to sing  
    That extremely lovely thing,  
"Scherzando! ma non troppo, ppp."

He gave them money, more than they could count,  
Scent from a most ingenious little fount,  
    More beer, in little kegs,  
    Many dozen hard-boiled eggs,  
And goodies to a fabulous amount.

Now follows the dim horror of my tale  
And I feel I'm growing gradually pale,  
    For, even at this day,  
    Though its sting has passed away,  
When I venture to remember it, I quail!

The elder of the brothers gave a squeal,  
All-overish it made me for to feel;  
    "Oh, Prince," he says, says he,  
    *"If a Prince indeed you be,*  
I've a mystery I'm going to reveal!

"Oh, listen, if you'd shun a horrid death,  
To what the gent who's speaking to you saith:  
    No 'Oüaits' in truth are we,  
    As you fancy that we be;  
For (ter-remble!) I am Aleck—this is Beth!"

Said Agib, "Oh! accursed of your kind,  
I have heard that ye are men of evil mind!"  
    Beth gave a fearful shriek—  
    But before he'd time to speak  
I was mercilessly collared from behind.

In number ten or twelve, or even more,  
They fastened me full length upon the floor.  
    On my face extended flat,  
    I was walloped with a cat  
For listening at the keyhole of a door.

Oh! the horror of that agonizing thrill!  
(I can feel the place in frosty weather still).  
    For a week from ten to four  
    I was fastened to the floor,  
While a mercenary wopped me with a will.

They branded me and broke me on a wheel,  
And they left me in an hospital to heal;  
    And, upon my solemn word,  
    I have never never heard  
What those Tartars had determined to reveal.

But that day of sorrow, misery, and rage,



I shall carry to the Catacombs of Age,  
Photographically lined  
On the tablet of my mind,  
When a yesterday has faded from its page.

*W. S. Gilbert.*

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## **SIR GUY THE CRUSADER**

Sir Guy was a doughty crusader,  
A muscular knight,  
Ever ready to fight,  
A very determined invader,  
And Dickey de Lion's delight.

Lenore was a Saracen maiden,  
Brunette, statuesque,  
The reverse of grotesque;  
Her pa was a bagman from Aden,  
Her mother she played in burlesque.

A *coryphée*, pretty and loyal,  
In amber and red,  
The ballet she led;  
Her mother performed at the Royal,  
Lenore at the Saracen's Head.

Of face and of figure majestic,  
She dazzled the cits—  
Ecstaticised pits;—  
Her troubles were only domestic,  
But drove her half out of her wits.

Her father incessantly lashed her,  
On water and bread  
She was grudgingly fed;  
Whenever her father he thrashed her,  
Her mother sat down on her head.

Guy saw her, and loved her, with reason,  
For beauty so bright  
Sent him mad with delight;  
He purchased a stall for the season  
And sat in it every night.

His views were exceedingly proper,  
He wanted to wed,  
So he called at her shed  
And saw her progenitor whop her—  
Her mother sit down on her head.

"So pretty," said he, "and so trusting!  
You brute of a dad,  
You unprincipled cad,  
Your conduct is really disgusting,  
Come, come, now admit it's too bad!

"You're a turbaned old Turk, and malignant—  
Your daughter Lenore  
I intensely adore,  
And I cannot help feeling indignant,  
A fact that I hinted before;

To see a fond father employing  
A deuce of a knout  
For to bang her about,  
To a sensitive lover's annoying."  
Said the bagman, "Crusader, get out."

Says Guy, "Shall a warrior laden

With a big spiky knob  
Sit in peace on his cob,  
While a beautiful Saracen maiden  
Is whipped by a Saracen snob?

"To London I'll go from my charmer."  
Which he did, with his loot  
(Seven hats and a flute),  
And was nabbed for his Sydenham armour  
At Mr. Ben-Samuel's suit.

Sir Guy he was lodged in the Compter;  
Her pa, in a rage,  
Died (don't know his age);  
His daughter she married the prompter,  
Grew bulky and quitted the stage.

*W. S. Gilbert.*

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## KITTY WANTS TO WRITE

Kitty wants to write! Kitty intellectual!  
What has been effectual to turn her stockings blue?  
Kitty's seventh season has brought sufficient reason,  
She has done 'most everything that there is left to do!  
Half of them to laugh about and half of them to rue,—  
Now we wait in terror for Kitty's wildest error.  
What has she to write about? Wheeeeeeeew!

Kitty wants to write! Débutante was Kitty,  
Frivolous and witty as ever bud that blew.  
Kitty lacked sobriety, yet she ran society,  
A leader whom the chaperons indulged a year or two;

Corner-men, eligibles, dancing-dolls she knew,—  
Kitty then was slighted, ne'er again invited;  
What has she to write about? Wheeeeeeeeeew!

Kitty wants to write! At the Social Settlement  
Girls of Kitty's mettle meant a mission for a few;  
Men to teach the classes, men to mould the masses,  
Men to follow Kitty to adventures strange and new.  
Some of her benevolence was hidden out of view!—  
A patroness offended, Kitty's slumming ended.  
What is there to write about? Wheeeeeeeeeew!

Kitty wants to write! Kitty was a mystic,  
Deep from cabalistic lore many hints she drew!  
Freaks of all description, Hindoo and Egyptian,  
Prattled in her parlor—such a wild and hairy crew!  
Many came for money, and one or two to woo—  
Kitty's pet astrologer wanted to acknowledge her!  
What has she to write about? Wheeeeeeeeeew!

Kitty wants to write! Kitty was a doctor;  
Nothing ever shocked her, though they hazed a little, too!  
Kitty learned of medicos how a heart unsteady goes,  
Besides a score of secrets that are secrets still to you.  
Kitty's course in medicine gave her many a clue—  
Much of modern history now is less a mystery.  
What has she to write about? Wheeeeeeeeeew!

Kitty wants to write! Everybody's writing!  
Won't it be exciting, the panic to ensue?  
We who all have known her, think what we have shown her!  
Read it in the magazines! Which half of *this* is true?  
Where did she get *that* idea? Is it him, or who?—  
Kitty's wretched enemies now will learn what venom is!  
What has she to write about? Wheeeeeeeeeew!

*Gelett Burgess.*

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## DIGHTON IS ENGAGED!

Dighton is engaged! Think of it and tremble!  
Two-and-twenty ladies who have known him must dissemble;  
Two-and-twenty ladies in a panic must repeat,  
"Dighton is a gentleman; will Dighton be discreet?"  
All the merry maidens who have known him at his best  
Wonder what the girl is like, and if he has confessed.  
Dighton the philanderer, will he prove a slanderer?  
A man gets confidential ere the honeymoon has sped—  
Dighton was a rover then, Dighton lived in clover then;  
Dighton is a gentleman—but Dighton is to wed!

Dighton is engaged! Think of it, Corinna!  
Watch and see his fiancée smile on you at dinner!  
Watch and hear his fiancée whisper, "*That's the one?*"  
Try and raise a blush for what you said was "only fun."  
Long have you been wedded; have you then forgot?  
If you have, I'll venture that a certain man has not!  
Dighton had a way with him; did you ever play with him?  
Now that dream is over and the episode is dead.  
Dighton never harried you after Charlie married you;  
Dighton is a gentleman—but Dighton is to wed!

Dighton is engaged! Think of it, Bettina!  
Did you ever love him when the sport was rather keener?  
Did you ever kiss him as you sat upon the stairs?  
Did you ever tell him of your former love affairs?  
Think of it uneasily and wonder if his wife  
Soon will know the amatory secrets of your life!  
Dighton was impressible, you were quite accessible—  
The bachelor who marries late is apt to lose his head.  
Dighton wouldn't hurt you; does it disconcert you?  
Dighton is a gentleman—but Dighton is to wed!

Dighton is engaged! Tremble, Mrs. Alice!  
When he comes no longer will you bear the lady malice?  
Now he comes to dinner, and he smokes cigars with Clint,  
But he never makes a blunder and he never drops a hint;  
He's a universal uncle, with a welcome everywhere,  
He adopts his sweetheart's children and he lets 'em pull his hair.  
Dighton has a memory bright and sharp as emery,  
He *could* tell them fairy stories that would make you rather red!  
Dighton can be trusted, though; Dighton's readjusted, though!  
Dighton is a gentleman—but Dighton is to wed!

*Gelett Burgess.*

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## PLAIN LANGUAGE FROM TRUTHFUL JAMES

### TABLE MOUNTAIN, 1870

Which I wish to remark—  
And my language is plain—  
That for ways that are dark,  
And for tricks that are vain,  
The heathen Chineese is peculiar,  
Which the same I would rise to explain.

Ah Sin was his name;  
And I will not deny  
In regard to the same  
What that name might imply;  
But his smile it was pensive and childlike,  
As I frequent remarked to Bill Nye.

It was August the third;

And quite soft was the skies:  
Which it might be inferred  
That Ah Sin was likewise;  
Yet he played it that day upon William  
And me in a way I despise.

Which we had a small game,  
And Ah Sin took a hand.  
It was Euchre. The same  
He did not understand;  
But he smiled as he sat by the table,  
With a smile that was childlike and bland.

Yet the cards they were stocked  
In a way that I grieve,  
And my feelings were shocked  
At the state of Nye's sleeve:  
Which was stuffed full of aces and bowers,  
And the same with intent to deceive.

But the hands that were played  
By that heathen Chineese,  
And the points that he made,  
Were quite frightful to see—  
Till at last he put down a right bower,  
Which the same Nye had dealt unto me.

Then I looked up at Nye,  
And he gazed upon me;  
And he rose with a sigh,  
And said, "Can this be?  
We are ruined by Chinese cheap labour—"  
And he went for that heathen Chineese.

In the scene that ensued  
I did not take a hand;  
But the floor it was strewed

Like the leaves on the strand  
With the cards that Ah Sin had been hiding,  
In the game "he did not understand."

In his sleeves, which were long,  
He had twenty-four packs—  
Which was coming it strong,  
Yet I state but the facts;  
And we found on his nails, which were taper,  
What is frequent in tapers—that's wax.

Which is why I remark,  
And my language is plain,  
That for ways that are dark,  
And for tricks that are vain,  
The heathen Chineese is peculiar—  
Which the same I am free to maintain.

*Bret Harte.*

---

## THE SOCIETY UPON THE STANISLAUS

I reside at Table Mountain, and my name is Truthful James;  
I am not up to small deceit, or any sinful games;  
And I'll tell in simple language what I know about the row  
That broke up our society upon the Stanislaw.

But first I would remark, that it is not a proper plan  
For any scientific man to whale his fellow-man,  
And, if a member don't agree with his peculiar whim,  
To lay for that same member for to "put a head" on him.

Now, nothing could be finer or more beautiful to see



Than the first six months' proceedings of that same society,  
Till Brown of Calaveras brought a lot of fossil bones  
That he found within a tunnel near the tenement of Jones.

Then Brown he read a paper, and he reconstructed there,  
From those same bones, an animal that was extremely rare;  
And Jones then asked the Chair for a suspension of the rules,  
Till he could prove that those same bones was one of his lost mules.

Then Brown he smiled a bitter smile and said he was at fault,  
It seemed he had been trespassing on Jones's family vault;  
He was a most sarcastic man, this quiet Mr. Brown,  
And on several occasions he had cleaned out the town.

Now, I hold it is not decent for a scientific gent  
To say another is an ass—at least, to all intent;  
Nor should the individual who happens to be meant  
Reply by heaving rocks at him to any great extent.

Then Abner Dean of Angel's raised a point of order, when  
A chunk of old red sandstone took him in the abdomen,  
And he smiled a kind of sickly smile, and curled up on the floor,  
And the subsequent proceedings interested him no more.

For, in less time than I write it, every member did engage  
In a warfare with the remnants of a palæozoic age;  
And the way they heaved those fossils in their anger was a sin,  
Till the skull of an old mammoth caved the head of Thompson in.

And this is all I have to say of these improper games  
For I live at Table Mountain, and my name is Truthful James;  
And I've told, in simple language, what I know about the row  
That broke up our society upon the Stanislow.

*Bret Harte.*

---

## "JIM"

Say there! P'r'aps  
Some on you chaps  
    Might know Jim Wild!  
Well,—no offence:  
Thar ain't no sense  
    In gittin' riled!

Jim was my chum  
    Up on the Bar:  
That's why I come  
    Down from up yar,  
Lookin' for Jim.  
Thank ye, sir! *you*  
Ain't of that crew,—  
    Blest if you are!

Money?—Not much;  
    That ain't my kind:  
I ain't no such.  
    Rum?—I don't mind,  
Seein' it's you.

Well, this yer Jim,  
Did you know him?—  
Jess 'bout your size;  
Same kind of eyes;—

Well, that is strange:  
    Why, it's two year  
    Since he came here,  
Sick, for a change.  
Well, here's to us:  
    Eh?  
The h——, you say!

Dead?  
That little cuss?

What makes you star,—  
You over thar?  
Can't a man drop  
's glass 'n yer shop  
But you must rar'?  
    It wouldn't take  
    D—— much to break  
You and your bar.

Dead!  
Poor—little—Jim!  
—Why, thar was me,  
Jones, and Bob Lee,  
Harry and Ben,—  
No—account men:  
Then to take *him*!

Well, thar—Good-bye—  
No more, sir,—I—  
    Eh?  
What's that you say?—  
Why, dern it!—sho!—  
No? Yes! By Jo!

Sold!  
Sold! Why, you limb!  
You ornery,  
    Derned old  
Long-legged Jim!

*Bret Harte.*

---

## WILLIAM BROWN OF OREGON

They called him Bill, the hired man,  
But she, her name was Mary Jane,  
The Squire's daughter; and to reign  
The belle from Ber-she-be to Dan  
Her little game. How lovers rash  
Got mittens at the spelling school!  
How many a mute, inglorious fool  
Wrote rhymes and sighed and died—mustache!

This hired man had loved her long,  
Had loved her best and first and last,  
Her very garments as she passed  
For him had symphony and song.  
So when one day with sudden frown  
She called him "Bill," he raised his head,  
He caught her eye and, faltering, said,  
"I love you; and my name is Brown."

She fairly waltzed with rage; she wept;  
You would have thought the house on fire.  
She told her sire, the portly squire,  
Then smelt her smelling-salts, and slept.  
Poor William did what could be done;  
He swung a pistol on each hip,  
He gathered up a great ox-whip,  
And drove toward the setting sun.

He crossed the great back-bone of earth,  
He saw the snowy mountains rolled  
Like mighty billows; saw the gold  
Of awful sunsets; felt the birth  
Of sudden dawn that burst the night  
Like resurrection; saw the face  
Of God and named it boundless space

Ringed round with room and shoreless light.

Her lovers passed. Wolves hunt in packs,  
They sought for bigger game; somehow  
They seemed to see above her brow  
The forky sign of turkey tracks.  
The teter-board of life goes up,  
The teter-board of life goes down,  
The sweetest face must learn to frown;  
The biggest dog has been a pup.

O maidens! pluck not at the air;  
The sweetest flowers I have found  
Grow rather close unto the ground,  
And highest places are most bare.  
Why, you had better win the grace  
Of our poor cussed Af-ri-can,  
Than win the eyes of every man  
In love alone with his own face.

At last she nursed her true desire.  
She sighed, she wept for William Brown,  
She watched the splendid sun go down  
Like some great sailing ship on fire,  
Then rose and checked her trunk right on;  
And in the cars she lunched and lunched,  
And had her ticket punched and punched,  
Until she came to Oregon.

She reached the limit of the lines,  
She wore blue specs upon her nose,  
Wore rather short and manly clothes,  
And so set out to reach the mines.  
Her pocket held a parasol  
Her right hand held a Testament,  
And thus equipped right on she went,  
Went water-proof and water-fall.

She saw a miner gazing down,  
    Slow stirring something with a spoon;  
    "O, tell me true and tell me soon,  
What has become of William Brown?"  
He looked askance beneath her specs,  
    Then stirred his cocktail round and round.  
    Then raised his head and sighed profound,  
And said, "He's handed in his checks."

Then care fed on her damaged cheek,  
    And she grew faint, did Mary Jane,  
    And smelt her smelling-salts in vain,  
She wandered, weary, worn, and weak.  
At last, upon a hill alone.  
    She came, and there she sat her down;  
    For on that hill there stood a stone,  
And, lo! that stone read, "William Brown."

"O William Brown! O William Brown!  
    And here you rest at last," she said,  
    "With this lone stone above your head,  
And forty miles from any town!  
I will plant cypress trees, I will,  
    And I will build a fence around,  
    And I will fertilise the ground  
With tears enough to turn a mill."

She went and got a hired man,  
    She brought him forty miles from town,  
    And in the tall grass squatted down  
And bade him build as she should plan.  
But cruel cow-boys with their bands  
    They saw, and hurriedly they ran  
    And told a bearded cattle man  
Somebody builded on his lands.

He took his rifle from the rack,  
He girt himself in battle pelt,  
He stuck two pistols in his belt,  
And, mounting on his horse's back,  
He plunged ahead. But when they showed  
A woman fair, about his eyes  
He pulled his hat, and he likewise  
Pulled at his beard, and chewed and chewed.

At last he gat him down and spake:  
"O lady dear, what do you here?"  
"I build a tomb unto my dear,  
I plant sweet flowers for his sake."  
The bearded man threw his two hands  
Above his head, then brought them down  
And cried, "Oh, I am William Brown,  
And this the corner-stone of my lands!"

*Joaquin Miller.*

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## **LITTLE BREECHES**

I don't go much on religion,  
I never ain't had no show;  
But I've got a middlin' tight grip, sir,  
On a handful o' things I know.  
I don't pan out on the prophets  
And free-will and that sort of thing—  
But I be'lieve in God and the angels,  
Ever sence one night last spring.

I come into town with some turnips,  
And my little Gabe come along—

No four-year-old in the county  
    Could beat him for pretty and strong—  
Peart and chipper and sassy,  
    Always ready to swear and fight—  
And I'd larnt him to chaw terbacker  
    Jest to keep his milk-teeth white.

The snow come down like a blanket  
    As I passed by Taggart's store;  
I went in for a jug of molasses  
    And left the team at the door.  
They scared at something and started—  
    I heard one little squall,  
And hell-to-split over the prairie!  
    Went team, Little Breeches, and all.

Hell-to-split over the prairie!  
    I was almost froze with skeer;  
But we roused up some torches,  
    And sarched for 'em far and near.  
At last we struck hosses and wagon,  
    Snowed under a soft white mound,  
Upsot, dead beat, but of little Gabe  
    No hide nor hair was found.

And hero all hope soured on me  
    Of my fellow-critter's aid;  
I jest flopped down on my marrow-bones,  
    Crotch-deep in the snow, and prayed.

---

By this, the torches was played out,  
    And me and Isrul Parr  
Went off for some wood to a sheepfold  
    That he said was somewhar thar.

We found it at last, and a little shed  
    Where they shut up the lambs at night;



We looked in and seen them huddled thar,  
So warm and sleepy and white;  
And thar sot Little Breeches and chirped,  
As peart as ever you see,  
"I want a chaw of terbacker,  
And that's what's the matter of me."

How did he git thar? Angels.  
He could never have walked in that storm:  
They jest scooped down and toted him  
To whar it was safe and warm.  
And I think that saving a little child,  
And fotching him to his own,  
Is a derned sight better business  
Than loafing around the Throne.

*John Hay.*

---

## **THE ENCHANTED SHIRT**

The King was sick. His cheek was red,  
And his eye was clear and bright;  
He ate and drank with a kingly zest,  
And peacefully snored at night.

But he said he was sick, and a king should know,  
And doctors came by the score.  
They did not cure him. He cut off their heads,  
And sent to the schools for more.

At last two famous doctors came,  
And one was as poor as a rat,—  
He had passed his life in studious toil,

And never found time to grow fat.

The other had never looked in a book;  
His patients gave him no trouble:  
If they recovered, they paid him well;  
If they died, their heirs paid double.

Together they looked at the royal tongue,  
As the King on his couch reclined;  
In succession they thumped his august chest,  
But no trace of disease could find.

The old sage said, "You're as sound as a nut."  
"Hang him up," roared the King in a gale—  
In a ten-knot gale of royal rage;  
The other leech grew a shade pale;

But he pensively rubbed his sagacious nose,  
And thus his prescription ran—  
*The King will be well, if he sleeps one night  
In the Shirt of a Happy Man.*

---

Wide o'er the realm the couriers rode,  
And fast their horses ran,  
And many they saw, and to many they spoke,  
But they found no Happy Man.

They found poor men who would fain be rich,  
And rich who thought they were poor;  
And men who twisted their waist in stays,  
And women that shorthose wore.

They saw two men by the roadside sit,  
And both bemoaned their lot;  
For one had buried his wife, he said,  
And the other one had not.

At last they came to a village gate,  
A beggar lay whistling there;  
He whistled, and sang, and laughed, and rolled,  
On the grass in the soft June air.

The weary couriers paused and looked  
At the scamp so blithe and gay;  
And one of them said, "Heaven save you, friend!  
You seem to be happy to-day."

"O yes, fair sirs," the rascal laughed,  
And his voice rang free and glad;  
"An idle man has so much to do  
That he never has time to be sad."

"This is our man," the courier said;  
"Our luck has lead us aright.  
I will give you a hundred ducats, friend,  
For the loan of your shirt to-night."

The merry blackguard lay back on the grass,  
And laughed till his face was black;  
"I would do it, God wot," and he roared with the fun,  
"But I haven't a shirt to my back."

---

Each day to the King the reports came in  
Of his unsuccessful spies,  
And the sad panorama of human woes  
Passed daily under his eyes.

And he grew ashamed of his useless life,  
And his maladies hatched in gloom;  
He opened his windows and let the air  
Of the free heaven into his room.

And out he went in the world, and toiled  
In his own appointed way;  
And the people blessed him, the land was glad,  
And the King was well and gay.

*John Hay.*

---

## **JIM BLUDSO**

Wal, no! I can't tell whar he lives,  
Because he don't live, you see;  
Leastways, he's got out of the habit  
Of livin' like you and me.  
Whar have you been for the last three years  
That you haven't heard folks tell  
How Jemmy Bludso passed-in his checks,  
The night of the Prairie Belle?

He weren't no saint—they engineers  
Is all pretty much alike—  
One wife in Natchez-under-the-Hill,  
And another one here in Pike.  
A keerless man in his talk was Jim,  
And an awkward man in a row—  
But he never flunked, and he never lied;  
I reckon he never knowed how.

And this was all the religion he had—  
To treat his engines well;  
Never be passed on the river;  
To mind the pilot's bell;  
And if ever the Prairie Belle took fire,  
A thousand times he swore,

He'd hold her nozzle agin the bank  
Till the last soul got ashore.

All boats have their day on the Mississip,  
And her day come at last.  
The Movastar was a better boat,  
But the Belle she wouldn't be passed;  
And so come tearin' along that night,—  
The oldest craft on the line,  
With a nigger squat on her safety valve,  
And her furnace crammed, rosin and pine.

The fire bust out as she clared the bar,  
And burnt a hole in the night,  
And quick as a flash she turned, and made  
To that willer-bank on the right.  
There was runnin' and cursin', but Jim yelled out  
Over all the infernal roar,  
'I'll hold her nozzle agin the bank  
Till the last galoot's ashore."

Through the hot black breath of the burnin' boat  
Jim Bludso's voice was heard,  
And they all had trust in his cussedness,  
And know he would keep his word.  
And, sure's you're born, they all got off  
Afore the smokestacks fell,—  
And Bludso's ghost went up alone  
In the smoke of the Prairie Belle.

He weren't no saint—but at jedgment  
I'd run my chance with Jim,  
'Longside of some pious gentlemen  
That wouldn't shook hands with him.  
He'd seen his duty, a dead-sure thing—  
And went for it thar and then:

And Christ ain't a going to be too hard  
On a man that died for men.

*John Hay.*

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## **WRECK OF THE "JULIE PLANTE"**

On wan dark night on Lac St. Pierre,  
De win' she blow, blow, blow,  
An' de crew of de wood scow "Julie Plante"  
Got scar't an' run below;  
For de win' she blow lak hurricane,  
Bimeby she blow some more,  
An' de scow bus' up on Lac St. Pierre,  
Wan arpent from de shore.

De Captinne walk on de fronte deck,  
An' walk de hin' deck, too—  
He call de crew from up de hole  
He call de cook also.  
De cook she's name was Rosie,  
She come from Montreal,  
Was chambre maid on lumber barge,  
On de Grande Lachine Canal.

De win' she blow from nor'—eas'—wes'  
De sout' win' she blow, too,  
W'en Rosie cry "Mon cher Captinne,  
Mon cher, w'at I shall do?"  
Den de Captinne t'row de big ankerre,  
But still de scow she dreef,  
De crew he can't pass on de shore,  
Becos' he los' hees skeef.

De night was dark, lak' one black cat,  
De wave run high an' fas',  
Wen de Captinne tak' de Rosie girl  
An' tie her to de mas'.  
Den he also tak' de life preserve,  
An' jomp off on de lak',  
An' say, "Good by, ma Rosie dear,  
I go drown for your sak'."

Nex' morning very early,  
'Bout ha'f-pas' two—t'ree—four—  
De Captinne, scow, an' de poor Rosie  
Was corpses on de shore;  
For he win' she blow lak' hurricane  
Bimeby she blow some more,  
An' de scow bus' up on Lac St. Pierre,  
Wan arpent from de shore.

#### MORAL

Now, all good wood scow sailor man  
Tak' warning by dat storm,  
An' go an' marry some nice French girl  
An' leev on wan beeg farm;

De win' can blow lak' hurricane,  
An' s'pose she blow some more,  
You can't get drown on Lac St. Pierre,  
So long you stay on shore.

*William Henry Drummond.*

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## THE ALARMED SKIPPER

## "IT WAS AN ANCIENT MARINER"

Many a long, long year ago,  
Nantucket skippers had a plan  
Of finding out, though "lying low,"  
How near New York their schooners ran.

They greased the lead before it fell,  
And then, by sounding through the night,  
Knowing the soil that stuck, so well,  
They always guessed their reckoning right.

A skipper gray, whose eyes were dim,  
Could tell, by *tasting*, just the spot,  
And so below he'd "dowse the glim"—  
After, of course, his "something hot."

Snug in his berth, at eight o'clock,  
This ancient skipper might be found;  
No matter how his craft would rock,  
He slept—for skippers' naps are sound!

The watch on deck would now and then  
Run down and wake him, with the lead;  
He'd up, and taste, and tell the men  
How many miles they went ahead.

One night, 'twas Jotham Marden's watch,  
A curious wag—the peddler's son—  
And so he mused (the wanton wretch),  
"To-night I'll have a grain of fun.

"We're all a set of stupid fools  
To think the skipper knows by *tasting*  
What ground he's on—Nantucket schools  
Don't teach such stuff, with all their basting!"



And so he took the well-greased lead  
And rubbed it o'er a box of earth  
That stood on deck—a parsnip-bed—  
And then he sought the skipper's berth.

"Where are we now, sir? Please to taste."  
The skipper yawned, put out his tongue,  
Then ope'd his eyes in wondrous haste,  
And then upon the floor he sprung!

The skipper stormed and tore his hair,  
Thrust on his boots, and roared to Marden,  
*"Nantucket's sunk, and here we are  
Right over old Marm Hackett's garden!"*

*James Thomas Fields.*

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## THE ELDERLY GENTLEMAN

By the side of a murmuring stream an elderly gentleman sat.  
On the top of his head was a wig, and a-top of his wig was his hat.

The wind it blew high and blew strong, as the elderly gentleman sat;  
And bore from his head in a trice, and plunged in the river his hat.

The gentleman then took his cane which lay by his side as he sat;  
And he dropped in the river his wig, in attempting to get out his hat.

His breast it grew cold with despair, and full in his eye madness sat;  
So he flung in the river his cane to swim with his wig, and his hat.

Cool reflection at last came across while this elderly gentleman sat;

So he thought he would follow the stream and look for his cane, wig, and hat.

His head being thicker than common, o'er-balanced the rest of his fat;  
And in plumped this son of a woman to follow his wig, cane, and hat.

George Canning.

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## SAYING NOT MEANING

Two gentlemen their appetite had fed,  
When opening his toothpick-case, one said,  
"It was not until lately that I knew  
That *anchovies* on *terrâ firmâ* grew."  
"Grow!" cried the other, "yes, they *grow*, indeed,  
Like other fish, but not upon the land;  
You might as well say grapes grow on a reed,  
Or in the Strand!"

"Why, sir," returned the irritated other,  
"My brother,  
When at Calcutta  
Beheld them *bonâ fide* growing;  
He wouldn't utter  
A lie for love or money, sir; so in  
This matter you are thoroughly mistaken."  
"Nonsense, sir! nonsense! I can give no credit  
To the assertion—none e'er saw or read it;  
Your brother, like his evidence, should be shaken."

"Be shaken, sir! let me observe, you are  
Perverse—in short—"  
"Sir," said the other, sucking his cigar,

And then his port—  
"If you will say impossibles are true,  
You may affirm just anything you please—  
That swans are quadrupeds, and lions blue,  
And elephants inhabit Stilton cheese!  
Only you must not *force* me to believe  
What's propagated merely to deceive."

"Then you force me to say, sir, you're a fool,"  
Return'd the bragger.  
Language like this no man can suffer cool:  
It made the listener stagger;  
So, thunder-stricken, he at once replied,  
"The traveler *lied*  
Who had the impudence to tell it you;"  
"Zounds! then d'ye mean to swear before my face  
That anchovies *don't* grow like cloves and mace?"  
"I *do*!"

Disputants often after hot debates  
Leave the contention as they found it—bone,  
And take to duelling or thumping *têtes*;  
Thinking by strength of artery to atone  
For strength of argument; and he who winces  
From force of words, with force of arms convinces!

With pistols, powder, bullets, surgeons, lint,  
Seconds, and smelling-bottles, and foreboding,  
Our friends advanced; and now portentous loading  
(Their hearts already loaded) serv'd to show  
It might be better they shook hands—but no;  
When each opines himself, though frighten'd, right,  
Each is, in courtesy, oblig'd to fight!  
And they *did* fight: from six full measured paces  
The unbeliever pulled his trigger first;  
And fearing, from the braggart's ugly faces,  
The whizzing lead had whizz'd its very worst,

Ran up, and with a *duelistic* fear  
    (His ire evanishing like morning vapors),  
Found him possess'd of one remaining ear,  
    Who in a manner sudden and uncouth,  
    Had given, not lent, the other ear to truth;  
For while the surgeon was applying lint,  
He, wriggling, cried—"The deuce is in't—  
    Sir, I *meant*—CAPERS!"

*William Basil Wake.*

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## **HANS BREITMANN'S PARTY**

Hans Breitmann gife a barty;  
    Dey had biano-blayin':  
I felled in lofe mit a Merican frau,  
    Her name was Madilda Yane.  
She hat haar as prawn ash a pretzel,  
    Her eyes vas himmel-plue,  
Und ven dey looket indo mine,  
    Dey shplit mine heart in two.

Hans Breitmann gife a barty:  
    I vent dere, you'll pe pound.  
I valtzet mit Madilda Yane  
    Und vent shpinnen round und round.  
De pootiest Fräulein in de house,  
    She vayed 'pout dwo hoondred pound,  
Und efery dime she gife a shoomp  
    She make de vindows sound.

Hans Breitmann gife a barty:  
    I dells you it cost him dear.

Dey rolled in more ash sefen kecks  
Of foost-rate Lager Beer,  
Und venefer dey knocks de shpicket in  
De Deutschers gifes a cheer.  
I dinks dat so vine a barty  
Nefer coom to a het dis year.

Hans Breitmann gife a barty;  
Dere all vas Souse und Brouse;  
Ven de sooper comed in, de gompany  
Did make demselfs to house.  
Dey ate das Brot und Gensy broost,  
De Bratwurst und Braten fine,  
Und vash der Abendessen down  
Mit four parrels of Neckarwein.

Hans Breitmann gife a barty.  
We all cot troonk ash bigs.  
I poot mine mout to a parrel of bier,  
Und emptied it oop mit a schwigs.  
Und denn I gissed Madilda Yane  
Und she shlog me on de kop,  
Und de gompany fited mit dapple-lecks  
Dill be coonshtable made oos shtop.

Hans Breitmann gife a barty—  
Where ish dat barty now!  
Where ish de lofely golden cloud  
Dat float on de moundain's prow?  
Where ish de himmelstrablende Stern—  
De shtar of de shpirit's light?  
All gonied afay mit de Lager Beer—  
Afay in de Ewigkeit!

*Charles Godfrey Leland.*

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## **BALLAD BY HANS BREITMANN**

Der noble Ritter Hugo  
Von Schwillensaufenstein  
Rode out mit shpeer and helmet,  
Und he coom to de panks of de Rhine.

Und oop dere rose a meermaid,  
Fot hadn't got nodings on,  
Und she say, "Oh, Ritter Hugo,  
Where you goes mit yourself alone?"

And he says, "I ride in de creenwood,  
Mit helmet und mit shpeer,  
Till I cooms into em Gasthaus,  
Und dere I trinks some beer."

Und den outshpoke the maiden  
Vot hadn't got nodings on:  
"I ton't tink mooch of beoplesh  
Dat goes mit demselfs alone.

"You'd petter coom down in de wasser,  
Where deres heaps of dings to see,  
Und hafe a shplendid tinner  
Und drafel along mit me.

"Dere you sees de fisch a schwimmin',  
Und you catches dem efery von:"—  
So sang dis wasser maiden,  
Vot hadn't got nodings on.

"Dere ish drunks all full mit money  
In ships dat vent down of old;  
Und you helpsh yourself, by dunder!  
To shimmerin' crowns of gold.

"Shoost look at these shpoons and vatches!  
Shoost see dese diamant rings!  
Coom down and fill your pockets,  
And I'll giss you like efery dings.

"Vot you vanst mit your schnapps and lager?  
Come down into der Rhine!  
Der ish pottles de Kaiser Charlemagne  
Vonce filled mit gold-red wine!"

*Dat* fetched him—she shtood all shpell-pound;  
She pooled his coat-tails down;  
She drewed him oonder der wasser,  
De maiden mit nodings on.

*Charles Godfrey Leland.*

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## GRAMPY SINGS A SONG

Row-diddy, dow de, my little sis,  
Hush up your teasin' and listen to this:  
'Tain't much of a jingle, 'tain't much of a tune,  
But it's spang-fired truth about Chester Cahoon.  
The thund'rinest fireman Lord ever made  
Was Chester Cahoon of the Tuttsville Brigade.  
He was boss of the tub and the foreman of hose;  
When the 'larm rung he'd start, sis, a-sheddin' his clothes,  
—Slung cote and slung wes'cote and kicked off his shoes,  
A-runnin' like fun, for he'd no time to lose.  
And he'd howl down the ro'd in a big cloud of dust,  
For he made it his brag he was allus there fust.  
—Allus there fust, with a whoop and a shout,

And he never shut up till the fire was out.  
And he'd knock out the winders and save all the doors,  
And tear off the clapboards, and rip up the floors,  
For he allus allowed 'twas a tarnation sin  
To 'low 'em to burn, for you'd want 'em agin.  
He gen'rally stirred up the most of his touse  
In hustling to save the outside of the house.  
And after he'd wrassled and hollered and pried,  
He'd let up and tackle the stuff 'twas inside.  
To see him you'd think he was daft as a loon,  
But that was jest habit with Chester Cahoon.

Row diddy-iddy, my little sis,  
Now see what ye think of a doin' like this:  
The time of the fire at Jenkins' old place  
It got a big start—was a desprit case;  
The fambly they didn't know which way to turn.  
And by gracious, it looked like it all was to burn.  
But Chester Cahoon—oh, that Chester Cahoon,  
He sailed to the roof like a reg'lar balloon;  
Donno how he done it, but done it he did,  
—Went down through the scuttle and shet down the lid.  
And five minutes later that critter he came  
To the second floor winder surrounded by flame.  
He lugged in his arms, sis, a stove and a bed,  
And balanced a bureau right square on his head.  
His hands they was loaded with crockery stuff,  
China and glass; as if that warn't enough,  
He'd rolls of big quilts round his neck like a wreath,  
And carried Mis' Jenkins' old aunt with his teeth.  
You're right—gospel right, little sis,—didn't seem  
The critter'd git down, but he called for the stream,  
And when it come strong and big round as my wrist;  
He stuck out his legs, sis, and give 'em a twist;  
And he hooked round the water jes' if 'twas a rope,  
And down he come easin' himself on the slope,  
—So almighty spry that he made that 'ere stream



As fit for his pupp'us' as if 'twas a beam.  
Oh, the thund'rinest fireman Lord ever made  
Was Chester Cahoon of the Tuttsville Brigade.

*Holman F. Day.*

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## THE FIRST BANJO

Go 'way, fiddle; folks is tired o' hearin' you a-squawkin'—  
Keep silence fur yo' betters!—don't you heah de banjo talkin'?  
About de 'possum's tail she's gwine to lecter—ladies, listen!—  
About de ha'r whut isn't dar, an' why de ha'r is missin':

"Dar's gwine to be a' oberflow," said Noah, lookin' solemn—  
Fur Noah tuk the "*Herald*," an' he read de ribber column—  
An' so he sot his hands to wuk a-cl'arin' timber-patches,  
An' 'lowed he's gwine to build a boat to beat de steamah *Natchez*.

Ol' Noah kep' a-nailin' an' a-chippin' an' a-sawin';  
An' all de wicked neighbours kep' a-laughin' an' a-pshawin';  
But Noah didn't min' 'em, knowin' whut wuz gwine to happen:  
An' forty days an' forty nights de rain it kep' a-drappin'.

Now, Noah had done cotched a lot ob ebry sort o' beas'es—  
Ob all de shows a-trabbelin', it beat 'em all to pieces!  
He had a Morgan colt an' sebral head o' Jarsey cattle—  
An' druv 'em 'board de Ark as soon's he heered de thunder rattle.

Den sech anoder fall ob rain!—it come so awful hebbby,  
De ribber riz immejitly, an' busted troo de lebbbee;  
De people all wuz drowneded out—'cep' Noah an' de critters,  
An' men he'd hired to work de boat—an' one to mix de bitters.

De Ark she kep' a-sailin' an' a-sailin', *an'* a-sailin';

De lion got his dander up, an' like to bruk de palin';  
De sarpints hissed; de painters yelled; tell, whut wid all de fussin',  
You c'u'dn't hardly heah de mate a-bossin' round' an' cussin'.

Now, Ham, he only nigger whut wuz runnin' on de packet,  
Got lonesome in de barber-shop, and c'u'dn't stan' de racket;  
An' so, fur to amuse he-se'f, he steamed some wood an' bent it,  
An' soon he had a banjo made—de fust dat wuz invented.

He wet de ledder, stretched it on; made bridge an' screws an aprin;  
An' fitted in a proper neck—'twas berry long and tap'rin';  
He tuk some tin, an' twisted him a thimble fur to ring it;  
An' den de mighty question riz: how wuz he gwine to string it?

De 'possum had as fine a tail as dis dat I's a-singin';  
De ha'r's so long an' thick an' strong,—des fit fur banjo-stringin';  
Dat nigger shaved 'em off as short as wash-day-dinner graces;  
An' sorted ob 'em by de size, f'om little E's to basses.

He strung her, tuned her, struck a jig,—'twus "Nebber min' de wedder,"—  
She soun' like forty-lebben bands a-playin' all togedder;  
Some went to pattin'; some to dancin': Noah called de figgers;  
An' Ham he sot an' knocked de tune, de happiest ob niggers!

Now, sence dat time—it's mighty strange—dere's not de slighes' showin'  
Ob any ha'r at all upon de 'possum's tail a-growin';  
An' curi's, too, dat nigger's ways: his people nebber los' 'em—  
Fur whar you finds de nigger—dar's de banjo an' de 'possum!

*Irwin Russell.*

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## THE ROMANCE OF THE CARPET

Basking in peace in the warm spring sun,  
South Hill smiled upon Burlington.

The breath of May! and the day was fair,  
And the bright motes danced in the balmy air.

And the sunlight gleamed where the restless breeze  
Kissed the fragrant blooms on the apple-trees.

His beardless cheek with a smile was spanned,  
As he stood with a carriage whip in his hand.

And he laughed as he doffed his bobtail coat,  
And the echoing folds of the carpet smote.

And she smiled as she leaned on her busy mop,  
And said she'd tell him when to stop.

So he pounded away till the dinner-bell  
Gave him a little breathing spell.

But he sighed when the kitchen clock struck one,  
And she said the carpet wasn't done.

But he lovingly put in his biggest licks,  
And he pounded like mad till the clock struck six.

And she said, in a dubious sort of way,  
That she guessed he could finish it up next day.

Then all that day, and the next day, too,  
That fuzz from the dirtless carpet flew.

And she'd give it a look at eventide,  
And say, "Now beat on the other side."

And the new days came as the old days went,  
And the landlord came for his regular rent.

And the neighbors laughed at the tireless broom,  
And his face was shadowed with clouds of gloom.

Till at last, one cheerless winter day,  
He kicked at the carpet and slid away.

Over the fence and down the street,  
Speeding away with footsteps fleet.

And never again the morning sun  
Smiled on him beating his carpet-drum.

And South Hill often said with a yawn,  
"Where's the carpet-martyr gone?"

Years twice twenty had come and passed  
And the carpet swayed in the autumn blast.

For never yet, since that bright spring-time,  
Had it ever been taken down from the line.

Over the fence a gray-haired man  
Cautiously clim, clome, clem, clum, clamb.

He found him a stick in the old woodpile,  
And he gathered it up with a sad, grim smile,

A flush passed over his face forlorn  
As he gazed at the carpet, tattered and torn.

And he hit it a most resounding thwack,  
Till the startled air gave his echoes back.

And out of the window a white face leaned,

And a palsied hand the pale face screened.

She knew his face; she gasped, and sighed,  
"A little more on the other side."

Right down on the ground his stick he threw,  
And he shivered and said, "Well, I am blowed!"

And he turned away, with a heart full sore,  
And he never was seen not more, not more.

*Robert J. Burdette.*

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## **THE HUNTING OF THE SNARK**

"Come, listen, my men, while I tell you again  
The five unmistakable marks  
By which you may know, wheresoever you go,  
The warranted genuine Snarks.

"Let us take them in order. The first is the taste,  
Which is meagre and hollow, but crisp:  
Like a coat that is rather too tight in the waist,  
With a flavor of Will-o'-the-wisp.

"Its habit of getting up late you'll agree  
That it carries too far when I say  
That it frequently breakfasts at five-o'clock tea,  
And dines on the following day.

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"The fourth is its fondness for bathing-machines,  
Which it constantly carries about,

And believes that they add to the beauty of scenes—  
A sentiment open to doubt.

"The fifth is ambition. It next will be right  
To describe each particular batch;  
Distinguishing those that have feathers, and bite,  
From those that have whiskers, and scratch.

"For, although common Snarks do no manner of harm,  
Yet I feel it my duty to say  
Some are Boojums—" The Bellman broke off in alarm,  
For the Baker had fainted away.

They roused him with muffins—they roused him with ice—  
They roused him with mustard and cress—  
They roused him with jam and judicious advice—  
They set him conundrums to guess.

When at length he sat up and was able to speak,  
His sad story he offered to tell;  
And the Bellman cried "Silence! Not even a shriek!"  
And excitedly tingled his bell.

There was silence supreme! Not a shriek, not a scream,  
Scarcely even a howl or a groan,  
As the man they called "Ho!" told his story of woe.  
In an antediluvian tone.

"My father and mother were honest, though poor—"  
"Skip all that!" cried the Bellman in haste,  
"If it once becomes dark, there's no chance of a Snark,  
We have hardly a minute to waste!"

"I skip forty years," said the Baker, in tears,  
"And proceed without further remark  
To the day when you took me aboard of your ship  
To help you in hunting the Snark.

"A dear uncle of mine (after whom I was named)  
Remarked, when I bade him farewell—"

"Oh, skip your dear uncle," the Bellman exclaimed,  
As he angrily tingled his bell.

"He remarked to me then," said that mildest of men,  
"If your Snark be a Snark, that is right;  
Fetch it home by all means—you may serve it with greens  
And it's handy for striking a light.

"You may seek it with thimbles—and seek it with care;  
You may hunt it with forks and hope;  
You may threaten its life with a railway-share;  
You may charm it with smiles and soap—

"But oh, beamish nephew, beware of the day,  
If your Snark be a Boojum! For then  
You will softly and suddenly vanish away  
And never be met with again!"

"It is this, it is this that oppresses my soul,  
When I think of my uncle's last words:  
And my heart is like nothing so much as a bowl  
Brimming over with quivering curds!

"I engage with the Snark—every night after dark—  
In a dreamy delirious fight:  
I serve it with greens in those shadowy scenes,  
And I use it for striking a light:

"But if ever I meet with a Boojum, that day,  
In a moment (of this I am sure),  
I shall softly and suddenly vanish away—  
And the notion I cannot endure!"

*Lewis Carroll.*

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## THE OLD MAN AND JIM

Old man never had much to say—  
    'Ceptin' to Jim,—  
And Jim was the wildest boy he had—  
    And the Old man jes' wrapped up in him!  
Never heerd him speak but once  
Er twice in my life,—and first time was  
When the army broke out, and Jim he went,  
The Old man backin' him, fer three months.—  
And all 'at I heerd the Old man say  
Was, jes' as we turned to start away,—  
    "Well; good-bye, Jim:  
    Take keer of yourse'f!"

'Peard-like, he was more satisfied  
    Jes' *lookin'* at Jim,  
And likin' him all to hisse'f-like, see?—  
    'Cause he was jes' wrapped up in him!  
And over and over I mind the day  
The Old man come and stood round in the way  
While we was drillin', a-watchin' Jim—  
And down at the deepot a-heerin' him say,—  
    "Well; good-bye, Jim:  
    Take keer of yourse'f!"

Never was nothin' about the farm  
    Disting'ished Jim;—  
Neighbours all ust to wonder why  
    The Old man 'peared wrapped up in him:  
But when Cap. Biggler, he writ back,  
'At Jim was the bravest boy we had  
In the whole dern rigiment, white er black,  
And his fightin' good as his farmin' bad—



'At he had led, with a bullet clean  
Bored through his thigh, and carried the flag  
Through the bloodiest battle you ever seen,—  
The Old man wound up a letter to him  
'At Cap. read to us, 'at said,—"Tell Jim  
    Good-bye;  
    And take keer of hisse'f."

Jim come back jes' long enough  
    To take the whim  
'At he'd like to go back in the cavelry—  
    And the Old man jes' wrapped up in him!—  
Jim 'lowed 'at he'd had sich luck afore,  
Guessed he'd tackle her three years more.  
And the Old man give him a colt he'd raised  
And follered him over to Camp Ben Wade,  
And laid around fer a week er so,  
Watchin' Jim on dress-parade—  
Tel finally he rid away,  
And last he heerd was the Old man say,—  
    "Well; good-bye, Jim:  
    Take keer of yourse'f!"

Tuk the papers, the Old man did,  
    A-watchin' fer Jim—  
Fully believin' he'd make his mark  
    *Some way*—jes' wrapped up in him!—  
And many a time the word 'u'd come  
'At stirred him up like the tap of a drum—  
At Petersburg, fer instance, where  
Jim rid right into their cannons there,  
And tuk 'em, and p'inted 'em t'other way,  
And socked it home to the boys in grey,  
As they skooted fer timber, and on and on—  
Jim a lieutenant and one arm gone,  
And the Old man's words in his mind all day,—  
    "Well; good-bye, Jim:

Take keer of yourse'f!"

Think of a private, now, perhaps,  
    We'll say like Jim,  
'At's clumb clean up to the shoulder-straps—  
    And the Old man jes' wrapped up in him!  
Think of him—with the war plum' through,  
And the glorious old Red-White-and-Blue  
A-laughin' the news down over Jim,  
And the Old man, bendin' over him—  
The surgeon turnin' away with tears  
'At hadn't leaked fer years and years—  
As the hand of the dyin' boy clung to  
His father's, the old voice in his ears,—  
    "Well; good-bye, Jim:  
    Take keer of yourse'f!"

*James Whitcomb Riley.*

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## A SAILOR'S YARN

*This is the tale that was told to me,  
By a battered and shattered son of the sea—  
To me and my messmate, Silas Green,  
When I was a guileless young marine.*

""Twas the good ship *Gyascutus*,  
    All in the China seas,  
With the wind a-lee and the capstan free  
    To catch the summer breeze.

""Twas Captain Porgie on the deck,  
    To his mate in the mizzen hatch,

While the boatswain bold, in the forward hold,  
Was winding the larboard watch.

"Oh, how does our good ship head to-night!  
How heads our gallant craft?'  
'Oh, she heads to the E. S. W. by N.,  
And the binnacle lies abaft!'

"Oh, what does the quadrant indicate,  
And how does the sextant stand?'  
'Oh, the sextant's down to the freezing point,  
And the quadrant's lost a hand!'

"Oh, and if the quadrant has lost a hand,  
And the sextant falls so low,  
It's our bodies and bones to Davy Jones  
This night are bound to go!

"Oh, fly aloft to the garboard strake!  
And reef the spanker boom;  
Bend a studding sail on the martingale,  
To give her weather room.

"Oh, boatswain, down in the for'ard hold  
What water do you find?'  
'Four foot and a half by the royal gaff  
And rather more behind!'

"Oh, sailors, collar your marline spikes  
And each belaying pin;  
Come stir your stumps, and spike the pumps,  
Or more will be coming in!'

"They stirred their stumps, they spiked the pumps,  
They spliced the mizzen brace;  
Aloft and alow they worked, but oh!  
The water gained apace.

"They bored a hole above the keel  
To let the water out;  
But, strange to say, to their dismay,  
The water in did spout.

"Then up spoke the Cook, of our gallant ship,  
And he was a lubber brave:  
'I have several wives in various ports,  
And my life I'd order save.'

"Then up spoke the Captain of Marines,  
Who dearly loved his prog:  
'It's awful to die, and it's worse to be dry,  
And I move we pipe to grog.'

"Oh, then 'twas the noble second mate  
What filled them all with awe;  
The second mate, as bad men hate,  
And cruel skipper's jaw.

"He took the anchor on his back,  
And leaped into the main;  
Through foam and spray he clove his way,  
And sunk and rose again!

"Through foam and spray, a league away  
The anchor stout he bore;  
Till, safe at last, he made it fast  
And warped the ship ashore!

""Taint much of a job to talk about,  
But a ticklish thing to see,  
And suth'in to do, if I say it, too,  
For that second mate was me!"

*Such was the tale that was told to me*

*By that modest and truthful son of the sea,  
And I envy the life of a second mate,  
Though captains curse him and sailors hate,  
For he ain't like some of the swabs I've seen,  
As would go and lie to a poor marine.*

*James Jeffrey Roche.*

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## **THE CONVERTED CANNIBALS**

Upon an island, all alone,  
They lived, in the Pacific;  
Somewhere within the Torrid Zone,  
Where heat is quite terrific.  
'Twould shock you were I to declare  
The many things they did not wear,  
Altho' no doubt  
One's best without  
Such things in heat terrific.

Though cannibals by birth were they,  
Yet, since they'd first existed,  
Their simple menu day by day  
Of such-like things consisted:  
Omelets of turtle's eggs, and yams,  
And stews from freshly-gathered clams,  
Such things as these  
Were,—if you please,—  
Of what their fare consisted.

But after dinner they'd converse,  
Nor did their topic vary;  
Wild tales of gore they would rehearse,

And talk of *missionary*.  
They'd gaze upon each other's joints,  
And indicate the tender points.

Said one: "For us  
'Tis dangerous  
To *think* of *missionary*."

Well, on a day, upon the shore,  
As flotsam, or as jetsam,  
Some wooden cases,—ten, or more,—  
Were cast up. "Let us get some,  
And see, my friend, what they contain;  
The chance may not occur again,"

Said good Who-zoo.  
Said Tum-tum, "Do;  
We'll both wade out and get some."

The cases held,—what do you think?—

"PRIME MISSIONARY—TINNED."

Nay! gentle reader, do not shrink—

The man who made it sinned:  
He thus had labelled bloater-paste  
To captivate the native taste.

He hoped, of course,  
This fraud to force  
On them. In this he sinned.

Our simple friends knew naught of sin;

They thought that this confection  
Was missionary in a tin  
According to direction.

For very joy they shed salt tears.

"'Tis what we've waited for, for years,"

Said they. "Hooray!  
We'll feast to-day  
According to direction."

"'Tis very tough," said one, for he  
The tin and all had eaten.  
"Too salt," the other said, "for me;  
The flavour might be beaten."  
It was enough. Soon each one swore  
He'd missionary eat no more:  
Their tastes were cured,  
They felt assured  
This flavour might be beaten.

And, should a missionary call  
To-day, he'd find them gentle,  
With no perverted tastes at all,  
And manners ornamental;  
He'd be received, I'm bound to say,  
In courteous and proper way;  
Nor need he fear  
To taste their cheer  
However ornamental.

*G. E. Farrow.*

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## **THE RETIRED PORK-BUTCHER AND THE SPOOK**

I may as well  
Proceed to tell  
About a Mister Higgs,  
Who grew quite rich  
In trade—the which  
Was selling pork and pigs.

From trade retired,  
He much desired

To rank with gentlefolk,  
So bought a place  
He called "The Chase,"  
And furnished it—old oak.

Ancestors got  
(Twelve pounds the lot,  
In Tottenham Court Road);  
A pedigree—  
For nine pounds three,—  
The Heralds' Court bestowed.

Within the hall,  
And on the wall,  
Hung armour bright and strong.  
"To Ethelbred"—  
The label read—  
"De Higgs, this did belong."

'Twas *quite* complete,  
This country seat,  
Yet neighbours stayed away.  
Nobody called,—  
Higgs was blackballed,—  
Which caused him great dismay.

"Why *can* it be?"  
One night said he  
When thinking of it o'er.  
There came a knock  
('Twas twelve o'clock)  
Upon his chamber door.

Higgs cried, "Come in!"  
A vapour thin  
The keyhole wandered through.  
Higgs rubbed his eyes



In mild surprise:  
A ghost appeared in view.

"I beg," said he,  
"You'll pardon me,  
In calling rather late.  
A family ghost,  
I seek a post,  
With wage commensurate.

"I'll serve you well;  
My 'fiendish yell'  
Is certain sure to please.  
'Sepulchral tones,'  
And 'rattling bones,'  
I'm *very* good at these.

"Five bob I charge  
To roam at large,  
With 'clanking chains' *ad lib.*;  
I do such things  
As 'gibberings'  
At one-and-three per gib.

"Or, by the week,  
I merely seek  
Two pounds—which is not dear;  
Because I need,  
Of course, *no* feed,  
*No* washing, and *no* beer."

Higgs thought it o'er  
A bit, before  
He hired the family ghost,  
But, finally,  
He did agree  
To give to him the post.

It got about—  
You know, no doubt,  
How quickly such news flies—  
Throughout the place,  
From "Higgses Chase"  
Proceeded ghostly cries.

The rumour spread,  
Folks shook their head,  
But dropped in one by one.  
A bishop came  
(Forget his name),  
And then the thing was done.

For afterwards  
*All* left their cards,  
"Because," said they, "you see,  
One who can boast  
A family ghost  
Respectable *must* be."

When it was due,  
The "ghostes's" screw  
Higgs raised—as was but right—  
They often play,  
In friendly way,  
A game of cards at night.

*G. E. Farrow.*

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## SKIPPER IRESON'S RIDE

Of all the rides since the birth of time,  
Told in story or sung in rhyme,—  
On Apuleius's Golden Ass,  
Or one-eyed Calendar's horse of brass,  
Witch astride of a human back,  
Islam's prophet on Al-Borak,—  
The strangest ride that ever was sped  
Was Ireson's, out from Marblehead!  
    Old Floyd Ireson, for his hard heart,  
    Tarred and feathered and carried in a cart  
    By the women of Marblehead!

Body of turkey, head of owl,  
Wings a-droop like a rained-on fowl,  
Feathered and ruffled in every part,  
Skipper Ireson stood in the cart.  
Scores of women, old and young,  
Strong of muscle, and glib of tongue,  
Pushed and pulled up the rocky lane,  
Shouting and singing the shrill refrain:  
    "Here's Flud Oirson, fur his horrd horrt,  
    Torr'd an' futherr'd an' corr'd in a corrt  
    By the women o' Morble'ead!"

Wrinkled scolds with hands on hips,  
Girls in bloom of cheek and lips,  
Wild-eyed, free-limbed, such as chase  
Bacchus round some antique vase,  
Brief of skirt, with ankles bare,  
Loose of kerchief and loose of hair,  
With conch-shells blowing and fish-horns' twang,  
Over and over the Mænads sang:  
    "Here's Flud Oirson, fur his horrd horrt,  
    Torr'd an' futherr'd an' corr'd in a corrt  
    By the women o' Morble'ead!"

Small pity for him!—He sailed away  
From a leaking ship, in Chaleur Bay,—  
Sailed away from a sinking wreck,  
With his own town's-people on her deck!  
"Lay by! lay by!" they called to him.  
Back he answered, "Sink or swim!  
Brag of your catch of fish again!"  
And off he sailed through the fog and rain!  
    Old Floyd Ireson, for his hard heart,  
    Tarred and feathered and carried in a cart  
    By the women of Marblehead!

Fathoms deep in dark Chaleur  
That wreck shall lie forevermore.  
Mother and sister, wife and maid,  
Looked from the rocks of Marblehead  
Over the moaning and rainy sea,—  
Looked for the coming that might not be!  
What did the winds and the sea-birds say  
Of the cruel captain who sailed away?—  
    Old Floyd Ireson, for his hard heart,  
    Tarred and feathered and carried in a cart  
    By the women of Marblehead!

Through the street, on either side,  
Up flew windows, doors swung wide;  
Sharp-tongued spinsters, old wives gray,  
Treble lent the fish-horn's bray.  
Sea-worn grandsires, cripple-bound,  
Hulks of old sailors run aground,  
Shook head, and fist, and hat, and cane,  
And cracked with curses the hoarse refrain:  
    "Here's Flud Oirson, fur his horrd horrt,  
    Torr'd an' futherr'd an' corr'd in a corrt  
    By the women o' Morble'ead!"

Sweetly along the Salem road

Bloom of orchard and lilac showed.  
Little the wicked skipper knew  
Of the fields so green and the sky so blue.  
Riding there in his sorry trim,  
Like an Indian idol glum and grim,  
Scarcely he seemed the sound to hear  
Of voices shouting, far and near:

"Here's Flud Oirson, fur his horrd horrt,  
Torr'd an' futherr'd an' corr'd in a corrt  
By the women o' Morble'ead!"

"Hear me, neighbors!" at last he cried,—  
"What to me is this noisy ride?  
What is the shame that clothes the skin  
To the nameless horror that lives within?  
Waking or sleeping, I see a wreck,  
And hear a cry from a reeling deck!  
Hate me and curse me,—I only dread  
The hand of God and the face of the dead!"  
Said old Floyd Ireson, for his hard heart,  
Tarred and feathered and carried in a cart  
By the women of Marblehead!

Then the wife of the skipper lost at sea  
Said, "God has touched him! Why should we?"  
Said an old wife, mourning her only son:  
"Cut the rogue's tether and let him run!"  
So with soft relentings and rude excuse,  
Half scorn, half pity, they cut him loose,  
And gave him a cloak to hide him in,  
And left him alone with his shame and sin.  
Poor Floyd Ireson, for his hard heart,  
Tarred and feathered and carried in a cart  
By the women of Marblehead!

*J. G. Whittier.*

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## DARIUS GREEN AND HIS FLYING-MACHINE

If ever there lived a Yankee lad,  
Wise or otherwise, good or bad,  
Who, seeing the birds fly, didn't jump  
With flapping arms from stake or stump,  
Or, spreading the tail  
Of his coat for a sail,  
Take a soaring leap from post or rail,  
And wonder why  
He couldn't fly,  
And flap and flutter and wish and try—  
If ever you knew a country dunce  
Who didn't try that as often as once,  
All I can say is, that's a sign  
He never would do for a hero of mine.

An aspiring genius was D. Green:  
The son of a farmer, age fourteen;  
His body was long and lank and lean—  
Just right for flying, as will be seen;  
He had two eyes as bright as a bean,  
And a freckled nose that grew between,  
A little awry—for I must mention  
That he had riveted his attention  
Upon his wonderful invention,  
Twisting his tongue as he twisted the strings,  
And working his face as he worked the wings,  
And with every turn of gimlet and screw  
Turning and screwing his mouth round too,  
Till his nose seemed bent  
To catch the scent,  
Around some corner, of new-baked pies,  
And his wrinkled cheeks and his squinting eyes

Grew puckered into a queer grimace,  
That made him look very droll in the face,  
And also very wise.  
And wise he must have been, to do more  
Than ever a genius did before,  
Excepting Dædalus of yore  
And his son Icarus, who wore  
Upon their backs  
Those wings of wax  
He had read of in the old almanacs.  
Darius was clearly of the opinion  
That the air is also man's dominion,  
And that, with paddle or fin or pinion,  
We soon or late shall navigate  
The azure as now we sail the sea.

The thing looks simple enough to me;  
And if you doubt it,  
Hear how Darius reasoned about it.  
"The birds can fly an' why can't I?  
Must we give in," says he with a grin.  
"That the bluebird an' phœbe  
Are smarter'n we be?  
Jest fold our hands an' see the swaller  
An' blackbird an' catbird beat us holler?  
Doos the little chatterin', sassy wren,  
No bigger'n my thumb, know more than men?  
Just show me that!  
Ur prove 't the bat  
Hez got more brains than's in my hat.  
An' I'll back down, an' not till then!"  
He argued further: "Nur I can't see  
What's th' use o' wings to a bumble-bee,  
Fur to gitt a livin' with, more'n to me;—  
Ain't my business  
Important's his'n is?  
That Icarus

Made a perty muss—  
Him an' his daddy Dædalus  
They might 'a' knowed wings made o' wax  
Wouldn't stand sun-heat an' hard whacks.  
        I'll make mine o' luther,  
        Ur suthin' ur other."

And he said to himself, as he tinkered and planned:  
"But I ain't goin' to show my hand  
To mummies that never can understand  
The fust idee that's big an' grand."  
So he kept his secret from all the rest,  
Safely buttoned within his vest;  
And in the loft above the shed  
Himself he locks, with thimble and thread  
And wax and hammer and buckles and screws  
And all such things as geniuses use;—  
Two bats for patterns, curious fellows!  
A charcoal-pot and a pair of bellows;  
Some wire, and several old umbrellas;  
A carriage-cover, for tail and wings;  
A piece of harness; and straps and strings;  
        And a big strong box,  
        In which he locks  
These and a hundred other things.  
His grinning brothers, Reuben and Burke  
And Nathan and Jotham and Solomon, lurk  
Around the corner to see him work—  
Sitting cross-legged, like a Turk,  
Drawing the waxed-end through with a jerk,  
And boring the holes with a comical quirk  
Of his wise old head, and a knowing smirk.  
But vainly they mounted each other's backs,  
And poked through knot-holes and pried through cracks;  
With wood from the pile and straw from the stacks  
He plugged the knot-holes and caulked the cracks;  
And a dipper of water, which one would think



He had brought up into the loft to drink  
    When he chanced to be dry,  
    Stood always nigh,  
    For Darius was sly!  
And whenever at work he happened to spy  
At chink or crevice a blinking eye,  
He let the dipper of water fly.  
"Take that! an' ef ever ye git a peep,  
Guess ye'll ketch a weasel asleep!"  
    And he sings as he locks  
    His big strong box:—

"The weasel's head is small an' trim,  
An' he is little an' long an' slim,  
An' quick of motion an' nimble of limb  
An' ef you'll be  
Advised by me,  
Keep wide awake when ye're ketchin' him!"

    So day after day  
He stitched and tinkered and hammered away,  
    Till at last 'twas done—  
The greatest invention under the sun!  
"An' now," says Darius, "hooray fur some fun!"

    'Twas the Fourth of July,  
    And the weather was dry,  
And not a cloud was on all the sky,  
Save a few light fleeces, which here and there  
    Half mist, half air,  
Like foam on the ocean went floating by—  
Just as lovely a morning as ever was seen  
For a nice little trip in a flying-machine.  
Thought cunning Darius: "Now I shan't go  
Along 'ith the fellers to see the show.  
I'll say I've got sich a terrible cough!  
An' then, when the folks 'ave all gone off,

I'll hev full swing fur to try the thing,  
An' practise a little on the wing."  
"Ain't goin' to see the celebration?"  
Says brother Nate. "No; botheration!  
I've got sich a cold—a toothache—I—  
My gracious!—feel's though I should fly!"  
Said Jotham, "Sho!  
Guess ye better go."  
But Darius said, "No!  
Shouldn't wonder 'f you might see me, though,  
'Long 'bout noon, ef I git red  
O' this jumpin', thumpin' pain 'n my head."  
For all the while to himself he said:—

"I tell ye what!  
I'll fly a few times around the lot,  
To see how 't seems, then soon's I've got  
The hang o' the thing, ez likely's not,  
I'll astonish the nation,  
An' all creation,  
By flyin' over the celebration!  
Over their heads I'll sail like an eagle;  
I'll balance myself on my wings like a sea-gull:  
I'll dance on the chimbleys; I'll stand on the steeple;  
I'll flop up to winders an' scare the people!  
I'll light on the liberty-pole, an' crow;  
An' I'll say to the gawpin' fools below,  
'What world's this 'ere  
That I've come near?'  
Fur I'll make 'em b'lieve I'm a chap f'm the moon;  
An' I'll try to race 'ith their ol' balloon!"  
He crept from his bed;  
And, seeing the others were gone, he said,  
"I'm gittin' over the cold 'n my head."  
And away he sped,  
To open the wonderful box in the shed.

His brothers had walked but a little way,  
When Jotham to Nathan chanced to say,  
"What is the feller up to, hey!"  
"Don'o'—the 's suthin' ur other to pay,  
Ur he wouldn't 'a' stayed tu hum to-day."  
Says Burke, "His toothache's all 'n his eye!  
*He* never 'd missed a Fo'th-o'-July,  
Ef he hedn't got some machine to try."  
Then Sol, the little one, spoke: "By darn!  
Le's hurry back an' hide 'n the barn,  
An' pay him fur tellin' us that yarn!"  
"Agreed!" Through the orchard they creep back  
Along by the fences, behind the stack,  
And one by one, through a hole in the wall,  
In under the dusty barn they crawl,  
Dressed in their Sunday garments all;  
And a very astonishing sight was that,  
When each in his cobwebbed coat and hat  
Came up through the floor like an ancient rat  
                    And there they hid;  
                    And Reuben slid  
The fastenings back, and the door undid.  
                    "Keep dark!" said he,  
"While I squint an' see what the' is to see."

As knights of old put on their mail—  
                    From head to foot an iron suit,  
Iron jacket and iron boot,  
Iron breeches, and on the head  
No hat, but an iron pot instead,  
                    And under the chin the bail,  
(I believe they called the thing a helm,)  
Then sallied forth to overwhelm  
The dragons and pagans that plagued the earth  
                    So this *modern* knight  
                    Prepared for flight,  
Put on his wings and strapped them tight

Jointed and jaunty, strong and light—  
Buckled them fast to shoulder and hip;  
Ten feet they measured from tip to tip  
And a helm had he, but that he wore,  
Not on his head, like those of yore,  
But more like the helm of a ship.

"Hush!" Reuben said,  
"He's up in the shed!  
He's opened the winder—I see his head!  
He stretches it out, an' pokes it about,  
Lookin' to see 'f the coast is clear,  
An' nobody near;—  
Guess he don' o' who's hid in here!  
He's riggin' a spring-board over the sill!  
Stop laffin', Solomon! Burke, keep still!  
He's a climbin' out now—Of all the things!  
What's he got on? I vum, it's wings!  
An' that 'tother thing? I vum, it's a tail!  
An' there he sits like a hawk on a rail!  
Steppin' careful, he travels the length  
Of his spring-board, and teeters to try its strength.  
Now he stretches his wings, like a monstrous bat;  
Peeks over his shoulder; this way an' that,  
Fur to see 'f the 's any one passin' by;  
But the 's on'y a caf an' goslin nigh.  
*They* turn up at him a wonderin' eye,  
To see— The dragon! he's goin' to fly!  
Away he goes! Jimminy! what a jump!  
Flop—flop—an' plump  
To the ground with a thump!  
Flutt'rin' an' flound'rin' all 'n a lump!"

As a demon is hurled by an angel's spear,  
Heels over head, to his proper sphere—  
Heels over head, and head over heels,  
Dizzily down the abyss he wheels—

So fell Darius. Upon his crown,  
In the midst of the barn-yard, he came down,  
In a wonderful whirl of tangled strings,  
Broken braces and broken springs.  
Broken tail and broken wings,  
Shooting-stars, and various things;  
Barn-yard litter of straw and chaff,  
And much that wasn't so sweet by half.  
Away with a bellow fled the calf,  
And what was that? Did the gosling laugh?  
'Tis a merry roar from the old barn-door,  
And he hears the voice of Jotham crying,  
"Say, D'rius! how do you like flyin'?"  
Slowly, ruefully, where he lay,  
Darius just turned and looked that way,  
As he stanch'd his sorrowful nose with his cuff.  
"Wal, I like flyin' well enough,"  
He said; "but the' ain't such a thunderin' sight  
O' fun in 't when ye come to light."

I just have room for the MORAL here:  
And this is the moral—Stick to your sphere.  
Or if you insist, as you have the right,  
On spreading your wings for a loftier flight,  
The moral is—Take care how you light.

*John Townsend Trowbridge.*

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## A GREAT FIGHT

"There was a man in Arkansaw  
As let his passions rise,  
And not unfrequently picked out  
Some other varmint's eyes.

"His name was Tuscaloosa Sam  
And often he would say,  
'There's not a cuss in Arkansaw  
I can't whip any day.'

"One morn, a stranger passin' by,  
Heard Sammy talkin' so,  
And down he scrambled from his hoss,  
And off his coat did go.

"He sorter kinder shut one eye,  
And spit into his hand,  
And put his ugly head one side,  
And twitched his trowsers' band.

""My boy,' says he, 'it's my belief,  
Whomever you may be,  
That I kin make you screech, and smell  
Pertiklor agony.'

"I'm thar,' said Tuscaloosa Sam,  
And chucked his hat away;  
'I'm thar,' says he, and buttoned up  
As far as buttons may.

"He thundered on the stranger's mug,  
The stranger pounded he;  
And oh! the way them critters fit

Was beautiful to see.

"They clinched like two rampageous bears,  
And then went down a bit;  
They swore a stream of six-inch oaths  
And fit, and fit, and fit.

"When Sam would try to work away,  
And on his pegs to git,  
The stranger'd pull him back; and so,  
They fit, and fit, and fit!

"Then like a pair of lobsters, both  
Upon the ground were knit,  
And yet the varmints used their teeth,  
And fit, and fit, and fit!!

"The sun of noon was high above,  
And hot enough to split,  
But only riled the fellers more,  
That fit, and fit, and fit!!!

"The stranger snapped at Samy's nose,  
And shortened it a bit;  
And then they both swore awful hard,  
And fit, and fit, and fit!!!!

"The mud it flew, the sky grew dark,  
And all the littenins lit;  
But still them critters rolled about,  
And fit, and fit, and fit!!!!!!

"First Sam on top, then t'other chap;  
When one would make a hit,  
The other'd smell the grass; and so  
They fit, and fit, and fit!!!!!!

"The night came on, the stars shone out  
As bright as wimmen's wit;  
And still them fellers swore and gouged,  
And fit, and fit, and fit!!!!!!

"The neighbours heard the noise they made,  
And thought an earthquake lit;  
Yet all the while 'twas him and Sam  
As fit, and fit, and fit!!!!!!

"For miles around the noise was heard;  
Folks couldn't sleep a bit,  
Because them two rantankerous chaps  
Still fit, and fit, and fit!!!!!!

"But jist at cock-crow, suddenly,  
There came an awful pause,  
And I and my old man run out  
To ascertain the cause.

"The sun was rising in the yeast,  
And lit the hull concern;  
But not a sign of either chap  
Was found at any turn.

"Yet, in the region where they fit,  
We found, to our surprise,  
One pint of buttons, two big knives,  
Some whiskers, and four, eyes!"

*Robert Henry Newell.*

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## **THE DONNYBROOK JIG**



Oh! 'twas Dermot O'Nolan M'Figg,  
That could properly handle a twig,  
    He wint to the fair, and kicked up a dust there,  
In dancing a Donnybrook jig—with his twig.  
Oh! my blessing to Dermot M'Figg.

Whin he came to the midst of the fair,  
He was all in a paugh for fresh air,  
    For the fair very soon, was as full—as the moon,  
Such mobs upon mobs as were there, oh rare!  
So more luck to sweet Donnybrook Fair.

But Dermot, his mind on love bent,  
In search of his sweetheart he went,  
    Peep'd in here and there, as he walked through the fair,  
And took a small drop in each tent—as he went,—  
Oh! on whisky and love he was bent.

And who should he spy in a jig,  
With a meal-man so tall and so big,  
    But his own darling Kate, so gay and so nate?  
Faith! her partner he hit him a dig—the pig,  
He beat the meal out of his wig.

The piper, to keep him in tune,  
Struck up a gay lilt very soon;  
    Until an arch wag cut a hole in the bag,  
And at once put an end to the tune—too soon—  
Och! the music flew up to the moon.

The meal-man he looked very shy,  
While a great big tear stood in his eye,  
    He cried, "Lord, how I'm kilt, all alone for that jilt;  
With her may the devil fly high in the sky,  
For I'm murdered, and don't know for why."

"Oh!" says Dermot, and he in the dance,  
Whilst a step to'ards his foe did advance,  
    "By the Father of Men, say but that word again,  
And I'll soon knock you back in a trance—to your dance,  
For with me you'd have but small chance."

"But," says Kitty, the darlint, says she,  
"If you'll only just listen to me,  
    It's myself that will show that he can't be your foe,  
Though he fought for his cousin—that's me," says she,  
"For sure Billy's related to me."

"For my own cousin-jarmin, Anne Wild,  
Stood for Biddy Mulroony's first child;  
    And Biddy's step-son, sure he married Bess Dunn,  
Who was gossip to Jenny, as mild a child  
As ever at mother's breast smiled."

"And may be you don't know Jane Brown,  
Who served goat's-whey in Dundrum's sweet town?  
    'Twas her uncle's half-brother, who married my mother,  
And bought me this new yellow gown, to go down  
When the marriage was held in Milltown."

"By the powers, then," says Dermot, "'tis plain,  
Like the son of that rascalion Cain,  
    My best friend I have kilt, though no blood is spilt,  
But the devil a harm did I mane—that's plain;  
And by me he'll be ne'er kilt again."

*Viscount Dillon.*

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## UNFORTUNATE MISS BAILEY

A captain bold from Halifax who dwelt in country quarters,  
Betrayed a maid who hanged herself one morning in her Garters.  
His wicked conscience smited him, he lost his Stomach daily,  
And took to drinking Ratafia while thinking of Miss Bailey.

One night betimes he went to bed, for he had caught a Fever;  
Says he, "I am a handsome man, but I'm a gay Deceiver."  
His candle just at twelve o'clock began to burn quite palely,  
A Ghost stepped up to his bedside and said "Behold Miss Bailey!"

"Avaunt, Miss Bailey!" then he cries, "your Face looks white and mealy."  
"Dear Captain Smith," the ghost replied, "you've used me ungentlely;  
The Crowner's 'Quest goes hard with me because I've acted frailly,  
And Parson Biggs won't bury me though I am dead Miss Bailey."

"Dear Corpse!" said he, "since you and I accounts must once for all close,  
There really is a one pound note in my regimental Smallclothes;  
I'll bribe the sexton for your grave." The ghost then vanished gaily  
Crying "Bless you, Wicked Captain Smith, Remember poor Miss Bailey."

*Unknown.*

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## THE LAIRD O' COCKPEN

The last two stanzas were added by Miss Ferrier.

The Laird o' Cockpen, he's proud and he's great;  
His mind is ta'en up wi' the things o' the state;  
He wanted a wife his braw house to keep;  
But favour wi' wooin' was fashious to seek.

Doun by the dyke-side a lady did dwell,  
At his table-head he thought she'd look well

M'Clish's ae daughter o' Claverse-ha' Lee—  
A pennyless lass wi' a lang pedigree.

His wig was well-pouther'd, as guid as when new,  
His waistcoat was white, his coat it was blue:  
He put on a ring, a sword, and cock'd hat—  
And wha could refuse the Laird wi' a' that?

He took the grey mare, and rade cannilie—  
And rapped at the yett o' Claverse-ha' Lee;  
"Gae tell mistress Jean to come speedily ben:  
She's wanted to speak wi' the Laird o' Cockpen."

Mistress Jean she was makin' the elder-flower wine;  
"And what brings the Laird at sic a like time?"  
She put off her apron, and on her silk gown,  
Her mutch wi' red ribbons, and gaed awa' down.

And when she cam' ben, he boued fu' low;  
And what was his errand he soon let her know,  
Amazed was the Laird when the lady said, Na,  
And wi' a laigh curtsie she turned awa'.

Dumfounder'd he was, but nae sigh did he gi'e;  
He mounted his mare, and rade cannilie;  
And aften he thought, as he gaed through the glen,  
"She's daft to refuse the Laird o' Cockpen."

And now that the Laird his exit had made,  
Mistress Jean she reflected on what she had said;  
"Oh! for ane I'll get better, it's waur I'll get ten—  
I was daft to refuse the Laird o' Cockpen."

Neist time that the Laird and the Lady were seen,  
They were gaun arm and arm to the kirk on the green;  
Now she sits in the ha' like a weel-tappit hen,  
But as yet there's nae chickens appeared at Cockpen.

*Lady Nairne.*

---

## **A WEDDING**

I tell thee, Dick, where I have been;  
Where I the rarest things have seen;  
    Oh, things without compare!  
Such sights again can not be found  
    In any place on English ground,  
    Be it at wake or fair.

At Charing Cross, hard by the way  
Where we (thou know'st) do sell our hay,  
    There is a house with stairs;  
And there did I see coming down  
Such folks as are not in our town;  
    Vorty at least, in pairs.

Amongst the rest one pest'lent fine  
(His beard no bigger tho' than thine)  
    Walk'd on before the rest;  
Our landlord looks like nothing to him;  
The King (God bless him!) 'twould undo him  
    Should he go still so drest.

At Course-a-park, without all doubt,  
He should have first been taken out  
    By all the maids i' th' town:  
Though lusty Roger there had been,  
Or little George upon the green,  
    Or Vincent of the crown.

But wot you what? The youth was going

To make an end of all his woing;  
The parson for him staid:  
Yet by his leave, for all his haste,  
He did not so much wish all past,  
Perchance as did the maid.

The maid (and thereby hangs a tale)  
For such a maid no Whitson-ale  
Could ever yet produce;  
No grape that's kindly ripe, could be  
So round, so plump, so soft, as she  
Nor half so full of juyce.

Her finger was so small, the ring  
Would not stay on which they did bring;  
It was too wide a peck:  
And, to say truth (for out it must),  
It look'd like the great collar (just)  
About our young colt's neck.

Her feet beneath her petticoat,  
Like little mice, stole in and out,  
As if they fear'd the light:  
But oh! she dances such a way;  
No sun upon an Easter day  
Is half so fine a sight.

Her cheeks so rare a white was on,  
No daisie makes comparison  
(Who sees them is undone);  
For streaks of red were mingled there,  
Such as are on a Cath'rine pear,  
The side that's next the Sun.

Her lips were red; and one was thin,  
Compared to that was next her chin  
(Some bee had stung it newly);

But, Dick, her eyes so guard her face,  
I durst no more upon them gaze,  
Than on a Sun in July.

Her mouth so small, when she does speak,  
Thou'dst swear her teeth her words did break,  
That they might passage get;  
But she so handled still the matter,  
They came as good as ours, or better,  
And are not spent a whit.

Passion, oh me! how I run on!  
There's that that would be thought upon,  
I trow, besides the bride.  
The business of the kitchen's great;  
For it is fit that men should eat,  
Nor was it there denied.

Just in the nick the Cook knock'd thrice,  
And all the waiters in a trice  
His summons did obey;  
Each serving man, with dish in hand,  
March'd boldly up like our train'd band,  
Presented, and away.

When all the meat was on the table,  
What man of knife, or teeth, was able  
To stay to be entreated?  
And this the very reason was,  
Before the parson could say grace  
The company was seated.

Now hats fly off, and youths carouse;  
Healts first go round, and then the house,  
The bride's came thick and thick;  
And when 'twas named another's health,  
Perhaps he made it hers by stealth,

(And who could help it, Dick?)

O' th' sudden, up they rise and dance;  
Then sit again, and sigh, and glance:  
Then dance again, and kiss:  
Thus sev'ral ways the time did pass,  
Till ev'ry woman wish'd her place,  
And ev'ry man wish'd his.

By this time all were stol'n aside  
To counsel and undress the bride;  
But that he must not know:  
But yet 'twas thought he guest her mind,  
And did not mean to stay behind  
Above an hour or so.

*Sir John Suckling.*

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# TRIBUTE

## THE AHKOND OF SWAT

Who, or why, or which, or *what*,  
Is the Ahkond of Swat?

Is he tall or short, or dark or fair?  
Does he sit on a stool or sofa or chair, or Squat,  
The Ahkond of Swat?

Is he wise or foolish, young or old?  
Does he drink his soup and his coffee cold, or Hot,  
The Ahkond of Swat?

Does he sing or whistle, jabber or talk,  
And when riding abroad does he gallop or walk, or Trot,  
The Ahkond of Swat?

Does he wear a turban, a fez, or a hat?  
Does he sleep on a mattress, a bed or a mat, or a Cot,  
The Ahkond of Swat?

When he writes a copy in round-hand size,  
Does he cross his t's and finish his i's with a Dot,  
The Ahkond of Swat?

Can he write a letter concisely clear,  
Without a speck or a smudge or smear or a Blot,  
The Ahkond of Swat?

Do his people like him extremely well?

Or do they, whenever they can, rebel, or Plot,  
At the Ahkond of Swat?

If he catches them then, either old or young,  
Does he have them chopped in pieces or hung, or Shot,  
The Ahkond of Swat?

Do his people prig in the lanes or park?  
Or even at times, when days are dark, Garotte?  
Oh, the Ahkond of Swat?

Does he study the wants of his own dominion?  
Or doesn't he care for public opinion a Jot,  
The Ahkond of Swat?

To amuse his mind do his people show him  
Pictures, or any one's last new poem, or What,  
For the Ahkond of Swat?

At night if he suddenly screams and wakes,  
Do they bring him only a few small cakes, or a Lot,  
For the Ahkond of Swat?

Does he live on turnips, tea or tripe,  
Does he like his shawl to be marked with a stripe or a Dot,  
The Ahkond of Swat?

Does he like to lie on his back in a boat  
Like the lady who lived in that isle remote, Shalott.  
The Ahkond of Swat?

Is he quiet, or always making a fuss?  
Is his steward a Swiss or a Swede or a Russ, or a Scot,  
The Ahkond of Swat?

Does he like to sit by the calm blue wave?  
Or to sleep and snore in a dark green cave, or a Grott,

The Ahkond of Swat?

Does he drink small beer from a silver jug?  
Or a bowl? or a glass? or a cup? or a mug? or a Pot,  
The Ahkond of Swat?

Does he beat his wife with a gold-topped pipe,  
When she lets the gooseberries grow too ripe, or Rot,  
The Ahkond of Swat?

Does he wear a white tie when he dines with his friends,  
And tie it neat in a bow with ends, or a Knot,  
The Ahkond of Swat?

Does he like new cream, and hate mince-pies?  
When he looks at the sun does he wink his eyes, or Not,  
The Ahkond of Swat?

Does he teach his subjects to roast and bake?  
Does he sail about on an inland lake, in a Yacht,  
The Ahkond of Swat?

Some one, or nobody knows I wot  
Who or which or why or what  
Is the Ahkond of Swat!

*Edward Lear.*

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## THE AHKOOND OF SWAT

"The Ahkoond of Swat is dead."—London Papers of Jan. 22, 1878.

What, what, what,  
What's the news from Swat?  
Sad news,  
Bad news,  
Comes by the cable led

Through the Indian Ocean's bed,  
Through the Persian Gulf, the Red  
Sea and the Med-  
iterranean—he's dead;  
The Ahkoond is dead!

For the Ahkoond I mourn,  
Who wouldn't?  
He strove to disregard the message stern,  
But he Ahkoodn't.  
Dead, dead, dead:  
(Sorrow, Swats!)  
Swats wha hae wi' Ahkoond bled,  
Swats whom he hath often led  
Onward to a gory bed,  
Or to victory,  
As the case might be.  
Sorrow, Swats!  
Tears shed,  
Shed tears like water.  
Your great Ahkoond is dead!  
That Swats the matter!

Mourn, city of Swat,  
Your great Ahkoond is not,  
But laid 'mid worms to rot.  
His mortal part alone, his soul was caught  
(Because he was a good Ahkoond)  
Up to the bosom of Mahound.  
Though earthly walls his frame surround

(Forever hallowed by the ground!)

And skeptics mock the lowly mound

And say "He's now of no Ahkoond!"

His soul is in the skies—

The azure skies that bend above his loved

Metropolis of Swat.

He sees with larger, other eyes,

Athwart all earthly mysteries—

He knows what's Swat.

Let Swat bury the great Ahkoond

With a noise of mourning and of lamentation!

Let Swat bury the great Ahkoond

With the noise of the mourning of the Swattish nation!

Fallen is at length

Its tower of strength;

Its sun is dimmed ere it had nooned;

Dead lies the great Ahkoond,

The great Ahkoond of Swat

Is not!

*George Thomas Lanigan.*

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## **DIRGE OF THE MOOLLA OF KOTAL,**

### **RIVAL OF THE AKHOOND OF SWAT**

#### **I**

Alas, unhappy land; ill-fated spot

Kotal—though where or what

On earth Kotal is, the bard has forgot;

Further than this indeed he knoweth not—  
It borders upon Swat!

## II

When sorrows come, they come not single spies,  
But in battal-  
ions: the gloom that lay on Swat now lies  
Upon Kotal,  
On sad Kotal whose people ululate  
For their loved Moolla late.  
Put away his little turban,  
And his narghileh embrowned,  
The lord of Kotal—rural urban—  
'S gone unto his last Akhoond,  
'S gone to meet his rival Swattan,  
'S gone, indeed, but not forgotten.

## III

His rival, but in what?  
Wherein did the deceased Akhoond of Swat  
Kotal's lamented Moolla late,  
As it were, emulate?  
Was it in the tented field  
With crash of sword on shield,  
While backward meaner champions reeled  
And loud the tom-tom pealed?  
Did they barter gash for scar  
With the Persian scimeter  
Or the Afghanistee tulwar,  
While loud the tom-tom pealed—  
While loud the tom-tom pealed,  
And the jim-jam squealed,  
And champions less well heeled  
Their war-horses wheeled  
And fled the presence of these mortal big bugs o' the field?  
Was Kotal's proud citadel—  
Bastioned, walled, and demi-luned,

Beaten down with shot and shell  
By the guns of the Akhoond?  
Or were wails despairing caught, as  
The burghers pale of Swat  
Cried in panic, "Moolla ad Portas?"  
—Or what?  
Or made each in the cabinet his mark  
Kotalese Gortschakoff, Swattish Bismarck?  
Did they explain and render hazier  
The policies of Central Asia?  
Did they with speeches from the throne,  
Wars dynastic,  
*Entents cordiales*,  
Between Swat and Kotal;  
Holy alliances,  
And other appliances  
Of statesmen with morals and consciences plastic  
Come by much more than their own?  
Made they mots, as "There to-day is  
No more Himalayehs,"  
Or, if you prefer it, "There to-day are  
No more Himalaya?"  
Or, said the Akhoond, "Sah,  
L'Etat de Swat c'est moi?"  
Khabu, did there come great fear  
On thy Khabuldozed Ameer  
Ali Shere?  
Or did the Khan of far  
Kashgar  
Tremble at the menace hot  
Of the Moolla of Kotal,  
"I will extirpate thee, pal  
Of my foe the Akhoond of Swat?"  
Who knows  
Of Moolla and Akhoond aught more than I did?  
Namely, in life they rivals were, or foes,  
And in their deaths not very much divided?



If any one knows it,  
Let him disclose it!

*George Thomas Lanigan.*

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## THE BALLAD OF BOUILLABAISSE

A street there is in Paris famous,  
For which no rhyme our language yields,  
Rue Neuve des Petits Champs its name is—  
The New Street of the Little Fields.  
And here's an inn, not rich and splendid,  
But still in comfortable case;  
The which in youth I oft attended,  
To eat a bowl of Bouillabaisse.

This Bouillabaisse a noble dish is—  
A sort of soup, or broth, or brew,  
Or hotchpotch of all sorts of fishes,  
That Greenwich never could outdo:  
Green herbs, red peppers, mussels, saffron,  
Soles, onions, garlic, roach, and dace:  
All these you eat at Terré's tavern  
In that one dish of Bouillabaisse.

Indeed, a rich and savoury stew 'tis;  
And true philosophers, methinks,  
Who love all sorts of natural beauties,  
Should love good victuals and good drinks.  
And Cordelier or Benedictine  
Might gladly, sure, his lot embrace,  
Nor find a fast-day too afflicting,  
Which served him up a Bouillabaisse.

I wonder if the house still there is?  
Yes, here the lamp is, as before;  
The smiling red-cheeked *écaillère* is  
Still opening oysters at the door.  
Is Terré still alive and able?  
I recollect his droll grimace:  
He'd come and smile before your table,  
And hope you liked your Bouillabaisse.

We enter—nothing's changed or older.  
"How's Monsieur Terré, waiter, pray?"  
The waiter stares, and shrugs his shoulder—  
"Monsieur is dead this many a day."  
"It is the lot of saint and sinner,  
So honest Terré's run his race."  
"What will Monsieur require for dinner?"  
"Say, do you still cook Bouillabaisse?"

"Oh, oui, Monsieur," 's the waiter's answer;  
"Quel vin Monsieur désire-t-il?"  
"Tell me a good one."—"That I can, Sir:  
The Chambertin with yellow seal."  
"So Terré's gone," I say, and sink in  
My old accustom'd corner-place;  
"He's done with feasting and with drinking,  
With Burgundy and with Bouillabaisse."

My old accustom'd corner here is,  
The table still is in the nook;  
Ah! vanished many a busy year is  
This well-known chair since last I took.  
When first I saw ye, *cari luoghi*,  
I'd scarce a beard upon my face,  
And now a grizzled, grim old foggy,  
I sit and wait for Bouillabaisse.

Where are you, old companions trusty  
Of early days here met to dine?  
Come, waiter! quick, a flagon crusty—  
I'll pledge them in the good old wine.  
The kind old voices and old faces  
My memory can quick retrace;  
Around the board they take their places,  
And share the wine and Bouillabaisse.

There's Jack has made a wondrous marriage;  
There's laughing Tom is laughing yet;  
There's brave Augustus drives his carriage;  
There's poor old Fred in the *Gazette*;  
On James's head the grass is growing:  
Good Lord! the world has wagged apace  
Since here we set the claret flowing,  
And drank, and ate the Bouillabaisse.

Ah me! how quick the days are flitting!  
I mind me of a time that's gone,  
When here I'd sit, as now I'm sitting,  
In this same place—but not alone.  
A fair young form was nestled near me,  
A dear dear face looked fondly up,  
And sweetly spoke and smiled to cheer me  
—There's no one now to share my cup.

---

I drink it as the Fates ordain it.  
Come, fill it, and have done with rhymes:  
Fill up the lonely glass, and drain it  
In memory of dear old times.  
Welcome the wine, whate'er the seal is;  
And sit you down and say your grace  
With thankful heart, whate'er the meal is.  
—Here comes the smoking Bouillabaisse!

W. M. Thackeray.

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## OULD DOCTOR MACK

Ye may tramp the world over  
From Delhi to Dover,  
And sail the salt say from Archangel to Arragon,  
Circumvint back  
Through the whole Zodiack,  
But to ould Dochter Mack ye can't furnish a paragon.  
Have ye the dropsy,  
The gout, the autopsy?  
Fresh livers and limbs instantaneous he'll shape yez,  
No ways infarior  
In skill, but suparior,  
And lineal postarior to Ould Aysculapius.

### *Chorus*

He and his wig wid the curls so carroty,  
Aigle eye, and complexion clarety:  
Here's to his health,  
Honor and wealth,  
The king of his kind and the crame of all charity!

How the rich and the poor,  
To consult for a cure,  
Crowd on to his doore in their carts and their carriages,  
Showin' their tongues  
Or unlacin' their lungs,  
For divle one symptom the dochter disparages.  
Troth, an' he'll tumble,  
For high or for humble,  
From his warm feather-bed wid no cross contrariety;

Makin' as light  
Of nursin' all night  
The beggar in rags as the belle of society.

*Chorus*—He and his wig, etc.

And as if by a meracle,  
Ailments hysterical,  
Dad, wid one dose of bread-pills he can smother,  
And quench the love-sickness  
Wid wonderful quickness,  
By prescribin' the right boys and girls to aich other.  
And the sufferin' childer—  
Your eyes 'twould bewilder  
To see the wee craythurs his coat-tails unravellin',  
And aich of them fast  
On some treasure at last,  
Well knowin' ould Mack's just a toy-shop out travellin'.

*Chorus*—He and his wig, etc.

Thin, his doctherin' done,  
In a rollickin' run  
Wid the rod or the gun, he's the foremost to figure.  
By Jupiter Ammon,  
What jack-snipe or salmon  
E'er rose to backgammon his tail-fly or trigger!  
And hark! the view-hollo!  
'Tis Mack in full follow  
On black "Faugh-a-ballagh" the country-side sailin'.  
Och, but you'd think  
'Twas old Nimrod in pink,  
Wid his spurs cryin' chink over park-wall and palin'.

*Chorus*

He and his wig wid the curls so carroty,  
Aigle eye, and complexion clarety:  
    Here's to his health,  
    Honor and wealth!  
Hip, hip, hooray! wid all hilarity,  
Hip, hip, hooray! That's the way,  
All at once, widout disparity!  
    One more cheer  
    For our dochter dear,  
The king of his kind and the crame of all charity.  
    Hip, hip, hooray!

*Alfred Perceval Graves.*

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## **FATHER O'FLYNN**

Of priests we can offer a charmin' variety,  
Far renowned for larnin' and piety;  
Still, I'd advance ye, widout impropriety,  
    Father O'Flynn as the flower of them all.

### CHORUS

*Here's a health to you, Father O'Flynn,  
Slainté, and slainté, and slainté agin;  
    Powerfulest preacher, and  
    Tenderest teacher, and  
    Kindliest creature in ould Donegal.*

Don't talk of your Provost and Fellows of Trinity,  
Famous for ever at Greek and Latinity,  
Dad and the divels and all at Divinity,  
    Father O'Flynn 'd make hares of them all!

Come, I venture to give you my word,  
Never the likes of his logic was heard,  
Down from Mythology  
Into Thayology,  
Troth! and Conchology if he'd the call.

*Chorus*

Och! Father O'Flynn, you've the wonderful way wid you,  
All ould sinners are wishful to pray wid you,  
All the young childer are wild for to play wid you,  
You've such a way wid you, Father avick!  
Still for all you've so gentle a soul,  
Gad, you've your flock in the grandest control;  
Checking the crazy ones,  
Coaxin' onaisy ones,  
Liftin' the lazy ones on wid the stick.

*Chorus*

And though quite avoidin' all foolish frivolity,  
Still at all seasons of innocent jollity,  
Where was the play-boy could claim an equality  
At comicality, Father, wid you?  
Once the Bishop looked grave at your jest,  
Till this remark set him off wid the rest:  
"Is it lave gaiety  
All to the laity?  
Cannot the clargy be Irishmen too?"

*Chorus*

*Alfred Perceval Graves.*

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## THE BALD-HEADED TYRANT

O the quietest home in earth had I,  
    No thought of trouble, no hint of care;  
Like a dream of pleasure the days fled by,  
    And Peace had folded her pinions there.  
But one day there joined in our household band  
A bald-headed tyrant from No-man's-land.

Oh, the despot came in the dead of night,  
    And no one ventured to ask him why;  
Like slaves we trembled before his might,  
    Our hearts stood still when we heard him cry;  
For never a soul could his power withstand,  
That bald-headed tyrant from No-man's-land.

He ordered us here, and he sent us there—  
    Though never a word could his small lips speak—  
With his toothless gums and his vacant stare,  
    And his helpless limbs so frail and weak,  
Till I cried, in a voice of stern command,  
"Go up, thou bald-head from No-man's-land!"

But his abject slaves they turned on me;  
    Like the bears in Scripture, they'd rend me there,  
The while they worshiped with bended knee  
    This ruthless wretch with the missing hair;  
For he rules them all with relentless hand,  
This bald-headed tyrant from No-man's-land.

Then I searched for help in every clime,  
    For peace had fled from my dwelling now,  
Till I finally thought of old Father Time,  
    And low before him I made my bow.  
"Wilt thou deliver me out of his hand,  
This bald-headed tyrant from No-man's-land?"



Old Time he looked with a puzzled stare,  
And a smile came over his features grim.  
"I'll take the tyrant under my care:  
Watch what my hour-glass does to him.  
The veriest humbug that ever was planned  
Is this same bald-head from No-man's-land."

Old Time is doing his work full well—  
Much less of might does the tyrant wield;  
But, ah! with sorrow my heart will swell,  
And sad tears fall as I see him yield.  
Could I stay the touch of that shriveled hand,  
I would keep the bald-head from No-man's-land.

For the loss of peace I have ceased to care;  
Like other vassals, I've learned, forsooth,  
To love the wretch who forgot his hair  
And hurried along without a tooth,  
And he rules me too with his tiny hand,  
This bald-headed tyrant from No-man's-land.

*Mary E. Vandyne.*

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## **BARNEY McGEE**

Barney McGee, there's no end of good luck in you,  
Will-o'-the-wisp, with a flicker of Puck in you,  
Wild as a bull-pup, and all of his pluck in you—  
Let a man tread on your coat and he'll see!  
Eyes like the lakes of Killarney for clarity,  
Nose that turns up without any vulgarity,  
Smile like a cherub, and hair that is carrotty—

Whoop, you're a rarity, Barney McGee!  
Mellow as Tarragon,  
Prouder than Aragon—  
Hardly a paragon,  
You will agree—  
Here's all that's fine to you!  
Books and old wine to you!  
Girls be divine to you,  
Barney McGee!

Lucky the day when I met you unwittingly,  
Dining where vagabonds came and went flittingly.  
Here's some *Barbera* to drink it befittingly,  
That day at Silvio's, Barney McGee!  
Many's the time we have quaffed our Chianti there,  
Listened to Silvio quoting us Dante there—  
Once more to drink Nebiolo Spumante there,  
How we'd pitch Pommery into the sea!  
There where the gang of us  
Met ere Rome rang of us,  
They had the hang of us  
To a degree.  
How they would trust to you!  
That was but just to you.  
Here's o'er their dust to you,  
Barney McGee!

Barney McGee, when you're sober you scintillate,  
But when you're in drink you're the pride of the intellect;  
Divil a one of us ever came in till late,  
Once at the bar where you happened to be—  
Every eye there like a spoke in you centering,  
You with your eloquence, blarney, and bantering—  
All Vagabondia shouts at your entering,  
King of the Tenderloin, Barney McGee!  
There's no satiety  
In your society

With the variety  
Of your *esprit*.  
Here's a long purse to you,  
And a great thirst to you!  
Fate be no worse to you,  
Barney McGee!

Och, and the girls whose poor hearts you deracinate,  
Whirl and bewilder and flutter and fascinate!  
Faith, it's so killing you are, you assassinate—  
Murder's the word for you, Barney McGee!  
Bold when they're sunny, and smooth when they're showery—  
Oh, but the style of you, fluent and flowery!  
Chesterfield's way, with a touch of the Bowery!  
How, would they silence you, Barney machree?  
Naught can your gab allay,  
Learned as Rabelais  
(You in his abbey lay  
Once on the spree).  
Here's to the smile of you,  
(Oh, but the guile of you!)  
And a long while of you,  
Barney McGee!

Facile with phrases of length and Latinity,  
Like honorificabilitudinitary,  
Where is the maid could resist your vicinity,  
Wiled by the impudent grace of your plea?  
Then your vivacity and pertinacity  
Carry the day with the divil's audacity;  
No mere veracity robs your sagacity  
Of perspicacity, Barney McGee.  
When all is new to them,  
What will you do to them?  
Will you be true to them?  
Who shall decree?  
Here's a fair strife to you!

Health and long life to you!  
And a great wife to you, Barney McGee!

Barney McGee, you're the pick of gentility;  
Nothing can phase you, you've such a facility;  
Nobody ever yet found your utility—  
There is the charm of you, Barney McGee;  
Under conditions that others would stammer in,  
Still unperturbed as a cat or a Cameron,  
Polished as somebody in the Decameron,  
Putting the glamour on price or Pawnee.  
In your meanderin',  
Love and philanderin',  
Calm as a mandarin  
Sipping his tea!  
Under the art of you,  
Parcel and part of you,  
Here's to the heart of you,  
Barney McGee!

You who were ever alert to befriend a man,  
You who were ever the first to defend a man,  
You who had always the money to lend a man,  
Down on his luck and hard up for a V!  
Sure, you'll be playing a harp in beatitude  
(And a quare sight you will be in that attitude)—  
Some day, where gratitude seems but a platitude,  
You'll find your latitude, Barney McGee.  
That's no flim-flam at all,  
Frivol or sham at all,  
Just the plain—Damn it all,  
Have one with me!  
Here's one and more to you!  
Friends by the score to you,  
True to the core to you,  
Barney McGee!

*Richard Hovey.*

---

## **ADDRESS TO THE TOOTHACHE**

My curse upon your venom'd stang,  
That shoots my tortur'd gooms alang;  
An' thro' my lug gies monie a twang,  
                                    Wi' gnawing vengeance,  
Tearing my nerves wi' bitter pang,  
                                    Like racking engines!

A' down my beard the slavers trickle!  
I throw the wee stools o'er the mickle,  
While round the fire the giglets keckle  
                                    To see me loup;  
An', raving mad, I wish a heckle  
                                    Were i' their doup!

When fevers burn, or ague freezes,  
Rheumatics gnaw, or colic squeezes,  
Our neebors sympathize to ease us  
                                    Wi' pitying moan;  
But thee!—thou hell o' a' diseases,  
                                    They mock our groan!

Of a' the num'rous human dools,  
Ill-hairsts, daft bargains, cutty-stools,  
Or worthy frien's laid i' the mools,  
                                    Sad sight to see!  
The tricks o' knaves, or fash o' fools,  
                                    Thou bear'st the gree!

Whare'er that place be priests ca' hell,

Whare a' the tones o' misery yell,  
An' rankèd plagues their numbers tell  
                                    In dreadfu' raw,  
Thou, Toothache, surely bear'st the bell  
                                    Amang them a'!

O thou grim, mischief-making chiel,  
That gars the notes o' discord squeel,  
'Till humankind aft dance a reel  
                                    In gore a shoe-thick;—  
Gie a' the faes o' Scotland's weal  
                                    A towmond's toothache!

*Robert Burns.*

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## **A FAREWELL TO TOBACCO**

May the Babylonish curse  
Straight confound my stammering verse,  
If I can a passage see  
In this word-perplexity,  
Or a fit expression find,  
Or a language to my mind,  
(Still the phrase is wide or scant)  
To take leave of thee, *great plant!*

Or in any terms relate  
Half my love, or half my hate:  
For I hate, yet love thee so,  
That, whichever thing I show,  
The plain truth will seem to be  
A contrain'd hyperbole,  
And the passion to proceed

More from a mistress than a weed.

Sooty retainer to the vine,  
Bacchus' black servant, negro fine;  
Sorcerer, that mak'st us dote upon  
Thy begrimed complexion,  
And, for thy pernicious sake,  
More and greater oaths to break  
Than reclaimed lovers take  
'Gainst women: thou thy siege dost lay  
Much too in the female way,  
While thou suck'st the laboring breath  
Faster than kisses or than death.

Thou in such a cloud dost bind us  
That our worst foes cannot find us,  
And ill-fortune, that would thwart us,  
Shoots at rovers, shooting at us;  
While each man, through thy height'ning steam,  
Does like a smoking Etna seem,  
And all about us does express  
(Fancy and wit in richest dress)  
A Sicilian fruitfulness.

Thou through such a mist dost show us  
That our best friends do not know us,  
And, for those allowed features,  
Due to reasonable creatures,  
Liken'st us to fell Chimeras,  
Monsters,—that who see us, fear us;  
Worse than Cerberus or Geryon,  
Or, who first loved a cloud, Ixion.

Bacchus we know, and we allow  
His tipsy rites. But what art thou  
That but by reflex canst show  
What his deity can do,

As the false Egyptian spell  
Aped the true Hebrew miracle?  
Some few vapors thou may'st raise,  
The weak brain may serve to amaze,  
But to the reins and nobler heart  
Canst nor life nor heat impart.

Brother of Bacchus, later born,  
The old world was sure forlorn  
Wanting thee, that aidest more  
The god's victories than, before,  
All his panthers, and the brawls  
Of his piping Bacchanals.  
These, as stale, we disallow,  
Or judge of *thee* meant: only thou  
His true Indian conquest art;  
And, for ivy round his dart,  
The reformèd god now weaves  
A finer thyrsus of thy leaves.

Scent to match thy rich perfume  
Chemic art did ne'er presume  
Through her quaint alembic strain,  
None so sov'reign to the brain;  
Nature, that did in thee excel,  
Framed again no second smell,  
Roses, violets, but toys  
For the smaller sort of boys,  
Or for greener damsels meant;  
Thou art the only manly scent.

Stinkingest of the stinking kind!  
Filth of the mouth and fog of the mind!  
Africa, that brags her foison,  
Breeds no such prodigious poison!  
Henbane, nightshade, both together,  
Hemlock, aconite—



Nay, rather,

Plant divine, of rarest virtue;  
Blisters on the tongue would hurt you!  
'Twas but in a sort I blamed thee;  
None e'er prosper'd who defamed thee;  
Irony all, and feign'd abuse,  
Such as perplex'd lovers use,  
At a need, when, in despair  
To paint forth their fairest fair,  
Or in part but to express  
That exceeding comeliness  
Which their fancies doth so strike,  
They borrow language of dislike;  
And, instead of Dearest Miss,  
Jewel, Honey, Sweetheart, Bliss,  
And those forms of old admiring,  
Call her Cockatrice and Siren,  
Basilisk, and all that's evil,  
Witch, Hyena, Mermaid, Devil,  
Ethiop, Wench, and Blackamoor,  
Monkey, Ape, and twenty more;  
Friendly Trait'ress, loving Foe—  
Not that she is truly so,  
But no other way they know  
A contentment to express,  
Borders so upon excess,  
That they do not rightly wot  
Whether it be from pain or not.

Or, as men constrain'd to part  
With what's nearest to their heart,  
While their sorrow's at the height,  
Lose discrimination quite,  
And their hasty wrath let fall,  
To appease their frantic gall,  
On the darling thing whatever,

Whence they feel it death to sever  
Though it be, as they, perforce,  
Guiltless of the sad divorce.

For I must (nor let it grieve thee,  
Friendliest of plants, that I must) leave thee.  
For thy sake, TOBACCO, I  
Would do anything but die,  
And but seek to extend my days  
Long enough to sing thy praise.  
But, as she who once hath been  
A king's consort is a queen  
Ever after, nor will bate  
Any tittle of her state  
Though a widow, or divorced,  
So I, from thy converse forced,  
The old name and style retain,  
A right Katherine of Spain;  
And a seat, too, 'mongst the joys  
Of the blest Tobacco Boys;  
Where, though I, by sour physician,  
Am debarr'd the full fruition  
Of thy favors, I may catch  
Some collateral sweets, and snatch  
Sidelong odors, that give life  
Like glances from a neighbor's wife;  
And still live in the by-places  
And the suburbs of thy graces;  
And in thy borders take delight,  
An unconquer'd Canaanite.

*Charles Lamb.*

---

**JOHN BARLEYCORN**

There were three kings into the east,  
Three kings both great and high;  
And they hae sworn a solemn oath  
John Barleycorn should die.

They took a plough and plough'd him down,  
Put clods upon his head;  
And they hae sworn a solemn oath  
John Barleycorn was dead.

But the cheerful spring came kindly on,  
And showers began to fall:  
John Barleycorn got up again,  
And sore surprised them all.

The sultry suns of summer came,  
And he grew thick and strong;  
His head weel arm'd wi' pointed spears,  
That no one should him wrong.

The sober autumn enter'd mild,  
When he grew wan and pale;  
His bending joints and drooping head  
Show'd he began to fail.

His colour sicken'd more and more,  
He faded into age;  
And then his enemies began  
To show their deadly rage.

They've ta'en a weapon, long and sharp,  
And cut him by the knee;  
Then tied him fast upon a cart,  
Like a rogue for forgerie.

They laid him down upon his back,

And cudgell'd him full sore;  
They hung him up before the storm,  
And turn'd him o'er and o'er.

They fillèd up a darksome pit  
With water to the brim:  
They heavèd in John Barleycorn,  
There let him sink or swim.

They laid him out upon the floor,  
To work him further woe:  
And still, as signs of life appear'd,  
They toss'd him to and fro.

They wasted o'er a scorching flame  
The marrow of his bones;  
But a miller used him worst of all—  
He crush'd him 'tween two stones.

And they hae ta'en his very heart's blood,  
And drank it round and round,  
And still the more and more they drank,  
Their joy did more abound.

John Barleycorn was a hero bold,  
Of noble enterprise;  
For if you do but taste his blood,  
'Twill make your courage rise.

'Twill make a man forget his woe;  
'Twill heighten all his joy:  
'Twill make the widow's heart to sing,  
Though the tear were in her eye.

Then let us toast John Barleycorn,  
Each man a glass in hand;

And may his great posterity  
Ne'er fail in old Scotland!

*Robert Burns.*

---

## STANZAS TO PALE ALE

Oh! I have loved thee fondly, ever  
Preferr'd thee to the choicest wine;  
From thee my lips they could not sever  
By saying thou contain'dst strychnine.  
Did I believe the slander? Never!  
I held thee still to be divine.

For me thy color hath a charm,  
Although 'tis true they call thee Pale;  
And be thou cold when I am warm,  
As late I've been—so high the scale  
Of FAHRENHEIT—and febrile harm  
Allay, refrigerating Ale!

How sweet thou art!—yet bitter, too  
And sparkling, like satiric fun;  
But how much better thee to brew,  
Than a conundrum or a pun,  
It is, in every point of view,  
Must be allow'd by every one.

Refresh my heart and cool my throat,  
Light, airy child of malt and hops!  
That dost not stuff, engross, and bloat  
The skin, the sides, the chin, the chops,

And burst the buttons off the coat,  
Like stout and porter—fattening slops!

*Unknown.*

---

## ODE TO TOBACCO

Thou who, when fears attack,  
Bidst them avaunt, and Black  
Care, at the horseman's back  
Perching, unseatest;  
Sweet, when the morn is gray;  
Sweet, when they've cleared away  
Lunch; and at close of day  
Possibly sweetest:

I have a liking old  
For thee, though manifold  
Stories, I know, are told,  
Not to thy credit;  
How one (or two at most)  
Drops make a cat a ghost—  
Useless, except to roast—  
Doctors have said it:

How they who use fusees  
All grow by slow degrees  
Brainless as chimpanzees,  
Meagre as lizards;  
Go mad, and beat their wives;  
Plunge (after shocking lives)  
Razors and carving knives  
Into their gizzards.

Confound such knavish tricks!  
Yet know I five or six  
Smokers who freely mix  
Still with their neighbors;  
Jones—(who, I'm glad to say,  
Asked leave of Mrs. J.)—  
Daily absorbs a clay  
After his labors.

Cats may have had their goose  
Cooked by tobacco-juice;  
Still why deny its use  
Thoughtfully taken?  
We're not as tabbies are:  
Smith, take a fresh cigar!  
Jones, the tobacco-jar!  
Here's to thee, Bacon!

*Charles Stuart Calverley.*

---

## **SONNET TO A CLAM**

### **DUM TACENT CLAIMANT**

Inglorious friend! most confident I am  
Thy life is one of very little ease;  
Albeit men mock thee with their similes  
And prate of being "happy as a clam!"  
What though thy shell protects thy fragile head  
From the sharp bailiffs of the briny sea?  
Thy valves are, sure, no safety-valves to thee,  
While rakes are free to desecrate thy bed,

And bear thee off—as foemen take their spoil—  
Far from thy friends and family to roam;  
Forced, like a Hessian, from thy native home,  
To meet destruction in a foreign broil!  
Though thou art tender yet thy humble bard  
Declares, O clam! thy case is shocking hard!

*John G. Saxe.*

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## TO A FLY

### TAKEN OUT OF A BOWL OF PUNCH

Ah! poor intoxicated little knave,  
Now senseless, floating on the fragrant wave;  
Why not content the cakes alone to munch?  
Dearly thou pay'st for buzzing round the bowl;  
Lost to the world, thou busy sweet-lipped soul—  
Thus Death, as well as Pleasure, dwells with Punch.

Now let me take thee out, and moralize—  
Thus 'tis with mortals, as it is with flies,  
Forever hankering after Pleasure's cup:  
Though Fate, with all his legions, be at hand,  
The beasts, the draught of Circe can't withstand,  
But in goes every nose—they must, will sup.

Mad are the passions, as a colt untamed!  
When Prudence mounts their backs to ride them mild.  
They fling, they snort, they foam, they rise inflamed,  
Insisting on their own sole will so wild.

Gadsbud! my buzzing friend, thou art not dead;



The Fates, so kind, have not yet snapped thy thread;  
By heavens, thou mov'st a leg, and now its brother.  
And kicking, lo, again, thou mov'st another!

And now thy little drunken eyes uncloze,  
And now thou feelest for thy little nose,  
And, finding it, thou rubbest thy two hands  
Much as to say, "I'm glad I'm here again."  
And well mayest thou rejoice—'tis very plain,  
That near wert thou to Death's unsocial lands.

And now thou rollest on thy back about,  
Happy to find thyself alive, no doubt—  
Now turnest—on the table making rings,  
Now crawling, forming a wet track,  
Now shaking the rich liquor from thy back,  
Now fluttering nectar from thy silken wings.

Now standing on thy head, thy strength to find,  
And poking out thy small, long legs behind;  
And now thy pinions dost thou briskly ply;  
Preparing now to leave me—farewell, fly!

Go, join thy brothers on yon sunny board,  
And rapture to thy family afford—  
There wilt thou meet a mistress, or a wife,  
That saw thee drunk, drop senseless in the stream.  
Who gave, perhaps, the wide-resounding scream,  
And now sits groaning for thy precious life.

Yes, go and carry comfort to thy friends,  
And wisely tell them thy imprudence ends.  
Let buns and sugar for the future charm;  
These will delight, and feed, and work no harm—

While Punch, the grinning, merry imp of sin,  
Invites th' unwary wanderer to a kiss,

Smiles in his face, as though he meant him bliss,  
Then, like an alligator, drags him in.  
Then, like an alligator, drags him in.

*John Wolcot.*

---

## ODE TO A BOBTAILED CAT

Felis Infelix! Cat unfortunate,  
With nary narrative!  
Canst thou no tail relate  
Of how  
(Miaow!)  
Thy tail end came to terminate so bluntly  
Didst wear it off by  
Sedentary habits  
As do the rabbits?

Didst go a  
Fishing with it,  
Wishing with it  
To "bob" for catfish,  
And get bobbed thyself?  
Curses on that fish!

Didst lose it in kittenhood,  
Hunggrily chawing it?  
Or, gaily pursuing it,  
Did it make tangent  
From thy swift circuit?

Did some brother Greyback—  
Yowling

And howling  
In nocturnal strife,  
Spitting and staring  
Cursing and swearing,  
Ripping and tearing,  
Calling thee "Sausagetail,"  
Abbreviate thy suffix?

Or did thy jealous wife  
Detect yer  
In some sly flirtation,  
And, after caudal lecture,  
Bite off thy termination?  
And sarve yer right!

Did some mischievous boy,  
Some barbarous boy,  
Eliminate thy finis?  
(Probably!)  
The wretch!  
The villain!  
Cruelly spillin'  
Thy innocent blood!

Furiously scratch him  
Where'er yer may catch him!

Well, Bob, this course now is left,  
Since thus of your tail you're bereft:  
Tell your friend that by letter  
From Paris  
You have learned the style there is  
To wear the tail short,  
And the briefer the better;  
Such is the passion,  
That every Grimalkin will  
Follow your fashion.

*Unknown.*

---

**A DIRGE**  
**CONCERNING THE LATE LAMENTED KING OF THE**  
**CANNIBAL ISLANDS**

And so our royal relative is dead!  
And so he rests from gustatory labors!  
The white man was his choice, but when he fed  
He'd sometimes entertain his tawny neighbors.  
He worshipped, as he said, his "Fe-fo-fum,"  
The goddess of the epigastrium.

And missionaries graced his festive board,  
Solemn and succulent, in twos and dozens,  
And smoked before their hospitable lord,  
Welcome as if they'd been his second cousins.  
When cold, he warmed them as he would his kin—  
They came as strangers, and he took them in.

And generous!—oh, wasn't he? I have known him  
Exhibit a celestial amiability:—  
He'd eat an enemy, and then would own him  
Of flavor excellent, despite hostility.  
The crudest captain of the Turkish navy  
He buried in an honorable grave—y.

He had a hundred wives. To make things pleasant  
They found it quite judicious to adore him;—  
And when he dined, the nymphs were always present—  
Sometimes beside him and sometimes—before him.

When he was tired of one, he called her "sweet,"  
And told her she was "good enough to eat."

He was a man of taste—and justice, too;  
He opened his mouth for e'en the humblest sinner,  
And three weeks stall-fed an emaciate Jew  
Before they brought him to the royal dinner.  
With preacher-men he shared his board and wallet  
And let them nightly occupy his palate!

We grow like what we eat. Bad food depresses;  
Good food exalts us like an inspiration,  
And missionary on the *menu* blesses  
And elevates the Feejee population.  
A people who for years, saints, bairns, and women ate  
Must soon their vilest qualities eliminate.

But the deceased could never hold a candle  
To those prim, pale-faced people of propriety  
Who gloat o'er gossip and get fat on scandal—  
The cannibals of civilized society;  
They drink the blood of brothers with their rations,  
And crunch the bones of living reputations.

They kill the soul; he only claimed the dwelling.  
They take the sharpened scalpel of surmises  
And cleave the sinews when the heart is swelling,  
And slaughter Fame and Honor for their prizes.  
They make the spirit in the body quiver;  
They quench the Light! He only took the—Liver!

I've known some hardened customers, I wot,  
A few tough fellows—pagans beyond question—  
I wish had got into his dinner-pot;  
Although I'm certain they'd defy digestion,  
And break his jaw, and ruin his esophagus,  
Were he the chief of beings anthropophagous!

How fond he was of children! To his breast  
The tenderest nurslings gained a free admission.  
Rank he despised, nor, if they came well dressed,  
Cared if they were plebeian or patrician.  
Shade of Leigh Hunt! Oh, guide this laggard pen  
To write of one who loved his fellow men!

*William Augustus Croffut.*

---



# WHIMSEY

## AN ELEGY

### ON THE GLORY OF HER SEX, MRS. MARY BLAIZE

Good people all, with one accord,  
Lament for Madam Blaize,  
Who never wanted a good word—  
From those who spoke her praise.

The needy seldom pass'd her door,  
And always found her kind;  
She freely lent to all the poor—  
Who left a pledge behind.

She strove the neighborhood to please  
With manners wondrous winning;  
And never follow'd wicked ways—  
Unless when she was sinning.

At church, in silks and satins new,  
With hoop of monstrous size,  
She never slumber'd in her pew—  
But when she shut her eyes.

Her love was sought, I do aver,  
By twenty beaux and more;  
The King himself has follow'd her—  
When she has walk'd before.

But now, her wealth and finery fled,



Her hangers-on cut short all;  
The doctors found, when she was dead—  
Her last disorder mortal.  
  
Let us lament, in sorrow sore,  
For Kent Street well may say,  
That had she lived a twelvemonth more  
She had not died to-day.

*Oliver Goldsmith.*

---

## PARSON GRAY

A quiet home had Parson Gray,  
Secluded in a vale;  
His daughters all were feminine,  
And all his sons were male.

How faithfully did Parson Gray  
The bread of life dispense—  
Well "posted" in theology,  
And post and rail his fence.

'Gainst all the vices of the age  
He manfully did battle;  
His chickens were a biped breed,  
And quadruped his cattle.

No clock more punctually went,  
He ne'er delayed a minute—  
Nor ever empty was his purse,  
When he had money in it.

His piety was ne'er denied;  
His truths hit saint and sinner;  
At morn he always breakfasted;  
He always dined at dinner.

He ne'er by any luck was grieved,  
By any care perplexed—  
No filcher he, though when he preached,  
He always "took" a text.

As faithful characters he drew  
As mortal ever saw;  
But ah! poor parson! when he died,  
His breath he could not draw!

*Oliver Goldsmith.*

---

## **THE IRISHMAN AND THE LADY**

There was a lady liv'd at Leith,  
A lady very stylish, man;  
And yet, in spite of all her teeth,  
She fell in love with an Irishman—  
A nasty, ugly Irishman,  
A wild, tremendous Irishman,  
A tearing, swearing, thumping, bumping, ranting, roaring Irishman.

His face was no ways beautiful,  
For with small-pox 'twas scarr'd across;  
And the shoulders of the ugly dog  
Were almost double a yard across.  
Oh, the lump of an Irishman,  
The whiskey-devouring Irishman,

The great he-rogue with his wonderful brogue—the fighting, rioting  
Irishman!

One of his eyes was bottle-green,  
And the other eye was out, my dear;  
And the calves of his wicked-looking legs  
Were more than two feet about, my dear.  
Oh, the great big Irishman,  
The rattling, battling Irishman—  
The stamping, ramping, swaggering, staggering, leathering swash of an  
Irishman!

He took so much of Lundy-foot  
That he used to snort and snuffle—O!  
And in shape and size the fellow's neck  
Was as bad as the neck of a buffalo.  
Oh, the horrible Irishman,  
The thundering, blundering Irishman—  
The slashing, dashing, smashing, lashing, thrashing, hashing Irishman!

His name was a terrible name, indeed,  
Being Timothy Thady Mulligan;  
And whenever he emptied his tumbler of punch  
He'd not rest till he fill'd it full again.  
The boosing, bruising Irishman,  
The 'toxicated Irishman—  
The whiskey, frisky, rummy, gummy, brandy, no dandy Irishman!

This was the lad the lady lov'd,  
Like all the girls of quality;  
And he broke the skulls of the men of Leith,  
Just by the way of jollity.  
Oh, the leathering Irishman,  
The barbarous, savage Irishman—  
The hearts of the maids, and the gentlemen's heads, were bothered, I'm  
sure, by this Irishman!

*William Maginn.*

---

## THE CATARACT OF LODORE

"How does the water  
Come down at Lodore?"  
My little boy asked me  
Thus, once on a time;  
And moreover he tasked me  
To tell him in rhyme.  
Anon at the word,  
There first came one daughter,  
And then came another,  
To second and third  
The request of their brother,  
And to hear how the water  
Comes down at Lodore,  
With its rush and its roar,  
As many a time  
They had seen it before.  
So I told them in rhyme,  
For of rhymes I had store;  
And 'twas in my vocation  
For their recreation  
That so I should sing;  
Because I was Laureate  
To them and the King.

From its sources which well  
In the tarn on the fell;  
From its fountains  
In the mountains,  
Its rills and its gills;  
Through moss and through brake,  
It runs and it creeps  
For a while till it sleeps

In its own little lake.  
And thence at departing,  
Awakening and starting,  
It runs through the reeds,  
And away it proceeds,  
Through meadow and glade,  
In sun and in shade,  
And through the wood-shelter,  
Among crags in its flurry,  
Helter-skelter,  
Hurry-scurry,  
Here it comes sparkling,  
And there it lies darkling;  
Now smoking and frothing  
Its tumult and wrath in,  
Till, in this rapid race  
On which it is bent,  
It reaches the place  
Of its steep descent.

The cataract strong  
Then plunges along,  
Striking and raging  
As if a war waging  
Its caverns and rocks among;  
Rising and leaping,  
Sinking and creeping,  
Swelling and sweeping,  
Showering and springing,  
Flying and flinging,  
Writhing and wringing,  
Eddying and whisking,  
Spouting and frisking,  
Turning and twisting  
Around and around  
With endless rebound:  
Smiting and fighting,

A sight to delight in;  
Confounding, astounding,  
Dizzying and deafening the ear with its sound.

Collecting, projecting,  
Receding and speeding,  
And shocking and rocking,  
And darting and parting,  
And threading and spreading,  
And whizzing and hissing,  
And dripping and skipping,  
And hitting and splitting,  
And shining and twining,  
And rattling and battling,  
And shaking and quaking,  
And pouring and roaring,  
And waving and raving,  
And tossing and crossing,  
And flowing and going,  
And running and stunning,  
And foaming and roaming,  
And dinning and spinning,  
And dropping and hopping,  
And working and jerking,  
And guggling and struggling,  
And heaving and cleaving,  
And moaning and groaning;  
And glittering and frittering,  
And gathering and feathering,  
And whitening and brightening,  
And quivering and shivering,  
And hurrying and skurrying,  
And thundering and floundering;

Dividing and gliding and sliding,  
And falling and brawling and sprawling,  
And driving and riving and striving,

And sprinkling and twinkling and wrinkling,  
And sounding and bounding and rounding,  
And bubbling and troubling and doubling,  
And grumbling and rumbling and tumbling,  
And clattering and battering and shattering;

Retreating and beating and meeting and sheeting,  
Delaying and straying and playing and spraying.  
Advancing and prancing and glancing and dancing,  
Recoiling, turmoiling and toiling and boiling,  
And gleaming and streaming and steaming and beaming,  
And rushing and flushing and brushing and gushing,  
And flapping and rapping and clapping and slapping,  
And curling and whirling and purling and twirling,  
And thumping and plumping and bumping and jumping,  
And dashing and flashing and splashing and clashing;  
And so never ending, but always descending,  
Sounds and motions forever and ever are blending,  
All at once and all o'er, with a mighty uproar,—  
And this way the water comes down at Lodore.

*Robert Southey.*

---

## LAY OF THE DESERTED INFLUENZAED

Doe, doe!  
I shall dever see her bore!  
Dever bore our feet shall rove  
The beadows as of yore!  
Dever bore with byrtle boughs  
Her tresses shall I twide—  
Dever bore her bellow voice  
Bake bellody with bide!

Dever shall we lidger bore,  
Abid the flow'rs at dood,  
Dever shall we gaze at dight  
Upon the tedtder bood!  
Ho, doe, doe!  
Those berry tibes have flowd,  
Ad I shall dever see her bore,  
By beautiful! by owd!  
Ho, doe, doe!  
I shall dever see her bore,  
She will forget be id a bonth,  
(Bost probably before)—  
She will forget the byrtle boughs,  
The flow'rs we plucked at dood,  
Our beetigs by the tedtder stars.  
Our gazigs at the bood.  
Ad I shall dever see agaid  
The Lily and the Rose;  
The dabask cheek! the sdowy brow!  
The perfect bouth ad dose!  
Ho, doe, doe!  
Those berry tibes have flowd—  
Ad I shall dever see her bore,  
By beautiful! by owd!!

*H. Cholmondeley-Pennell.*

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## **BELAGCHOLLY DAYS**

Chilly Dovebber with his boadigg blast  
Dow cubs add strips the beddow add the lawd,  
Eved October's suddy days are past—  
Add Subber's gawd!



I kdown dot what it is to which I cligg  
That stirs to sogg add sorrow, yet I trust  
That still I sigg, but as the liddets sigg—  
Because I bust.

Add dow, farewell to roses add to birds,  
To larded fields and tigkligg streablets eke;  
Farewell to all articulated words  
I faid would speak.

Farewell, by cherished strolliggs od the sward,  
Greed glades add forest shades, farewell to you;  
With sorrowing heart I, wretched add forlord,  
Bid you—achew!!!

*Unknown.*

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## **RHYME OF THE RAIL**

Singing through the forests,  
Rattling over ridges,  
Shooting under arches,  
Rumbling over bridges,  
Whizzing through the mountains,  
Buzzing o'er the vale—  
Bless me! this is pleasant,  
Riding on the Rail!

Men of different "stations"  
In the eye of Fame  
Here are very quickly  
Coming to the same.

High and lowly people,  
Birds of every feather,  
On a common level  
Travelling together.

Gentleman in shorts,  
Looming very tall;  
Gentleman at large,  
Talking very small;  
Gentleman in tights,  
With a loose-ish mien;  
Gentleman in grey,  
Looking rather green;

Gentleman quite old,  
Asking for the news;  
Gentleman in black,  
In a fit of blues;  
Gentleman in claret,  
Sober as a vicar;  
Gentleman in tweed,  
Dreadfully in liquor!

Stranger on the right,  
Looking very sunny,  
Obviously reading  
Something very funny.  
Now the smiles are thicker,  
Wonder what they mean?  
Faith, he's got the KNICKER-  
BOCKER MAGAZINE!

Stranger on the left,  
Closing up his peepers;  
Now he snores again,  
Like the Seven Sleepers;  
At his feet a volume

Gives the explanation,  
How the man grew stupid  
From "Association."

Ancient maiden lady  
Anxiously remarks,  
That there must be peril  
'Mong so many sparks;  
Roguish-looking fellow,  
Turning to the stranger,  
Says it's his opinion  
*She* is out of danger!

Woman with her baby,  
Sitting *vis-à-vis*,  
Baby keeps a-squalling,  
Woman looks at me;  
Asks about the distance,  
Says it's tiresome talking,  
Noises of the cars  
Are so very shocking!

Market-woman, careful  
Of the precious casket,  
Knowing eggs are eggs,  
Tightly holds her basket;  
Feeling that a smash,  
If it came, would surely  
Send her eggs to pot  
Rather prematurely.

Singing through the forests,  
Rattling over ridges,  
Shooting under arches,  
Rumbling over bridges,  
Whizzing through the mountains,  
Buzzing o'er the vale;

Bless me! this is pleasant,  
Riding on the Rail!

*John G. Saxe.*

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## ECHO

I asked of Echo, t'other day  
    (Whose words are often few and funny),  
What to a novice she could say  
    Of courtship, love, and matrimony.  
Quoth Echo plainly,— "Matter-o'-money!"

Whom should I marry? Should it be  
    A dashing damsel, gay and pert,  
A pattern of inconstancy;  
    Or selfish, mercenary flirt?  
Quoth Echo, sharply,— "Nary flirt!"

What if, aweary of the strife  
    That long has lured the dear deceiver,  
She promise to amend her life,  
    And sin no more; can I believe her?  
Quoth Echo, very promptly,— "Leave her!"

But if some maiden with a heart  
    On me should venture to bestow it,  
Pray, should I act the wiser part  
    To take the treasure or forego it?  
Quoth Echo, with decision,— "Go it!"

But what if, seemingly afraid  
    To bind her fate in Hymen's fetter,

She vow she means to die a maid,  
In answer to my loving letter?  
Quoth Echo, rather coolly,— "Let her!"

What if, in spite of her disdain,  
I find my heart intertwined about  
With Cupid's dear delicious chain  
So closely that I can't get out?  
Quoth Echo, laughingly,— "Get out!"

But if some maid with beauty blest,  
As pure and fair as Heaven can make her,  
Will share my labor and my rest  
Till envious Death shall overtake her?  
Quoth Echo (*sotto voce*),—"Take her!"

*John G. Saxe.*

---

## SONG

Echo, tell me, while I wander  
O'er this fairy plain to prove him,  
If my shepherd still grows fonder,  
Ought I in return to love him?  
Echo: Love him, love him!

If he loves, as is the fashion,  
Should I churlishly forsake him?  
Or in pity to his passion,  
Fondly to my bosom take him?  
Echo: Take him, take him!

Thy advice then, I'll adhere to,

Since in Cupid's chains I've led him;  
And with Henry shall not fear to  
Marry, if you answer, "Wed him!"  
Echo: Wed him, wed him!

*Joseph Addison.*

---

## A GENTLE ECHO ON WOMAN

### IN THE DORIC MANNER

*Shepherd.* Echo, I ween, will in the woods reply,  
And quaintly answer questions: shall I try?  
*Echo.* Try.  
*Shepherd.* What must we do our passion to express?  
*Echo.* Press.  
*Shepherd.* How shall I please her, who ne'er loved before?  
*Echo.* Before.  
*Shepherd.* What most moves women when we them address?  
*Echo.* A dress.  
*Shepherd.* Say, what can keep her chaste whom I adore?  
*Echo.* A door.  
*Shepherd.* If music softens rocks, love tunes my lyre.  
*Echo.* Liar.  
*Shepherd.* Then teach me, Echo, how shall I come by her?  
*Echo.* Buy her.  
*Shepherd.* When bought, no question I shall be her dear?  
*Echo.* Her deer.  
*Shepherd.* But deer have horns: how must I keep her under?  
*Echo.* Keep her under.  
*Shepherd.* But what can glad me when she's laid on bier?  
*Echo.* Beer.  
*Shepherd.* What must I do so women will be kind?

|                  |                                                                                         |                 |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| <i>Echo.</i>     |                                                                                         | Be kind.        |
| <i>Shepherd.</i> | What must I do when women will be cross?                                                |                 |
| <i>Echo.</i>     |                                                                                         | Be cross.       |
| <i>Shepherd.</i> | Lord, what is she that can so turn and wind?                                            |                 |
| <i>Echo.</i>     |                                                                                         | Wind.           |
| <i>Shepherd.</i> | If she be wind, what stills her when she blows?                                         |                 |
| <i>Echo.</i>     |                                                                                         | Blows.          |
| <i>Shepherd.</i> | But if she bang again, still should I bang her?                                         |                 |
| <i>Echo.</i>     |                                                                                         | Bang her.       |
| <i>Shepherd.</i> | Is there no way to moderate her anger?                                                  |                 |
| <i>Echo.</i>     |                                                                                         | Hang her.       |
| <i>Shepherd.</i> | Thanks, gentle Echo! right thy answers tell<br>What woman is and how to guard her well. |                 |
| <i>Echo.</i>     |                                                                                         | Guard her well. |

*Dean Swift.*

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## LAY OF ANCIENT ROME

Oh, the Roman was a rogue,  
 He erat was, you bettum;  
 He ran his automobilus  
 And smoked his cigarettum.  
 He wore a diamond studibus  
 And elegant cravattum,  
 A maxima cum laude shirt  
 And such a stylish hattum!

He loved the luscious hic-haec-hoc,  
 And bet on games and equi;  
 At times he won at others though,  
 He got it in the nequi;  
 He winked, (quo usque tandem?) at

Puellas on the Forum,  
And sometimes, too, he even made  
Those goo-goo oculorum!

He frequently was seen  
At combats gladiatorial  
And ate enough to feed  
Ten boarders at Memorial;  
He often went on sprees  
And said, on starting homus,  
"Hic labour—opus est,  
Oh, where's my hic—hic—domus?"

Although he lived in Rome,—  
Of all the arts the middle—  
He was, (excuse the phrase,)  
A horrid individ'l;  
Ah, what a different thing  
Was the homo (dative, hominy)  
Of far away B. C.  
From us of Anno Domini.

*Thomas R. Ybarra.*

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## **A NEW SONG OF NEW SIMILES**

My passion is as mustard strong;  
I sit all sober sad;  
Drunk as a piper all day long,  
Or like a March-hare mad.



Round as a hoop the bumpers flow;  
I drink, yet can't forget her;  
For though as drunk as David's sow  
I love her still the better.

Pert as a pear-monger I'd be,  
If Molly were but kind;  
Cool as a cucumber could see  
The rest of womankind.

Like a stuck pig I gaping stare,  
And eye her o'er and o'er;  
Lean as a rake, with sighs and care,  
Sleek as a mouse before.

Plump as a partridge was I known,  
And soft as silk my skin;  
My cheeks as fat as butter grown,  
But as a goat now thin!

I melancholy as a cat,  
Am kept awake to weep;  
But she, insensible of that,  
Sound as a top can sleep.

Hard is her heart as flint or stone,  
She laughs to see me pale;  
And merry as a grig is grown,  
And brisk as bottled ale.

The god of Love at her approach  
Is busy as a bee;  
Hearts sound as any bell or roach,  
Are smit and sigh like me.

Ah me! as thick as hops or hail  
The fine men crowd about her;

But soon as dead as a door-nail  
Shall I be, if without her.

Straight as my leg her shape appears,  
O were we join'd together!  
My heart would be scot-free from cares,  
And lighter than a feather.

As fine as five-pence is her mien,  
No drum was ever tighter;  
Her glance is as the razor keen,  
And not the sun is brighter.

As soft as pap her kisses are,  
Methinks I taste them yet;  
Brown as a berry is her hair,  
Her eyes as black as jet.

As smooth as glass, as white as curds  
Her pretty hand invites;  
Sharp as her needle are her words,  
Her wit like pepper bites.

Brisk as a body-louse she trips,  
Clean as a penny drest;  
Sweet as a rose her breath and lips,  
Round as the globe her breast.

Full as an egg was I with glee,  
And happy as a king:  
Good Lord! how all men envied me!  
She loved like any thing.

But false as hell, she, like the wind,  
Chang'd, as her sex must do;  
Though seeming as the turtle kind,  
And like the gospel true.

If I and Molly could agree,  
Let who would take Peru!  
Great as an Emperor should I be,  
And richer than a Jew.

Till you grow tender as a chick,  
I'm dull as any post;  
Let us like burs together stick,  
And warm as any toast.

You'll know me truer than a die,  
And wish me better sped;  
Flat as a flounder when I lie,  
And as a herring dead.

Sure as a gun she'll drop a tear  
And sigh, perhaps, and wish,  
When I am rotten as a pear,  
And mute as any fish.

*John Gay.*

---

## **THE AMERICAN TRAVELLER**

To Lake Aghmoogenegamook  
All in the State of Maine,  
A man from Wittequergauma came  
One evening in the rain.

"I am a traveller," said he,  
"Just started on a tour,  
And go to Nomjamskillicook

To-morrow morn at four."

He took a tavern-bed that night,  
And, with the morrow's sun,  
By way of Sekledobskus went,  
With carpet-bag and gun.

A week passed on, and next we find  
Our native tourist come  
To that sequestered village called  
Genasagarnagum.

From thence he went to Absequoit,  
And there—quite tired of Maine—  
He sought the mountains of Vermont,  
Upon a railroad train.

Dog Hollow, in the Green Mount State,  
Was his first stopping-place;  
And then Skunk's Misery displayed  
Its sweetness and its grace.

By easy stages then he went  
To visit Devil's Den;  
And Scrabble Hollow, by the way,  
Did come within his ken.

Then *via* Nine Holes and Goose Green  
He travelled through the State;  
And to Virginia, finally,  
Was guided by his fate.

Within the Old Dominion's bounds,  
He wandered up and down;  
To-day at Buzzard's Roost ensconced,  
To-morrow, at Hell Town.

At Pole Cat, too, he spent a week,  
Till friends from Bull Ring came;  
And made him spend a day with them  
In hunting forest-game.

Then, with his carpet-bag in hand,  
To Dog Town next he went;  
Though stopping at Free Negro Town,  
Where half a day he spent.

From thence, into Negationburg  
His route of travel lay;  
Which having gained, he left the State,  
And took a southward way.

North Carolina's friendly soil  
He trod at fall of night,  
And, on a bed of softest down,  
He slept at Hell's Delight.

Morn found him on the road again,  
To Lousy Level bound;  
At Bull's Tail, and Lick Lizard, too,  
Good provender he found.

The country all about Pinch Gut  
So beautiful did seem  
That the beholder thought it like  
A picture in a dream.

But the plantations near Burnt Coat  
Were even finer still,  
And made the wondering tourist feel  
A soft, delicious thrill.

At Tear Shirt, too, the scenery  
Most charming did appear,

With Snatch It in the distance far,  
And Purgatory near.

But, spite of all these pleasant scenes,  
The tourist stoutly swore  
That home is brightest, after all,  
And travel is a bore.

So back he went to Maine, straightway;  
A little wife he took;  
And now is making nutmegs at  
Moosehicmagunticook.

*Robert H. Newell.*

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## **THE ZEALLESS XYLOGRAPHER**

### **DEDICATED TO THE END OF THE DICTIONARY**

A xylographer started to cross the sea  
By means of a Xanthic Xebec;  
But, alas! he sighed for the Zuyder Zee,  
And feared he was in for a wreck.  
He tried to smile, but all in vain,  
Because of a Zygomatoc pain;  
And as for singing, his cheeriest tone  
Reminded him of a Xylophone—  
Or else, when the pain would sharper grow,  
His notes were as keen as a Zuffolo.  
And so it is likely he did not find  
On board Xenodochy to his mind.  
The fare was poor, and he was sure  
Xerofphagy he could not endure;

Zoöphagous surely he was, I aver,  
This dainty and starving Xylographer.  
Xylophagous truly he could not be—  
No sickly vegetarian he!  
He'd have blubbered like any old Zeuglodon  
Had Xerophthalmia not come on.  
And the end of it was he never again  
In a Xanthic Xebec went sailing the main.

*Mary Mapes Dodge.*

---

## THE OLD LINE FENCE

Zig-zagging it went  
On the line of the farm,  
And the trouble it caused  
Was often quite warm,  
THE OLD LINE FENCE.  
It was changed every year  
By decree of the court,  
To which, when worn out,  
Our sires would resort  
WITH THE OLD LINE FENCE.  
In hoeing their corn,  
When the sun, too, was hot,  
They surely would jaw,  
Punch or claw, when they got  
TO THE OLD LINE FENCE.  
In dividing the lands  
It fulfilled no desires,  
But answered quite well  
In "dividing" our sires,  
THIS OLD LINE FENCE.

Though sometimes in this  
It would happen to fail,  
When, with top rail in hand,  
One would flare up and scale  
THE OLD LINE FENCE!  
Then the conflict was sharp  
On debatable ground,  
And the fertile soil there  
Would be mussed far around  
THE OLD LINE FENCE.  
It was shifted so oft  
That no flowers there grew.  
What frownings and clods,  
And what words were shot through  
THE OLD LINE FENCE!  
Our sires through the day  
There would quarrel or fight,  
With a vigour and vim,  
But 'twas different at night  
BY THE OLD LINE FENCE.  
The fairest maid there  
You would have descried  
That ever leaned soft  
On the opposite side  
OF AN OLD LINE FENCE.  
Where our fathers built hate  
There we builded our love,  
Breathed our vows to be true  
With our hands raised above  
THE OLD LINE FENCE.  
Its place might be changed,  
But there we would meet,  
With our heads through the rails,  
And with kisses most sweet,  
AT THE OLD LINE FENCE.  
It was love made the change,  
And the clasping of hands



Ending ages of hate,  
And between us now stands  
NOT A SIGN OF LINE FENCE.  
No debatable ground  
Now enkindles alarms.  
I've the girl I met there,  
And, well, both of the farms,  
AND NO LINE FENCE.

*A. W. Bellow.*

---

## **O-U-G-H**

### **A FRESH HACK AT AN OLD KNOT**

I'm taught p-l-o-u-g-h  
S'all be pronouncé "plow."  
"Zat's easy w'en you know," I say,  
"Mon Anglais, I'll get through!"

My teacher say zat in zat case,  
O-u-g-h is "oo."  
And zen I laugh and say to him,  
"Zees Anglais make me cough."

He say "Not 'coo,' but in zat word,  
O-u-g-h is 'off,'"   
Oh, Sacre bleu! such varied sounds  
Of words makes me hiccough!

He say, "Again mon frien' ees wrong;  
O-u-g-h is 'up'  
In hiccough." Zen I cry, "No more,

You make my t'roat feel rough."

"Non, non!" he cry, "you are not right;

O-u-g-h is 'uff."

I say, "I try to spik your words,

I cannot spik zem though!"

"In time you'll learn, but now you're wrong!

O-u-g-h is 'owe."

"I'll try no more, I s'all go mad,

I'll drown me in ze lough!"

"But ere you drown yourself," said he,

"O-u-g-h is 'ock."

He taught no more, I held him fast,

And killed him wiz a rough.

*Charles Battell Loomis.*

---

## ENIGMA ON THE LETTER H

'Twas whispered in heaven, 'twas muttered in hell,  
And echo caught faintly the sound as it fell;  
On the confines of earth 'twas permitted to rest,  
And the depths of the ocean its presence confessed;  
'Twill be found in the sphere when 'tis riven asunder,  
Be seen in the lightning, and heard in the thunder.  
'Twas allotted to man with his earliest breath,  
It assists at his birth and attends him in death,  
Presides o'er his happiness, honor, and health,  
Is the prop of his house and the end of his wealth,  
In the heaps of the miser is hoarded with care,  
But is sure to be lost in his prodigal heir.

It begins every hope, every wish it must bound,  
It prays with the hermit, with monarchs is crowned;  
Without it the soldier, the sailor, may roam,  
But woe to the wretch who expels it from home.  
In the whisper of conscience 'tis sure to be found,  
Nor e'en in the whirlwind of passion is drowned;  
'Twill soften the heart, but, though deaf to the ear,  
It will make it acutely and instantly hear;  
But, in short, let it rest like a delicate flower;  
Oh, breathe on it softly, it dies in an hour.

*Catherine Fanshawe.*

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## **TRAVESTY OF MISS FANSHAWE'S ENIGMA**

I dwells in the Hearth, and I breathes in the Hair;  
If you searches the Hocean, you'll find that I'm there.  
The first of all Hangels in Holympus am Hi,  
Yet I'm banished from 'Eaven, expelled from on 'igh.  
But, though on this Horb I'm destined to grovel,  
I'm ne'er seen in an 'Ouse, in an 'Ut, nor an 'Ovel.  
Not an 'Orse, not an 'Unter e'er bears me, alas!  
But often I'm found on the top of a Hass.  
I resides in a Hattic, and loves not to roam,  
And yet I'm invariably absent from 'Ome.  
Though 'Ushed in the 'Urricane, of the Hatmosphere part,  
I enters no 'Ed, I creeps into no 'Art.  
Only look, and you'll see in the Heye Hi appear;  
Only 'Ark, and you'll 'Ear me just breathe in the Hear.  
Though in sex not an 'E, I am (strange paradox)  
Not a bit of an 'Effer, but partly a Hox.  
Of Heternity I'm the beginning! and, mark,  
Though I goes not with Noar, I'm first in the Hark.

I'm never in 'Ealth; have with Fysic no power,  
I dies in a month, but comes back in a Hour.

*Horace Mayhew.*

---

## **AN ELEGY ON THE DEATH OF A MAD DOG**

Good people all, of every sort,  
Give ear unto my song;  
And if you find it wondrous short,—  
It cannot hold you long.

In Islington there was a man,  
Of whom the world might say  
That still a godly race he ran,—  
Whene'er he went to pray.

A kind and gentle heart he had,  
To comfort friends and foes;  
The naked every day he clad,—  
When he put on his clothes.

And in that town a dog was found,  
As many dogs there be,  
Both mongrel, puppy, whelp, and hound,  
And curs of low degree.

The dog and man at first were friends;  
But when a pique began,  
The dog, to gain some private ends,  
Went mad, and bit the man.

Around from all the neighboring streets,

The wondering neighbors ran,  
And swore the dog had lost his wits  
To bite so good a man.

The wound it seemed both sore and sad  
To every Christian eye;  
And while they swore the dog was mad  
They swore the man would die.

But soon a wonder came to light,  
That showed the rogues they lied;  
The man recovered of the bite,  
The dog it was that died.

*Oliver Goldsmith.*

---

## **AN EPITAPH**

Interred beneath this marble stone  
Lie sauntering Jack and idle Joan.  
While rolling threescore years and one  
Did round this globe their courses run.  
If human things went ill or well,  
If changing empires rose or fell,  
The morning past, the evening came,  
And found this couple just the same.  
They walked and ate, good folks. What then?  
Why, then they walked and ate again;  
They soundly slept the night away;  
They did just nothing all the day,  
Nor sister either had, nor brother;  
They seemed just tallied for each other.  
Their moral and economy

Most perfectly they made agree;  
Each virtue kept its proper bound,  
Nor trespassed on the other's ground.  
Nor fame nor censure they regarded;  
They neither punished nor rewarded.  
He cared not what the footman did;  
Her maids she neither praised nor chid;  
So every servant took his course,  
And, bad at first, they all grew worse;  
Slothful disorder filled his stable,  
And sluttish plenty decked her table.  
Their beer was strong, their wine was port;  
Their meal was large, their grace was short.  
They gave the poor the remnant meat,  
Just when it grew not fit to eat.  
They paid the church and parish rate,  
And took, but read not, the receipt;  
For which they claimed their Sunday's due  
Of slumbering in an upper pew.  
No man's defects sought they to know,  
So never made themselves a foe.  
No man's good deeds did they commend,  
So never raised themselves a friend.  
Nor cherished they relations poor,  
That might decrease their present store;  
Nor barn nor house did they repair,  
That might oblige their future heir.  
They neither added nor confounded;  
They neither wanted nor abounded.  
Nor tear nor smile did they employ  
At news of grief or public joy  
When bells were rung and bonfires made,  
If asked, they ne'er denied their aid;  
Their jug was to the ringers carried,  
Whoever either died or married.  
Their billet at the fire was found,  
Whoever was deposed or crowned.

Nor good, nor bad, nor fools, nor wise;  
They would not learn, nor could advise;  
Without love, hatred, joy, or fear,  
They led—a kind of—as it were;  
Nor wished, nor cared, nor laughed, nor cried.  
And so they lived, and so they died.

*Matthew Prior.*

---

## **OLD GRIMES**

Old Grimes is dead; that good old man  
We never shall see more:  
He used to wear a long, black coat,  
All button'd down before.

His heart was open as the day,  
His feelings all were true;  
His hair was some inclined to gray—  
He wore it in a queue.

Whene'er he heard the voice of pain,  
His breast with pity burn'd;  
The large, round head upon his cane  
From ivory was turn'd.

Kind words he ever had for all;  
He knew no base design:  
His eyes were dark and rather small,  
His nose was aquiline.

He lived at peace with all mankind,  
In friendship he was true:

His coat had pocket-holes behind,  
His pantaloons were blue.

Unharm'd, the sin which earth pollutes  
He pass'd securely o'er,  
And never wore a pair of boots  
For thirty years or more.

But good old Grimes is now at rest,  
Nor fears misfortune's frown:  
He wore a double-breasted vest—  
The stripes ran up and down.

He modest merit sought to find,  
Any pay it its desert:  
He had no malice in his mind,  
No ruffles on his shirt.

His neighbors he did not abuse—  
Was sociable and gay:  
He wore large buckles on his shoes,  
And changed them every day.

His knowledge, hid from public gaze,  
He did not bring to view,  
Nor made a noise, town-meeting days,  
As many people do.

His worldly goods he never threw  
In trust to fortune's chances,  
But lived (as all his brothers do)  
In easy circumstances.

Thus undisturb'd by anxious cares,  
His peaceful moments ran;  
And everybody said he was  
A fine old gentleman.



*Albert Gorton Greene.*

---

## THE ENDLESS SONG

Oh, I used to sing a song,  
An' dey said it was too long,  
So I cut it off de en'  
To accommodate a frien'  
Nex' do', nex' do'—  
To accommodate a frien' nex' do'.

But it made de matter wuss  
Dan it had been at de fus,  
'Ca'ze de en' was gone, an' den  
Co'se it didn't have no en'  
Any mo', any mo'—  
Oh, it didn't have no en' any mo'!

So, to save my frien' from sinnin',  
I cut off de song's beginnin';  
Still he cusses right along  
Whilst I sings *about* my song  
Jes so, jes so—  
Whilst I sings *about* my song *jес so*.

How to please 'im is my riddle,  
So I'll fall back on my fiddle;  
For I'd stan' myself on en'  
To accommodate a frien'  
Nex' do', nex' do'—  
To accommodate a frien' nex' do'.

*Ruth McEnery Stuart.*

---

## THE HUNDRED BEST BOOKS

First there's the Bible,  
And then the Koran,  
Odgers on Libel,  
Pope's Essay on Man,  
Confessions of Rousseau,  
The Essays of Lamb,  
Robinson Crusoe  
And Omar Khayyam,  
Volumes of Shelley  
And Venerable Bede,  
Machiavelli  
And Captain Mayne Reid,  
Fox upon Martyrs  
And Liddell and Scott,  
Stubbs on the Charters,  
The works of La Motte,  
The Seasons by Thomson,  
And Paul de Verlaine,  
Theodore Mommsen  
And Clemens (Mark Twain),  
The Rocks of Hugh Miller,  
The Mill on the Floss,  
The Poems of Schiller,  
The Iliados,  
Don Quixote (Cervantes),  
La Pucelle by Voltaire,  
Inferno (that's Dante's),  
And Vanity Fair,  
Conybeare-Howson,  
Brillat-Savarin,

And Baron Munchausen,  
    Mademoiselle De Maupin,  
The Dramas of Marlowe,  
    The Three Musketeers,  
Clarissa Harlowe,  
    And the Pioneers,  
Sterne's Tristram Shandy,  
    The Ring and the Book,  
And Handy Andy,  
    And Captain Cook,  
The Plato of Jowett,  
    And Mill's Pol. Econ.,  
The Haunts of Howitt,  
    The Encheiridion,  
Lothair by Disraeli,  
    And Boccaccio,  
The Student's Paley,  
    And Westward Ho!  
The Pharmacopœia,  
    Macaulay's Lays,  
Of course The Medea,  
    And Sheridan's Plays,  
The Odes of Horace,  
    And Verdant Green,  
The Poems of Morris,  
    The Faery Queen,  
The Stones of Venice,  
    Natural History (White's),  
And then Pendennis,  
    The Arabian Nights,  
Cicero's Orations,  
    Plain Tales from the Hills,  
The Wealth of Nations,  
    And Byles on Bills,  
As in a Glass Darkly,  
    Demosthenes' Crown,  
The Treatise of Berkeley,

Tom Hughes's Tom Brown,  
The Mahabharata,  
The Humour of Hook,  
The Kreutzer Sonata,  
And Lalla Rookh,  
Great Battles by Creasy,  
And Hudibras,  
And Midshipman Easy,  
And Rasselas,  
Shakespeare *in extenso*  
And the Æneid,  
And Euclid (Colenso),  
The Woman who Did,  
Poe's Tales of Mystery,  
Then Rabelais,  
Guizot's French History,  
And Men of the Day,  
Rienzi, by Lytton,  
The Poems of Burns,  
The Story of Britain,  
The Journey (that's Sterne's),  
The House of Seven Gables,  
Carroll's Looking-glass,  
Æsop his Fables,  
And Leaves of Grass,  
Departmental Ditties,  
The Woman in White,  
The Tale of Two Cities,  
Ships that Pass in the Night,  
Meredith's Feverel,  
Gibbon's Decline,  
Walter Scott's Peveril,  
And—some verses of mine.

*Mostyn T. Pigott.*

---

## THE COSMIC EGG

Upon a rock, yet uncreate,  
Amid a chaos inchoate,  
An uncreated being sate;  
Beneath him, rock,  
Above him, cloud.  
And the cloud was rock,  
And the rock was cloud.  
The rock then growing soft and warm,  
The cloud began to take a form,  
A form chaotic, vast and vague,  
Which issued in the cosmic egg.  
Then the Being uncreate  
On the egg did incubate,  
And thus became the incubator;  
And of the egg did allegate,  
And thus became the alligator;  
And the incubator was potentate,  
But the alligator was potentator.

*Unknown.*

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## FIVE WINES

Brisk methinks I am, and fine  
When I drink my cap'ring wine;  
Then to love I do incline,  
When I drink my wanton wine;  
And I wish all maidens mine,  
When I drink my sprightly wine;  
Well I sup and well I dine,

When I drink my frolic wine;  
But I languish, lower, and pine,  
When I want my fragrant wine.

*Robert Herrick.*

---

## **A RHYME FOR MUSICIANS**

Händel, Bendel, Mendelssohn,  
Brendel, Wendel, Jadassohn,  
Müller, Hiller, Heller, Franz,  
Plothow, Flotow, Burto, Ganz.

Meyer, Geyer, Meyerbeer,  
Heyer, Weyer, Beyer, Beer,  
Lichner, Lachner, Schachner, Dietz,  
Hill, Will, Brüll, Grill, Drill, Reiss, Rietz.

Hansen, Jansen, Jensen, Kiehl,  
Siade, Gade, Laade, Stiehl,  
Naumann, Riemann, Diener, Wurst,  
Niemann, Kiemann, Diener, Furst.

Kochler, Dochler, Rubinstein,  
Himmel, Hummel, Rosenhain,  
Lauer, Bauer, Kleinecke,  
Homberg, Plomberg, Reinecke.

*E. Lemke.*

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# **MY MADELINE**

## **SERENADE IN M FLAT**

### **SUNG BY MAJOR MARMADUKE MUTTONHEAD TO MADEMOISELLE MADELINE MENDOZA**

My Madeline! my Madeline!  
Mark my melodious midnight moans;  
Much may my melting music mean,  
My modulated monotones.

My mandolin's mild minstrelsy,  
My mental music magazine,  
My mouth, my mind, my memory,  
Must mingling murmur "Madeline!"

Muster 'mid midnight masquerades,  
Mark Moorish maidens, matrons' mien;  
'Mongst Murcia's most majestic maids,  
Match me my matchless Madeline.

Mankind's malevolence may make  
Much melancholy musing mine;  
Many my motives may mistake,  
My modest merits much malign.

My Madeline's most mirthful mood  
Much mollifies my mind's machine,  
My mournfulness's magnitude  
Melts—make me merry, Madeline!

Match-making mas may machinate,  
Manœuvring misses me mis-ween;  
Mere money may make many mate,  
My magic motto's "Madeline!"

Melt, most mellifluous melody,  
    'Midst Murcia's misty mounts marine;  
Meet me 'mid moonlight; marry me,  
    *Madonna mia!* my Madeline!

*Walter Parke.*

---

## SUSAN SIMPSON

Sudden swallows swiftly skimming,  
    Sunset's slowly spreading shade,  
Silvery songsters sweetly singing,  
    Summer's soothing serenade.

Susan Simpson strolled sedately,  
    Stifling sobs, suppressing sighs.  
Seeing Stephen Slocum, stately  
    She stopped, showing some surprise.

"Say," said Stephen, "sweetest sigher;  
    Say, shall Stephen spouseless stay?"  
Susan, seeming somewhat shyer,  
    Showed submissiveness straightway.

Summer's season slowly stretches,  
    Susan Simpson Slocum she—  
So she signed some simple sketches—  
    Soul sought soul successfully.

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Six Septembers Susan swelters;  
    Six sharp seasons snow supplies;



Susan's satin sofa shelters  
Six small Slocums side by side.

*Unknown.*

---

## THE MARCH TO MOSCOW

The Emperor Nap he would set off  
On a summer excursion to Moscow;  
The fields were green and the sky was blue,  
Morbleu! Parbleu!  
What a splendid excursion to Moscow!

Four hundred thousand men and more  
Must go with him to Moscow:  
There were Marshals by the dozen,  
And Dukes by the score;  
Princes a few, and Kings one or two;  
While the fields are so green, and the sky so blue,  
Morbleu! Parbleu!  
What a pleasant excursion to Moscow!

There was Junot and Augereau,  
Heigh-ho for Moscow!  
Dombrowsky and Poniatowsky,  
Marshall Ney, lack-a-day!  
General Rapp, and the Emperor Nap;  
Nothing would do,  
While the fields were so green, and the sky so blue,  
Morbleu! Parbleu!  
Nothing would do  
For the whole of his crew,  
But they must be marching to Moscow.

The Emperor Nap he talk'd so big  
That he frighten'd Mr. Roscoe.  
John Bull, he cries, if you'll be wise,  
Ask the Emperor Nap if he will please  
To grant you peace upon your knees,  
Because he is going to Moscow!  
He'll make all the Poles come out of their holes,  
And beat the Russians, and eat the Prussians;  
For the fields are green, and the sky is blue,  
Morbleu! Parbleu!  
And he'll certainly march to Moscow!

And Counsellor Brougham was all in a fume  
At the thought of the march to Moscow:  
The Russians, he said, they were undone,  
And the great Fee-Faw-Fum  
Would presently come,  
With a hop, step, and jump, unto London,  
For, as for his conquering Russia,  
However some persons might scoff it,  
Do it he could, do it he would,  
And from doing it nothing would come but good,  
And nothing could call him off it.  
Mr. Jeffrey said so, who must certainly know,  
For he was the Edinburgh Prophet.  
They all of them knew Mr. Jeffrey's Review,  
Which with Holy Writ ought to be reckon'd:  
It was, through thick and thin, to its party true,  
Its back was buff, and its sides were blue,  
Morbleu! Parbleu!  
It served them for law and for gospel too.

But the Russians stoutly they turned to  
Upon the road to Moscow.  
Nap had to fight his way all through;  
They could fight, though they could not parler-vous;

But the fields were green, and the sky was blue,  
Morableu! Parbleu!  
And so he got to Moscow.

He found the place too warm for him,  
For they set fire to Moscow.  
To get there had cost him much ado,  
And then no better course he knew  
While the fields were green, and the sky was blue,  
Morableu! Parbleu!  
But to march back again from Moscow.

The Russians they stuck close to him  
All on the road from Moscow.  
There was Tormazow and Jemalow,  
And all the others that end in ow;  
Milarodovitch and Jaladovitch,  
And Karatschkowitch,  
And all the others that end in itch;  
Schamscheff, Souchosaneff,  
And Schepaleff,  
And all the others that end in eff:  
Wasiltschikoff, Kotsomaroff,  
And Tchoglokoff,  
And all the others that end in off;  
Rajeffsky, and Novereffsky,  
And Rieffsky,  
And all the others that end in effsky;  
Oscharoffsky and Rostoffsky,  
And all the others that end in offsky;  
And Platoff he play'd them off,  
And Shouvaloff he shovell'd them off,  
And Markoff he mark'd them off,  
And Krosnoff he cross'd them off,  
And Touchkoff he touch'd them off,  
And Boroskoff he bored them off,  
And Kutousoff he cut them off,

And Parenzoff he pared them off,  
And Worronzoff he worried them off,  
And Doctoroff he doctor'd them off,  
And Rodinoff he flogg'd them off.  
And, last of all, an Admiral came,  
A terrible man with a terrible name,  
A name which you all know by sight very well,  
But which no one can speak, and no one can spell.  
They stuck close to Nap with all their might;  
They were on the left and on the right  
Behind and before, and by day and by night;  
He would rather parlez-vous than fight;  
But he look'd white, and he look'd blue.  
Morbleu! Parbleu!  
When parlez-vous no more would do.  
For they remember'd Moscow.

And then came on the frost and snow  
All on the road from Moscow.  
The wind and the weather he found, in that hour,  
Cared nothing for him, nor for all his power;  
For him who, while Europe crouch'd under his rod,  
Put his trust in his Fortune, and not in his God.  
Worse and worse every day the elements grew,  
The fields were so white and the sky was so blue,  
Sacrebleu! Ventrebleu!  
What a horrible journey from Moscow!

What then thought the Emperor Nap  
Upon the road from Moscow?  
Why, I ween he thought it small delight  
To fight all day, and to freeze all night;  
And he was besides in a very great fright,  
For a whole skin he liked to be in;  
And so not knowing what else to do,  
When the fields were so white, and the sky so blue,  
Morbleu! Parbleu!

He stole away,—I tell you true,—  
Upon the road from Moscow.  
'Tis myself, quoth he, I must mind most;  
So the devil may take the hindmost.

Too cold upon the road was he;  
Too hot had he been at Moscow;  
But colder and hotter he may be,  
For the grave is colder than Moscovy;  
And a place there is to be kept in view,  
Where the fire is red, and the brimstone blue,  
Morbleu! Parbleu!  
Which he must go to,  
If the Pope say true,  
If he does not in time look about him;  
Where his namesake almost  
He may have for his Host;  
He has reckon'd too long without him;  
If that Host get him in Purgatory,  
He won't leave him there alone with his glory;  
But there he must stay for a very long day,  
For from thence there is no stealing away,  
As there was on the road from Moscow.

*Robert Southey.*

---

## HALF HOURS WITH THE CLASSICS

Ah, those hours when by-gone sages  
Led our thoughts through Learning's ways,  
When the wit of sunnier ages,  
Called once more to Earth the days  
When rang through Athens' vine-hung lanes

Thy wild, wild laugh, Aristophanes!

Pensive through the land of Lotus,  
    Sauntered we by Nilus' side;  
Garrulous old Herodotus  
    Still our mentor, still our guide,  
Prating of the mystic bliss  
Of Isis and of Osiris.

All the learn'd ones trooped before us,  
    All the wise of Hellas' land,  
Down from mythic Pythagoras,  
    To the hemlock drinker grand.  
Dark the hour that closed the gates  
Of gloomy Dis on thee, Socrates.

Ah, those hours of tend'rest study,  
    When Electra's poet told  
Of Love's cheek once warm and ruddy,  
    Pale with grief, with death chill cold!  
Sobbing low like summer tides  
Flow thy verses, Euripides!

High our hearts beat when Cicero  
    Shook the Capitolian dome;  
How we shuddered, watching Nero  
    'Mid the glare of blazing Rome!  
How those records still affright us  
On thy gloomy page, Tacitus!

Back to youth I seem to glide, as  
    I recall those by-gone scenes,  
When we conned o'er Thucydides,  
    Or recited Demosthenes.

L'ENVOI

Ancient sages, pardon these  
Somewhat doubtful quantities.

*H. I. DeBurgh.*

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## ON THE OXFORD CARRIER

Here lieth one, who did most truly prove  
That he could never die while he could move;  
So hung his destiny never to rot  
While he might still jog on and keep his trot;  
Made of sphere metal, never to decay  
Until his revolution was at stay.  
Time numbers motion, yet (without a crime  
'Gainst old truth) motion number'd out his time  
And like an engine moved with wheel and weight,  
His principles being ceased, he ended straight.  
Rest, that gives all men life, gave him his death,  
And too much breathing put him out of breath;  
Nor were it contradiction to affirm,  
Too long vacation hasten'd on his term.  
Merely to drive the time away he sicken'd,  
Fainted, and died, nor would with ale be quicken'd;  
"Nay," quoth he, on his swooning bed outstretch'd,  
"If I mayn't carry, sure I'll ne'er be fetch'd,  
But vow, though the cross doctors all stood hearers,  
For one carrier put down to make six bearers."  
Ease was his chief disease; and to judge right,  
He died for heaviness that his cart went light:  
His leisure told him that his time was come.  
And lack of load made his life burdensome.  
That even to his last breath (there be that say't),  
As he were press'd to death, he cried, "More weight;"

But, had his doings lasted as they were,  
He had been an immortal carrier.  
Obedient to the moon he spent his date  
In course reciprocal, and had his fate  
Link'd to the mutual flowing of the seas,  
Yet (strange to think) his wane was his increase:  
His letters are deliver'd all, and gone,  
Only remains the superscription.

*John Milton.*

---

## **NINETY-NINE IN THE SHADE**

O for a lodge in a garden of cucumbers!  
O for an iceberg or two at control!  
O for a vale which at mid-day the dew cumbers!  
O for a pleasure-trip up to the pole!

O for a little one-story thermometer,  
With nothing but zeroes all ranged in a row!  
O for a big double-barreled hygrometer,  
To measure this moisture that rolls from my brow!

O that this cold world were twenty times colder!  
(That's irony red-hot it seemeth to me);  
O for a turn of its dreaded cold shoulder!  
O what a comfort an ague would be!

O for a grotto frost-lined and rill-riven,  
Scooped in the rock under cataract vast!  
O for a winter of discontent even!  
O for wet blankets judiciously cast!



O for a soda-fount spouting up boldly  
From every hot lamp-post against the hot sky!  
O for proud maiden to look on me coldly,  
Freezing my soul with a glance of her eye!

Then O for a draught from a cup of cold pizen,  
And O for a resting-place in the cold grave!  
With a bath in the Styx where the thick shadow lies on  
And deepens the chill of its dark-running wave.

*Rossiter Johnson.*

---

## THE TRIOLET

Easy is the triolet,  
If you really learn to make it!  
Once a neat refrain you get,  
Easy is the triolet.  
As you see!—I pay my debt  
With another rhyme. Deuce take it,  
Easy is the triolet,  
If you really learn to make it!

*William Ernest Henley.*

---

## THE RONDEAU

You bid me try, Blue-eyes, to write  
A Rondeau. What! forthwith?—to-night?

Reflect? Some skill I have, 'tis true;  
But thirteen lines!—and rhymed on two!—  
"Refrain," as well. Ah, hapless plight!

Still there are five lines—ranged aright.  
These Gallic bonds, I feared, would fright  
My easy Muse. They did, till you—  
You bid me try!

That makes them eight.—The port's in sight;  
'Tis all because your eyes are bright!  
Now just a pair to end in "oo,"—  
When maids command, what can't we do?  
Behold! The Rondeau—tasteful, light—  
You bid me try!

*Austin Dobson.*

---

## LIFE<sup>[1]</sup>

1. Why all this toil for triumphs of an hour?
2. Life's a short summer, man a flower.
3. By turns we catch the vital breath and die—
4. The cradle and the tomb, alas! so nigh.
5. To be, is better far than not to be.
6. Though all man's life may seem a tragedy;
7. But light cares speak when mighty griefs are dumb,
8. The bottom is but shallow whence they come.
9. Your fate is but the common lot of all:
10. Unmingled joys here to no man befall,
11. Nature to each allots his proper sphere;
12. Fortune makes folly her peculiar care;
13. Custom does often reason overrule,

14. And throw a cruel sunshine on a fool.
15. Live well; how long or short, permit to Heaven;
16. They who forgive most, shall be most forgiven.
17. Sin may be clasped so close we cannot see its face—
18. Vile intercourse where virtue has no place.
19. Then keep each passion down, however dear;
20. Thou pendulum betwixt a smile and tear.
21. Her sensual snares, let faithless pleasure lay,
22. With craft and skill, to ruin and betray;
23. Soar not too high to fall, but stoop to rise.
24. We masters grow of all that we despise.
25. Oh, then, renounce that impious self-esteem;
26. Riches have wings, and grandeur is a dream.
27. Think not ambition wise because 'tis brave,
28. The paths of glory lead but to the grave.
29. What is ambition?—'tis a glorious cheat!—
30. Only destructive to the brave and great.
31. What's all the gaudy glitter of a crown?
32. The way to bliss lies not on beds of down.
33. How long we live, not years but actions tell;
34. That man lives twice who lives the first life well.
35. Make, then, while yet ye may, your God your friend,
36. Whom Christians worship yet not comprehend.
37. The trust that's given guard, and to yourself be just;
38. For, live we how we can, yet die we must.

*Unknown.*

[1] 1. Young; 2. Dr. Johnson; 3. Pope; 4. Prior; 5. Sewell; 6. Spenser; 7. Daniell; 8. Sir Walter Raleigh; 9. Longfellow; 10. Southwell; 11. Congreve; 12. Churchill; 13. Rochester; 14. Armstrong; 15. Milton; 16. Bailey; 17. Trench; 18. Somerville; 19. Thomson; 20. Byron; 21. Smollett; 22. Crabbe; 23. Massinger; 24. Cowley; 25. Beattie; 26. Cowper; 27. Sir Walter Davenant; 28. Gray; 29. Willis; 30. Addison; 31. Dryden; 32. Francis Quarles; 33. Watkins; 34. Herrick; 35. William Mason; 36. Hill; 37. Dana; 38. Shakespeare.

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## ODE TO THE HUMAN HEART

Blind Thamyras, and blind Mæonides,  
Pursue the triumph and partake the gale!  
Drop tears as fast as the Arabian trees,  
To point a moral or adorn a tale.

Full many a gem of purest ray serene,  
Thoughts that do often lie too deep for tears,  
Like angels' visits, few and far between,  
Deck the long vista of departed years.

Man never is, but always to be bless'd;  
The tenth transmitter of a foolish face,  
Like Aaron's serpent, swallows up the rest,  
And makes a sunshine in the shady place.

For man the hermit sigh'd, till woman smiled,  
To waft a feather or to drown a fly,  
(In wit a man, simplicity a child,)  
With silent finger pointing to the sky.

But fools rush in where angels fear to tread  
Far out amid the melancholy main;  
As when a vulture on Imaus bred,  
Dies of a rose in aromatic pain.

*Laman Blanchard.*

---

## A STRIKE AMONG THE POETS

In his chamber, weak and dying,  
While the Norman Baron lay,  
Loud, without, his men were crying,  
"Shorter hours and better pay."

Know you why the ploughman, fretting,  
Homeward plods his weary way  
Ere his time? He's after getting  
Shorter hours and better pay.

See! the *Hesperus* is swinging  
Idle in the wintry bay,  
And the skipper's daughter's singing,  
"Shorter hours and better pay."

Where's the minstrel boy? I've found him  
Joining in the labour fray  
With his placards slung around him,  
"Shorter hours and better pay."

Oh, young Lochinvar is coming;  
Though his hair is getting grey,  
Yet I'm glad to hear him humming,  
"Shorter hours and, better pay."

E'en the boy upon the burning  
Deck has got a word to say,  
Something rather cross concerning  
Shorter hours and better pay.

Lives of great men all remind us  
We can make as much as they,  
Work no more, until they find us  
Shorter hours and better pay.

Hail to thee, blithe spirit! (Shelley)

Wilt thou be a blackleg? Nay.  
Soaring, sing above the mêlée,  
"Shorter hours and better pay."

*Unknown.*

---

## **WHATEVER IS, IS RIGHT**

Lives there a man with soul so dead  
Who never to himself has said,  
                                "Shoot folly as it flies"?  
Oh! more than tears of blood can tell,  
Are in that word, farewell, farewell!  
                                'Tis folly to be wise.

And what is friendship but a name,  
That boils on Etna's breast of flame?  
                                Thus runs the world away,  
Sweet is the ship that's under sail  
To where yon taper cheers the vale,  
                                With hospitable ray!

Drink to me only with thine eyes  
Through cloudless climes and starry skies!  
                                My native land, good night!  
Adieu, adieu, my native shore;  
'Tis Greece, but living Greece no more—  
                                Whatever is, is right!

*Laman Blanchard.*

---

## NOTHING

Mysterious Nothing! how shall I define  
Thy shapeless, baseless, placeless emptiness?  
Nor form, nor colour, sound, nor size is thine,  
Nor words nor fingers can thy voice express;  
But though we cannot thee to aught compare,  
A thousand things to thee may likened be,  
And though thou art with nobody nowhere,  
Yet half mankind devote themselves to thee.  
How many books thy history contain;  
How many heads thy mighty plans pursue;  
What labouring hands thy portion only gain;  
What busy bodies thy doings only do!  
To thee the great, the proud, the giddy bend,  
And—like my sonnet—all in nothing end.

*Richard Porson.*

---

## DIRGE

To the memory of Miss Ellen Gee, of Kew, who died in  
consequence of being stung in the eye.

Peerless yet hapless maid of Q!  
Accomplish'd LN G!  
Never again shall I and U  
Together sip our T.

For, ah! the Fates I know not Y,  
Sent 'midst the flowers a B,  
Which ven'mous stung her in the I,  
So that she could not C.

LN exclaim'd, "Vile spiteful B!  
If ever I catch U  
On jess'mine, rosebud, or sweet P,  
I'll change your singing Q.

"I'll send you like a lamb or U  
Across th' Atlantic C.  
From our delightful village Q  
To distant O Y E.

"A stream runs from my wounded I,  
Salt as the briny C  
As rapid as the X or Y,  
The OIO or D.

"Then fare thee ill, insensate B!  
Who stung, nor yet knew Y,  
Since not for wealthy Durham's C  
Would I have lost my I."

They bear with tears fair LN G  
In funeral R A,  
A clay-cold corse now doom'd to B  
Whilst I mourn her DK.



Ye nymphs of Q, then shun each B,  
List to the reason Y;  
For should A B C U at T,  
He'll surely sting your I.

Now in a grave L deep in Q,  
She's cold as cold can B,  
Whilst robins sing upon A U  
Her dirge and LEG.

*Unknown.*

---

## **O D V**

### **CONTAINING A FULL, TRUE, AND PARTICULAR ACCOUNT OF THE TERRIBLE FATE OF ABRAHAM ISAACS, OF IVY LANE**

"True 'tis P T, and P T 'tis, 'tis true."

In I V Lane, of C T fame,  
There lived a man D C,  
And A B I 6 was his name,  
Now mark his history.

Long time his conduct free from blame  
Did merit L O G,  
Until an evil spirit came  
In the shape of O D V.

"O! that a man into his mouth  
Should put an N M E  
To steal away his brains"—no drouth

Such course from sin may free.

Well, A B drank, the O T loon!  
And learned to swear, sans ruth;  
And then he gamed, and U Z soon  
To D V 8 from truth.

An hourly glass with him was play,  
He'd swallow that with phlegm;  
Judge what he'd M T in a day,  
"X P D *Herculem*."

Of virtue none to sots, I trow,  
With F E K C prate;  
And O of N R G could now  
From A B M N 8.

Who on strong liquor badly dote,  
Soon poverty must know;  
Thus A B in a C D coat  
Was shortly forced to go.

From poverty D C T he caught,  
And cheated not A F U,  
For what he purchased paying O,  
Or but an "I O U."

Or else when he had tried B 4,  
To shirk a debt, his wits,  
He'd cry, "You shan't wait N E more,  
I'll W or quits."

So lost did I 6 now A P R,  
That said his wife, said she,  
"F U act so, your fate quite clear  
Is for 1 2 4 C."

His inside soon was out and out  
More fiery than K N;  
And while his state was thereabout  
A cough C V R came.

He I P K Q N A tried,  
And linseed T and rue;  
But O could save him, so he died  
As every 1 must 2.

Poor wight! till black in' the face he raved,  
'Twas P T S 2 C  
His latest spirit "spirit" craved—  
His last words, "O D V."

#### **MORAL**

I'll not S A to preach and prate,  
But tell U if U do  
Drink O D V at such R 8,  
Death will 4 stall U 2.

O U then who A Y Z have,  
Shun O D V as a wraith,  
For 'tis a bonus to the grave,  
An S A unto death.

*Unknown.*

---

### **A MAN OF WORDS**

A man of words and not of deeds,  
Is like a garden full of weeds;  
And when the weeds begin to grow,

It's like a garden full of snow;  
And when the snow begins to fall,  
It's like a bird upon the wall;  
And when the bird away does fly,  
It's like an eagle in the sky;  
And when the sky begins to roar,  
It's like a lion at the door;  
And when the door begins to crack,  
It's like a stick across your back;  
And when your back begins to smart,  
It's like a penknife in your heart;  
And when your heart begins to bleed,  
You're dead, and dead, and dead indeed.

*Unknown.*

---

## **SIMILES**

As wet as a fish—as dry as a bone;  
As live as a bird—as dead as a stone;  
As plump as a partridge—as poor as a rat;  
As strong as a horse—as weak as a cat;  
As hard as a flint—as soft as a mole;  
As white as a lily—as black as a coal;  
As plain as a pike-staff—as rough as a bear;  
As light as a drum—as free as the air;  
As heavy as lead—as light as a feather;  
As steady as time—uncertain as weather;  
As hot as an oven—as cold as a frog;  
As gay as a lark—as sick as a dog;  
As slow as the tortoise—as swift as the wind;  
As true as the Gospel—as false as mankind;  
As thin as a herring—as fat as a pig;

As proud as a peacock—as blithe as a grig;  
As savage as tigers—as mild as a dove;  
As stiff as a poker—as limp as a glove;  
As blind as a bat—as deaf as a post;  
As cool as a cucumber—as warm as a toast;  
As flat as a flounder—as round as a ball;  
As blunt as a hammer—as sharp as an awl;  
As red as a ferret—as safe as the stocks;  
As bold as a thief—as sly as a fox;  
As straight as an arrow—as crook'd as a bow;  
As yellow as saffron—as black as a sloe;  
As brittle as glass—as tough as gristle;  
As neat as my nail—as clean as a whistle;  
As good as a feast—as had as a witch;  
As light as is day—as dark as is pitch;  
As brisk as a bee—as dull as an ass;  
As full as a tick—as solid as brass.

*Unknown.*

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## NO!

No sun—no moon!  
No morn—no noon—  
No dawn—no dusk—no proper time of day—  
No sky—no earthly view—  
No distance looking blue—  
No road—no street—no "t'other side the way"—  
No end to any Row—  
No indications where the Crescents go—  
No top to any steeple—  
No recognitions of familiar people—  
No courtesies for showing 'em—

No knowing 'em!  
No travelling at all—no locomotion,  
No inkling of the way—no notion—  
    "No go"—by land or ocean—  
    No mail—no post—  
    No news from any foreign coast—  
No park—no ring—no afternoon gentility—  
    No company—no nobility—  
No warmth, no cheerfulness, no healthful ease,  
No comfortable feel in any member—  
No shade, no shine, no butterflies, no bees,  
No fruits, no flowers, no leaves, no birds, November!

*Thomas Hood.*

---

## **FAITHLESS SALLY BROWN**

Young Ben he was a nice young man,  
    A carpenter by trade;  
And he fell in love with Sally Brown,  
    That was a lady's maid.

But as they fetched a walk one day,  
    They met a press-gang crew;  
And Sally she did faint away,  
    Whilst Ben he was brought to.

The boatswain swore with wicked words,  
    Enough to shock a saint,  
That though she did seem in a fit,  
    'Twas nothing but a feint.

"Come, girl," said he, "hold up your head,

He'll be as good as me;  
For when your swain is in our boat,  
A boatswain he will be."

So when they'd made their game of her,  
And taken off her elf,  
She roused, and found she only was  
A coming to herself.

"And is he gone, and is he gone?"  
She cried, and wept outright:  
"Then I will to the water side,  
And see him out of sight."

A waterman came up to her,—  
"Now, young woman," said he,  
"If you weep on so, you will make  
Eye-water in the sea."

"Alas! they've taken my beau, Ben,  
To sail with old Benbow;"  
And her woe began to run afresh,  
As if she'd said, "Gee woe!"

Says he, "They've only taken him  
To the Tender-ship, you see;"  
"The Tender-ship," cried Sally Brown,  
"What a hard-ship that must be!

"O! would I were a mermaid now,  
For then I'd follow him;  
But, O!—I'm not a fish-woman,  
And so I cannot swim.

"Alas! I was not born beneath  
The virgin and the scales,  
So I must curse my cruel stars,

And walk about in Wales."

Now Ben had sailed to many a place  
That's underneath the world;  
But in two years the ship came home,  
And all her sails were furled.

But when he called on Sally Brown,  
To see how she got on,  
He found she'd got another Ben,  
Whose Christian name was John.

"O, Sally Brown, O, Sally Brown,  
How could you serve me so?  
I've met with many a breeze before,  
But never such a blow!"

Then reading on his 'bacco-box,  
He heaved a heavy sigh,  
And then began to eye his pipe,  
And then to pipe his eye.

And then he tried to sing "All's Well,"  
But could not, though he tried;  
His head was turned, and so he chewed  
His pigtail till he died.

His death, which happened in his berth,  
At forty-odd befell:  
They went and told the sexton, and  
The sexton tolled the bell.

*Thomas Hood.*

---



## TIM TURPIN

Tim Turpin he was gravel blind,  
And ne'er had seen the skies:  
For Nature, when his head was made,  
Forgot to dot his eyes.

So, like a Christmas pedagogue,  
Poor Tim was forced to do,—  
Look out for pupils, for he had  
A vacancy for two.

There's some have specs to help their sight  
Of objects dim and small;  
But Tim had *specks* within his eyes,  
And could not see at all.

Now Tim he wooed a servant maid,  
And took her to his arms;  
For he, like Pyramus, had cast  
A wall-eye on her charms.

By day she led him up and down  
Where'er he wished to jog,  
A happy wife, although she led  
The life of any dog.

But just when Tim had lived a month  
In honey with his wife,  
A surgeon oped his Milton eyes,  
Like oysters, with a knife.

But when his eyes were opened thus,  
He wished them dark again;  
For when he looked upon his wife,  
He saw her very plain.

Her face was bad, her figure worse,  
He couldn't bear to eat;  
For she was anything but like  
A Grace before his meat.

Now Tim he was a feeling man:  
For when his sight was thick,  
It made him feel for everything,—  
But that was with a stick.

So, with a cudgel in his hand,—  
It was not light or slim,—  
He knocked at his wife's head until  
It opened unto him.

And when the corpse was stiff and cold,  
He took his slaughtered spouse,  
And laid her in a heap with all  
The ashes of her house.

But, like a wicked murderer,  
He lived in constant fear  
From day to day, and so he cut  
His throat from ear to ear.

The neighbors fetched a doctor in:  
Said he, "This wound I dread  
Can hardly be sewed up,—his life  
Is hanging on a thread."

But when another week was gone,  
He gave him stronger hope,—  
Instead of hanging on a thread,  
Of hanging on a rope.

Ah! when he hid his bloody work,

In ashes round about,  
How little he supposed the truth  
Would soon be sifted out!

But when the parish dustman came,  
His rubbish to withdraw,  
He found more dust within the heap  
Than he contracted for!

A dozen men to try the fact,  
Were sworn that very day;  
But though they all were jurors, yet  
No conjurors were they.

Said Tim unto those jurymen,  
"You need not waste your breath,  
For I confess myself, at once,  
The author of her death.

"And O, when I reflect upon  
The blood that I have spilt,  
Just like a button is my soul,  
Inscribed with double *guilt*!"

Then turning round his head again  
He saw before his eyes  
A great judge, and a little judge,  
The judges of a-size!

The great judge took his judgment-cap,  
And put it on his head,  
And sentenced Tim by law to hang  
Till he was three times dead.

So he was tried, and he was hung  
(Fit punishment for such)

On Horsham drop, and none can say  
It was a drop too much.

*Thomas Hood.*

---

## FAITHLESS NELLY GRAY

Ben Battle was a soldier bold,  
And used to war's alarms:  
But a cannon-ball took off his legs,  
So he laid down his arms!

Now, as they bore him off the field,  
Said he, "Let others shoot,  
For here I leave my second leg,  
And the Forty-second Foot!"

The army surgeons made him limbs:  
Said he, "They're only pegs;  
But there's as wooden members quite,  
As represent my legs!"

Now Ben he loved a pretty maid,  
Her name was Nelly Gray;  
So he went to pay her his devours  
When he'd devoured his pay!

But when he called on Nelly Gray,  
She made him quite a scoff;  
And when she saw his wooden legs,  
Began to take them off!

"O Nelly Gray! O Nelly Gray!

Is this your love so warm?  
The love that loves a scarlet coat,  
Should be more uniform!"

Said she, "I loved a soldier once,  
For he was blithe and brave;  
But I will never have a man  
With both legs in the grave!

"Before you had those timber toes,  
Your love I did allow,  
But then you know, you stand upon  
Another footing now!"

"O Nelly Gray! O Nelly Gray!  
For all your jeering speeches,  
At duty's call I left my legs  
In Badajos's breaches!"

"Why, then," said she, "you've lost the feet  
Of legs in war's alarms,  
And now you cannot wear your shoes  
Upon your feats of arms!"

"Oh, false and fickle Nelly Gray;  
I know why you refuse:  
Though I've no feet—some other man  
Is standing in my shoes!

"I wish I ne'er had seen your face;  
But now a long farewell!  
For you will be my death—alas!  
You will not be my Nell!"

Now, when he went from Nelly Gray,  
His heart so heavy got—  
And life was such a burden grown,

It made him take a knot!

So round his melancholy neck  
A rope he did entwine,  
And, for his second time in life  
Enlisted in the Line!

One end he tied around a beam,  
And then removed his pegs,  
And as his legs were off,—of course,  
He soon was off his legs!

And there he hung till he was dead  
As any nail in town,—  
For though distress had cut him up,  
It could not cut him down!

A dozen men sat on his corpse,  
To find out why he died—  
And they buried Ben in four cross-roads,  
With a stake in his inside!

*Thomas Hood.*

---

## **SALLY SIMPKIN'S LAMENT**

"Oh! what is that comes gliding in,  
And quite in middling haste?  
It is the picture of my Jones,  
And painted to the waist.

"It is not painted to the life,  
For where's the trousers blue?

O Jones, my dear!—Oh, dear! my Jones,  
What is become of you?"

"O Sally, dear, it is too true,—  
The half that you remark  
Is come to say my other half  
Is bit off by a shark!

"O Sally, sharks do things by halves,  
Yet most completely do!  
A bite in one place seems enough,  
But I've been bit in two.

"You know I once was all your own,  
But now a shark must share!  
But let that pass—for now to you  
I'm neither here nor there.

"Alas! death has a strange divorce  
Effected in the sea,  
It has divided me from you,  
And even me from me!

"Don't fear my ghost will walk o' nights  
To haunt, as people say;  
My ghost *can't* walk, for, oh! my legs  
Are many leagues away!

"Lord! think when I am swimming round,  
And looking where the boat is,  
A shark just snaps away a *half*,  
Without 'a *quarter's* notice.'

"One half is here, the other half  
Is near Columbia placed;  
O Sally, I have got the whole  
Atlantic for my waist.

"But now, adieu—a long adieu!  
I've solved death's awful riddle,  
And would say more, but I am doomed  
To break off in the middle!"

*Thomas Hood.*

---

## DEATH'S RAMBLE

One day the dreary old King of Death  
Inclined for some sport with the carnal,  
So he tied a pack of darts on his back,  
And quietly stole from his charnel.

His head was bald of flesh and of hair,  
His body was lean and lank;  
His joints at each stir made a crack, and the cur  
Took a gnaw, by the way, at his shank.

And what did he do with his deadly darts,  
This goblin of grisly bone?  
He dabbled and spilled man's blood, and he killed  
Like a butcher that kills his own.

The first he slaughtered it made him laugh  
(For the man was a coffin-maker),  
To think how the mutes, and men in black suits,  
Would mourn for an undertaker.

Death saw two Quakers sitting at church;  
Quoth he, "We shall not differ."  
And he let them alone, like figures of stone,



For he could not make them stiffer.

He saw two duellists going to fight,  
In fear they could not smother;  
And he shot one through at once—for he knew  
They never would shoot each other.

He saw a watchman fast in his box,  
And he gave a snore infernal;  
Said Death, "He may keep his breath, for his sleep  
Can never be more eternal."

He met a coachman driving a coach  
So slow that his fare grew sick;  
But he let him stray on his tedious way,  
For Death only wars on the *quick*.

Death saw a tollman taking a toll,  
In the spirit of his fraternity;  
But he knew that sort of man would extort,  
Though summoned to all eternity.

He found an author writing his life,  
But he let him write no further;  
For Death, who strikes whenever he likes,  
Is jealous of all self-murder!

Death saw a patient that pulled out his purse,  
And a doctor that took the sum;  
But he let them be—for he knew that the "fee"  
Was a prelude to "faw" and "fum."

He met a dustman ringing a bell,  
And he gave him a mortal thrust;  
For himself, by law, since Adam's flaw,  
Is contractor for all our dust.

He saw a sailor mixing his grog,  
And he marked him out for slaughter;  
For on water he scarcely had cared for death,  
And never on rum-and-water.

Death saw two players playing at cards,  
But the game wasn't worth a dump,  
For he quickly laid them flat with a spade,  
To wait for the final trump!

*Thomas Hood.*

---

## **PANEGYRIC ON THE LADIES**

### **READ ALTERNATE LINES**

That man must lead a happy life  
Who's free from matrimonial chains,  
Who is directed by a wife  
Is sure to suffer for his pains.

Adam could find no solid peace  
When Eve was given for a mate;  
Until he saw a woman's face  
Adam was in a happy state.

In all the female race appear  
Hypocrisy, deceit, and pride;  
Truth, darling of a heart sincere,  
In woman never did reside.

What tongue is able to unfold  
The failings that in woman dwell?

The worth in woman we behold  
Is almost imperceptible.

Confusion take the man, I say,  
Who changes from his singleness,  
Who will not yield to woman's sway  
Is sure of earthly blessedness.

*Unknown.*

---

## AMBIGUOUS LINES

**READ WITH A COMMA AFTER THE FIRST NOUN IN EACH  
LINE**

I saw a peacock with a fiery tail  
I saw a blazing comet pour down hail  
I saw a cloud all wrapt with ivy round  
I saw a lofty oak creep on the ground  
I saw a beetle swallow up a whale  
I saw a foaming sea brimful of ale  
I saw a pewter cup sixteen feet deep  
I saw a well full of men's tears that weep  
I saw wet eyes in flames of living fire  
I saw a house as high as the moon and higher  
I saw the glorious sun at deep midnight  
I saw the man who saw this wondrous sight.

I saw a pack of cards gnawing a bone  
I saw a dog seated on Britain's throne  
I saw King George shut up within a box  
I saw an orange driving a fat ox  
I saw a butcher not a twelvemonth old

I saw a great-coat all of solid gold  
I saw two buttons telling of their dreams  
I saw my friends who wished I'd quit these themes.

*Unknown.*

---

## SURNAMES

Men once were surnamed for their shape or estate  
(You all may from history worm it),  
There was Louis the bulky, and Henry the Great,  
John Lackland, and Peter the Hermit:  
But now, when the doorplates of misters and dames  
Are read, each so constantly varies;  
From the owner's trade, figure, and calling, surnames  
Seem given by the rule of contraries.

Mr. Wise is a dunce, Mr. King is a whig,  
Mr. Coffin's uncommonly sprightly,  
And huge Mr. Little broke down in a gig  
While driving fat Mrs. Golightly.  
At Bath, where the feeble go more than the stout  
(A conduct well worthy of Nero),  
Over poor Mr. Lightfoot, confined with the gout,  
Mr. Heavyside danced a bolero.

Miss Joy, wretched maid, when she chose Mr. Love,  
Found nothing but sorrow await her;  
She now holds in wedlock, as true as a dove,  
That fondest of mates, Mr. Hayter.  
Mr. Oldcastle dwells in a modern-built hut;  
Miss Sage is of madcaps the archest;  
Of all the queer bachelors Cupid e'er cut,

Old Mr. Younghusband's the starchest.

Mr. Child, in a passion, knock'd down Mr. Rock;  
Mr. Stone like an aspen-leaf shivers;  
Miss Pool used to dance, but she stands like a stock  
Ever since she became Mrs. Rivers.  
Mr. Swift hobbles onward, no mortal knows how,  
He moves as though cords had entwined him;  
Mr. Metcalf ran off upon meeting a cow,  
With pale Mr. Turnbull behind him.

Mr. Barker's as mute as a fish in the sea,  
Mr. Miles never moves on a journey,  
Mr. Gotobed sits up till half after three,  
Mr. Makepeace was bred an attorney.  
Mr. Gardener can't tell a flower from a root,  
Mr. Wild with timidity draws back,  
Mr. Ryder performs all his journeys on foot,  
Mr. Foot all his journeys on horseback.

Mr. Penny, whose father was rolling in wealth,  
Consumed all the fortune his dad won;  
Large Mr. Le Fever's the picture of health;  
Mr. Goodenough is but a bad one;  
Mr. Cruikshank stept into three thousand a year  
By showing his leg to an heiress:  
Now I hope you'll acknowledge I've made it quite clear  
Surnames ever go by contraries.

*James Smith.*

---

**A TERNARY OF LITTLES, UPON A PIPKIN OF JELLY  
SENT TO A LADY**

A little saint best fits a little shrine,  
A little prop best fits a little vine;  
As my small cruse best fits my little wine.

A little seed best fits a little soil,  
A little trade best fits a little toil;  
As my small jar best fits my little oil.

A little bin best fits a little bread,  
A little garland fits a little head;  
As my small stuff best fits my little shed.

A little hearth best fits a little fire,  
A little chapel fits a little choir;  
As my small bell best fits my little spire.

A little stream best fits a little boat,  
A little lead best fits a little float;  
As my small pipe best fits my little note.

A little meat best fits a little belly,  
As sweetly, lady, give me leave to tell ye,  
This little pipkin fits this little jelly.

*Robert Herrick.*

---

## **A CARMAN'S ACCOUNT OF A LAW-SUIT**

Marry, I lent my gossip my mare, to fetch home coals,  
And he her drownéd into the quarry holes;  
And I ran to the Consistory, for to 'plain,  
And there I happened among a greedy meine.

They gave me first a thing they call Citandum;  
Within eight days, I got but Libellandum;  
Within a month, I got Ad oppenendum;  
In half a year, I got Interloquendum;  
And then I got—how call ye it?—Ad replicandum.  
But I could never one word yet understand them;  
And then, they caused me cast out many placks,  
And made me pay for four-and-twenty acts.  
But, ere they came half gait to Concludendum,  
The fiend one plack was left for to defend him.  
Thus they postponed me two years, with their train,  
Then, hodie ad octo, bade me come again,  
And then, these rooks, they roupit wonder fast,  
For sentence silver, they criéd at the last.  
Of Pronunciandum they made me wonder fain;  
But I got never my good grey mare again.

*Sir David Lindesay.*

---

## OUT OF SIGHT, OUT OF MIND

The oft'ner seen, the more I lust,  
The more I lust, the more I smart,  
The more I smart, the more I trust,  
The more I trust, the heavier heart,  
The heavy heart breeds mine unrest,  
Thy absence therefore I like best.

The rarer seen, the less in mind,  
The less in mind, the lesser pain,  
The lesser pain, less grief I find,  
The lesser grief, the greater gain,  
The greater gain, the merrier I,

Therefore I wish thy sight to fly.

The further off, the more I joy,  
The more I joy, the happier life,  
The happier life, less hurts annoy,  
The lesser hurts, pleasure most rife,  
Such pleasures rife shall I obtain  
When distance doth depart us train.

*Barnaby Googe.*

---

## NONGTONGPAW

John Bull for pastime took a prance,  
Some time ago, to peep at France;  
To talk of sciences and arts,  
And knowledge gain'd in foreign parts.  
Monsieur, obsequious, heard him speak,  
And answer'd John in heathen Greek:  
To all he ask'd, 'bout all he saw,  
'Twas, *Monsieur, je vous n'entends pas.*

John, to the Palais-Royal come,  
Its splendor almost struck him dumb.  
"I say, whose house is that there here?"  
"House! *Je vous n'entends pas, Monsieur.*"  
"What, Nongtongpaw again!" cries John;  
"This fellow is some mighty Don:  
No doubt he's plenty for the maw,  
I'll breakfast with this Nongtongpaw."

John saw Versailles from Marli's height,  
And cried, astonish'd at the sight,



"Whose fine estate is that there here?"  
"State! *Je vous n'entends pas, Monsieur.*"  
"His? what! the land and houses, too?  
The fellow's richer than a Jew:  
On *everything* he lays his claw!  
I'd like to dine with Nongtongpaw."

Next tripping came a courtly fair,  
John cried, enchanted with her air,  
"What lovely wench is that there here?"  
"Ventch! *Je vous n'entends pas, Monsieur.*"  
"What, he again? Upon, my life!  
A palace, lands, and then a wife  
Sir Joshua might delight to draw!  
I'd like to sup with Nongtongpaw."

"But hold! whose funeral's that?" cries John.  
"*Je vous n'entends pas.*"—"What! is he gone?  
Wealth, fame, and beauty could not save  
Poor Nongtongpaw then from the grave!  
His race is run, his game is up,—  
I'd with him breakfast, dine, and sup;  
But since he chooses to withdraw,  
Good night t'ye, Mounseer Nongtongpaw!"

*Charles Dibdin.*

---

## LOGICAL ENGLISH

I said, "This horse, sir, will you shoe?"  
And soon the horse was shod.  
I said, "This deed, sir, will you do?"  
And soon the deed was dod!

I said, "This stick, sir, will you break?"  
At once the stick he broke.  
I said, "This coat, sir, will you make?"  
And soon the coat he moke!

*Unknown.*

---

## **LOGIC**

I have a copper penny and another copper penny,  
Well, then, of course, I have two copper pence;  
I have a cousin Jenny and another cousin Jenny,  
Well, pray, then, do I have two cousin Jence?

*Unknown.*

---

## **THE CAREFUL PENMAN**

A Persian penman named Aziz,  
Remarked, "I think I know my biz.  
For when I write my name as is,  
It is Aziz as is Aziz."

*Unknown.*

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## QUESTIONS WITH ANSWERS

What is earth, sexton?—A place to dig graves;  
What is earth, rich men?—A place to work slaves,  
What is earth, grey-beard?—A place to grow old;  
What is earth, miser?—A place to dig gold;  
What is earth, school-boy?—A place for my play;  
What is earth, maiden?—A place to be gay;  
What is earth, seamstress?—A place where I weep;  
What is earth, sluggard?—A good place to sleep;  
What is earth, soldier?—A place for a battle;  
What is earth, herdsman?—A place to raise cattle;  
What is earth, widow?—A place of true sorrow;  
What is earth, tradesman?—I'll tell you to-morrow;  
What is earth, sick man?—'Tis nothing to me;  
What is earth, sailor?—My home is the sea;  
What is earth, statesman?—A place to win fame;  
What is earth, author?—I'll write there my name;  
What is earth, monarch?—For my realm 'tis given;  
What is earth, Christian?—The gateway of heaven.

*Unknown.*

---

## CONJUGAL CONJUGATIONS

Dear maid, let me speak  
What I never yet spoke:  
You have made my heart squeak  
As it never yet squoke,  
And for sight of you, both my eyes ache as they ne'er before oak.  
  
With your voice my ears ring,

And a sweeter ne'er rung,  
Like a bird's on the wing  
When at morn it has wung.  
And gladness to me it doth bring, such as never voice brung.

My feelings I'd write,  
But they cannot be wrote,  
And who can indite  
What was never indote!  
And my love I hasten to plight—the first that I plote.

Yes, you would I choose,  
Whom I long ago chose,  
And my fond spirit sues  
As it never yet sose,  
And ever on you do I muse, as never man mose.

The house where you bide  
Is a blessed abode;  
Sure, my hopes I can't hide,  
For they will not be hode,  
And no person living has sighed, as, darling, I've sode.

Your glances they shine  
As no others have shone,  
And all else I'd resign  
That a man could resone,  
And surely no other could pine as I lately have pone.

And don't you forget  
You will ne'er be forgot,  
You never should fret  
As at times you have frot,  
I would chase all the cares that beset, if they ever besot.

For you I would weave  
Songs that never were wove,

And deeds I'd achieve  
Which no man yet arove,  
And for me you never should grieve, as for you I have grove.

I'm as worthy a catch  
As ever, was caught.  
O, your answer I watch  
As a man never waught,  
And we'd make the most elegant match as ever was maught.

Let my longings not sink;  
I would die if they sunk.  
O, I ask you to think  
As you never have thunk,  
And our fortunes and lives let us link, as no lives could be lunk.

*A. W. Bellow.*

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## **LOVE'S MOODS AND SENSES**

Sally Salter, she was a young lady who taught,  
And her friend Charley Church was a preacher who praught!  
Though his enemies called him a screecher who scraught.

His heart when he saw her kept sinking and sunk,  
And his eye, meeting hers, began winking and wunk;  
While she in her turn fell to thinking, and thunk.

He hastened to woo her, and sweetly he wooed,  
For his love grew until to a mountain it grewed,  
And what he was longing to do then he doed.

In secret he wanted to speak, and he spoke,  
To seek with his lips what his heart long had soke;

So he managed to let the truth leak, and it loke.

He asked her to ride to the church, and they rode,  
They so sweetly did glide, that they both thought they glode,  
And they came to the place to be tied, and were tode.

Then, "homeward" he said, "let us drive" and they drove,  
And soon as they wished to arrive, they arrove;  
For whatever he couldn't contrive she controve.

The kiss he was dying to steal, then he stole:  
At the feet where he wanted to kneel, then he knole,  
And said, "I feel better than ever I fole."

So they to each other kept clinging, and clung;  
While time his swift circuit was winging, and wung;  
And this was the thing he was bringing, and brung:

The man Sally wanted to catch, and had caught—  
That she wanted from others to snatch, and had snaught—  
Was the one that she now liked to scratch and she scraught.

And Charley's warm love began freezing and froze,  
While he took to teasing, and cruelly toze  
The girl he had wished to be squeezing and squoze.

"Wretch!" he cried, when she threatened to leave him, and left,  
"How could you deceive me, as you have deceft?"  
And she answered, "I promised to cleave, and I've cleft!"

*Unknown.*

---

## THE SIEGE OF BELGRADE

An Austrian army, awfully array'd,  
Boldly by battery besiege Belgrade;  
Cossack commanders cannonading come,  
Deal devastation's dire destructive doom;  
Ev'ry endeavour engineers essay,  
For fame, for freedom, fight, fierce furious fray.  
Gen'ral's 'gainst gen'ral's grapple,—gracious God!  
How honors Heav'n heroic hardihood!  
Infuriate, indiscriminate in ill,  
Just Jesus, instant innocence instill!  
Kinsmen kill kinsmen, kindred kindred kill.  
Labour low levels longest, loftiest lines;  
Men march 'midst mounds, motes, mountains, murd'rous mines.  
Now noisy, noxious numbers notice nought,  
Of outward obstacles o'ercoming ought;  
Poor patriots perish, persecution's pest!  
Quite quiet Quakers "Quarter, quarter," quest;  
Reason returns, religion, right, redounds,  
Suwarow stop such sanguinary sounds!  
Truce to thee, Turkey, terror to thy train!  
Unwise, unjust, unmerciful Ukraine!  
Vanish vile vengeance, vanish victory vain!  
Why wish we warfare? wherefore welcome won  
Xerxes, Nantippus, Navier, Xenophon?  
Yield, ye young Yaghier yeomen, yield your yell!  
Zimmerman's, Zoroaster's, Zeno's zeal  
Again attract; arts against arms appeal.  
All, all ambitious aims, avaunt, away!  
Et cetera, et cetera, et ceterae.

*Unknown.*

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## THE HAPPY MAN

La Galisse now I wish to touch;  
Droll air! if I can strike it,  
I'm sure the song will please you much;  
That is, if you should like it.

La Galisse was, indeed, I grant,  
Not used to any dainty,  
When he was born; but could not want  
As long as he had plenty.

Instructed with the greatest care,  
He always was well bred,  
And never used a hat to wear  
But when 'twas on his head.

His temper was exceeding good,  
Just of his father's fashion;  
And never quarrels boiled his blood  
Except when in a passion.

His mind was on devotion bent;  
He kept with care each high day,  
And Holy Thursday always spent  
The day before Good Friday.

He liked good claret very well,  
I just presume to think it;  
For ere its flavour he could tell  
He thought it best to drink it.

Than doctors more he loved the cook,  
Though food would make him gross,  
And never any physic took  
But when he took a dose.

Oh, happy, happy is the swain



The ladies so adore;  
For many followed in his train  
Whene'er he walked before.

Bright as the sun his flowing hair  
In golden ringlets shone;  
And no one could with him compare,  
If he had been alone.

His talents I cannot rehearse,  
But every one allows  
That whatsoe'er he wrote in verse,  
No one could call it prose.

He argued with precision nice,  
The learned all declare;  
And it was his decision wise,  
No horse could be a mare.

His powerful logic would surprise,  
Amaze, and much delight:  
He proved that dimness of the eyes  
Was hurtful to the sight.

They liked him much—so it appears  
Most plainly—who preferred him;  
And those did never want their ears  
Who any time had heard him.

He was not always right, 'tis true,  
And then he must be wrong;  
But none had found it out, he knew,  
If he had held his tongue.

Whene'er a tender tear he shed,  
'Twas certain that he wept;  
And he would lie awake in bed,

Unless, indeed, he slept.

In tilting everybody knew  
His very high renown;  
Yet no opponents he o'erthrew  
But those that he knocked down.

At last they smote him in the head,—  
What hero ever fought all?  
And when they saw that he was dead,  
They knew the wound was mortal.

And when at last he lost his breath,  
It closed his every strife;  
For that sad day that sealed his death  
Deprived him of his life.

*Gilles Ménage.*

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## THE BELLS

Oh, it's H-A-P-P-Y I am, and it's F-R-double-E,  
And it's G-L-O-R-Y to know that I'm S-A-V-E-D.  
Once I was B-O-U-N-D by the chains of S-I-N  
And it's L-U-C-K-Y I am that all is well again.

Oh, the bells of Hell go ting-a-ling-a-ling  
For you, but not for me.  
The bells of Heaven go sing-a-ling-a-ling  
For there I soon shall be.  
Oh, Death, where is thy sting-a-ling-a-ling  
Oh, Grave, thy victorie-e.

No Ting-a-ling-a-ling, no sting-a-ling-a-ling  
But sing-a-ling-a-ling for me.

*Unknown.*

---

## TAKINGS

He took her fancy when he came,  
He took her hand, he took a kiss,  
He took no notice of the shame  
That glowed her happy cheek at this.

He took to come of afternoons,  
He took an oath he'd ne'er deceive,  
He took her master's silver spoons,  
And after that he took his leave.

*Thomas Hood, Jr.*

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## A BACHELOR'S MONO-RHYME

Do you think I'd marry a woman  
That can neither cook nor sew,  
Nor mend a rent in her gloves  
Or a tuck in her furbelow;  
Who spends her time in reading  
The novels that come and go;  
Who tortures heavenly music,  
And makes it a thing of woe;

Who deems three-fourths of my income  
Too little, by half, to show  
What a figure she'd make, if I'd let her,  
'Mid the belles of Rotten Row;  
Who has not a thought in her head  
Where thoughts are expected to grow,  
Except of trumpery scandals  
Too small for a man to know?  
Do you think I'd wed with *that*,  
Because both high and low  
Are charmed by her youthful graces  
And her shoulders white as snow?  
Ah no! I've a wish to be happy,  
I've a thousand a year or so,  
'Tis all I can expect  
That fortune will bestow!  
So, pretty one, idle one, stupid one!  
You're not for me, I trow,  
To-day, nor yet to-morrow,  
No, no! decidedly no!

*Charlts Mackay.*

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## THE ART OF BOOK-KEEPING

How hard, when those who do not wish  
To lend, that's lose, their books,  
Are snared by anglers—folks that fish  
With literary hooks;

Who call and take some favourite tome,  
But never read it through;  
They thus complete their set at home,

By making one at you.

Behold the bookshelf of a dunce  
Who borrows—never lends;  
Yon work, in twenty volumes, once  
Belonged to twenty friends.

New tales and novels you may shut  
From view—'tis all in vain;  
They're gone—and though the leaves are "cut"  
They never "come again."

For pamphlets lent I look around,  
For tracts my tears are spilt;  
But when they take a book that's bound,  
'Tis surely extra guilt.

A circulating library  
Is mine—my birds are flown;  
There's one odd volume left, to be  
Like all the rest, a-lone.

I, of my "Spenser" quite bereft,  
Last winter sore was shaken;  
Of "Lamb" I've but a quarter left,  
Nor could I save my "Bacon."

My "Hall" and "Hill" were levelled flat,  
But "Moore" was still the cry;  
And then, although I threw them "Sprat,"  
They swallowed up my "Pye."

O'er everything, however slight,  
They seized some airy trammel;  
They snatched my "Hogg" and "Fox" one night,  
And pocketed my "Campbell."

And then I saw my "Crabbe" at last,  
Like Hamlet's, backward go;  
And as my tide was ebbing fast,  
Of course I lost my "Rowe."

I wondered into what balloon  
My books their course had bent;  
And yet, with all my marvelling, soon  
I found my "Marvell" went.

My "Mallet" served to knock me down,  
Which makes me thus a talker;  
And once, while I was out of town,  
My "Johnson" proved a "Walker."

While studying o'er the fire one day  
My "Hobbes" amidst the smoke;  
They bore my "Colman" clean away,  
And carried off my "Coke."

They picked my "Locke," to me far more  
Than Bramah's patent's worth;  
And now my losses I deplore,  
Without a "Home" on earth.

If once a book you let them lift,  
Another they conceal,  
For though I caught them stealing "Swift,"  
As swiftly went my "Steele."

"Hope" is not now upon my shelf,  
Where late he stood elated;  
But, what is strange, my "Pope" himself  
Is excommunicated.

My little "Suckling" in the grave  
Is sunk, to swell the ravage;

And what 'twas Crusoe's fate to save  
    'Twas mine to lose—a "Savage."

Even "Glover's" works I cannot put  
    My frozen hands upon;  
Though ever since I lost my "Foote,"  
    My "Bunyan" has been gone.

My "Hoyle" with "Cotton" went; oppressed,  
    My "Taylor" too must fail;  
To save my "Goldsmith" from arrest,  
    In vain I offered "Bayle."

I "Prior," sought, but could not see  
    The "Hood" so late in front;  
And when I turned to hunt for "Lee,"  
    Oh! where was my "Leigh Hunt!"

I tried to laugh, old care to tickle,  
    Yet could not "Tickell" touch;  
And then, alas! I missed my "Mickle,"  
    And surely mickle's much.

'Tis quite enough my griefs to feed,  
    My sorrows to excuse,  
To think I cannot read my "Reid,"  
    Nor even use my "Hughes."

To "West," to "South," I turn my head,  
    Exposed alike to odd jeers;  
For since my "Roger Ascham's" fled,  
    I ask 'em for my "Rogers."

They took my "Horne"—and "Horne Tooke" too,  
    And thus my treasures flit;  
I feel when I would "Hazlitt" view,  
    The flames that it has lit.

My word's worth little, "Wordsworth" gone,  
If I survive its doom;  
How many a bard I doted on  
Was swept off—with my "Broome."

My classics would not quiet lie,  
A thing so fondly hoped;  
Like Dr. Primrose, I may cry,  
"My 'Livy' has eloped!"

My life is wasting fast away—  
I suffer from these shocks;  
And though I fixed a lock on "Grey"  
There's grey upon my locks.

I'm far from young—am growing pale—  
I see my "Butter" fly;  
And when they ask about my *ail*,  
'Tis "Burton" I reply.

They still have made me slight returns,  
And thus my griefs divide;  
For oh! they've cured me of my "Burns,"  
And eased my "Akenside."

But all I think I shall not say,  
Nor let my anger burn;  
For as they never found me "Gay,"  
They have not left me "Sterne."

*Laman Blanchard.*

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**AN INVITATION TO THE ZOOLOGICAL GARDENS**



## BY A STUTTERING LOVER

I have found out a gig-gig-gift for my fuf-fuf-fair,  
I have found where the rattlesnakes bub-bub-breed;  
Will you co-co-come, and I'll show you the bub-bub-bear,  
And the lions and tit-tit-tigers at fuf-fuf-feed.

I know where the co-co-cockatoo's song  
Makes mum-mum-melody through the sweet vale;  
Where the mum-monkeys gig-gig-grin all the day long,  
Or gracefully swing by the tit-tit-tit-tail.

You shall pip-play, dear, some did-did-delicate joke  
With the bub-bub-bear on the tit-tit-top of his pip-pip-pip-pole;  
But observe, 'tis forbidden to pip-pip-poke  
At the bub-bub-bear with your pip-pip-pink pip-pip-pip-pip-parasol!

You shall see the huge elephant pip-pip-play,  
You shall gig-gig-gaze on the stit-stit-stately raccoon;  
And then, did-did-dear, together we'll stray  
To the cage of the bub-bub-blue-faced bab-bab-boon.

You wished (I r-r-remember it well,  
And I lul-lul-loved you the m-m-more for the wish)  
To witness the bub-bub-beautiful pip-pip-pelican  
swallow the l-l-live little fuf-fuf-fish!

*Unknown.*

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## A NOCTURNAL SKETCH

Even is come; and from the dark Park, hark,  
The signal of the setting sun—one gun!

And six is sounding from the chime, prime time  
To go and see the Drury-Lane, Dane slain,—  
Or hear Othello's jealous doubt spout out,—  
Or Macbeth raving at that shade-made blade,  
Denying to his frantic clutch much touch;—  
Or else to see Ducrow with wide stride ride  
Four horses as no other man can span;  
Or in the small Olympic Pit, sit split  
Laughing at Liston, while you quiz his phiz.  
Anon Night comes, and with her wings brings things  
Such as, with his poetic tongue, Young sung;  
The gas up-blazes with its bright white light,  
And paralytic watchmen prowl, howl, growl,  
About the streets and take up Pall-Mall Sal,  
Who, hasting to her nightly jobs, robs fobs.

Now thieves to enter for your cash, smash, crash,  
Past drowsy Charley, in a deep sleep, creep,  
But frightened by Policeman B 3, flee,  
And while they're going, whisper low, "No go!"  
Now puss, while folks are in their beds, treads leads.  
And sleepers waking, grumble—"Drat that cat!"  
Who in the gutter caterwauls, squalls, mauls  
Some feline foe, and screams in shrill ill-will.

Now Bulls of Bashan, of a prize size, rise  
In childish dreams, and with a roar gore poor  
Georgy, or Charley, or Billy, willy-nilly;—  
But Nursemaid, in a nightmare rest, chest-pressed,  
Dreameth of one of her old flames, James Games,  
And that she hears—what faith is man's!—Ann's banns  
And his, from Reverend Mr. Rice, twice, thrice:  
White ribbons flourish, and a stout shout out,  
That upward goes, shows Rose knows those bows' woes!

*Thomas Hood.*

---

## LOVELILTS

Thine eyes, dear one, dot dot, are like, dash, what?  
They, pure as sacred oils, bless and anoint  
My sin-swamped soul which at thy feet sobs out,  
O exclamation point, O point, O point!

Ah, had I words, blank blank, which, dot, I've not,  
I'd swoon in songs which should'st illumine the dark  
With light of thee. Ah, God (it's *strong* to swear)  
Why, why, interrogation mark, why, mark?

Dot dot dot dot. And so, dash, yet, but nay!  
My tongue takes pause; some words must not be said,  
For fear the world, cold hyphen-eyed, austere,  
Should'st shake thee by the throat till reason fled.

One hour of love we've had. Dost thou recall  
Dot dot dash blank interrogation mark?  
The night was ours, blue heaven over all  
Dash, God! dot stars, keep thou our secret dark!

*Marion Hill.*

---

## JOCOSA LYRA

In our hearts is the Great One of Avon  
Engraven,  
And we climb the cold summits once built on  
By Milton.

But at times not the air that is rarest  
Is fairest,  
And we long in the valley to follow  
Apollo.

Then we drop from the heights atmospheric  
To Herrick,  
Or we pour the Greek honey, grown blander,  
Of Landor;

Or our cosiest nook in the shade is  
Where Praed is,  
Or we toss the light bells of the mocker  
With Locker.

Oh, the song where not one of the Graces  
Tight-laces,—  
Where we woo the sweet Muses not starchly  
But archly,—

Where the verse, like a piper a-Maying,  
Comes playing,—  
And the rhyme is as gay as a dancer  
In answer,—

It will last till men weary of pleasure  
In measure!  
It will last till men weary of laughter ...  
And after!

*Austin Dobson.*

---

**TO A THESAURUS**

O precious code, volume, tome,  
Book, writing, compilation, work  
Attend the while I pen a pome,  
A jest, a jape, a quip, a quirk.

For I would pen, engross, indite,  
Transcribe, set forth, compose, address,  
Record, submit—yea, even write  
An ode, an elegy to bless—

To bless, set store by, celebrate,  
Approve, esteem, endow with soul,  
Commend, acclaim, appreciate,  
Immortalize, laud, praise, extol.

Thy merit, goodness, value, worth,  
Experience, utility—  
O manna, honey, salt of earth,  
I sing, I chant, I worship thee!

How could I manage, live, exist,  
Obtain, produce, be real, prevail,  
Be present in the flesh, subsist,  
Have place, become, breathe or inhale.

Without thy help, recruit, support,  
Opitulation, furtherance,  
Assistance, rescue, aid, resort,  
Favour, sustention and advance?

Alack! Alack! and well-a-day!  
My case would then be dour and sad,  
Likewise distressing, dismal, gray,  
Pathetic, mournful, dreary, bad.

---

Though I could keep this up all day,  
This lyric, elegiac, song,  
Meseems hath come the time to say  
Farewell! Adieu! Good-by! So long!

*Franklin P. Adams.*

---

## THE FUTURE OF THE CLASSICS

No longer, O scholars, shall Plautus  
Be taught us.  
No more shall professors be partial  
To Martial.  
No ninny  
Will stop playing "shinney"  
For Pliny.  
Not even the veriest Mexican Greaser  
Will stop to read Cæsar.  
No true son of Erin will leave his potato  
To list to the love-lore of Ovid or Plato.  
Old Homer,  
That hapless old roamer,  
Will ne'er find a rest 'neath collegiate dome or  
Anywhere else. As to Seneca,  
Any cur  
Safely may snub him, or urge ill  
Effects from the reading of Virgil.  
Cornelius Nepos  
Wont keep us  
Much longer from pleasure's light errands—  
Nor Terence.  
The irreverent now may all scoff in ease  
At the shade of poor old Aristophanes.

And moderns it now doth behoove in all  
Ways to despise poor old Juvenal;  
And to chivvy  
Livy.  
The class-room hereafter will miss a row  
Of eager young students of Cicero.  
The 'longshoreman—yes, and the dock-rat, he's  
Down upon Socrates.  
And what'll  
Induce us to read Aristotle?  
We shall fail in  
Our duty to Galen.  
No tutor henceforward shall rack us  
To construe old Horatius Flaccus.  
We have but a wretched opinion  
Of Mr. Justinian.  
In our classical pabulum mix we've no wee sop  
Of Æsop.  
Our balance of intellect asks for no ballast  
From Sallust.  
With feminine scorn no fair Vassar-bred lass at us  
Shall smile if we own that we cannot read Tacitus.  
No admirer shall ever now weathe with begonias  
The bust of Suetonius.  
And so, if you follow me,  
We'll have to cut Ptolemy.  
Besides, it would just be considered facetious  
To look at Lucretius.  
And you can  
Not go in Society if 'you read Lucan,  
And we cannot have any fun  
Out of Xenophon.

*Unknown.*

---

## CAUTIONARY VERSES

My little dears, who learn to read, pray early, learn to shun  
That very silly thing indeed which people call a pun;  
Read Entick's rules, and 'twill be found how simple an offence  
It is to make the selfsame sound afford a double sense.

For instance, ale may make you ail, your aunt an ant may kill,  
You in a vale may buy a veil and Bill may pay the bill.  
Or if to France your bark you steer, at Dover it may be  
A peer appears upon the pier, who blind, still goes to sea.

Thus, one might say, when, to a treat, good friends accept our greeting,  
'Tis meet that men who meet to eat should eat their meat when meeting;  
Brawn on the board's no bore indeed, although from boar prepared;  
Nor can the fowl on which we feed, foul feeding be declared.

Thus one ripe fruit may be a pear, and yet be pared again,  
And still be one, which seemeth rare until we do explain.  
It therefore should be all your aim to speak with ample care,  
For who, however fond of game, would choose to swallow hair?

A fat man's gait may make us smile, who have no gate to close;  
The farmer sitting on his stile no stylish person knows.  
Perfumers men of scents must be; some Scilly men are bright;  
A brown man oft deep read we see, a black a wicked wight.

Most wealthy men good manors have, however vulgar they;  
And actors still the harder slave the oftener they play;  
So poets can't the baize obtain, unless their tailors choose;  
While grooms and coachmen, not in vain, each evening seek the Mews.

The dyer, who by dyeing lives, a dire life maintains;  
The glazier, it is known, receives his profits for his panes;  
By gardeners thyme is tied, 'tis true, when spring is in its prime,  
But time or tide won't wait for you if you are tied for time.

Then now you see, my little dears, the way to make a pun;



A trick which you, through coming years, should sedulously shun;  
The fault admits of no defence; for wheresoe'er 'tis found,  
You sacrifice for sound the sense; the sense is never sound.

So let your words and actions too, one single meaning prove,  
And, just in all you say or do, you'll gain esteem and love;  
In mirth and play no harm you'll know when duty's task is done,  
But parents ne'er should let you go unpunished for a pun!

*Theodore Hook.*

---

## **THE WAR: A-Z**

An Austrian Archduke, assaulted and assailed,  
Broke Belgium's barriers, by Britain bewailed,  
Causing consternation, confused chaotic crises;  
Diffusing destructive, death dealing devices.  
England engaged earnestly, eager every ear,  
France fought furiously, forsaking foolish fear,  
Great German garrisons grappled Gallic guard,  
Hohenzollern Hussars hammered, heavy, hard.  
Infantry, Imperial, Indian, Irish, intermingling,  
Jackets jaunty, joking, jesting, jostling, jingling.  
Kinetic, Kruppised Kaiser, kingdom's killing knight,  
Laid Louvain lamenting, London lacking light,  
Mobilising millions, marvellous mobility,  
Numberless nonentities, numerous nobility.  
Oligarchies olden opposed olive offering,  
Prussia pressed Paris, Polish protection proffering,  
Quaint Quebec quickly quartered quotidian quota,  
Renascent Russia, resonant, reported regal rota.  
Scotch soldiers, sterling, songs stalwart sung,  
"Tipperary" thundered through titanic tongue.

United States urging unarmament, unwanted,  
Visualised victory vociferously vaunted,  
Wilson's warnings wasted, world war wild,  
Xenian Nanthochroi Nantippically X-iled.  
Yorkshire's young yeomen yelling youthfully,  
"Zigzag Zeppelins, Zuyder Zee."

*John R. Edwards.*

---

## **LINES TO MISS FLORENCE HUNTINGDON**

Sweet maiden of Passamaquoddy  
Shall we seek for communion of souls  
Where the deep Mississippi meanders  
Or the distant Saskatchewan rolls?

Ah, no!—for in Maine I will find thee  
A sweetly sequestered nook,  
Where the far-winding Skoodoowabskooksis  
Conjoins with the Skoodoowabskook.

There wander two beautiful rivers,  
With many a winding and crook:  
The one is the Skoodoowabskooksis;  
The other, the Skoodoowabskook.

Ah, sweetest of haunts! though unmentioned  
In geography, atlas, or book,  
How fair is the Skoodoowabskooksis,  
When joining the Skoodoowabskook!

Our cot shall be close by the waters,  
Within that sequestered nook,

Reflected by Skoodoowabskooksis,  
And mirrored in Skoodoowabskook.

You shall sleep to the music of leaflets,  
By zephyrs in wantonness shook,  
To dream of the Skoodoowabskooksis,  
And, perhaps, of the Skoodoowabskook.

Your food shall be fish from the waters,  
Drawn forth on the point of a hook,  
From murmuring Skoodoowabskooksis,  
Or meandering Skoodoowabskook.

You shall quaff the most sparkling of waters,  
Drawn forth from a silvery brook,  
Which flows to the Skoodoowabskooksis,  
And so to the Skoodoowabskook.

And you shall preside at the banquet,  
And I shall wait on you as cook;  
And we'll talk of the Skoodoowabskooksis,  
And sing of the Skoodoowabskook.

Let others sing loudly of Saco,  
Of Quoddy and Tattamagouche,  
Of Kenebeccasis and Quaco,  
Of Merigoniche and Buctouche,

Of Nashwaak and Magaguadavique,  
Or Memmerimammericook:—  
There's none like the Skoodoowabskooksis,  
Excepting the Skoodoowabskook!

*Unknown.*

---

## TO MY NOSE

Knows he that never took a pinch,  
Nosey, the pleasure thence which flows,  
Knows he the titillating joys  
    Which my nose knows?  
O Nose, I am as proud of thee  
As any mountain of its snows,  
I gaze on thee, and feel that pride  
    A Roman knows!

*Albert A. Forrester (Alfred Crowquill).*

---

## A POLKA LYRIC

Qui nunc dancere vult modo,  
Wants to dance in the fashion, oh!  
Discere debet—ought to know,  
Kickere floor cum heel and toe,  
    One, two, three,  
    Hop with me,  
Whirligig, twirligig, rapide.

Polkam jungere, Virgo, vis,  
Will you join the polka, miss?  
Liberius—most willingly,  
Sic agimus—then let us try:  
    Nunc vide,  
    Skip with me,  
Whirlabout, roundabout, celere.

Tum læva cito, turn dextra,

First to the left, and then t'other way;  
Aspice retro in vultu,  
You look at her, and she looks at you.  
Das palmam  
Change hands, ma'am;  
Celere—run away, just in sham.

*Barclay Philips.*

---

### **A CATALECTIC MONODY!**

A cat I sing, of famous memory,  
Though *catachrestical* my song may be;  
In a small garden *catacomb* she lies,  
And *cataclysms* fill her comrades' eyes;  
Borne on the air, the *catacoustic* song  
Swells with her virtues' *catalogue* along,  
No *cataplasm* could lengthen out her years,  
Though mourning friends shed *cataracts* of tears.  
Once loud and strong her *catechist*-like voice  
It dwindled to a *catcall*'s squeaking noise;  
Most *categorical* her virtues shone,  
By *catenation* join'd each one to one;—  
But a vile *catchpoll* dog, with cruel bite,  
Like *catling*'s cut, her strength disabled quite;  
Her *caterwauling* pierced the heavy air,  
As *cataphracts* their arms through legions bear;  
'Tis vain! as *caterpillars* drag away  
Their lengths, like *cattle* after busy day,  
She ling'ring died, nor left in kit *kat* the  
Embodiment of this *catastrophe*.

*Cruikshank's Omnibus.*

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## ODE FOR A SOCIAL MEETING

WITH SLIGHT ALTERATIONS BY A TEETOTALER<sup>[1]</sup>

Come! fill a fresh bumper—for why should we go  
While the nectar still reddens our cups as they flow?  
Pour out the rich juices still bright with the sun,  
Till o'er the brimmed crystal the rubies shall run.  
The purple-globed clusters their life-dews have bled;  
How sweet is the breath of the fragrance they shed!  
For Summer's last roses lie hid in the wines  
That were garnered by maidens who laughed through the vines,  
Then a smile, and a glass, and a toast, and a cheer,  
For all the good wine, and we've some of it here!  
In cellar, in pantry, in attic, in hall,  
Down, down with the tyrant that masters us all!  
Long live the gay servant that laughs for us all!

*Oliver Wendell Holmes.*

---

## THE JOVIAL PRIEST'S CONFESSION

TRANSLATED FROM THE LATIN OF WALTER DE MAPES, TIME  
OF HENRY II

I devise to end my days—in a tavern drinking,  
May some Christian hold for me—the glass when I am shrinking,  
That the cherubim may cry—when they see me sinking,  
God be merciful to a soul—of this gentleman's way of thinking.

A glass of wine amazingly—enlighteneth one's internals;  
'Tis wings bedewed with nectar—that fly up to supernals;  
Bottles cracked in taverns—have much the sweeter kernels,  
Than the sups allowed to us—in the college journals.

Every one by nature hath—a mold which he was cast in;  
I happen to be one of those—who never could write fasting;  
By a single little boy—I should be surpass'd in  
Writing so: I'd just as lief—be buried; tomb'd and grass'd in.

Every one by nature hath—a gift too, a dotation:  
I, when I make verses—do get the inspiration  
Of the very best of wine—that comes into the nation:  
It maketh sermons to astound—for edification.

Just as liquor floweth good—floweth forth my lay so;  
But I must moreover eat—or I could not say so;  
Naught it availeth inwardly—should I write all day so;  
But with God's grace after meat—I beat Ovidius Naso.

Neither is there given to me—prophetic animation,  
Unless when I have eat and drank—yea, ev'n to saturation,  
Then in my upper story—hath Bacchus domination,  
And Phœbus rushes into me, and beggareth all relation.

*Leigh Hunt.*

---

## LIMERICKS

There was an old man of Tobago,  
Who lived upon rice, gruel and sago;  
Till, much to his bliss,  
His physician said this:  
"To a leg, sir, of mutton, you may go."

There was an old soldier of Bister,  
Went walking one day with his sister;  
When a cow, at one poke,  
Tossed her into an oak,  
Before the old gentleman missed her.

There was a young man of St. Kitts  
Who was very much troubled with fits;  
The eclipse of the moon  
Threw him into a swoon,  
When he tumbled and broke into bits.

There was an old man who said, "Gee!  
I can't multiply seven by three!  
Though fourteen seems plenty,  
It *might* come to twenty,—  
I haven't the slightest idee!"

There was an old man in a pie,  
Who said, "I must fly! I must fly!"  
When they said, "You can't do it!"  
He replied that he knew it,  
But he *had* to get out of that pie!

A Tutor who tooted the flute  
Tried to teach two young tooters to toot;  
Said the two to the Tutor,  
"Is it harder to toot, or  
To tutor two tooters to toot?"



Carolyn Wells.

RECITED BY A CHINESE INFANT

If-itty-teshi-mow Jays  
Haddee ny up-plo-now-shi-buh nays;  
    ha! ha!  
    He lote im aw dow,  
    Witty motti-fy flow;  
A-flew-ty ho-lot-itty flays! Hee!

*Translation*

Infinitesimal James  
Had nine unpronounceable names;  
    He wrote them all down,  
    With a mortified frown,  
And threw the whole lot in the flames.

For beauty I am not a star,  
There are others more handsome by far;  
    But my face I don't mind it,  
    For I am behind it,  
It's the people in front that I jar.

There was a young lady of Oakham,  
Who would steal your cigars and then soak 'em  
    In treacle and rum,  
    And then smear them with gum,  
So it wasn't a pleasure to smoke 'em.

There was an Old Man in a tree  
Who was horribly bored by a bee;  
    When they said, "Does it buzz?"  
    He replied, "Yes, it does!"  
It's a regular brute of a bee."

*Edward Lear.*

There was an Old Man of St. Bees  
Who was stung in the arm by a wasp.  
When asked, "Does it hurt?"  
He replied, "No, it doesn't,  
But I thought all the while 'twas a hornet."

*W. S. Gilbert.*

There was an old man of the Rhine,  
When asked at what hour he would dine,  
Replied, "At eleven,  
Four, six, three and seven,  
And eight and a quarter of nine."

There was a young man of Laconia,  
Whose mother-in-law had pneumonia;  
He hoped for the worst,  
And after March first  
They buried her 'neath a begonia.

There was a young man of the cape  
Who always wore trousers of crêpe;  
When asked, "Don't they tear?"  
He replied, "Here and there;  
But they keep such a beautiful shape."

There once were some learned M.D.'s,  
Who captured some germs of disease,  
And infected a train,  
Which without causing pain,  
Allowed one to catch it with ease.

*Oliver Herford.*

There was a young lady of Lynn,  
Who was deep in original sin;  
    When they said, "Do be good,"  
    She said, "Would if I could!"  
And straightway went at it ag'in.

I'd rather have fingers than toes;  
I'd rather have ears than a nose;  
    And as for my hair  
    I'm glad it's all there,  
I'll be awfully sad when it goes.

*Gelett Burgess.*

There was a young fellow named Clyde;  
Who was once at a funeral spied.  
    When asked who was dead,  
    He smilingly said,  
"I don't know,—I just came for the ride!"

There was a young lady of Truro,  
Who wished a mahogany bureau;  
    But her father said, "Dod!  
    All the men on Cape Cod  
Couldn't buy a mahogany bureau!"

There was a young man of Ostend  
Who vowed he'd hold out to the end,  
    But when halfway over  
    From Calais to Dover,  
He done what he didn't intend—

There was a young man of Cohoes,  
Wore tar on the end of his nose;  
    When asked why he done it,  
    He said for the fun it  
Afforded the men of Cohoes.

*Robert J. Burdette.*

There is a young artist called Whistler,  
Who in every respect is a bristler;  
    A tube of white lead,  
    Or a punch on the head,  
Come equally handy to Whistler.

*Dante Gabriel Rossetti.*

There is a creator named God,  
Whose doings are sometimes quite odd;  
    He made a painter named Val,  
    And I say and I shall,  
That he does no great credit to God.

*J. M. Whistler.*

There was a young lady of station,  
"I love man!" was her sole exclamation;  
    But when men cried, "You flatter!"  
    She replied, "Oh, no matter!  
Isle of Man, is the true explanation."

*Lewis Carroll.*

There was a young lady of Twickenham,  
Whose shoes were too tight to walk quick in 'em;  
    She came back from her walk,  
    Looking white as a chalk,  
And took 'em both off and was sick in 'em.

*Oliver Herford.*

"It's a very warm day," observed Billy.  
"I hope that you won't think it silly  
If I say that this heat  
Makes me think 'twould be sweet  
If one were a coolie in Chile!"

*Tudor Jenks.*

There was a young man from Cornell,  
Who said, "I'm aware of a smell,  
But whether it's drains  
Or human remains,  
I'm really unable to tell."

There was a young lady from Joppa,  
Whose friends all decided to drop her;  
She went with a friend  
On a trip to Ostend,—  
And the rest of the story's improper.

There once was a sculptor named Phidias,  
Whose statues by some were thought hideous;  
He made Aphrodite  
Without any nighty,  
Which shocked all the ultra-fastidious.

John woke on Jan. first and felt queer;  
Said, "Crackers I'll swear off this year!  
For the lobster and wine  
And the rabbit were fine,—  
And it certainly wasn't the beer."

There was a young lady of Venice  
Who used hard-boiled eggs to play tennis;  
When they said, "You are wrong,"  
She replied, "Go along!  
You don't know how prolific my hen is!"

There was a young man of Fort Blainey,  
Who proposed to his typist named Janey;  
    When his friends said, "Oh, dear!  
    She's so old and so queer!"  
He replied, "But the day was so rainy!"

---



# NONSENSE

## LUNAR STANZAS

Night saw the crew like pedlers with their packs  
Altho' it were too dear to pay for eggs;  
Walk crank along with coffin on their backs  
While in their arms they bow their weary legs.

And yet 'twas strange, and scarce can one suppose  
That a brown buzzard-fly should steal and wear  
His white jean breeches and black woollen hose,  
But thence that flies have souls is very clear.

But, Holy Father! what shall save the soul,  
When cobblers ask three dollars for their shoes?  
When cooks their biscuits with a shot-tower roll,  
And farmers rake their hay-cocks with their hoes.

Yet, 'twere profuse to see for pendant light,  
A tea-pot dangle in a lady's ear;  
And 'twere indelicate, although she might  
Swallow two whales and yet the moon shine clear.

But what to me are woven clouds, or what,  
If dames from spiders learn to warp their looms?  
If coal-black ghosts turn soldiers for the State,  
With wooden eyes, and lightning-rods for plumes?

Oh! too, too shocking! barbarous, savage taste!  
To eat one's mother ere itself was born!



To gripe the tall town-steeple by the waste,  
And scoop it out to be his drinking-horn.

No more: no more! I'm sick and dead and gone;  
Boxed in a coffin, stifled six feet deep;  
Thorns, fat and fearless, prick my skin and bone,  
And revel o'er me, like a soulless sheep.

*Henry Coggsell Knight.*

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## THE WHANGO TREE

The woggly bird sat on the whango tree,  
Nooping the rinkum corn,  
And graper and graper, alas! grew he,  
And cursed the day he was born.  
His crute was clum and his voice was rum,  
As curiously thus sang he,  
"Oh, would I'd been rammed and eternally clammed  
Ere I perched on this whango tree."

Now the whango tree had a bubbly thorn,  
As sharp as a nootie's bill,  
And it stuck in the woggly bird's umptum lorn  
And weepadge, the smart did thrill.  
He fumbled and cursed, but that wasn't the worst,  
For he couldn't at all get free,  
And he cried, "I am gammed, and injustibly nammed  
On the luggardly whango tree."

And there he sits still, with no worm in his bill,  
Nor no guggledom in his nest;  
He is hungry and bare, and gobliddered with care,

And his grabbles give him no rest;  
He is weary and sore and his tugmut is soar,  
And nothing to nob has he,  
As he chirps, "I am blammed and corruptibly jammed,  
In this cuggerdom whango tree."

*Unknown.*

---

### **THREE CHILDREN**

Three children sliding on the ice  
Upon a summer's day,  
As it fell out they all fell in,  
The rest they ran away.

Now, had these children been at home,  
Or sliding on dry ground,  
Ten thousand pounds to one penny  
They had not all been drowned.

You parents all that children have,  
And you too that have none,  
If you would have them safe abroad  
Pray keep them safe at home.

*Unknown.*

---

### **'TIS MIDNIGHT**

'Tis midnight, and the setting sun  
Is slowly rising in the west;  
The rapid rivers slowly run,  
The frog is on his downy nest.  
The pensive goat and sportive cow,  
Hilarious, leap from bough to bough.

*Unknown.*

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## COSSIMBAZAR

Come fleetly, come fleetly, my hookabadar,  
For the sound of the tam-tam is heard from afar.  
"Banoolah! Banoolah!" The Brahmins are nigh,  
And the depths of the jungle re-echo their cry.

*Pestonjee Bomanjee!*

Smite the guitar;

Join in the chorus, my hookabadar.

Heed not the blast of the deadly monsoon,  
Nor the blue Brahmaputra that gleams in the moon  
Stick to thy music, and oh, let the sound  
Be heard with distinctness a mile or two round.

*Jamsetjee, Jeejeebhoy!*

Sweep the guitar.

Join in the chorus, my hookabadar.

Art thou a Buddhist, or dost thou indeed  
Put faith in the monstrous Mohammedan creed?  
Art thou a Ghebir—a blinded Parsee?  
Not that it matters an atom to me.

*Cursetjee Bomanjee!*

Twang the guitar  
Join in the chorus, my hookabadar.

*Henry S. Leigh.*

---

## **AN UNSUSPECTED FACT**

If down his throat a man should choose  
In fun, to jump or slide,  
He'd scrape his shoes against his teeth,  
Nor dirt his own inside.  
But if his teeth were lost and gone,  
And not a stump to scrape upon,  
He'd see at once how very pat  
His tongue lay there by way of mat,  
And he would wipe his feet on *that*!

*Edward Cannon.*

---

## **THE CUMBERBUNCE**

I strolled beside the shining sea,  
I was as lonely as could be;  
No one to cheer me in my walk  
But stones and sand, which cannot talk—  
Sand and stones and bits of shell,  
Which never have a thing to tell.

But as I sauntered by the tide

I saw a something at my side,  
A something green, and blue, and pink,  
And brown, and purple, too, I think.  
I would not say how large it was;  
I would not venture that, because  
It took me rather by surprise,  
And I have not the best of eyes.

Should you compare it to a cat,  
I'd say it was as large as that;  
Or should you ask me if the thing  
Was smaller than a sparrow's wing,  
I should be apt to think you knew,  
And simply answer, "Very true!"

Well, as I looked upon the thing,  
It murmured, "Please, sir, can I sing?"  
And then I knew its name at once—  
It plainly was a Cumberbunce.

You are amazed that I could tell  
The creature's name so quickly? Well,  
I knew it was not a paper-doll,  
A pencil or a parasol,  
A tennis-racket or a cheese,  
And, as it was not one of these,  
And I am not a perfect dunce—  
It had to be a Cumberbunce!

With pleading voice and tearful eye  
It seemed as though about to cry.  
It looked so pitiful and sad  
It made me feel extremely bad.  
My heart was softened to the thing  
That asked me if it, please, could sing.  
Its little hand I longed to shake,  
But, oh, it had no hand to take!

I bent and drew the creature near,  
And whispered in its pale blue ear,  
"What! Sing, my Cumberbunce? You can!  
Sing on, sing loudly, little man!"

The Cumberbunce, without ado,  
Gazed sadly on the ocean blue,  
And, lifting up its little head,  
In tones of awful longing, said:

"Oh, I would sing of mackerel skies,  
And why the sea is wet,  
Of jelly-fish and conger-eels,  
And things that I forget.  
And I would hum a plaintive tune  
Of why the waves are hot  
As water boiling on a stove,  
Excepting that they're not!

"And I would sing of hooks and eyes,  
And why the sea is slant,  
And gayly tips the little ships,  
Excepting that I can't!  
I never sang a single song,  
I never hummed a note.  
There is in me no melody,  
No music in my throat.

"So that is why I do not sing  
Of sharks, or whales, or anything!"

I looked in innocent surprise,  
My wonder showing in my eyes,  
"Then why, O, Cumberbunce," I cried,  
"Did you come walking at my side  
And ask me if you, please, might sing,  
When you could not warble anything?"

"I did not ask permission, sir,  
I really did not, I aver.  
You, sir, misunderstood me, quite.  
I did not ask you if I *might*.  
Had you correctly understood,  
You'd know I asked you if I *could*."

So, as I cannot sing a song,  
Your answer, it is plain, was wrong.  
The fact I could not sing I knew,  
But wanted your opinion, too."

A voice came softly o'er the lea.  
"Farewell! my mate is calling me!"

I saw the creature disappear,  
Its voice, in parting, smote my ear—  
"I thought all people understood  
The difference 'twixt 'might' and 'could'!"

*Paul West.*

---

## **MR. FINNEY'S TURNIP**

Mr. Finney had a turnip  
And it grew and it grew;  
And it grew behind the barn,  
And that turnip did no harm.

There it grew and it grew  
Till it could grow no longer;  
Then his daughter Lizzie picked it

And put it in the cellar.

There it lay and it lay  
Till it began to rot;  
And his daughter Susie took it  
And put it in the pot.

And they boiled it and boiled it  
As long as they were able,  
And then his daughters took it,  
And put it on the table.

Mr. Finney and his wife  
They sat down to sup;  
And they ate and they ate  
And they ate that turnip up.

*Unknown.*

---

## **NONSENSE VERSES**

Lazy-bones, lazy-bones, wake up and peep!  
The cat's in the cupboard, your mother's asleep.  
There you sit snoring, forgetting her ills;  
Who is to give her her Bolus and Pills?  
Twenty fine Angels must come into town,  
All for to help you to make your new gown:  
Dainty aerial Spinsters and Singers;  
Aren't you ashamed to employ such white fingers?  
Delicate hands, unaccustom'd to reels,  
To set 'em working a poor body's wheels?  
Why they came down is to me all a riddle,  
And left Hallelujah broke off in the middle:



Jove's Court, and the Presence angelical, cut—  
To eke out the work of a lazy young slut.  
Angel-duck, Angel-duck, winged and silly,  
Pouring a watering-pot over a lily,  
Gardener gratuitous, careless of pelf,  
Leave her to water her lily herself,  
Or to neglect it to death if she chuse it:  
Remember the loss is her own if she lose it.

*Charles Lamb.*

---

## **LIKE TO THE THUNDERING TONE**

Like to the thundering tone of unspoke speeches,  
Or like a lobster clad in logic breeches,  
Or like the gray fur of a crimson cat,  
Or like the mooncalf in a slipshod hat;  
E'en such is he who never was begotten  
Until his children were both dead and rotten.

Like to the fiery tombstone of a cabbage,  
Or like a crab-louse with its bag and baggage,  
Or like the four square circle of a ring,  
Or like to hey ding, ding-a, ding-a, ding;  
E'en such is he who spake, and yet, no doubt,  
Spake to small purpose, when his tongue was out.

Like to a fair, fresh, fading, wither'd rose,  
Or like to rhyming verse that runs in prose,  
Or like the stumbles of a tinder-box,  
Or like a man that's sound yet sickness mocks;  
E'en such is he who died and yet did laugh  
To see these lines writ for his epitaph.

*Bishop Corbet in 17th century.*

---

## **ÆSTIVATION**

In candent ire the solar splendour flames;  
The foles, languescant, pend from arid rames;  
His humid front the cive, anhelant, wipes,  
And dreams of erring on ventiferous ripes.

How dulce to vive occult to mortal eyes,  
Dorm on the herb with none to supervise,  
Carp the suave berries from the crescent vine,  
And bibe the flow from longicaudate kine!

To me, alas! no verdurous visions come,  
Save yon exiguous pool's conferva-scum—  
No concave vast repeats the tender hue  
That laves my milk-jug with celestial blue.

Me wretched! let me curr to quercine shades!  
Effund your albid hausts, lactiferous maids!  
Oh, might I vole to some umbrageous clump,—  
Depart—be off,—excede,—evade,—crump!

*Oliver Wendell Holmes.*

---

## **UNCLE SIMON AND UNCLE JIM**

Uncle Simon he  
Clumb up a tree  
To see  
What he could see,  
When presentlee

Uncle Jim  
Clumb up beside of him  
And squatted down by he.

*Charles Farrar Browne (Artemus Ward).*

---

## **A TRAGIC STORY**

There lived a sage in days of yore,  
And he a handsome pigtail wore;  
But wondered much and sorrowed more,  
Because it hung behind him.

He mused upon this curious case,  
And swore he'd change the pigtail's place,  
And have it hanging at his face,  
Not dangling there behind him.

Says he, "The mystery I've found,—  
I'll turn me round,"—he turned him round;  
But still it hung behind him.

Then round and round, and out and in,  
All day the puzzled sage did spin;  
In vain—it mattered not a pin,—  
The pigtail hung behind him.

And right and left, and round about,  
And up and down, and in and out,  
He turned; but still the pigtail stout  
Hung steadily behind him.

And though his efforts never slack,  
And though he twist and twirl and tack,  
Alas! still faithful to his back,  
The pigtail hangs behind him.

*W. M. Thackeray.*

---

## **SONNET FOUND IN A DESERTED MAD HOUSE**

Oh that my soul a marrow-bone might seize!  
For the old egg of my desire is broken,  
Spilled is the pearly white and spilled the yolk, and  
As the mild melancholy contents grease  
My path the shorn lamb baas like bumblebees.  
Time's trashy purse is as a taken token  
Or like a thrilling recitation, spoken  
By mournful mouths filled full of mirth and cheese.

And yet, why should I clasp the earthful urn?  
Or find the frittered fig that felt the fast?  
Or choose to chase the cheese around the churn?  
Or swallow any pill from out the past?  
Ah, no Love, not while your hot kisses burn  
Like a potato riding on the blast.

*Unknown.*

---

# THE JIM-JAM KING OF THE JOU-JOUS

## AN ARABIAN LEGEND

Translated from the Arabic

Far off in the waste of desert sand,  
The Jim-jam rules in the Jou-jou land:  
He sits on a throne of red-hot rocks,  
And moccasin snakes are his curling locks;  
And the Jou-jous have the conniption fits  
In the far-off land where the Jim-jam sits—  
If things are now as things were then.  
Allah il Allah! Oo-aye! Amen!

The country's so dry in Jou-jou land  
You could wet it down with Sahara sand,  
And over its boundaries the air  
Is hotter than 'tis—no matter where:  
A camel drops down completely tanned  
When he crosses the line in Jou-jou land—  
If things are now as things were then.  
Allah il Allah! Oo-aye! Amen!

A traveller once got stuck in the sand  
On the fiery edge of Jou-jou land;  
The Jou-jous they confiscated him,  
And the Jim-jam tore him limb from limb;  
But, dying, he said: "If eaten I am,  
I'll disagree with this Dam-jim-jam!  
He'll think his stomach's a Hoodoo's den!"  
Allah il Allah! Oo-aye! Amen!

Then the Jim-jam felt so bad inside,

It just about humbled his royal pride.  
He decided to physic himself with sand,  
And throw up his job in the Jou-jou land.  
He descended his throne of red-hot rocks,  
And hired a barber to cut his locks:  
The barber died of the got-'em-again.  
Allah il Allah! Oo-aye! Amen!

And now let every good Mussulman  
Get all the good from this tale he can.  
If you wander off on a Jamboree,  
Across the stretch of the desert sea,  
Look out that right at the height of your booze  
You don't get caught by the Jou-jou-jous!  
You may, for the Jim-jam's at it again.  
Allah il Allah! Oo-aye! Amen!

*Alaric Bertrand Stuart.*

---

## TO MARIE

When the breeze from the bluebottle's blustering blim  
Twirls the toads in a tooroomaloo,  
And the whiskery whine of the wheedlesome whim  
Drowns the roll of the rattatattoo,  
Then I dream in the shade of the shally-go-shee,  
And the voice of the bally-molay  
Brings the smell of stale poppy-cods blummerged in blee  
From the willy-wad over the way.

Ah, the shuddering shoo and the blinketty-blanks  
When the yungalung falls from the bough  
In the blast of a hurricane's hicketty-hanks

On the hills of the hocketty-how!  
Give the rigamarole to the clangery-whang,  
If they care for such fiddlededee;  
But the thingumbob kiss of the whangery-bang  
Keeps the higgledy-piggle for me.

#### L'ENVOI

It is pilly-po-doddle and aligobung  
When the lollypop covers the ground,  
Yet the poldiddle perishes punketty-pung  
When the heart jimmy-coggles around.  
If the soul cannot snoop at the giggle-some cart,  
Seeking surcease in gluggety-glug,  
It is useless to say to the pulsating heart,  
"Panky-doodle ker-chuggetty-chug!"

*John Bennett.*

---

#### MY DREAM

I dreamed a dream next Tuesday week,  
Beneath the apple-trees;  
I thought my eyes were big pork-pies,  
And my nose was Stilton cheese.  
The clock struck twenty minutes to six,  
When a frog sat on my knee;  
I asked him to lend me eighteenpence,  
But he borrowed a shilling of me.

*Unknown.*

---

## THE ROLICKING MASTODON

A rollicking Mastodon lived in Spain,  
In the trunk of a Tranquil Tree.  
His face was plain, but his jocular vein  
Was a burst of the wildest glee.  
His voice was strong and his laugh so long  
That people came many a mile,  
And offered to pay a guinea a day  
For the fractional part of a smile.

The Rollicking Mastodon's laugh was wide—  
Indeed, 'twas a matter of family pride;  
And oh! so proud of his jocular vein  
Was the Rollicking Mastodon over in Spain.

The Rollicking Mastodon said one day,  
"I feel that I need some air,  
For a little ozone's a tonic for bones,  
As well as a gloss for the hair."  
So he skipped along and warbled a song  
In his own triumphant way.  
His smile was bright and his skip was light  
As he chirruped his roundelay.

The Rollicking Mastodon tripped along,  
And sang what Mastodons call a song;  
But every note of it seemed to pain  
The Rollicking Mastodon over in Spain.

A Little Peetookle came over the hill,  
Dressed up in a bollitant coat;  
And he said, "You need some harroway seed,  
And a little advice for your throat."  
The Mastodon smiled and said, "My child,  
There's a chance for your taste to grow.



If you polish your mind, you'll certainly find  
How little, how little you know."

The Little Peetookle, his teeth he ground  
At the Mastodon's singular sense of sound;  
For he felt it a sort of a musical stain  
On the Rollicking Mastodon over in Spain.

"Alas! and alas! has it come to this pass?"  
Said the Little Peetookle. "Dear me!  
It certainly seems your horrible screams  
Intended for music must be!"  
The Mastodon stopped, his ditty he dropped,  
And murmured, "Good morning, my dear!  
I never will sing to a sensitive thing  
That shatters a song with a sneer!"

The Rollicking Mastodon bade him "adieu."  
Of course 'twas a sensible thing to do;  
For Little Peetookle is spared the strain  
Of the Rollicking Mastodon over in Spain.

*Arthur Macy.*

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## *NONSENSE VERSES*

### **THE INVISIBLE BRIDGE**

I'd Never Dare to Walk across  
A Bridge I Could Not See;  
For Quite afraid of Falling off,  
I fear that I Should Be!

## THE LAZY ROOF

The Roof it has a Lazy Time  
A-lying in the Sun;  
The Walls they have to Hold Him Up;  
They do Not Have Much Fun!

## MY FEET

My feet, they haul me Round the House,  
They Hoist me up the Stairs;  
I only have to Steer them and  
They Ride me Everywheres.

*Gelett Burgess.*

---

## SPIRK TROLL-DERISIVE

The Crankadox leaned o'er the edge of the moon,  
And wistfully gazed on the sea  
Where the Gryxabodill madly whistled a tune  
To the air of "Ti-fol-de-ding-dee."  
The quavering shriek of the Fliupthecreek  
Was fitfully wafted afar  
To the Queen of the Wunks as she powdered her cheek  
With the pulverized rays of a star.

The Gool closed his ear on the voice of the Grig,  
And his heart it grew heavy as lead  
As he marked the Baldekin adjusting his wig

On the opposite side of his head;  
And the air it grew chill as the Gryxabodill  
Raised his dank, dripping fins to the skies  
To plead with the Plunk for the use of her bill  
To pick the tears out of his eyes.

The ghost of the Zhack flitted by in a trance;  
And the Squidjum hid under a tub  
As he heard the loud hooves of the Hooken advance  
With a rub-a-dub-dub-a-dub dub!  
And the Crankadox cried as he laid down and died,  
"My fate there is none to bewail!"  
While the Queen of the Wunks drifted over the tide  
With a long piece of crape to her tail.

*James Whitcomb Riley.*

---

## THE MAN IN THE MOON

Said the Raggedy Man on a hot afternoon,  
"My!  
Sakes!  
What a lot o' mistakes  
Some little folks makes on the Man in the Moon  
But people that's been up to see him like Me,  
And calls on him frequent and intimutly,  
Might drop a few hints that would interest you  
Clean!  
Through!  
If you wanted 'em to—  
Some actual facts that might interest you!  
  
"O the Man in the Moon has a crick in his back

Whee!

Whimm!

Ain't you sorry for him?

And a mole on his nose that is purple and black;  
And his eyes are so weak that they water and run  
If he dares to *dream* even he looks at the sun,—  
So he jes' dreams of stars, as the doctor's advise—

My!

Eyes!

But isn't he wise—

To jes' dream of stars, as the doctors advise?

"And the Man in the Moon has a boil on his ear—

Whee!

Whing!

What a singular thing!

I know! but these facts are authentic, my dear,—  
There's a boil on his ear; and a corn on his chin,—  
He calls it a dimple,—but dimples stick in,—  
Yet it might be a dimple turned over, you know!

Whang!

Ho!

Why certainly so!—

It might be a dimple turned over, you know!

"And the Man in the Moon has a rheumatic knee,

Gee!

Whizz!

What a pity that is!

And his toes have worked round where his heels ought to be.  
So whenever he wants to go North he goes South,  
And comes back with porridge crumbs all round his mouth,  
And he brushes them off with a Japanese fan,

Whing!

Whann!

What a marvellous man!

What a very remarkably marvellous man!

"And the Man in the Moon," sighed the Raggedy Man,  
"Gits!  
So!  
Sullonesome, you know!  
Up there by himself since creation began!—  
That when I call on him and then come away,  
He grabs me and holds me and begs me to stay,—  
Till—well, if it wasn't for *Jimmy-cum-Jim*,  
Dadd!  
Limb!  
I'd go pardners with him!  
Jes' jump my bob here and be pardners with him!"

*James Whitcomb Riley.*

---

## THE LUGUBRIOUS WHING-WHANG

Out on the margin of moonshine land,  
Tickle me, love, in these lonesome ribs,  
Out where the whing-whang loves to stand  
Writing his name with his tail on the sand,  
And wiping it out with his oogerish hand;  
Tickle me, love, in these lonesome ribs.

Is it the gibber of gungs and keeks?  
Tickle me, love, in these lonesome ribs,  
Or what *is* the sound the whing-whang seeks,  
Crouching low by the winding creeks,  
And holding his breath for weeks and weeks?  
Tickle me, love, in these lonesome ribs.

Aroint him the wraithest of wraithly things!

Tickle me, love, in these lonesome ribs,  
'Tis a fair whing-whangess with phosphor rings,  
And bridal jewels of fangs and stings,  
And she sits and as sadly and softly sings  
As the mildewed whir of her own dead wings;  
Tickle me, dear; tickle me here;  
Tickle me, love, in these lonesome ribs.

*James Whitcomb Riley.*

---

## THE YONGHY-BONGHY-BO

### I

On the Coast of Coromandel  
Where the early pumpkins blow,  
In the middle of the woods  
Lived the Yonghy-Bonghy-Bo.  
Two old chairs, and half a candle,  
One old jug without a handle,—  
These were all his worldly goods:  
In the middle of the woods,  
These were all the worldly goods  
Of the Yonghy-Bonghy-Bo,  
Of the Yonghy-Bonghy-Bo.

### II

Once, among the Bong-trees walking  
Where the early pumpkins blow,  
To a little heap of stones  
Came the Yonghy-Bonghy-Bo.  
There he heard a Lady talking,  
To some milk-white Hens of Dorking,  
"'Tis the Lady Jingly Jones!

On that little heap of stones  
Sits the Lady Jingly Jones!"  
Said the Yonghy-Bonghy-Bo,  
Said the Yonghy-Bonghy-Bo.

### III

"Lady Jingly! Lady Jingly!  
Sitting where the pumpkins blow,  
Will you come and be my wife?"  
Said the Yonghy-Bonghy-Bo,  
"I am tired of living singly,—  
On this coast so wild and shingly,—  
I'm a-weary of my life;  
If you'll come and be my wife,  
Quite serene would be my life!"  
Said the Yonghy-Bonghy-Bo,  
Said the Yonghy-Bonghy-Bo.

### IV

"On this Coast of Coromandel  
Shrimps and watercresses grow,  
Prawns are plentiful and cheap,"  
Said the Yonghy-Bonghy-Bo.  
"You shall have my chairs and candle,  
And my jug without a handle!  
Gaze upon the rolling deep  
(Fish is plentiful and cheap):  
As the sea, my love is deep!"  
Said the Yonghy-Bonghy-Bo,  
Said the Yonghy-Bonghy-Bo.

### V

Lady Jingly answered sadly,  
And her tears began to flow,—  
"Your proposal comes too late,  
Mr. Yonghy-Bonghy-Bo!  
I would be your wife most gladly!"

(Here she twirled her fingers madly,  
"But in England I've a mate!  
Yes! you've asked me far too late,  
For in England I've a mate,  
Mr. Yonghy-Bonghy-Bo!  
Mr. Yonghy-Bonghy-Bo!

## VI

"Mr. Jones (his name is Handel,—  
Handel Jones, Esquire & Co.)  
Dorking fowls delights to send,  
Mr. Yonghy-Bonghy-Bo!  
Keep, oh, keep your chairs and candle,  
And your jug without a handle,—  
I can merely be your friend!  
Should my Jones more Dorkings send,  
I will give you three, my friend!  
Mr. Yonghy-Bonghy-Bo!  
Mr. Yonghy-Bonghy-Bo!

## VII

"Though you've such a tiny body,  
And your head so large doth grow,—  
Though your hat may blow away,  
Mr. Yonghy-Bonghy-Bo!  
Though you're such a Hoddy Doddy,  
Yet I wish that I could modify  
the words I needs must say!  
Will you please to go away?  
That is all I have to say,  
Mr. Yonghy-Bonghy-Bo!  
Mr. Yonghy-Bonghy-Bo!"

## VIII

Down the slippery slopes of Myrtle,  
Where the early pumpkins blow,  
To the calm and silent sea



Fled the Yonghy-Bonghy-Bo.  
There, beyond the Bay of Gurtle,  
Lay a large and lively Turtle.  
    "You're the Cove," he said, "for me:  
    On your back beyond the sea,  
    Turtle, you shall carry me!"  
Said the Yonghy-Bonghy-Bo,  
Said the Yonghy-Bonghy-Bo.

IX

Through the silent roaring ocean  
Did the Turtle swiftly go;  
    Holding fast upon his shell  
    Rode the Yonghy-Bonghy-Bo.  
With a sad primæval motion  
Toward the sunset isles of Boshen  
    Still the Turtle bore him well,  
    Holding fast upon his shell.  
    "Lady Jingly Jones, farewell!"  
Sang the Yonghy-Bonghy-Bo,  
Sang the Yonghy-Bonghy-Bo.

X

From the Coast of Coromandel  
Did that Lady never go,  
    On that heap of stones she mourns  
    For the Yonghy-Bonghy-Bo.  
On that Coast of Coromandel,  
In his jug without a handle  
    Still she weeps, and daily moans;  
    On the little heap of stones  
    To her Dorking Hens she moans,  
For the Yonghy-Bonghy-Bo,  
For the Yonghy-Bonghy-Bo.

*Edward Lear.*

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## THE JUMBLIES

### I

They went to sea in a sieve, they did;  
In a sieve they went to sea:  
In spite of all their friends could say,  
On a winter's morn, on a stormy day,  
In a sieve they went to sea.  
And when the sieve turned round and round,  
And every one cried, "You'll all be drowned!"  
They called aloud, "Our sieve ain't big;  
But we don't care a button, we don't care a fig:  
In a sieve we'll go to sea!"  
Far and few, far and few,  
Are the lands where the Jumblies live;  
Their heads are green, and their hands are blue;  
And they went to sea in a sieve.

### II

They sailed away in a sieve, they did,  
In a sieve they sailed so fast,  
With only a beautiful pea-green veil  
Tied with a ribbon by way of a sail,  
To a small tobacco-pipe mast.  
And every one said who saw them go,  
"Oh! won't they soon be upset, you know?  
For the sky is dark and the voyage is long,  
And, happen what may, it's extremely wrong  
In a sieve to sail so fast."  
Far and few, far and few,  
Are the lands where the Jumblies live;  
Their heads are green and their hands are blue;  
And they went to sea in a sieve.

### III

The water it soon came in, it did;  
The water it soon came in:  
So, to keep them dry, they wrapped their feet  
In a pinky paper all folded neat;  
And they fastened it down with a pin.  
And they passed the night in a crockery-jar;  
And each of them said, "How wise we are!  
Though the sky be dark, and the voyage be long,  
Yet we never can think we were rash or wrong,  
While round in our sieve we spin."  
Far and few, far and few,  
Are the lands where the Jumblies live;  
Their heads are green and their hands are blue;  
And they went to sea in a sieve.

#### IV

And all night long they sailed away;  
And when the sun went down,  
They whistled and warbled a moony song  
To the echoing sound of a coppery gong,  
In the shade of the mountains brown.  
"O Timballoo! How happy we are  
When we live in a sieve and a crockery-jar!  
And all night long, in the moonlight pale,  
We sail away with a pea-green sail  
In the shade of the mountains brown."  
Far and few, far and few,  
Are the lands where the Jumblies live;  
Their heads are green, and their hands are blue;  
And they went to sea in a sieve.

#### V

They sailed to the Western Sea, they did,—  
To a land all covered with trees;  
And they bought an owl and a useful cart,  
And a pound of rice, and a cranberry-tart,  
And a hive of silvery bees;

And they bought a pig, and some green jackdaws,  
And a lovely monkey with lollipop paws,  
And forty bottles of ring-bo-ree,  
And no end of Stilton cheese.  
Far and few, far and few,  
Are the lands where the Jumblies live;  
Their heads are green, and their hands are blue;  
And they went to sea in a sieve.

## VI

And in twenty years they all came back,—  
In twenty years or more;  
And every one said, "How tall they've grown!  
For they've been to the Lakes, and the Terrible Zone,  
And the hills of the Chankly Bore."  
And they drank their health, and gave them a feast—  
Of dumplings made of beautiful yeast;  
And every one said, "If we only live,  
We, too, will go to sea in a sieve,  
To the hills of the Chankly Bore."  
Far and few, far and few,  
Are the lands where the Jumblies live;  
Their heads are green, and their hands are blue;  
And they went to sea in a sieve.

*Edward Lear.*

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## THE POBBLE WHO HAS NO TOES

The Pobble who has no toes  
Had once as many as we;  
When they said, "Some day you may lose them all,"  
He replied, "Fish fiddle de-dee!"

And his Aunt Jobiska made him drink  
Lavender water tinged with pink;  
For she said, "The World in general knows  
There's nothing so good for a Pobble's toes!"

The Pobble who has no toes  
Swam across the Bristol Channel;  
But before he set out he wrapped his nose  
In a piece of scarlet flannel.  
For his Aunt Jobiska said, "No harm  
Can come to his toes if his nose is warm;  
And it's perfectly known that a Pobble's toes  
Are safe—provided he minds his nose."

The Pobble swam fast and well,  
And when boats or ships came near him,  
He tinkledy-binkledy-winkled a bell  
So that all the world could hear him.  
And all the Sailors and Admirals cried,  
When they saw him nearing the farther side,  
"He has gone to fish for his Aunt Jobiska's  
Runcible Cat with crimson whiskers!"

But before he touched the shore—  
The shore of the Bristol Channel,  
A sea-green Porpoise carried away  
His wrapper of scarlet flannel.  
And when he came to observe his feet,  
Formerly garnished with toes so neat,  
His face at once became forlorn  
On perceiving that all his toes were gone!

And nobody ever knew,  
From that dark day to the present,  
Whoso had taken the Pobble's toes,  
In a manner so far from pleasant.  
Whether the shrimps or crawfish gray,

Or crafty mermaids stole them away,  
Nobody knew; and nobody knows  
How the Pobble was robbed of his twice five toes!

The Pobble who has no toes  
Was placed in a friendly Bark,  
And they rowed him back and carried him up  
To his Aunt Jobiska's Park.  
And she made him a feast at his earnest wish,  
Of eggs and buttercups fried with fish;  
And she said, "It's a fact the whole world knows,  
That Pobbles are happier without their toes."

*Edward Lear.*

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## THE NEW VESTMENTS

There lived an old man in the kingdom of Tess,  
Who invented a purely original dress;  
And when it was perfectly made and complete,  
He opened the door and walked into the street.

By way of a hat he'd a loaf of Brown Bread,  
In the middle of which he inserted his head;  
His Shirt was made up of no end of dead Mice,  
The warmth of whose skins was quite fluffy and nice;  
His Drawers were of Rabbit-skins, so were his Shoes,  
His Stockings were skins, but it is not known whose;  
His Waistcoat and Trowsers were made of Pork Chops;  
His Buttons were Jujubes and Chocolate Drops.

His Coat was all Pancakes with Jam for a border,  
And a girdle of Biscuits to keep it in order.

And he wore over all, as a screen from bad weather,  
A Cloak of green Cabbage leaves, stitched all together.

He had walked a short way, when he heard a great noise  
Of all sorts of Beasticles, Birdlings and Boys;  
And from every long street and dark lane in the town  
Beasts, Birdies and Boys in a tumult rushed down.  
Two Cows and a Calf ate his Cabbage leaf Cloak;  
Four Apes seized his girdle which vanished like smoke;  
Three Kids ate up half of his Pancaky Coat,  
And the tails were devoured by an ancient He Goat.  
An army of Dogs in a twinkling tore *up* his  
Pork Waistcoat and Trowsers to give to their Puppies;  
And while they were growling and mumbling the Chops  
Ten Boys prigged the Jujubes and Chocolate Drops.  
He tried to run back to his house, but in vain,  
For scores of fat Pigs came again and again;  
They rushed out of stables and hovels and doors,  
They tore off his Stockings, his Shoes and his Drawers.  
And now from the housetops with screechings descend  
Striped, spotted, white, black and grey Cats without end;  
They jumped on his shoulders and knocked off his hat,  
When Crows, Ducks and Hens made a mincemeat of that.  
They speedily flew at his sleeves in a trice  
And utterly tore up his Shirt of dead Mice;  
They swallowed the last of his Shirt with a squall,—  
Whereon he ran home with no clothes on at all.  
And he said to himself as he bolted the door,  
"I will not wear a similar dress any more,  
Any more, any more, any more, nevermore!"

*Edward Lear.*

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## THE TWO OLD BACHELORS

Two old Bachelors were living in one house;  
One caught a Muffin, the other caught a Mouse.  
Said he who caught the Muffin to him who caught the Mouse,  
"This happens just in time, for we've nothing in the house,  
Save a tiny slice of lemon and a teaspoonful of honey,  
And what to do for dinner,—since we haven't any money?  
And what can we expect if we haven't any dinner  
But to lose our teeth and eyelashes and keep on growing thinner?"

Said he who caught the Mouse to him who caught the Muffin,  
"We might cook this little Mouse if we only had some Stuffin'!  
If we had but Sage and Onions we could do extremely well,  
But how to get that Stuffin' it is difficult to tell!"

And then those two old Bachelors ran quickly to the town  
And asked for Sage and Onions as they wandered up and down;  
They borrowed two large Onions, but no Sage was to be found  
In the Shops or in the Market or in all the Gardens round.  
But some one said, "A hill there is, a little to the north,  
And to its purpledicular top a narrow way leads forth;  
And there among the rugged rocks abides an ancient Sage,—  
An earnest Man, who reads all day a most perplexing page.  
Climb up and seize him by the toes,—all studious as he sits,—  
And pull him down, and chop him into endless little bits!  
Then mix him with your Onion (cut up likewise into scraps),  
And your Stuffin' will be ready, and very good—perhaps."

And then those two old Bachelors, without loss of time,  
The nearly purpledicular crags at once began to climb;  
And at the top among the rocks, all seated in a nook,  
They saw that Sage a-reading of a most enormous book.  
"You earnest Sage!" aloud they cried, "your book you've read enough in!  
We wish to chop you into bits and mix you into Stuffin'!"

But that old Sage looked calmly up, and with his awful book  
At those two Bachelors' bald heads a certain aim he took;  
And over crag and precipice they rolled promiscuous down,—



At once they rolled, and never stopped in lane or field or town;  
And when they reached their house, they found (besides their want of  
    Stuffin')

The Mouse had fled—and previously had eaten up the Muffin.

They left their home in silence by the once convivial door;  
And from that hour those Bachelors were never heard of more.

*Edward Lear.*

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## JABBERWOCKY

'Twas brillig, and the slithy toves  
    Did gyre and gimble in the wabe;  
All mimsy were the borogoves,  
    And the mome raths outgrabe.

"Beware the Jabberwock, my son!  
    The jaws that bite, the claws that catch!  
Beware the Jubjub bird, and shun  
    The frumious Bandersnatch!"

He took his vorpal sword in hand:  
    Long time the manxome foe he sought.  
So rested he by the Tumtum tree,  
    And stood awhile in thought.

And as in uffish thought he stood,  
    The Jabberwock with eyes of flame,  
Came whiffling through the tulgey wood,  
    And burbled as it came!

One, two! One, two! And through, and through

The vorpal blade went snicker-snack!  
He left it dead, and with its head  
He went galumphing back.

"And hast thou slain the Jabberwock?  
Come to my arms, my beamish boy!  
Oh, frabjous day! Callooh! callay!"  
He chortled in his joy.

'Twas brillig, and the slithy toves  
Did gyre and gimble in the wabe;  
All mimsy were the borogoves  
And the mome raths outgrabe.

*Lewis Carroll.*

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## **WAYS AND MEANS**

I'll tell thee everything I can;  
There's little to relate.  
I saw an aged aged man,  
A-sitting on a gate.  
"Who are you, aged man?" I said,  
"And how is it you live?"  
His answer trickled through my head  
Like water through a sieve.

He said, "I look for butterflies  
That sleep among the wheat:  
I make them into mutton-pies,  
And sell them in the street.  
I sell them unto men," he said,  
"Who sail on stormy seas;

And that's the way I get my bread—  
A trifle, if you please."

But I was thinking of a plan  
To dye one's whiskers green,  
And always use so large a fan  
That they could not be seen.  
So, having no reply to give  
To what the old man said,  
I cried, "Come, tell me how you live!"  
And thumped him on the head.

His accents mild took up the tale;  
He said, "I go my ways  
And when I find a mountain-rill  
I set it in a blaze;  
And thence they make a stuff they call  
Rowland's Macassar Oil—  
Yet twopence-halfpenny is all  
They give me for my toil."

But I was thinking of a way  
To feed oneself on batter,  
And so go on from day to day  
Getting a little fatter.  
I shook him well from side to side,  
Until his face was blue;  
"Come, tell me how you live," I cried,  
"And what it is you do!"

He said, "I hunt for haddock's eyes  
Among the heather bright,  
And work them into waistcoat-buttons  
In the silent night.  
And these I do not sell for gold  
Or coin of silvery shine,  
But for a copper halfpenny

And that will purchase nine.

"I sometimes dig for buttered rolls,  
Or set limed twigs for crabs;  
I sometimes search the grassy knolls  
For wheels of Hansom cabs.  
And that's the way" (he gave a wink)  
"By which I get my wealth—  
And very gladly will I drink  
Your Honor's noble health."

I heard him then, for I had just  
Completed my design  
To keep the Menai Bridge from rust  
By boiling it in wine.  
I thanked him much for telling me  
The way he got his wealth,  
But chiefly for his wish that he  
Might drink my noble health.

And now if e'er by chance I put  
My fingers into glue,  
Or madly squeeze a right-hand foot  
Into a left-hand shoe,  
Or if I drop upon my toe  
A very heavy weight,  
I weep, for it reminds me so  
Of that old man I used to know—  
Whose look was mild, whose speech was slow,  
Whose hair was whiter than the snow,  
Whose face was very like a crow,  
With eyes, like cinders, all aglow,  
Who seemed distracted with his woe,  
Who rocked his body to and fro,  
And muttered mumblingly, and low,  
As if his mouth were full of dough,  
Who snorted like a buffalo—

That summer evening, long ago,  
A-sitting on a gate.

*Lewis Carroll.*

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## **HUMPTY DUMPTY'S RECITATION**

"In winter, when the fields are white,  
I sing this song for your delight——

"In spring, when woods are getting green,  
I'll try and tell you what I mean:"

"In summer, when the days are long,  
Perhaps you'll understand the song:

In autumn, when the leaves are brown,  
Take pen and ink, and write it down."

"I sent a message to the fish:  
I told them 'This is what I wish.'

The little fishes of the sea,  
They sent an answer back to me.

The little fishes' answer was,  
'We cannot do it, Sir, because——'"

"I sent to them again to say  
'It will be better to obey.'

The fishes answered, with a grin,  
'Why, what a temper you are in!'

I told them once, I told them twice:  
They would not listen to advice.

I took a kettle large and new,  
Fit for the deed I had to do.

My heart went hop, my heart went thump:  
I filled the kettle at the pump.

Then some one came to me and said,  
'The little fishes are in bed.'

I said to him, I said it plain,  
'Then you must wake them up again.'

I said it very loud and clear:  
I went and shouted in his ear.

But he was very stiff and proud:  
He said, 'You needn't shout so loud!'

And he was very proud and stiff:  
He said, 'I'd go and wake them, if——'

I took a corkscrew from the shelf:  
I went to wake them up myself.

And when I found the door was locked,  
I pulled and pushed and kicked and knocked.

And when I found the door was shut,  
I tried to turn the handle, but——"

*Lewis Carroll.*

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## SOME HALLUCINATIONS

He thought he saw an Elephant,  
That practised on a fife:  
He looked again, and found it was  
A letter from his wife.  
"At length I realise," he said,  
"The bitterness of Life!"

He thought he saw a Buffalo  
Upon the chimney-piece:  
He looked again, and found it was  
His Sister's Husband's Niece.  
"Unless you leave this house," he said,  
"I'll send for the Police!"

He thought he saw a Rattlesnake  
That questioned him in Greek:  
He looked again, and found it was  
The Middle of Next Week.  
"The one thing I regret," he said,  
"Is that it cannot speak!"

He thought he saw a Banker's Clerk  
Descending from the 'bus:  
He looked again, and found it was  
A Hippopotamus:  
"If this should stay to dine," he said,  
"There won't be much for us!"

He thought he saw an Albatross  
That fluttered round the lamp:  
He looked again, and found it was  
A Penny-Postage-Stamp.  
"You'd best be getting home," he said;  
"The nights are very damp!"

He thought he saw a Coach-and-Four  
That stood beside his bed:  
He looked again, and found it was  
A Bear without a Head.  
"Poor thing," he said, "poor silly thing!  
It's waiting to be fed!"

He thought he saw a Kangaroo  
That worked a coffee-mill:  
He looked again, and found it was  
A Vegetable-Pill.  
"Were I to swallow this," he said,  
"I should be very ill!"

*Lewis Carroll.*

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## **SING FOR THE GARISH EYE**

Sing for the garish eye,  
When moonless brandlings cling!  
Let the froddering crooner cry,  
And the braddled sapster sing.  
For never, and never again,  
Will the tottering beechlings play,  
For bratticed wrackers are singing aloud,  
And the throngers croon in May!

The wracking globe unstrung,  
Unstrung in the frittering light  
Of a moon that knows no day,  
Of a day that knows no night!  
Diving away in the crowd



Of sparkling frets in spray,  
The bratticed wrackers are singing aloud,  
And the throngers croon in May!

Hasten, O hapful blue,  
Blue, of the shimmering brow,  
Hasten the deed to do  
That shall roddle the welkin now!  
For never again shall a cloud  
Out-thribble the babbling day,  
When bratticed wrackers are singing aloud,  
And the throngers croon in May!

*W. S. Gilbert.*

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## **THE SHIPWRECK**

Upon the poop the captain stands,  
As starboard as may be;  
And pipes on deck the topsail hands  
To reef the topsail-gallant strands  
Across the briny sea.

"Ho! splice the anchor under-weigh!"  
The captain loudly cried;  
"Ho! lubbers brave, belay! belay!"  
For we must luff for Falmouth Bay  
Before to-morrow's tide."

The good ship was a racing yawl,  
A spare-rigged schooner sloop,  
Athwart the bows the taffrails all  
In grummets gay appeared to fall,

To deck the mainsail poop.

But ere they made the Foreland Light,  
And Deal was left behind,  
The wind it blew great gales that night,  
And blew the doughty captain tight,  
Full three sheets in the wind.

And right across the tiller head  
The horse it ran apace,  
Whereon a traveller hitched and sped  
Along the jib and vanished  
To heave the trysail brace.

What ship could live in such a sea?  
What vessel bear the shock?  
"Ho! starboard port your helm-a-lee!  
Ho! reef the maintop-gallant-tree,  
With many a running block!"

And right upon the Scilly Isles  
The ship had run aground;  
When lo! the stalwart Captain Giles  
Mounts up upon the gaff and smiles,  
And slews the compass round.

"Saved! saved!" with joy the sailors cry,  
And scandalize the skiff;  
As taut and hoisted high and dry  
They see the ship unstoppered lie  
Upon the sea-girt cliff.

And since that day in Falmouth Bay,  
As herring-fishers trawl,  
The youngers hear the boatswains say  
How Captain Giles that awful day  
Preserved the sinking yawl.

*E. H. Palmer.*

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## **UFFIA**

When sporgles spanned the floreate mead  
And cogwogs gleet upon the lea,  
Uffia gopped to meet her love  
Who smeeged upon the equat sea.

Dately she walked aglost the sand;  
The boreal wind seet in her face;  
The moggling waves yalped at her feet;  
Pangwangling was her pace.

*Harriet R. White.*

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## **'TIS SWEET TO ROAM**

'Tis sweet to roam when morning's light  
Resounds across the deep;  
And the crystal song of the woodbine bright  
Hushes the rocks to sleep,  
And the blood-red moon in the blaze of noon  
Is bathed in a crumbling dew,  
And the wolf rings out with a glittering shout,  
To-whit, to-whit, to-whoo!

*Unknown.*

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## THREE JOVIAL HUNTSMEN

There were three jovial huntsmen,  
As I have heard them say,  
And they would go a-hunting  
All on a summer's day.

All the day they hunted,  
And nothing could they find  
But a ship a-sailing,  
A-sailing with the wind.

One said it was a ship,  
The other said Nay;  
The third said it was a house  
With the chimney blown away.

And all the night they hunted,  
And nothing could they find;  
But the moon a-gliding,  
A-gliding with the wind.

One said it was the moon,  
The other said Nay;  
The third said it was a cheese,  
And half o't cut away.

*Unknown.*

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## KING ARTHUR

When good King Arthur ruled the land,  
He was a goodly king:  
He stole three pecks of barley meal,  
To make a bag-pudding.

A bag-pudding the king did make,  
And stuffed it well with plums;  
And in it put great lumps of fat,  
As big as my two thumbs.

The king and queen did eat thereof,  
And noblemen beside;  
And what they could not eat that night,  
The queen next morning fried.

*Unknown.*

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## **HYDER IDDLLE**

Hyder iddle diddle dell,  
A yard of pudding is not an ell;  
Not forgetting tweedle-dye,  
A tailor's goose will never fly.

*Unknown.*

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## **THE OCEAN WANDERER**

Bright breaks the warrior o'er the ocean wave  
Through realms that rove not, clouds that cannot save,  
Sinks in the sunshine; dazzles o'er the tomb  
And mocks the mutiny of Memory's gloom.  
Oh! who can feel the crimson ecstasy  
That soothes with bickering jar the Glorious Tree?  
O'er the high rock the foam of gladness throws,  
While star-beams lull Vesuvius to repose:  
Girds the white spray, and in the blue lagoon,  
Weeps like a walrus o'er the waning moon?  
Who can declare?—not thou, pervading boy  
Whom pibrochs pierce not, crystals cannot cloy;—  
Not thou soft Architect of silvery gleams,  
Whose soul would simmer in Hesperian streams,  
Th' exhaustless fire—the bosom's azure bliss,  
That hurtles, life-like, o'er a scene like this;—  
Defies the distant agony of Day—  
And sweeps o'er hecatombs—away! away!  
Say shall Destruction's lava load the gale,  
The furnace quiver and the mountain quail?  
Say shall the son of Sympathy pretend  
His cedar fragrance with our Chief's to blend?  
There, where the gnarled monuments of sand  
Howl their dark whirlwinds to the levin brand;  
Conclusive tenderness; fraternal grog,  
Tidy conjunction; adamant bog,  
Impetuous arrant toadstool; Thundering quince,  
Repentant dog-star, inessential Prince,  
Expound. Pre-Adamite eventful gun,  
Crush retribution, currant-jelly, pun,  
Oh! eligible Darkness, fender, sting,  
Heav'n-born Insanity, courageous thing.  
Intending, bending, scouring, piercing all,  
Death like pomatum, tea, and crabs must fall.

*Unknown.*

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## SCIENTIFIC PROOF

If we square a lump of pemmican  
And cube a pot of tea,  
Divide a musk ox by the span  
From noon to half-past three;  
If we calculate the Eskimo  
By solar parallax,  
Divide the sextant by a floe  
And multiply the cracks  
By nth-powered igloos, we may prove  
All correlated facts.

If we prolongate the parallel  
Indefinitely forth,  
And cube a sledge till we can tell  
The real square root of North;  
Bisect a seal and bifurcate  
The tangent with a pack  
Of Polar ice, we get the rate  
Along the Polar track,  
And proof of corollary things  
Which otherwise we lack.

If we multiply the Arctic night  
By X times ox times moose,  
And build an igloo on the site  
Of its hypotenuse;  
If we circumscribe an arc about  
An Arctic dog and weigh  
A segment of it, every doubt  
Is made as clear as day.  
We also get the price of ice  
F. O. B. Baffin's Bay.

If we amplify the Arctic breeze  
By logarithmic signs,  
And run through the isosceles  
Imaginary lines,  
We find that twice the half of one  
Is equal to the whole.  
Which, when the calculus is done,  
Quite demonstrates the Pole.  
It also gives its length and breadth  
And what's the price of coal.  
And what's the price of coal.

*J. W. Foley.*

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## **THE THINGUMBOB**

### **A PASTEL**

The Thingumbob sat at eventide,  
On the shore of a shoreless sea,  
Expecting an unexpected attack  
From something it could not foresee.

A still calm rests on the angry waves,  
The low wind whistles a mournful tune,  
And the Thingumbob sighs to himself, "Alas,  
I've had no supper now since noon."

*Unknown.*

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## WONDERS OF NATURE

Ah! who has seen the mailed lobster rise,  
Clap her broad wings, and, soaring, claim the skies?  
When did the owl, descending from her bower,  
Crop, 'midst the fleecy flocks, the tender flower;  
Or the young heifer plunge, with pliant limb,  
In the salt wave, and, fish-like, try to swim?  
The same with plants, potatoes 'tatoes breed,  
The costly cabbage springs from cabbage-seed;  
Lettuce to lettuce, leeks to leeks succeed;  
Nor e'er did cooling cucumbers presume  
To flower like myrtle, or like violets bloom.

*The Anti-Jacobin.*

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## LINES BY AN OLD FOGY

I'm thankful that the sun and moon  
Are both hung up so high,  
That no presumptuous hand can stretch  
And pull them from the sky.

If they were not, I have no doubt  
But some reforming ass  
Would recommend to take them down  
And light the world with gas.

*Unknown.*

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# **A COUNTRY SUMMER PASTORAL**

As written by a learned scholar of the city from knowledge derived from etymological deductions rather than from actual experience.

I would flee from the city's rule and law,  
From its fashion and form cut loose,  
And go where the strawberry grows on its straw,  
And the gooseberry on its goose;  
Where the catnip tree is climbed by the cat  
As she crouches for her prey—  
The guileless and unsuspecting rat  
On the rattan bush at play.

I will watch at ease for the saffron cow  
And the cowlet in their glee,  
As they leap in joy from bough to bough  
On the top of the cowslip tree;  
Where the musical partridge drums on his drum,  
And the dog devours the dogwood plum  
And the wood chuck chucks his wood,  
In the primitive solitude.

And then to the whitewashed dairy I'll turn,  
Where the dairymaid hastening hies,  
Her ruddy and golden-haired butter to churn  
From the milk of her butterflies;  
And I'll rise at morn with the early bird,  
To the fragrant farm-yard pass,  
When the farmer turns his beautiful herd  
Of grasshoppers out to grass.

*Unknown.*

---

## TURVEY TOP

'Twas after a supper of Norfolk brawn  
That into a doze I chanced to drop,  
And thence awoke in the grey of dawn,  
In the wonder-land of Turvey Top.

A land so strange I never had seen,  
And could not choose but look and laugh—  
A land where the small the great includes,  
And the whole is less than the half!

A land where the circles were not lines  
Round central points, as schoolmen show,  
And the parallels met whenever they chose,  
And went playing at touch-and-go!

There—except that every round was square,  
And save that all the squares were rounds—  
No surface had limits anywhere,  
So they never could beat the bounds.

In their gardens, fruit before blossom came,  
And the trees diminished as they grew;  
And you never went out to walk a mile,  
It was the mile that walked to you.

The people there are not tall or short,  
Heavy or light, or stout or thin,  
And their lives begin where they should leave off,  
Or leave off where they should begin.

There childhood, with naught of childish glee,  
Looks on the world with thoughtful brow;  
'Tis only the aged who laugh and crow,  
And cry "We have done with it now!";

A singular race! what lives they spent!  
Got up before they went to bed!  
And never a man said what he meant,  
Or a woman meant what she said.

They blended colours that will not blend,  
All hideous contrasts voted sweet;  
In yellow and red their Quakers dress'd,  
And considered it rather neat.

They didn't believe in the wise and good,  
Said the best were worst, the wisest fools;  
And 'twas only to have their teachers taught  
That they founded national schools.

They read in "books that are no books,"  
Their classics—chess-boards neatly bound;  
Those their greatest authors who never wrote,  
And their deepest the least profound.

Now, such were the folks of that wonder-land,  
A curious people, as you will own;  
But are there none of the race abroad,  
Are no specimens elsewhere known?

Well, I think that he whose views of life  
Are crooked, wrong, perverse, and odd,  
Who looks upon all with jaundiced eyes—  
Sees himself and believes it God,

Who sneers at the good, and makes the ill,  
Curses a world he cannot mend;  
Who measures life by the rule of wrong  
And abuses its aim and end,

The man who stays when he ought to move,

And only goes when he ought to stop—  
Is strangely like the folk in my dream,  
And would flourish in Turvey Top.

*William Sawyer.*

---

## **A BALLAD OF BEDLAM**

O lady wake!—the azure moon  
Is rippling in the verdant skies,  
The owl is warbling his soft tune,  
Awaiting but thy snowy eyes.  
The joys of future years are past,  
To-morrow's hopes have fled away;  
Still let us love, and e'en at last,  
We shall be happy yesterday.

The early beam of rosy night  
Drives off the ebon morn afar,  
While through the murmur of the light  
The huntsman winds his mad guitar.  
Then, lady, wake! my brigantine  
Pants, neighs, and prances to be free;  
Till the creation I am thine.  
To some rich desert fly with me.

*Unknown.*

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# NATURAL HISTORY

## THE FASTIDIOUS SERPENT

There was a snake that dwelt in Skye,  
Over the misty sea, oh;  
He lived upon nothing but gooseberry pie  
For breakfast, dinner and tea, oh.

Now gooseberry pie—as is very well known,—  
Over the misty sea, oh,  
Is not to be found under every stone,  
Nor yet upon every tree, oh.

And being so ill to please with his meat,  
Over the misty sea, oh;  
The snake had sometimes nothing to eat,  
And an angry snake was he, oh.

Then he'd flick his tongue and his head he'd shake,  
Over the misty sea, oh,  
Crying, "Gooseberry pie! For goodness' sake,  
Some gooseberry pie for me, oh."

And if gooseberry pie was not to be had,  
Over the misty sea, oh,  
He'd twine and twist like an eel gone mad,  
Or a worm just stung by a bee, oh.

But though he might shout and wriggle about,  
Over the misty sea, oh,



The snake had often to go without  
His breakfast, dinner and tea, oh.

*Henry Johnstone.*

---

## THE LEGEND OF THE FIRST CAM-U-EL

### AN ARABIAN APOLOGUE

Across the sands of Syria,  
Or, possibly, Algeria,  
Or some benighted neighbourhood of barrenness and drouth,  
There came the Prophet Sam-u-el  
Upon the Only Cam-u-el—  
A bumpy, grumpy Quadruped of discontented mouth.

The atmosphere was glutinous;  
The Cam-u-el was mutinous;  
He dumped the pack from off his back; with horrid grunts and squeals  
He made the desert hideous;  
With strategy perfidious  
He tied his neck in curlicues, he kicked his paddy heels.

Then quoth the gentle Sam-u-el,  
"You rogue, I ought to lam you well!  
Though zealously I've shielded you from every grief and woe,  
It seems, to voice a platitude,  
You haven't any gratitude.  
I'd like to hear what cause you have for doing thus and so!"

To him replied the Cam-u-el,  
"I beg your pardon, Sam-u-el.  
I know that I'm a Reprobate, I know that I'm a Freak;  
But, oh! this utter loneliness!

My too-distinguished Onliness!  
Were there but other Cam-u-els I wouldn't be Unique."

The Prophet beamed beguilingly.  
"Aha," he answered, smilingly,  
"You feel the need of company? I clearly understand.  
We'll speedily create for you  
The corresponding mate for you—  
Ho! presto, change-o, dinglebat!"—he waved a potent hand,

And, lo! from out Vacuity  
A second Incongruity,  
To wit, a Lady Cam-u-el was born through magic art.  
Her structure anatomical,  
Her form and face were comical;  
She was, in short, a Cam-u-el, the other's counterpart.

As Spaniards gaze on Aragon,  
Upon that Female Paragon  
So gazed the Prophet's Cam-u-el, that primal Desert Ship.  
A connoisseur meticulous,  
He found her that ridiculous  
He grinned from ear to auricle *until he split his lip!*

Because of his temerity  
That Cam-u-el's posterity  
Must wear divided upper lips through all their solemn lives!  
A prodigy astonishing  
Reproachfully admonishing  
Those, wicked, heartless married men who ridicule their wives.

*Arthur Guiterman.*

---

## UNSATISFIED YEARNING

Down in the silent hallway  
Scampers the dog about,  
And whines, and barks, and scratches,  
In order to get out.

Once in the glittering starlight,  
He straightway doth begin  
To set up a doleful howling  
In order to get in.

*R. K. Munkittrick.*

---

## KINDLY ADVICE

Be kind to the panther! for when thou wert young,  
In thy country far over the sea,  
'Twas a panther ate up thy papa and mama,  
And had several mouthfuls of thee!

Be kind to the badger! for who shall decide  
The depth of his badgery soul?  
And think of the tapir, when flashes the lamp  
O'er the fast and the free flowing bowl.

Be kind to the camel! nor let word of thine  
Ever put up his bactrian back;  
And cherish the she-kangaroo with her bag,  
Nor venture to give her the sack.

Be kind to the ostrich! for how canst thou hope  
To have such a stomach as it?  
And when the proud day of your "bridal" shall come,

Do give the poor birdie a "bit."

Be kind to the walrus! nor ever forget  
To have it on Tuesday to tea;  
But butter the crumpets on only one side,  
Save such as are eaten by thee.

Be kind to the bison! and let the jackal  
In the light of thy love have a share;  
And coax the ichneumon to grow a new tail,  
And have lots of larks in its lair!

Be kind to the bustard, that genial bird,  
And humour its wishes and ways;  
And when the poor elephant suffers from bile,  
Then tenderly lace up his stays!

*Unknown.*

---

## KINDNESS TO ANIMALS

Speak gently to the herring and kindly to the calf,  
Be blithesome with the bunny, at barnacles don't laugh!  
Give nuts unto the monkey, and buns unto the bear,  
Ne'er hint at currant jelly if you chance to see a hare!  
Oh, little girls, pray hide your combs when tortoises draw nigh,  
And never in the hearing of a pigeon whisper Pie!  
But give the stranded jelly-fish a shove into the sea,—  
Be always kind to animals wherever you may be!

Oh, make not game of sparrows, nor faces at the ram,  
And ne'er allude to mint sauce when calling on a lamb.  
Don't beard the thoughtful oyster, don't dare the cod to crimp,  
Don't cheat the pike, or ever try to pot the playful shrimp.

Tread lightly on the turning worm, don't bruise the butterfly,  
Don't ridicule the wry-neck, nor sneer at salmon-fry;  
Oh, ne'er delight to make dogs fight, nor bantams disagree,—  
Be always kind to animals wherever you may be!

Be lenient with lobsters, and ever kind to crabs,  
And be not disrespectful to cuttle-fish or dabs;  
Chase not the Cochin-China, chaff not the ox obese,  
And babble not of feather-beds in company with geese.  
Be tender with the tadpole, and let the limpet thrive,  
Be merciful to mussels, don't skin your eels alive;  
When talking to a turtle don't mention calipee—  
Be always kind to animals wherever you may be.

*J. Ashby-Sterry.*

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## **TO BE OR NOT TO BE**

### **I**

I sometimes think I'd rather crow  
And be a rooster than to roost  
And be a crow. But I dunno.

### **II**

A rooster he can roost also,  
Which don't seem fair when crows can't crow.  
Which may help some. Still I dunno.

### **III**

Crows should be glad of one thing, though;  
Nobody thinks of eating crow,  
While roosters they are good enough  
For anyone unless they're tough.

#### IV

There are lots of tough old roosters, though,  
And anyway a crow can't crow,  
So mebbly roosters stand more show.  
It looks that way. But I dunno.

*Unknown.*

---

### THE HEN

Was once a hen of wit not small  
    (In fact, 'twas not amazing),  
And apt at laying eggs withal,  
Who, when she'd done, would scream and bawl,  
    As if the house were blazing.  
A turkey-cock, of age mature,  
    Felt thereat indignation;  
'Twas quite improper, he was sure—  
He would no more the thing endure;  
    So, after cogitation,  
He to the lady straight repaired,  
And thus his business he declared:  
    "Madam, pray, what's the matter,  
That always, when you've laid an egg,  
    You make so great a clatter?  
I wish you'd do the thing in quiet.  
Do be advised by me, and try it."  
"Advised by you!" the lady cried,  
And tossed her head with proper pride;  
"And what do you know, now I pray,  
Of the fashion of the present day,  
You creature ignorant and low?

However, if you want to know,  
This is the reason why I do it:  
I lay my egg, and then review it!"

*Matthew Claudius.*

---

## OF BAITING THE LION

Remembering his taste for blood  
    You'd better bait him with a cow;  
Persuade the brute to chew the cud  
    Her tail suspended from a bough;  
It thrills the lion through and through  
    To hear the milky creature moo.

Having arranged this simple ruse,  
    Yourself you climb a neighboring tree;  
See to it that the spot you choose  
    Commands the coming tragedy;  
Take up a smallish Maxim gun,  
    A search-light, whisky, and a bun.

It's safer, too, to have your bike  
    Standing immediately below,  
In case your piece should fail to strike,  
    Or deal an ineffective blow;  
The Lion moves with perfect grace,  
    But cannot go the scorcher's pace.

Keep open ear for subtle signs;  
    Thus, when the cow profusely moans,  
That means to say, the Lion dines.  
    The crunching sound, of course, is bones;

Silence resumes her ancient reign—  
This shows the cow is out of pain.

But when a fat and torpid hum  
Escapes the eater's unctuous nose,  
Turn up the light and let it come  
Full on his innocent repose;  
Then pour your shot between his eyes,  
And go on pouring till he dies.

Play, even so, discretion's part;  
Descend with stealth; bring on your gun;  
Then lay your hand above his heart  
To see if he is really done;  
Don't skin him till you know he's dead  
Or you may perish in his stead!

---

Years hence, at home, when talk is tall,  
You'll set the gun-room wide agape,  
Describing how with just a small  
Pea-rifle, going after ape  
You met a Lion unaware,  
And felled him flying through the air.

*Owen Seaman.*

---

## **THE FLAMINGO**

Inspired by reading a chorus of spirits in a German play

### **FIRST VOICE**

Oh! tell me have you ever seen a red, long-leg'd Flamingo?  
Oh! tell me have you ever yet seen him the water in go?



**SECOND VOICE**

Oh! yes at Bowling-Green I've seen a red long-leg'd Flamingo,  
Oh! yes at Bowling-Green I've there seen him the water in go.

**FIRST VOICE**

Oh! tell me did you ever see a bird so funny stand-o  
When forth he from the water comes and gets upon the land-o?

**SECOND VOICE**

No! in my life I ne'er did see a bird so funny stand-o  
When forth he from the water comes and gets upon the land-o.

**FIRST VOICE**

He has a leg some three feet long, or near it, so they say, Sir.  
Stiff upon one alone he stands, t'other he stows away, Sir.

**SECOND VOICE**

And what an ugly head he's got! I wonder that he'd wear it.  
But rather *more* I wonder that his long, thin neck can bear it.

**FIRST VOICE**

And think, this length of neck and legs (no doubt they have their uses)  
Are members of a little frame, much smaller than a goose's!

**BOTH**

Oh! isn't he a curious bird, that red, long-leg'd Flamingo?  
A water bird, a gawky bird, a sing'lar bird, by jingo!

*Lewis Gaylord Clark.*

---

**WHY DOTTH A PUSSY CAT?**

Why doth a pussy cat prefer,  
When dozing, drowsy, on the sill,  
To purr and purr and purr and purr  
Instead of merely keeping still?  
With nodding head and folded paws,  
She keeps it up without a cause.

Why doth she flaunt her lofty tail  
In such a stiff right-angled pose?  
If lax and limp she let it trail  
'Twould seem more restful, Goodness knows!  
When strolling 'neath the chairs or bed,  
She lets it bump above her head.

Why doth she suddenly refrain  
From anything she's busied in  
And start to wash, with might and main,  
Most any place upon her skin?  
Why doth she pick that special spot,  
Not seeing if it's soiled or not?

Why doth she never seem to care  
To come directly when you call,  
But makes approach from here and there,  
Or sidles half around the wall?  
Though doors are opened at her mew,  
You often have to push her through.

Why doth she this? Why doth she that?  
I seek for cause—I yearn for clews;  
The subject of the pussy cat  
Doth endlessly inspire the mews.  
Why doth a pussy cat? Ah, me,  
I haven't got the least idee. '.

*Burges Johnson.*

---

## THE WALRUS AND THE CARPENTER

The sun was shining on the sea,  
Shining with all his might:  
He did his very best to make  
The billows smooth and bright—  
And this was odd, because it was  
The middle of the night.

The moon was shining sulkily,  
Because she thought the sun  
Had got no business to be there  
After the day was done—  
"It's very rude of him," she said,  
"To come and spoil the fun!"

The sea was wet as wet could be,  
The sands were dry as dry.  
You could not see a cloud, because  
No cloud was in the sky:  
No birds were flying overhead—  
There were no birds to fly.

The Walrus and the Carpenter  
Were walking close at hand;  
They wept like anything to see  
Such quantities of sand:  
"If this were only cleared away,"  
They said, "it would be grand!"

"If seven maids with seven mops  
Swept it for half a year,  
Do you suppose," the Walrus said,  
"That they could get it clear?"

"I doubt it," said the Carpenter,  
And shed a bitter tear.

"O Oysters come and walk with us!"  
The Walrus did beseech.  
"A pleasant walk, a pleasant talk,  
Along the briny beach:  
We cannot do with more than four,  
To give a hand to each."

The eldest Oyster looked at him,  
But not a word he said:  
The eldest Oyster winked his eye,  
And shook his heavy head—  
Meaning to say he did not choose  
To leave the oyster-bed.

But four young Oysters hurried up,  
All eager for the treat:  
Their coats were brushed, their faces washed,  
Their shoes were clean and neat—  
And this was odd, because, you know,  
They hadn't any feet.

Four other Oysters followed them,  
And yet another four;  
And thick and fast they came at last,  
And more, and more, and more—  
All hopping through the frothy waves,  
And scrambling to the shore.

The Walrus and the Carpenter  
Walked on a mile or so,  
And then they rested on a rock,  
Conveniently low:  
And all the little Oysters stood  
And waited in a row.

"The time has come," the Walrus said,  
    "To talk of many things:  
Of shoes—and ships—and sealing-wax—  
    Of cabbages—and kings—  
And why the sea is boiling hot—  
    And whether pigs have wings."

"But wait a bit," the Oysters cried,  
    "Before we have our chat;  
For some of us are out of breath,  
    And all of us are fat!"  
"No hurry!" said the Carpenter.  
    They thanked him much for that.

"A loaf of bread," the Walrus said,  
    "Is what we chiefly need;  
Pepper and vinegar besides  
    Are very good indeed—  
Now, if you're ready, Oysters dear,  
    We can begin to feed."

"But not on us," the Oysters cried,  
    Turning a little blue.  
"After such kindness that would be  
    A dismal thing to do!"  
"The night is fine," the Walrus said,  
    "Do you admire the view?"

"It was so kind of you to come,  
    And you are very nice!"  
The Carpenter said nothing but,  
    "Cut us another slice.  
I wish you were not quite so deaf—  
    I've had to ask you twice!"

"It seems a shame," the Walrus said,

"To play them such a trick.  
After we've brought them out so far  
And made them trot so quick!"  
The Carpenter said nothing but,  
"The butter's spread too thick!"

"I weep for you," the Walrus said,  
"I deeply sympathize."  
With sobs and tears he sorted out  
Those of the largest size,  
Holding his pocket-handkerchief  
Before his streaming eyes.

"O Oysters," said the Carpenter,  
"You've had a pleasant run!  
Shall we be trotting home again?"  
But answer came there none—  
And this was scarcely odd, because  
They'd eaten every one.

*Lewis Carroll.*

---

## **NIRVANA**

I am  
A Clam!  
Come learn of me  
Unclouded peace and calm content,  
Serene, supreme tranquillity,  
Where thoughtless dreams and dreamless thoughts are blent.

When the salt tide is rising to the flood,  
In billows blue my placid pulp I lave;

And when it ebbs I slumber in the mud,  
Content alike with ooze or crystal wave.

I do not shudder when in chowder stewed,  
Nor when the Coney Islander engulfs me raw.  
When in the church soup's dreary solitude  
Alone I wander, do I shudder? Naw!

If jarring tempests beat upon my bed,  
Or summer peace there be,  
I do not care: as I have said,  
All's one to me;  
A Clam  
I am.

*Unknown.*

---

## THE CATFISH

The saddest fish that swims the briny ocean,  
The Catfish I bewail.  
I cannot even think without emotion  
Of his distressful tail.  
When with my pencil once I tried to draw one,  
(I dare not show it here)  
Mayhap it is because I never saw one,  
The picture looked so queer.  
I vision him half feline and half fishy,  
A paradox in twins,  
Unmixable as vitriol and vichy—  
A thing of fur and fins.  
A feline Tantalus, forever chasing  
His fishy self to rend;

His finny self forever self-effacing  
In circles without end.  
This tale may have a Moral running through it  
As Æsop had in his;  
If so, dear reader, you are welcome to it,  
If you know what it is!

*Oliver Herford.*

---

## WAR RELIEF

"Can you spare a Threepenny bit,  
Dear Miss Turkey," said Sir Mouse,  
"For Job's Turkey's benefit?  
I've engaged the Opera House!"

"Alas! I've naught to spare!"  
Said Miss Turkey, "save advice,  
I am getting up a Fair,  
To relieve the Poor Church Mice."

*Oliver Herford.*

---

## THE OWL AND THE PUSSY-CAT

The Owl and the Pussy-Cat went to sea  
In a beautiful pea-green boat:  
They took some honey, and plenty of money  
Wrapped up in a five-pound note.



The Owl looked up to the stars above,  
And sang to a small guitar,  
"Oh, lovely Pussy, oh, Pussy, my love,  
What a beautiful Pussy you are,  
You are,  
You are!  
What a beautiful Pussy you are!"

Pussy said to the Owl, "You elegant fowl,  
How charmingly sweet you sing!  
Oh, let us be married; too long we have tarried:  
But what shall we do for a ring?"  
They sailed away for a year and a day,  
To the land where the bong-tree grows;  
And there in the wood a Piggy-wig stood,  
With a ring at the end of his nose,  
His nose,  
His nose,  
With a ring at the end of his nose.

"Dear Pig, are you willing to sell for one shilling  
Your ring?" Said the Piggy, "I will."  
So they took it away and were married next day  
By the Turkey who lives on the hill.  
They dined on mince and slices of quince,  
Which they ate with a runcible spoon;  
And hand in hand, on the edge of the sand,  
They danced by the light of the moon,  
The moon,  
The moon,  
They danced by the light of the moon.

*Edward Lear.*

---

## MEXICAN SERENADE

When the little armadillo  
With his head upon his pillow  
Sweetly rests,  
And the parrakeet and lindo  
Flitting past my cabin window  
Seek their nests,—

When the mists of even settle  
Over Popocatpetl,  
Dropping dew,—  
Like the condor, over yonder,  
Still I ponder, ever fonder,  
Dear, of You!

May no revolution shock you,  
May the earthquake gently rock you  
To repose,  
While the sentimental panthers  
Sniff the pollen-laden anthers  
Of the rose!

While the pelican is pining,  
While the moon is softly shining  
On the stream,  
May the song that I am singing  
Send a tender cadence winging  
Through your dream!

I have just one wish to utter—  
That you twinkle through your shutter  
Like a star,  
While, according to convention,  
I shall cas-u-ally mention  
My guitar.

Señorita Maraquita,  
Muy bonita, pobracita!—  
Hear me weep!—  
But the night is growing wetter,  
So I guess that you had better  
Go to sleep.

*Arthur Guiterman.*

---

## ORPHAN BORN

I am a lone, unfathered chick,  
Of artificial hatching,  
A pilgrim in a desert wild,  
By happier, mothered chicks reviled,  
From all relationships exiled,  
To do my own lone scratching.

Fair science smiled upon my birth  
One raw and gusty morning;  
But ah, the sounds of barnyard mirth  
To lonely me have little worth;  
Alone am I in all the earth—  
An orphan without borning.

Seek I my mother? I would find  
A heartless personator;  
A thing brass-feathered, man-designed,  
With steam-pipe arteries intermined,  
And pulseless cotton-batting lined—  
A patent incubator.

It wearies me to think, you see—  
Death would be better, rather—  
Should downy chicks be hatched of me,  
By fate's most pitiless decree,  
My piping pullets still would be  
With never a grandfather.

And when to earth I bid adieu  
To seek a planet greater,  
I will not do as others do,  
Who fly to join the ancestral crew,  
For I will just be gathered to  
My incubator.

*Robert J. Burdette.*

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## **DIVIDED DESTINIES**

It was an artless Bandar, and he danced upon a pine,  
And much I wondered how he lived, and where the beast might dine,  
And many, many other things, till, o'er my morning smoke,  
I slept the sleep of idleness and dreamed that Bandar spoke.

He said: "Oh, man of many clothes! sad crawler on the Hills!  
Observe, I know not Ranken's shop, nor Ranken's monthly bills!  
I take no heed to trousers or the coats that you call dress;  
Nor am I plagued with little cards for little drinks at Mess.

"I steal the bunnia's grain at morn, at noon and eventide  
(For he is fat and I am spare), I roam the mountainside,  
I follow no man's carriage, and no, never in my life  
Have I flirted at Peliti's with another Bandar's wife.

"Oh, man of futile fopperies—unnecessary wraps;

I own no ponies in the Hills, I drive no tall-wheeled traps;  
I buy me not twelve-button gloves, 'short-sixes' eke, or rings,  
Nor do I waste at Hamilton's my wealth on pretty things.

"I quarrel with my wife at home, we never fight abroad;  
But Mrs. B. has grasped the fact I am her only lord.  
I never heard of fever—dumps nor debts depress my soul;  
And I pity and despise you!" Here he pouched my breakfast-roll.

His hide was very mangy and his face was very red,  
And undisguisedly he scratched with energy his head.  
His manners were not always nice, but how my spirit cried  
To be an artless Bandar loose upon the mountainside!

So I answered: "Gentle Bandar, an inscrutable Decree  
Makes thee a gleesome, fleasome Thou, and me a wretched Me.  
Go! Depart in peace, my brother, to thy home amid the pine;  
Yet forget not once a mortal wished to change his lot with thine."

*Rudyard Kipling.*

---

## THE VIPER

Yet another great truth I record in my verse,  
That some Vipers are venomous, some the reverse;  
A fact you may prove if you try,  
By procuring two Vipers and letting them bite;  
With the first you are only the worse for a fright,  
But after the second you die.

*Hilaire Belloc.*

---

## THE LLAMA

The Llama is a woolly sort of fleecy, hairy goat,  
With an indolent expression and an undulating throat,  
Like an unsuccessful literary man.  
And I know the place he lives in (or at least I think I do)  
It is Ecuador, Brazil or Chile—possibly Peru;  
You must find it in the Atlas if you can.

The Llama of the Pampases you never should confound  
(In spite of a deceptive similarity of sound),  
With the Lhama who is Lord of Turkestan.  
For the former is a beautiful and valuable beast,  
But the latter is not lovable nor useful in the least;  
And the Ruminant is preferable surely to the Priest  
Who battens on the woful superstitions of the East,  
The Mongol of the Monastery of Shan.

*Hilaire Belloc.*

---

## THE YAK

As a friend to the children commend me the yak,  
You will find it exactly the thing:  
It will carry and fetch, you can ride on its back,  
Or lead it about with a string.

A Tartar who dwells on the plains of Thibet  
(A desolate region of snow)  
Has for centuries made it a nursery pet,  
And surely the Tartar should know!

Then tell your papa where the Yak can be got,  
And if he is awfully rich,  
He will buy you the creature—or else he will not,  
(I cannot be positive which).

---

## THE FROG

Be kind and tender to the Frog,  
And do not call him names,  
As "Slimy-Skin," or "Polly-wog,"  
Or likewise, "Uncle James,"  
Or "Gape-a-grin," or "Toad-gone-wrong,"  
Or, "Billy-Bandy-knees;"  
The Frog is justly sensitive  
To epithets like these.

No animal will more repay  
A treatment kind and fair,  
At least, so lonely people say Who keep a frog (and, by the way,  
They are extremely rare).

*Hilaire Belloc.*

---

## THE MICROBE

The Microbe is so very small  
You cannot make him out at all,  
But many sanguine people hope  
To see him through a microscope.

His jointed tongue that lies beneath  
A hundred curious rows of teeth;  
His seven tufted tails with lots  
Of lovely pink and purple spots

On each of which a pattern stands,  
Composed of forty separate bands;  
His eyebrows of a tender green;  
All these have never yet been seen—  
But Scientists, who ought to know,  
Assure us that they must be so....  
Oh! let us never, never doubt  
What nobody is sure about!

*Hilaire Belloc.*

---

## **THE GREAT BLACK CROW**

The crow—the crow! the great black crow!  
He cares not to meet us wherever we go;  
He cares not for man, beast, friend, nor foe,  
For nothing will eat him he well doth know.  
Know—know! you great black crow!  
It's a comfort to feel like a great black crow!

The crow—the crow! the great black crow!  
He loves the fat meadow—his taste is low;  
He loves the fat worms, and he dines in a row  
With fifty fine cousins all black as a sloe.  
Sloe—sloe! you great black crow!  
But it's jolly to fare like a great black crow!

The crow—the crow! the great black crow!



He never gets drunk on the rain or snow;  
He never gets drunk, but he never says no!  
If you press him to tipple ever so.  
So—so! you great black crow!  
It's an honour to soak like a great black crow!

The crow—the crow! the great black crow!  
He lives for a hundred year and mo';  
He lives till he dies, and he dies as slow  
As the morning mists down the hill that go.  
Go—go! you great black crow!  
But it's fine to live and die like a great black crow!

*Philip James Bailey.*

---

## **THE COLUBRIAD**

Close by the threshold of a door nailed fast,  
Three kittens sat; each kitten looked aghast.  
I, passing swift and inattentive by,  
At the three kittens cast a careless eye;  
Not much concerned to know what they did there;  
Not deeming kittens worth a poet's care.  
But presently, a loud and furious hiss  
Caused me to stop, and to exclaim, "What's this?"  
When lo! upon the threshold met my view,  
With head erect, and eyes of fiery hue,  
A viper long as Count de Grasse's queue.  
Forth from his head his forked tongue he throws,  
Darting it full against a kitten's nose;  
Who, having never seen, in field or house,  
The like, sat still and silent as a mouse;  
Only projecting, with attention due,

Her whiskered face, she asked him, "Who are you?"  
On to the hall went I, with pace not slow,  
But swift as lightning, for a long Dutch hoe:  
With which well armed, I hastened to the spot  
To find the viper—but I found him not.  
And, turning up the leaves and shrubs around,  
Found only that he was not to be found;  
But still the kittens, sitting as before,  
Sat watching close the bottom of the door.  
"I hope," said I, "the villain I would kill  
Has slipped between the door and the door-sill;  
And if I make despatch, and follow hard,  
No doubt but I shall find him in the yard:"  
(For long ere now it should have been rehearsed,  
'Twas in the garden that I found him first.)  
E'en there I found him: there the full-grown cat  
His head, with velvet paw, did gently pat;  
As curious as the kittens erst had been  
To learn what this phenomenon might mean.  
Filled with heroic ardour at the sight,  
And fearing every moment he would bite,  
And rob our household of our only cat  
That was of age to combat with a rat;  
With outstretched hoe I slew him at the door,  
And taught him never to come there no more!

*William Cowper.*

---

## THE RETIRED CAT

A Poet's Cat, sedate and grave  
As poet well could wish to have,  
Was much addicted to inquire

For nooks to which she might retire,  
And where, secure as mouse in chink,  
She might repose, or sit and think.  
I know not where she caught the trick;  
Nature perhaps herself had cast her  
In such a mold PHILOSOPHIQUE,  
Or else she learned it of her master.  
Sometimes ascending, debonair,  
An apple-tree, or lofty pear,  
Lodged with convenience in the fork,  
She watched the gardener at his work;  
Sometimes her ease and solace sought  
In an old empty watering-pot,  
There wanting nothing, save a fan,  
To seem some nymph in her sedan,  
Appareled in exactest sort,  
And ready to be borne to court.

But love of change it seems has place  
Not only in our wiser race;  
Cats also feel, as well as we,  
That passion's force, and so did she.  
Her climbing, she began to find,  
Exposed her too much to the wind,  
And the old utensil of tin  
Was cold and comfortless within:  
She therefore wished, instead of those,  
Some place of more serene repose,  
Where neither cold might come, nor air  
Too rudely wanton in her hair,  
And sought it in the likeliest mode  
Within her master's snug abode.

A drawer, it chanced, at bottom lined  
With linen of the softest kind,  
With such as merchants introduce  
From India, for the ladies' use;

A drawer, impending o'er the rest,  
Half open, in the topmost chest,  
Of depth enough, and none to spare,  
Invited her to slumber there;  
Puss with delight beyond expression,  
Surveyed the scene and took possession.  
Recumbent at her ease, ere long,  
And lulled by her own humdrum song,  
She left the cares of life behind,  
And slept as she would sleep her last,  
When in came, housewifely inclined,  
The chambermaid, and shut it fast,  
By no malignity impelled,  
But all unconscious whom it held.

Awakened by the shock (cried puss)  
"Was ever cat attended thus!  
The open drawer was left, I see,  
Merely to prove a nest for me,  
For soon as I was well composed,  
Then came the maid, and it was closed.  
How smooth those 'kerchiefs, and how sweet  
Oh what a delicate retreat!  
I will resign myself to rest  
Till Sol declining in the west,  
Shall call to supper, when, no doubt,  
Susan will come, and let me out."

The evening came, the sun descended,  
And puss remained still unattended.  
The night rolled tardily away  
(With her indeed 'twas never day),  
The sprightly morn her course renewed,  
The evening gray again ensued,  
And puss came into mind no more  
Than if entombed the day before;  
With hunger pinched, and pinched for room,

She now presaged approaching doom.  
Nor slept a single wink, nor purred,  
Conscious of jeopardy incurred.

That night, by chance, the poet, watching,  
Heard an inexplicable scratching;  
His noble heart went pit-a-pat,  
And to himself he said—"What's that?"  
He drew the curtain at his side,  
And forth he peeped, but nothing spied.  
Yet, by his ear directed, guessed  
Something imprisoned in the chest;  
And, doubtful what, with prudent care  
Resolved it should continue there.  
At length a voice which well he knew,  
A long and melancholy mew,  
Saluting his poetic ears,  
Consoled him, and dispelled his fears;  
He left his bed, he trod the floor,  
He 'gan in haste the drawers explore,  
The lowest first, and without stop  
The next in order to the top.  
For 'tis a truth well known to most,  
That whatsoever thing is lost,  
We seek it, ere it come to light,  
In every cranny but the right.  
Forth skipped the cat, not now replete  
As erst with airy self-conceit,  
Nor in her own fond comprehension,  
A theme for all the world's attention,  
But modest, sober, cured of all  
Her notions hyperbolical,  
And wishing for a place of rest,  
Any thing rather than a chest.  
Then stepped the poet into bed  
With this reflection in his head:

**MORAL**

Beware of too sublime a sense  
Of your own worth and consequence.  
The man who dreams himself so great,  
And his importance of such weight,  
That all around in all that's done  
Must move and act for him alone,  
Will learn in school of tribulation  
The folly of his expectation.

*William Cowper.*

---

## **A DARWINIAN BALLAD**

Oh, many have told of the monkeys of old,  
What a pleasant race they were,  
And it seems most true that I and you  
Are derived from an apish pair.  
They all had nails, and some had tails,  
And some—no "accounts in arrear";  
They climbed up the trees, and they scratched out the—these  
Of course I will not mention here.

They slept in a wood, or wherever they could,  
For they didn't know how to make beds;  
They hadn't got huts; they dined upon nuts,  
Which they cracked upon each other's heads.  
They hadn't much scope, for a comb, brush or soap,  
Or towels, or kettle or fire.  
They had no coats nor capes, for ne'er did these apes  
Invent what they didn't require.

The sharpest baboon never used fork or spoon,  
Nor made any boots for his toes,

Nor could any thief steal a silk handker-chief,  
For no ape thought much of his nose;  
They had cold collations; they ate poor relations:  
Provided for thus, by-the-bye.  
No Ou-rang-ou-tang a song ever sang—  
He couldn't, and so didn't try.

From these though descended our manners are mended,  
Though still we can grin and backbite!  
We cut up each other, be he friend or brother,  
And tales are the fashion—at night.  
This origination is all speculation—  
We gamble in various shapes;  
So Mr. Darwin may speculate in  
Our ancestors having been apes.

*Unknown.*

---

## THE PIG

### A COLLOQUIAL POEM

Jacob! I do not like to see thy nose  
Turn'd up in scornful curve at yonder pig,  
It would be well, my friend, if we like him,  
Were perfect in our kind!... And why despise  
The sow-born grunter?... He is obstinate,  
Thou answerest; ugly, and the filthiest beast  
That banquets upon offal.... Now I pray you  
Hear the pig's counsel.

Is he obstinate?

We must not, Jacob, be deceived by words;  
We must not take them as unheeding hands

Receive base money at the current worth  
But with a just suspicion try their sound,  
And in the even balance weight them well  
See now to what this obstinacy comes:  
A poor, mistreated, democratic beast,  
He knows that his unmerciful drivers seek  
Their profit, and not his. He hath not learned  
That pigs were made for man,... born to be brawn'd  
And baconized: that he must please to give  
Just what his gracious masters please to take;  
Perhaps his tusks, the weapons Nature gave  
For self-defense, the general privilege;  
Perhaps,... hark, Jacob! dost thou hear that horn?  
Woe to the young posterity of Pork!  
Their enemy is at hand.

Again. Thou say'st

The pig is ugly. Jacob, look at him!  
Those eyes have taught the lover flattery.  
His face,... nay, Jacob! Jacob! were it fair  
To judge a lady in her dishabille?  
Fancy it dressed, and with saltpeter rouged.  
Behold his tail, my friend; with curls like that  
The wanton hop marries her stately spouse:  
So crisp in beauty Amoretta's hair  
Rings round her lover's soul the chains of love.  
And what is beauty, but the aptitude  
Of parts harmonious? Give thy fancy scope,  
And thou wilt find that no imagined change  
Can beautify this beast. Place at his end  
The starry glories of the peacock's pride,  
Give him the swan's white breast; for his horn-hoofs  
Shape such a foot and ankle as the waves  
Crowded in eager rivalry to kiss  
When Venus from the enamor'd sea arose;...  
Jacob, thou canst but make a monster of him!  
An alteration man could think, would mar  
His pig-perfection.



The last charge,... he lives  
A dirty life. Here I could shelter him  
With noble and right-reverend precedents.  
And show by sanction of authority  
That 'tis a very honorable thing  
To thrive by dirty ways. But let me rest  
On better ground the unanswerable defense.  
The pig is a philosopher, who knows  
No prejudice. Dirt?... Jacob, what is dirt?  
If matter,... why the delicate dish that tempts  
An o'ergorged epicure to the last morsel  
That stuffs him to the throat-gates, is no more.  
If matter be not, but as sages say,  
Spirit is all, and all things visible  
Are one, the infinitely modified,  
Think, Jacob, what that pig is, and the mire  
Wherein he stands knee-deep!  
And there! the breeze  
Pleads with me, and has won thee to a smile  
That speaks conviction. O'er yon blossom'd field  
Of beans it came, and thoughts of bacon rise.

*Robert Southey.*

---

## **A FISH STORY**

A whale of great porosity  
And small specific gravity,  
Dived down with much velocity  
Beneath the sea's concavity.

But soon the weight of water  
Squeezed in his fat immensity,

Which varied—as it ought to—  
Inversely as his density.

It would have moved to pity  
An Ogre or a Hessian,  
To see poor Spermaceti  
Thus suffering compression.

The while he lay a-roaring  
In agonies gigantic,  
The lamp-oil out came pouring,  
And greased the wide Atlantic.

(Would we'd been in the Navy,  
And cruising there! Imagine us  
All in a sea of gravy,  
With billow oleaginous!)

At length old million-pounder,  
Low on a bed of coral,  
Gave his last dying flounder,  
Where to I pen this moral.

#### **MORAL**

O, let this tale dramatic,  
Anent the whale Norwegian  
And pressure hydrostatic,  
Warn you, my young collegian,

That down-compelling forces  
Increase as you get deeper;  
The lower down your course is,  
The upward path's the steeper.

*Henry A. Beers.*

---

## THE CAMERONIAN CAT

There was a Cameronian cat  
Was hunting for a prey,  
And in the house she caught a mouse  
Upon the Sabbath-day.

The Whig, being offended  
At such an act profane,  
Laid by his book, the cat he took,  
And bound her in a chain.

"Thou damned, thou cursed creature!  
This deed so dark with thee!  
Think'st thou to bring to hell below  
My holy wife and me?

"Assure thyself that for the deed  
Thou blood for blood shalt pay,  
For killing of the Lord's own mouse  
Upon the Sabbath-day."

The presbyter laid by the book,  
And earnestly he prayed  
That the great sin the cat had done  
Might not on him be laid.

And straight to execution  
Poor pussy she was drawn,  
And high hanged up upon a tree—  
The preacher sung a psalm.

And, when the work was ended,  
They thought the cat near dead;  
She gave a paw, and then a mew,  
And stretchèd out her head.

"Thy name," said he, "shall certainly  
A beacon still remain,  
A terror unto evil ones  
For evermore, Amen."

*Unknown.*

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## THE YOUNG GAZELLE

### A MOORE-ISH TALE

In early youth, as you may guess,  
I revelled in poetic lore,  
And while my schoolmates studied less,  
I resolutely studied *Moore*.

Those touching lines from "Lalla Rookh,"—  
"Ah, ever thus—" you know them well,  
Such root within my bosom took,  
I wished *I* had a young Gazelle.

Oh, yes! a sweet, a sweet Gazelle,  
"To charm me with its soft black eye,"  
So soft, so liquid, that a spell  
Seems in that gem-like orb to lie.

Years, childhood passed, youth fled away,  
My vain desire I'd learned to quell,  
Till came that most auspicious day  
When *some one gave me a Gazelle*.

With care, and trouble, and expense,

'Twas brought from Afric's northern cape;  
It seemed of great intelligence,  
And oh! so beautiful a shape.

Its lustrous, liquid eye was bent  
With special lovingness on me;  
No gift that mortal could present  
More welcome to my heart could be.

I brought him food with fond caress,  
Built him a hut, snug, neat, and warm;  
I called him "Selim," to express  
The marked *s(e)limness* of his form.

The little creature grew so tame,  
He "learned to know (the neighbors) well;"  
And then the ladies, when they came,  
Oh! how they "nursed that dear Gazelle."

But, woe is me! on earthly ground  
Some ill with every blessing dwells;  
And soon to my dismay I found  
That this applies to young Gazelles.

When free allowed to roam indoors,  
The mischief that he did was great;  
The walls, the furniture, the floors,  
He made in a terrific state.

He nibbled at the table-cloth,  
And trod the carpet into holes,  
And in his gambols, nothing loth,  
Kicked over scuttles full of coals.

To view his image in the glass,  
He reared upon his hinder legs;  
And thus one morn I found, alas!

Two porcelain vases smashed like eggs.

Whatever did his fancy catch  
By way of food, he would not wait  
To be invited, but would snatch  
It from one's table, hand, or plate.

He riled the dog, annoyed the cat,  
And scared the goldfish into fits;  
He butted through my newest hat,  
And tore my manuscript to bits.

'Twas strange, so light his hooflets weighed,  
His limbs as slender as a hare's,  
The noise my little Selim made  
In trotting up and down the stairs.

To tie him up I thought was wise,  
But loss of freedom gave him pain;  
I could not stand those pleading eyes,  
And so I let him go again.

How sweet to see him skip and prance  
Upon the gravel or the lawn;  
More light in step than fairies' dance,  
More graceful than an English fawn.

But then he spoilt the garden so,  
Trode down the beds, raked up the seeds,  
And ate the plants—nor did he show  
The least compunction for his deeds.

He trespassed on the neighbors' ground,  
And broke two costly melon frames,  
With other damages—a pound  
To pay, resulted from his games.

In short, the mischief was immense  
That from his gamesome pranks befel,  
And, truly, in a double sense,  
He proved a *very* "dear Gazelle."

At length I sighed—"Ah, ever thus  
Doth disappointment mock each hope;  
But 'tis in vain to make a fuss;  
You'll have to go, my antelope."

The chance I wished for did occur;  
A lady going to the East  
Was willing; so I gave to her  
That little antelopian beast.

I said, "This antler'd desert child  
In Turkish palaces may roam,  
But he is much too free and wild  
To keep in any English home."

Yes, tho' I gave him up with tears,  
Experience had broke the spell,  
And if I live a thousand years,  
I'll never have a young Gazelle.

*Walter Parke.*

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## THE BALLAD OF THE EMEU

O say, have you seen at the Willows so green—  
So charming and rurally true—  
A Singular bird; with a manner absurd,  
Which they call the Australian Emeu?

Have you?  
Ever seen this Australian Emeu?

It trots all around with its head on the ground,  
Or erects it quite out of your view;  
And the ladies all cry, when its figure they spy,  
"O, what a sweet pretty Emeu!  
Oh! do  
Just look at that lovely Emeu!"

One day to this spot, when the weather was hot,  
Came Matilda Hortense Fortescue;  
And beside her there came a youth of high name—  
Augustus Florell Montague:  
The two  
Both loved that wild foreign Emeu.

With two loaves of bread then they fed it, instead  
Of the flesh of the white cockatoo,  
Which once was its food in that wild neighbourhood  
Where ranges the sweet kangaroo  
That, too,  
Is game for the famous Emeu!

Old saws and gimlets but its appetite whet  
Like the world famous bark of Peru;  
There's nothing so hard that the bird will discard,  
And nothing its taste will eschew,  
That you  
Can give that long-legged Emeu!

The time slipped away in this innocent play,  
When up jumped the bold Montague:  
"Where's that specimen pin that I gaily did win  
In raffle, and gave unto you,  
Fortescue?"  
No word spoke the guilty Emeu!



"Quick! tell me his name whom thou gavest that same,  
Ere these hands in thy blood I imbrue!"  
"Nay, dearest," she cried as she clung to his side,  
"I'm innocent as that Emeu!"  
"Adieu!"  
He replied, "Miss M. H. Fortescue!"

Down she dropped at his feet, all as white as a sheet,  
As wildly he fled from her view;  
He thought 'twas her sin—for he knew not the pin  
Had been gobbled up by the Emeu;  
All through  
"I'm innocent as that Emeu!"

*Bret Harte.*

---

## THE TURTLE AND FLAMINGO

A lively young turtle lived down by the banks  
Of a dark rolling stream called the Jingo;  
And one summer day, as he went out to play,  
Fell in love with a charming flamingo—  
An enormously genteel flamingo!  
An expansively crimson flamingo!  
A beautiful, bouncing flamingo!

Spake the turtle, in tones like a delicate wheeze:  
"To the water I've oft seen you in go,  
And your form has impressed itself deep on my shell,  
You perfectly modelled flamingo!  
You tremendously A-1 flamingo!  
You in-ex-press-*i*-ble flamingo!"

"To be sure, I'm a turtle, and you are a belle,  
And my language is not your fine lingo;  
But smile on me, tall one, and be my bright flame,  
You miraculous, wondrous flamingo!  
You blazingly beauteous flamingo!  
You turtle-absorbing flamingo!  
You inflammably gorgeous flamingo!"

Then the proud bird blushed redder than ever before,  
And that was quite un-nec-es-sa-ry,  
And she stood on one leg and looked out of one eye,  
The position of things for to vary,—  
This aquatical, musing flamingo!  
This dreamy, uncertain flamingo!  
This embarrassing, harassing flamingo!

Then she cried to the quadruped, greatly amazed:  
"Why your passion toward *me* do you hurtle?  
I'm an ornithological wonder of grace,  
And you're an illogical turtle,—  
A waddling, impossible turtle!  
A low-minded, grass-eating turtle!  
A highly improbable turtle!"

Then the turtle sneaked off with his nose to the ground  
And never more looked at the lasses;  
And falling asleep, while indulging his grief,  
Was gobbled up whole by Agassiz,—  
The peripatetic Agassiz!  
The turtle-dissecting Agassiz!  
The illustrious, industrious Agassiz!

Go with me to Cambridge some cool, pleasant day,  
And the skeleton lover I'll show you;  
He's in a hard case, but he'll look in your face,  
Pretending (the rogue!) he don't know you!

Oh, the deeply deceptive young turtle!  
The double-faced, glassy-cased turtle!  
The *green* but a very *mock* turtle!

*James Thomas Fields.*

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# JUNIORS

## PRIOR TO MISS BELLE'S APPEARANCE

What makes you come *here* fer, Mister,  
So much to *our* house?—*Say?*  
Come to see our big sister!—  
An' Charley he says 'at you kissed her  
An' he ketched you, thuther day!—  
Didn' you, Charley?—But we p'omised Belle  
And crossed our heart to never to tell—  
'Cause *she* gived us some o' them-er  
Chawk'lut-drops 'at you bringed to her!

Charley he's my little b'uther—  
An' we has a-mostest fun,  
Don't we, Charley?—Our Muther,  
Whenever we whips one-anuther,  
Tries to whip *us*—an' we *run*—  
Don't we, Charley?—An' nen, bime-by,  
Nen she gives us cake—an' pie—  
Don't she, Charley?—when we come in  
An' p'omise never to do it agin!

*He's* named Charley.—I'm *Willie*—  
An' I'm got the purtiest name!  
But Uncle Bob *he* calls me "Billy"—  
Don't he, Charley?—'Nour filly  
We named "Billy," the same  
Ist like me! An' our Ma said  
'At "Bob put foolishnuss into our head!"—

Didn' she, Charley?—An' *she* don't know  
Much about *boys*!—'Cause Bob said so!

Baby's a funniest feller!  
Naint no hair on his head—  
*Is* they, Charley? It's meller  
Wite up there! An' ef Belle er  
Us ask wuz we that way, Ma said,—  
"Yes; an' yer *Pa's* head wuz soft as that,  
An' it's that way yet!"—An' Pa grabs his hat  
An' says, "Yes, childern, she's right about Pa—  
'Cause that's the reason he married yer Ma!"

An' our Ma says 'at "Belle couldn'  
Ketch nothin 'at all but ist '*bows!*'"  
An' *Pa* says 'at "you're soft as puddun!"—  
An *Uncle Bob* says "you're a good-un—  
'Cause he can tell by yer nose!"—  
Didn' he, Charley? And when Belle'll play  
In the poller on th' pianer, some day,  
Bob makes up funny songs about you,  
Till she gits mad—like he wants her to!

Our sister *Fanny*, she's '*leven*  
Years old. 'At's mucher 'an *I*—  
Ain't it, Charley?... I'm seven!—  
But our sister *Fanny's* in *Heaven*!  
Nere's where you go ef you die!—  
Don't you, Charley? Nen you has *wings*—  
*Ist like Fanny!*—an' *purtiest things!*—  
Don't you, Charley? An' nen you can *fly*—  
Ist fly—an' ever'thing!... Wisht *I'd* die!

*James Whitcomb Riley.*

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## **THERE WAS A LITTLE GIRL**

There was a little girl,  
And she had a little curl  
    Right in the middle of her forehead.  
When she was good  
She was very, very good,  
    And when she was bad she was horrid.

One day she went upstairs,  
When her parents, unawares,  
    In the kitchen were occupied with meals  
And she stood upon her head  
In her little trundle-bed,  
    And then began hooraying with her heels.

Her mother heard the noise,  
And she thought it was the boys  
    A-playing at a combat in the attic;  
But when she climbed the stair,  
And found Jemima there,  
    She took and she did spank her most emphatic.

*Unknown.*

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## **THE NAUGHTY DARKEY BOY**

There was a cruel darkey boy,  
    Who sat upon the shore,  
A catching little fishes by  
    The dozen and the score.

And as they squirmed and wriggled there,  
He shouted loud with glee,  
"You surely cannot want to live,  
You're little-er dan me."

Just then with a malicious leer,  
And a capacious smile,  
Before him from the water deep  
There rose a crocodile.

He eyed the little darkey boy,  
Then heaved a blubbering sigh,  
And said, "You cannot want to live,  
You're little-er than I."

The fishes squirm and wriggle still,  
Beside that sandy shore,  
The cruel little darkey boy,  
Was never heard of more.

*Unknown.*

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## **DUTCH LULLABY**

Wynken, Blynken, and Nod one night  
Sailed off in a wooden shoe,—  
Sailed on a river of misty light  
Into a sea of dew.  
"Where are you going, and what do you wish?"  
The old moon asked the three.  
"We have come to fish for the herring-fish  
That live in this beautiful sea;  
Nets of silver and gold have we,"



Said Wynken,  
Blynken,  
And Nod.

The old moon laughed and sung a song,  
As they rocked in the wooden shoe;  
And the wind that sped them all night long  
Ruffled the waves of dew;  
The little stars were the herring-fish  
That lived in the beautiful sea.  
"Now cast your nets wherever you wish,  
But never afeard are we!"  
So cried the stars to the fishermen three,  
Wynken,  
Blynken,  
And Nod.

All night long their nets they threw  
For the fish in the twinkling foam,  
Then down from the sky came the wooden shoe,  
Bringing the fishermen home;  
'Twas all so pretty a sail, it seemed  
As if it could not be;  
And some folk thought 'twas a dream they'd dreamed  
Of sailing that beautiful sea;  
But I shall name you the fishermen three:  
Wynken,  
Blynken,  
And Nod.

Wynken and Blynken are two little eyes,  
And Nod is a little head,  
And the wooden shoe that sailed the skies  
Is a wee one's trundle-bed;  
So shut your eyes while Mother sings  
Of wonderful sights that be,  
And you shall see the beautiful things

As you rock on the misty sea  
Where the old shoe rocked the fishermen three,  
    Wynken,  
    Blynken,  
    And Nod.

*Eugene Field.*

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## **THE DINKEY-BIRD**

In an ocean, 'way out yonder  
    (As all sapient people know),  
Is the land of Wonder-Wander,  
    Whither children love to go;  
It's their playing, romping, swinging,  
    That give great joy to me  
While the Dinkey-Bird goes singing  
    In the Amfalula-tree!

There the gum-drops grow like cherries,  
    And taffy's thick as peas,—  
Caramels you pick like berries  
    When, and where, and how you please  
Big red sugar-plums are clinging  
    To the cliffs beside that sea  
Where the Dinkey-Bird is singing  
    In the Amfalula-tree.

So when children shout and scamper  
    And make merry all the day,  
When there's naught to put a damper  
    To the ardor of their play;  
When I hear their laughter ringing,

Then I'm sure as sure can be  
That the Dinkey-Bird is singing  
In the Amfalula-tree.

For the Dinkey-Bird's bravuras  
And staccatos are so sweet—  
His roulades, appoggiaturas,  
And robustos so complete,  
That the youth of every nation—  
Be they near or far away—  
Have especial delectation  
In that gladsome roundelay.

Their eyes grow bright and brighter,  
Their lungs begin to crow,  
Their hearts get light and lighter,  
And their cheeks are all aglow;  
For an echo cometh bringing  
The news to all and me  
That the Dinkey-Bird is singing  
In the Amfalula-tree.

I'm sure you'd like to go there  
To see your feathered friend—  
And so many goodies grow there  
You would like to comprehend!  
*Speed, little dreams, your winging*  
*To that land across the sea*  
*Where the Dinkey-Bird is singing*  
*In the Amfalula-Tree!*

*Eugene Field.*

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## THE LITTLE PEACH

A little peach in the orchard grew,  
A little peach of emerald hue:  
Warmed by the sun, and wet by the dew,  
It grew.

One day, walking the orchard through,  
That little peach dawned on the view  
Of Johnny Jones and his sister Sue—  
Those two.

Up at the peach a club they threw:  
Down from the limb on which it grew,  
Fell the little peach of emerald hue—  
Too true!

John took a bite, and Sue took a chew,  
And then the trouble began to brew,—  
Trouble the doctor couldn't subdue,—  
Paregoric too.

Under the turf where the daisies grew,  
They planted John and his sister Sue;  
And their little souls to the angels flew—  
Boo-hoo!

But what of the peach of emerald hue,  
Warmed by the sun, and wet by the dew?  
Ah, well! its mission on earth is through—  
Adieu!

*Eugene Field.*

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**COUNSEL TO THOSE THAT EAT**

With chocolate-cream that you buy in the cake  
Large mouthfuls and hurry are quite a mistake.

Wise persons prolong it as long as they can  
But putting in practice this excellent plan.

The cream from the chocolate lining they dig  
With a Runaway match or a clean little twig.

Many hundreds,—nay, thousands—of scoopings they make  
Before they've exhausted a twopenny cake.

With ices 'tis equally wrongful to haste;  
You ought to go slowly and dwell on each taste.

Large mouthfuls are painful, as well as unwise,  
For they lead to an ache at the back of the eyes.

And the delicate sip is e'en better, one finds,  
If the ice is a mixture of different kinds.

*Unknown.*

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## HOME AND MOTHER

Sleep, my own darling,  
By, baby, by;  
Mother is with thee,  
By, baby, by.  
There, baby. (Oh, how the wild winds wail!)  
Hush, baby. (Turning to sleet and hail;  
Ah, how the pine-tree moans and mutters!—

I wonder if Ellen will think of the shutters?)

Sleep, my own darling,  
By, baby, by;  
Mother is with thee,  
By, baby, by.

Rest thee. (She couldn't have left the blower  
Down in the parlor? There's so much to show her!)  
By-by, my sweetest. (Now the rain's pouring!  
Is it wind or the dining-room fire that's roaring?)

Sleep, my own darling,  
By, baby, by;  
Mother is with thee,  
By, baby, by.

How lovely his forehead!—my own blessed pet!  
He's nearly asleep. (Now I mustn't forget  
That pork in the brine, and the stair-rods to-morrow.)  
Heaven shield him forever from trouble and sorrow!

Sleep, my own darling,  
By, baby, by;  
Mother is with thee,  
By, baby, by.

Those dear little ringlets, so silky and bright!  
(I do hope the muffins will be nice and light.)  
How lovely he is! (Yes, she said she could fry.)  
Oh, what would I do if my baby should die!

Sleep, my own darling,  
By, baby, by;  
Mother is with thee,  
By, baby, by.

That sweet little hand, and the soft, dimpled cheek!  
Sleep, darling. (I'll have his clothes shortened this week.  
How tightly he's holding my dress; I'm afraid  
He'll wake when I move. There! his bed isn't made!)

Sleep, my own darling,  
By, baby, by;  
In thy soft cradle  
Peacefully lie.  
(He's settled at last. But I can't leave him so,  
Though I ought to be going this instant, I know.  
There's everything standing and waiting down-stairs.  
Ah me, but a mother is cumbered with cares!)

*Mary Mapes Dodge.*

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## **LITTLE ORPHANT ANNIE**

Little Orphant Annie's come to our house to stay,  
An' wash the cups and saucers up, an' brush the crumbs away,  
An' shoo the chickens off the porch, an' dust the hearth, an' sweep,  
An' make the fire, an' bake the bread, an' earn her board-an'-keep;  
An' all us other children, when the supper things is done,  
We set around the kitchen fire an' has the mostest fun  
A-list'nin' to the witch-tales 'at Annie tells about,  
An' the Gobble-uns 'at gits you  
    Ef you  
        Don't  
            Watch  
                Out!

Onc't there was a little boy wouldn't say his pray'rs—  
An' when he went to bed at night, away up stairs,  
His mammy heerd him holler, an' his daddy heerd him bawl,  
An' when they turn't the kivvers down, he wasn't there at all!  
An' they seeked him in the rafter-room, an' cubby-hole, an' press,  
An' seeked him up the chimbly-flue, an' ever'wheres, I guess;  
But all they ever found was thist his pants an' roundabout!

An' the Gobble-uns'll git you  
Ef you  
Don't  
Watch  
Out!

An' one time a little girl 'ud allus laugh an' grin,  
An' make fun of ever' one, an' all her blood-an'-kin;  
An' onc't when they was "company," an' ole folks was there,  
She mocked 'em an' shocked 'em, an' said she didn't care!  
An' thist as she kicked her heels, an' turn't to run an' hide,  
They was two great big Black Things a-standin' by her side,  
An' they snatched her through the ceilin' 'fore she knowed what she's  
about!

An' the Gobble-uns'll git you  
Ef you  
Don't  
Watch  
Out!

An' little Orphant Annie says, when the blaze is blue,  
An' the lampwick sputters, an' the wind goes woo-oo!  
An' you hear the crickets quit, an' the moon is gray,  
An' the lightnin'-bugs in dew is all squenched away,—  
You better mind yer parents, and yer teachers fond and dear,  
An' churish them 'at loves you, an' dry the orphant's tear,  
An' he'p the pore an' needy ones 'at clusters all about,  
Er the Gobble-uns'll git you

Ef you  
Don't  
Watch  
Out!

*James Whitcomb Riley.*

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## A VISIT FROM ST. NICHOLAS

'Twas the night before Christmas, when all through the house  
Not a creature was stirring, not even a mouse;  
The stockings were hung by the chimney with care,  
In hopes that St. Nicholas soon would be there;  
The children were nestled all snug in their beds,  
While visions of sugar-plums danced in their heads;  
And mamma in her kerchief, and I in my cap,  
Had just settled our brains for a long winter's nap,  
When out on the lawn there arose such a clatter,  
I sprang from the bed to see what was the matter.  
Away to the window I flew like a flash,  
Tore open the shutters, and threw up the sash.  
The moon on the breast of the new-fallen snow  
Gave a luster of mid-day to objects below,  
When, what to my wondering eyes should appear,  
But a miniature sleigh, and eight tiny reindeer,  
With a little old driver, so lively and quick,  
I knew in a moment it must be St. Nick.  
More rapid than eagles his coursers they came,  
And he whistled, and shouted, and called them by name;  
"Now, *Dasher!* now, *Dancer!* now, *Prancer* and *Vixen!*  
On, *Comet!* on, *Cupid!* on, *Dunder* and *Blitzen!*  
To the top of the porch! To the top of the wall!  
Now, dash away! Dash away! Dash away all!"  
As dry leaves that before the wild hurricane fly,  
When they meet with an obstacle, mount to the sky;  
So up to the housetop the coursers they flew,  
With the sleigh full of toys, and St. Nicholas, too.  
And then in a twinkling, I heard on the roof  
The prancing and pawing of each little hoof.  
As I drew in my head, and was turning around,  
Down the chimney St. Nicholas came with a bound.  
He was dressed all in fur, from his head to his foot,  
And his clothes were all tarnished with ashes and soot;

A bundle of toys he had flung on his back,  
And he looked like a peddler just opening his pack.  
His eyes—how they twinkled!—his dimples how merry!  
His cheeks were like roses, his nose like a cherry!  
His droll little mouth was drawn up like a bow,  
And the beard of his chin was as white as the snow;  
The stump of a pipe he held tight in his teeth,  
And the smoke it encircled his head like a wreath;  
He had a broad face and a round little belly,  
That shook when he laughed like a bowlful of jelly.  
He was chubby and plump, a right jolly old elf,  
And I laughed when I saw him, in spite of myself;  
A wink of his eye and a twist of his head,  
Soon gave me to know I had nothing to dread;  
He spoke not a word, but went straight to his work,  
And filled all the stockings; then turned with a jerk,  
And laying his finger aside of his nose,  
And giving a nod, up the chimney he rose;  
He sprang to his sleigh, to his team gave a whistle,  
And away they all flew like the down of a thistle;  
But I heard him exclaim, ere he drove out of sight,  
*"Happy Christmas to all, and to all a good night!"*

*Clement Clarke Moore.*

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## **A NURSERY LEGEND**

Oh! listen, little children, to a proper little song  
Of a naughty little urchin who was always doing wrong:  
He disobey'd his mammy, and he disobey'd his dad,  
And he disobey'd his uncle, which was very near as bad.  
He wouldn't learn to cipher, and he wouldn't learn to write,  
But he *would* tear up his copy-books to fabricate a kite;  
And he used his slate and pencil in so barbarous a way,

That the grinders of his governess got looser ev'ry day.

At last he grew so obstinate that no one could contrive  
To cure him of a theory that two and two made five  
And, when they taught him how to spell, he show'd his wicked whims  
By mutilating Pinnock and mislaying Watts's Hymns.  
Instead of all such pretty books, (which *must* improve the mind,)  
He cultivated volumes of a most improper kind;  
Directories and almanacks he studied on the sly,  
And gloated over Bradshaw's Guide when nobody was by.

From such a course of reading you can easily divine  
The condition of his morals at the age of eight or nine.  
His tone of conversation kept becoming worse and worse,  
Till it scandalised his governess and horrified his nurse.  
He quoted bits of Bradshaw that were quite unfit to hear,  
And recited from the Almanack, no matter who was near:  
He talked of Reigate Junction and of trains both up and down,  
And referr'd to men who call'd themselves Jones, Robinson, and Brown.

But when this naughty boy grew up he found the proverb true,  
That Fate one day makes people pay for all the wrong they do.  
He was cheated out of money by a man whose name was Brown,  
And got crippled in a railway smash while coming up to town.  
So, little boys and little girls, take warning while you can,  
And profit by the history of this unhappy man.  
Read Dr. Watts and Pinnock, dears; and when you learn to spell,  
Shun Railway Guides, Directories, and Almanacks as well!

*Henry S. Leigh.*

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## **A LITTLE GOOSE**

The chill November day was done,  
The working world home faring;  
The wind came roaring through the streets  
And set the gas-lights flaring;  
And hopelessly and aimlessly  
The scared old leaves were flying;  
When, mingled with the sighing wind,  
I heard a small voice crying.

And shivering on the corner stood  
A child of four, or over;  
No cloak or hat her small, soft arms,  
And wind blown curls to cover.  
Her dimpled face was stained with tears;  
Her round blue eyes ran over;  
She cherished in her wee, cold hand,  
A bunch of faded clover.

And one hand round her treasure while  
She slipped in mine the other:  
Half scared, half confidential, said,  
"Oh! please, I want my mother!"  
"Tell me your street and number, pet:  
Don't cry, I'll take you to it."  
Sobbing she answered, "I forget:  
The organ made me do it.

"He came and played at Milly's steps,  
The monkey took the money;  
And so I followed down the street,  
The monkey was so funny.  
I've walked about a hundred hours,  
From one street to another:  
The monkey's gone, I've spoiled my flowers,  
Oh! please, I want my mother."

"But what's your mother's name? and what  
The street? Now think a minute."  
"My mother's name is mamma dear—  
The street—I can't begin it."  
"But what is strange about the house,  
Or new—not like the others?"  
"I guess you mean my trundle-bed,  
Mine and my little brother's.

"Oh dear! I ought to be at home  
To help him say his prayers,—  
He's such a baby he forgets;  
And we are both such players;—  
And there's a bar to keep us both  
From pitching on each other,  
For Harry rolls when he's asleep:  
Oh dear! I want my mother."

The sky grew stormy; people passed  
All muffled, homeward faring:  
"You'll have to spend the night with me,"  
I said at last, despairing,  
I tied a kerchief round her neck—  
"What ribbon's this, my blossom?"  
"Why don't you know!" she smiling, said,  
And drew it from her bosom.

A card with number, street, and name;  
My eyes astonished met it;  
"For," said the little one, "you see  
I might sometimes forget it:  
And so I wear a little thing  
That tells you all about it;  
For mother says she's very sure  
I should get lost without it."

*Eliza Sproat Turner.*

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## LEEDLE YAWCOB STRAUSS

I haf von funny leedle poy,  
Vot comes schust to mine knee;  
Der queerest schap, der createst rogue,  
As efer you dit see.  
He runs, und schumps, und schmashes dings  
In all barts off der house:  
But vot off dot? He vas mine son,  
Mine leedle Yawcob Strauss.

He get der measles und der mumbs  
And eferyding dot's oudt;  
He sbills mine glass off lager bier,  
Poots schnuff indo mine kraut.  
He fills mine pipe mit Limburg cheese—  
Dot vas der roughest chouse;  
I'd dake dot vrom no oder poy  
But leedle Yawcob Strauss.

He dakes der milk-ban for a dhrum,  
Und cuts mine cane in dwo,  
To make der schticks to beat it mit—  
Mine cracious, dot vas drue!  
I dinks mine hed vas schplit abart,  
He kicks oup sooch a touse:  
But nefer mind; der poys vas few  
Like dot young Yawcob Strauss.

He asks me questions sooch as dese:  
Who baints mine nose so red?  
Who vas it cuts dot schmoodth blace oudt  
Vrom der hair ubon mine hed?  
Und vere dere plaze goes vrom her lamp

Vene'er der glim I douse.  
How gan I all dose dings eggsblain  
To dot schmall Yawcob Strauss?

I somedimes dink I schall go vild  
Mit sooch a grazzy poy,  
Und vish vonce more I gould haf rest,  
Und beaceful dimes enshoy;  
But ven he vas aschleep in ped  
So quiet as a mouse,  
I prays der Lord, "Dake anyding,  
But leaf dot Yawcob Strauss."

*Charles Follen Adams.*

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## **A PARENTAL ODE TO MY SON, AGED THREE YEARS AND FIVE MONTHS**

Thou happy, happy elf!  
(But stop,—first let me kiss away that tear)—  
Thou tiny image of myself!  
(My love, he's poking peas into his ear!)  
Thou merry, laughing sprite!  
With spirits feather-light,  
Untouched by sorrow, and unsoiled by sin—  
(Good Heavens! the child is swallowing a pin!)

Thou little tricky Puck!  
With antic toys so funnily bestuck,  
Light as the singing bird that wings the air—  
(The door! the door! he'll tumble down the stair!)  
Thou darling of thy sire!  
(Why, Jane, he'll set his pinafore afire!)

Thou imp of mirth and joy!  
In love's dear chain, so strong and bright a link,  
Thou idol of thy parents—(Drat the boy!  
There goes my ink!)

Thou cherub—but of earth;  
Fit playfellow for Fays, by moonlight pale,  
In harmless sport and mirth,  
(That dog will bite him if he pulls its tail!)  
Thou human humming-bee, extracting honey  
From every blossom in the world that blows,  
Singing in youth's elysium ever sunny,  
(Another tumble!—that's his precious nose!)

Thy father's pride and hope!  
(He'll break the mirror with that skipping-rope!)  
With pure heart newly stamped from Nature's mint—  
(Where *did* he learn that squint?)  
Thou young domestic dove!  
(He'll have that jug off with another shove!)  
Dear nursling of the Hymeneal nest!  
(Are those torn clothes his best?)  
Little epitome of man!  
(He'll climb upon the table, that's his plan!)  
Touched with the beauteous tints of dawning life  
(He's got a knife!)

Thou enviable being!  
No storms, no clouds, in thy blue sky foreseeing,  
Play on, play on,  
My elfin John!  
Toss the light ball—bestride the stick—  
(I knew so many cakes would make him sick!)  
With fancies, buoyant as the thistle-down,  
Prompting the face grotesque, and antic brisk,  
With many a lamb-like frisk,  
(He's got the scissors, snipping at your gown!)



Thou pretty opening rose!  
(Go to your mother, child, and wipe your nose!)  
Balmy and breathing music like the South,  
(He really brings my heart into my mouth!)  
Fresh as the morn, and brilliant as its star,—  
(I wish that window had an iron bar!)  
Bold as the hawk, yet gentle as the dove,—  
(I'll tell you what, my love,  
I cannot write unless he's sent above!)

*Thomas Hood.*

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## **LITTLE MAMMA**

Why is it the children don't love me  
As they do Mamma?  
That they put her ever above me—  
"Little Mamma?"  
I'm sure I do all that I can do,  
What more can a rather big man do,  
Who can't be Mamma—  
Little Mamma?

Any game that the tyrants suggest,  
"Logomachy,"—which I detest,—  
Doll-babies, hop-scotch, or baseball,  
I'm always on hand at the call.  
When Noah and the others embark,  
I'm the elephant saved in the ark.  
I creep, and I climb, and I crawl—  
By turns am the animals all.  
For the show on the stair

I'm always the bear,  
Chimpanzee, camel, or kangaroo.  
It is never, "Mamma,—  
    *Little* Mamma,—  
    Won't *you*?"

My umbrella's the pony, if any—  
None ride on Mamma's parasol:  
I'm supposed to have always the penny  
For bonbons, and beggars, and all.  
My room is the one where they clatter—  
Am I reading, or writing, what matter!  
My knee is the one for a trot,  
My foot is the stirrup for Dot.  
If his fractions get into a snarl  
Who straightens the tangles for Karl?  
Who bounds Massachusetts and Maine,  
And tries to bound flimsy old Spain?  
    Why,  
    It is *I*,  
    Papa,—  
    Not Little Mamma!

That the youngsters are ingrates don't say.  
I think they love me—in a way—  
As one does the old clock on the stair,—  
Any curious, cumbrous affair  
That one's used to having about,  
And would feel rather lonely without.  
I think that they love me, I say,  
In a sort of a tolerant way;  
    But it's plain that Papa  
    Isn't Little Mamma.

Thus when twilight comes stealing anear,  
When things in the firelight look queer;  
And shadows the playroom enwrap,

They never climb into my lap  
And toy with *my* head, smooth and bare,  
As they do with Mamma's shining hair;  
Nor feel round my throat and my chin  
For dimples to put fingers in;  
Nor lock my neck in a loving vise,  
And say they're "mousies"—that's mice—  
    And will nibble my ears,  
    Will nibble and bite  
With their little mice-teeth, so sharp and so white,  
If I do not kiss them this very minute—  
Don't-wait-a-bit-but-at-once-begin-it—  
    Dear little Papa!  
That's what they say and do to Mamma.

If, mildly hinting, I quietly say that  
Kissing's a game that more can play at,  
They turn up at once those innocent eyes,  
And I suddenly learn to my great surprise  
    That my face has "prickles"—  
    My moustache tickles.  
If, storming their camp, I seize a pert shaver,  
And take as a right what was asked as a favor,  
    It is, "Oh, Papa,  
    How horrid you are—  
You taste exactly like a cigar!"

But though the rebels protest and pout,  
And make a pretence of driving me out,  
I hold, after all, the main redoubt,—  
Not by force of arms nor the force of will,  
But the power of love, which is mightier still.  
And very deep in their hearts, I know,  
Under the saucy and petulant "Oh,"  
The doubtful "Yes," or the naughty "No,"  
    They love Papa.

And down in the heart that no one sees,  
Where I hold my feasts and my jubilees,  
I know that I would not abate one jot  
Of the love that is held by my little Dot  
Or my great big boy for their little Mamma,  
Though out in the cold it crowded Papa.  
I would not abate it the tiniest whit,  
And I am not jealous the least little bit;  
For I'll tell you a secret: Come, my dears,  
And I'll whisper it—right-into-your-ears—  
I, too, love Mamma,  
Little Mamma!

*Charles Henry Webb.*

---

## **THE COMICAL GIRL**

There was a child, as I have been told,  
Who when she was young didn't look very old.  
Another thing, too, some people have said,  
At the top of her body there grew out a head;  
And what perhaps might make some people stare  
Her little bald pate was all covered with hair.  
Another strange thing which made gossipers talk,  
Was that she often attempted to walk.  
And then, do you know, she occasioned much fun  
By moving so fast as sometimes to run.  
Nay, indeed, I have heard that some people say  
She often would smile and often would play.  
And what is a fact, though it seems very odd,  
She had monstrous dislike to the feel of a rod.  
This strange little child sometimes hungry would be  
And then she delighted her victuals to see.

Even drink she would swallow, and though strange it appears  
Whenever she listened it was with her ears.  
With her eyes she could see, and strange to relate  
Her peepers were placed in front of her pate.  
There, too, was her mouth and also her nose,  
And on her two feet were placed her ten toes.  
Her teeth, I've been told, were fixed in her gums,  
And beside having fingers she also had thumbs.  
A droll child she therefore most surely must be,  
For not being blind she was able to see.  
One circumstance more had slipped from my mind  
Which is when not cross she always was kind.  
And, strangest of any that yet I have said,  
She every night went to sleep on her bed.  
And, what may occasion you no small surprise,  
When napping, she always shut close up her eyes.

*M. Pelham.*

---

## **BUNCHES OF GRAPES**

"Bunches of grapes," says Timothy,  
"Pomegranates pink," says Elaine;  
"A junket of cream and a cranberry tart  
For me," says Jane.

"Love-in-a-mist," says Timothy,  
"Primroses pale," says Elaine;  
"A nosegay of pinks and mignonette  
For me," says Jane.

"Chariots of gold," says Timothy,  
"Silvery wings," says Elaine;

"A bumpety ride in a waggon of hay  
For me," says Jane.

*Walter Ramal.*

---



# IMMORTAL STANZAS

## THE PURPLE COW

I never saw a Purple Cow,  
I never hope to see one;  
But I can tell you, anyhow,  
I'd rather see than be one.

*Gelett Burgess.*

---

## THE YOUNG LADY OF NIGER

There was a young lady of Niger  
Who smiled as she rode on a Tiger;  
They came back from the ride  
With the lady inside,  
And the smile on the face of the Tiger.

*Unknown.*

---

## THE LAUGHING WILLOW



To see the Kaiser's epitaph  
Would make a weeping willow laugh.

*Oliver Herford.*

---

## **SAID OPIE READ**

Said Opie Read to E. P. Roe,  
"How do you like Gaboriau?"  
"I like him very much indeed!"  
Said E. P. Roe to Opie Read.

*Julian Street and James Montgomery Flagg.*

---

## **MANILA**

Oh, dewy was the morning, upon the first of May,  
And Dewey was the admiral, down in Manila Bay;  
And dewy were the Regent's eyes, them royal orbs of blue,  
And do we feel discouraged? We do not think we do!

*Eugene F. Ware.*

---

## **ON THE ARISTOCRACY OF HARVARD**

I come from good old Boston,  
The home of the bean and the cod;  
Where the Cabots speak only to Lowells,  
And the Lowells speak only to God!

*Dr. Samuel G. Bushnell.*

---

## **ON THE DEMOCRACY OF YALE**

Here's to the town of New Haven,  
The home of the truth and the light;  
Where God speaks to Jones in the very same tones,  
That he uses with Hadley and Dwight!

*Dean Jones.*

---

## **THE HERRING**

"The Herring he loves the merry moonlight  
And the Mackerel loves the wind,  
But the Oyster loves the dredging song  
For he comes of a gentler kind."

*Sir Walter Scott.*

---

## **IF THE MAN**

If the man who turnips cries,  
Cry not when his father dies,  
'Tis a proof that he had rather  
Have a turnip than his father.

*Samuel Johnson.*

---

## **THE KILKENNY CATS**

There wanst was two cats of Kilkenny,  
Each thought there was one cat too many,  
So they quarrell'd and fit,  
They scratch'd and they bit,  
Till, barrin' their nails,  
And the tips of their tails,  
Instead of two cats, there warnt any.

*Unknown.*

---

## **POOR DEAR GRANDPAPA**

What is the matter with Grandpapa?  
What can the matter be?  
He's broken his leg in trying to spell  
Tommy without a T.

*D'Arcy W. Thompson.*

---

## **MORE WALKS**

Whene'er I take my walks abroad,  
How many rich I see;  
There's A. and B. and C. and D.  
All better off than me!

*Richard Harris Barham.*

---

## **INDIFFERENCE**

The cat is in the parlour,  
The dog is in the lake;  
The cow is in the hammock,—  
What difference does it make?

---

## **MADAME SANS SOUCI**

"Bon jour, Madame Sans Souci;  
Combien coûtent ces soucis ci?"  
"Six sous." "Six sous ces soucis ci!  
C'est trop cher, Madame Sans Souci!"

---

## **A RIDDLE**

The man in the wilderness asked of me  
How many strawberries grew in the sea.  
I answered him as I thought good,  
As many as red herrings grow in the wood.

---

## **IF**

If all the land were apple-pie,  
And all the sea were ink;  
And all the trees were bread and cheese,  
What should we do for drink?

---

## **THE END**

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| I remember, I remember                                    | <a href="#">107</a> |
| I reside at Table Mountain, and my name is Truthful James | <a href="#">650</a> |
| I said, "This horse, sir, will you shoe?"                 | <a href="#">809</a> |
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| I saw a certain sailorman who sat beside the sea          | <a href="#">70</a>  |
| I saw a peacock with a fiery tail                         | <a href="#">804</a> |
| I sent for Ratcliffe; was so ill                          | <a href="#">365</a> |
| I sent my love a parcel                                   | <a href="#">262</a> |
| I shall not ask Jean Jacques Rousseau                     | <a href="#">212</a> |
| I sometimes think I'd rather crow                         | <a href="#">891</a> |
| I strolled beside the shining sea                         | <a href="#">844</a> |
| I tell thee, Dick, where I have been                      | <a href="#">704</a> |
| I walked and came upon a picket fence                     | <a href="#">470</a> |
| I was in Margate last July. I walk'd upon the pier        | <a href="#">558</a> |
| I wonder what your thoughts are, little cloud             | <a href="#">134</a> |
| I would all womankind were dead                           | <a href="#">88</a>  |
| I would flee from the city's rule and law                 | <a href="#">883</a> |
| I would that all men my hard case might know              | <a href="#">397</a> |
| I wrote some lines once on a time                         | <a href="#">38</a>  |
| I wus mighty good-lookin' when I was young                | <a href="#">129</a> |

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| I'd Never Dare to Walk across                            | <a href="#"><u>855</u></a> |
| I'd read three hours. Both notes and text                | <a href="#"><u>142</u></a> |
| If all be true that I do think                           | <a href="#"><u>364</u></a> |
| If all the harm women have done                          | <a href="#"><u>248</u></a> |
| If all the land were apple-pie                           | <a href="#"><u>951</u></a> |
| If all the trees in all the woods were men               | <a href="#"><u>238</u></a> |
| If down his throat a man should choose                   | <a href="#"><u>844</u></a> |
| If e'er my rhyming be at fault                           | <a href="#"><u>55</u></a>  |
| If ever there lived a Yankee lad                         | <a href="#"><u>690</u></a> |
| If I go to see the play                                  | <a href="#"><u>48</u></a>  |
| If I should die to-night                                 | <a href="#"><u>489</u></a> |
| If I were thine, I'd fail not of endeavour               | <a href="#"><u>345</u></a> |
| If I were you, when ladies at the play, Sir              | <a href="#"><u>146</u></a> |
| If, in the month of dark December                        | <a href="#"><u>80</u></a>  |
| If life were never bitter                                | <a href="#"><u>436</u></a> |
| If the man who turnips cries                             | <a href="#"><u>949</u></a> |
| If there is a vile, pernicious                           | <a href="#"><u>60</u></a>  |
| If thou wouldst stand on Etna's burning brow             | <a href="#"><u>445</u></a> |
| If we square a lump of pemmican                          | <a href="#"><u>880</u></a> |
| If you become a nun, dear                                | <a href="#"><u>206</u></a> |
| I'll sing you a song, not very long                      | <a href="#"><u>275</u></a> |
| I'll tell thee everything I can                          | <a href="#"><u>870</u></a> |
| I'm taught p-l-o-u-g-h                                   | <a href="#"><u>761</u></a> |
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| "Immortal Newton never spoke                             | <a href="#"><u>369</u></a> |
| In a church which is furnish'd with mullion and gable, I | <a href="#"><u>280</u></a> |
| In a Devonshire lane as I trotted along                  | <a href="#"><u>266</u></a> |
| In all thy humors, whether grave or mellow               | <a href="#"><u>368</u></a> |
| In an ocean, 'way out yonder                             | <a href="#"><u>929</u></a> |
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| In candent ire the solar splendour flames                | <a href="#"><u>849</u></a> |
| In days of peace my fellow-men                           | <a href="#"><u>31</u></a>  |
| In early youth, as you may guess                         | <a href="#"><u>918</u></a> |
| In form and feature, face and limb                       | <a href="#"><u>108</u></a> |
| In heaven a spirit doth dwell                            | <a href="#"><u>472</u></a> |
| In his chamber, weak and dying                           | <a href="#"><u>785</u></a> |
| In Köln, a town of monks and bones                       | <a href="#"><u>363</u></a> |
| In letters large upon the frame                          | <a href="#"><u>347</u></a> |
| In London I never know what I'd be at                    | <a href="#"><u>265</u></a> |
| In our hearts is the Great One of Avon                   | <a href="#"><u>824</u></a> |
| In the age that was golden, the halcyon time             | <a href="#"><u>338</u></a> |
| In the "Foursome" some would fain                        | <a href="#"><u>222</u></a> |
| In the lonesome latter years                             | <a href="#"><u>429</u></a> |
| In these days of indigestion                             | <a href="#"><u>77</u></a>  |
| "In winter, when the fields are white                    | <a href="#"><u>872</u></a> |
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| Interred beneath this marble stone                       | <a href="#"><u>765</u></a> |
| Is moss-prankt dells which the sunbeams flatter          | <a href="#"><u>372</u></a> |
| It is told, on Buddhi-theosophic schools                 | <a href="#"><u>92</u></a>  |
| It is very aggravating                                   | <a href="#"><u>50</u></a>  |
| It looked extremely rocky for the Mudville nine that day | <a href="#"><u>601</u></a> |
| It may be so—perhaps thou hast                           | <a href="#"><u>236</u></a> |
| It once might have been, once only                       | <a href="#"><u>339</u></a> |
| It was a millinger most gay                              | <a href="#"><u>186</u></a> |
| It was a Moorish maiden was sitting by the well          | <a href="#"><u>196</u></a> |
| It was a robber's daughter, and her name was Alice Brown | <a href="#"><u>639</u></a> |
| It was a summer's evening                                | <a href="#"><u>252</u></a> |
| It was a tall young oysterman lived by the river-side    | <a href="#"><u>583</u></a> |
| It was an artless Bandar, and he danced upon a pine      | <a href="#"><u>904</u></a> |
| It was a hairy oubit, sac proud he crept alabg           | <a href="#"><u>330</u></a> |
| It was in a pleasant deepô, sequestered from the rain    | <a href="#"><u>613</u></a> |

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| It was many and many a year ago                 | <a href="#"><u>532</u></a> |
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| It worries me to beat the band                  | <a href="#"><u>137</u></a> |
| Its eyes are gray                               | <a href="#"><u>121</u></a> |
| I've been trying to fashion a wifely ideal      | <a href="#"><u>68</u></a>  |
| Jacob! I do not like to see thy nose            | <a href="#"><u>914</u></a> |
| Jem writes his verses with more speed           | <a href="#"><u>363</u></a> |
| Jim Bowker, he said, if he'd had a fair show    | <a href="#"><u>357</u></a> |
| John Alcohol, my foe, John                      | <a href="#"><u>529</u></a> |
| John Bull for pastime took a prance             | <a href="#"><u>808</u></a> |
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| Lady Clara Vere de Vere!                        | <a href="#"><u>412</u></a> |
| Lady, I loved you all last year                 | <a href="#"><u>327</u></a> |
| Lady mine, most fair thou art                   | <a href="#"><u>221</u></a> |
| Lady, very fair are you                         | <a href="#"><u>184</u></a> |
| Lanty was in love, you see                      | <a href="#"><u>208</u></a> |
| Last year I trod these fields with Di           | <a href="#"><u>155</u></a> |
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| Lest it may more quarrels breed                 | <a href="#"><u>279</u></a> |
| Life and the Universe show spontaneity          | <a href="#"><u>315</u></a> |
| Life is a gift that most of us hold dear        | <a href="#"><u>357</u></a> |
| Life would be an easy matter                    | <a href="#"><u>57</u></a>  |
| Lilies, lilies, white lilies and yellow         | <a href="#"><u>379</u></a> |
| Like to the thundering tone of unspoke speeches | <a href="#"><u>848</u></a> |
| Little bopeepals                                | <a href="#"><u>324</u></a> |
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| Little Penelope Socrates                                      | <a href="#"><u>284</u></a> |
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| Lord Erskine, at women presuming to rail                      | <a href="#"><u>366</u></a> |
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| Marry, I lent my gossip my mare, to fetch home coals          | <a href="#"><u>807</u></a> |
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| Men, Dying, make their wills, but wives                       | <a href="#"><u>362</u></a> |
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| Miss Flora McFlimsey, of Madison Square                       | <a href="#"><u>148</u></a> |
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| My brother Jack was nine in May                               | <a href="#"><u>390</u></a> |
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| My dear young friend, whose shining wit                       | <a href="#"><u>42</u></a>  |
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| My Heart will break—I'm sure it will                          | <a href="#"><u>183</u></a> |
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| My Love has sicklied unto Loath                               | <a href="#"><u>410</u></a> |
| My Madeline! my Madeline!                                     | <a href="#"><u>773</u></a> |
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| My William was a soldier, and he says to me, says he                   | <a href="#">598</a> |
| Mysterious Nothing! how shall I define                                 | <a href="#">786</a> |
| Nay, I cannot come into the garden just now                            | <a href="#">188</a> |
| "Needy Knife-grinder! whither are you going?                           | <a href="#">249</a> |
| Night saw the crew like pedlars with their packs                       | <a href="#">841</a> |
| No fault in women, to refuse                                           | <a href="#">166</a> |
| No longer, O scholars, shall Platus                                    | <a href="#">826</a> |
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| No usual words can bear the woe I feel                                 | <a href="#">379</a> |
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| O cool in the summer is salad                                          | <a href="#">436</a> |
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| O for a lodge in a garden of cucumbers!                                | <a href="#">781</a> |
| O, if my love offended me                                              | <a href="#">184</a> |
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| O mickle yeuks the keckle doup                                         | <a href="#">384</a> |
| O my earliest love, who, ere I number'd                                | <a href="#">116</a> |
| O nymph with the nicest of noses                                       | <a href="#">544</a> |
| O precious code, volume, tome                                          | <a href="#">825</a> |
| O reverend sir, I do declare                                           | <a href="#">195</a> |
| O say, have you seen at the willows so green                           | <a href="#">921</a> |
| O Season supposed of all free flowers                                  | <a href="#">527</a> |
| O the quietest home on earth had I                                     | <a href="#">720</a> |
| O thou wha in the heavens dost dwell                                   | <a href="#">272</a> |
| O what harper could worthily harp it                                   | <a href="#">64</a>  |
| O'er the men of Ethiopia she would pour her cornucopia                 | <a href="#">160</a> |
| Of all life's plagues I recommend to no man                            | <a href="#">76</a>  |
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| Of all the men one meets about                                                  | <a href="#">370</a> |
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| Of all the wimming doubly blest                                                 | <a href="#">241</a> |
| Of priests we can offer a charmin' variety                                      | <a href="#">719</a> |
| Oh, but she was dark and shrill                                                 | <a href="#">509</a> |
| Oh, dewy was the morning, upon the first of May                                 | <a href="#">949</a> |
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| Oh! I have loved thee fondly, ever                                              | <a href="#">732</a> |
| Oh, I know a certain woman who is reckoned with the good                        | <a href="#">132</a> |
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| Oh, I want to win me hame                                                       | <a href="#">385</a> |
| Oh listen, little children, to a proper little song                             | <a href="#">937</a> |
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| Oh, Mary had a little lamb, regarding whose cuticular                           | <a href="#">477</a> |
| Oh, my Geraldine                                                                | <a href="#">180</a> |
| Oh, sing a song of phosphates                                                   | <a href="#">324</a> |
| Oh, solitude thou wonder-working fay                                            | <a href="#">457</a> |
| Oh, tell me have you ever seen a red, long-leg'd Flamingo?                      | <a href="#">894</a> |
| Oh that my soul a marrow-bone might seize!                                      | <a href="#">851</a> |
| Oh, the days were ever shiny                                                    | <a href="#">204</a> |
| Oh, the fisherman is a happy wight!                                             | <a href="#">81</a>  |
| Oh, the Roman was a rogue                                                       | <a href="#">753</a> |
| "Oh, 'tis time I should talk to your mother                                     | <a href="#">181</a> |
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| Oh, what a fund of joy jocund lies hid in harmless hoaxes!                      | <a href="#">26</a>  |
| "Oh! what is that comes gliding in                                              | <a href="#">800</a> |
| Oh, what's the way to Arcady?                                                   | <a href="#">201</a> |
| Oh, Wing Tee Wee                                                                | <a href="#">139</a> |
| Oh, would that working I might shun                                             | <a href="#">47</a>  |
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| Old Nick, who taught the village school                | <a href="#"><u>174</u></a> |
| On wan dark night on Lac St. Pierre                    | <a href="#"><u>662</u></a> |
| On me he shall ne'er put a ring                        | <a href="#"><u>191</u></a> |
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| On the eighth day of March it was, some people say     | <a href="#"><u>58</u></a>  |
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| One evening while reclining                            | <a href="#"><u>268</u></a> |
| One morning when Spring was in her teens               | <a href="#"><u>188</u></a> |
| One of the kings of Scanderoon                         | <a href="#"><u>578</u></a> |
| One stormy morn I chanced to meet                      | <a href="#"><u>123</u></a> |
| One, who is not, we see; but one, whom we see not, is  | <a href="#"><u>458</u></a> |
| Or ever a lick of Art was done                         | <a href="#"><u>383</u></a> |
| Out of the clothes that cover me                       | <a href="#"><u>471</u></a> |
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| Out rode from his wild, dark castle                    | <a href="#"><u>49</u></a>  |
| Out upon it, I have loved                              | <a href="#"><u>218</u></a> |
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| Paddy McCabe was dying one day                         | <a href="#"><u>307</u></a> |
| Peerless yet hapless maid of Q!                        | <a href="#"><u>787</u></a> |
| Perchance it was her eyes of blue                      | <a href="#"><u>74</u></a>  |
| Perhaps you may a-noticed I been soht o' solemn lately | <a href="#"><u>157</u></a> |
| Philosophy shows us 'twixt monkey and man              | <a href="#"><u>92</u></a>  |
| Ph, it's H-A-P-P-Y I am, and it's F-R-double-E         | <a href="#"><u>816</u></a> |
| Poor Lucy Lake was overgrown                           | <a href="#"><u>463</u></a> |
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| Pour varlet, pour the water                            | <a href="#"><u>486</u></a> |
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| Qui nune dancere vult modo                               | <a href="#"><u>832</u></a> |
| Quixotic is his enterprise and hopeless his adventure is | <a href="#"><u>25</u></a>  |
| Quoth John to Joan, will thou have me                    | <a href="#"><u>217</u></a> |
| Rain on the face of the sea                              | <a href="#"><u>427</u></a> |
| Remembering his taste for blood                          | <a href="#"><u>893</u></a> |
| Roll on, thou ball, roll on!                             | <a href="#"><u>256</u></a> |
| Rooster her sign                                         | <a href="#"><u>414</u></a> |
| Row-diddy, dow de, my little sis                         | <a href="#"><u>670</u></a> |
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| Say there! P'r'aps                                       | <a href="#"><u>652</u></a> |
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| Sez Alderman Grady                                       | <a href="#"><u>232</u></a> |
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| Shepherd. Echo, I wean, will in the woods reply          | <a href="#"><u>752</u></a> |
| She kept her secret well, oh, yes                        | <a href="#"><u>158</u></a> |
| She stood beneath the mistletoe                          | <a href="#"><u>196</u></a> |
| She went around and asked subscriptions                  | <a href="#"><u>167</u></a> |
| Side by side in the crowded streets                      | <a href="#"><u>393</u></a> |
| Sin, I admit your general rule                           | <a href="#"><u>363</u></a> |
| Since for kissing thee, Minguillo                        | <a href="#"><u>122</u></a> |
| Sing for the garish eye                                  | <a href="#"><u>875</u></a> |
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| Sleep, my own darling                               | <a href="#"><u>932</u></a> |
| Slim feet than lilies tenderer                      | <a href="#"><u>477</u></a> |
| Sly Beelzebub took all occasions                    | <a href="#"><u>364</u></a> |
| So slowly you walk, and so quickly you eat          | <a href="#"><u>369</u></a> |
| So that's Cleopathera's Needle, bedad               | <a href="#"><u>105</u></a> |
| Some ladies now make pretty songs                   | <a href="#"><u>367</u></a> |
| Some poets sing of sweethearts dead                 | <a href="#"><u>223</u></a> |
| Speak gently to the herring and kindly to the calf  | <a href="#"><u>891</u></a> |
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| Stiff are the warrior's muscles                     | <a href="#"><u>456</u></a> |
| Strange pie that is almost a passion                | <a href="#"><u>472</u></a> |
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## Transcriber's Notes

Obvious typographical errors have been corrected.

It is not always obvious if verses in the original have been split through pagination; if there is doubt the split has been retained.

['Ode for a Social Meeting'](#) has some words struck out and replaced above with alternatives. This has been represented with the struckout words underlined in red and the alternate words in boxes above. The font of the poem has been switched to monospaced to accurately align the two.

Both "Geoffrey" and "Goeffrey" are used as spellings for Geoffrey Chaucer's name without obvious reason. The spelling has been standardised here to the more commonly accepted (today) version "Geoffrey".

The title of "Spirk, Troll-Derisive" uses both "Troll" and "Throll" throughout the original text. The spelling has been standardised here to "Troll".

"There is no poem in the original beginning ['Oh! Weary mother'](#) and it appears to have been an error. The page reference, '000,' is from the original."

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